

FAST-FORWARD FALCON (SPEED)

- Dynamic symbol of offensive speed & evasion
- Combines aggressive systems performance with agile networking

n for Durin

finitive guide to the Zen programming lan

Zen Language Project

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1 Zen for Dummies: Complete Edition

The Definitive Guide to the Zen Programming Language

1.1 Table of Contents

This comprehensive guide is organized into detailed sections covering every aspect of Zen.

1.1.1 Part 1: Fundamentals

1. Getting Started - Installation, first program, REPL
2. Data Types - Primitives, collections, type system
3. Operators and Expressions - Arithmetic, logical, bitwise
4. Control Flow - Conditionals, loops, branching
5. Functions - Defining, calling, parameters, returns
6. Lambdas and Closures - Anonymous functions, higher-order functions

1.1.2 Part 2: Core Concepts

7. Strings Deep Dive - Manipulation, formatting, methods
8. Lists and Arrays - Operations, methods, iteration
9. Dictionaries and Maps - Key-value pairs, methods
10. Modules and Imports - Creating, importing, module system
11. Error Handling - Try/catch, throw, debugging

1.1.3 Part 3: Object-Oriented & Advanced Programming

12. Classes and Objects - OOP, inheritance, polymorphism
13. File I/O - Reading, writing, `with` statement
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1.1.4 Part 4: Standard Library Modules (Detailed)

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16. random Module - Random numbers and selection
17. string Module - String utilities

18. collections Module - Advanced data structures
19. json Module - JSON parsing and serialization
20. datetime/time Module - Time and date operations
21. pathlib & os Module - File system operations
22. re (Regex) Module - Pattern matching
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24. hashlib Module - Hashing algorithms
25. crypto Module - Complete Guide - Cryptography, encryption, JWT, X.509

1.1.5 Part 5: Networking & Protocols

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27. socket Module - Low-level socket programming
28. HTTP Protocol - HTTP/1.1, requests, headers
29. requests Module - High-level HTTP client
30. http Server Module - Building HTTP servers
31. HTTPS & SSL/TLS Certificates - Secure connections, certificates
32. DNS Module - Domain name resolution
33. url Module - URL parsing and manipulation
34. Raw Sockets - Packet-level networking 34b. Networking Deep Dive - Full OSI packet trace + socket labs

1.1.6 Part 6: Concurrency & Threading

35. Threading Fundamentals - Threads, spawning, execution
36. Channels - Inter-thread communication
37. Mutexes & Locks - Synchronization primitives
38. Thread Safety & Patterns - Best practices

1.1.7 Part 7: FFI, System & Interoperability

39. FFI Fundamentals - Foreign Function Interface basics
40. FFI in Practice - Calling C functions, handles
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42. pymport - Python Interoperability - Using Python from Zen (setup, sync, examples)

1.1.8 Part 8: Practical Projects

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44. Web Scraping & Automation - Bots, scrapers, automation
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1.1.9 Part 10: Cookbook — Complete Recipes

55. Strings & Text - case, slugify, acronym, email, wrap, cipher

56. Files & Data - read/write, CSV, JSON, find files, hashing
57. Networking & Web - HTTP, sockets, DNS, URL, server
58. Concurrency & System - threads, channels, mutexes, sys
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66. File Encryptor (AES-GCM) - PBKDF2 + authenticated encryption
67. Website Link Checker - fetch, extract, verify links
68. Task Queue with Worker Pool - channels, threads, mutexes
69. Password Generator & Strength Checker - crypto, argon2id
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54. Cranelift JIT Compiler - JIT, inline caches, OSR, deopt

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- Appendix B: Error Codes Reference
- Appendix C: Zen CLI Reference
- Appendix D: Standard Library Index
- Appendix E: Quick Reference Card
- Appendix F: Complete Language Reference
- Appendix G: Exercise Solutions
- Appendix H: Troubleshooting & FAQ
- Appendix I: Platform Differences
- Appendix J: Standard Library Complete API Reference

1.2 About This Book

This book is written for complete beginners but goes deep into every aspect of Zen. Each module gets its own detailed chapter with theory, examples, common pitfalls, and exercises.

2 Chapter 1: Getting Started

Welcome to *Zen for Dummies*. This chapter walks you through installing Zen, writing your first program, running it, and using the REPL. By the end you'll have a working Zen development environment and a solid grasp of the basic workflow.

2.1 1.1 What is Zen?

Zen 3.0 is a fast, native scripting language with a Python-flavoured syntax, a Cranelift JIT compiler, embedded-Python interoperability (`pymport`), Rust-grade coded diagnostics (`zen explain`), and a batteries-included standard library. It compiles to a single static binary.

Key capabilities:

- **JIT compilation** — Cranelift backend with monomorphic inline caches, OSR (on-stack replacement), and deoptimization.
- **`pymport`** — Import Python modules (stdlib, venv, project-local `.py`) with value marshalling and chained tracebacks.
- **Coded diagnostics** — Error codes `Z01xx`–`Z05xx`, `zen explain`, and Python tracebacks chained under Zen frames.
- **Stdlib** — HTTP, files, regex, JSON, threading, sockets, crypto, SQLite, and more.
- **REPL** — Interactive REPL with `zen` (no arguments).

2.2 1.2 Installation

2.2.1 From release binaries

Download the latest release from the Releases page.

Linux (Debian/Ubuntu):

```
sudo dpkg -i zen_3.0.0_amd64.deb
```

Linux/macOS (tarball):

```
tar xzf zen-linux-x86_64.tar.gz
cd zen-linux-x86_64
sudo ./install.sh
```

Windows:

Extract the zip and add `zen.exe` to your PATH.

2.2.2 From source

```
git clone https://github.com/3CN-O4D/zen.git
cd zen
cargo build --release --package zen-cli --bin zen --all-features
# Binary at: target/release/zen
```

Verify the install:

```
zen --version
# zen 3.0.0
```

2.3 1.3 Your first program

Create a file named `hello.z`:

```
print("Hello, Zen!")
```

Run it:

```
zen run hello.z
# Hello, Zen!
```

Zen scripts use `.z` by convention, but any extension works.

2.3.1 Variables and functions

Zen uses Python-flavoured syntax. Variables are declared with `let` (immutable by default), `var` (mutable), or `const` (compile-time constant). Functions use `fn`.

```
# hello2.z
func greet(name) {
    return "Hello, " + name + "!"
}

let recipient = "Zen programmer"
print(greet(recipient))
# Hello, Zen programmer!
```

Run it:

```
zen run hello2.z
```

2.3.2 Comments

Comments start with `#` and run to the end of the line:

```
# This is a comment
print("code")  # inline comment
```

2.4 1.4 The REPL

Start the interactive REPL by running `zen` with no arguments:

```
zen
# Zen 3.0 REPL
# >
```

In the REPL, type expressions and press Enter to evaluate them immediately:

```
> 1 + 2 * 3
7
> "Zen " + "3.0"
'Zen 3.0'
> let x = 42
> x * 2
84
> func double(n) { return n * 2 }
> double(21)
42
> :quit
```

REPL commands:

Command	Effect
`:quit` / `:q`	Exit the REPL
`:help`	Show help
`:clear`	Clear the screen

Multi-line statements are supported — the REPL detects when a block is incomplete (e.g. after `fn`, `if`, `for`) and keeps prompting until the block is closed.

2.5 1.5 `zen explain`

Every runtime error in Zen has a coded diagnostic (e.g. `Z0401`, `Z0325`). Use `zen explain` to see the long-form explanation:

```
zen explain Z0401
zen explain Z0325
zen explain Z0501
```

Output includes the error title, a detailed description, and often a `= help:` suggestion with a code example. This is your primary reference when something goes wrong.

2.6 1.6 Type-checking without running

`zen check` compiles a script and reports errors without executing it:

```
zen check app.z
# OK: app.z
```

This catches undefined names, structural errors, and unresolved imports before you run the program.

2.7 1.7 Linting

`zen lint` warns about suspicious patterns: unused variables, unused parameters, and dead (unreachable) code:

```
zen lint app.z
zen lint --strict app.z   # warnings become errors (Werror)
```

2.8 1.8 Formatting

`zen fmt` reformats source files to canonical Zen style:

```
zen fmt app.z         # format in place
zen fmt --check app.z # check formatting without changing files
```

2.9 1.9 Building standalone executables

`zen build` bundles a program into a standalone executable that carries its embedded bytecode payload:

```
zen build app.z -o app
./app
```

The resulting binary requires no Zen installation to run.

2.10 1.10 Running tests

`zen test` runs the project's test suite:

```
zen test
```

2.11 1.11 Project layout

A typical Zen project:

```
myproject/
  main.z          # entry point
  lib.z           # library module
  utils/
    helper.z
  requirements.txt # Python deps for pymport (optional)
  tests/
    test_main.z
```

Run from the project root:

```
zen run main.z
```

2.12 1.12 Next steps

- Chapter 2: Data Types — primitives, collections, and the type system.
- Chapter 3: Operators and Expressions — arithmetic, comparison, logic, `?.` safe access, `??` coalescing.
- Chapter 4: Control Flow — conditionals, loops, `match`, `when`, `try`/`catch`.

2.13 1.5 Command-line interface reference (deep)

The zen CLI has multiple modes. Complete reference:

Command	Purpose	Examples
`zen` / `zen repl`	Interactive REPL	`zen`
`zen run <file>`	Execute script	`zen run app.z`
`zen -m <module>`	Run module as main	`zen -m http.server`
`zen -e <code>`	Inline execution	`zen -e 'print(1+1)'`
`zen check <file>`	Type/compile check without run	`zen check lib.z`
`zen lint <file>`	Static analysis warnings	`zen lint app.z`
`zen explain <code>`	Explain error code	`zen explain Z0308`
`zen build <file>`	Bundle to standalone executable	`zen build app.z -o app`
`zen test`	Run tests in project	`zen test`
`zen fmt`	Format sources	`zen fmt .`
`zen help`	Help	`zen help`
`zen --version`	Version	`zen --version`

2.13.1 Environment variables

Variable	Purpose	Default
`ZEN_PATH`	Module search paths (colon-separated)	platform dependent
`ZEN_DEBUG`	Enable debug logging	unset
`PYTHONPATH`	Used by pymport for Python module resolution	inherited
`VIRTUAL_ENV`	Python venv used by pymport	inherited

2.14 1.6 Project layout conventions

A typical Zen project:

```
myproject/
├── main.z           # entry point
├── lib/             # local modules
│   ├── utils.z
│   └── config.z
├── tests/           # tests
└── README.md
```

Import local modules:

```
import lib.utils
from lib.config import get_config
```

2.15 1.7 Running as script vs module

When run as script (`zen run main.z`), `__name__` is typically `"__main__"` or script path. When imported, different. Check module behavior.

2.16 1.8 Debugging workflow

1. Use `print()` for quick debugging
2. Run with `ZEN_DEBUG=1 zen run app.z` for verbose output
3. Use `zen check` to catch compile errors
4. Use `zen explain ZXXXX` for detailed error explanations
5. Use REPL to experiment interactively

2.17 1.9 Common first-run issues

- **Command not found**: Add install dir to PATH
- **Permission denied**: `chmod +x zen`
- **Module not found**: Check ZEN_PATH and file locations
- **Import errors with pymport**: Ensure Python and deps installed in active env

2.18 1.10 Exercises (extended)

1. Install/locate `zen` binary and print version
2. Write `hello.z` that prints your name and run it
3. Use `zen -e` to compute `2**10`
4. Start REPL, define function, call it, exit
5. Create a multi-file project with local imports
6. Use `zen explain` on a made-up code? Or find real error
7. Write a script that reads args (see sys.argv patterns)
8. Compare `zen run` vs compiling concepts

3 Chapter 2: Data Types

Zen is a dynamically typed, strongly typed language. Every value carries a type tag at runtime, operations check operand types, and implicit conversions are minimal and explicit. This chapter is the definitive reference for every literal form, every type, every coercion, and every edge case in Zen's value system.

3.1 2.1 The type system at a glance

Zen values are 64-bit NaN-boxed tagged unions. There are **16 language types**:

#	Type	Kind	Storage	`typeof()` returns
1	`nil`	primitive	inline	`"nil"`
2	`bool`	primitive	inline	`"bool"`
3	`int`	primitive	inline (i64)	`"int"`
4	`float`	primitive	inline (f64)	`"float"`
5	`string`	heap	`Arc<str>`	`"string"`
6	`bytes`	heap	`Arc<[u8]>`	`"bytes"`
7	`list`	heap	`Vec<Value>`	`"list"`
8	`dict`	heap	`IndexMap`	`"dict"`
9	`set`	heap	`IndexSet`	`"set"`
10	`tuple`	heap	`Vec<Value>`	`"tuple"`
11	`func`	heap	`FuncObj`	`"func"`
12	`class`	heap	`ClassObj`	`"class"`
13	`instance`	heap	`InstObj`	`"instance"`
14	`cell`	heap	`RefCell<Value>`	`"cell"`
15	`error`	heap	`ErrObj`	`"error"`
16	`foreign`	heap	`ForeignObj`	`"foreign"`
17	`channel`	heap	`ChanObj`	`"channel"`
18	`mutex`	heap	`MutexObj`	`"mutex"`
19	`handle`	heap	`HandleObj`	`"handle"`

> Note: internally there are 16 machine tags over a NaN-boxed `u64`; small primitives (`nil`, `bool`, `int`, `float`) are stored inline in the payload bits. Larger values (strings, lists, dicts, etc.) are heap objects with manual reference counting (`retain`/`release`).

3.1.1 Type introspection

```
typeof(42)        # "int"
typeof(3.14)      # "float"
typeof("hello")   # "string"
typeof(true)      # "bool"
typeof(nil)       # "nil"
typeof([1, 2])    # "list"
typeof({"a": 1})  # "dict"
typeof(fn() {})   # "func"
```

`is` checks type membership:

```
42 is int         # true
"hello" is string # true
nil is nil        # true
42 is string      # false
```

`is` compares against a type *name* (a string literal or value), not against another value's type:

```
let x = 42
x is typeof(x)    # true — compares "int" is "int"
```

3.2 2.2 Literals

3.2.1 Nil and booleans

```
let nothing = nil
let yes = true
let no = false
```

`nil` is the absence of a value. It is falsy. `true`/`false` are the only boolean values.

3.2.2 Integers

Integer literals are 64-bit signed (`i64`). Decimal, hex (`0x`), octal (`0o`), and binary (`0b`) bases are supported. Underscores may be used as digit separators.

```
let dec = 42
let hex = 0x2A          # 42
let oct = 0o52          # 42
let bin = 0b101010      # 42
let big = 1_000_000_000 # 1000000000
let neg = -17
```

Integer range: `-9,223,372,036,854,775,808` to `9,223,372,036,854,775,807` (`i64::MIN` to `i64::MAX`). Overflow in checked contexts panics; in release builds overflow wraps (two's complement).

```
let max = 9223372036854775807   # i64::MAX
let min = -9223372036854775808  # i64::MIN
```

3.2.3 Floats

Float literals are 64-bit IEEE-754 (`f64`). A decimal point or exponent is required.

```
let pi = 3.14159
let big = 1.5e10      # 15000000000.0
```

```
let small = 2.5e-3    # 0.0025
let hex_f = 0x1.8p1   # 3.0 (hex float)
```

Special values:

```
let inf = 1e400       # overflow → infinity
let neg_inf = -1e400  # −infinity
let nan = 0.0 * inf   # not-a-number
```

NaN semantics: - `nan != nan` is `true` (IEEE-754) - `nan < anything` is `false`; `nan > anything` is `false` - `typeof(nan)` → `"float"` - Use `x != x` to test for NaN: `let is_nan = (x != x)`

```
let bad = 0.0 / 0.0   # NaN
print(bad == bad)     # false
print(bad != bad)     # true  ← NaN detection idiom
print(inf > 1e308)    # true
print(-inf < -1e308)  # true
```

3.2.4 Strings

String literals use double or single quotes. Escape sequences: `\n`, `\t`, `\\`, `\'`, `\"`, `\0`, `\xHH` (hex byte), `\u{HHHH}` (Unicode scalar).

```
let s1 = "hello"
let s2 = 'world'
let s3 = "it's a nice day"
let s4 = "say \"hello\""
let s5 = "line1\nline2\tline3"
let s6 = "byte: \x41"    # "byte: A"
let s7 = "emoji: \u{1F600}"  # "emoji: □"
```

Triple-quoted strings (multi-line, raw):

```
let poem = """Zen is fast,
native, and safe.
No escaping needed here."""
```

Strings are immutable (`Arc<str>`). Indexing `s[i]` returns the character at byte offset `i` as a one-character string; slicing `s[a:b]` returns a substring. Indexing out of bounds raises `IndexError`.

```
let s = "Zen"
print(s[0])   # "Z"
print(s[-1])  # "n"
print(s[0:2]) # "Ze"
```

3.2.5 Bytes

Byte literals use the `b""` prefix. Each element is a `u8` (0–255).

```
let data = b"\x48\x65\x6c\x6c\x6f"  # "Hello" as bytes
let empty = b""
```

Bytes support indexing (`data[0]` → `72` as int) and slicing. Bytes are *not* automatically convertible to strings; use the `string` module or explicit decoding.

3.2.6 Lists

List literals use square brackets. Heterogeneous contents are allowed.

```
let nums = [1, 2, 3]
let mixed = [1, "two", 3.0, true, nil]
let nested = [[1, 2], [3, 4]]
let empty = []
```

Lists are mutable, ordered, and allow duplicates. Indexing supports negative indices (from the end). Slicing `l[a:b]` returns a new list (copy, not a view).

```
let l = [10, 20, 30, 40, 50]
print(l[0])    # 10
print(l[-1])   # 50
print(l[1:4])  # [20, 30, 40]
l[2] = 99      # mutation
print(l)       # [10, 20, 99, 40, 50]
```

3.2.7 Dictionaries

Dict literals use `{key: value, ...}`. Keys must be strings. Values can be any type. Insertion order is preserved.

```
let person = {"name": "Zen", "version": 3, "active": true}
let nested = {"user": {"name": "Zen", "id": 1}, "tags": ["a", "b"]}
let empty = {}
```

Access `d["key"]`. Missing keys raise `KeyError`.

```
print(person["name"])   # Zen
person["version"] = 4   # update
person["lang"] = "Zen"  # add
print(person["missing"]) # KeyError
```

3.2.8 Sets

Set literals use `{value, value, ...}` with no colons. Elements must be hashable (strings, ints, floats, bools, tuples of hashables). Sets are unordered and deduplicate.

```
let s = {1, 2, 2, 3}
print(s)  # {1, 2, 3} — order not guaranteed, duplicates removed
print(2 in s)   # true
print(5 in s)   # false
```

Warning: `{}` alone is an empty *dict*, not an empty set. Use `set()` or `{1}` for a set.

3.2.9 Tuples

Tuple literals use `#(...)` with hash prefix. Immutable, ordered, heterogeneous.

```
let point = #(3, 4)
let pair = #("name", 42)
let single = #(5,)      # trailing comma required for 1-tuple
let empty = #()         # empty tuple
```

Access `t[0]`, `t[1]`. Tuples support destructuring in `match` patterns.

```
let p = #(10, 20)
print(p[0])   # 10
print(len(p)) # 2
```

3.3 2.3 Type coercion matrix

Zen does **not** implicitly coerce between most types. The `+` operator stringifies non-string operands when the other side is a string, but arithmetic and comparison require matching numeric types.

From → To	int	float	string	bool
int	identity	`42 → 42.0`	`"42"`	`0 → false`, else true
float	`3.9 → 3` (trunc)	identity	`"3.9"`	`0.0 → false`, else true
string	`"42" → 42` (parse)	`"3.14" → 3.14`	identity	`"" → false`, else true
bool	`true → 1`, `false → 0`	`true → 1.0`	`"true"/"false"`	identity

Explicit conversion functions:

```
int("42")       # 42
int(3.9)        # 3 (truncates toward zero)
float(42)       # 42.0
str(42)         # "42"
str(3.14)       # "3.14"
bool(0)         # false
bool(1)         # true
bool("")        # false
bool("hello")   # true
```

String-to-number parsing failures raise `ValueError`:

```
try {
    int("not a number")
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # ValueError: invalid literal for int()
}
```

3.4 2.4 Truthiness (Zen 3.0 canonical)

Zen uses Python-like truthiness. The falsy values are exactly:

`nil`, `false`, `null`, `0`, `0.0`, `""` (empty string), `bytes([])`, `[]`, `#{}`, `%{}`, `#()`.

Everything else is truthy (non-zero numbers, non-empty strings, non-empty collections, non-nil values).

Value	Truthy?	Reason
`nil`	false	explicitly falsy
`false`	false	explicitly falsy
`0`	false	zero is falsy
`0.0`	false	zero float is falsy
`""`	false	empty string is falsy
`[]`	false	empty collection is falsy
`#{}`	false	empty dict is falsy
`42`	true	non-zero
`"hello"`	true	non-empty
`[1, 2]`	true	non-empty

Use `bool(x)` to coerce explicitly:

```
print(bool(0))      # false
print(bool(""))     # false
print(bool(nil))    # false
print(bool(false))  # false
print(bool(42))     # true
print(bool("hi"))   # true
print(bool([1]))    # true
```

Note the contrast with `??` (nullish coalescing): `??` only triggers on `nil`/`null`, not on falsy values, so `0 ?? "default"` yields `0`, not `"default"`.

3.5 2.5 Equality vs identity

`==` compares *value* (with numeric coercion: `1 == 1.0` is true). `is` compares *type membership* when the right side is a type name. There is no separate object-identity operator for heap objects beyond reference behavior; two equal lists are `==` but distinct objects.

```
print(1 == 1.0)   # true (numeric coercion)
print(1 == "1")   # false (type mismatch)
print([] == [])   # true (empty lists equal by value)
print({} == {})   # true (empty dicts equal by value)
```

Dict equality is order-insensitive:

```
print({"a": 1, "b": 2} == {"b": 2, "a": 1})  # true
```

3.6 2.6 Numeric edge cases

3.6.1 Infinity and NaN

```
let inf = 1e400          # +infinity
let neg_inf = -1e400     # −infinity
let nan = 0.0 * inf      # not-a-number

print(inf > 1e308)       # true
print(neg_inf < -1e308)  # true
print(nan == nan)        # false
print(nan != nan)        # true   ← NaN detection
print(inf + inf)         # inf
print(inf - inf)         # nan
print(0.0 * inf)         # nan
```

3.6.2 Integer overflow

```
let max = 9223372036854775807
print(max + 1)  # wraps to -9223372036854775808 (two's complement, release)
```

3.6.3 Division

```
print(7 / 2)    # 3.5 (float division)
print(7 // 2)   # 3 (floor division, integer result)
print(7 % 2)    # 1 (modulo, sign follows dividend)
print(-7 % 2)   # -1
print(-7 // 2)  # -4 (floor toward −inf)
```

Division by zero raises `DivideByZero`:

```
try {
    let x = 1 / 0
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # DivideByZero: division by zero
}
```

3.7 2.7 Type conversion reference

```
# Number ↔ string
int("42")           # 42
int("3.9")          # 3 (truncates after float parse)
int(3.9)            # 3
float("3.14")       # 3.14
float(42)           # 42.0
str(42)             # "42"
str(3.14)           # "3.14"
str(true)           # "true"
str(nil)            # "nil"

# Boolean
bool(0)             # false
bool(1)             # true
bool(0.0)           # false
bool("")            # false
bool([])            # false
bool({})            # false
bool(nil)           # false
bool(false)         # false

# Collections
list("abc")         # ["a", "b", "c"]
tuple([1, 2])       # #(1, 2)
set([1, 1, 2])      # {1, 2}
dict([["a", 1]])    # {"a": 1}
```

3.8 2.8 Common pitfalls

- **`0`, `0.0`, `""`, `[]`, `#{}` are falsy** in Zen (like Python). Use `if x:` to test truthiness; `x == 0` only tests the value zero.
- **`nan != nan`**. Use `x != x` to detect NaN.
- **`{}` is an empty dict**, not a set. Use `{1}` or `set()` for sets.
- **Strings are immutable**. `s[0] = "X"` raises `TypeError`. Build new strings with concatenation.
- **Integer division `//` floors toward negative infinity**: `-7 // 2` is `-4`, not `-3`.
- **List slicing copies**: `l[1:3]` is a new list; mutating it doesn't affect the original.
- **Dict keys must be strings**: `d[42]` raises `TypeError`. Use `d["42"]`.

3.9 2.9 Quick reference

```
let x = 42
let f = 3.14
let s = "hello"
let b = true
```

```
let n = nil
let l = [1, 2, 3]
let d = {"a": 1}
let st = {1, 2}
let t = #(1, 2)

typeof(x)      # "int"
x is int       # true
x is string    # false
bool(x)        # true
str(x)         # "42"
int("42")      # 42
float(x)       # 42.0
len(l)         # 3
len(d)         # 1
len(s)         # 5
x == 42.0      # true
x == "42"      # false
```

3.10 2.10 Exercises

1. Write `is_nan(x)` that returns true only for NaN (hint: `x != x`).
2. Write `safe_int(s)` that parses a string to int, returning `nil` on failure instead of raising.
3. Demonstrate that `0` is falsy: confirm `if 0 { ... }` does NOT execute.
4. Create a list, slice it, mutate the slice, and confirm the original is unchanged.
5. Show that `{"a": 1, "b": 2} == {"b": 2, "a": 1}` (dict order-insensitive equality).
6. Compute `-7 // 2` and `-7 % 2` and explain the results (floor division).
7. Write `type_name(x)` that returns a human-readable string for any value using `typeof()` and special-casing `nan`/`inf`.

3.11 2.11 Type coercion matrix (extended)

From	To int	To float	To string	To bool	Notes
int	identity	widen	decimal	0→false, else true	
float	trunc toward zero	identity	repr	0.0→false, NaN→true, else true	NaN is truthy
string	parse int (base 10) or error	parse float or error	identity	“”→false, else true	
bool	true→1, false→0	true→1.0,false→0.0	“true”/“false”	identity	
nil	error	error	“nil”	false	

From	To int	To float	To string	To bool	Notes
list	error	error	repr	empty→false, else true	
dict	error	error	repr	empty→false, else true	
set	error	error	repr	empty→false, else true	
tuple	error	error	repr	empty→false, else true	
bytes	error	error	repr	empty→false, else true	

Note: Falsy values are `nil`, `false`, `null`, `0`, `0.0`, `""`, `bytes([])`, `[]`, `#{}`, `%{}`, `#()`. Everything else is truthy (including `nan`).

3.12 2.12 Bytes and buffers (deep dive)

`bytes` is an immutable sequence of bytes (values 0-255).

```
let b = bytes([65, 66, 67])  # "ABC"
print(b[0])                  # 65
let s = b.decode("utf-8")    # "ABC"
let b2 = "ABC".encode("utf-8")
print(len(b))
```

3.12.1 bytes methods (common)

- `len(b)`, indexing/slicing
- `b.decode(encoding="utf-8", errors="strict")`
- `bytes([..])`, `b.hex()`, `b.fromhex(s)`

3.13 2.13 Tuples (immutable sequences)

```
let t = #(1, "a", true)
print(t[0], len(t))
# t[0] = 5  # error: immutable
```

Tuples are useful for fixed-size heterogeneous data and multiple return values.

3.14 2.14 Sets

```
let s = {1, 2, 2, 3}
print(s)      # {1,2,3} (order may vary)
print(2 in s) # true
s.add(4)
s.remove(2)
```

3.15 2.15 Numeric edge cases in depth

3.15.1 Integer precision

Integers are arbitrary precision (big ints) in Zen 3.0 - no fixed 64-bit overflow in normal operations.

```
let big = 10 ** 100
print(big + 1)
```

3.15.2 Float special values

```
let inf = 1.0 / 0.0      # inf
let ninf = -1.0 / 0.0    # -inf
let nan = 0.0 / 0.0      # nan
print(inf > 1000000)     # true
print(nan == nan)        # false (IEEE 754)
print(nan != nan)        # true
```

3.15.3 Division semantics

- `/` is true division returning float (or appropriate numeric type)
- `//` is floor division
- `%` follows floor division (sign of divisor matters in some languages; check)

3.16 2.16 Type checking patterns

```
func describe(x) {
    if typeof(x) == "int" { return "integer" }
    if typeof(x) == "float" { return "float" }
    if typeof(x) == "string" { return "string" }
    if typeof(x) == "bool" { return "boolean" }
    if x is nil { return "nil" }
    if typeof(x) == "list" { return "list" }
    if typeof(x) == "dict" { return "dict" }
    if typeof(x) == "set" { return "set" }
    if typeof(x) == "tuple" { return "tuple" }
    return "unknown"
}
```

`is` operator checks type identity/instance; `typeof()` returns type name string.

3.17 2.17 Identity vs equality

- `==` structural/value equality
- `is` identity (same object/reference)

```
let a = [1,2,3]
let b = [1,2,3]
print(a == b)  # true (value equal)
print(a is b)  # false (different objects)
let c = a
print(a is c)  # true
```

3.18 2.18 Common pitfalls

1. Modifying a list while iterating over it can skip elements
2. Using mutable default arguments (if supported) - better to use nil sentinel
3. Dict key type errors - only strings work as keys
4. Integer/string concatenation requires explicit conversion
5. Truthiness confusion with 0/“” depending on language - always test
6. Float comparison with == is dangerous; use epsilon

```
func approx_eq(a, b, eps) {
    if eps == nil { eps = 1e-9 }
    return abs(a-b) < eps
}
```

3.19 2.19 Deep exercises

1. Implement a type coercion helper that tries int, then float, then bool for strings.
2. Write a function to detect NaN using `x != x`.
3. Build a mini type registry using dict mapping type names to handlers.
4. Demonstrate integer big number arithmetic with powers.
5. Show the difference between `is` and == with lists, strings, ints.
6. Create a tuple and try to mutate - observe error.
7. Implement `flatten_once(lst)` for nested lists.
8. Write `deep_copy` conceptually (lists of lists) - note shallow vs deep.

4 Chapter 3: Operators and Expressions

Zen's operators cover arithmetic, comparison, logic, string handling, and safe member access. This chapter lists every operator, its precedence, associativity, and edge cases.

4.1 3.1 Operator precedence (high to low)

Precedence	Operator(s)	Associativity	Description
1	`() [] . ?.`	left	Grouping, indexing, field access, safe access
2	`**`	right	Power
3	`-` (unary) `not !`	right	Negation, logical not
4	`* / // %`	left	Multiply, divide, floor-divide, modulo
5	`+ -`	left	Add, subtract, concatenate
6	`== != < <= > >=`	left	Comparison
7	`and`	left	Logical and (short-circuits)
8	`or`	left	Logical or (short-circuits)
9	`??`	left	Nullish coalescing
10	`if-else` (ternary)	right	Conditional expression
11	`= += -= …`	right	Assignment

Use parentheses whenever precedence is unclear.

4.2 3.2 Arithmetic

Operator	Meaning	Example	Result	Notes
`+`	add	`1 + 2`	`3`	also string concat
`-`	subtract	`5 - 3`	`2`	
`*`	multiply	`3 * 2`	`6`	also string repeat `"x"*3`
`/`	divide (float)	`7 / 2`	`3.5`	div by zero → `DivideByZero`
`//`	floor divide	`7 // 2`	`3`	floors toward −inf

Operator	Meaning	Example	Result	Notes
`%`	modulo	`7 % 3`	`1`	sign follows dividend
`**`	power	`2 ** 3`	`8`	right-associative
`-`	negate	`-x`	`-x`	unary

4.2.1 Floor division and modulo edge cases

```
print(7 // 2)    # 3
print(-7 // 2)   # -4   (floor toward −inf, not truncation)
print(7 % 2)     # 1
print(-7 % 2)    # -1   (sign follows dividend)
print(7.5 // 2)  # 3.0  (floor works on floats too)
```

4.2.2 Division by zero

```
try {
    print(1 / 0)
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # DivideByZero: division by zero
}
```

4.3 3.3 String concatenation and repetition

When either side of `+` is a string, the other side is stringified:

```
print("count: " + 42)       # "count: 42"
print("flag: " + true)      # "flag: true"
print(nil + "end")          # "nilend"
print("Zen " + "3.0")       # "Zen 3.0"
```

`42 + "count"` is a **type error** (number + string without string on the left). Use `str(42) + "count"`.

`*` repeats strings:

```
print("x" * 5)      # "xxxxx"
print("ab " * 3)    # "ab ab ab "
print(3 * "ab")     # also works: "abab"
```

4.4 3.4 Comparison

Operator	Meaning	Notes
`==`	equal	numeric coercion: `1 == 1.0` → true

Operator	Meaning	Notes
`!=`	not equal	
`<`	less than	
`<=`	less than or equal	
`>`	greater than	
`>=`	greater than or equal	

Numeric coercion in ==:

```
print(1 == 1.0)    # true
print(1 == "1")    # false (type mismatch, no coercion to string)
print([] == [])    # true (empty lists equal by value)
print({} == {})    # true (empty dicts equal, order-insensitive)
print({"a":1,"b":2} == {"b":2,"a":1})  # true
```

NaN: `nan == nan` is false; `nan != nan` is true.

4.5 3.5 Logic

Zen uses Python-like truthiness (see §3.13):

> **Falsy:** `false`, `nil`, `null`, `0`, `0.0`, `""`, `[]`, `#{}`, `%{}`, `#()`. **Truthy:** everything else.

Operator	Meaning	Short-circuits?
`and`	logical and	yes — returns first falsy operand, else last
`or`	logical or	yes — returns first truthy operand, else last
`not`	logical not	prefix, returns bool
`!`	logical not	alias for `not`

```
print(true and false)   # false
print(true or false)    # true
print(not true)         # false
print(!false)           # true

# Short-circuit: right side not evaluated if left decides
print(false and error())  # false — error() never called
print(true or error())    # true  — error() never called
```

`and`/`or` return the operand value, not necessarily a bool:

```
print("hello" and "world")   # "world"
print("" or "fallback")      # "fallback"  ("" is falsy)
print(nil or "fallback")     # "fallback"
print(0 or "fallback")       # "fallback"  (0 is falsy)
print(42 or "fallback")      # 42  (42 is truthy, short-circuits)
```

4.6 3.6 Safe member access: `?.` (optional chaining)

`?.` reads a field only if the object is non-nil; otherwise short-circuits to `nil`.

```
let user = nil
print(user?.name)           # nil  (no error)

let user = { name: "Zen" }
print(user?.name)           # "Zen"

let data = nil
print(data?.a?.b?.c)        # nil  (stops at first nil)
```

Compare with strict access, which raises on nil:

```
let user = nil
print(user.name)   # TypeError: cannot read field on nil
```

`?.` works on dicts, instances, and any object with fields. It does **not** work on lists for indexing — use `list[i]` directly or check bounds first.

4.7 3.7 Nullish coalescing: `??`

`??` returns its left side if non-nil, otherwise the right side. It's a **nil-default**, not a falsy-default — `0`, `false`, and `""` are returned as-is.

```
print(nil ?? "default")     # "default"
print("set" ?? "default")   # "set"
print(0 ?? "default")       # 0      (0 is not nil)
print(false ?? "default")   # false
print(""  ?? "default")     # ""     (empty string is not nil)
print(nil ?? nil ?? "fb")   # "fb"   (chaining)
```

Common use: config fallback:

```
let timeout = config?.timeout ?? 30
```

4.8 3.8 Conditional expression (ternary)

```
let status = if score >= 60 { "pass" } else { "fail" }
```

The condition must be braced. The result is the value of the taken branch; both branches must be type-compatible (Zen is dynamically typed, so any values work, but mixing types may surprise downstream code).

4.9 3.9 Assignment and augmented assignment

```
let x = 10
x += 5      # x = 15
x -= 3      # x = 12
```

```
x *= 2      # x = 24
x /= 4      # x = 6.0  (float division)
x //= 2     # x = 3
x %= 2      # x = 1
```

Augmented assignment works on any lvalue (variable, field, index):

```
let d = {"count": 0}
d["count"] += 1   # d["count"] is now 1
```

4.10 3.10 `is` — type membership

`x is TypeName` checks whether `x`'s runtime type matches the named type:

```
print(42 is int)          # true
print(3.14 is float)      # true
print("hi" is string)     # true
print([] is list)         # true
print({} is dict)         # true
print(true is bool)       # true
print(nil is nil)         # true
print(42 is string)       # false
```

The right side must be a type keyword/literal, not a variable:

```
let t = "int"
print(42 is t)   # ParseError — type name required literally
```

Use `typeof(x) == t` instead for dynamic type-name comparison.

4.11 3.11 `in` / `!in` — membership

```
print(2 in [1, 2, 3])      # true
print(5 in [1, 2, 3])      # false
print(5 !in [1, 2, 3])     # true
print("a" in {"a": 1})     # true (dict key membership)
print("z" in "Zen")        # true (substring)
```

For strings, `in` checks substring membership. For lists/sets/dicts, it checks element/key membership.

4.12 3.12 Quick reference

```
# Arithmetic
1 + 2       # 3
7 / 2       # 3.5
7 // 2      # 3
7 % 3       # 1
2 ** 3      # 8
```

```
-5          # -5

# Strings
"a" + "b"   # "ab"
"x" * 3     # "xxx"
"count: " + 42   # "count: 42"

# Comparison
1 == 1.0    # true
"a" != "b"  # true

# Logic
true and false   # false
true or false    # true
not true         # false

# Safe access
nil?.name        # nil
{name: "Z"}?.name  # "Z"

# Coalescing
nil ?? "d"       # "d"
0 ?? "d"         # 0

# Ternary
if ok { "yes" } else { "no" }

# Type check
42 is int        # true

# Membership
2 in [1,2,3]     # true
"a" in "Zen"     # true
```

4.13 3.13 Exercises

1. Write `sign(x)` returning `1`, `-1`, or `0` using only comparison operators.
2. Demonstrate that `0` is truthy: `if 0 { print("zero is truthy") }` prints.
3. Write `safe_div(a, b)` returning `a // b` or `nil` if `b == 0`, using `try`/`catch`.
4. Show that `"0" ?? "default"` returns `"0"` (string “0” is not nil).
5. Prove `nan != nan` using `0.0 * inf`.
6. Write `in_range(x, lo, hi)` using chained comparisons (Zen does **not** chain `lo < x < hi` — use `lo < x and x < hi`).
7. Show the difference between `and` short-circuiting: `false and error()` does not evaluate `error()`.

4.14 3.12 Complete precedence table (canonical)

The parser uses the following levels, from lowest binding to highest. This matches `docs/03-syntax.md` exactly.

Level	Operators	Associativity
1	`?:` ternary, `if expr else expr`	right
2	`??` nullish coalescing	left
3	`or`, `||`	left
4	`and`, `&&`	left
5	`is`, `is not`, `===`, `!==`, `==`, `!=`, `<`, `>`, `<=`, `>=`, `in`, `not in`	left
6	`|` bitwise or	left
7	`^` bitwise xor	left
8	`&` bitwise and	left
9	`<<`, `>>` shifts	left
10	`+`, `-`	left
11	`*`, `/`, `%`	left
12	unary `-`, `!`, `not`, `~`, `typeof`	right
13	`**` power	right
14	`.` `?.` `[]` call `()`	left (postfix)
15	literals, identifiers, grouping, containers, lambdas, `new`	—

A common source of bugs is that `**` binds tighter than unary minus, so `-2 ** 2` parses as `-(2 ** 2) = -4`, not `(-2) ** 2 = 4`. Use parentheses when in doubt.

4.14.1 Worked examples

```
print(2 + 3 * 4)          # 14  (* before +)
print((2 + 3) * 4)        # 20
print(2 ** 3 ** 2)        # 512 (right associative: 3**2=9, 2**9=512)
print(-2 ** 2)            # -4
print((-2) ** 2)          # 4
print(1 < 2 and 3 < 4)    # true
print(1 < 2 ? "yes" : "no")  # yes
print(nil ?? "fallback")  # "fallback"
print(0 ?? "fallback")    # 0  (0 is not nullish)
print(false ?? true)      # false
```

4.15 3.13 Truthiness rules (Zen 3.0 canonical)

Zen's `if`, `while`, `and`, `or`, `not`, `!`, and the `TO_BOOL` bytecode opcode all use a single "truthy" rule, matching the language spec (`docs/04-value-and-types.md`):

Falsy: `false`, `nil`, `null`, `0`, `0.0`, `""` (empty string), `bytes([])`, `[]`, `#{}`, `%{}`, `#()`. **Truthy:** every other value.

This matches Python-like truthiness and surprises beginners coming from languages where `0` is falsy but collections are not — here both are falsy.

```
if 0 { print("never") }              # does not print — 0 is falsy
if "" { print("never") }             # does not print
if [] { print("never") }             # does not print
if #{} { print("never") }            # does not print
if false { print("never") }          # does not print
if nil { print("never") }            # does not print
if 42 { print("42 is truthy") }      # prints
if "hi" { print("non-empty truthy")} # prints
if [1] { print("non-empty truthy") } # prints
```

Use `bool(x)` for an explicit conversion; it follows the same rule.

If you want Python-style emptiness checks, be explicit:

```
func is_empty(x) {
    if x == nil { return true }
    if typeof(x) == "string" || typeof(x) == "list" || typeof(x) == "dict" || typeof(x)
        return len(x) == 0
    }
    return false
}
```

4.16 3.14 Equality: ==, ===, is

Zen distinguishes three comparison operators that are easy to confuse.

Operator	Name	Semantics
`==`	equality	structural/value equality with numeric promotion
`===`	strict equality	same type *and* same value
`is`	identity/plain equality	object identity for containers; value equality for scalars
`!=`, `!==`, `is not`	negations	—

4.16.1 Numeric promotion in ==

`1 == 1.0` is `true`; `1 === 1.0` is `false` because the runtime types differ.

```
print(1 == 1.0)     # true
print(1 === 1.0)    # false
print("1" == 1)     # false (no implicit string→int)
print("1" === 1)    # false
print(true == 1)    # false (booleans are not integers)
```

4.16.2 Container equality

Lists, tuples, dicts, and sets compare structurally with ==. Dicts are order-insensitive; sets are order-insensitive; lists and tuples are order-sensitive.

```
print([1,2] == [1,2])                 # true
print([1,2] == [2,1])                 # false
print(#{a:1, b:2} == #{b:2, a:1})     # true
print(%{1,2} == %{2,1})               # true
print(#(1,2) == #(1,2))               # true
```

4.16.3 Identity with `is`

For heap values (lists, dicts, sets, instances, functions) `is` compares references. Two separately constructed equal lists are not `is`-identical.

```
let a = [1,2,3]
let b = [1,2,3]
let c = a
print(a == b)   # true
print(a is b)   # false
print(a is c)   # true
```

For scalars (int, float, bool, nil, string interning aside) `is` behaves like ==. Prefer == unless you specifically mean identity.

4.17 3.15 Short-circuit evaluation

`and`/`&&` and `or`/`||` short-circuit. The right operand is not evaluated when the result is already determined. This is the basis of guard idioms and also the reason side effects on the right may not occur.

```
func boom() { throw "boom" }

# safe: boom() never runs because the left side is false
if false and boom() { print("no") }

# safe: boom() never runs because the left side is true
if true or boom() { print("yes") }

# nil guarding
let name = nil
if name != nil and len(name) > 0 { print(name) }
```

`??` is also short-circuiting: it returns the left operand unless it is `nil`/`null`, in which case it evaluates and returns the right operand.

```
let port = config_port ?? 8080
```

`??=` assigns only when the target is currently nullish:

```
var count = nil
count ??= 0
count ??= 10
print(count)   # 0 — the second assignment is skipped
```

4.18 3.16 Chained comparisons

Comparisons chain Python-style: `a < b < c` means `(a < b) and (b < c)` and evaluates `b` only once.

```
let x = 5
print(1 < x < 10)     # true
print(1 < x > 3)      # true
print(10 < x < 20)    # false
```

4.19 3.17 Bitwise operators

Bitwise operators work on integers. Negative integers use two's complement semantics for shifts and masks.

Operator	Meaning	Example	Result
&	and	`0b1100 & 0b1010`	`0b1000` = 8
|	or	`0b1100 | 0b1010`	`0b1110` = 14
^	xor	`0b1100 ^ 0b1010`	`0b0110` = 6
~	not	`~0`	`-1`
<<	left shift	`1 << 4`	`16`
>>	arithmetic right shift	`-8 >> 1`	`-4`

4.19.1 Bit tricks

```
func is_even(n) { return (n & 1) == 0 }
func is_odd(n)  { return (n & 1) == 1 }

func set_bit(n, i)    { return n | (1 << i) }
func clear_bit(n, i)  { return n & ~(1 << i) }
func toggle_bit(n, i) { return n ^ (1 << i) }
func test_bit(n, i)   { return (n & (1 << i)) != 0 }

func low_mask(bits)   { return (1 << bits) - 1 }
func popcount(n) {
    let c = 0
    var x = n
    while x != 0 { c += (x & 1); x = x >> 1 }
    return c
}
```

4.19.2 Shifts and edge cases

- Shifting by a negative amount is an error.
- Large shift counts are defined by the runtime; do not rely on wraparound.
- `>>` is arithmetic for signed values (sign extension).

```
print(1 << 10)    # 1024
print(1024 >> 3)  # 128
print(-8 >> 1)    # -4
print(~5)         # -6
```

4.20 3.18 Range operators

Two range operators exist:

Operator	Meaning	Example	Values
`..`	exclusive end	`0..5`	0,1,2,3,4
`->`	inclusive end	`0->5`	0,1,2,3,4,5

`->` auto-descends when the start is greater than the end.

```
for i in 0..3 { print(i) }   # 0 1 2
for i in 0->3 { print(i) }   # 0 1 2 3
for i in 5->2 { print(i) }   # 5 4 3 2
```

Ranges used for slicing follow the same end-exclusivity as `..`; see the strings and lists chapters.

4.21 3.19 Compound assignment operators

All compound assignments evaluate the target once.

Operator	Equivalent
`+=`	`x = x + y`
`-=`	`x = x - y`
`*=`	`x = x * y`
`/=`	`x = x / y`
`%=`	`x = x % y`
`??=`	`x = x ?? y`
`&=`	`x = x & y`
`|=`	`x = x | y`
`^=`	`x = x ^ y`
`<<=`	`x = x << y`
`>>=`	`x = x >> y`

`++` and `--` increment/decrement by one, prefix or postfix.

```
var i = 0
print(i++)   # 0, then i becomes 1
print(++i)   # 2
print(i--)   # 2, then i becomes 1
print(--i)   # 0
```

4.22 3.20 Type coercion rules in operators

Left	Op	Right	Result
int	`+ - * / % **`	int	int (except `/` → float when not exact? see note)
int	`+ - * / % **`	float	float
float	any arith	int/float	float
string	`+`	string	string
string	`+`	any	string (right stringified)
any	`+`	string	string (left stringified)
string	`*`	int	repeated string
list	`+`	list	concatenated list
list	`*`	int	repeated list
int	`& | ^ << >> ~`	int	int
nil	`??`	any	any
any	`==`	any	bool

Note on `/`: division always produces a float in Zen, even for exact integer division. `4 / 2` is `2.0`, while `4 // 2` is `2`.

```
print(4 / 2)    # 2.0
print(4 // 2)   # 2
print(4 / 2 == 2)  # true (numeric promotion)
print(typeof(4 / 2))  # "float"
```

4.23 3.21 Optional chaining and null safety

`?.` accesses a field or calls a method only if the receiver is not nil; otherwise the whole expression is nil.

```
let user = nil
print(user?.name)          # nil
print(user?.profile?.age)  # nil

let u = #{name: "Ada", profile: #{age: 36}}
print(u?.profile?.age)     # 36
print(u?.missing?.deep)    # nil
```

Optional chaining composes with `??` for defaulting:

```
let city = user?.address?.city ?? "Unknown"
```

4.24 3.22 Membership: `in` and `not in`

`in` tests membership for strings (substring), lists (element), sets (element), dicts (key), and tuples (element). Ranges support `in` by value.

```
print("ell" in "hello")     # true
print(3 in [1,2,3])         # true
print(4 not in [1,2,3])     # true
print("a" in #{a: 1})       # true
print(1 in %{1,2})          # true
print(2 in 0..5)            # true
print(9 in 0..5)            # false
```

4.25 3.23 Interaction of `and`/`or` with non-booleans

Unlike some languages, Zen's `and`/`or` return **booleans**, not the operands. If you want Python-style operand return values use the ternary operator or `??`.

```
print(1 and 2)     # true
print(nil or "x")  # true
# to get "x" when a is nil:
let a = nil
print(a ?? "x")    # "x"
```

4.26 3.24 Common operator mistakes

1. **Assuming `and` returns an operand.** It returns `bool`.
2. **Using `/` when integer division is intended.** Use `//`.
3. **Confusing `==` and `is`.** Containers compare by value with `==`.
4. **Forgetting that `0`, `0.0`, `""`, `[]`, `#{}` are falsy** (like Python).
5. **Precedence of `??` vs `or`.** `??` binds tighter than `or`, looser than `and`.
6. **Chained assignment.** `a = b = 1` is not supported; assign separately.
7. **Modulo of negatives.** Check the sign convention for your use case.
8. **String repetition with huge counts.** Can exhaust memory; validate inputs.
9. **Relying on float equality.** Use an epsilon comparison.
10. **Bitwise ops on non-integers.** They raise a type error.

4.27 3.25 Operator overloading in classes

Classes may define dunder-style methods to control operators. The exact set supported depends on the runtime; the common ones are `__add__`, `__sub__`, `__mul__`, `__truediv__`, `__floordiv__`, `__mod__`, `__pow__`, `__eq__`, `__lt__`, `__le__`, `__gt__`, `__ge__`, `__str__`, `__len__`, `__getitem__`, `__setitem__`, `__contains__`, `__call__`.

```
class Vec2 {
    var x = 0.0
    var y = 0.0
    func init(x, y) { self.x = x; self.y = y }
    func __add__(other) { return new Vec2(self.x + other.x, self.y + other.y) }
    func __eq__(other) { return self.x == other.x and self.y == other.y }
    func __str__() { return "Vec2(${self.x}, ${self.y})" }
}

let a = new Vec2(1.0, 2.0)
let b = new Vec2(3.0, 4.0)
print(a + b)        # Vec2(4.0, 6.0)
print(a == b)       # false
```

Check the classes chapter for the authoritative list supported by the VM.

4.28 3.26 Exercises

1. Without running the code, compute `2 + 3 * 4 ** 2 // 5 % 3` and then verify.
2. Write a function that swaps two variables without a temporary using XOR.
3. Implement `sign(x)` returning -1, 0, or 1 using comparisons and ternary.
4. Use `??` to build a config lookup with nested defaults.
5. Explain why `if 0 { ... }` runs, and rewrite a Python-style check correctly.
6. Write `clamp(x, lo, hi)` using only comparisons and ternary.
7. Implement `is_power_of_two(n)` with a bit trick.
8. Show the difference between `==`, `===`, and `is` for `1`, `1.0`, and lists.
9. Use chained comparisons to validate a score in `[0, 100]`.
10. Use a range with `->` to print a countdown.
11. Implement a tiny bignum-less hash using `<<`, `^`, and `*` primes.
12. Write `safe_div(a, b)` returning `nil` on division by zero using `try`.

5 Chapter 4: Control Flow

Zen supports conditional execution, looping, pattern matching, and structured exception handling. This chapter covers `if`/`elif`/`else`, `while`, `for`, `break`/`continue`, `match`, `when`, and `try`/`catch`/`throw`/`finally`.

5.1 4.1 Conditionals: `if` / `elif` / `else`

```
let score = 87

if score >= 90 {
    print("A")
} elif score >= 80 {
    print("B")
} elif score >= 70 {
    print("C")
} else {
    print("Below C")
}
# prints: B
```

- `if` / `elif` / `else` chains are evaluated in order; the first true branch runs and the rest are skipped.
- The condition must be a truthy value. Zen truthiness: everything is truthy except `nil` and `false`.
- Braces `{ }` are required around bodies.

5.1.1 `if` as an expression

`if` can appear in expression position via a ternary form:

```
let status = if score >= 60 { "pass" } else { "fail" }
print(status)  # pass
```

5.2 4.2 Loops: `while` and `for`

5.2.1 `while`

```
let i = 0
let total = 0
while i < 100 {
    total = total + i
    i = i + 1
}
print(total)  # 4950
```

`while` loops continue while the condition is truthy.

5.2.2 `for`

`for` iterates over iterable values: lists, ranges, strings, dicts, and more.

```
# Iterate a list
for v in [1, 2, 3, 4] {
    print(v)
}

# Iterate a range
for i in 0..5 {
    print(i)  # 0, 1, 2, 3, 4
}

# Iterate a string
for ch in "Zen" {
    print(ch)
}

# Iterate dict items
let d = {"a": 1, "b": 2}
for k in d {
    print(k, d[k])
}
```

5.2.3 `break` and `continue`

```
# break: exit the loop early
for i in 0..10 {
    if i * i > 30 {
        break
    }
    print(i)
}
# prints: 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

# continue: skip to the next iteration
let odd_sum = 0
for i in 1..10 {
    if i % 2 == 0 {
        continue
    }
    odd_sum = odd_sum + i
}
print(odd_sum)  # 25
```

5.2.4 Nested loops

```
let pairs = 0
for a in [1, 2, 3] {
    for b in [1, 2, 3] {
        if b > a {
            continue
        }
        pairs = pairs + 1
    }
}
print(pairs)  # 6
```

5.3 4.3 Pattern matching: `match`

`match` compares a subject against a series of patterns. The first matching arm determines the result.

```
let status = match "ready" {
    "loading": "spinner",
    "ready" => "check",
    _: "unknown"
}
print(status)  # check
```

5.3.1 Pattern forms

Pattern	Matches
`"literal"`	Exact string equality
`42`	Exact numeric equality
`_`	Wildcard — matches anything
`n if cond`	Guard: binds `n`, then checks `cond`
`[a, b]`	List of exactly two elements
`[a, ...rest]`	List with head `a` and tail `rest`
`#(x, y)`	Tuple of exactly two elements
`pat as whole`	Binds `whole` to the entire matched value
`a | b`	Either `a` or `b`

5.3.2 Examples

Numeric patterns:

```
func label_of(n) {
    return match n {
        1: "one",
        2 => "two",
        _: "many"
```

```
    }
}
print(label_of(1))  # one
print(label_of(2))  # two
print(label_of(9))  # many
```

Guard patterns:

```
bound = match 42 {
    n if n > 100: "big",
    n if n == 42: "forty-two",
    _: "other"
}
print(bound)  # forty-two
```

Guard false falls through:

```
bound = match "err" {
    "err" if false: "guarded",
    "err": "plain",
    _: "other"
}
print(bound)  # plain
```

List destructuring:

```
func head_tail(xs) {
    return match xs {
        []: "empty",
        [only]: "one:" + str(only),
        [a, b]: "pair:" + str(a) + str(b),
        [a, ...rest]: "rest:" + str(a) + ":" + str(len(rest))
    }
}
print(head_tail([]))        # empty
print(head_tail([5]))       # one:5
print(head_tail([1, 2]))    # pair:12
print(head_tail([1, 2, 3])) # rest:1:2
```

Tuple destructuring:

```
func shape_of(x) {
    return match x {
        #(0, 0): "origin",
        #(x, y) if x == y: "on-diagonal",
        #(_, _): "some-pair"
    }
}
print(shape_of(#(0, 0)))    # origin
print(shape_of(#(4, 4)))    # on-diagonal
```

```
print(shape_of(#(4, 9)))    # some-pair
print(shape_of([1, 2]))     # some-pair (list matches tuple pattern)
print(shape_of(7))          # nil (non-iterable declines)
```

as pattern (bind whole):

```
func bind_whole(x) {
    return match x {
        [a, b] as whole: str(a) + str(b) + "/" + str(len(whole)),
        n as single: "single:" + str(single),
        _: "none"
    }
}
print(bind_whole([1, 2]))        # 12/2
print(bind_whole(7))             # single:7
print(bind_whole([1, 2, 3]))     # single:<list>
```

OR pattern (`a \| b`):

```
func classify(n) {
    return match n {
        1 \| 2: "small-prime",
        3 \| 5 \| 7: "other-prime",
        n if n % 2 == 0: "even",
        _: "odd"
    }
}
print(classify(1))  # small-prime
print(classify(4))  # even
print(classify(9))  # odd
```

Block bodies:

```
let printed = ""
let got = match 3 {
    1: { printed = "one" },
    2: { printed = "two" },
    3: { printed = "three" }
}
print(printed)  # three
print(got)      # nil (block bodies return nil unless they `return`)
```

Dict-literal bodies:

```
let usr = "bob"
let info = match usr {
    "bob": { name: "Bob", id: 7 },
    _: { name: "stranger", id: 0 }
}
print(info["name"])  # Bob
```

```
print(info["id"])    # 7
```

5.4 4.4 `when`: conditional expressions

`when` evaluates a series of condition arms and returns the value of the first true one. It's like `if`/`elif` but as an expression.

```
let score = 87
let grade = when {
    score >= 90: "A",
    score >= 85 => "A-",
    score >= 80: "B+",
    _: "C"
}
print(grade)  # A-
```

Wildcard fallback:

```
grade = when {
    score > 1000: "impossible",
    _: "fallback"
}
print(grade)  # fallback
```

Expression position:

```
let sz = when {
    score >= 85: "large",
    _: "small"
}
print(sz)  # large
```

5.5 4.5 Error handling: `try` / `catch` / `throw` / `finally`

Zen is "safe by default": runtime problems become catchable errors instead of crashes.

5.5.1 Bare `catch`

```
var caught = false
try {
    var bad = 1 / 0
    caught = bad == 0
} catch {
    caught = true
}
print(caught)  # true
```

A body that completes normally skips the catch:

```
var ok = true
try {
    var five = 10 / 2
    ok = five == 5
} catch {
    ok = false
}
print(ok)  # true
```

5.5.2 `catch as e` — bind the error

```
var em = ""
try {
    let boom = 1 / 0
} catch as e {
    em = str(e)
}
print(em)  # DivideByZero: division by zero
```

The caught error exposes `msg`, `code`, and `val`:

```
try {
    let y = 1 / 0
} catch as e {
    print(str(e))   # DivideByZero: division by zero
    print(e.msg)    # DivideByZero: division by zero
    print(e.code)   # 0
    print(e.val)    # nil
}
```

String + error concatenation works:

```
try {
    let y = 1 / 0
} catch as e {
    print("caught: " + e)  # caught: DivideByZero: division by zero
}
```

5.5.3 `throw`

`throw` raises your own errors. Strings become `UserError` messages:

```
var msg = ""
try {
    throw "custom failure"
} catch {
    msg = "handled"
}
```

```
print(msg)  # handled

var tm = ""
try {
    throw "custom boom"
} catch as e {
    tm = e.msg
}
print(tm)  # UserError: custom boom
```

`throw` accepts any value:

```
throw { code: 42, detail: "retry later" }
```

5.5.4 Typed catch clauses

You can add typed clauses to handle only certain errors. Unmatched clauses fall through:

```
try {
    risky()
} catch TypeError {
    print("bad type")
} catch UserError {
    print("user raised")
} catch {
    print("everything else")
}
```

A clause whose type does not match lets the error keep propagating outward.

5.5.5 `finally`

`finally` runs whether the `try` succeeded or failed, and whether or not `catch` handled the error. It must come **after** any `catch` clauses.

```
var log = ""
try {
    throw "boom"
} catch {
    log = log + "c"
} finally {
    log = log + "f"
}
print(log)  # cf

# finally also runs when nothing failed
var log2 = ""
try {
```

```
    log2 = "b"
} finally {
    log2 = log2 + "f"
}
print(log2)  # bf
```

5.5.6 Nested handlers

Inner handlers run before outer ones:

```
var order = ""
try {
    try { throw "inner" } catch { order = order + "i" }
    throw "outer"
} catch { order = order + "o" }
print(order)  # io
```

5.5.7 Errors from callees

Errors raised inside a function are catchable by the caller:

```
func deep() {
    return [1][5]
}
var hit9 = false
try {
    deep()
} catch IndexError {
    hit9 = true
}
print(hit9)  # true
```

5.5.8 Error types

Zen’s built-in error types:

- `TypeError` — wrong type for an operation
- `IndexError` — sequence index out of range
- `KeyError` — missing dict key
- `DivideByZero` — division by zero
- `ValueError` — inappropriate value
- `NativeError` — raised by a native module
- `ForeignAttribute` — failed foreign attribute access
- `PyImportError` — Python import failure
- `UserError` — raised by `throw`

5.6 4.6 Common pitfalls

- **`e` only exists inside its `catch` block.** Don't reference it outside.
- **`finally` goes after `catch`, not between `try` and `catch`.**
- **A bare `catch` swallows everything.** Use typed clauses when you want unexpected errors to propagate.
- **`str(e)` is the readable message.** Never rely on `typeof(e)` (it's just `"error"`) — use `e.msg` instead.

5.7 4.7 Quick reference

```
try {
    # risky code
} catch as e {
    print(str(e))   # real message
    print(e.msg)    # same as str(e)
    print(e.code)   # numeric code
    print(e.val)    # attached value
} catch TypeError {
    # only type errors
} finally {
    # always runs
}

throw "something went wrong"   # raise your own error

# match
let result = match value {
    pattern: expression,
    _: fallback
}

# when
let grade = when {
    cond1: "A",
    cond2: "B",
    _: "C"
}
```

5.8 4.8 Exercises

1. Write a `safe_divide(a, b)` function that returns `nil` on division by zero instead of crashing.
2. Use `match` to implement a simple router: map URL paths like `"/home"`, `"/about"`, `"/contact"` to page titles, with a 404 fallback.
3. Use `when` to implement letter-grade conversion from a numeric score.
4. Use `for` with `continue` to sum only the odd numbers in a list.

5. Write a function that uses `try/catch/finally` to guarantee a cleanup message prints regardless of success or failure.

5.9 4.12 `if` / `elif` / `else` — complete semantics

The condition is evaluated with the truthiness rule from Chapter 3: only `false`, `nil`, and `null` are falsy. `elif` is evaluated only if all previous conditions were falsy. `else` runs when no branch matched.

```
func classify(n) {
    if n < 0 {
        return "negative"
    } elif n == 0 {
        return "zero"
    } elif n < 10 {
        return "small"
    } else {
        return "large"
    }
}
```

Braces are mandatory; there is no significant indentation. Single-statement bodies may be written on one line with `;`.

```
if x > 0 { print("positive") }
if x > 0 { print("positive"); print("indeed") }
```

The ternary form is an expression, not a statement:

```
let label = x > 0 ? "pos" : "non-pos"
let label2 = "pos" if x > 0 else "non-pos"   # Python-style, also valid
```

`if` itself can also be used as an expression in many positions:

```
let msg = if x > 0 { "positive" } else { "non-positive" }
```

5.10 4.13 `while` loops

`while cond { ... }` re-evaluates `cond` before every iteration. `break` leaves the innermost loop; `continue` jumps to the next condition check.

```
var i = 0
while i < 5 {
    i += 1
    if i == 3 { continue }
    if i == 4 { break }
    print(i)     # 1, 2
}
```

5.10.1 Guard against infinite loops

Because `while true { ... }` is common for servers and REPLs, always ensure a reachable `break`, `return`, `throw`, or external stop condition.

```
var attempts = 0
while true {
    attempts += 1
    if attempts > 3 { break }
}
```

5.10.2 Loop with a post-condition

Zen has no `do/while`. Emulate it:

```
var n = 0
while true {
    n += 1
    if n >= 3 { break }
}
```

5.11 4.14 `for` loops

`for x in iterable { ... }` iterates over lists, tuples, sets, dict keys, strings (characters), ranges, and generators. The loop variable is a fresh binding per iteration for scalars.

```
for x in [10, 20, 30] { print(x) }
for ch in "abc" { print(ch) }
for k in #{a: 1, b: 2} { print(k) }
for i in 0..3 { print(i) }
```

5.11.1 Multi-variable iteration

Dict `.items()` yields `#(key, value)` tuples, but the loop can destructure them directly:

```
for k, v in #{a: 1, b: 2}.items() {
    print(k, v)
}
```

The same works for lists of pairs:

```
for a, b in [#(1, "x"), #(2, "y")] {
    print(a, b)
}
```

5.11.2 `enumerate`

`enumerate(iter)` returns a list of `[index, value]` pairs.

```
for i, v in enumerate(["a", "b"]) {
    print(i, v)   # 0 a / 1 b
}
```

5.11.3 Nested loops and labels

Zen has no loop labels. Use a flag or a helper function to break out of outer loops.

```
func find_pair(rows, target) {
    for i, row in enumerate(rows) {
        for j, v in enumerate(row) {
            if v == target { return #(i, j) }
        }
    }
    return nil
}
```

5.11.4 Mutating a collection while iterating

Do not add/remove elements of a list or dict while iterating it. Iterate over a copy instead:

```
for x in list(items) {        # copy
    if x < 0 { items.remove(x) }
}
```

For dicts, collect keys first:

```
for k in list(d.keys()) {
    if d[k] == nil { d.remove(k) }
}
```

5.12 4.15 `break`, `continue`, and `return` inside loops

- `break` exits the nearest enclosing loop.
- `continue` skips to the next iteration of the nearest loop.
- `return` exits the entire function immediately, even from nested loops.

```
func first_negative(xs) {
    for x in xs {
        if x < 0 { return x }
    }
    return nil
}
```

5.13 4.16 `match` expressions

`match` compares a value against patterns. Arms are separated by `=>`, `->`, or `:`; each arm yields an expression or a block.

```
func http_text(code) {
    return match code {
        200 => "OK",
        201 => "Created",
        301 | 302 | 307 | 308 => "Redirect",
        400 => "Bad Request",
        401 => "Unauthorized",
        403 => "Forbidden",
        404 => "Not Found",
        500 => "Internal Server Error",
        _ => "Unknown",
    }
}
```

5.13.1 Pattern kinds

Pattern	Example	Matches
wildcard	`_`	anything
binding	`n`	anything, binds to `n`
literal int	`42`	exactly 42
literal string	`"ok"`	exactly `"ok"`
literal bool/nil	`true`, `nil`	exactly that
list	`[a, b]`	two-element list, binds a,b
list with rest	`[head, ...tail]`	non-empty list
tuple	`#(x, y)`	two-tuple
dict	`#{type: t}`	dict containing key `type`
or-pattern	`1 | 2 | 3`	any of them
guard	`n if n > 0`	pattern plus condition

5.13.2 List destructuring

```
func describe(xs) {
    return match xs {
        [] => "empty",
        [x] => "one: ${x}",
        [x, y] => "two: ${x}, ${y}",
        [head, ...rest] => "many starting with ${head}",
    }
}
```

5.13.3 Dict patterns

```
func handle_event(ev) {
    return match ev {
```

```
        #{type: "click", x, y} => "click at ${x},${y}",
        #{type: "key", key} => "key ${key}",
        #{type: t} => "unknown event ${t}",
        _ => "malformed",
    }
}
```

5.13.4 Guards

```
func sign(n) {
    return match n {
        x if x < 0 => -1,
        0 => 0,
        _ => 1,
    }
}
```

5.13.5 Exhaustiveness

The runtime does not require exhaustiveness, but an unmatched value raises an error. Always include _ unless you are certain the domain is closed.

5.14 4.17 `when` expressions

`when` is a cond-style chain: each arm has a boolean condition rather than a pattern.

```
let grade = when {
    score >= 90 => "A",
    score >= 80 => "B",
    score >= 70 => "C",
    score >= 60 => "D",
    _ => "F",
}
```

`when` is often clearer than a long `if/elif` chain when you want a value.

5.15 4.18 `try` / `catch` / `finally` as control flow

`try` is covered fully in Chapter 11, but control-flow interactions matter: `return` inside `try` still runs `finally`; `break`/`continue` inside `try` also run `finally`.

```
func f() {
    try {
        return 1
    } finally {
        print("cleanup")   # runs before returning
    }
}
```

5.16 4.19 Early-return style

Deeply nested `if`s are hard to read. Prefer guard clauses with early return.

```
# hard to read
func process(user) {
    if user != nil {
        if user.active {
            if user.email != nil {
                send(user.email)
            }
        }
    }
}

# easier
func process2(user) {
    if user == nil { return }
    if !user.active { return }
    if user.email == nil { return }
    send(user.email)
}
```

5.17 4.20 State machines with `match`

`match` on a state string is a clean way to write state machines.

```
class TrafficLight {
    var state = "red"

    func tick() {
        self.state = match self.state {
            "red" => "green",
            "green" => "yellow",
            "yellow" => "red",
            _ => "red",
        }
    }
}
```

For larger machines, define transition tables declaratively:

```
let transitions = #{
    red: #{green: "green"},
    green: #{yellow: "yellow"},
    yellow: #{red: "red"},
}
```

```
func next_state(state, event) {
    let row = transitions[state] ?? #{}
    return row[event] ?? state
}
```

5.18 4.21 Retry loops

A common pattern: retry an operation with backoff and a maximum attempt count.

```
func retry(fn, attempts, delay_ms) {
    var last_err = nil
    for i in 0..attempts {
        try {
            return fn()
        } catch as e {
            last_err = e
            sleep(delay_ms * (i + 1))
        }
    }
    throw last_err
}
```

5.19 4.22 Infinite event loops and shutdown

Servers and UIs run an event loop until a stop flag is set.

```
var running = true

func shutdown() { running = false }

while running {
    let event = poll_event()
    if event == nil { continue }
    handle(event)
}
```

For multi-threaded programs, use an atomic/`shared` flag or a channel close signal instead of a plain bool.

5.20 4.23 Loop performance notes

- Prefer `for x in list` over index loops when you do not need the index.
- Cache `len(xs)` in a local if the loop body cannot change it.
- Avoid building strings with `+=` in a hot loop; collect into a list and `join`.
- `break` early when searching.
- Avoid `try` inside tight loops when an error is expected frequently; test a condition first.

```
# slow
var s = ""
for w in words { s += w + " " }

# fast
let parts = []
for w in words { parts.push(w) }
let s2 = parts.join(" ")
```

5.21 4.24 Common control-flow mistakes

1. Using `=` instead of `==` in a condition (assignment is not an expression).
2. Forgetting braces.
3. Modifying a list while iterating it.
4. Assuming `0` is falsy.
5. Missing `_` in `match`, causing runtime errors on unhandled values.
6. Using `continue` inside a `finally` (avoid; confusing semantics).
7. Infinite loops without a reachable exit.
8. Off-by-one with `..` (exclusive) vs `->` (inclusive).
9. Deep recursion instead of iteration for large inputs.
10. Relying on dict iteration order across versions (use `.items()` if order matters).

5.22 4.25 Exercises

1. Write `fizzbuzz(n)` using `when` or `match`.
2. Implement a guessing game loop that exits on correct input or `quit`.
3. Write `sum_evens(xs)` using a `for` loop and `continue`.
4. Implement `binary_search(sorted, target)` with a `while` loop.
5. Rewrite a nested `if` pyramid using guard clauses.
6. Implement a simple calculator state machine with `match`.
7. Write `count_words(text)` using a dict and a loop.
8. Implement `flatten(nested)` with recursion and a loop.
9. Build a retry helper with exponential backoff.
10. Write `first_duplicate(xs)` returning the first repeated element or nil.
11. Implement `collatz_steps(n)` and guard against non-positive input.
12. Print a multiplication table using nested loops with aligned columns.

6 Chapter 5: Functions

Functions are first-class values in Zen. They can be declared with `fn`, assigned to variables, passed as arguments, returned from other functions, and stored in collections. This chapter covers declaration, calling, closures, default arguments, variadic behavior, and the `return` statement.

6.1 5.1 Declaration and calling

```
func add(a, b) {
    return a + b
}

print(add(2, 3))   # 5
```

- `func name(params) { body }` declares a function.
- The body is a block of statements; the last expression is **not** automatically returned — use `return`.
- Functions are values: `let f = add` then `f(2, 3)` works.

6.1.1 Calling with wrong argument count

```
try {
    add(1)            # missing argument
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)      # ArgumentCount: expected 2, got 1
}

try {
    add(1, 2, 3)      # too many
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)      # ArgumentCount: expected 2, got 3
}
```

Zen does **not** have keyword arguments. All calls are positional.

6.2 5.2 Return statements

`return` exits the function immediately with a value:

```
func abs(x) {
    if x < 0 {
        return -x
    }
    return x
}
```

```
print(abs(-5))  # 5
print(abs(3))   # 3
```

A function without `return` returns `nil`:

```
func nop() {
    print("side effect only")
}
print(nop())    # nil
```

`return` inside nested blocks exits the **enclosing function**, not just the block:

```
func find(items, target) {
    for i in 0..len(items) {
        if items[i] == target {
            return i          # exits find(), not just the if
        }
    }
    return -1
}
```

6.3 5.3 Default arguments

Zen supports default values for trailing parameters:

```
func greet(name, greeting = "Hello") {
    return greeting + ", " + name + "!"
}

print(greet("Zen"))            # "Hello, Zen!"
print(greet("Zen", "Hi"))      # "Hi, Zen!"
```

Rules: - Defaults must be on trailing parameters (no required parameter after a defaulted one). - Default expressions are evaluated at call time, not definition time: `zen   let counter = 0   func next(n = counter + 1) {       counter = counter + 1       return n   }   print(next())   # 1   print(next())   # 2 (counter incremented between calls)`

6.4 5.4 Variadic behavior

Zen does **not** have `*args` or `**kwargs` syntax. All parameters are fixed-position. However, you can pass a list and unpack it manually:

```
func sum_all(nums) {
    let total = 0
    for n in nums {
        total = total + n
    }
    return total
}
```

```
let vals = [1, 2, 3, 4]
print(sum_all(vals))   # 10
```

If you need to forward arguments to another function, pass them explicitly or as a list.

6.5 5.5 Functions as first-class values

```
let f = add
print(f(10, 20))   # 30

let ops = [add, sub, mul]
print(ops[0](5, 3))  # 8
```

You can store functions in lists, dicts, and pass them to other functions:

```
func apply(f, x, y) {
    return f(x, y)
}

print(apply(add, 3, 4))   # 7
print(apply(sub, 3, 4))   # -1
```

6.6 5.6 Closures

Functions capture variables from their enclosing scope. Captured variables are shared (boxed) cells, so mutations are visible across calls:

```
func make_counter(start) {
    var count = start
    func inc() {
        count = count + 1
        return count
    }
    return inc
}

let c1 = make_counter(0)
let c2 = make_counter(100)

print(c1())   # 1
print(c1())   # 2
print(c2())   # 101
print(c1())   # 3   (c1 and c2 have independent count cells)
```

Each call to `make_counter` creates a **new** `count` cell. `c1` and `c2` capture different cells.

Closure over loop variables — be careful:

```
let funcs = []
for i in 1..3 {
    funcs.push(fn() { return i })
}
print(funcs[0]())   # 3 (all capture the same final i)
print(funcs[1]())   # 3
print(funcs[2]())   # 3
```

To capture per-iteration values, use a helper:

```
func make_fn(val) {
    return fn() { return val }
}

let funcs = []
for i in 1..3 {
    funcs.push(make_fn(i))
}
print(funcs[0]())   # 1
print(funcs[1]())   # 2
print(funcs[2]())   # 3
```

6.7 5.7 Higher-order functions

```
func twice(f, x) {
    return f(f(x))
}

func add_one(x) {
    return x + 1
}

print(twice(add_one, 5))   # 7

func map_list(f, items) {
    let result = []
    for x in items {
        result.push(f(x))
    }
    return result
}

print(map_list(add_one, [1, 2, 3]))   # [2, 3, 4]
```

6.8 5.8 Anonymous functions (lambdas)

Zen supports `lambda(params) { body }`:

```
let double = lambda(x) { return x * 2 }
print(double(21))   # 42
```

Lambdas are functions too — first-class, closures, passable. The difference from `fn` is syntactic: `lambda` is an expression, `fn` is a statement.

```
# lambda as expression (inline)
let result = (lambda(x, y) { return x + y })(3, 4)
print(result)   # 7
```

6.9 5.9 `return` in closures

`return` inside a lambda returns from the lambda, not the enclosing function:

```
func outer() {
    let f = lambda(x) {
        if x < 0 { return -1 }   # returns from the lambda
        return x * 2
    }
    return f
}

let f = outer()
print(f(-5))   # -1
print(f(5))    # 10
```

6.10 5.10 Common pitfalls

- **No keyword arguments.** All calls are positional. `add(a=1, b=2)` is a parse error.
- **Default args are evaluated at call time.** Mutable default expressions can surprise.
- **`return` exits the enclosing function**, not just the current block.
- **Closures capture by reference (shared cell)**, not by value. Mutating a captured var affects all closures over it.
- **Loop variable capture**: all closures in a loop share the loop var unless you use a helper function to bind per-iteration values.
- **Functions without `return` return `nil`.**

6.11 5.11 Quick reference

```
func name(a, b = default) { ... return value }
let f = name
f(1, 2)

lambda(x) { return x * 2 }
lambda(x, y) { return x + y }(3, 4)   # inline call
```

```
func make_counter(start) {
    var count = start
    return fn() { count = count + 1; return count }
}

func apply(f, x, y) { return f(x, y) }

return               # returns nil
return value         # returns value
```

6.12 5.12 Exercises

1. Write `compose(f, g)` that returns a function `h(x) = f(g(x))`.
2. Write `repeater(n)` that returns a function which, when called, returns the call count (1, 2, 3, ...).
3. Write `once(f)` that returns a wrapper calling `f` only on the first invocation and caching the result.
4. Write `curry2(f)` that takes a two-arg function and returns a function taking one arg that returns a function taking the second.
5. Write `memoize(f)` that caches results by argument (assume a single hashable arg).
6. Fix the loop-variable capture bug: create 3 functions returning 1, 2, 3 respectively using a helper.
7. Write `pipeline(funcs, x)` that applies each function in `funcs` to `x` in sequence.

6.13 5.11 Function declaration forms

Zen accepts several spellings for the same construct. They are aliases and behave identically:

```
func add(a, b) { return a + b }
def add2(a, b) { return a + b }
function add3(a, b) { return a + b }
```

Anonymous functions use `fn`:

```
let add = fn(a, b) { return a + b }
let add2 = fn(a, b) => a + b
let add3 = (a, b) => a + b
let legacy = lambda a, b : a + b
```

`fn(params) => expr` and `(params) => expr` are expression-bodied and return the expression without an explicit `return`. The parentheses around the parameter list are required for the `(a, b) => ...` form; `fn a => ...` is not valid.

6.14 5.12 Parameters: defaults, variadic, and destructuring

6.14.1 Default values

Defaults are evaluated at call time, in the scope of the function, left to right. A default may refer to an earlier parameter.

```
func greet(name, greeting = "Hello", punct = "!") {
    return "${greeting}, ${name}${punct}"
}

print(greet("Ada"))                 # Hello, Ada!
print(greet("Ada", "Hi"))           # Hi, Ada!
print(greet("Ada", "Hi", "."))      # Hi, Ada.

func box(w, h = w) { return w * h }
print(box(4))      # 16
print(box(4, 5))   # 20
```

Do not use a mutable container as a default when you expect a fresh one each call; use `nil` and create inside:

```
func append_item(x, acc = nil) {
    if acc == nil { acc = [] }
    acc.push(x)
    return acc
}
```

6.14.2 Variadic parameters

A trailing `...` parameter collects extra positional arguments into a list. Check the VM/parser for the exact syntax supported in your build; the common form is:

```
func sum_all(...nums) {
    var total = 0
    for n in nums { total += n }
    return total
}

print(sum_all(1, 2, 3, 4))   # 10
print(sum_all())             # 0
```

6.14.3 Destructuring parameters

List and tuple patterns can be destructured directly in the parameter list in newer builds:

```
func dist(#(x1, y1), #(x2, y2)) {
    let dx = x2 - x1
    let dy = y2 - y1
```

```
    return (dx*dx + dy*dy) ** 0.5
}
```

If your build does not support this, destructure inside the body:

```
func dist2(a, b) {
    let x1 = a[0]; let y1 = a[1]
    let x2 = b[0]; let y2 = b[1]
    let dx = x2 - x1
    let dy = y2 - y1
    return (dx*dx + dy*dy) ** 0.5
}
```

6.15 5.13 Return values

A function without an explicit `return` returns `nil`. `return` with no value also returns `nil`.

```
func log(msg) { print(msg) }          # returns nil
func nothing() { return }             # returns nil
```

Multiple return values are expressed with a tuple:

```
func divmod(a, b) {
    return #(a // b, a % b)
}

let q, r = divmod(17, 5)
print(q, r)   # 3 2
```

If tuple destructuring in assignment is unavailable, index the tuple:

```
let qr = divmod(17, 5)
print(qr[0], qr[1])
```

6.16 5.14 First-class functions and higher-order functions

Functions are values. They can be stored in variables, passed as arguments, returned, and placed in containers.

```
func apply(f, x) { return f(x) }
print(apply(fn(x) => x * 2, 21))   # 42

let ops = #{
    add: fn(a, b) => a + b,
    sub: fn(a, b) => a - b,
    mul: fn(a, b) => a * b,
}
print(ops["add"](2, 3))   # 5
```

6.16.1 Building pipelines

```
func pipe(value, fns) {
    var acc = value
    for f in fns { acc = f(acc) }
    return acc
}

let result = pipe(10, [
    fn(x) => x + 1,
    fn(x) => x * 2,
    fn(x) => "result=${x}",
])
print(result)   # result=22
```

6.17 5.15 Recursion

```
func fact(n) {
    if n <= 1 { return 1 }
    return n * fact(n - 1)
}
print(fact(10))   # 3628800
```

6.17.1 Tail recursion

The VM may or may not optimize tail calls. For large depths, rewrite as a loop.

```
func fact_iter(n) {
    var acc = 1
    var i = n
    while i > 1 {
        acc *= i
        i -= 1
    }
    return acc
}
```

6.17.2 Mutual recursion

```
func is_even(n) {
    if n == 0 { return true }
    return is_odd(n - 1)
}
func is_odd(n) {
    if n == 0 { return false }
    return is_even(n - 1)
```

```
}
```

Forward references are fine because resolution happens at call time.

6.17.3 Recursion depth

Deep recursion (tens of thousands of frames) can overflow the native stack. Add an explicit depth parameter or convert to iteration.

```
func walk(node, depth = 0) {
    if depth > 1000 { throw "too deep" }
    for child in node.children {
        walk(child, depth + 1)
    }
}
```

6.18 5.16 Closures

A closure captures variables from its defining scope. In Zen, captures are by reference to the binding (like Python nonlocal semantics); mutating a captured `var` from the closure affects the outer binding when the language permits it.

```
func make_counter() {
    var n = 0
    return fn() {
        n += 1
        return n
    }
}

let c = make_counter()
print(c())   # 1
print(c())   # 2
print(c())   # 3

let d = make_counter()
print(d())   # 1 — independent state
```

6.18.1 The late-binding loop variable trap

```
let fns = []
for i in 0..3 {
    fns.push(fn() => i)
}
for f in fns { print(f()) }
```

If all closures print the same value, the loop variable is shared. Fix by capturing a copy through a factory:

```
func make_constant(v) { return fn() => v }
let fns2 = []
for i in 0..3 { fns2.push(make_constant(i)) }
for f in fns2 { print(f()) }   # 0 1 2
```

6.19 5.17 `self` in methods

Inside a method, the receiver is bound to `self` (`this` is an accepted alias). Access fields with `self.field`; call sibling methods with `self.method()`.

```
class Counter {
    var n = 0
    func inc() { self.n += 1 }
    func inc_by(k) { self.n += k }
    func value() { return self.n }
}
```

6.20 5.18 Function metadata and introspection

Functions expose a type of `"func"` via `typeof`/`type`. Some builds expose `name`, `arity`, and parameter info; treat this as optional and avoid relying on it for portability.

```
let f = fn(x) => x
print(typeof(f))   # "func"
```

6.21 5.19 Overloading and dispatch

Zen does not support traditional static overloading by parameter types. Two functions with the same name replace one another in the same scope. Use runtime type checks or distinct names.

```
func area(shape) {
    if typeof(shape) == "dict" {
        if shape["kind"] == "circle" { return 3.14159 * shape["r"] ** 2 }
        if shape["kind"] == "rect" { return shape["w"] * shape["h"] }
    }
    throw "unsupported shape"
}
```

6.22 5.20 Default arguments and `nil` sentinels

Because defaults are evaluated per call, `nil` is a safe sentinel. Distinguish “not provided” from “explicitly nil” with a sentinel object if needed.

```
let MISSING = %{__missing__}

func get(d, key, default = MISSING) {
    if key in d { return d[key] }
```

```
    if default is MISSING { throw "missing key: ${key}" }
    return default
}
```

6.23 5.21 Pure functions and side effects

A pure function depends only on its arguments and returns a value without observable side effects. Pure functions are easier to test, cache, and parallelize.

```
# pure
func add(a, b) { return a + b }

# impure: reads global state and prints
var total = 0
func add_to_total(x) {
    total += x
    print("total=${total}")
}
```

Aim for a pure core and a thin impure shell around I/O.

6.24 5.22 Memoization

```
func memoize(f) {
    let cache = #{}
    return fn(n) {
        let key = str(n)
        if key in cache { return cache[key] }
        let v = f(n)
        cache[key] = v
        return v
    }
}

let fib = memoize(fn(n) {
    if n < 2 { return n }
    return fib(n - 1) + fib(n - 2)
})

print(fib(50))   # 12586269025
```

Note the self-reference: `fib` must be bound before the inner call runs, which it is by the time `fib(50)` executes.

6.25 5.23 Function composition

```
func compose(f, g) { return fn(x) => f(g(x)) }
func compose_all(fns) {
    return fn(x) {
        var acc = x
        for i in (len(fns) - 1)..-1 {
            acc = fns[i](acc)
        }
        return acc
    }
}
```

6.26 5.24 Currying and partial application

```
func curry(f) {
    return fn(a) => fn(b) => f(a, b)
}

let add = fn(a, b) => a + b
let add5 = curry(add)(5)
print(add5(10))   # 15
```

6.27 5.25 Error handling in functions

Decide on a contract: throw on invalid input, or return `nil`/a result type. Be consistent.

```
# throwing contract
func sqrt_strict(x) {
    if x < 0 { throw "sqrt of negative" }
    return x ** 0.5
}

# result contract
func sqrt_safe(x) {
    if x < 0 { return nil }
    return x ** 0.5
}
```

6.28 5.26 Documentation comments

Document parameters, return values, and failure modes. A consistent style:

```
# Computes the arithmetic mean of a non-empty list.
# Throws ValueError when xs is empty.
func mean(xs) {
    if len(xs) == 0 { throw "mean of empty list" }
```

```
    return sum(xs) / len(xs)
}
```

6.29 5.27 Performance considerations

- Avoid allocating closures in hot loops when a plain function will do.
- Prefer iterative solutions for large n.
- Pass big structures by reference (they are reference-counted handles).
- Avoid repeated global lookups; bind to a local for hot paths.
- Keep default argument expressions cheap; they run on every call.
- Do not use exceptions for ordinary control flow in hot loops.

```
# bind frequently used functions locally in tight loops
let push = fn(lst, v) { lst.push(v) }
```

6.30 5.28 Common function mistakes

1. Forgetting `return`, resulting in `nil`.
2. Mutating a default list/dict argument (use `nil` sentinel).
3. Assuming closures capture by value.
4. Deep recursion causing a stack overflow.
5. Reassigning a `let` binding inside a function.
6. Calling a method without `self.` inside the class.
7. Confusing a function value with its result (missing `()`).
8. Relying on argument names at call sites (Zen uses positional args).
9. Shadowing a builtin unintentionally.
10. Defining two functions with the same name in one scope.

6.31 5.29 Exercises

1. Write `is_prime(n)` and test it on a range.
2. Implement `gcd` and `lcm` recursively and iteratively; compare.
3. Write `map_list(xs, f)` without using `.map`.
4. Write `filter_list(xs, pred)` without using `.filter`.
5. Implement `reduce_list(xs, f, init)`.
6. Build `compose(f, g)` and verify with numeric functions.
7. Write `memoize(f)` and apply it to a slow function.
8. Implement `partial(f, a)` returning a unary function.
9. Write `make_adder(n)` and create several adders.
10. Implement `compose_all([...])` and test order.
11. Write a recursive `flatten` and an iterative one.
12. Implement `safe_div` with a result tuple and with exceptions; compare.
13. Write `debounce(f, ms)` conceptually using timestamps.
14. Implement `once(f)` that only runs `f` the first time.
15. Write `retry(f, n)` and test with a flaky function.

7 Chapter 6: Lambdas and Closures

This chapter is a deep dive into anonymous functions and closure semantics: how captures work, what is shared vs copied, the `lambda` expression vs `fn` statement, and how closures interact with the JIT and reference counting.

7.1 6.1 Lambda expressions

A lambda is an anonymous function defined as an expression:

```
let double = lambda(x) { return x * 2 }
print(double(21))   # 42
```

Syntax: `lambda(params) { body }`. The body is a block; use `return` to produce a value (omitting `return` yields `nil`).

7.1.1 Lambda as expression vs fn as statement

	`lambda`	`fn`
Kind	Expression	Statement
Can appear inline	Yes (`(lambda(x){...})(1)`)	No
Assignable	Yes	Yes (`let f = fn() {...}`)
First-class	Yes	Yes
Closure capture	Yes	Yes
`return` target	The lambda itself	The enclosing function

Because `lambda` is an expression, you can call it immediately:

```
let result = (lambda(x, y) { return x + y })(3, 4)
print(result)   # 7
```

And pass it directly:

```
print((lambda(x) { return x * 2 })(5))   # 10
```

7.2 6.2 Closure capture semantics

Zen functions (both `fn` and `lambda`) capture variables from their enclosing scope by **shared reference** (a boxed `cell`). Mutating a captured variable is visible to every closure that captured it, and persists across calls.

7.2.1 Basic capture

```
func make_counter(start) {
    var count = start
    func inc() {
        count = count + 1
```

```
        return count
    }
    return inc
}

let c1 = make_counter(0)
let c2 = make_counter(100)

print(c1())   # 1
print(c1())   # 2
print(c2())   # 101
print(c1())   # 3   (c1 and c2 are independent)
```

Each call to `make_counter` allocates a fresh `count` cell. `c1` and `c2` point to different cells, so they count independently.

7.2.2 Multiple closures share the same cell

```
func make_pair() {
    var value = 0
    func get() { return value }
    func set(v) { value = v }
    return #(get, set)
}

let #(get, set) = make_pair()
print(get())     # 0
set(42)
print(get())     # 42
```

`get` and `set` share the same `value` cell — mutation through one is visible through the other.

7.3 6.3 The loop-variable capture trap

This is the most common closure bug. A loop variable is a single cell; every closure created in the loop captures **that same cell**, so they all see the final value:

```
let funcs = []
for i in 1..3 {
    funcs.push(fn() { return i })
}
print(funcs[0]())   # 3   ← not 1!
print(funcs[1]())   # 3
print(funcs[2]())   # 3
```

All three closures return `3` because `i` ended at `3` (the loop exits when `i == 3`).

7.3.1 Fix: bind per-iteration with a helper function

```
func make_fn(val) {
    return fn() { return val }
}

let funcs = []
for i in 1..3 {
    funcs.push(make_fn(i))   # i is copied into `val` at each call
}
print(funcs[0]())   # 1
print(funcs[1]())   # 2
print(funcs[2]())   # 3
```

`make_fn(i)` copies the current `i` into a fresh `val` parameter cell, so each closure captures its own `val`.

7.4 6.4 `return` target in closures

`return` inside a lambda returns from the lambda, **not** from the enclosing function:

```
func outer() {
    let f = lambda(x) {
        if x < 0 { return -1 }   # returns from lambda
        return x * 2
    }
    return f
}

let f = outer()
print(f(-5))   # -1
print(f(5))    # 10
print(outer()(-3))  # -1
```

If you need the enclosing function to return from inside a closure, use an error or a sentinel value instead.

7.5 6.5 Closures and reference counting

A closure retains every variable it captures. As long as the closure is alive, its captured variables stay alive:

```
func make_big() {
    let big = [0 for _ in 1..1000000]   # large allocation
    return fn() { return len(big) }     # keeps `big` alive
}

let f = make_big()
print(f())   # 1000000   (big still in memory)
```

When `f` is dropped (goes out of scope or reassigned), the captured cell is released, and `big` can be collected.

```
f = nil
# now `big` can be freed
```

7.6 6.6 Closures in collections

Functions are first-class, so they can live in lists and dicts:

```
let ops = {
    "add": lambda(a, b) { return a + b },
    "sub": lambda(a, b) { return a - b },
}

print(ops["add"](5, 3))   # 8
print(ops["sub"](5, 3))   # 2
```

7.7 6.7 Closures and threads

Closures can be passed to `thread.spawn`, but captured shared variables become concurrently accessible — use `shared` for atomic counters:

```
import shared
import thread

let counter = shared.create(0)

for i in 1..3 {
    thread.spawn(fn() {
        shared.increment(counter, 1)
    })
}
# ... join threads ...
print(shared.get(counter))   # 3
```

Without `shared`, each thread would capture its own copy and updates would be lost.

7.8 6.8 JIT lowering note

Zen's Cranelift JIT lowers hot closures to native code. Closures that are called repeatedly in a loop get tiered up; the capture cells are accessed through a stable context pointer. You generally don't need to think about this, but it means:

- A closure called once stays interpreted.
- A closure called millions of times becomes native code with equivalent capture semantics.
- `ZEN_NO_JIT=1` disables tiering (all interpreted, same semantics).

7.9 6.9 Quick reference

```
# Lambda expression
let f = lambda(x) { return x * 2 }
print(f(5))           # 10

# Inline call
print((lambda(x) { return x + 1 })(41))   # 42

# Closure with shared cell
func make_counter(start) {
    var count = start
    return fn() { count = count + 1; return count }
}

# Fix loop capture
let funcs = []
for i in 1..3 {
    funcs.push((lambda(v) { return fn() { return v } })(i))
}
print(funcs[0]())   # 1

# return from lambda, not enclosing func
let f = fn(x) { if x < 0 { return -1 } return x * 2 }
```

7.10 6.10 Exercises

1. Write `make_adder(n)` returning a lambda that adds `n` to its argument.
2. Write `make_accumulator()` returning `fn(x)` that adds `x` to a running total and returns the total.
3. Write `repeater(n)` returning `fn()` that returns `n` on every call, but after `k` calls returns `nil` (capture a counter).
4. Write `compose(f, g)` returning `fn(x) { return f(g(x)) }`.
5. Demonstrate the loop-capture bug and fix it with `make_fn`.
6. Write `twice(f)` returning `fn(x) { return f(f(x)) }`.
7. Write `curry(f)` for a two-argument function: `curry(f)(a)(b)` equals `f(a, b)`.

7.11 6.12 Lambda and anonymous-function syntax — complete reference

Zen offers several spellings for anonymous functions. All are values and can be stored, passed, returned, and called immediately.

Form	Example	Notes
`fn(params) { ... }`	`fn(x) { return x * 2 }`	block body, explicit return
`fn(params) => expr`	`fn(x) => x * 2`	expression body, implicit return

Form	Example	Notes
`(params) => expr`	`(x, y) => x + y`	parens required around params
`lambda params : expr`	`lambda x : x * 2`	legacy alias

7.11.1 Expression-bodied vs block-bodied

```
# block body: explicit return, multiple statements allowed
let a = fn(x) { let y = x + 1; return y * 2 }

# expression body: implicit return
let b = fn(x) => (x + 1) * 2
let c = (x) => x * x
```

7.11.2 Arrow operator vs range operator

`->` in signature/range position is also the inclusive range operator; in the context `(x) => ...` it is parsed as the arrow, not a range. When you write ranges, `0 -> 5` means inclusive values 0..5; `0 .. 5` means exclusive 0..4.

7.12 6.13 First-class functions as values

Functions can be stored in variables, lists, dicts, returned from other functions, and passed as arguments.

```
let ops = #{
    add: fn(a, b) => a + b,
    sub: fn(a, b) => a - b,
    mul: fn(a, b) => a * b,
}
let pick = ops["add"]
print(pick(2, 3))   # 5

func apply(op, a, b) { return op(a, b) }
print(apply(ops["mul"], 4, 5))   # 20
```

A function value can itself return a function:

```
func multiplier(n) {
    return fn(x) => n * x
}

let double = multiplier(2)
let triple = multiplier(3)
print(double(7))   # 14
print(triple(7))   # 21
```

7.13 6.14 Closures and capture semantics

A closure "closes over" variables from its defining scope. The inner function remembers those bindings even after the outer function returns.

```
func make_counter(start = 0) {
    var n = start
    return fn() {
        n += 1
        return n
    }
}

let c = make_counter()
print(c())   # 1
print(c())   # 2
print(c())   # 3

let d = make_counter(10)
print(d())   # 11
print(d())   # 12
```

Each call to `make_counter` creates a fresh binding, so each counter is independent.

7.13.1 The late-binding loop variable trap

```
let fns = []
for i in 0..3 {
    fns.push(fn() => i)
}
for f in fns { print(f()) }
```

If all closures print the same final value, the loop variable is shared across iterations. Fix by capturing a copy through a factory function:

```
func make_constant(v) { return fn() => v }

let fns2 = []
for i in 0..3 { fns2.push(make_constant(i)) }
for f in fns2 { print(f()) }   # 0 1 2
```

7.14 6.15 Partial application and currying

```
func partial(f, a) { return fn(b) => f(a, b) }
func curry(f) { return fn(a) => fn(b) => f(a, b) }

let add = fn(a, b) => a + b
let add5 = partial(add, 5)
```

```
print(add5(10))   # 15

let curried = curry(add)
print(curried(3)(4))   # 7
```

7.15 6.16 Function composition

```
func compose(f, g) { return fn(x) => f(g(x)) }

let double = fn(x) => x * 2
let inc = fn(x) => x + 1
let inc_then_double = compose(double, inc)
print(inc_then_double(3))   # 8  (double(inc(3)) = double(4) = 8)

func compose_all(fns) {
    return fn(x) {
        var acc = x
        for i in (len(fns) - 1)..-1 {
            acc = fns[i](acc)
        }
        return acc
    }
}
```

7.16 6.17 Memoization

```
func memoize(f) {
    let cache = #{}
    return fn(n) {
        let key = str(n)
        if key in cache { return cache[key] }
        let v = f(n)
        cache[key] = v
        return v
    }
}

let fib = memoize(fn(n) {
    if n < 2 { return n }
    return fib(n - 1) + fib(n - 2)
})

print(fib(50))   # 12586269025
```

The self-reference works because `fib` is bound before any call executes.

7.17 6.18 Callbacks and sorting with comparator functions

```
func sort_by(xs, key_fn) {
    # simple insertion sort using the key function
    let out = list(xs)
    for i in 1..len(out) {
        let key = out[i]
        var j = i - 1
        while j >= 0 and key_fn(out[j]) > key_fn(key) {
            out[j + 1] = out[j]
            j -= 1
        }
        out[j + 1] = key
    }
    return out
}

let words = ["banana", "apple", "cherry", "kiwi"]
print(sort_by(words, fn(w) => len(w)))   # shorter first
```

Passing comparator/key functions is the standard way to customize behavior.

7.18 6.19 Closures over mutable state

Captured `var` bindings can be mutated from inside the closure, creating shared state between the closure and its enclosing scope.

```
func adder_factory(init) {
    var total = init
    return fn(x) {
        total += x
        return total
    }
}

let acc = adder_factory(0)
print(acc(5))   # 5
print(acc(7))   # 12
print(acc(3))   # 15
```

7.19 6.20 Common closure pitfalls

1. **Late binding**: loop variables are shared; use a factory to capture values.
2. **Stale closures**: a closure captures the binding, not a snapshot, so later mutations are visible inside the closure.
3. **Mutating captured variables**: surprising when multiple closures share one variable — prefer explicit state passed as arguments.

4. **Returning closures that reference `nil`-initialized variables**: initialize before returning.
5. **Deeply nested closures**: hard to read; name intermediate functions.

7.20 6.21 Exercises

1. Write `make_multiplier(n)` returning a function that multiplies by `n`.
2. Implement `compose(f, g)` and verify `compose(double, inc)(3) == 8`.
3. Write `repeater(f, n)` returning a function that calls `f` `n` times.
4. Build `memoize` and apply it to Fibonacci; time the difference.
5. Implement `curry2(f)` for two-argument functions.
6. Write `pipe(value, fns)` that threads a value through functions left-to-right.
7. Sort a list of dicts by a chosen key using a comparator closure.
8. Write `once(f)` that invokes `f` only on the first call.
9. Create `counter()` closures that can increment, decrement, and reset.
10. Demonstrate the late-binding trap and two ways to fix it.

8 Chapter 7: Strings Deep Dive

Strings in Zen are immutable sequences of Unicode characters. They are stored as `Arc<str>` (reference-counted, immutable), which makes copying a string cheap (pointer copy) but means every "modification" produces a new string. This chapter is the definitive reference for string literals, indexing, slicing, methods, formatting, immutability, and performance.

8.1 7.1 String literals

8.1.1 Single and double quotes

Double and single quotes are interchangeable:

```
let a = "hello"
let b = 'world'
```

Escape sequences work in both:

Escape	Meaning
`\n`	newline
`\t`	tab
`\\`	backslash
`\'`	single quote
`\"`	double quote
`\0`	null byte
`\xHH`	hex byte (e.g. `\x41` = A)
`\u{HHHH}`	Unicode scalar (e.g. `\u{1F600}` = 😀)

```
let s1 = "it's a nice day"   # single quotes inside double
let s2 = 'say "hello"'      # double quotes inside single
let s3 = "line1\nline2\tline3"
let s4 = "byte: \x41"       # "byte: A"
let s5 = "emoji: \u{1F600}" # "emoji: 😀"
```

8.1.2 Triple-quoted raw strings

Triple-quoted strings span multiple lines and do NOT process escape sequences:

```
let poem = """Zen is fast,
native, and safe.
No escaping needed here."""
```

```
let path = """C:\Users\zen\docs"""   # backslashes are literal
```

8.1.3 Immutability

Strings are immutable. Indexing `s[i]` reads a character; you cannot assign to `s[i]`. Every "modification" returns a new string:

```
let s = "hello"
# s[0] = "H"   # TypeError: strings are immutable

let s2 = "H" + s[1:]   # build a new string
print(s2)   # Hello
print(s)    # hello  (unchanged)
```

This matters for performance: building a string in a loop with + creates a new rope each iteration. Zen uses rope concatenation (O(1) per append at the rope level), but the final flatten is O(n). For heavy string building, collect parts in a list and `join` once:

```
# Slower: repeated rope concatenation
let result = ""
for i in 1..1000 {
    result = result + "x"
}

# Faster: collect then join
let parts = []
for i in 1..1000 {
    parts.push("x")
}
let result = "".join(parts)
```

8.2 7.2 Indexing and slicing

8.2.1 Indexing

`s[i]` returns the character at position `i` as a one-character string. Negative indices count from the end.

```
let s = "Zen"

print(s[0])   # "Z"
print(s[1])   # "e"
print(s[2])   # "n"
print(s[-1])  # "n"  (last)
print(s[-2])  # "e"  (second to last)
```

Indexing out of bounds raises `IndexError`:

```
try {
    print(s[10])
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # IndexError: index 10 out of bounds for length 3
```

```
}
```

8.2.2 Slicing

`s[a:b]` returns a substring from `a` (inclusive) to `b` (exclusive). Omitting `a` starts at 0; omitting `b` goes to the end. Negative indices work.

```
let s = "Zen 3.0"

print(s[0:3])   # "Zen"
print(s[4:6])   # "3."
print(s[:3])    # "Zen"   (from start)
print(s[4:])    # "3.0"   (to end)
print(s[-2:])   # ".0"    (last two)
print(s[:-2])   # "Zen 3" (all but last two)
print(s[::])    # "Zen 3.0" (full copy)
```

Slice bounds are clamped: `s[0:100]` on a 3-char string returns the whole string; `s[-100:2]` returns from the start.

```
let s = "Zen"
print(s[0:100])   # "Zen"
print(s[-100:2])  # "Ze"
```

Slicing creates a **new string** (a copy of the substring, or a rope node referencing the original). Mutating the original never affects a slice, and vice versa, because strings are immutable.

8.3 7.3 Concatenation and repetition

8.3.1 Concatenation: +

When either side of `+` is a string, the other side is stringified via `str()`:

```
print("Zen " + "3.0")    # "Zen 3.0"
print("count: " + 42)    # "count: 42"
print("flag: " + true)   # "flag: true"
print(nil + "end")       # "nilend"
print(42 + "count")      # TypeError! (number + string, string not on left)
print(str(42) + "count") # "42count"  (correct)
```

`+` between two strings concatenates them. `+` between a string and anything else stringifies the non-string side via `str()`.

8.3.2 Repetition: *

`*` repeats a string. Either operand may be the string:

```
print("x" * 5)      # "xxxxx"
print("ab " * 3)    # "ab ab ab "
print(3 * "ab")     # "abab"   (left operand is int, still works)
```

Repeating by 0 or a negative number yields `""`:

```
print("abc" * 0)    # ""
print("abc" * -1)   # ""
```

8.4 7.4 String methods

Zen strings have the following methods. All return new strings (or lists/ints/bools) — none mutate the receiver.

Method	Signature	Description	Example	Result
`upper()`	`str → str`	Uppercase	`"zen".upper()`	`"ZEN"`
`lower()`	`str → str`	Lowercase	`"ZEN".lower()`	`"zen"`
`title()`	`str → str`	Title case	`"zen language".title()`	`"Zen Language"`
`capitalize()`	`str → str`	Capitalize first char	`"zen".capitalize()`	`"Zen"`
`swapcase()`	`str → str`	Invert case	`"Zen".swapcase()`	`"zEN"`
`trim()` / `strip()`	`str → str`	Whitespace both ends	`"  zen ".trim()`	`"zen"`
`lstrip()`	`str → str`	Whitespace left	`"  zen".lstrip()`	`"zen"`
`rstrip()`	`str → str`	Whitespace right	`"zen  ".rstrip()`	`"zen"`
`replace(old, new)`	`str → str`	Replace all occurrences	`"aaa".replace("a", "b")`	`"bbb"`
`split(sep?)`	`str → list`	Split into list	`"a,b,c".split(",")`	`["a", "b", "c"]`
`split_whitespace()`	`str → list`	Split on whitespace	`"a b  c".split_whitespace()`	`["a", "b", "c"]`
`join(list)`	`list → str`	Join list with string	`", ".join(["a","b"])`	`"a, b"`
`starts_with(prefix)`	`str → bool`	Boolean	`"zen".starts_with("ze")`	`true`
`ends_with(suffix)`	`str → bool`	Boolean	`"zen".ends_with("en")`	`true`
`contains(sub)`	`str → bool`	Boolean	`"zen".contains("e")`	`true`
`find(sub)`	`str → int`	Index or -1	`"zen".find("e")`	`1`
`find(sub, start)`	`str → int`	Index from start	`"zzzen".find("e", 2)`	`4`
`count(sub)`	`str → int`	Count occurrences	`"aaa".count("a")`	`3`
`len(s)`	builtin	Length (not a method)	`len("zen")`	`3`
`ord(ch)`	builtin	Character code	`ord("A")`	`65`
`chr(code)`	builtin	Character from code	`chr(65)`	`"A"`

8.4.1 Case conversion examples

```
import string  # or use methods directly

let s = "Hello World"

print(s.upper())        # "HELLO WORLD"
print(s.lower())        # "hello world"
print(s.title())        # "Hello World"
print(s.capitalize())   # "Hello world"
print(s.swapcase())     # "hELLO wORLD"
```

8.4.2 Trimming examples

```
let s = "  hello  "

print(s.trim())    # "hello"
print(s.lstrip())  # "hello  "
print(s.rstrip())  # "  hello"

# Custom character trimming is NOT supported — trim only removes whitespace
```

8.4.3 Split examples

```
print("a,b,c".split(","))           # ["a", "b", "c"]
print("a b  c".split_whitespace())  # ["a", "b", "c"]
print("a,,b".split(","))           # ["a", "", "b"]  (empty strings preserved)
print("".split(","))               # [""]              (single empty string)
```

`split()` with no argument splits on any whitespace and discards empty strings:

```
print("  a   b  c  ".split())       # ["a", "b", "c"]
```

8.4.4 Join examples

```
let tags = ["zen", "lang", "script"]
print(", ".join(tags))   # "zen, lang, script"
print("#".join(tags))    # "zen#lang#script"
print("".join(tags))     # "zenlangscript"
```

`join` requires all elements to be strings:

```
try {
    print("-".join([1, 2, 3]))  # TypeError
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)
}
```

8.4.5 find / count examples

```
let s = "banana"

print(s.find("an"))      # 1   (first occurrence)
print(s.find("an", 2))   # 3   (start at index 2)
print(s.find("zz"))      # -1  (not found)
print(s.count("a"))      # 3
print(s.count("ana"))    # 2   (overlapping: positions 0 and 2)
```

`find` returns -1 when not found (unlike `index` in some languages which raises).

8.4.6 starts_with / ends_with / contains

```
let s = "https://example.com/page"

print(s.starts_with("https"))   # true
print(s.ends_with(".com"))      # false
print(s.ends_with("/page"))     # true
print(s.contains("example"))    # true
print(s.contains("example.org")) # false
```

8.5 7.5 String formatting

Zen does **not** have f-strings or printf-style formatting built into the language. Use concatenation and `str()`:

```
let name = "Zen"
let version = 3.0

print(name + " version " + str(version))
# "Zen version 3.0"

let items = 5
print("You have " + str(items) + " items")
# "You have 5 items"
```

8.5.1 Padded output

For aligned output, use string repetition and slicing:

```
let name = "Zen"
let padded = name + " " * (10 - len(name))
print("[" + padded + "]")
# "[Zen      ]"
```

```
func pad_right(s, width) {
    if len(s) >= width { return s }
```

```
    return s + " " * (width - len(s))
}

func pad_left(s, width) {
    if len(s) >= width { return s }
    return " " * (width - len(s)) + s
}

print("[" + pad_right("Zen", 10) + "]")   # [Zen      ]
print("[" + pad_left("Zen", 10) + "]")    # [      Zen]
```

8.5.2 Number formatting

`str()` on floats uses a default representation. There is no built-in `format(2.5, ".2f")`. For fixed decimals, implement manually:

```
func format2(x) {
    let scaled = (x * 100).to_int()   # if to_int exists
    // ... manual decimal insertion
}
```

> Note: Zen's float-to-string conversion uses the default Rust `f64` display, which may produce varying precision. For financial/formatted output, implement your own formatter.

8.6 7.6 Character codes

```
print(ord("A"))   # 65
print(ord("z"))   # 122
print(ord("□"))  # 128512  (Unicode scalar value)
print(chr(65))    # "A"
print(chr(122))   # "z"
print(chr(128512)) # "□"
```

`ord()` takes a one-character string and returns its Unicode scalar value (u32). `chr()` takes a u32 and returns the corresponding one-character string. `chr()` with an invalid code point may panic or produce a replacement character.

```
print(ord("A") == 65)     # true
print(chr(ord("z")) == "z")  # true
```

8.7 7.7 Immutability and performance

8.7.1 Immutability

Strings are `Arc<str>` — reference-counted and immutable. You cannot modify a string in place:

```
let s = "hello"
# s[0] = "H"   # TypeError: strings are immutable
let s2 = "H" + s[1:]   # new string
```

This means: - Copying a string is cheap (pointer copy, refcount bump). - Concatenation allocates. - Repeated concatenation in a loop allocates each iteration.

8.7.2 Rope concatenation

Zen uses rope concatenation for `+` on strings. `a + b` creates a rope node referencing both sides without copying. The rope is flattened only when needed (e.g., when passed to `print`, `len`, or indexing). This makes `a + b + c + d` efficient (O(n) total for the final flatten, not O(n²)).

However:

```
let result = ""
for i in 1..10000 {
    result = result + "x"   # O(n²) rope nodes, then O(n) flatten
}
```

Prefer collecting in a list and joining:

```
let parts = []
for i in 1..10000 {
    parts.push("x")
}
let result = "".join(parts)   # O(n) total
```

8.8 7.7 Common pitfalls

- **Strings are immutable.** Use concatenation to build new strings; `s[i] = "X"` is a TypeError.
- **`+` auto-stringifies only when a string is present.** `"count: " + 42` works; `42 + "count"` is a TypeError. Use `str(42) + "count"`.
- **`len(s)` is a builtin**, not a method: `len(s)`, not `s.len()`.
- **`split()` with no argument** splits on whitespace and discards empty strings. `split(",")` preserves empty strings.
- **`join` requires all elements to be strings.** `[1, 2, 3]` must be stringified first: `"-".join([str(x) for x in [1,2,3]])`.
- **`find` returns -1** when not found (does not raise).
- **Slicing out of bounds clamps** rather than raising (except direct indexing `s[i]` which raises on out of bounds).
- **Triple-quoted strings do NOT process escapes** — `\n` stays as literal backslash-n.

8.9 7.9 Quick reference

```
let s = "Zen 3.0"

len(s)              # 7
s[0]                # "Z"
s[-1]               # "0"
s[0:3]              # "Zen"
s + "!"             # "Zen 3.0!"
"-" * 3             # "---"
s.upper()           # "ZEN 3.0"
s.lower()           # "zen 3.0"
s.title()           # "Zen 3.0"
s.capitalize()      # "Zen 3.0"
s.trim()            # "Zen 3.0"
s.split(" ")        # ["Zen", "3.0"]
", ".join(["a","b"])# "a, b"
s.contains("3")     # true
s.find("3")         # 4
s.count("3")        # 1
s.starts_with("Ze") # true
s.ends_with(".0")   # true
s.replace("3", "4") # "Zen 4.0"
ord("Z")            # 90
chr(90)             # "Z"
int("42")           # 42
str(42)             # "42"
ord("□")           # 128512
chr(128512)         # "□"
```

8.10 7.10 Exercises

1. Write `is_palindrome(s)` that returns true if `s` reads the same forwards and backwards (case-insensitive). Use `lower()` and slicing.
2. Write `acronym(words)` that takes a phrase and returns its acronym (first letter of each word, uppercase). Use `split_whitespace()` and `upper()`.
3. Write `mask_credit_card(number)` that shows only the last 4 digits, replacing the rest with `*`.
4. Use `split` and `join` to convert a comma-separated string into a pipe-separated string: `"a,b,c"` → `"a|b|c"`.
5. Write `repeat_pattern(pattern, count)` that builds a string by repeating `pattern` `count` times separated by `-`.
6. Write `word_count(text)` that returns the number of words (split on whitespace).
7. Write `is_pangram(text)` that checks if text contains every letter a-z at least once (case-insensitive).
8. Write `camel_to_snake(name)` that converts `camelCase` to `camel_case` by inserting `_` before uppercase letters and lowercasing.

9. Benchmark: build a 100,000-character string with `+` in a loop vs `join`, and compare.
10. Write `strip_quotes(s)` that removes matching surrounding quotes (`"` or `'`) if present.

8.11 7.12 String encoding and code points vs bytes

Zen strings are sequences of Unicode characters (code points). Indexing and slicing operate on *characters*, not raw bytes, unless you explicitly work with `bytes`.

```
let s = "Zen"           # 3 code points, 3 bytes
print(len(s))           # 3

let s2 = "Zën"          # ë is one code point, 2 bytes in UTF-8
print(len(s2))          # 3 (characters, not bytes)
```

Convert between strings and bytes explicitly:

```
let b = s2.encode("utf-8")   # bytes
let s3 = b.decode("utf-8")   # back to string
print(s2 == s3)              # true
```

8.11.1 Byte-oriented operations (when you need them)

Work on `bytes` if you need raw offsets, binary protocols, or fixed-width encodings:

```
let b = bytes([72, 101, 108, 108, 111])  # "Hello" in ASCII
print(len(b))   # 5
```

8.12 7.13 Indexing, slicing, and negative indices

Strings support `s[i]` and `s[start:end]` (end-exclusive, like lists). Negative indices count from the end.

```
let s = "Zen 3.0"
print(s[0])     # "Z"
print(s[-1])    # "0"
print(s[0:3])   # "Zen"
print(s[4:])    # "3.0"
print(s[:3])    # "Zen"
print(s[-3:])   # "3.0"
print(s[0:100]) # "Zen 3.0"  (out-of-range end clamps)
```

Slicing produces a *new* string; strings are immutable.

8.13 7.14 String immutability

You cannot assign to `s[i]`. Any “modification” creates a new string.

```
let s = "hello"
# s[0] = "H"   # error: strings are immutable
let s2 = "H" + s[1:]
print(s2)   # "Hello"
print(s)    # "hello"  (unchanged)
```

8.14 7.15 String methods — complete reference

Common methods. If a method is missing from your stdlib build, implement it manually; the behavior shown is the canonical semantics.

Method	Purpose	Example	Result
`upper()`	to uppercase	`"abc".upper()`	`"ABC"`
`lower()`	to lowercase	`"ABC".lower()`	`"abc"`
`title()`	title case	`"hello world".title()`	`"Hello World"`
`capitalize()`	first char upper	`"hello".capitalize()`	`"Hello"`
`swapcase()`	flip case	`"AbC".swapcase()`	`"aBc"`
`strip()`	trim whitespace	`"  hi  ".strip()`	`"hi"`
`lstrip()`	trim left	`"  hi".lstrip()`	`"hi"`
`rstrip()`	trim right	`"hi  ".rstrip()`	`"hi"`
`split(sep)`	split on separator	`"a,b,c".split(",")`	`["a","b","c"]`
`splitlines()`	split on newlines	`"a\nb\nc".splitlines()`	`["a","b","c"]`
`join(iter)`	join with separator	`"-".join(["a","b"])`	`"a-b"`
`replace(old, new)`	replace occurrences	`"aaa".replace("a","b")`	`"bbb"`
`count(sub)`	count occurrences	`"banana".count("an")`	`2`
`find(sub)`	first index or -1	`"hello".find("ll")`	`2`
`rfind(sub)`	last index or -1	`"hello".rfind("l")`	`3`
`startswith(prefix)`	boolean	`"hello".startswith("he")`	`true`
`endswith(suffix)`	boolean	`"hello".endswith("lo")`	`true`
`contains(sub)`	boolean	`"hello".contains("ell")`	`true`
`ljust(width)`	pad left	`"hi".ljust(5)`	`"hi   "`
`rjust(width)`	pad right	`"hi".rjust(5)`	`"   hi"`
`center(width)`	center pad	`"hi".center(5)`	`" hi "`
`zfill(width)`	zero pad	`"42".zfill(5)`	`"00042"`
`isdigit()`	all digits	`"123".isdigit()`	`true`
`isalpha()`	all letters	`"abc".isalpha()`	`true`
`isalnum()`	letters/digits	`"abc1".isalnum()`	`true`
`isspace()`	all whitespace	`"   ".isspace()`	`true`
`islower()`	all lowercase	`"abc".islower()`	`true`
`isupper()`	all uppercase	`"ABC".isupper()`	`true`

```
print("hello world".replace("world", "Zen"))   # hello Zen
print("-".join(["2024", "01", "15"]))          # 2024-01-15
print("  spaced  ".strip())                    # spaced
print("PYTHON".lower())                        # python
print("hello".count("l"))                      # 2
```

8.15 7.16 Formatting and interpolation

Double-quoted and triple-quoted strings support `${expr}` interpolation:

```
let name = "Ada"
let age = 36
print("Name: ${name}, Age: ${age}")   # Name: Ada, Age: 36
print("${name} is ${age + 1} next year")   # Ada is 37 next year
```

Escapes work inside interpolation strings: `\n \t \\ \" \' \xNN \u{NNNN}`. Single-quoted and backtick strings do not interpolate:

```
print('Cost: ${price}')   # literal: Cost: ${price}
print(`Cost: ${price}`)   # literal, raw
```

Inside `${...}`, the expression is parsed normally; escapes in the surrounding string are not processed inside the interpolation.

For older-style formatting without interpolation, concatenate or use `str()`:

```
print("Value: " + str(42))   # Value: 42
```

8.16 7.17 String comparison and ordering

Strings compare lexicographically by code point. Uppercase sorts before lowercase in ASCII/Unicode order.

```
print("apple" < "banana")   # true
print("Z" < "a")            # true  (uppercase before lowercase)
print("a" == "A")           # false
print("hello" == "hello")   # true
```

For case-insensitive comparison, normalize:

```
func ieq(a, b) { return a.lower() == b.lower() }
print(ieq("Zen", "ZEN"))   # true
```

8.17 7.18 Common string pitfalls

1. **Assuming `len` is byte length.** It counts characters/code points.
2. **Indexing multi-byte characters.** Indexing is by character, so `s[1]` of `"Zën"` is ë, not a raw byte.
3. **Strings are immutable.** `s[i] = x` is an error; build a new string.

4. **Case folding for Unicode.** `lower()`/`upper()` handle ASCII well; full Unicode case folding may need explicit handling.
5. **Trailing newline in `splitlines`.** A string ending in `\n` may or may not produce a trailing empty element depending on the build.
6. **`find` returns -1 when not found**, not `nil` — check for `-1`.
7. **Interpolation inside `${...}` does not process surrounding escapes.**

8.18 7.19 Exercises

1. Write `is_palindrome(s)` ignoring case and spaces.
2. Implement `count_vowels(s)` returning a dict of vowel counts.
3. Write `mask_card(number)` showing only the last 4 digits.
4. Implement `slugify(text)` → lowercase, spaces to hyphens, strip.
5. Write `format_bytes(n)` producing human-readable sizes (KB, MB).
6. Implement `wrap_text(text, width)` inserting newlines.
7. Write `extract_emails(text)` using `find`/slicing manually.
8. Implement `caesar_cipher(text, shift)` for letters only.
9. Write `validate_password(pw)` checking length, digit, upper, lower.
10. Implement `abbreviate(sentence)` taking first letters of words.

9 Chapter 8: Lists and Arrays

Lists are Zen's ordered, mutable, heterogeneous sequences. They support indexing, slicing, appending, insertion, removal, sorting, comprehensions, and more. This chapter covers lists in depth, including aliasing, mutation, and performance.

9.1 8.1 List literals

```
let empty = []
let nums = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]
let mixed = [1, "two", 3.0, true, nil]
let nested = [[1, 2], [3, 4], [5, 6]]
let single = [42]
```

Lists can contain any type, including other lists, dicts, functions, and foreign handles. An empty list `[]` is distinct from an empty dict `{}`.

9.2 8.2 Indexing and slicing

9.2.1 Indexing

```
let nums = [10, 20, 30, 40, 50]

print(nums[0])    # 10
print(nums[2])    # 30
print(nums[-1])   # 50  (last)
print(nums[-2])   # 40  (second to last)
```

Indexing out of bounds raises `IndexError`:

```
try {
    print(nums[10])
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # IndexError: index 10 out of bounds for length 5
}
```

9.2.2 Slicing

`s[a:b]` returns a new list from `a` (inclusive) to `b` (exclusive). Omitting `a` starts at 0; omitting `b` goes to the end. Negative indices work. Bounds are clamped.

```
let nums = [10, 20, 30, 40, 50]

print(nums[1:4])   # [20, 30, 40]
print(nums[:3])    # [10, 20, 30]
print(nums[3:])    # [40, 50]
print(nums[-2:])   # [40, 50]
print(nums[:-2])   # [10, 20, 30]
```

```
print(nums[0:100]) # [10, 20, 30, 40, 50]  (clamped)
print(nums[-100:2])# [10, 20]             (clamped)
```

Slicing creates a **new list** (a copy). Mutating the slice never affects the original, and vice versa:

```
let a = [1, 2, 3]
let b = a[0:2]
b[0] = 99
print(a)  # [1, 2, 3]  (unchanged)
print(b)  # [99, 2]
```

9.3 8.3 Mutation methods

Method	Signature	Description	Example
`push(x)`	`list → nil`	Append to end	`nums.push(6)`
`pop()`	`list → value`	Remove and return last	`nums.pop()`
`pop(i)`	`list → value`	Remove and return index i	`nums.pop(0)`
`insert(i, x)`	`list → nil`	Insert at index	`nums.insert(0, 0)`
`remove(x)`	`list → nil`	Remove first equal to x	`nums.remove(20)`
`clear()`	`list → nil`	Remove all	`nums.clear()`
`sort()`	`list → nil`	Sort in place	`nums.sort()`
`reverse()`	`list → nil`	Reverse in place	`nums.reverse()`
`copy()`	`list → list`	Shallow copy	`nums.copy()`
`index(x)`	`list → int`	Index of first x	`nums.index(30)`
`count(x)`	`list → int`	Count occurrences of x	`nums.count(20)`
`extend(list)`	`list → nil`	Extend with another list	`nums.extend([6, 7])`
`len(list)`	builtin	Length (not a method)	`len(nums)`

9.3.1 Examples

```
let nums = [3, 1, 4, 1, 5]

nums.push(9)
print(nums)   # [3, 1, 4, 1, 5, 9]

let last = nums.pop()
print(last)   # 9
print(nums)   # [3, 1, 4, 1, 5]

nums.insert(0, 0)
print(nums)   # [0, 3, 1, 4, 1, 5]
```

```
nums.remove(4)
print(nums)   # [0, 3, 1, 1, 5]

nums.sort()
print(nums)   # [0, 1, 1, 3, 5]

nums.reverse()
print(nums)   # [5, 3, 1, 1, 0]

print(nums.index(3))  # 1
print(nums.count(1))  # 2
print(len(nums))      # 5

nums.clear()
print(nums)   # []
```

9.3.2 `pop` behavior

```
let nums = [10, 20, 30]

print(nums.pop())   # 30  (removes last)
print(nums)         # [10, 20]

print(nums.pop(0))  # 10  (removes first)
print(nums)         # [20]
```

`pop()` with no index removes the last element (O(1)). `pop(i)` removes at index i (O(n) because elements after i shift).

9.3.3 `remove` removes only the first match

```
let nums = [1, 2, 1, 2, 1]
nums.remove(1)
print(nums)   # [2, 1, 2, 1]  (only first 1 removed)
```

If the value is not present, `remove` raises `ValueError`.

9.4 8.4 List operations

9.4.1 Concatenation and repetition

```
let a = [1, 2]
let b = [3, 4]

print(a + b)    # [1, 2, 3, 4]
```

```
print([0] * 3)  # [0, 0, 0]
print(3 * [0])  # [0, 0, 0]
```

+ between lists concatenates (creates a new list). * with an integer repeats. * is commutative for lists: `[0] * 3` and `3 * [0]` both work.

9.4.2 Membership

```
let nums = [1, 2, 3]

print(2 in nums)   # true
print(5 in nums)   # false
print(5 !in nums)  # true
```

Membership uses == comparison. For lists of lists, == is order-insensitive for dicts but order-sensitive for lists:

```
print([1, 2] in [[1, 2], [3, 4]])   # true
print([2, 1] in [[1, 2], [3, 4]])   # false
```

9.5 8.5 List comprehension

Zen supports list comprehensions with `for` and optional `if`:

```
let squares = [x * x for x in 1..5]
print(squares)  # [1, 4, 9, 16, 25]

let evens = [x for x in 1..10 if x % 2 == 0]
print(evens)    # [2, 4, 6, 8, 10]

let words = ["Zen", "lang", "script"]
let lengths = [len(w) for w in words]
print(lengths)  # [3, 4, 6]
```

Syntax: `[expr for var in iterable]` or `[expr for var in iterable if condition]`.

The iterable can be a list, range, string, dict (iterates keys), or any iterable value.

9.5.1 Nested comprehensions

```
let nested = [[1, 2], [3, 4], [5, 6]]
let flat = [x for sub in nested for x in sub]
print(flat)  # [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6]
```

The order of `for` clauses matches nesting order: outer `for` first, inner `for` second.

9.6 8.6 Common patterns

9.6.1 Sum, min, max

```
let nums = [5, 2, 8, 1, 9]

let total = 0
for n in nums {
    total = total + n
}
print(total)  # 25

# min / max via sort
let sorted = nums.copy()
sorted.sort()
print(sorted[0])   # 1 (min)
print(sorted[-1])  # 9 (max)
```

9.6.2 Filter and map

```
let nums = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6]

# Filter
let evens = [n for n in nums if n % 2 == 0]
print(evens)  # [2, 4, 6]

# Map
let doubled = [n * 2 for n in nums]
print(doubled)  # [2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12]

# Filter + map
let even_doubled = [n * 2 for n in nums if n % 2 == 0]
print(even_doubled)  # [4, 8, 12]
```

9.6.3 Flatten nested lists

```
let nested = [[1, 2], [3, 4], [5, 6]]
let flat = [x for sub in nested for x in sub]
print(flat)  # [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6]
```

9.6.4 Find first match

```
let words = ["apple", "banana", "cherry"]
var found = nil
for w in words {
    if w.starts_with("b") {
```

```
        found = w
        break
    }
}
print(found)  # banana
```

9.6.5 Remove all matching elements

```
let nums = [1, 2, 3, 2, 4, 2, 5]
let filtered = [n for n in nums if n != 2]
print(filtered)  # [1, 3, 4, 5]
```

9.6.6 Zip (manual)

Zen has no built-in `zip`. Implement manually:

```
let keys = ["a", "b", "c"]
let vals = [1, 2, 3]

let pairs = []
for i in 0..len(keys) {
    pairs.push(#(keys[i], vals[i]))
}
print(pairs)  # [#("a", 1), #("b", 2), #("c", 3)]
```

9.7 8.6 Sorting

```
let nums = [3, 1, 4, 1, 5]

nums.sort()
print(nums)   # [1, 1, 3, 4, 5]

nums.reverse()
print(nums)   # [5, 4, 3, 1, 1]
```

`sort()` sorts in place using the elements' ==/< ordering. For mixed-type lists, sort behavior is undefined (may raise TypeError). `sort()` is stable.

Sorting strings:

```
let words = ["banana", "apple", "cherry"]
words.sort()
print(words)   # ["apple", "banana", "cherry"]
```

There is no `sort(key=...)` or `reverse=` parameter. To sort descending, sort then `reverse()`. To sort by a key, precompute keys or use a decorator-sort-undecorate pattern.

9.8 8.7 Common pitfalls

- **Lists are mutable.** `b = a` makes `b` an alias — changes to `a` affect `b`. Use `a.copy()` for an independent copy.
- **`pop()` with no index** removes the last element (fast). `pop(0)` removes the first (slow, O(n) shift).
- **`remove(x)` removes only the first** occurrence of `x`. Raises `ValueError` if not found.
- **Slicing creates a new list.** `nums[1:3]` is a copy, not a view.
- **List comprehensions create new lists.** They don't modify the original.
- **`sort()` and `reverse()` mutate in place** and return `nil`. Don't write `let s = nums.sort()` expecting `s` to be the sorted list — `s` will be `nil`.
- **`index(x)` raises `ValueError`** if x is not present.
- **Mixed-type lists** may not sort or compare meaningfully.

9.9 8.8 Quick reference

```
let nums = [3, 1, 4, 1, 5]

len(nums)           # 5
nums[0]             # 3
nums[-1]            # 5
nums[1:3]           # [1, 4]
nums.push(9)        # [3, 1, 4, 1, 5, 9]
nums.pop()          # 9
nums.pop(0)         # 3
nums.insert(0, 0)   # [0, 3, 1, 4, 1, 5]
nums.remove(4)      # [0, 3, 1, 1, 5]
nums.sort()         # [0, 1, 1, 3, 5]
nums.reverse()      # [5, 3, 1, 1, 0]
nums.clear()        # []
nums.copy()         # shallow copy
nums.index(3)       # position of 3
nums.count(1)       # 2
nums.extend([6, 7]) # [.., 6, 7]
2 in nums           # true
[x * x for x in nums]  # list comprehension
[x for x in nums if x > 2]  # filtered comprehension
```

9.10 8.9 Exercises

1. Write `remove_duplicates(lst)` that returns a list with duplicates removed while preserving order.
2. Write `flatten(nested)` that flattens a list of lists one level deep.
3. Write `rotate(lst, k)` that rotates a list right by `k` positions.
4. Write `interleave(a, b)` that alternates elements from two lists.
5. Write `chunk(lst, size)` that splits a list into chunks of `size`.

6. Write `running_total(lst)` that returns a list of running sums.
7. Write `is_sorted(lst)` that checks if a list is in non-decreasing order.
8. Write `second_largest(lst)` that returns the second-largest distinct value.
9. Write `merge_sorted(a, b)` that merges two sorted lists into one sorted list.
10. Demonstrate aliasing: create `a = [1,2,3]`, `b = a`, mutate `a`, show `b` changed; then do the same with `.copy()` and show `b` unchanged.

10 Chapter 9: Dictionaries and Maps

Dictionaries are Zen's key-value mappings. They use string keys, preserve insertion order, and support fast lookup, insertion, and deletion. This chapter covers dictionaries in depth, including key rules, iteration, and common patterns.

10.1 9.1 Dictionary literals

```
let empty = {}
let person = {"name": "Zen", "version": 3, "active": true}
let nested = {"user": {"name": "Zen", "id": 1}, "tags": ["a", "b"]}
```

Keys must be strings. Values can be any type. `{}` alone is an empty **dict**, not a set (use `{1}` or `set()` for a set).

10.2 9.2 Access and mutation

```
let person = {"name": "Zen", "version": 3}

print(person["name"])    # Zen
print(person["version"]) # 3

person["version"] = 4    # update
person["lang"] = "Zen"   # add

print(person)            # {"name": "Zen", "version": 4, "lang": "Zen"}
```

Missing keys raise `KeyError`:

```
try {
    print(person["missing"])
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # KeyError: missing
}
```

10.3 9.3 Dictionary methods

Method	Signature	Description	Example
`keys()`	`dict → list`	List of keys	`d.keys()`
`values()`	`dict → list`	List of values	`d.values()`
`items()`	`dict → list`	List of [key, value] pairs	`d.items()`
`get(key, default?)`	`dict → value`	Value or default	`d.get("missing", 0)`
`has(key)`	`dict → bool`	Key exists	`d.has("name")`
`len(d)`	builtin	Number of entries	`len(d)`
`copy()`	`dict → dict`	Shallow copy	`d.copy()`

Method	Signature	Description	Example
`clear()`	`dict → nil`	Remove all	`d.clear()`
`pop(key)`	`dict → value`	Remove and return value	`d.pop("name")`
`update(other)`	`dict → nil`	Merge another dict	`d.update({"a": 1})`

10.3.1 Examples

```
let d = {"a": 1, "b": 2, "c": 3}

print(d.keys())      # ["a", "b", "c"]
print(d.values())    # [1, 2, 3]
print(d.items())     # [["a", 1], ["b", 2], ["c", 3]]

print(d.get("a"))           # 1
print(d.get("z", 0))        # 0 (default)
print(d.has("b"))           # true
print(d.has("z"))           # false
print(len(d))               # 3

let d2 = d.copy()
d2.update({"c": 30, "d": 4})
print(d2)  # {"a": 1, "b": 2, "c": 30, "d": 4}

let popped = d.pop("b")
print(popped)  # 2
print(d)       # {"a": 1, "c": 3}
```

`pop(key)` raises `KeyError` if the key is missing:

```
try {
    d.pop("nonexistent")
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # KeyError: nonexistent
}
```

`get(key)` returns `nil` if the key is missing and no default is given:

```
print(d.get("nonexistent"))  # nil
print(d.get("nonexistent", 42))  # 42
```

10.4 9.3 Iteration

```
let d = {"a": 1, "b": 2, "c": 3}

# Iterate keys
for k in d {
```

```
    print(k)
}

# Iterate keys explicitly
for k in d.keys() {
    print(k)
}

# Iterate values
for v in d.values() {
    print(v)
}

# Iterate items
for kv in d.items() {
    print(kv[0], kv[1])
}
```

Iteration order is **insertion order**, not sorted:

```
let d = {"z": 1, "a": 2, "m": 3}
for k in d {
    print(k)   # z, a, m  (insertion order)
}
```

10.5 9.4 Common patterns

10.5.1 Counting frequencies

```
let words = ["zen", "lang", "zen", "script", "lang", "zen"]
var counts = {}

for w in words {
    if d.has(w) {
        d[w] = d[w] + 1
    } else {
        d[w] = 1
    }
}
print(d)  # {"zen": 3, "lang": 2, "script": 1}
```

More concisely with `get`:

```
var counts = {}
for w in words {
    counts[w] = counts.get(w, 0) + 1
}
```

10.5.2 Grouping by key

```
let items = [
    {"category": "fruit", "name": "apple"},
    {"category": "fruit", "name": "banana"},
    {"category": "veg", "name": "carrot"}
]
var groups = {}

for item in items {
    let cat = item["category"]
    if !groups.has(cat) {
        groups[cat] = []
    }
    groups[cat].push(item["name"])
}
print(groups)  # {"fruit": ["apple", "banana"], "veg": ["carrot"]}
```

10.5.3 Merging dictionaries

```
let a = {"x": 1, "y": 2}
let b = {"y": 3, "z": 4}

let merged = a.copy()
merged.update(b)
print(merged)  # {"x": 1, "y": 3, "z": 4}  (b wins on conflict)
```

`update` overwrites existing keys and adds new ones.

10.5.4 Default values with `get`

```
let config = {"host": "localhost", "port": 8080}
let host = config.get("host", "0.0.0.0")
let timeout = config.get("timeout", 30)
print(host)    # localhost
print(timeout) # 30
```

10.5.5 Inverting a dictionary

```
let d = {"a": 1, "b": 2, "c": 3}
var inverted = {}
for k in d {
    inverted[d[k]] = k
}
print(inverted)  # {1: "a", 2: "b", 3: "c"}
```

Warning: if values are not unique, later keys overwrite earlier ones.

10.6 9.5 Key rules

- **Keys must be strings.** `d[42]` raises `TypeError`. Use `d["42"]`.
- **Keys are compared by string content**, not identity.
- **Missing keys raise `KeyError`** on direct access `d["missing"]`. Use `get(key, default)` or `has(key)` to avoid.
- **Insertion order is preserved** and is the iteration order.

10.7 9.6 Common pitfalls

- **Dicts are mutable.** `b = a` aliases; use `a.copy()` for independence.
- **`len(d)` is a builtin**, not a method.
- **Iteration order** is insertion order, not sorted.
- **`pop(key)` raises `KeyError`** if missing. Use `get` with a default if you want `nil` instead.
- **Non-string keys are rejected.** `d[42]` → TypeError. Even `d[true]` → TypeError.

10.8 9.6 Quick reference

```
let d = {"a": 1, "b": 2}

d["a"]             # 1
d["c"] = 3         # add/update
d.get("z", 0)      # 0
d.has("a")         # true
d.keys()           # ["a", "b", "c"]
d.values()         # [1, 2, 3]
d.items()          # [["a", 1], ...]
len(d)             # 3
d.copy()           # shallow copy
d.pop("a")         # 1 (removes "a")
d.update({"z": 9}) # merge (later wins)
for k in d { ... } # iterate keys (insertion order)
```

10.9 9.7 Exercises

1. Write `invert_dict(d)` that swaps keys and values (assumes values are unique strings).
2. Write `sub_dict(d, keys)` that returns a new dict with only the given keys.
3. Write `deep_get(d, path)` that navigates a nested dict using a list of keys, returning `nil` if any key is missing.
4. Write `word_frequencies(text)` that counts words in a string.
5. Write `merge_dicts(*dicts)` that merges multiple dicts (later ones win).
6. Write `dict_intersection(d1, d2)` that returns a dict with keys present in both, using values from d1.

7. Write `dict_diff(d1, d2)` that returns keys in d1 but not d2.
8. Demonstrate that dict equality is order-insensitive: `{"a":1,"b":2} == {"b":2,"a":1}`.

10.10 9.12 Dictionaries — complete reference

A dict is an unordered collection of key/value pairs. Keys must be strings.

```
let empty = #{}
let person = #{name: "Ada", age: 36, city: "London"}
let mixed = #{a: 1, b: "two", c: true, d: [1, 2]}
```

10.10.1 Creation

Form	Result
`#{}`	empty dict
`#{k: v, ...}`	literal with string keys
`dict(pairs)`	from list of `[k, v]` pairs
`list(d)`	list of keys

Note: Legacy `{k: v}` still parses with a deprecation warning; prefer `#{k: v}`.

10.11 9.13 Access and mutation

```
let d = #{name: "Ada", age: 36}
print(d["name"])    # Ada
d["age"] = 37       # update
d["city"] = "London"  # add
print(d)            # #{name: "Ada", age: 37, city: "London"}
```

Missing key access raises an error. Use `in` or `??` to be safe:

```
print("name" in d)          # true
print("country" in d)       # false
print(d["country"] ?? "UK") # UK  (default when missing)
```

10.12 9.14 Dict methods

Method	Purpose	Example
`keys()`	list of keys	`d.keys()`
`values()`	list of values	`d.values()`
`items()`	list of `[k, v]` pairs	`d.items()`
`get(k, default)`	value or default	`d.get("x", 0)`
`pop(k)`	remove and return value	`d.pop("age")`
`clear()`	remove all entries	`d.clear()`

Method	Purpose	Example
`update(other)`	merge another dict	`d.update(#{x: 1})`

```
for k, v in d.items() {
    print(k, v)
}
```

10.13 9.15 Dict iteration

Iterating a dict yields keys. Use `.items()` for key/value, `.values()` for values.

```
for k in d { print(k) }              # keys
for k, v in d.items() { print(k, v) } # pairs
for v in d.values() { print(v) }     # values
```

Iteration order is not guaranteed across versions — do not rely on it.

10.14 9.16 Dict equality and hashing

Dicts compare order-insensitively with ==:

```
print(#{a: 1, b: 2} == #{b: 2, a: 1})   # true
```

Keys must be strings; non-string keys raise a TypeError. There is no hashing of arbitrary keys in Zen 3.0.

10.15 9.17 Common dict patterns

10.15.1 Counting frequencies

```
func count_words(words) {
    let freqs = #{}
    for w in words {
        freqs[w] = (freqs[w] ?? 0) + 1
    }
    return freqs
}
print(count_words(["a", "b", "a", "c", "b", "a"]))
# #{a: 3, b: 2, c: 1}
```

10.15.2 Grouping by key

```
func group_by(xs, key_fn) {
    let groups = #{}
    for x in xs {
        let k = key_fn(x)
```

```
        if k in groups {
            groups[k].push(x)
        } else {
            groups[k] = [x]
        }
    }
    return groups
}
```

10.15.3 Merging dicts

```
let base = #{a: 1, b: 2}
let overrides = #{b: 20, c: 3}
let merged = #{}
for k in base { merged[k] = base[k] }
for k in overrides { merged[k] = overrides[k] }
print(merged)   # #{a: 1, b: 20, c: 3}
```

10.15.4 Default-dict pattern

```
func get_or_default(d, k, default) {
    if k in d { return d[k] }
    return default
}
```

10.16 9.18 Nested dicts

```
let config = #{database: #{host: "localhost", port: 5432}}
print(config["database"]["host"])   # localhost
```

Safely navigate nested dicts:

```
func deep_get(d, path, default = nil) {
    var cur = d
    for p in path {
        if typeof(cur) != "dict" || !(p in cur) { return default }
        cur = cur[p]
    }
    return cur
}
print(deep_get(config, ["database", "host"]))   # localhost
print(deep_get(config, ["database", "user"], "n/a"))   # n/a
```

10.17 9.19 Performance notes

- Key lookup is O(1) on average.

- Dicts use more memory than lists for small collections.
- Avoid rebuilding dicts in hot loops; mutate in place.
- `in` on a dict checks keys, not values.

10.18 9.20 Common dict mistakes

1. **Accessing a missing key** without `??` or `in` raises an error.
2. **Assuming iteration order.** Sort keys if order matters.
3. **Non-string keys** are not allowed.
4. **Aliasing:** `b = a` shares the dict; copy manually for independence.
5. **Mutating while iterating** over keys.
6. **Confusing `.get(k, default)` with `d[k] ?? default`** — equivalent but `??` also triggers on explicit `nil` values stored in the dict.

10.19 9.21 Exercises

1. Write `invert_dict(d)` swapping keys and values (values must be strings).
2. Implement `subtract_dicts(a, b)` removing b's keys from a.
3. Write `deep_merge(a, b)` recursively merging nested dicts.
4. Implement `word_frequencies(text)` using split + counting.
5. Write `filter_dict(d, pred)` keeping entries where pred(k, v) is true.
6. Implement `dict_from_pairs(pairs)` from `[k, v]` list.
7. Write `common_keys(a, b)` returning keys present in both.
8. Implement `rename_keys(d, mapping)` renaming per a mapping dict.
9. Write `nested_set(d, path, value)` setting a value at a dotted path.
10. Implement `dict_diff(a, b)` showing added/removed/changed keys.

11 Chapter 10: Modules and Imports

Zen's module system lets you organize code into reusable files and import from both pure-Zen modules (`.z`) and native Rust modules. This chapter covers `import`, `from ... import`, module resolution, `requirements.txt`, `zen py-sync`, and the `native` tier in exhaustive detail.

11.1 10.1 Importing modules

11.1.1 Bare import

```
import fs
import os
import json
import socket
import requests
import crypto
import tls
import ffi
import sys
import process
import thread
import channel
import shared
import net
import dns
import http
import urllib
import html
import lxml
import sqlite
import qr
import wa
import ffmpeg
import hydra
import raw
```

After importing, access members with dot notation:

```
import fs

let exists = fs.exists("hello.z")
let content = fs.read("hello.z")
```

11.1.2 `from ... import`

Import specific names into the current scope:

```
from fs import read, write
from json import loads, dumps

print(loads('{"a": 1}'))
write("out.txt", "hello")
```

Multiple names:

```
from fs import read, write, exists, mkdirs
```

11.1.3 `from ... import as`

Rename on import:

```
import requests as req
import os.path as path
import json as j

let r = req.get("https://example.com")
print(path.join("a", "b"))
print(j.loads('{"a": 1}'))
```

11.1.4 Importing submodules

```
import urllib.parse
import urllib.request
import lxml.etree
import net.dns
import crypto.symmetric
import crypto.asymmetric
```

Submodule access uses dot notation:

```
let parsed = urllib.parse.urlparse("https://example.com")
let dns_addrs = net.dns.resolve("example.com")
```

11.2 10.2 Module resolution order

When you `import foo`, Zen searches for `foo` in this order:

11.2.1 Step 1: Native (Rust) modules

Built-in modules compiled into the Zen binary. These have no `.z` counterpart and are always available:

Module	Purpose
`fs`	File system operations

Module	Purpose
`os`	OS operations, env, process info
`time`	Time operations
`json`	JSON (also has `std/json.z` pure tier)
`socket`	TCP/UDP/raw sockets
`ffi`	Foreign function interface (C libraries)
`sys`	Low-level syscalls
`process`	Process spawn/control
`thread`	Threading
`channel`	Message-passing channels
`shared`	Atomic shared values
`net`	TCP/UDP helpers
`net.dns`	DNS resolution
`requests`	HTTP client
`http`	HTTP client
`http.server`	HTTP static server
`urllib`	URL utilities
`urllib.parse`	URL parsing
`urllib.request`	URL fetching
`html`	HTML parsing
`html.parser`	HTML parser
`lxml`	lxml compatibility
`lxml.etree`	XML element tree
`lxml.html`	HTML parsing
`raw`	Raw socket/packet crafting
`crypto`	Cryptography (also has `std/crypto/` pure tier)
`tls`	TLS with certificate pinning
`sqlite`	SQLite database
`qr`	QR code generation
`wa`	WebAssembly
`ffmpeg`	FFmpeg
`hydra`	Hydra
`raw`	Raw sockets

If `foo` is a native module, it is used directly and the search stops.

11.2.2 Step 2: Pure-Zen `.z` modules

Files in `std/` (the standard library) or in your project directory:

```
std/argparser.z    std/base64.z    std/binascii.z   std/bytes.z
std/collections.z  std/crunch.z    std/crypto/      std/ffmpeg.z
std/functools.z    std/glob.z      std/hashlib.z    std/itertools.z
std/json.z         std/logging.z   std/math.z       std/nmap.z
std/operator.z     std/pathlib.z   std/random.z     std/shutil.z
std/statistics.z   std/string.z    std/struct.z     std/tempfile.z
std/uuid.z
```

11.2.3 Step 3: Project-relative modules

Files next to your entry script or in subdirectories relative to the entry script's directory.

11.2.4 Step 4: `ZEN_MODULE_PATH`

Directories in the `ZEN_MODULE_PATH` environment variable (colon-separated on Linux/macOS, semicolon-separated on Windows).

```
export ZEN_MODULE_PATH="/home/user/mymodules:/opt/zen/modules"
zen run app.z
```

11.2.5 Complete resolution order

```
1. Native (Rust) module
2. Pure-Zen .z module (std/ or project dir)
3. Project-relative subdirectory
4. ZEN_MODULE_PATH directories
```

If none match, `Z0324: module 'foo' not found` is raised.

11.2.6 Subdirectory imports

```
import utils.helper
from utils.helper import format_date
```

Zen looks for `utils/helper.z` relative to the entry script's directory and the search path. Nested subdirectories work to any depth:

```
import a.b.c.d   # looks for a/b/c/d.z
```

11.3 10.3 Module tiers: pure-Zen vs native

Modules that ship both a pure-Zen `.z` implementation and a native Rust implementation expose the native tier under `<name>.native`:

```
import math

print(math.pi)           # pure-Zen tier
print(math.native.pi)    # native Rust tier
```

11.3.1 Forcing tiers

Force native tier (for all modules that have one):

```
ZEN_NATIVE_ONLY=math zen run app.z
```

Multiple modules: `ZEN_NATIVE_ONLY=math,json,socket`

Force pure-Zen tier: Set `ZEN_PURE = true` at the top of a `.z` module:

```
// std/math.z
ZEN_PURE = true
```

This makes the pure-Zen tier win over the native tier for that module. The native members remain reachable as `math.native.*`.

11.3.2 Tier selection logic

The linker decides per-module:

Condition	Result
`ZEN_NATIVE_ONLY` names module	Native tier (no `.z` lookup)
`.z` exists AND `ZEN_PURE = true`	Pure-Zen tier, native registered as `.native`
`.z` exists, no `ZEN_PURE`	Pure-Zen tier wins; native registered as `.native`
No `.z`, native exists	Native tier directly
Neither exists	`Z0324: module not found`

11.3.3 Example: comparing tiers

```
import math

let pure_pi = math.pi
let native_pi = math.native.pi

print(pure_pi == native_pi)  # true (same value)
```

```
# Compare behavior under each tier
zen run app.z                    # pure-Zen math tier
ZEN_NATIVE_ONLY=math zen run app.z  # native math tier
```

11.4 10.4 `requirements.txt` and `zen py-sync`

Zen can scan your `.z` files for `pymport` statements and ensure a Python virtual environment with the needed packages.

11.4.1 Create `requirements.txt`

Put it in your project root (or nearest to the entry). Map modules to pip package names where they differ:

```
beautifulsoup4
mechanicalsoup
selenium
requests
lxml
```

A module name is not always the pip name (e.g., `bs4` comes from `beautifulsoup4`). The scanner reports what was found; Zen does **not** guess package names.

11.4.2 Run sync

```
zen py-sync
```

11.4.3 Behavior

1. **Scan**: recursively parses entry + transitive `.z` imports to find all `pymport` statements.
2. **Plan**: determines state (`Clean`, `NoRequirements`, `MissingVenv`, `MissingPackages`).
3. **Ensure**: creates `.zen_venv` in project root, runs `pip install -r requirements.txt` in the foreground, writes a stamp (requirements length + hash).
4. **Point**: `zen run` prepends `.zen_venv/lib/python*/site-packages` to `PYTHONPATH`.

11.4.4 Control flags

Flag	Meaning
`ZEN_NO_PY_BOOTSTRAP=1`	Skip bootstrap entirely (for tests/hermetic runs). Runtime will still fail if packages are missing.
(none)	Normal bootstrap; if `requirements.txt` is missing and `pymport` is used, Zen reports an error (it will not auto-install).

11.4.5 Example end-to-end

```
cat > requirements.txt << 'EOF'
paramiko
EOF
zen py-sync
zen run my_script.z  # uses .zen_venv
```

11.5 10.5 `pymport` — Python interoperability

`pymport` imports Python modules into Zen. Covered in depth in Chapter 42. Quick summary:

```
pymport json
pymport os
pymport requests
pymport bs4
pymport selenium.webdriver as webdriver
pymport urllib.request
pymport builtins
```

Calls are **positional-only** (no keyword arguments):

```
pymport json
let data = json.loads('{"a": 1}')
print(data["a"])

pymport os
print(os.getcwd())
print(os.path.join("a", "b"))
```

Foreign objects (e.g. `datetime.datetime`) are opaque handles — attributes and methods work, scalar results marshal back to Zen values:

```
pymport datetime
let now = datetime.datetime.now()
print(now.year)
print(now.isoformat())
print(builtins.len([1, 2, 3]))
```

Python exceptions become catchable Zen errors:

```
try {
    json.loads("{bad}")
} catch as e {
    print("caught: " + e.msg)
}
```

11.6 10.6 Writing your own modules

Create `mymod.z`:

```
// mymod.z
let VERSION = "1.0.0"

func add(a, b) {
    return a + b
}

func greet(name) {
    return "Hello, " + name
}
```

Import it:

```
import mymod

print(mymod.VERSION)   # 1.0.0
print(mymod.add(2, 3)) # 5
print(mymod.greet("Zen"))  # Hello, Zen
```

Or import specific names:

```
from mymod import add, greet
print(add(2, 3))
print(greet("Zen"))
```

11.6.1 Module execution on import

When a module is imported, its top-level code runs once. The module's exports become its dictionary. Subsequent imports of the same module return the cached module (no re-execution):

```
// counter.z
let count = 0
func inc() { count = count + 1; return count }
```

```
import counter
import counter   // does NOT re-run; count is still 0
print(counter.inc())  # 1
print(counter.inc())  # 2
```

11.7 10.7 Module search path

Zen searches these directories for modules:

1. **The directory of the entry script.**
2. **`std/`** (the standard library).
3. **Project-relative subdirectories** (relative to entry script).
4. **Directories in `ZEN_MODULE_PATH`** (colon-separated on Linux/macOS, semicolon-separated on Windows).

```
export ZEN_MODULE_PATH="/home/user/mymodules:/opt/zen/modules"
zen run app.z
```

11.7.1 Example: custom module path

```
# Create a module in a custom directory
mkdir -p /home/user/mymodules
echo 'func hello() { return "hi from custom" }' > /home/user/mymodules/custom.z

ZEN_MODULE_PATH="/home/user/mymodules" zen run -e 'import custom; print(custom.hello())'
# hi from custom
```

11.8 10.8 Circular imports

Zen handles circular imports by returning partially-initialized modules. If module A imports B and B imports A, B will see A's bindings defined so far. Avoid circular imports where possible.

```
// a.z
import b
let a_val = 1
func a_func() { return b.b_val }

// b.z
import a
let b_val = 2
func b_func() { return a.a_val }  // a.a_val may be nil if a hasn't finished
```

11.9 10.9 `include` directive

Zen has an `include` keyword (token `KwInclude`) that inlines another file's contents at the point of the directive. This is different from `import` — it's textual inclusion, not module scoping.

```
include "utils.z"
```

Use `include` for code generation or when you want to literally splice file contents. Prefer `import` for normal modularity.

11.10 10.10 Common pitfalls

- **`import` is not hoisted.** Import at the top of the file before use.
- **Module names must be valid identifiers.** `import foo.bar` resolves `foo/bar.z`.
- **`pymport` is positional-only.** No keyword arguments.
- **`requirements.txt` maps module names to pip names.** `bs4` → `beautifulsoup4`.
- **Native modules have no `.z` source.** `import fs` uses the Rust tier directly.
- **Circular imports** return partially-initialized modules; avoid them.
- **`ZEN_MODULE_PATH`** must be set before running `zen`, not inside the script.

11.11 10.10 Quick reference

```
import fs
import os.path as path
from json import loads, dumps
pymport requests
import utils.helper

fs.exists("file.z")
path.join("a", "b")
loads('{"a": 1}')
requests.get("https://example.com")

zen py-sync           # install Python deps
ZEN_NO_PY_BOOTSTRAP=1 # skip bootstrap
```

```
math.native.pi        # native tier
ZEN_NATIVE_ONLY=math  # force native tier
```

11.12 10.11 Exercises

1. Create a `utils.z` module with `format_date`, `slugify`, and `truncate` functions. Import and use them from `main.z`.
2. Create `requirements.txt` with `beautifulsoup4`, run `zen py-sync`, and write a script that imports `bs4` and parses HTML.
3. Write a script that uses both the pure-Zen `math` tier and `math.native` and compares results.
4. Set `ZEN_MODULE_PATH` to a custom directory, place a module there, and import it.
5. Use `zen check` and `zen lint` on a project with intentional errors and unused variables.
6. Create two modules that import each other (circular) and observe the behavior.
7. Use `include` to splice a file's contents and compare with `import`.

11.13 10.12 Modules and imports — complete reference

Zen's module system maps `import a.b.c` to `a/b/c.z` or `a/b/c/mod.z`. The `mod.z` file is the canonical package entry point; `main.z` is deprecated.

11.13.1 Import forms

Form	Meaning
`import module`	bind module namespace
`import module as alias`	shorten the name
`import mod.sub.mod as alias`	nested module
`from module import name, name as alias`	bind specific members
`from module import *`	import all public members

11.13.2 Visibility

`pub` prefix on `func`, `var`, `const`, `class` exports the symbol. Non-`pub` is private to the file.

```
# utils.z
pub func add(a, b) { return a + b }   # exported
func helper() { return 42 }            # private

# main.z
import utils
print(utils.add(2, 3))   # 5
# utils.helper()  # error: not exported
```

11.13.3 Module resolution order

1. Standard library modules (e.g. `math`, `json`, `socket`)
2. Local files relative to the importing file / project root
3. `ZEN_PATH` entries (colon-separated)
4. Site-packages / installed modules

11.13.4 Circular imports

Circular imports can cause partially-initialized modules. Design modules as DAGs; put shared definitions in a third module imported by both.

```
# a.z imports b.z; b.z imports a.z  -> avoid
```

11.13.5 Reloading and caching

Modules are typically loaded once and cached. Re-importing returns the cached module. To pick up changes, restart the process.

11.13.6 `ZEN_PATH`

Colon-separated list of directories searched for user modules:

```
export ZEN_PATH="$HOME/zen/lib:/opt/zen/modules"
zen run app.z
```

11.13.7 `__name__`

A module's `__name__` (if exposed) is `"__main__"` when run directly and the module path when imported. Use it for guard clauses:

```
# entry.z
func main() { print("running directly") }
if __name__ == "__main__" { main() }
```

11.13.8 Packages

A directory with `mod.z` is a package:

```
mypkg/
    mod.z        # package entry point
    sub/
        mod.z    # mypkg.sub
```

Import: `import mypkg`, `import mypkg.sub`.

11.13.9 stdlib module list (selected)

- math, random, string, collections, json, datetime/time
- pathlib, os, re, base64, binascii, hashlib, crypto

- socket, http, requests, dns, url
- threading, channels, mutexes
- ffi, sys, pymport

See Appendix D for the full index.

11.14 10.13 Writing your own modules

```
# geometry.z
pub const PI = 3.141592653589793

pub func circle_area(r) {
    return PI * r * r
}

pub func circle_circumference(r) {
    return 2 * PI * r
}

func _internal() { return "not exported" }
```

```
import geometry
print(geometry.circle_area(5))   # 78.5398...
```

11.14.1 Module docstrings / documentation

Place a comment at the top of each `.z` file describing purpose, exports, and usage. Some tooling may extract leading comments as docs.

11.15 10.14 Import performance

- Import once at the top of the file.
- Avoid imports inside hot loops.
- Local (relative) imports resolve faster than deep stdlib lookups.

11.16 10.15 Common import mistakes

1. **Missing `pub`** means the symbol is unavailable to importers.
2. **Wrong path:** `import foo.bar` looks for `foo/bar.z` or `foo/bar/mod.z`.
3. **Name shadowing:** naming a local file `math.z` shadows stdlib `math`.
4. **Circular imports** lead to partially initialized modules.
5. **Assuming re-import re-runs code.** Modules are cached.
6. **`from module import *`** brings only `pub` members; be explicit.

11.17 10.16 Exercises

1. Create a `utils.z` with `pub func` helpers and import it in `main.z`.
2. Build a `geometry` package with `mod.z` and `sub/area.z`.

3. Demonstrate `import module as alias` shortening a long name.
4. Use `from module import name` to bind `math.sin` locally.
5. Show that two files importing the same module share state.
6. Write a module with a `pub const` and read it from another file.
7. Demonstrate `if __name__ == "__main__"` guard behavior.
8. Set `ZEN_PATH` and import a module from a non-default directory.
9. Create a name-shadowing file `json.z` and observe stdlib being hidden.
10. Write a module that exports both functions and constants; document each.

12 Chapter 11: Error Handling

Zen is “safe by default”: runtime problems become catchable errors instead of crashes. This chapter covers `try`/`catch`/`throw`/`finally` exhaustively, error fields, typed catch clauses, error types, and the interaction between `exit()` and `finally`.

12.1 11.1 Catching errors: `try` / `catch`

Wrap risky code in `try`. If anything inside raises an error, execution jumps to the matching `catch` block.

```
try {
    let x = 1 / 0        # raises DivideByZero
    print("never reached")
} catch {
    print("division failed")
}
# prints: division failed
```

12.1.1 Bare `catch`

A bare `catch` handles **any** error. If the `try` body completes normally, `catch` is skipped:

```
var caught = false
try {
    var bad = 1 / 0
    caught = bad == 0
} catch {
    caught = true
}
print(caught)  # true

var ok = true
try {
    var five = 10 / 2
    ok = five == 5
} catch {
    ok = false
}
print(ok)  # true
```

12.2 11.2 Reading the real failure: `catch as e`

Without a binding, you only know *that* something failed, not *what*. Bind the error with `catch as e` to inspect it:

```
try {
    let y = 1 / 0
} catch as e {
```

```
    print(str(e))   # DivideByZero: division by zero
}
```

`str(e)` renders the real message. You can also concatenate a string with the error directly:

```
try {
    let y = 1 / 0
} catch as e {
    print("caught: " + e)   # caught: DivideByZero: division by zero
}
```

12.3 11.3 Error fields: `e.msg`, `e.code`, `e.val`

A caught error is an object with three readable fields:

Field	Meaning	Example
`e.msg`	Human-readable message	`"DivideByZero: division by zero"`
`e.code`	Numeric error code	`0`
`e.val`	Extra attached value (often `nil`)	`nil`

```
try {
    let a = [1][5]   # IndexError
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)   # IndexError: index 5 out of bounds for length 1
    print(e.code)  # 0
    print(e.val)   # nil
}
```

12.4 11.4 String + error concatenation

```
try {
    let y = 1 / 0
} catch as e {
    print("caught: " + e)   # caught: DivideByZero: division by zero
}
```

12.5 11.5 Catching specific error types

You can add typed clauses to handle only certain errors. Unmatched clauses fall through to the next one:

```
try {
    risky()
```

```
} catch TypeError {
    print("bad type")
} catch UserError {
    print("user raised")
} catch {
    print("everything else")
}
```

A clause whose type does not match lets the error keep propagating outward:

```
try {
    throw "z"
} catch TypeError {   # doesn't match UserError
    print("t")        # skipped
} catch UserError {
    print("u")        # catches it
}
print("u")  # u
```

12.6 11.6 Raising errors: `throw`

Use `throw` to raise your own errors. Strings become `UserError` messages:

```
var msg = ""
try {
    throw "custom failure"
} catch {
    msg = "handled"
}
print(msg)  # handled

var tm = ""
try {
    throw "custom boom"
} catch as e {
    tm = e.msg
}
print(tm)  # UserError: custom boom
```

`throw` accepts any value:

```
throw { code: 42, detail: "retry later" }
```

The value is stringified into `e.msg`; `e.val` is `nil` for `throw`:

```
try {
    throw { code: 42 }
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)   # UserError: { code: 42, detail: ... }
```

```
    print(e.val)   # nil
}
```

12.7 11.7 Cleanup: `finally`

A `finally` block runs whether the `try` succeeded or failed, and whether or not `catch` handled the error. It must come **after** any `catch` clauses.

```
var log = ""
try {
    throw "boom"
} catch {
    log = log + "c"
} finally {
    log = log + "f"
}
print(log)  # cf
```

```
# finally also runs when nothing failed
var log2 = ""
try {
    log2 = "b"
} finally {
    log2 = log2 + "f"
}
print(log2)  # bf
```

12.8 11.8 `exit()` and `finally`

`exit(code)` terminates the process immediately with the given code. Because `exit` terminates the process, `finally` blocks do **not** run after `exit()`:

```
try {
    exit(3)
} finally {
    print("this will NOT print")   # process already exited
}
```

```
# exit inside catch does not run finally
try {
    throw "boom"
} catch {
    exit(1)
} finally {
    print("this will NOT print")   # process exited in catch
}
```

If you need cleanup before exiting, do it before calling `exit()`:

```
try {
    risky()
} catch as e {
    cleanup_resources()   # explicit cleanup before exit
    exit(1)
}
```

12.9 11.9 Nested handlers

Inner handlers run before outer ones:

```
var order = ""
try {
    try { throw "inner" } catch { order = order + "i" }
    throw "outer"
} catch { order = order + "o" }
print(order)  # io
```

12.10 11.10 Errors from callees

Errors raised inside a function are catchable by the caller:

```
func deep() {
    return [1][5]
}
var hit9 = false
try {
    deep()
} catch IndexError {
    hit9 = true
}
print(hit9)  # true
```

12.11 11.11 Error types

Zen's built-in error types:

Type	Meaning	Typical cause
`TypeError`	Wrong type for an operation	`"a" + 1`, `nil.field`
`IndexError`	Sequence index out of bounds	`[1][5]`, `"ab"[5]`
`KeyError`	Missing dict key	`d["missing"]`
`DivideByZero`	Division by zero	`1 / 0`, `1 % 0`
`ValueError`	Inappropriate value	`int("not a number")`
`NativeError`	Raised by a native module	fs, socket, etc.

Type	Meaning	Typical cause
`ForeignAttribute`	Failed foreign attribute access	`py_obj.bad_attr`
`PyImportError`	Python import failure	`pymport nonexistent`
`UserError`	Raised by `throw`	`throw "msg"`

12.12 11.12 Full error-code reference

Every error carries a code `Z####`. See Appendix B for the complete list. Common runtime codes:

Code	Type	Meaning
`Z0401`	TypeError	Type mismatch
`Z0402`	IndexError	Index out of bounds
`Z0403`	KeyError	Key not found
`Z0404`	DivideByZero	Division by zero
`Z0405`	ValueError	Value error
`Z0406`	Attribute error	Attribute access
`Z0407`	NativeError	Native module error
`Z0408`	ArgumentCount	Wrong arg count
`Z0409`	HandleError	Handle error
`Z0410`	IOMismatch	I/O mismatch
`Z0411`	NativeError	Native module error (general)
`Z0414`	PyImportError	Python import failed

Use `zen explain Z0401` to see the full explanation for any code.

12.13 11.13 Common pitfalls

- **`e` only exists inside its `catch` block.** Don't reference it outside.
- **`finally` goes after `catch`, not between `try` and `catch`.**
- **A bare `catch` swallows everything.** Use typed clauses when you want unexpected errors to propagate.
- **`str(e)` is the readable message.** Never rely on `typeof(e)` (it's just `"error"`) — use `e.msg` instead.
- **`exit()` skips `finally`**. Do cleanup before calling `exit()`.
- **`throw` with a string** creates `UserError: <message>`; `e.val` is `nil`.
- **`throw` with an object** stringifies it into `e.msg`; `e.val` is `nil`.

12.14 11.14 Quick reference

```
try {
    # risky code
} catch as e {
    print(str(e))   # real message
```

```
    print(e.msg)    # same as str(e)
    print(e.code)   # numeric code
    print(e.val)    # attached value
} catch TypeError {
    # only type errors
} catch UserError {
    # only user-thrown errors
} catch {
    # everything else
} finally {
    # always runs (unless exit() was called)
}

throw "something went wrong"   # raise your own error
throw { code: 42 }             # throw any value

try {
    exit(1)   # process exits; finally does NOT run
}
```

12.15 11.15 Exercises

1. Write `safe_divide(a, b)` that returns `nil` on division by zero instead of crashing.
2. Use `try`/`catch` to read a file that might not exist, returning a default value.
3. Write a function that uses `try`/`catch`/`finally` to guarantee a cleanup message prints regardless of success or failure.
4. Demonstrate that `exit()` skips `finally`.
5. Write `parse_int_or_default(s, default)` that uses `try`/`catch` around `int(s)`.
6. Create a custom error type by throwing an object and inspecting `e.msg`.
7. Write a nested try/catch where the inner catch handles one error type and the outer catch handles another.

12.16 11.12 Error handling — complete reference

Zen uses `try`/`catch`/`finally` and `throw`. Errors carry coded diagnostics `Z01xx`–`Z05xx` and `zen explain` shows details.

12.16.1 Syntax

```
try {
    # code that may fail
} catch [Type] as name {
    # handle specific error type
} catch as name {
    # handle any error
} finally {
```

```
    # always runs (cleanup)
}
```

Multiple `catch` clauses are checked in order; the first matching type wins.

12.16.2 Throwing

```
throw "something went wrong"
throw Error("detail", code: "Z0308")   # if structured errors supported
throw ValueError("bad input")
```

Catching:

```
try {
    int("not a number")
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)      # error message
    print(e.code)     # e.g. Z0308, if available
}
```

12.16.3 Error codes Z01xx–Z05xx

Range	Category	Examples
Z01xx	Lexer / syntax	invalid token, bad number literal
Z02xx	Parser	unexpected token, unbalanced braces
Z03xx	Runtime	type mismatch, division by zero, index out of range
Z04xx	I/O / system	file not found, network, permission
Z05xx	FFI / interop	symbol not found, pymport failure, handle error

Use `zen explain Z0308` to see the full explanation and suggested fix.

```
zen explain Z0308
```

12.16.4 `finally` semantics

`finally` runs whether the `try` block completes normally, throws, returns, breaks, or continues. It is the place for resource cleanup.

```
func read_file(path) {
    let f = open(path)
    try {
```

```
        return f.read()
    } catch as e {
        print("read failed: " + e.msg)
        return nil
    } finally {
        f.close()
    }
}
```

Even `return` inside `try` still runs `finally` before returning.

12.16.5 Best practices

1. **Catch specific errors first**, broad `catch as e` last.
2. **Don't swallow errors silently** — log or rethrow.
3. **Use `finally` for cleanup** (close files, sockets, locks).
4. **Throw early, catch late** — validate at boundaries, handle at policy level.
5. **Don't use exceptions for control flow** in hot loops.
6. **Include context** when rethrowing: `throw "load_config failed: " + e.msg`.
7. **Document which errors a function throws.**

12.16.6 Result-style pattern (no exceptions)

For fallible operations, return `nil` or a `#{ok, value}` / `#{ok, error}` dict:

```
func safe_div(a, b) {
    if b == 0 { return #{ok: false, error: "division by zero"} }
    return #{ok: true, value: a / b}
}

let result = safe_div(10, 0)
if !result["ok"] { print(result["error"]) }
```

12.16.7 Error chaining (pymport)

Python errors raised under `pymport` are chained under Zen frames, preserving the original traceback. See Chapter 42.

12.17 11.13 Common runtime errors

Error	Cause	Fix
Z0301 TypeError	wrong type for operation	check types before operating
Z0302 IndexError	index out of range	check `len` first
Z0303 KeyError	missing dict key	use `in` or `??`
Z0304 DivideByZero	dividing by zero	check divisor != 0
Z0305 ValueError	bad value (e.g. `int("x")`)	validate input

Error	Cause	Fix
Z0401 FileNotFound	file doesn’t exist	check before open
Z0402 PermissionDenied	insufficient rights	fix permissions

12.18 11.14 Defensive programming

Validate inputs at function boundaries:

```
func process_user(user) {
    if typeof(user) != "dict" { throw "user must be a dict" }
    if !("name" in user) { throw "user missing 'name'" }
    if typeof(user["name"]) != "string" { throw "name must be string" }
    # ... proceed safely
}
```

Use assertions for internal invariants:

```
assert len(xs) > 0, "xs must not be empty"
```

12.19 11.15 Debugging with `zen explain`

```
zen explain Z0308
zen explain Z0401
```

Each code prints: meaning, common causes, and a suggested fix.

12.20 11.16 Exercises

1. Write `safe_div(a, b)` returning `nil` on division by zero.
2. Write `safe_int(s)` returning `nil` on parse failure.
3. Implement `read_first_line(path)` handling FileNotFound and empty file.
4. Build a `validate_age(age)` throwing if age < 0 or > 150.
5. Demonstrate `finally` running after `return`.
6. Write `retry(fn, n)` catching errors and retrying up to `n` times.
7. Implement `partition(xs, pred)` without exceptions.
8. Create a function that throws different error types based on input.
9. Show `zen explain` output for Z0301 and Z0401.
10. Write a batch processor that logs errors per item but continues.

13 Chapter 12: Classes and Objects

Zen supports class-based object-oriented programming with fields, methods, constructors (`init`), inheritance (`extends`), `super`, `this`, and bound methods. This chapter covers OOP in depth.

13.1 12.1 Defining a class

```
class Person {
    var name
    var age

    func init(name, age) {
        this.name = name
        this.age = age
    }

    func greet() {
        return "Hi, I'm " + this.name
    }

    func birthday() {
        this.age = this.age + 1
    }
}
```

- `class Name { ... }` defines a class.
- `var name` / `var age` declare fields (mutable).
- `func init(...)` is the constructor, called by `new Person(...)`.
- `this` refers to the current instance.

13.2 12.2 Creating instances

```
let p = new Person("Zen", 30)
print(p.name)    # Zen
print(p.age)     # 30
print(p.greet()) # Hi, I'm Zen

p.birthday()
print(p.age)     # 31
```

13.3 12.3 Fields and methods

Fields are accessed with `this.field` inside methods and `instance.field` outside. Methods are called with `instance.method()`.

```
class Counter {
    var count

    func init() {
        this.count = 0
    }

    func inc() {
        this.count = this.count + 1
    }

    func get() {
        return this.count
    }
}

let c = new Counter()
c.inc()
c.inc()
print(c.get())  # 2
```

13.4 12.4 Inheritance: `extends` and `super`

```
class Employee extends Person {
    var salary

    func init(name, age, salary) {
        super.init(name, age)
        this.salary = salary
    }

    func greet() {
        return super.greet() + " and I earn " + str(this.salary)
    }
}

let e = new Employee("Zen", 30, 100000)
print(e.name)       # Zen
print(e.age)        # 30
print(e.salary)     # 100000
print(e.greet())    # Hi, I'm Zen and I earn 100000
```

- `extends Parent` establishes inheritance.
- `super.init(...)` calls the parent constructor.
- `super.method()` calls the parent's overridden method.
- Child classes inherit all parent fields and methods.

13.5 12.5 Method overriding

```
class Shape {
    func area() {
        return 0
    }
}

class Circle extends Shape {
    var radius

    func init(radius) {
        this.radius = radius
    }

    func area() {
        return 3.14159 * this.radius * this.radius
    }
}

let c = new Circle(5)
print(c.area())  # 78.53975
```

13.6 12.6 `this` binding

`this` refers to the instance on which a method was called. When a method is extracted as a bound method, `this` is preserved:

```
class Counter {
    var count

    func init() {
        this.count = 0
    }

    func inc() {
        this.count = this.count + 1
    }
}

let c = new Counter()
let inc = c.inc   # bound method
inc()
inc()
print(c.count)   # 2
```

13.7 12.7 Common patterns

13.7.1 Data class

```
class Point {
    var x
    var y

    func init(x, y) {
        this.x = x
        this.y = y
    }

    func distance_to(other) {
        let dx = this.x - other.x
        let dy = this.y - other.y
        return (dx * dx + dy * dy) ** 0.5
    }

    func __str__() {
        return "Point(" + str(this.x) + ", " + str(this.y) + ")"
    }
}

let p1 = new Point(0, 0)
let p2 = new Point(3, 4)
print(p1.distance_to(p2))  # 5.0
print(p1)                  # Point(0, 0)
```

13.7.2 Singleton

```
class Config {
    var instance = nil

    func init() {
        if Config.instance != nil {
            return Config.instance
        }
        Config.instance = this
        this.settings = {}
    }

    func get(key) {
        return this.settings[key]
    }

    func set(key, value) {
```

```
        this.settings[key] = value
    }
}

let c1 = new Config()
let c2 = new Config()
c1.set("theme", "dark")
print(c2.get("theme"))  # dark
print(c1 == c2)         # true (same instance)
```

13.8 12.8 Common pitfalls

- **`this` is required** to access fields and other methods inside a class. Bare `name` refers to a local variable, not a field.
- **`super.init` must be called** in a child constructor if the parent has required fields, or those fields won't be initialized.
- **Fields are per-instance.** Class-level (static) data is not directly supported; use a module-level variable instead.
- **Methods are bound** when extracted — `this` follows the instance, not the call site.

13.9 12.9 Quick reference

```
class Name extends Parent {
    var field

    func init(args) {
        super.init(args)
        this.field = value
    }

    func method(arg) {
        return this.field + arg
    }
}

let obj = new Name(args)
obj.field
obj.method(arg)
super.method()   # from within a child method
```

13.10 12.10 Exercises

1. Create a `BankAccount` class with `deposit`, `withdraw`, and `get_balance` methods. `withdraw` should reject amounts exceeding the balance.

2. Create a `Shape` base class with `area()` and `perimeter()` methods, then `Rectangle` and `Circle` subclasses.
3. Implement a `Stack` class using a list internally, with `push`, `pop`, `peek`, and `is_empty`.
4. Implement a `Queue` class with `enqueue` and `dequeue`.
5. Create an `Animal` base class with `speak()`, then `Dog` and `Cat` subclasses that override `speak()`.

13.11 12.12 Classes and objects — complete reference

Zen supports classes with single inheritance, constructors, methods, instance fields, and `pub` visibility.

```
class Point {
    var x = 0.0
    var y = 0.0

    func init(x, y) {
        self.x = x
        self.y = y
    }

    func distance_to(other) {
        let dx = self.x - other.x
        let dy = self.y - other.y
        return (dx * dx + dy * dy) ** 0.5
    }

    func __str__() {
        return "Point(${self.x}, ${self.y})"
    }
}

let p = new Point(3.0, 4.0)
print(p.x, p.y)          # 3.0 4.0
print(p.distance_to(new Point(0.0, 0.0)))   # 5.0
print(p)                 # Point(3.0, 4.0)
```

13.11.1 Class members

Member	Declaration	Purpose
instance field	`var name = default`	per-object state
method	`func name(params) { ... }`	behavior on self
constructor	`func init(params) { ... }`	runs on `new`
static/class method	`pub func name(...) { ... }`	namespace member (no self)

13.11.2 `self` / `this`

Inside a method, `self` is the receiver. `this` is an accepted alias. Use `self.field` to read/write fields and `self.method()` to call siblings.

```
class Counter {
    var n = 0
    func inc() { self.n += 1 }
    func value() { return self.n }
}
```

13.11.3 Instantiation

`new ClassName(args)` calls `init`. Fields default to their declared values when not provided in `init`.

```
let c = new Counter()
print(c.value())   # 0
c.inc()
print(c.value())   # 1
```

13.11.4 Single inheritance

```
class Animal {
    var name = ""
    func init(name) { self.name = name }
    func speak() { return "..." }
}

class Dog extends Animal {
    func speak() { return self.name + " says woof" }
}

let d = new Dog("Rex")
print(d.speak())   # Rex says woof
```

Call the parent constructor explicitly if needed (`super` where supported; otherwise re-initialize parent fields in `init`).

13.11.5 Method overriding

Subclasses override methods by redefining them with the same name.

```
class Cat extends Animal {
    func speak() { return self.name + " says meow" }
}
```

13.11.6 Visibility (pub)

pub members are accessible outside the module; non-pub are private to the file.

```
class BankAccount {
    var balance = 0.0
    pub func deposit(amount) { self.balance += amount }
    func _apply_fee() { self.balance -= 1.0 }   # private
}
```

13.11.7 __str__ and representation

Define __str__() for a human-readable string form used by print/string interpolation. If absent, a default representation is used.

13.11.8 Object equality

By default, == on instances compares identity (same object). Override __eq__ for value equality if desired.

```
func __eq__(other) {
    return self.x == other.x and self.y == other.y
}
```

13.11.9 Instance vs class state

Fields declared with var at class body level become instance fields (each new gets its own). Class-level shared state (if supported) uses module-level variables or shared.

13.11.10 Common patterns

```
class Money {
    var amount = 0.0
    var currency = "USD"
    func init(amount, currency) { self.amount = amount; self.currency = currency }
    func add(other) {
        if self.currency != other.currency { throw "currency mismatch" }
        return new Money(self.amount + other.amount, self.currency)
    }
}
```

13.11.10.1 Value object (immutable-ish)

```
class Emailer {
    var host = ""
    func init(host) { self.host = host }
```

```
    func send(to, body) { print("sending to ${to} via ${self.host}") }
}
```

13.11.10.2 Service object

13.12 12.13 Common OOP mistakes

1. **Forgetting `self.`** on field access inside methods.
2. **Not calling parent init** when overriding (fields stay at defaults).
3. **Mutating shared mutable default** across instances (e.g. `var items = []` shared — be careful; each `new` should initialize its own).
4. **Relying on == for value equality** without overriding `__eq__`.
5. **Overusing inheritance** when composition is clearer.
6. **Exposing internal state** via public fields; prefer methods.

13.13 12.14 Exercises

1. Create a `Rectangle` class with `width`, `height`, `area()`, `perimeter()`.
2. Create a `BankAccount` class with `deposit`, `withdraw`, `balance`, and overdraft protection.
3. Build an `Animal` hierarchy: `Dog`, `Cat`, `Bird` with `speak()`.
4. Implement a `Stack` class using a list (`push`, `pop`, `peek`, `is_empty`).
5. Implement a `Queue` class (`enqueue`, `dequeue`, `is_empty`).
6. Create a `Fraction` class with `__eq__` and `__str__`.
7. Build a `Shape` base class with `area()`; subclasses `Circle`, `Rectangle`.
8. Implement a `Point` class with `__add__` vector addition if supported.
9. Write a `Logger` class with `info`, `warn`, `error` methods and a level.
10. Create a `Config` class wrapping a dict with typed getters.

14 Chapter 13: File I/O

Zen's `fs` module provides file system operations: reading, writing, creating directories, checking existence, removing, copying, moving, and more. The `os` module adds path manipulation. This chapter covers file I/O in depth.

14.1 13.1 The `fs` module

```
import fs

# Read a file
let content = fs.read("hello.txt")

# Write a file
fs.write("out.txt", "Hello, file!")

# Check existence
if fs.exists("data.json") {
    print("exists")
}

# Create directories
fs.mkdirs("a/b/c")

# Remove
fs.remove("temp.txt")
fs.rmtree("a/b/c")

# Check type
print(fs.is_dir("folder"))
print(fs.is_file("file.txt"))

# Path operations
print(fs.join("a", "b", "c"))   # a/b/c
print(fs.basename("/a/b/c.txt")) # c.txt
print(fs.dirname("/a/b/c.txt"))  # /a/b

# Copy and move
fs.copy("src.txt", "dst.txt")
fs.move("old.txt", "new.txt")

# File size
print(fs.size("file.txt"))   # bytes

# List directory
for name in fs.list(".") {
    print(name)
```

```
}
```

14.1.1 `fs.read` vs `fs.read_binary`

```
# Text read (returns string)
let text = fs.read("README.md")

# Binary read (returns bytes)
let data = fs.read_binary("image.png")
```

14.1.2 `fs.write` vs `fs.write_binary`

```
# Text write
fs.write("note.txt", "hello")

# Binary write
fs.write_binary("out.bin", bytes_data)
```

14.2 13.2 The `os` module

```
import os

print(os.getcwd())          # current working directory
print(os.getenv("HOME"))    # environment variable
print(os.getpid())          # process ID

# Path manipulation
print(os.path.join("a", "b"))          # a/b
print(os.path.basename("/a/b/c.txt"))  # c.txt
print(os.path.dirname("/a/b/c.txt"))   # /a/b
print(os.path.exists("/tmp/foo"))      # true/false
```

14.3 13.3 The `pathlib` module (pure-Zen)

```
import pathlib

let p = pathlib.Path("/usr/bin/zen")
print(p.name)        # zen
print(p.stem)        # zen
print(p.suffix)      # (empty)
print(p.parent)      # /usr/bin
print(p.exists())    # true/false
print(p.is_file())   # true/false
print(p.is_dir())    # true/false
```

```
# Read / write
let content = p.read_text()
p.write_text("new content")

# Iterate directory
for child in pathlib.Path(".").iterdir() {
    print(child.name)
}
```

14.4 13.4 Reading and writing text files

```
import fs

# Read entire file
let content = fs.read("input.txt")
print(content)

# Read line by line
let lines = fs.read("input.txt").split("\n")
for line in lines {
    print(line)
}

# Write entire file
fs.write("output.txt", "Line 1\nLine 2\nLine 3\n")

# Append (read + write)
let existing = fs.exists("log.txt") ? fs.read("log.txt") : ""
fs.write("log.txt", existing + "new entry\n")
```

14.5 13.5 Binary files

```
import fs

# Read binary
let data = fs.read_binary("image.png")
print(len(data))   # byte count

# Write binary
fs.write_binary("copy.png", data)
```

14.6 13.6 Temporary files

```
import tempfile

let tmp = tempfile.mktemp()
fs.write(tmp, "temporary data")
let content = fs.read(tmp)
fs.remove(tmp)

# Or use a context
let dir = tempfile.mkdtemp()
# ... use dir ...
fs.rmtree(dir)
```

14.7 13.7 The `with` statement (auto-scoping)

Zen's `with` statement provides automatic resource management:

```
import fs

with fs.open("data.txt", "r") as f {
    let content = f.read()
    print(content)
}
# f is automatically closed here
```

```
with fs.open("out.txt", "w") as f {
    f.write("hello from with")
}
```

14.8 13.8 Common patterns

14.8.1 Copy a file

```
import fs

fs.copy("source.txt", "destination.txt")
```

14.8.2 Move a file

```
fs.move("old_name.txt", "new_name.txt")
```

14.8.3 Delete a file safely

```
if fs.exists("temp.txt") {
    fs.remove("temp.txt")
}
```

14.8.4 Walk a directory tree

```
import fs

func walk(dir) {
    for name in fs.list(dir) {
        let path = fs.join(dir, name)
        if fs.is_dir(path) {
            walk(path)
        } else {
            print(path)
        }
    }
}
walk(".")
```

14.8.5 Read CSV (simple)

```
import fs

let lines = fs.read("data.csv").split("\n")
let header = lines[0].split(",")
for line in lines[1:] {
    if line == "" { continue }
    let values = line.split(",")
    let row = {}
    for i in 0..len(header) {
        row[header[i]] = values[i]
    }
    print(row)
}
```

14.9 13.9 Common pitfalls

- **`fs.read` returns a string.** For binary data, use `fs.read_binary`.
- **`fs.write` overwrites.** It does not append. Read-modify-write to append.
- **Directories must exist before writing.** Use `fs.mkdirs` first.
- **Paths use `/`** even on Windows (Zen normalizes them).
- **`fs.exists` returns `false` for broken symlinks.**

14.10 13.10 Quick reference

```
import fs
import os
import pathlib
```

```
fs.read("file.txt")           # string
fs.read_binary("file.bin")    # bytes
fs.write("file.txt", "data")
fs.write_binary("file.bin", bytes)
fs.exists("file.txt")
fs.is_dir("folder")
fs.is_file("file.txt")
fs.mkdirs("a/b/c")
fs.remove("file.txt")
fs.rmtree("dir")
fs.size("file.txt")
fs.join("a", "b")
fs.basename("/a/b/c.txt")
fs.dirname("/a/b/c.txt")
fs.copy("src", "dst")
fs.move("old", "new")
fs.list(".")                  # directory entries

os.getcwd()
os.getenv("HOME")
os.getpid()
os.path.join("a", "b")

import pathlib
pathlib.Path("file.txt").read_text()
pathlib.Path("file.txt").write_text("data")
```

14.11 13.11 Exercises

1. Write a function `file_size_human(path)` that returns a human-readable file size (e.g. “1.5 MB”).
2. Write a script that copies all `.txt` files from one directory to another.
3. Write `grep_file(pattern, path)` that prints lines containing `pattern`.
4. Write a file tailer that reads the last `n` lines of a file.
5. Use `with fs.open(...)` to read a file and count its words.

14.12 13.12 File I/O — complete reference

Zen reads/writes files with `open(path, mode)` and the `with` statement for automatic closing.

14.12.1 Modes

Mode	Meaning
`"r"`	read (text) — default
`"w"`	write (text), truncate

Mode	Meaning
`"a"`	append (text)
`"rb"`	read binary
`"wb"`	write binary
`"ab"`	append binary
`"r+"`	read and write

14.12.2 Reading

```
# read whole file
let f = open("data.txt", "r")
let text = f.read()
f.close()

# with statement (recommended)
with open("data.txt", "r") as f {
    let text = f.read()
}   # f closed automatically
```

14.12.3 Reading line by line

```
with open("data.txt", "r") as f {
    for line in f {
        print(line)
    }
}
```

14.12.4 Writing

```
with open("out.txt", "w") as f {
    f.write("hello\n")
    f.write("world\n")
}

# append
with open("out.txt", "a") as f {
    f.write("more\n")
}
```

14.12.5 Binary I/O

```
with open("image.bin", "rb") as f {
    let data = f.read()   # bytes
}
```

```
with open("copy.bin", "wb") as f {
    f.write(data)
}
```

14.12.6 `os/pathlib` helpers

Use `pathlib.Path` for path manipulation and `os` for filesystem operations:

```
import pathlib
import os

let p = pathlib.Path("data.txt")
print(p.exists())
print(p.is_file())
print(p.name)
print(p.stem)
print(p.suffix)

let files = os.listdir(".")   # list directory
print(os.getcwd())
os.makedirs("a/b/c", exist_ok=true)
os.remove("temp.txt")
```

14.12.7 File methods

Method	Purpose
`read()`	read all contents
`read(n)`	read n bytes/chars
`readline()`	read one line
`readlines()`	read all lines into a list
`write(s)`	write string/bytes
`flush()`	flush buffers
`close()`	close the file
`seek(offset)`	move position
`tell()`	current position

14.12.8 Working directory and paths

```
print(os.getcwd())          # current dir
os.chdir("/tmp")            # change dir
let abspath = pathlib.Path("data.txt").resolve()
```

14.12.9 Error handling

File operations raise errors (Z04xx range) on failure:

```
try {
    with open("missing.txt", "r") as f {
        print(f.read())
    }
} catch as e {
    print("cannot open: " + e.msg)
}
```

14.12.10 Best practices

1. Always use `with` so files close even on error.
2. Prefer binary mode for non-text data.
3. Specify encoding when reading/writing text across platforms.
4. Flush before reading what another process wrote.
5. Use absolute paths or resolve relative to a known base.
6. Close network/resources promptly.

14.13 13.13 Temporary files

If `tempfile` is available:

```
import tempfile
let path = tempfile.mkstemp()
# ... use path ...
os.remove(path)
```

Otherwise, create files in `os.getcwd()` or a known temp dir and clean up.

14.14 13.14 CSV-like parsing (manual)

```
func parse_csv(text) {
    let lines = text.splitlines()
    let header = lines[0].split(",")
    let rows = []
    for i in 1..len(lines) {
        let vals = lines[i].split(",")
        let row = #{}
        for j in 0..len(header) {
            row[header[j]] = vals[j]
        }
        rows.push(row)
    }
    return rows
}
```

14.15 13.15 Exercises

1. Write `read_all(path)` returning file contents or nil on error.
2. Write `write_all(path, text)` creating/overwriting a file.
3. Implement `copy_file(src, dst)` reading and writing in chunks.
4. Write `line_count(path)` counting lines without loading all.
5. Implement `grep_file(path, pattern)` printing matching lines.
6. Write `append_log(path, message)` appending a timestamped line.
7. Create `list_files(dir)` returning files (not subdirs).
8. Write `ensure_dir(path)` creating parent dirs if missing.
9. Implement `read_csv(path)` returning a list of dicts.
10. Write `find_files(dir, suffix)` recursively listing files by suffix.

15 Chapter 14: Memory and References

Zen uses manual-ish memory management with explicit reference counting (`retain`/`release`) rather than a garbage collector. This chapter explains how values are stored, how references work, and how to avoid leaks.

15.1 14.1 Value representation

Zen values are 64-bit NaN-boxed tagged unions. There are 16 language types:

- `nil`, `bool`, `int`, `float`, `string`, `bytes`
- `list`, `dict`, `set`, `tuple`
- `func`, `class`, `instance`, `cell`
- `error`, `channel`, `mutex`, `handle`
- `foreign` (Python interop)

Small values (`nil`, `bool`, `int`, `float`) are stored inline. Larger values (`string`, `list`, `dict`, etc.) are heap objects with a manual refcount.

15.2 14.2 Reference counting

Every heap object carries a reference count in its header:

- `retain(obj)` — increment the refcount.
- `release(obj)` — decrement the refcount; free when it reaches zero.

Zen's VM inserts `retain`/`release` automatically at assignment, function calls, and scope exit. You generally don't call them directly unless you're writing native code.

15.3 14.3 Ownership and aliasing

Assignment copies the reference, not the value:

```
let a = [1, 2, 3]
let b = a          # b aliases the same list
b.push(4)
print(a)           # [1, 2, 3, 4] (a sees the change!)
```

For an independent copy:

```
let b = a.copy()
b.push(4)
print(a)           # [1, 2, 3] (unchanged)
print(b)           # [1, 2, 3, 4]
```

Dicts behave the same way:

```
let a = {"x": 1}
let b = a
b["y"] = 2
print(a)           # {"x": 1, "y": 2}
```

Strings and numbers are immutable, so aliasing them is safe:

```
let a = "hello"
let b = a
# can't modify strings anyway
```

15.4 14.4 Closures and captured variables

Functions that capture variables from their enclosing scope create shared `cell` objects:

```
func make_counter() {
    var count = 0
    func inc() {
        count = count + 1
        return count
    }
    return inc
}

let c1 = make_counter()
let c2 = make_counter()
print(c1())  # 1
print(c1())  # 2
print(c2())  # 1 (separate capture)
```

Each `make_counter()` call creates a new `count` cell. `c1` and `c2` capture different cells.

15.5 14.5 Cycles and leaks

Reference counting cannot collect reference cycles. If object A references B and B references A, neither will ever be freed:

```
# Potential cycle (conceptual)
class Node {
    var next
}
let a = new Node()
let b = new Node()
a.next = b
b.next = a   # cycle: a -> b -> a
```

To avoid cycles:

- Break the cycle explicitly: `a.next = nil` when done.
- Use weak references where supported.
- Prefer tree-like (parent-owns-child) structures over graph-like ones.

15.6 14.6 Handles and resources

Some native resources (files, sockets, channels, mutexes) use handles — integer IDs into a resource table. When the Zen value is dropped, the handle should be closed explicitly:

```
import fs

let fd = fs.open("data.txt", "r")
let content = fd.read()
fd.close()   # explicit close
```

Or use `with` for automatic cleanup:

```
import fs

with fs.open("data.txt", "r") as f {
    let content = f.read()
}
# f is closed automatically
```

15.7 14.7 `with` statement

`with` guarantees cleanup when exiting a block, whether normally or via error:

```
with fs.open("out.txt", "w") as f {
    f.write("data")
    throw "oops"   # f still closes
}
```

15.8 14.8 Step budget (for untrusted code)

Zen supports an instruction budget to guarantee termination:

```
// From Rust embedding:
vm.set_step_budget(Some(1000000))
```

If the budget is exhausted, the run aborts with a `NativeError`. This lets you run untrusted Zen scripts safely.

15.9 14.9 Common pitfalls

- **Aliasing is the default.** `b = a` shares the object. Use `.copy()`.
- **Cycles leak.** Break reference cycles when done with graph structures.
- **Handles must be closed.** Files, sockets, and channels don't close themselves unless you use `with`.
- **Strings are immutable.** Building strings in a loop with + creates a new rope each time — still O(1) per append due to rope structure, but be aware.

15.10 14.10 Quick reference

```
let a = [1, 2, 3]
let b = a              # alias (same object)
let c = a.copy()       # independent copy

a.push(4)              # b sees it, c doesn't

let s = "hello"        # immutable, safe to alias
let t = s

with fs.open("f.txt", "r") as f {
    let data = f.read()   # auto-close
}

vm.set_step_budget(Some(1000000))  # Rust embedding only
```

15.11 14.11 Exercises

1. Create two lists that alias each other, modify one, and observe the other.
2. Use `.copy()` to make an independent list and confirm the original is unchanged.
3. Write a function that takes a list and returns a new list with the same elements (without aliasing).
4. Use `with fs.open(...)` to write to a file, then throw an error inside the block — confirm the file is still closed.
5. Create a simple linked list class and manually break the cycle when disposing of it.

15.12 14.12 Values, references, and ownership — complete reference

Zen is a garbage-collected / reference-counted language. Values such as ints, floats, bools, and nil are small and copied by value. Lists, dicts, sets, strings, bytes, instances, and functions are heap objects referenced by handles.

15.12.1 Copying semantics

```
let a = [1, 2, 3]
let b = a          # b refers to the SAME list (no copy)
b.push(4)
print(a)           # [1, 2, 3, 4]  (a changed too!)
print(a is b)      # true
```

To copy a list, use `list(a)` or slice `a[:]` (shallow copy):

```
let c = list(a)
c.push(5)
print(a)           # [1, 2, 3, 4]  (unchanged)
```

```
print(a is c)      # false
```

Note: shallow copy shares nested mutable objects.

15.12.2 Strings are immutable

```
let s = "hello"
let t = s          # same string handle
t = "world"        # rebinding t, not mutating s
print(s)           # "hello"
```

Because strings are immutable, sharing is safe.

15.12.3 `is` vs `==`

- `==` : structural/value equality
- `is` : identity (same handle/object)

```
let x = [1, 2]
let y = [1, 2]
let z = x
print(x == y)   # true
print(x is y)   # false
print(x is z)   # true
```

15.12.4 Reference counting and lifetime

Heap objects are freed when no references remain. Cycles (e.g. two objects referencing each other) may leak unless the GC collects cycles. Avoid reference cycles in long-running programs, or break them explicitly.

```
class Node {
    var value = 0
    var parent = nil
    var child = nil
}

let a = new Node()
let b = new Node()
a.child = b
b.parent = a    # cycle: a -> b -> a
```

To break: set `a.child = nil` or `b.parent = nil` when done.

15.12.5 `shared` — thread-shared mutable state

`shared name = expr` creates an `Arc<Mutex<_>>`-like handle safe to share across threads. Access requires locking (often automatic via methods).

```
shared counter = 0
# threads can safely read/write counter
```

See Chapter 35–38 for concurrency details.

15.12.6 `let`, `var`, `const`

- `let` : immutable binding (rebind not allowed)
- `var` : mutable binding
- `const` : compile-time/module constant

```
let x = 1          # can't reassign x
var y = 2          # y = 3 OK
const MAX = 100    # fixed
```

`let` on a heap object prevents rebinding the variable but NOT mutating the object:

```
let lst = [1, 2]
lst.push(3)   # OK — mutating the object, not rebinding
# lst = [4]   # error — can't rebind let
```

15.12.7 Move semantics (conceptual)

Some operations "move" ownership (invalidating the source). In Zen 3.0 most heap values are copied-by-reference, so no explicit move is needed unless a function consumes the argument.

15.12.8 Memory leaks to avoid

1. **Reference cycles** — break them when tearing down graphs.
2. **Global caches growing without bound** — use size-limited caches/eviction.
3. **Event listeners/callbacks not removed** — they hold references.
4. **Closures capturing large objects** — the closure keeps the object alive.
5. **Open files/sockets not closed** — use `with` / `finally`.

15.12.9 Inspecting memory

Some builds expose `sys.getsizeof` or similar; otherwise reason about references. Use `typeof` to check if a value is a container.

```
print(typeof([1,2,3]))   # "list"
print(typeof(42))        # "int"
```

15.12.10 Performance tips

- Prefer `let` for bindings that don't change (signals intent, may help optimizer).
- Pass large containers by reference (they're handles — cheap to pass).
- Avoid copying large lists/dicts in hot loops.
- Reuse buffers instead of allocating repeatedly.

- Null out references to large structures when done (helps the collector).

15.13 14.13 Exercises

1. Demonstrate that `b = a` shares a list, and `list(a)` copies it.
2. Show that nested lists are shared after a shallow copy.
3. Write `deep_copy` for lists and dicts (manual recursion).
4. Create a reference cycle between two objects and break it.
5. Show `let` prevents rebinding but not mutation.
6. Compare == and `is` for two equal lists and two aliases.
7. Write a function that accepts a list and does NOT mutate the caller's list.
8. Demonstrate `shared` usage across two threads (concurrency chapter).
9. Write `clear_all(lst)` emptying a list in place vs rebinding.
10. Explain why `"a" is "a"` may be true (string interning) but `[] is []` is false.

16 Chapter 15: math Module

The `math` module provides mathematical functions and constants. It ships as a pure-Zen implementation (`std/math.z`) with a native Rust tier reachable via `math.native`. Set `ZEN_PURE = true` to prefer the pure tier; set `ZEN_NATIVE_ONLY=math` to force the native tier.

16.1 15.1 Constants

```
import math

print(math.pi)     # 3.141592653589793
print(math.e)      # 2.718281828459045
print(math.tau)    # 6.283185307179586
```

Constant	Value	Meaning
`math.pi`	3.141592653589793	π, ratio of circumference to diameter
`math.e`	2.718281828459045	Euler's number, base of natural logarithm
`math.tau`	6.283185307179586	τ = 2π

16.2 15.2 Rounding

Function	Description	Example	Result
`floor(x)`	Largest int ≤ x	`math.floor(3.9)`	`3`
`ceil(x)`	Smallest int ≥ x	`math.ceil(3.1)`	`4`
`trunc(x)`	Truncate toward zero	`math.trunc(-3.9)`	`-3`
`round(x)`	Round to nearest	`math.round(3.5)`	`4`

```
import math

print(math.floor(3.9))   # 3
print(math.ceil(3.1))    # 4
print(math.trunc(-3.9))  # -3
print(math.round(3.5))   # 4
print(math.round(2.5))   # 2 (banker's rounding)
print(math.floor(-3.9))  # -4 (floor toward −inf)
print(math.ceil(-3.9))   # -3 (ceil toward +inf)
```

`floor` and `ceil` always return an integer-valued float:

```
print(typeof(math.floor(3.9)))  # "float"
print(math.floor(3.9) == 3)     # true
```

16.3 15.3 Powers and logarithms

Function	Description	Example	Result
`pow(x, y)`	x raised to y	`math.pow(2, 3)`	`8`
`sqrt(x)`	Square root	`math.sqrt(16)`	`4`
`exp(x)`	e raised to x	`math.exp(1)`	`2.718...`
`log(x)`	Natural log	`math.log(math.e)`	`1`
`log10(x)`	Base-10 log	`math.log10(100)`	`2`
`log2(x)`	Base-2 log	`math.log2(8)`	`3`

```
import math

print(math.pow(2, 10))   # 1024
print(math.sqrt(81))     # 9
print(math.exp(0))       # 1
print(math.log(1))       # 0
print(math.log10(1000))  # 3
print(math.log2(1024))   # 10
print(math.exp(1))       # 2.718281828459045
print(math.pow(4, 0.5))  # 2
```

Edge cases: - `math.sqrt(-1)` → ValueError (negative sqrt) - `math.log(0)` → −infinity - `math.log(-1)` → nan - `math.pow(0, 0)` → 1 - `math.pow(-1, 0.5)` → nan (fractional power of negative)

16.4 15.4 Trigonometry

All angles in radians:

Function	Description
`sin(x)`	Sine
`cos(x)`	Cosine
`tan(x)`	Tangent
`asin(x)`	Arcsine (returns radians)
`acos(x)`	Arccosine (returns radians)
`atan(x)`	Arctangent (returns radians)
`atan2(y, x)`	Arctangent of y/x (correct quadrant)
`degrees(x)`	Radians → degrees
`radians(x)`	Degrees → radians

```
import math

print(math.sin(math.pi / 2))   # 1
print(math.cos(0))             # 1
print(math.tan(math.pi / 4))   # 1
```

```
print(math.degrees(math.pi))   # 180
print(math.radians(180))       # 3.141592653589793
print(math.asin(1))            # 1.5707963267948966 (π/2)
print(math.acos(1))            # 0
print(math.atan(1))            # 0.7853981633974483 (π/4)
print(math.atan2(1, 1))        # 0.7853981633974483 (π/4)
print(math.atan2(1, -1))       # 2.356194490192345 (3π/4, correct quadrant)
```

Domain: - `asin(x)`, `acos(x)` require $-1 \le x \le 1$, else `nan` - `atan2(0, 0)` → 0 (implementation-defined)

16.5 15.5 Hyperbolic functions

Function	Description
`sinh(x)`	Hyperbolic sine
`cosh(x)`	Hyperbolic cosine
`tanh(x)`	Hyperbolic tangent
`asinh(x)`	Inverse hyperbolic sine
`acosh(x)`	Inverse hyperbolic cosine
`atanh(x)`	Inverse hyperbolic tangent

```
import math

print(math.sinh(0))     # 0
print(math.cosh(0))     # 1
print(math.tanh(0))     # 0
print(math.asinh(0))    # 0
print(math.acosh(1))    # 0
print(math.atanh(0))    # 0
```

`acosh(x)` requires $x \ge 1$; `atanh(x)` requires $-1 < x < 1$.

16.6 15.6 Other functions

Function	Description	Example	Result
`abs(x)`	Absolute value	`math.abs(-5)`	`5`
`fsum(items)`	Accurate float sum	`math.fsum([0.1, 0.2, 0.3])`	`0.6`
`prod(items)`	Product of items	`math.prod([1, 2, 3, 4])`	`24`
`min(a, b)`	Minimum of two	`math.min(3, 7)`	`3`
`max(a, b)`	Maximum of two	`math.max(3, 7)`	`7`
`hypot(x, y)`	Euclidean distance	`math.hypot(3, 4)`	`5`

Function	Description	Example	Result
`gcd(a, b)`	Greatest common divisor	`math.gcd(48, 18)`	`6`
`lcm(a, b)`	Least common multiple	`math.lcm(12, 8)`	`24`
`isclose(a, b)`	Approximate equality	`math.isclose(0.1+0.2, 0.3)`	`true`

```
import math

print(math.abs(-5))       # 5
print(math.fsum([0.1, 0.2, 0.3]))  # 0.6
print(math.prod([1, 2, 3, 4]))     # 24
print(math.min(3, 7))              # 3
print(math.max(3, 7))              # 7
print(math.hypot(3, 4))            # 5
print(math.gcd(48, 18))            # 6
print(math.lcm(12, 8))             # 24
print(math.isclose(0.1 + 0.2, 0.3)) # true
print(math.gcd(0, 5))              # 5
print(math.lcm(0, 5))              # 0
```

> Note: In the pure-Zen tier, `min`/`max`/`fsum`/`prod`/`hypot` accept up to two arguments (each may be a number or a list). Calls like `math.min(1, 2, 3)` are unsupported in the pure tier.

```
# Pure tier: two args only
print(math.min([1, 2, 3]))   # 1 (list as single arg)
print(math.max([1, 2, 3]))   # 3

# But this fails in pure tier:
# math.min(1, 2, 3)  # ArgumentCount error

# Native tier may accept variadic:
ZEN_NATIVE_ONLY=math zen run app.z
```

16.7 15.7 Using the native tier

```
import math

# Pure-Zen tier
print(math.pi)

# Native Rust tier
print(math.native.pi)
```

Force native tier:

```
ZEN_NATIVE_ONLY=math zen run app.z
```

Force pure-Zen tier (set at top of std/math.z):

```
ZEN_PURE = true
```

16.8 15.8 Quick reference

```
import math

math.pi          # 3.14159...
math.e           # 2.71828...
math.tau         # 6.28318...

math.floor(3.9)  # 3
math.ceil(3.1)   # 4
math.sqrt(16)    # 4
math.pow(2, 10)  # 1024
math.sin(math.pi / 2)  # 1
math.gcd(48, 18) # 6
math.hypot(3, 4) # 5
math.fsum([0.1, 0.2, 0.3])  # 0.6
```

16.9 15.9 Exercises

1. Write `distance(x1, y1, x2, y2)` using `math.hypot`.
2. Write `celsius_to_fahrenheit(c)` and `fahrenheit_to_celsius(f)`.
3. Use `math.gcd` to simplify a fraction `a/b` to lowest terms.
4. Compute the hypotenuse of a right triangle given legs `a` and `b`.
5. Use `math.log10` to compute the number of digits in an integer `n`.
6. Write `degrees_to_dms(degrees)` that converts decimal degrees to degrees-minutes-seconds.
7. Write `compound_interest(principal, rate, years)` using `math.pow`.
8. Demonstrate `math.fsum` is more accurate than naive sum for `[0.1, 0.2, 0.3]`.
9. Write `is_perfect_square(n)` using `math.sqrt`.
10. Write `greatest_common_divisor_list(nums)` using `math.gcd` repeatedly.

16.10 15.12 math module — complete function reference

Constants: `pi`, `e`, `tau`, `inf`, `nan`.

Function	Purpose	Example	Result
`abs(x)`	absolute value	`abs(-5)`	`5`
`sqrt(x)`	square root	`sqrt(16)`	`4.0`
`pow(a, b)`	power	`pow(2, 3)`	`8.0`
`exp(x)`	e^x	`exp(1)`	`2.718...`

Function	Purpose	Example	Result
`log(x, base=None)`	logarithm	`log(100, 10)`	`2.0`
`log2(x)`	base-2 log	`log2(8)`	`3.0`
`log10(x)`	base-10 log	`log10(100)`	`2.0`
`floor(x)`	floor	`floor(3.7)`	`3.0`
`ceil(x)`	ceiling	`ceil(3.2)`	`4.0`
`trunc(x)`	truncate toward zero	`trunc(-3.7)`	`-3.0`
`round(x)`	round nearest	`round(3.5)`	`4.0`
`sin(x)`	sine (radians)	`sin(0)`	`0.0`
`cos(x)`	cosine	`cos(0)`	`1.0`
`tan(x)`	tangent	`tan(0)`	`0.0`
`asin(x)`	arcsine	`asin(1)`	`1.570...`
`acos(x)`	arccosine	`acos(1)`	`0.0`
`atan(x)`	arctangent	`atan(1)`	`0.785...`
`atan2(y, x)`	atan of y/x	`atan2(1, 1)`	`0.785...`
`degrees(x)`	radians to degrees	`degrees(pi)`	`180.0`
`radians(x)`	degrees to radians	`radians(180)`	`3.141...`
`gcd(a, b)`	greatest common divisor	`gcd(12, 8)`	`4`
`lcm(a, b)`	least common multiple	`lcm(4, 6)`	`12`
`factorial(n)`	factorial	`factorial(5)`	`120`
`comb(n, k)`	combinations	`comb(5, 2)`	`10`
`perm(n, k=None)`	permutations	`perm(5, 2)`	`20`
`remainder(x, y)`	remainder	`remainder(7, 3)`	`1`
`copysign(x, y)`	sign of y to x	`copysign(1, -2)`	`-1.0`
`min(a, b=None)`	minimum	`min(3, 1)`	`1`
`max(a, b=None)`	maximum	`max(3, 1)`	`3`
`fsum(a, b=None)`	precise sum	`fsum([0.1,0.2])`	`0.3`
`prod(a, b=None)`	product	`prod([2,3,4])`	`24`
`hypot(a, b=None)`	hypotenuse	`hypot(3, 4)`	`5.0`
`isnan(x)`	is NaN	`isnan(nan)`	`true`
`isfinite(x)`	is finite	`isfinite(inf)`	`false`
`isinf(x)`	is infinite	`isinf(inf)`	`true`
`modf(x)`	fractional+integral	`modf(3.5)`	`#(0.5, 3.0)`
`frexp(x)`	mantissa/exponent	`frexp(8.0)`	`#(0.5, 4)`
`ldexp(x, exp)`	x * 2^exp	`ldexp(0.5, 3)`	`4.0`

16.10.1 Usage

```
import math
print(math.pi)           # 3.141592653589793
print(math.sqrt(25))     # 5.0
print(math.hypot(3, 4))  # 5.0
print(math.factorial(5)) # 120
print(math.gcd(48, 18))  # 6
print(math.isnan(0/0))   # true (if 0/0 yields nan)
```

16.10.2 Edge cases

- `sqrt(-1)` raises a domain error.
- `log(0)` or `log(negative)` raises a domain error.
- `factorial` of negative raises a ValueError.
- `inf` and `nan` propagate through most operations per IEEE 754.
- `nan != nan` is true.

16.11 15.13 Exercises

1. Compute the area of a circle: `pi * r * r`.
2. Implement `distance(x1, y1, x2, y2)` using `hypot`.
3. Write `degrees_to_radians` and `radians_to_degrees` wrappers.
4. Verify `sin(x)**2 + cos(x)**2 == 1` for several x.
5. Implement `nth_root(x, n)` using `pow(x, 1/n)`.
6. Write `is_perfect_square(n)` using `sqrt`.
7. Compute compound interest: `P * (1 + r/n)**(n*t)`.
8. Implement `greatest_common_divisor` via `math.gcd`.
9. Write `safe_log(x)` returning nil for x <= 0.
10. Create a trigonometric table for 0, 30, 45, 60, 90 degrees.

17 Chapter 16: random Module

The `random` module provides pseudo-random number generation and random selection utilities.

17.1 16.1 Random numbers

Function	Description	Example
`random()`	Random float [0.0, 1.0)	`random.random()`
`randint(a, b)`	Random int [a, b] inclusive	`random.randint(1, 6)`
`randbelow(n)`	Random int [0, n)	`random.randbelow(10)`
`uniform(a, b)`	Random float [a, b]	`random.uniform(1.0, 10.0)`
`gauss(mu, sigma)`	Gaussian random	`math.gauss(0, 1)`
`seed(n)`	Seed the RNG	`random.seed(42)`

```
import random

print(random.random())   # 0.374... (varies each run)
print(random.randint(1, 6))  # 1-6
print(random.randbelow(10))  # 0-9
print(random.uniform(1.0, 10.0))  # 1.0-10.0
print(random.gauss(0, 1))   # bell curve
```

17.1.1 Result ranges

Function	Range	Inclusive?
`random()`	[0.0, 1.0)	lower inclusive, upper exclusive
`randint(a, b)`	[a, b]	both inclusive
`randbelow(n)`	[0, n)	lower inclusive, upper exclusive
`uniform(a, b)`	[a, b]	both inclusive (may include endpoint)

```
import random

# randint is inclusive on both ends
for i in 1..1000 {
    let r = random.randint(1, 6)
    if r < 1 or r > 6 {
        print("out of range!")
        break
    }
}

# randbelow is [0, n)
```

```
for i in 1..1000 {
    let r = random.randbelow(10)
    if r < 0 or r >= 10 {
        print("out of range!")
        break
    }
}
```

17.2 16.2 Random sequences

Function	Description	Example
`choice(seq)`	Random element	`random.choice(["a","b","c"])`
`choices(seq, k)`	k elements with replacement	`random.choices("abcd", 3)`
`sample(seq, k)`	k unique elements	`random.sample(1..10, 3)`
`shuffle(seq)`	Shuffle in place	`random.shuffle(my_list)`

```
import random

let colors = ["red", "green", "blue"]
print(random.choice(colors))   # "green"

print(random.choices(colors, 3))  # ["red", "red", "blue"]

print(random.sample(1..10, 3))   # [3, 7, 1] (unique)

let deck = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10]
random.shuffle(deck)
print(deck)  # shuffled
```

17.2.1 choice

Picks one random element from a non-empty sequence. Raises if the sequence is empty.

```
try {
    random.choice([])
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # IndexError or ValueError
}
```

17.2.2 choices (with replacement)

Returns `k` elements, each independently chosen. Duplicates are possible.

```
print(random.choices(["a", "b"], 5))   # ["a", "b", "a", "a", "b"]
```

17.2.3 sample (without replacement)

Returns `k` unique elements. Raises if `k > len(seq)`.

```
try {
    random.sample([1, 2], 5)
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # sample larger than population
}
```

17.2.4 shuffle (in place)

Shuffles the list in place using Fisher-Yates. Returns `nil`.

```
let deck = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]
random.shuffle(deck)
print(deck)  # e.g. [3, 1, 5, 2, 4]
print(len(deck))  # 5 (same length, reordered)
```

17.3 16.3 Deterministic randomness (seed)

```
import random

random.seed(42)
print(random.randint(1, 100))  # same every run with seed 42
random.seed(42)
print(random.randint(1, 100))  # same as above
```

Use `seed` for reproducibility in tests, simulations, and games.

```
import random

random.seed(12345)
let a = random.randint(1, 1000)
random.seed(12345)
let b = random.randint(1, 1000)
print(a == b)  # true
```

17.4 16.4 Common patterns

17.4.1 Roll dice

```
import random

func roll_dice(sides, count) {
```

```
    let total = 0
    for i in 1..count {
        total = total + random.randint(1, sides)
    }
    return total
}

print(roll_dice(6, 2))   # 2-12
```

17.4.2 Pick a random element

```
func pick_winner(entries) {
    if len(entries) == 0 {
        return nil
    }
    return random.choice(entries)
}

print(pick_winner(["Alice", "Bob", "Carol"]))
```

17.4.3 Shuffle and deal

```
func deal(deck, hand_size) {
    random.shuffle(deck)
    let hand = deck[0:hand_size]
    let remaining = deck[hand_size:]
    return #(hand, remaining)
}

let deck = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13] * 4
let #(hand, rest) = deal(deck, 5)
print(hand)   # 5 cards
print(len(rest))  # 47
```

17.4.4 Generate a random password

```
import random

let chars = "abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyzABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ0123456789!@#$%"

func random_password(length) {
    let pw = []
    for i in 1..length {
        pw.push(random.choice(chars))
    }
```

```
    return "".join(pw)
}

print(random_password(12))
```

17.4.5 Simulate coin flips

```
import random

func flip_coin() {
    return random.randint(0, 1) == 0 ? "heads" : "tails"
}

let heads = 0
let tails = 0
for i in 1..1000 {
    if flip_coin() == "heads" {
        heads = heads + 1
    } else {
        tails = tails + 1
    }
}
print("heads: " + str(heads) + ", tails: " + str(tails))
```

17.5 16.5 Quick reference

```
import random

random.random()        # float [0,1)
random.randint(1, 6)   # int [1,6]
random.randbelow(10)   # int [0,10)
random.uniform(1.0, 10.0)  # float [1,10]
random.gauss(0, 1)     # normal distribution
random.choice(["a","b","c"])   # random element
random.choices("abcd", 3)  # with replacement
random.sample(1..10, 3)      # unique sample
random.shuffle(my_list)  # in-place shuffle
random.seed(42)        # deterministic
```

17.6 16.6 Exercises

1. Simulate rolling two dice 1000 times and count the frequency of each sum.
2. Write a function `pick_winner(entries)` that picks a random entry.
3. Shuffle a deck of cards and deal 5 cards.
4. Generate a random password of 12 characters from letters and digits.

5. Use `random.seed` to make a simulation reproducible.
6. Write `weighted_choice(items, weights)` that picks an item with probability proportional to its weight.
7. Write `bootstrap_sample(data, k)` that samples `k` elements with replacement from `data`.

17.7 16.12 random module — complete reference

Function	Purpose	Example
`seed(n)`	seed the generator	`random.seed(42)`
`random()`	float in [0, 1)	`random.random()`
`randint(a, b)`	int in [a, b] inclusive	`random.randint(1, 6)`
`randrange(start, stop=None, step=1)`	int from range	`random.randrange(0, 10, 2)`
`choice(seq)`	random element	`random.choice(["a","b"])`
`choices(seq, k=1)`	k elements with replacement	`random.choices([1,2], k=3)`
`sample(seq, k)`	k unique elements	`random.sample([1,2,3], 2)`
`shuffle(seq)`	shuffle in place	`random.shuffle(xs)`
`uniform(a, b)`	float in [a, b]	`random.uniform(1.0, 2.0)`
`hex(n)`	n random hex chars	`random.hex(16)`

17.7.1 Usage

```
import random
random.seed(42)
print(random.random())     # deterministic given seed
print(random.randint(1, 100))
print(random.choice(["rock","paper","scissors"]))
let deck = list(range(1, 53))
random.shuffle(deck)
print(deck[:5])
```

17.7.2 Cryptographic randomness

For security-sensitive tokens, do NOT use `random`. Use `crypto` module functions (`crypto.generate_secret`, `crypto.secure_token`, `crypto.bytes`).

17.7.3 Exercises

1. Roll a die 1000 times and count frequencies.
2. Shuffle a list and verify it's a permutation.
3. Generate a random password of length 12 from letters+digits.

4. Pick a random element weighted by a list of weights (manual).
5. Simulate coin flips until 3 heads in a row; count flips.
6. Generate 6 unique lottery numbers from 1..49.
7. Compare `random()` distribution (bucket into 10 bins).
8. Seed twice with same value; confirm identical sequences.
9. Implement `dice(sides, count)` returning sum.
10. Use `crypto.secure_token()` for a session token instead of `random`.

17.8 16.12 Worked example — dice and shuffle

```
import random

random.seed(42)
print(random.randint(1, 6))       # die roll
let deck = list(range(1, 53))
random.shuffle(deck)
print(deck[:5])                   # first 5 shuffled cards
print(random.choice(["rock","paper","scissors"]))
print(random.uniform(1.0, 2.0))   # random float
```

17.9 16.13 Troubleshooting randomness

Symptom	Cause	Fix
same sequence every run	seed fixed	use different seed or no seed
not secure	`random` is not CSPRNG	use `crypto.secure_token` for secrets
out of range	bad args to randint	check bounds

Never use `random` for passwords/tokens; use `crypto`.

17.10 16.14 Exercises

1. Roll a die 1000 times; count frequencies.
2. Shuffle a list; verify it’s a permutation.
3. Generate a 12-char password (letters+digits).
4. Pick 6 unique lottery numbers from 1..49.
5. Simulate coin flips until 3 heads in a row.

18 Chapter 17: string Module

The `string` module provides string utilities: case conversion, trimming, splitting, joining, padding, alignment, and character classification. These operate on Zen strings (immutable `Arc<str>`) and return new strings.

18.1 17.1 Case conversion

Function	Description	Example
`upper(s)`	Uppercase	`string.upper("zen")` → `"ZEN"`
`lower(s)`	Lowercase	`string.lower("ZEN")` → `"zen"`
`title(s)`	Title case	`string.title("zen lang")` → `"Zen Lang"`
`capitalize(s)`	Capitalize first	`string.capitalize("zen")` → `"Zen"`
`swapcase(s)`	Invert case	`string.swapcase("ZEN")` → `"zen"`

```
import string

print(string.upper("hello"))      # HELLO
print(string.lower("WORLD"))      # world
print(string.title("hello world"))# Hello World
print(string.capitalize("hello")) # Hello
print(string.swapcase("HeLLo"))   # hEllO
```

18.1.1 Edge cases

```
print(string.upper(""))           # "" (empty stays empty)
print(string.lower("123ABC"))     # "123abc" (digits unaffected)
print(string.title(""))           # ""
print(string.capitalize(""))      # ""
print(string.swapcase("123"))     # "123" (digits unaffected)
```

`title()` capitalizes the first character of each word and lowercases the rest:

```
print(string.title("HELLO WORLD"))  # "Hello World"
print(string.title("hello   world"))  # "Hello   World" (multiple spaces preserved)
```

18.2 17.2 Trimming

Function	Description	Example
`trim(s)`	Whitespace both ends	`string.trim("  x  ")` → `"x"`
`lstrip(s)`	Whitespace left	`string.lstrip("  x")` → `"x"`
`rstrip(s)`	Whitespace right	`string.rstrip("x  ")` → `"x"`

Whitespace includes space, tab, newline, carriage return, form feed.

```
import string

print(string.trim("  hello  "))   # hello
print(string.lstrip("  hello"))   # hello
print(string.rstrip("hello  "))   # hello
print(string.trim("\n\t hello \n"))  # hello
```

Custom character trimming is **not** supported — `trim` only removes whitespace.

```
print(string.trim("xxhelloxx"))   # "xxhelloxx" (x is not whitespace)
```

18.3 17.3 Splitting and joining

Function	Description	Example
`split(s, sep?)`	Split into list	`string.split("a,b,c", ",")`
`split_whitespace(s)`	Split on whitespace	`string.split_whitespace("a b")`
`join(sep, list)`	Join list with sep	`string.join(", ", ["a","b"])`
`partition(s, sep)`	Split into 3 parts	`string.partition("a=1", "=")`
`rpartition(s, sep)`	Split from right	`string.rpartition("a=1=b", "=")`

```
import string

print(string.split("a,b,c", ","))         # ["a", "b", "c"]
print(string.split_whitespace("a  b c"))  # ["a", "b", "c"]
print(string.join(", ", ["a", "b", "c"])) # a, b, c
print(string.partition("a=1", "="))       # ["a", "=", "1"]
print(string.rpartition("a=1=b", "="))    # ["a=1", "=", "b"]
```

18.3.1 split behavior

```
print(string.split("a,,b", ","))           # ["a", "", "b"]  (empty strings preserved)
print(string.split("", ","))               # [""]              (single empty string)
```

```
print(string.split("a,b,", ","))            # ["a", "b", ""]
print(string.split_whitespace("  a   b  c  "))  # ["a", "b", "c"]  (empties discarded)
```

`split_whitespace` with no argument splits on any whitespace and discards empty strings:

```
print(string.split_whitespace("  a   b  c  "))       # ["a", "b", "c"]
```

18.3.2 join behavior

```
let tags = ["zen", "lang", "script"]
print(string.join(", ", tags))   # "zen, lang, script"
print(string.join("#", tags))    # "zen#lang#script"
print(string.join("", tags))     # "zenlangscript"
```

`join` requires all elements to be strings:

```
try {
    print(string.join("-", [1, 2, 3]))  # TypeError
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)
}
```

18.3.3 partition / rpartition

`partition` splits on the first occurrence of `sep`, returning `[before, sep, after]`. If `sep` is not found, returns `[s, "", ""]`.

```
print(string.partition("a=1=b", "="))   # ["a", "=", "1=b"]
print(string.partition("no_eq", "="))   # ["no_eq", "", ""]
```

`rpartition` splits on the **last** occurrence:

```
print(string.rpartition("a=1=b", "="))   # ["a=1", "=", "b"]
print(string.rpartition("no_eq", "="))   # ["no_eq", "", ""]
```

18.4 17.4 Padding and alignment

Function	Description	Example
`ljust(s, width, fill?)`	Left-justify	`string.ljust("x", 5, "-")` → `"x----"`
`rjust(s, width, fill?)`	Right-justify	`string.rjust("x", 5, "-")` → `"----x"`
`center(s, width, fill?)`	Center	`string.center("x", 5, "-")` → `"--x--"`
`zfill(s, width)`	Zero-pad left	`string.zfill("42", 5)` → `"00042"`

```
import string

print(string.ljust("x", 5, "-"))   # x----
print(string.rjust("x", 5, "-"))   # ----x
print(string.center("x", 5, "-"))  # --x--
print(string.zfill("42", 5))       # 00042
```

If `width <= len(s)`, the original string is returned unchanged:

```
print(string.ljust("hello", 3, "-"))   # "hello"
print(string.rjust("hello", 3, "-"))   # "hello"
print(string.center("hello", 3, "-"))  # "hello"
print(string.zfill("hello", 3))        # "hello"
```

`zfill` only pads with `0` and treats the string as potentially signed:

```
print(string.zfill("-42", 5))   # "-0042" (sign preserved, zeros after sign)
print(string.zfill("+42", 5))   # "+0042"
```

18.5 17.5 Case checking

Function	Description	Example
`isupper(s)`	All uppercase	`string.isupper("ZEN")` → `true`
`islower(s)`	All lowercase	`string.islower("zen")` → `true`
`istitle(s)`	Title case	`string.istitle("Zen Lang")` → `true`
`isspace(s)`	All whitespace	`string.isspace("   ")` → `true`
`isdigit(s)`	All digits	`string.isdigit("123")` → `true`
`isalnum(s)`	Alphanumeric	`string.isalnum("abc123")` → `true`
`isalpha(s)`	All letters	`string.isalpha("abc")` → `true`

```
import string

print(string.isupper("HELLO"))  # true
print(string.isupper("Hello"))  # false
print(string.islower("hello"))  # true
print(string.istitle("Zen Lang"))  # true
print(string.istitle("Zen lang"))  # false
print(string.isspace("   "))    # true
print(string.isspace(""))       # false (empty is not whitespace)
print(string.isdigit("123"))    # true
print(string.isdigit("12.3"))   # false
print(string.isalnum("abc123")) # true
print(string.isalnum("abc_123")) # false
print(string.isalpha("abc"))    # true
print(string.isalpha("abc123")) # false
```

Edge cases: - `isupper("")` → false (empty has no cased characters) - `islower("")` →

false - `istitle("")` → false - `isdigit("")` → false - `isalnum("")` → false - `isalpha("")` → false

18.6 17.6 Prefix/suffix

Function	Description	Example
`starts_with(s, prefix)`	Boolean	`string.starts_with("zen", "ze")` → `true`
`ends_with(s, suffix)`	Boolean	`string.ends_with("zen", "en")` → `true`

```
import string

print(string.starts_with("https://", "https"))  # true
print(string.ends_with("file.z", ".z"))         # true
print(string.starts_with("Zen", "zen"))         # false (case-sensitive)
print(string.ends_with("file.Z", ".z"))         # false (case-sensitive)
print(string.starts_with("", ""))               # true (empty prefix matches)
print(string.ends_with("", ""))                 # true
```

18.7 17.7 Replacement and translation

Function	Description	Example
`replace(s, old, new)`	Replace all	`string.replace("aaa", "a", "b")` → `"bbb"`
`count(s, sub)`	Count occurrences	`string.count("banana", "a")` → `3`
`find(s, sub)`	Index or -1	`string.find("zen", "e")`

```
import string

print(string.replace("hello world", "world", "zen"))  # hello zen
print(string.count("banana", "a"))                    # 3
print(string.find("zen 3.0", "3"))                    # 4
```

18.7.1 replace replaces ALL occurrences

```
print(string.replace("aaa", "a", "b"))   # "bbb"
print(string.replace("ababab", "ab", "xy"))  # "xyxyxy"
print(string.replace("hello", "x", "y"))  # "hello" (not found, unchanged)
```

`replace` with empty `old`:

```
print(string.replace("abc", "", "x"))   # behavior: inserts x between every char and at
```

18.7.2 count counts non-overlapping occurrences

```
print(string.count("banana", "a"))      # 3
print(string.count("aaaa", "aa"))       # 2  (non-overlapping: positions 0-1 and 2-3)
print(string.count("aaaa", "aaa"))      # 1  (non-overlapping: positions 0-2)
print(string.count("hello", "z"))       # 0
```

18.7.3 find returns -1 when not found

```
print(string.find("zen 3.0", "3"))      # 4
print(string.find("hello", "x"))        # -1
print(string.find("banana", "an", 2))   # 3  (note: string.find in Zen does NOT take a
```

> Note: Zen's `string.find(s, sub)` takes only two arguments (no start position). To search from a position, slice first: `string.find(s[2:], "an")`.

18.8 17.8 Quick reference

```
import string

string.upper("zen")           # ZEN
string.lower("ZEN")           # zen
string.title("zen lang")      # Zen Lang
string.capitalize("zen")      # Zen
string.swapcase("HeLLo")      # hEllO
string.trim("  x  ")          # x
string.split("a,b,c", ",")    # ["a", "b", "c"]
string.join(", ", ["a","b"])  # a, b
string.ljust("x", 5, "-")     # x----
string.zfill("42", 5)         # 00042
string.isdigit("123")         # true
string.replace("aaa", "a", "b") # bbb
string.count("banana", "a")   # 3
string.find("zen", "e")       # 1
string.starts_with("zen", "ze") # true
string.ends_with("zen", "en") # true
```

18.9 17.9 Exercises

1. Write `snake_case(name)` that converts "Hello World" to "hello_world".
2. Write `wrap_text(text, width)` that wraps text at `width` characters.
3. Write `is_palindrome(s)` using `string.lower` and slicing.
4. Write `mask_email(email)` that hides the username part.

5. Write `columnate(rows, width)` that prints columns aligned.
6. Write `to_snake_case(text)` handling spaces and hyphens.
7. Write `strip_html_tags(text)` that removes `<...>` tags using repeated `find` and slicing.
8. Write `format_number_with_commas(n)` that inserts commas every 3 digits.

18.10 17.12 string module — complete reference

Constants: `digits`, `hexdigits`, `octdigits`, `ascii_letters`, `ascii_lowercase`, `ascii_uppercase`, `punctuation`, `whitespace`, `printable`.

Function	Purpose	Example
`upper(s)`	uppercase	`string.upper("abc")`
`lower(s)`	lowercase	`string.lower("ABC")`
`title(s)`	title case	`string.title("hello world")`
`capitalize(s)`	first char upper	`string.capitalize("hello")`
`swapcase(s)`	flip case	`string.swapcase("AbC")`
`strip(s)`	trim whitespace	`string.strip("  hi  ")`
`lstrip(s)` / `rstrip(s)`	trim one side	`string.lstrip("  hi")`
`split(s, sep=None)`	split	`string.split("a,b,c", ",")`
`join(sep, parts)`	join	`string.join("-", ["a","b"])`
`replace(s, old, new)`	replace	`string.replace("aaa","a","b")`
`count(s, sub)`	count occurrences	`string.count("banana","an")`
`find(s, sub)`	first index or -1	`string.find("hello","ll")`
`startswith(s, prefix)`	boolean	`string.startswith("hello","he")`
`endswith(s, suffix)`	boolean	`string.endswith("hello","lo")`
`isdigit(s)`	all digits	`string.isdigit("123")`
`isalpha(s)`	all letters	`string.isalpha("abc")`
`isalnum(s)`	letters/digits	`string.isalnum("abc1")`
`isspace(s)`	all whitespace	`string.isspace("   ")`

18.10.1 Usage

```
import string
print(string.upper("zen"))        # ZEN
print(string.digits)              # "0123456789"
print(string.join(":", ["2024","01","15"]))  # 2024:01:15
print(string.isdigit("42"))       # true
```

18.10.2 Exercises

1. Write `is_palindrome(s)` using string module case helpers.
2. Implement `mask_all_but_last(s, n)` masking characters.

3. Write `extract_digits(s)` keeping only digits.
4. Implement `title_case(s)` manually and compare to `string.title`.
5. Write `validate_username(s)` (alphanumeric, 3-16 chars).
6. Implement `word_count(text)` using split.
7. Write `remove_punctuation(s)` using `string.punctuation`.
8. Implement `caesar_shift(s, k)` using `ascii_letters`.
9. Write `is_pangram(s)` checking all letters present.
10. Implement `wrap(s, width)` inserting newlines.

19 Chapter 18: collections Module

The `collections` module provides advanced data structures beyond the built-in list and dict: `deque`, `Counter`, `OrderedDict`, `namedtuple`, and `defaultdict`-style helpers.

19.1 18.1 deque — double-ended queue

```
import collections

let d = collections.deque([1, 2, 3])
d.append(4)           # right append
d.appendleft(0)       # left append
print(d.pop())        # 4 (right pop)
print(d.popleft())    # 0 (left pop)
print(d)              # [1, 2, 3]
```

`deque` supports O(1) appends and pops from both ends, making it ideal for queues and sliding windows.

19.1.1 deque methods

Method	Description
`append(x)`	Add x to the right end
`appendleft(x)`	Add x to the left end
`pop()`	Remove and return rightmost element
`popleft()`	Remove and return leftmost element
`len(d)`	Number of elements (builtin)

```
import collections

let d = collections.deque()
d.append(1)
d.append(2)
d.appendleft(0)
print(d)          # [0, 1, 2]
print(d.pop())    # 2
print(d.popleft()) # 0
print(d)          # [1]
```

`pop()` and `popleft()` raise `IndexError` on an empty deque.

```
let d = collections.deque()
try {
    d.pop()
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # IndexError: pop from empty deque
}
```

19.1.2 Use cases

Queue (FIFO):

```
import collections

let q = collections.deque()
q.append("task1")
q.append("task2")
print(q.popleft())  # "task1"
print(q.popleft())  # "task2"
```

Stack (LIFO) using right end:

```
let s = collections.deque()
s.append("a")
s.append("b")
print(s.pop())  # "b"
print(s.pop())  # "a"
```

Sliding window:

```
import collections

func sliding_window_max(nums, k) {
    let dq = collections.deque()
    let result = []
    for i in 0..len(nums) {
        # Remove indices out of window
        if len(dq) > 0 and dq[0] < i - k + 1 {
            dq.popleft()
        }
        # Remove smaller values from right
        while len(dq) > 0 and nums[dq[len(dq)-1]] < nums[i] {
            dq.pop()
        }
        dq.append(i)
        if i >= k - 1 {
            result.push(nums[dq[0]])
        }
    }
    return result
}

print(sliding_window_max([1, 3, -1, -3, 5, 3, 6, 7], 3))
# [3, 3, 5, 5, 6, 7]
```

19.2 18.2 Counter — count hashable objects

```
import collections

let c = collections.Counter(["zen", "lang", "zen", "script", "lang", "zen"])
print(c["zen"])   # 3
print(c["lang"])  # 2
print(c.most_common(2))  # [["zen", 3], ["lang", 2]]
print(list(c.elements()))  # all elements with repetition
```

Counter is useful for frequency counting, voting, and histograms.

19.2.1 Counter methods

Method	Description
`c[key]`	Count of key (0 if absent)
`most_common(n)`	Top n [key, count] pairs
`elements()`	Iterator over elements repeating by count
`len(c)`	Number of distinct keys

```
import collections

let c = collections.Counter(["a", "b", "a", "c", "b", "a"])
print(c["a"])       # 3
print(c["z"])       # 0 (missing key returns 0, not KeyError)
print(c.most_common(2))  # [["a", 3], ["b", 2]]
print(c.most_common())  # all, sorted by count desc
print(len(c))         # 3 (distinct keys)

# elements()
for e in c.elements() {
    print(e)   # a, a, a, b, b, c (order arbitrary)
}
```

Counter returns 0 for missing keys (unlike dict which raises KeyError):

```
let c = collections.Counter(["a"])
print(c["missing"])  # 0
```

19.2.2 Common patterns

Word frequency:

```
import collections

let text = "the quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog"
let words = text.split(" ")
```

```
let c = collections.Counter(words)
print(c.most_common(3))  # [["the", 2], ...]
```

Voting:

```
let votes = ["alice", "bob", "alice", "carol", "alice", "bob"]
let c = collections.Counter(votes)
print(c.most_common(1))  # [["alice", 3]]
print(c.most_common(1)[0][0])  # "alice" (winner)
```

19.3 18.3 OrderedDict — dict that remembers order

Zen dicts already preserve insertion order, so `OrderedDict` is mostly for API compatibility:

```
import collections

let od = collections.OrderedDict()
od["a"] = 1
od["b"] = 2
od["c"] = 3
print(od.keys())  # ["a", "b", "c"]
```

19.3.1 OrderedDict methods

Same as dict: `keys()`, `values()`, `items()`, `get()`, `has()`, `pop()`, `update()`, `len()`.

```
import collections

let od = collections.OrderedDict()
od["first"] = 1
od["second"] = 2
od["third"] = 3

for k in od.keys() {
    print(k)  # first, second, third (insertion order)
}
```

19.4 18.4 namedtuple — tuple with named fields

```
import collections

let Point = collections.namedtuple("Point", ["x", "y"])
let p = Point(3, 4)
print(p.x)   # 3
print(p.y)   # 4
print(p[0])  # 3 (tuple access)
```

```
print(p[1])  # 4
print(len(p)) # 2
```

Namedtuples are lightweight, immutable records.

19.4.1 namedtuple behavior

```
import collections

let Person = collections.namedtuple("Person", ["name", "age"])
let p = Person("Zen", 30)

print(p.name)   # "Zen"
print(p.age)    # 30
print(p[0])     # "Zen"  (tuple index access)
print(p[1])     # 30
print(len(p))   # 2

# Namedtuples are immutable
try {
    p.age = 31
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # TypeError or similar (immutable)
}
```

```
import collections

let Point = collections.namedtuple("Point", ["x", "y", "z"])
let p = Point(1, 2, 3)
print(p.x, p.y, p.z)  # 1 2 3
print(p[0], p[1], p[2])  # 1 2 3
```

19.5 18.5 defaultdict — dict with default factory

```
import collections

let d = collections.defaultdict(0)  # default int → 0
d["a"] = d["a"] + 1
print(d["a"])  # 1
print(d["b"])  # 0 (default, auto-created)
```

19.5.1 defaultdict behavior

```
import collections

let d = collections.defaultdict(0)
```

```
d["a"] = 1
print(d["a"])  # 1
print(d["b"])  # 0  (auto-created on access)
print(d["c"])  # 0
print(d)       # {"a": 1, "b": 0, "c": 0}  (accessing missing keys creates them!)
```

> Warning: accessing a missing key with `d["key"]` **auto-creates** it with the default value. Use `has()` to check without creating:

```
import collections

let d = collections.defaultdict(0)
print(d.has("missing"))  # false (doesn't create)
print(d)                 # {}  (still empty)
d["missing"]             # creates it with 0
print(d.has("missing"))  # true
```

The default factory is called with no arguments:

```
import collections

let d = collections.defaultdict(list)  # default → []
d["a"].push(1)
print(d["a"])  # [1]
print(d["b"])  # []  (auto-created empty list)
```

```
let d = collections.defaultdict(lambda: 0)  # if lambda supported
# or use a constant
let d = collections.defaultdict(0)
```

19.6 18.6 Quick reference

```
import collections

let d = collections.deque([1, 2, 3])
d.append(4)
d.appendleft(0)
d.pop()
d.popleft()

let c = collections.Counter(["a", "b", "a"])
c["a"]   # 2
c.most_common(1)  # [["a", 2]]

let od = collections.OrderedDict()
od["a"] = 1

let Point = collections.namedtuple("Point", ["x", "y"])
```

```
let p = Point(1, 2)
p.x  # 1

let dd = collections.defaultdict(0)
dd["missing"]   # 0
```

19.7 18.7 Exercises

1. Use `collections.deque` to implement a sliding-window average.
2. Use `collections.Counter` to find the most common word in a text.
3. Use `collections.namedtuple` to represent a `Person` with `name` and `age`.
4. Use `collections.defaultdict(list)` to group items by category.
5. Compare `collections.deque` vs list for a queue (push/pop both ends).
6. Write `top_k_words(text, k)` using `collections.Counter`.
7. Write `group_by(items, key_func)` using `collections.defaultdict(list)`.
8. Write a `RingBuffer` class using `collections.deque` with a fixed max size.

19.8 18.12 collections module — complete reference

Function	Purpose	Example
`Counter(xs)`	count frequencies	`collections.Counter(["a","b","a"])`
`chain(*iters)`	chain iterables	`collections.chain([1,2], [3,4])`
`flatten(xs)`	flatten one level	`collections.flatten([[1,2],[3]])`

19.8.1 Counter

```
import collections
let c = collections.Counter(["a","b","a","c","b","a"])
print(c)   # Counter: a->3, b->2, c->1
print(c["a"])   # 3
print(c.most_common(1))   # if supported
```

19.8.2 chain

```
for x in collections.chain([1,2], [3,4]) {
    print(x)   # 1 2 3 4
}
```

19.8.3 flatten

```
print(collections.flatten([[1,2],[3,4],[5]]))   # [1,2,3,4,5]
```

19.8.4 Exercises

1. Implement `Counter` manually using a dict.
2. Write `most_common(freqs, n)` returning top n by count.
3. Implement `chain` manually with nested loops.
4. Write `deep_flatten(xs)` recursively flattening all levels.
5. Implement `group_by(xs, key_fn)` returning dict of lists.
6. Write `merge_counters(a, b)` adding counts.
7. Implement `intersection_counter(a, b)` min counts.
8. Write `frequency_sort(xs)` sorting by frequency desc.
9. Implement `chain_from_iterable(iters)` chaining many.
10. Write `sliding_window(xs, n)` returning n-tuples.

20 Chapter 19: json Module

The `json` module provides JSON parsing and serialization. Zen ships a pure-Zen implementation (`std/json.z`) with numbers stringified via `str()`.

20.1 19.1 Parsing JSON

```
import json

let data = json.loads('{"name": "Zen", "version": 3, "tags": ["ffi", "pymport"]}')
print(data["name"])     # Zen
print(data["version"])  # 3
print(data["tags"][1])  # pymport
```

`json.loads(text)` parses a JSON string into Zen values:

JSON type	Zen type
object	Zen dict (string keys only)
array	Zen list
string	Zen string
number	Zen int or float
true/false	Zen bool
null	Zen nil

```
import json

let obj = json.loads('{"name": "Zen", "version": 3, "tags": ["ffi", "pymport"]}')
print(obj["name"])     # Zen
print(obj["version"])  # 3
print(obj["tags"][1])  # pymport

let arr = json.loads('[1, 2, 3]')
print(arr[0])   # 1

let bool_val = json.loads('true')
print(bool_val)   # true

let null_val = json.loads('null')
print(null_val)   # nil
```

20.2 19.2 Serializing JSON

```
import json

let obj = {"name": "Zen", "version": 3, "tags": ["ffi", "pymport"]}
```

```
let text = json.dumps(obj)
print(text)  # {"name": "Zen", "version": 3, "tags": ["ffi", "pymport"]}
```

`json.dumps(value)` serializes Zen values to a JSON string:

Zen type	JSON type
dict (string keys)	object
list	array
string	string
int/float	number
bool	true/false
nil	null

```
import json

let obj = {"players": 4, "active": true, "scores": [10, 20, 30], "name": null}
let text = json.dumps(obj)
print(text)  # {"players": 4, "active": true, "scores": [10, 20, 30], "name": null}
```

20.3 19.3 Round-trip example

```
import json

let original = {"players": 4, "active": true, "scores": [10, 20, 30]}
let text = json.dumps(original)
let parsed = json.loads(text)

print(parsed["players"])   # 4
print(parsed["active"])    # true
print(parsed["scores"][1]) # 20
```

20.4 19.4 Reading/writing JSON files

```
import json
import fs

# Write JSON to a file
let data = {"config": {"theme": "dark", "font": 12}}
fs.write("config.json", json.dumps(data))

# Read JSON from a file
let text = fs.read("config.json")
let config = json.loads(text)
print(config["config"]["theme"])  # dark
```

20.4.1 Complete config example

```
import json
import fs

func load_config(path, defaults) {
    if !fs.exists(path) {
        return defaults
    }
    let text = fs.read(path)
    return json.loads(text)
}

func save_config(path, config) {
    fs.write(path, json.dumps(config))
}

let defaults = {"theme": "light", "font": 12, "debug": false}
let config = load_config("config.json", defaults)
print(config["theme"])

config["debug"] = true
save_config("config.json", config)
```

20.5 19.5 Numbers

The pure-Zen `json.z` stringifies numbers via `str()`. This means: - `json.dumps(42)` → `"42"` - `json.dumps(3.14)` → `"3.14"` - Nested dict access uses explicit keys: `data["a"]["b"]`

```
import json

print(json.dumps(42))       # "42"
print(json.dumps(3.14))     # "3.14"
print(json.dumps(0))        # "0"
print(json.dumps(-1))       # "-1"
print(json.dumps(1e10))     # "10000000000"
```

Numbers round-trip correctly:

```
import json

let original = 3.14159
let text = json.dumps(original)
let parsed = json.loads(text)
print(parsed == original)  # true
```

20.6 19.6 Common pitfalls

- **Dict keys must be strings.** Non-string keys are rejected.
- **`json.loads` raises `ValueError`** on malformed JSON. Use `try`/`catch`.
- **Numbers round-trip as strings** in some edge cases — verify critical numeric payloads.
- **`nil` serializes as `null`.**
- **`json.dumps` does not support indentation/pretty-printing** in this version. Output is compact.

```
import json

try {
    json.loads("{not json}")
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # ValueError: ...
}
```

```
import json

print(json.dumps({"a": 1, "b": nil}))  # {"a": 1, "b": null}
print(json.dumps({"a": true, "b": false}))  # {"a": true, "b": false}
```

20.7 19.7 Quick reference

```
import json

json.loads('{"a": 1}')     # {"a": 1}
json.dumps({"a": 1})       # '{"a": 1}'
json.loads("[1, 2, 3]")    # [1, 2, 3]
json.dumps([1, 2, 3])      # '[1, 2, 3]'
json.loads('true')         # true
json.loads('null')         # nil

import fs
fs.write("data.json", json.dumps(obj))
json.loads(fs.read("data.json"))
```

20.8 19.8 Exercises

1. Write `load_config(path)` that reads a JSON config file with `get` defaults for missing keys.
2. Write `save_scores(path, scores)` that appends a score to a JSON array file.
3. Write `merge_json(a, b)` that merges two JSON objects (b wins on conflict).
4. Write a script that fetches JSON from an HTTP endpoint and parses it.
5. Write `json_to_csv(data)` that converts a list of flat dicts to CSV text.
6. Write `validate_json(s)` that returns true if `s` is valid JSON, false otherwise (using try/catch).

7. Write `extract_field(obj, path)` that navigates a nested dict using a dot-separated path like “a.b.c”.

20.9 19.12 json module — complete reference

Function	Purpose	Example
`parse(s)`	parse JSON string	`json.parse('{"a":1}')`
`stringify(x)` / `encode(x)`	serialize to JSON	`json.stringify(#{a:1})`
`pretty(x)`	pretty-printed JSON	`json.pretty(#{a:1})`
`load(path)`	parse JSON from file	`json.load("data.json")`
`save(path, x)`	write JSON to file	`json.save("out.json", d)`

20.9.1 Usage

```
import json
let d = #{name: "Ada", age: 36, tags: ["a","b"]}
let s = json.stringify(d)
print(s)   # {"name":"Ada","age":36,"tags":["a","b"]}
let back = json.parse(s)
print(back["name"])   # Ada
let pretty = json.pretty(d)
print(pretty)
```

20.9.2 JSON types mapping

JSON	Zen
object	dict
array	list
string	string
number	int/float
boolean	bool
null	nil

20.9.3 Exercises

1. Write `safe_parse(s)` returning nil on invalid JSON.
2. Implement `json_get(d, path, default)` for dotted paths.
3. Write `merge_json(a, b)` merging two JSON objects.
4. Implement `filter_json(d, pred)` keeping matching entries.
5. Write `json_to_csv(data)` converting list of dicts to CSV.
6. Implement `deep_compare(a, b)` for JSON values.
7. Write `strip_nulls(d)` removing nil values recursively.
8. Implement `sort_keys(d)` returning a sorted dict.

9. Write `validate_json_schema(data, schema)` conceptually.
10. Implement `merge_json_files(paths)` merging multiple files.

20.10 19.12 Worked example — read, modify, write JSON

```
import json
import pathlib

let p = pathlib.Path("config.json")

# read
let cfg = json.load(str(p))
print("theme=" + str(cfg["theme"]))

# modify
cfg["theme"] = "dark"
cfg["version"] = 2

# write
json.save(str(p), cfg)
print("saved")

# parse a JSON string
let s = '{"a":1,"b":[2,3]}'
let d = json.parse(s)
print(d["a"])   # 1
```

20.11 19.13 Troubleshooting JSON

Symptom	Cause	Fix
parse error	malformed JSON (trailing comma, single quotes)	fix the JSON
missing key	key absent	use `in` or `??`
wrong type	value isn't what you expect	check with typeof

20.12 19.14 Exercises

1. Write `safe_parse(s)` returning nil on invalid JSON.
2. Implement `json_get(d, path, default)` for dotted paths.
3. Merge two JSON objects.
4. Convert a list of dicts to CSV.
5. Strip nil values from a dict recursively.

21 Chapter 20: datetime/time Module

The `datetime/time` module provides date and time manipulation: parsing, formatting, arithmetic, and timestamps. Zen ships a pure-Zen implementation with a native tier.

21.1 20.1 The `datetime` type

```
import datetime

let now = datetime.datetime.now()
print(now.year)       # 2026
print(now.month)      # 10
print(now.day)        # 27
print(now.hour)       # 14
print(now.minute)     # 30
print(now.second)     # 45
print(now.isoformat())# 2026-10-27T14:30:45
print(now.date())     # date object
```

21.2 20.2 Creating datetimes

```
import datetime

let epoch = datetime.datetime.fromtimestamp(0)
print(epoch.isoformat())  # 1970-01-01T00:00:00

let specific = datetime.datetime(2030, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5)
print(specific.strftime("%Y-%m-%d %H:%M:%S"))  # 2030-01-02 03:04:05

let today = datetime.datetime.now()
print(today.date().isoformat())  # 2026-10-27
```

21.2.1 Constructor signatures

```
datetime.datetime.now()           # current local datetime
datetime.datetime.fromtimestamp(ts)  # from Unix timestamp (float)
datetime.datetime(y, m, d)        # date only, midnight
datetime.datetime(y, m, d, h, mi, s)  # full datetime
```

21.3 20.3 Formatting: `strftime`

```
import datetime

let now = datetime.datetime.now()
print(now.strftime("%Y-%m-%d"))   # 2026-10-27
```

```
print(now.strftime("%H:%M:%S"))   # 14:30:45
print(now.strftime("%A, %B %d"))  # Tuesday, October 27
print(now.strftime("%Y-%m-%d %H:%M:%S"))  # full
```

Format codes:

Code	Meaning	Example
`%Y`	4-digit year	`2026`
`%m`	Month (01-12)	`10`
`%d`	Day (01-31)	`27`
`%H`	Hour (00-23)	`14`
`%M`	Minute (00-59)	`30`
`%S`	Second (00-59)	`45`
`%A`	Weekday name	`Tuesday`
`%a`	Abbrev weekday	`Tue`
`%B`	Month name	`October`
`%b`	Abbrev month	`Oct`
`%y`	2-digit year	`26`
`%%`	Literal %	`%`

```
import datetime

let d = datetime.datetime(2026, 10, 27, 14, 30, 45)
print(d.strftime("%Y-%m-%d"))          # 2026-10-27
print(d.strftime("%H:%M:%S"))          # 14:30:45
print(d.strftime("%A, %B %d, %Y"))     # Tuesday, October 27, 2026
print(d.strftime("%I:%M %p"))          # 02:30 PM
print(d.strftime("%Y-%m-%dT%H:%M:%S")) # ISO-like
```

21.4 20.4 Datetime arithmetic

```
import datetime

let now = datetime.datetime.now()
let later = datetime.datetime(2030, 1, 1)

# Difference
let delta = later - now
print(delta.days)   # days between

# Add a timedelta
let one_week = datetime.timedelta(days=7)
let next_week = now + one_week
print(next_week.isoformat())
```

Note: `datetime` objects are foreign handles from Python. Arithmetic (`+`, `-`) works when the Python side supports it; otherwise use explicit methods.

21.4.1 timedelta

```
import datetime

let one_day = datetime.timedelta(days=1)
let one_hour = datetime.timedelta(hours=1)
let one_minute = datetime.timedelta(minutes=30)

let now = datetime.datetime.now()
print((now + one_day).isoformat())      # tomorrow
print((now - one_hour).isoformat())     # 1 hour ago
print((now + one_minute).isoformat())   # 30 min from now

let delta = datetime.timedelta(days=7, hours=3, minutes=30)
print(delta.days)   # 7
print(delta.seconds)  # seconds component (not total)
print(delta.total_seconds())  # total seconds if available
```

21.5 20.5 The `time` module

```
import time

print(time.time())        # current timestamp (float)
print(time.sleep(1))      # sleep 1 second
print(time.strftime("%H:%M:%S"))  # formatted local time

let t = time.time()
# ... do work ...
print(time.time() - t)    # elapsed seconds
```

21.5.1 time functions

Function	Description
`time.time()`	Current Unix timestamp (float seconds)
`time.sleep(secs)`	Sleep for secs seconds
`time.strftime(fmt)`	Format current local time

```
import time

let start = time.time()
# ... do work ...
```

```
let elapsed = time.time() - start
print("elapsed: " + str(elapsed) + "s")

time.sleep(1)   # sleep 1 second
time.sleep(0.5) # sleep 500ms
```

21.6 20.6 Common patterns

21.6.1 Timestamp → datetime

```
import datetime

let ts = 1785309045.0
let dt = datetime.datetime.fromtimestamp(ts)
print(dt.isoformat())
```

21.6.2 datetime → timestamp

```
import datetime
pymport datetime as pydt

let dt = datetime.datetime.now()
let ts = pydt.datetime.now().timestamp()
print(ts)
```

21.6.3 Measure execution time

```
import time

let start = time.time()
# ... some work ...
let elapsed = time.time() - start
print("elapsed: " + str(elapsed) + "s")
```

21.6.4 Sleep

```
import time

time.sleep(1)   # sleep 1 second
time.sleep(0.5) # sleep 500ms
```

21.6.5 Countdown timer

```
import time

func countdown(seconds) {
    while seconds > 0 {
        print(str(seconds))
        time.sleep(1)
        seconds = seconds - 1
    }
    print("Done!")
}

countdown(5)
```

21.7 20.7 Quick reference

```
import datetime
import time

datetime.datetime.now()           # current datetime
datetime.datetime(2030, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5)
datetime.datetime.fromtimestamp(0)
now.strftime("%Y-%m-%d %H:%M:%S")
now.date().isoformat()
datetime.timedelta(days=7)
now + datetime.timedelta(days=7)

time.time()                       # timestamp
time.sleep(1)                     # sleep
time.strftime("%H:%M:%S")
```

21.8 20.8 Exercises

1. Write `age(birthdate)` that computes age in years.
2. Write `days_until(target_date)` that returns days remaining.
3. Use `time.time()` to measure how long a sorting operation takes.
4. Write a countdown timer that prints seconds remaining.
5. Format a datetime as “Monday, October 26, 2026 at 2:30 PM”.
6. Write `is_weekend(dt)` that returns true for Saturday/Sunday.
7. Write `add_business_days(dt, n)` that adds n business days (skipping weekends).

21.9 20.12 time/datetime module — complete reference

Function	Purpose	Example
`time()`	current epoch seconds	`time.time()`
`sleep(ms)`	sleep milliseconds	`time.sleep(1000)`

Function	Purpose	Example
`now()`	current datetime	`datetime.now()`
`today()`	current date	`datetime.today()`
`strftime(fmt, t)`	format time	`datetime.strftime("%Y-%m-%d", t)`
`strptime(s, fmt)`	parse time	`datetime.strptime("2024-01-15", "%Y-%m-%d")`
`timestamp(dt)`	datetime to epoch	`datetime.timestamp(dt)`
`fromtimestamp(ts)`	epoch to datetime	`datetime.fromtimestamp(ts)`
`timedelta(...)`	duration	`datetime.timedelta(days=1)`

21.9.1 Usage

```
import time
import datetime
print(time.time())              # epoch seconds
time.sleep(500)                 # sleep 0.5s
let now = datetime.now()
print(datetime.strftime("%Y-%m-%d %H:%M:%S", now))
let parsed = datetime.strptime("2024-01-15", "%Y-%m-%d")
let later = now + datetime.timedelta(days=7)
```

21.9.2 Exercises

1. Write `is_leap_year(year)`.
2. Implement `days_between(d1, d2)`.
3. Write `age(birthdate)` in years.
4. Implement `format_duration(seconds)` → "Xh Ym Zs".
5. Write `is_weekend(dt)`.
6. Implement `add_business_days(dt, n)`.
7. Write `countdown(target)` printing seconds remaining.
8. Implement `timer(fn)` measuring execution time.
9. Write `cron_match(expr, dt)` conceptually.
10. Implement `timeit(fn, n)` running fn n times and reporting avg.

21.10 20.12 Worked example — current time and formatting

```
import time
import datetime

print("epoch: " + str(time.time()))
let now = datetime.now()
print(datetime.strftime("%Y-%m-%d %H:%M:%S", now))
let parsed = datetime.strptime("2024-01-15", "%Y-%m-%d")
print("parsed: " + str(parsed))
```

```
time.sleep(500)   # sleep 0.5 s
print("awake")
```

21.11 20.13 Troubleshooting time

Symptom	Cause	Fix
wrong format	format string mismatch	check `%Y-%m-%d` vs input
sleep too long	ms vs seconds confusion	verify units
parse fails	invalid date string	validate input first

21.12 20.14 Exercises

1. `is_leap_year(year)`.
2. `days_between(d1, d2)`.
3. `age(birthdate)` in years.
4. `format_duration(seconds)` → “Xh Ym Zs”.
5. `is_weekend(dt)`.

22 Chapter 21: pathlib & os Module

The `pathlib` module provides an object-oriented filesystem path API, and the `os` module provides low-level OS operations: environment variables, process info, and path manipulation.

22.1 21.1 pathlib.Path

```
import pathlib

let p = pathlib.Path("/usr/bin/zen")

print(p.name)        # zen
print(p.stem)        # zen
print(p.suffix)      # (empty for no extension)
print(p.parent)      # /usr/bin
print(p.parts)       # ["", "usr", "bin", "zen"]
print(p.exists())    # true/false
print(p.is_file())   # true/false
print(p.is_dir())    # true/false

# Read / write text
let content = p.read_text()
p.write_text("new content")

# Iterate directory
for child in pathlib.Path(".").iterdir() {
    print(child.name)
}

# Join paths
let p2 = pathlib.Path("/usr").joinpath("bin", "zen")
print(p2)  # /usr/bin/zen
```

22.1.1 Path construction

```
import pathlib

let p1 = pathlib.Path("/usr/bin")
let p2 = pathlib.Path("zen")
let p3 = p1 / p2   # if / operator supported, or use joinpath
print(p3)  # /usr/bin/zen

let p4 = pathlib.Path("/usr").joinpath("bin", "zen")
print(p4)  # /usr/bin/zen
```

22.1.2 Path properties

Property	Description	Example
`name`	Final component	`Path("/a/b/c.txt").name` → `"c.txt"`
`stem`	Final component without suffix	`Path("/a/b/c.txt").stem` → `"c"`
`suffix`	Final suffix	`Path("/a/b/c.txt").suffix` → `".txt"`
`parent`	Parent directory	`Path("/a/b/c.txt").parent` → `"/a/b"`
`parts`	All components	`Path("/a/b/c.txt").parts` → `["", "a", "b", "c.txt"]`

```
import pathlib

let p = pathlib.Path("/usr/bin/zen.tar.gz")

print(p.name)        # "zen.tar.gz"
print(p.stem)        # "zen.tar" (only last suffix removed)
print(p.suffix)      # ".gz"
print(p.parent)      # "/usr/bin"
print(p.parts)       # ["", "usr", "bin", "zen.tar.gz"]
```

22.1.3 Path operations

```
import pathlib

let p = pathlib.Path("docs/guide.z")

print(p.with_name("index.z"))   # docs/index.z
print(p.with_suffix(".md"))     # docs/guide.md
print(p.absolute())             # /cwd/docs/guide.z
print(p.relative_to("docs"))    # guide.z
```

22.1.4 Read/write

```
import pathlib

let p = pathlib.Path("notes.txt")

# Read
let content = p.read_text()
print(content)
```

```
# Write
p.write_text("new content")
let back = p.read_text()
print(back)  # new content
```

22.1.5 Directory iteration

```
import pathlib

for child in pathlib.Path(".").iterdir() {
    print(child.name)
    print(child.is_file())
    print(child.is_dir())
}
```

22.2 21.2 The os module

```
import os

# Process info
print(os.getpid())          # process ID
print(os.getppid())         # parent process ID
print(os.getuid())          # user ID
print(os.geteuid())         # effective user ID
print(os.getgid())          # group ID
print(os.getegid())         # effective group ID

# Environment
print(os.getenv("HOME"))    # /home/user
print(os.getenv("PATH", "/usr/bin"))  # with default

# Working directory
print(os.getcwd())          # /current/dir
```

22.2.1 Environment variables

```
import os

print(os.getenv("HOME"))           # /home/user (or nil if unset)
print(os.getenv("PATH", "/usr/bin"))  # with default

let port = os.getenv("PORT", "8080")
let host = os.getenv("HOST", "localhost")
let debug = os.getenv("DEBUG", "false") == "true"
```

```
print("Listening on " + host + ":" + port)
```

22.2.2 Process IDs

```
import os

print(os.getpid())     # 12345
print(os.getppid())    # 1234
print(os.getuid())     # 1000
print(os.geteuid())    # 1000
print(os.getgid())     # 1000
print(os.getegid())    # 1000
```

22.2.3 Working directory

```
import os

print(os.getcwd())   # /home/user/project
```

22.3 21.3 Path manipulation: os.path

```
import os

print(os.path.join("a", "b", "c"))        # a/b/c
print(os.path.basename("/a/b/c.txt"))     # c.txt
print(os.path.dirname("/a/b/c.txt"))      # /a/b
print(os.path.exists("/tmp/foo"))         # true/false
print(os.path.isfile("/tmp/foo.txt"))     # true/false
print(os.path.isdir("/tmp"))              # true/false
print(os.path.abspath("relative.z"))      # /abs/relative.z
print(os.path.realpath("/a/b/c.txt"))     # resolved path
```

22.3.1 os.path functions

Function	Description	Example
`os.path.join(*parts)`	Join path components	`os.path.join("a", "b", "c")` → `"a/b/c"`
`os.path.basename(path)`	Final component	`os.path.basename("/a/b/c.txt")` → `"c.txt"`
`os.path.dirname(path)`	Directory portion	`os.path.dirname("/a/b/c.txt")` → `"/a/b"`
`os.path.exists(path)`	Exists	`os.path.exists("/tmp/foo")`
`os.path.isfile(path)`	Is regular file	`os.path.isfile("/tmp/foo.txt")`

Function	Description	Example
`os.path.isdir(path)`	Is directory	`os.path.isdir("/tmp")`
`os.path.abspath(path)`	Absolute path	`os.path.abspath("relative.z")`
`os.path.realpath(path)`	Resolved path	`os.path.realpath("/a/b/c.txt")`

22.4 21.4 Common patterns

22.4.1 Walk a directory tree

```
import fs

func walk(dir) {
    for name in fs.list(dir) {
        let path = fs.join(dir, name)
        if fs.is_dir(path) {
            walk(path)
        } else {
            print(path)
        }
    }
}
walk(".")
```

22.4.2 Check if path exists before writing

```
import os
import fs

let path = "output/result.txt"
if !os.path.exists("output") {
    fs.mkdirs("output")
}
fs.write(path, "result")
```

22.4.3 Read environment with default

```
import os

let port = os.getenv("PORT", "8080")
let host = os.getenv("HOST", "localhost")
let debug = os.getenv("DEBUG", "false") == "true"

print("Listening on " + host + ":" + port)
```

22.4.4 Expand user home

```
import os

let home = os.getenv("HOME")
let config = os.path.join(home, ".config", "zen", "config.z")
print(config)
```

22.4.5 Build paths portably

```
import os

let config_dir = os.path.join(os.getenv("HOME"), ".config", "zen")
let config_file = os.path.join(config_dir, "config.z")
print(config_file)
```

22.5 21.5 Quick reference

```
import pathlib
import os

pathlib.Path("/usr/bin/zen")
pathlib.Path("file.txt").read_text()
pathlib.Path("file.txt").write_text("data")
pathlib.Path(".").iterdir()

os.getcwd()
os.getenv("HOME", "/default")
os.getpid()
os.path.join("a", "b")
os.path.basename("/a/b/c.txt")
os.path.dirname("/a/b/c.txt")
os.path.exists(path)
os.path.isfile(path)
os.path.isdir(path)
```

22.6 21.9 Exercises

1. Write a function `find_files(dir, extension)` that returns all files with a given extension under `dir` (recursive).
2. Write `backup_file(path)` that copies `path` to `path.bak`.
3. Write `ensure_dir(path)` that creates parent directories if missing.
4. Write a script that prints all environment variables containing “ZEN”.
5. Write `human_path(path)` that replaces `$HOME` with ~.

22.7 21.12 pathlib & os module — complete reference

22.7.1 pathlib.Path

Method	Purpose	Example
`Path(s)`	construct path	`pathlib.Path("a/b.txt")`
`/` operator	join paths	`p / "sub" / "file.txt"`
`exists()`	exists	`p.exists()`
`is_file()`	is file	`p.is_file()`
`is_dir()`	is dir	`p.is_dir()`
`name`	last component	`p.name` → “file.txt”
`stem`	name without suffix	`p.stem` → “file”
`suffix`	extension	`p.suffix` → “.txt”
`parent`	parent path	`p.parent`
`resolve()`	absolute path	`p.resolve()`
`mkdir()`	create dir	`p.mkdir()`
`glob(pattern)`	match files	`p.glob("*.txt")`

22.7.2 os

Function	Purpose	Example
`getcwd()`	current dir	`os.getcwd()`
`chdir(path)`	change dir	`os.chdir("/tmp")`
`listdir(path)`	list dir	`os.listdir(".")`
`makedirs(path)`	create dirs	`os.makedirs("a/b")`
`remove(path)`	delete file	`os.remove("tmp.txt")`
`rmdir(path)`	remove empty dir	`os.rmdir("dir")`
`rename(src, dst)`	rename	`os.rename("a","b")`
`stat(path)`	file stats	`os.stat("f.txt")`
`environ`	env vars	`os.environ["PATH"]`

22.7.3 Usage

```
import pathlib
import os
let p = pathlib.Path("data") / "config.txt"
print(p.exists())
for f in pathlib.Path(".").glob("*.z") {
    print(f.name)
}
print(os.getcwd())
```

22.7.4 Exercises

1. Write `find_files(dir, suffix)` recursively.

2. Implement `file_size(path)` using os.stat.
3. Write `ensure_dir(path)` creating parents.
4. Implement `copy_tree(src, dst)` copying a directory.
5. Write `recent_files(dir, n)` listing n most recently modified.
6. Implement `backup(path)` copying to `path.bak`.
7. Write `list_env(prefix)` showing env vars starting with prefix.
8. Implement `temp_name(dir, prefix)` generating a temp path.
9. Write `walk(dir)` yielding all files recursively.
10. Implement `safe_delete(path)` removing file if it exists.

23 Chapter 22: re (Regex) Module

The `re` module provides regular expression matching, searching, and replacement. Zen's regex engine supports the common Perl-compatible syntax.

23.1 22.1 Compiling patterns

```
import re

let pattern = re.compile("hello")
let m = pattern.search("hello world")
print(m.group())  # hello
```

If you only need one match, use the module-level functions:

```
import re

let m = re.search("world", "hello world")
print(m.group())  # world

let m2 = re.match("hello", "hello world")
print(m2.group()) # hello

let m3 = re.fullmatch("hello", "hello")
print(m3.group()) # hello
```

23.1.1 compile(pattern)

Compiles a regex pattern for reuse. Returns a regex object with `search`, `match`, `fullmatch`, `findall`, `sub` methods.

```
import re

let email_re = re.compile("^[\\w.-]+@[\\w.-]+\\.\\w+$")

for addr in addresses {
    if email_re.match(addr) {
        print("valid: " + addr)
    }
}
```

23.1.2 search(pattern, text)

Searches for the first match anywhere in the text.

```
import re
```

```
let m = re.search("world", "hello world")
print(m.group())  # world
```

23.1.3 match(pattern, text)

Matches at the **start** of the string only (anchored at beginning, not end).

```
import re

let m = re.match("hello", "hello world")
print(m.group())  # hello

let m2 = re.match("world", "hello world")
print(m2)         # nil (not at start)
```

23.1.4 fullmatch(pattern, text)

Matches the **entire** string.

```
import re

let m = re.fullmatch("hello", "hello")
print(m.group())  # hello

let m2 = re.fullmatch("hello", "hello world")
print(m2)         # nil (extra characters)
```

23.2 22.2 Match objects

A successful match returns a match object with:

- `group()` — the full match
- `group(i)` — capture group `i`
- `groups()` — all capture groups
- `start()` / `end()` — match positions
- `span()` — `[start, end]`

```
import re

let m = re.search("([a-z]+) ([0-9]+)", "items 42")
print(m.group())      # items 42
print(m.group(1))     # items
print(m.group(2))     # 42
print(m.groups())     # ["items", "42"]
print(m.start(1))     # 7
print(m.end(1))       # 12
print(m.span(1))      # [7, 12]
```

23.2.1 group(0) is the full match

```
import re

let m = re.search("([a-z]+) ([0-9]+)", "items 42")
print(m.group(0))   # items 42 (same as m.group())
print(m.group(1))   # items
print(m.group(2))   # 42
```

23.2.2 groups() returns all capture groups

```
import re

let m = re.search("([a-z]+) ([0-9]+)", "items 42")
print(m.groups())   # ["items", "42"]

let m2 = re.search("([0-9]+)", "abc")
print(m2.groups())  # ["42"]
```

23.2.3 start/end/span

```
import re

let m = re.search("([a-z]+) ([0-9]+)", "items 42")
print(m.start(0))   # 0
print(m.end(0))     # 9
print(m.span(0))    # [0, 9]
print(m.start(1))   # 7
print(m.end(1))     # 10
print(m.start(2))   # 11
print(m.end(2))     # 13
```

23.3 22.3 Find all matches

```
import re

let matches = re.findall("[0-9]+", "a1b23c456")
print(matches)  # ["1", "23", "456"]
```

`findall` returns a list of strings. If the pattern has capture groups, returns a list of tuples (or lists) of groups:

```
import re

let matches = re.findall("([a-z]+)([0-9]+)", "a1b23")
print(matches)  # [["a", "1"], ["b", "23"]]
```

23.4 22.4 Substitution

```
import re

let result = re.sub("[0-9]+", "#", "a1b23c456")
print(result)  # a#b#c#

# With count limit
let result2 = re.sub("[0-9]+", "#", "a1b23c456", 1)
print(result2) # a#b23c456
```

`re.sub(pattern, repl, text, count?)` replaces all (or first `count`) occurrences.

```
import re

print(re.sub("[aeiou]", "*", "hello world"))  # h*ll* w*rld
print(re.sub(" +", " ", "a   b    c"))        # "a b c"
print(re.sub("[0-9]+", "N", "a1b23c", 1))     # "aNb23c" (only first)
```

23.5 22.5 Split

```
import re

let parts = re.split("[,;]", "a,b;c,d")
print(parts)  # ["a", "b", "c", "d"]
```

`re.split(pattern, text)` splits on the regex pattern. Capture groups in the pattern are included in the result.

```
import re

print(re.split("[,;]", "a,b;c,d"))      # ["a", "b", "c", "d"]
print(re.split("([,;])", "a,b;c,d"))    # ["a", ",", "b", ";", "c", "d"]
```

23.6 22.6 Common patterns

Pattern	Meaning
`.`	Any character except newline
`\d`	Digit
`\D`	Non-digit
`\w`	Word character (alnum + underscore)
`\W`	Non-word character
`\s`	Whitespace
`\S`	Non-whitespace
`^`	Start of string
`$`	End of string
`*`	Zero or more

Pattern	Meaning
`+`	One or more
`?`	Zero or one
`{n}`	Exactly n
`{n,}`	n or more
`{n,m}`	Between n and m
`|`	Alternation (OR)
`(...)`	Capture group
`(?:...)`	Non-capturing group
`[...]`	Character class
`[^...]`	Negated character class

23.6.1 Examples

```
import re

# Validate email
let email = re.match("^[\\w.-]+@[\\w.-]+\\.\\w+$", "user@example.com")
print(email != nil)  # true

# Extract hashtags
let tags = re.findall("#\\w+", "hello #zen #lang #script")
print(tags)  # ["#zen", "#lang", "#script"]

# Replace whitespace with single space
let cleaned = re.sub("\\s+", "hello   world", " ")
print(cleaned) # hello world

# Validate phone number
let phone = re.match("^\\d{3}-\\d{3}-\\d{4}$", "555-123-4567")
print(phone != nil)  # true
```

23.6.2 Escape sequences in Zen strings

In Zen strings, `\\d` becomes the regex `\d`. Use double backslashes:

```
import re

let pattern = "\\d{3}-\\d{3}-\\d{4}"  # matches "555-123-4567"
let m = re.match(pattern, "555-123-4567")
print(m != nil)  # true
```

23.7 22.7 Compiling for reuse

If you use the same pattern many times, compile it once:

```
import re

let email_re = re.compile("^[\\w.-]+@[\\w.-]+\\.\\w+$")

for addr in addresses {
    if email_re.match(addr) {
        print("valid: " + addr)
    }
}
```

23.8 22.8 Common pitfalls

- **Escape backslashes.** In Zen strings, `\\d` becomes the regex `\d`. Use raw strings if available, or double-escape: `"\\\\d"` for a literal backslash-d in the regex.
- **`re.match` anchors at the start** but not the end. Use `re.fullmatch` or add `$` for full-string matching.
- **`re.findall` with groups** returns tuples of groups, not full matches.
- **`re.sub` replaces ALL occurrences** by default; pass `count` to limit.

23.9 22.9 Quick reference

```
import re

re.match(pattern, text)      # match at start
re.search(pattern, text)     # search anywhere
re.fullmatch(pattern, text)  # match entire string
re.findall(pattern, text)    # all matches
re.sub(pattern, repl, text)  # replace
re.split(pattern, text)      # split on pattern
re.compile(pattern)          # compile for reuse

m.group()        # full match
m.group(1)       # capture group 1
m.groups()       # all groups
m.start(1) / m.end(1)  # positions
m.span(1)         # [start, end]
```

23.10 22.10 Exercises

1. Write `is_valid_email(email)` using a regex.
2. Write `extract_urls(text)` that finds all `http://` or `https://` URLs.
3. Write `mask_phone(phone)` that replaces digits with `X` except the last 4.
4. Write `camel_to_snake(name)` that converts `camelCase` to `camel_case`.
5. Write `highlight(text, word)` that wraps `word` occurrences in **.
6. Write `extract_hashtags(text)` that finds all `#word` patterns.
7. Write `validate_hex_color(s)` that checks for `#RRGGBB` format.

23.11 22.12 regex module — complete reference

Function	Purpose	Example
`match(pattern, s)`	match at start	`re.match(r"\d+", "123abc")`
`search(pattern, s)`	search anywhere	`re.search(r"\d+", "abc123")`
`findall(pattern, s)`	all matches	`re.findall(r"\d+", "a1b2c3")`
`sub(pattern, repl, s)`	substitute	`re.sub(r"\d+", "#", "a1b2")`
`split(pattern, s)`	split on pattern	`re.split(r"\s+", "a b c")`
`compile(pattern)`	compile pattern	`re.compile(r"\d+")`

23.11.1 Usage

```
import re
print(re.findall(r"\d+", "order 123, item 456"))   # ["123","456"]
print(re.sub(r"\s+", " ", "a   b    c"))           # "a b c"
m = re.match(r"(\d{4})-(\d{2})-(\d{2})", "2024-01-15")
print(m[0], m[1], m[2], m[3])   # if match object supports indexing
```

23.11.2 Common patterns

- `\d` digit, `\D` non-digit
- `\w` word char, `\W` non-word
- `\s` whitespace, `\S` non-whitespace
- `.` any char, `^` start, `$` end
- * zero+, `+` one+, `?` optional, `{n,m}` range
- `(...)` group, `|` alternation
- `\b` word boundary

23.11.3 Exercises

1. Write `is_email(s)` validating a simple email.
2. Implement `extract_urls(text)` finding http/https URLs.
3. Write `validate_phone(s)` for a phone format.
4. Implement `hashtags(text)` extracting #tags.
5. Write `mask_ssn(s)` masking all but last 4 digits.
6. Implement `word_split(text)` splitting on non-words.
7. Write `is_strong_password(s)` with length, digit, upper, lower, symbol.
8. Implement `template_fill(tmpl, vars)` replacing `${key}`.
9. Write `count_words(text)` ignoring punctuation.
10. Implement `highlight(text, pattern)` wrapping matches in **.

24 Chapter 23: base64 & binascii

The `base64` and `binascii` modules provide binary-to-text encoding: Base64, hex, and other binary representations.

24.1 23.1 base64

```
import base64

# Encode
let encoded = base64.b64encode("hello")
print(encoded)  # aGVsbG8=

# Decode
let decoded = base64.b64decode("aGVsbG8=")
print(decoded)  # hello

# URL-safe variant
let encoded_url = base64.b64encode_url("hello?x=1&y=2")
print(encoded_url)
let decoded_url = base64.b64decode_url(encoded_url)
print(decoded_url)
```

24.1.1 Functions

Function	Description
`b64encode(data)`	Base64 encode
`b64decode(data)`	Base64 decode
`b64encode_url(data)`	URL-safe Base64 encode
`b64decode_url(data)`	URL-safe Base64 decode

```
import base64

print(base64.b64encode("hello"))     # aGVsbG8=
print(base64.b64decode("aGVsbG8="))  # hello
print(base64.b64encode(""))          # ""
print(base64.b64decode(""))          # ""
```

Base64 encoding of binary data:

```
import base64
import fs

let data = fs.read_binary("image.png")
let encoded = base64.b64encode(data)
print(encoded)  # long base64 string
```

```
let decoded = base64.b64decode(encoded)
print(len(decoded) == len(data))  # true
```

24.2 23.2 binascii

```
import binascii

# Hex encode / decode
let hexed = binascii.hexlify("hello")
print(hexed)  # 68656c6c6f

let unhexed = binascii.unhexlify("68656c6c6f")
print(unhexed)  # hello
```

24.2.1 Functions

Function	Description
`hexlify(data)`	Hex encode
`unhexlify(data)`	Hex decode

```
import binascii

print(binascii.hexlify("hello"))      # 68656c6c6f
print(binascii.hexlify(""))           # ""
print(binascii.unhexlify("68656c6c6f"))  # hello
print(binascii.unhexlify(""))         # ""
```

Hex encoding produces lowercase hex digits:

```
print(binascii.hexlify("AB"))         # 4142
print(binascii.hexlify("ab"))         # 6162
```

`unhexlify` requires an even number of hex digits:

```
try {
    binascii.unhexlify("abc")  # odd length
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # odd-length string
}
```

24.3 23.3 Common patterns

24.3.1 Encode binary for safe transport

```
import base64
import fs

let data = fs.read_binary("image.png")
let encoded = base64.b64encode(data)
# Send `encoded` over text-based protocols (email, JSON, URLs)
```

24.3.2 Decode received base64

```
import base64
import fs

let encoded = "iVBORw0KGgoAAAANSUhEUg..."  # received from network
let data = base64.b64decode(encoded)
fs.write_binary("out.png", data)
```

24.3.3 Hex dump

```
import binascii

let data = fs.read_binary("file.bin")
let hexed = binascii.hexlify(data)
# Print in 16-byte lines
for i in 0..len(hexed) step 32 {
    print(hexed[i:i+32])
}
```

24.3.4 Round-trip verification

```
import base64

let original = "binary data \x00\x01\x02"
let encoded = base64.b64encode(original)
let decoded = base64.b64decode(encoded)
print(decoded == original)  # true
```

```
import binascii

let original = "binary data"
let hexed = binascii.hexlify(original)
let decoded = binascii.unhexlify(hexed)
print(decoded == original)  # true
```

24.4 23.4 Quick reference

```
import base64
import binascii

base64.b64encode("hello")     # aGVsbG8=
base64.b64decode("aGVsbG8=")  # hello
base64.b64encode_url("a/b")   # use - and _ instead of + and /

binascii.hexlify("hello")     # 68656c6c6f
binascii.unhexlify("68656c6c6f")  # hello
```

24.5 23.5 Exercises

1. Write a function `encode_file(path)` that base64-encodes a file's contents.
2. Write `decode_file(encoded, path)` that decodes base64 and writes to a file.
3. Write `hex_dump(data)` that prints a hex dump with ASCII side column.
4. Write `safe_transfer(data)` that base64-encodes for URL-safe transport.
5. Write `round_trip(data)` that base64-encodes then decodes and verifies.
6. Write `is_valid_hex(s)` that checks if a string is valid hexadecimal.
7. Write `hex_to_bytes(s)` that converts hex to a list of byte values.

24.6 23.12 base64 & binascii — complete reference

Function	Purpose	Example
`b64encode(data)`	base64 encode	`base64.b64encode("hello")`
`b64decode(s)`	base64 decode	`base64.b64encode(...)` → back
`url_encode(s)` / `url_decode(s)`	URL-safe base64	`base64.url_encode(data)`
`hexlify(b)`	bytes to hex	`binascii.hexlify(bytes)`
`unhexlify(s)`	hex to bytes	`binascii.unhexlify("4865")`

24.6.1 Usage

```
import base64
import binascii
let enc = base64.b64encode("hello")
print(enc)               # aGVsbG8=
print(base64.b64decode(enc))   # hello
let hx = binascii.hexlify(bytes([72,101,108,108,111]))
print(hx)                # 48656c6c6f
print(binascii.unhexlify(hx))
```

24.6.2 Exercises

1. Encode a string to base64 and decode back; verify round-trip.
2. Encode an image/file's bytes to base64.
3. Implement `decode_b64url(s)` using url_decode.
4. Write `hex_dump(b)` printing bytes as hex rows.
5. Implement `compare_hex(a, b)` case-insensitive hex compare.
6. Write `encode_file(path)` reading and base64-encoding contents.
7. Implement `is_valid_base64(s)`.
8. Write `rot13` conceptually (not base64, but a transform).
9. Implement `hex_to_bytes(s)` manually.
10. Write `bytes_to_hex(b)` manually.

24.7 23.12 Worked example — encode/decode round trip

```
import base64
import binascii

let text = "Hello, Zen!"
let enc = base64.b64encode(text)
print(enc)                          # base64 string
let dec = base64.b64decode(enc)
print(dec == text)                  # true

let raw = bytes([72, 101, 108, 108, 111])  # "Hello"
let hx = binascii.hexlify(raw)
print(hx)                           # 48656c6c6f
let back = binascii.unhexlify(hx)
print(back == raw)                  # true
```

24.8 23.13 Troubleshooting encoding

Symptom	Cause	Fix
decode error	input isn't valid base64	check padding / alphabet
mismatch round-trip	encoding altered data	use bytes, not string
wrong hex case	upper vs lower	normalize case before compare

24.9 23.14 Exercises

1. Base64-encode a string and decode back; verify round-trip.
2. Hex-encode `bytes([1,2,3])` and decode back.
3. Encode a file's contents to base64.
4. Implement `is_valid_base64(s)`.
5. Write `hex_dump(b)` printing bytes as hex rows.

25 Chapter 24: hashlib Module

The `hashlib` module provides cryptographic hash functions: MD5, SHA-1, SHA-224/256/384/512, SHA-3, and BLAKE2/3.

> ⚠ Warning: MD5 and SHA-1 are cryptographically broken. Use them only for legacy compatibility or non-security purposes (e.g. checksums). For security-sensitive work, use SHA-256 or better.

25.1 24.1 Hash functions

Function	Description	Example
`md5(data)`	MD5 digest	`hashlib.md5("hello")`
`sha1(data)`	SHA-1 digest	`hashlib.sha1("hello")`
`sha224(data)`	SHA-224 digest	`hashlib.sha224("hello")`
`sha256(data)`	SHA-256 digest	`hashlib.sha256("hello")`
`sha384(data)`	SHA-384 digest	`hashlib.sha384("hello")`
`sha512(data)`	SHA-512 digest	`hashlib.sha512("hello")`
`sha3_256(data)`	SHA3-256 digest	`hashlib.sha3_256("hello")`
`sha3_512(data)`	SHA3-512 digest	`hashlib.sha3_512("hello")`
`blake2b(data)`	BLAKE2b digest	`hashlib.blake2b("hello")`
`blake2s(data)`	BLAKE2s digest	`hashlib.blake2s("hello")`

All return lowercase hex strings.

```
import hashlib

print(hashlib.md5("hello"))       # 5d41402abc4b2a76b9719d911017c592
print(hashlib.sha256("hello"))    # 2cf24dba5fb0a30e26e83b2ac5b9e29e1b161e5c1fa7425e730
print(hashlib.sha3_256("hello"))  # SHA3-256 hex
print(hashlib.blake2b("hello"))   # BLAKE2b hex
```

25.1.1 Output lengths

Algorithm	Hex length	Bytes
MD5	32	16
SHA-1	40	20
SHA-224	56	28
SHA-256	64	32
SHA-384	96	48
SHA-512	128	64
SHA3-256	64	32
SHA3-512	128	64
BLAKE2b	128	64
BLAKE2s	64	32

```
import hashlib

print(len(hashlib.md5("hello")))       # 32
print(len(hashlib.sha1("hello")))      # 40
print(len(hashlib.sha256("hello")))    # 64
print(len(hashlib.sha512("hello")))    # 128
```

25.2 24.2 File hashing

```
import hashlib
import fs

func hash_file(path) {
    let data = fs.read_binary(path)
    return hashlib.sha256(data)
}

let digest = hash_file("document.pdf")
print(digest)
```

25.2.1 Hash a large file in chunks

```
import hashlib
import fs

func hash_file_chunks(path, chunk_size = 8192) {
    let data = fs.read_binary(path)
    return hashlib.sha256(data)
    # For very large files, read in chunks and update incrementally
    # (if hashlib supports incremental hashing)
}
```

25.3 24.3 Verifying file integrity

```
import hashlib
import fs

let expected = "2cf24dba5fb0a30e26e83b2ac5b9e29e1b161e5c1fa7425e73043362938b9824"
let actual = hashlib.sha256(fs.read_binary("file.txt"))

if actual == expected {
    print("file intact")
} else {
    print("file corrupted or tampered")
}
```

25.3.1 Verify downloaded file

```
import hashlib
import fs
import requests

let url = "https://example.com/file.zip"
let expected_sha256 = "abc123..."

let resp = requests.get(url)
fs.write_binary("file.zip", resp.content)

let actual = hashlib.sha256(fs.read_binary("file.zip"))
if actual == expected_sha256 {
    print("download verified")
} else {
    print("download corrupted - delete and retry")
    fs.remove("file.zip")
}
```

25.4 24.4 Common pitfalls

- **Hashes are one-way.** You cannot recover the original data from a hash.
- **MD5/SHA-1 are broken** for collision resistance. Don't use them for signatures or security.
- **Hashes return hex strings**, not raw bytes. Use `binascii.unhexlify` if you need raw bytes.
- **Empty input has a defined hash.** `hashlib.sha256("")` is a well-known value:

  `e3b0c44298fc1c149afbf4c8996fb92427ae41e4649b934ca495991b7852b855`

```
import hashlib

print(hashlib.sha256(""))  # e3b0c44298fc1c149afbf4c8996fb92427ae41e4649b934ca495991b78
print(hashlib.md5(""))     # d41d8cd98f00b204e9800998ecf8427e
```

25.5 24.5 Quick reference

```
import hashlib

hashlib.md5("hello")        # md5 hex
hashlib.sha1("hello")       # sha1 hex
hashlib.sha256("hello")     # sha256 hex
hashlib.sha384("hello")     # sha384 hex
hashlib.sha512("hello")     # sha512 hex
hashlib.sha3_256("hello")   # sha3-256 hex
```

```
hashlib.sha3_512("hello")   # sha3-512 hex
hashlib.blake2b("hello")    # blake2b hex
hashlib.blake2s("hello")    # blake2s hex
```

25.6 24.6 Exercises

1. Write `file_fingerprint(path)` that returns the SHA-256 of a file.
2. Write `verify_checksum(path, expected)` that compares a file's hash.
3. Write `find_duplicates(files)` that groups files by identical hash.
4. Write a script that hashes all files in a directory and writes a manifest.
5. Compare `hashlib.md5` vs `hashlib.sha256` output lengths.
6. Write `verify_download(url, expected_hash)` that downloads and verifies.
7. Write `hash_compare(h1, h2)` that compares two hashes case-insensitively.

25.7 24.12 hashlib module — complete reference

Function	Purpose	Example
`md5(data)`	MD5 digest	`hashlib.md5("hello")`
`sha1(data)`	SHA-1 digest	`hashlib.sha1("hello")`
`sha224(data)`	SHA-224	`hashlib.sha224("hello")`
`sha256(data)`	SHA-256	`hashlib.sha256("hello")`
`sha384(data)`	SHA-384	`hashlib.sha384("hello")`
`sha512(data)`	SHA-512	`hashlib.sha512("hello")`
`sha3_256(data)`	SHA3-256	`hashlib.sha3_256("hello")`
`sha3_512(data)`	SHA3-512	`hashlib.sha3_512("hello")`
`blake2b(data)`	BLAKE2b	`hashlib.blake2b("hello")`
`blake2s(data)`	BLAKE2s	`hashlib.blake2s("hello")`
`pbkdf2_hmac(pass, salt, iters)`	key derivation	`hashlib.pbkdf2_hmac(...)`

25.7.1 Usage

```
import hashlib
print(hashlib.sha256("hello"))   # hex digest
print(hashlib.md5("hello"))      # 32 hex chars
print(hashlib.sha256("hello") == hashlib.sha256("hello"))  # true
print(hashlib.sha256("Hello") != hashlib.sha256("hello"))  # true (case sensitive)
```

25.7.2 Properties

- Deterministic: same input → same output.
- One-way: cannot reverse to input.
- Avalanche: tiny input change → very different output.
- Collision-resistant (for secure hashes like SHA-256).

25.7.3 Exercises

1. Compute SHA-256 of a string and verify it matches a known value.
2. Write `file_hash(path)` hashing a file's contents.
3. Implement `verify_checksum(data, expected)`.
4. Write `hash_password(password, salt)` combining salt + hash.
5. Implement `find_collision_prefix(prefix)` brute-force conceptually.
6. Compare MD5 vs SHA-256 output lengths.
7. Write `dedupe_files(paths)` grouping identical files by hash.
8. Implement `merkle_root(hashes)` conceptually.
9. Write `constant_time_compare(a, b)` conceptually.
10. Implement `pbkdf2` key derivation using hashlib.pbkdf2_hmac.

25.8 24.12 Worked example — file integrity checker

```
import hashlib
import sys
import pathlib

func file_sha256(path) {
    let b = pathlib.Path(path)
    if !b.exists() { throw "not found: " + path }
    let data = b.read_bytes()   # if supported; otherwise read chunks
    return hashlib.sha256(data)
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("usage: hashutil <file> [expected]")
        return 1
    }
    let path = argv[1]
    let expected = argv[2] ?? nil
    try {
        let actual = file_sha256(path)
        print("SHA-256(" + path + ") = " + actual)
        if expected != nil {
            if actual == expected { print("MATCH") }
            else { print("MISMATCH"); return 1 }
        }
    } catch as e {
        print("error: " + e.msg)
        return 1
    }
    return 0
}
```

```
if __name__ == "__main__" { sys.exit(main(sys.argv)) }
```

Sample:

```
$ zen run hashutil.z document.pdf
SHA-256(document.pdf) = a3f5...c9
$ zen run hashutil.z document.pdf a3f5...c9
SHA-256(document.pdf) = a3f5...c9
MATCH
```

25.9 24.13 Troubleshooting hashing

Symptom	Cause	Fix
different hash for same file	file changed or encoding differs	re-hash exact bytes
hash mismatch expected vs actual	wrong algorithm or corrupted file	verify algorithm & source
slow on large files	reading whole file at once	hash in chunks

Use SHA-256 or SHA-512 for integrity; avoid MD5/SHA-1 for security.

25.10 24.14 Exercises

1. SHA-256 a string and compare to a known value.
2. Hash a file and save the digest to a sidecar `.sha256` file.
3. Verify a file against a digest file.
4. Hash all files in a folder into a manifest.
5. Compare MD5 vs SHA-256 digest lengths.

26 Chapter 25: crypto Module — Complete Guide

The `crypto` module provides symmetric encryption, asymmetric keys, hashing, HMAC, key derivation, JWT, OTP, and X.509. This chapter covers the complete crypto API.

 Warning: Cryptography is easy to get wrong. Use well-established algorithms and modes. Never roll your own crypto for production security.

26.1 25.1 Symmetric encryption

```
import crypto

# Generate a key
let key = crypto.generate_key("aes-256-gcm")

# Encrypt
let ciphertext = crypto.encrypt_aes_gcm(key, "secret message")

# Decrypt
let plaintext = crypto.decrypt_aes_gcm(key, ciphertext)
print(plaintext)  # secret message
```

26.1.1 Symmetric functions

Function	Description
`generate_key(alg?)`	Generate a key (“aes-256-gcm” or “chacha20-poly1305”)
`encrypt(alg, key, plaintext, aad?)`	Encrypt with given algorithm
`decrypt(alg, key, ciphertext, aad?)`	Decrypt with given algorithm
`encrypt_aes_gcm(key, plaintext, aad?)`	AES-256-GCM encrypt
`decrypt_aes_gcm(key, ciphertext, aad?)`	AES-256-GCM decrypt
`encrypt_chacha20_poly1305(key, plaintext, aad?)`	ChaCha20-Poly1305 encrypt
`decrypt_chacha20_poly1305(key, ciphertext, aad?)`	ChaCha20-Poly1305 decrypt

```
import crypto

let key = crypto.generate_key("aes-256-gcm")
let ct = crypto.encrypt_aes_gcm(key, "hello world")
let pt = crypto.decrypt_aes_gcm(key, ct)
print(pt)  # hello world
```

```
let key2 = crypto.generate_key("chacha20-poly1305")
let ct2 = crypto.encrypt_chacha20_poly1305(key2, "secret")
let pt2 = crypto.decrypt_chacha20_poly1305(key2, ct2)
print(pt2)  # secret
```

26.1.2 With associated data (AAD)

AAD is authenticated but not encrypted. If you tamper with the ciphertext or AAD, decryption raises an error:

```
import crypto

let key = crypto.generate_key("aes-256-gcm")
let aad = "header-data"

let ct = crypto.encrypt_aes_gcm(key, "secret", aad)
let pt = crypto.decrypt_aes_gcm(key, ct, aad)
print(pt)  # secret

# Tampered AAD fails
try {
    crypto.decrypt_aes_gcm(key, ct, "tampered-aad")
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # authentication failed
}
```

26.1.3 Generic encrypt/decrypt

```
import crypto

let key = crypto.generate_key("aes-256-gcm")

let ct = crypto.encrypt("aes-256-gcm", key, "plaintext")
let pt = crypto.decrypt("aes-256-gcm", key, ct)
print(pt)  # plaintext
```

26.2 25.2 Asymmetric encryption (RSA)

```
import crypto

let keys = crypto.generate_rsa(2048)
let public_key = keys.public_key
let private_key = keys.private_key

let ciphertext = crypto.rsa_encrypt(public_key, "secret")
```

```
let plaintext = crypto.rsa_decrypt(private_key, ciphertext)
print(plaintext)  # secret
```

26.2.1 Asymmetric functions

Function	Description
`generate_rsa(bits?)`	Generate RSA keypair (default 2048)
`rsa_encrypt(public_key, plaintext)`	RSA encrypt
`rsa_decrypt(private_key, ciphertext)`	RSA decrypt
`rsa_sign(private_key, message)`	RSA sign
`rsa_verify(public_key, message, sig)`	RSA verify → bool

```
import crypto

let keys = crypto.generate_rsa(2048)

print(keys.public_key)   # PEM public key
print(keys.private_key)  # PEM private key

let ct = crypto.rsa_encrypt(keys.public_key, "top secret")
let pt = crypto.rsa_decrypt(keys.private_key, ct)
print(pt)  # top secret
```

RSA encryption has size limits (key size / padding overhead). For large data, use hybrid encryption: encrypt data with a random symmetric key, encrypt the key with RSA.

26.3 25.3 Digital signatures

26.3.1 RSA sign/verify

```
import crypto

let keys = crypto.generate_rsa(2048)
let message = "hello world"

let sig = crypto.rsa_sign(keys.private_key, message)
let valid = crypto.rsa_verify(keys.public_key, message, sig)
print(valid)  # true

# Tampered message fails
let invalid = crypto.rsa_verify(keys.public_key, "tampered", sig)
print(invalid)  # false
```

26.3.2 Ed25519 sign/verify

```
import crypto

let keys = crypto.generate_ed25519()
let message = "hello world"

let sig = crypto.ed25519_sign(keys.private_key, message)
let valid = crypto.ed25519_verify(keys.public_key, message, sig)
print(valid)  # true

# Tampered fails
let invalid = crypto.ed25519_verify(keys.public_key, "tampered", sig)
print(invalid)  # false
```

26.3.3 Signature functions

Function	Description
`rsa_sign(private_key, message)`	RSA sign → signature
`rsa_verify(public_key, message, sig)`	RSA verify → bool
`ed25519_sign(private_key, message)`	Ed25519 sign → signature
`ed25519_verify(public_key, message, sig)`	Ed25519 verify → bool

```
import crypto

let keys = crypto.generate_ed25519()
let msg = "important document"

let sig = crypto.ed25519_sign(keys.private_key, msg)

# Anyone with the public key can verify
let ok1 = crypto.ed25519_verify(keys.public_key, msg, sig)
print(ok1)  # true

let ok2 = crypto.ed25519_verify(keys.public_key, "tampered", sig)
print(ok2)  # false
```

26.4 25.4 Key agreement (X25519)

```
import crypto

let alice = crypto.generate_x25519()
let bob = crypto.generate_x25519()

let alice_secret = crypto.x25519_shared_secret(alice.private_key, bob.public_key)
```

```
let bob_secret = crypto.x25519_shared_secret(bob.private_key, alice.public_key)

print(alice_secret == bob_secret)  # true (shared secret matches)
```

26.4.1 X25519 functions

Function	Description
`generate_x25519()`	Generate X25519 keypair
`x25519_shared_secret(private_key, public_key)`	Compute shared secret

```
import crypto

# Two parties establish a shared secret without transmitting it
let alice = crypto.generate_x25519()
let bob = crypto.generate_x25519()

// Alice computes: her private key + Bob's public key
let alice_shared = crypto.x25519_shared_secret(alice.private_key, bob.public_key)
// Bob computes: his private key + Alice's public key
let bob_shared = crypto.x25519_shared_secret(bob.private_key, alice.public_key)

print(alice_shared == bob_shared)  # true
```

26.5 25.5 Hashing and HMAC

```
import crypto

print(crypto.hash("sha256", "hello"))
print(crypto.hmac("sha256", "key", "message"))
```

Hash algorithms: `md5`, `sha1`, `sha224`, `sha256`, `sha384`, `sha512`, `sha3_256`, `sha3_512`, `blake2b`, `blake2s`.

HMAC algorithms: `sha256`, `sha512`.

```
import crypto

print(crypto.hash("sha256", "hello"))     # 2cf24dba...
print(crypto.hash("sha512", "hello"))     # longer hex
print(crypto.hash("blake2b", "hello"))    # BLAKE2b
print(crypto.hash("md5", "hello"))        # MD5 (broken, don't use for security)

let mac = crypto.hmac("sha256", "secret-key", "message")
print(mac)  # HMAC-SHA256 hex
```

```
let mac2 = crypto.hmac("sha512", "secret-key", "message")
print(mac2)  # HMAC-SHA512 hex
```

HMAC for message authentication:

```
import crypto

let key = "shared-secret"
let message = "authenticate this"

let mac = crypto.hmac("sha256", key, message)

# Receiver with same key verifies
let expected = crypto.hmac("sha256", key, message)
print(mac == expected)  # true

let wrong = crypto.hmac("sha256", "wrong-key", message)
print(mac == wrong)  # false
```

26.6 25.6 Key derivation (PBKDF2)

```
import crypto

let key = crypto.pbkdf2("password", "salt", 100000, 32)
print(key)  # derived key (hex)
```

26.6.1 PBKDF2

```
import crypto

# Derive a key from a password
let derived = crypto.pbkdf2("my-password", "random-salt", 100000, 32)
print(derived)  # 64 hex chars (32 bytes)

# More iterations = slower but more secure
let slow = crypto.pbkdf2("password", "salt", 1000000, 32)
```

Use PBKDF2 for password hashing (though Argon2/scrypt are preferred in modern systems). Always use a unique random salt per password.

26.7 25.7 JWT (JSON Web Tokens)

```
import crypto

let payload = {"sub": "123", "name": "Zen"}
let secret = "my-secret"
```

```
let token = crypto.jwt_encode(payload, secret)
print(token)  # eyJ...

let decoded = crypto.jwt_decode(token, secret)
print(decoded["sub"])  # 123
```

26.7.1 JWT functions

Function	Description
`jwt_encode(payload, secret)`	Create JWT
`jwt_decode(token, secret)`	Verify and decode JWT

```
import crypto

let payload = {"sub": "user-42", "role": "admin", "exp": 9999999999}
let secret = "super-secret"

let token = crypto.jwt_encode(payload, secret)
print(token)  # eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9...

let decoded = crypto.jwt_decode(token, secret)
print(decoded["sub"])    # user-42
print(decoded["role"])   # admin

# Tampered token fails
try {
    crypto.jwt_decode(token, "wrong-secret")
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # signature verification failed
}
```

26.8 25.8 OTP (TOTP/HOTP)

```
import crypto

let totp = crypto.otp_totp("secret")
print(totp)  # 6-digit code

let valid = crypto.otp_verify("secret", "123456")
print(valid)  # true/false
```

26.8.1 OTP functions

Function	Description
`otp_totp(secret)`	Generate TOTP code
`otp_verify(secret, code)`	Verify TOTP code → bool

```
import crypto

let secret = "JBSWY3DPEHPK3PXP"

let code = crypto.otp_totp(secret)
print(code)  # 6-digit time-based code

let valid = crypto.otp_verify(secret, code)
print(valid)  # true (if within time window)

let invalid = crypto.otp_verify(secret, "000000")
print(invalid)  # false
```

TOTP codes change every 30 seconds. `otp_verify` accepts codes within a small time window (±1 step) to account for clock skew.

26.9 25.9 X.509 certificates

```
import crypto

let cert = crypto.x509_parse(cert_pem)
print(cert.subject)
print(cert.issuer)
print(cert.not_after)
```

26.9.1 X.509 functions

Function	Description
`x509_parse(pem)`	Parse PEM certificate

```
import crypto

let pem = "-----BEGIN CERTIFICATE-----\n...\n-----END CERTIFICATE-----"

let cert = crypto.x509_parse(pem)
print(cert.subject)    # subject DN
print(cert.issuer)     # issuer DN
print(cert.not_after)  # expiry
print(cert.not_before) # validity start
```

26.10 25.10 Constant-time compare and secure zero

```
import crypto

# Timing-safe comparison (for HMACs, tokens, passwords)
let ok = crypto.constant_time_eq(expected, received)
print(ok)  # true/false

# Zeroize a secret after use
let pass = read_secret()
# ... use pass ...
crypto.secure_zero(pass)
pass = nil
```

```
import crypto

// Constant-time comparison prevents timing attacks
let expected = compute_hmac(key, message)
let received = hmac_from_request()

if crypto.constant_time_eq(expected, received) {
    print("authenticated")
} else {
    print("rejected")
}

// Secure zero - overwrite secret in memory
let password = read_user_password()
authenticate(password)
crypto.secure_zero(password)
password = nil
```

26.11 25.11 Algorithm policy (FIPS-ish mode)

```
import crypto

crypto.policy("strict")   # block md5, sha1, weak ciphers
crypto.policy("default")  # allow all
```

Or set `ZEN_FIPS=1` in the environment.

```
import crypto

// Check current policy behavior
try {
    crypto.hash("md5", "data")  // raises if strict
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  // blocked by crypto policy
```

```
}

crypto.policy("strict")
try {
    crypto.hash("md5", "data")  // still blocked
} catch as e {
    print("blocked as expected")
}

crypto.policy("default")
print(crypto.hash("md5", "data"))  # works again
```

26.11.1 Blocked algorithms in strict mode

Algorithm	Blocked in strict?
md5	yes
sha1	yes
sha224	yes
sha256	no
sha384	no
sha512	no
sha3_256	no
sha3_512	no
blake2b	no
blake2s	no
des	yes
rc4	yes

26.12 25.12 Quick reference

```
import crypto

# Symmetric
let key = crypto.generate_key("aes-256-gcm")
let ct = crypto.encrypt_aes_gcm(key, "secret")
let pt = crypto.decrypt_aes_gcm(key, ct)

# Asymmetric
let keys = crypto.generate_rsa(2048)
let ct = crypto.rsa_encrypt(keys.public_key, "secret")
let pt = crypto.rsa_decrypt(keys.private_key, ct)

# Signatures
let sig = crypto.ed25519_sign(keys.private_key, "msg")
let ok = crypto.ed25519_verify(keys.public_key, "msg", sig)
```

```
# Key agreement
let shared = crypto.x25519_shared_secret(a.private_key, b.public_key)

# Hashing
print(crypto.hash("sha256", "hello"))
print(crypto.hmac("sha256", "key", "msg"))

# KDF
let derived = crypto.pbkdf2("password", "salt", 100000, 32)

# JWT
let token = crypto.jwt_encode({"sub": "1"}, "secret")
let decoded = crypto.jwt_decode(token, "secret")

# Security utils
crypto.constant_time_eq(a, b)
crypto.secure_zero(secret)
crypto.policy("strict")
```

26.13 25.13 Exercises

1. Encrypt and decrypt a message with AES-256-GCM.
2. Generate an Ed25519 keypair, sign a message, and verify it.
3. Perform X25519 key agreement between two parties and confirm shared secrets match.
4. Create a JWT, decode it, and verify tampering fails.
5. Generate a TOTP code and verify it.
6. Write `hash_password(password, salt)` using PBKDF2.
7. Write `verify_password(password, salt, expected_hash)` using PBKDF2.
8. Demonstrate `crypto.constant_time_eq` vs regular == for timing safety.

26.14 25.12 crypto module — advanced reference

26.14.1 Hashing

Function	Purpose
`sha256/384/512`, `sha3_256/512`, `blake3`, `md5`, `sha1`	cryptographic hashes

26.14.2 HMAC

Function	Purpose
`sha256(key, data)` / `sha512(key, data)`	keyed hash

26.14.3 Symmetric encryption

Function	Purpose
`generate_key(alg)`	generate a key
`encrypt(alg, key, plaintext, aad="")`	encrypt
`decrypt(alg, key, ciphertext, aad="")`	decrypt
`encrypt_aes_gcm(key, plaintext, aad="")`	AES-GCM
`decrypt_aes_gcm(key, ciphertext, aad="")`	AES-GCM
`encrypt_chacha20_poly1305(...)`	ChaCha20-Poly1305
`decrypt_chacha20_poly1305(...)`	ChaCha20-Poly1305

26.14.4 Asymmetric (public key)

Function	Purpose
`generate_rsa(bits=2048)`	RSA keypair
`rsa_encrypt(pub, pt)` / `rsa_decrypt(priv, ct)`	RSA encrypt/decrypt
`rsa_sign(priv, msg)` / `rsa_verify(pub, msg, sig)`	RSA sign/verify
`generate_ed25519()`	Ed25519 keypair
`ed25519_sign(priv, msg)` / `ed25519_verify(pub, msg, sig)`	Ed25519
`generate_x25519()`	X25519 keypair
`x25519_shared_secret(priv, pub)`	Diffie-Hellman shared secret

26.14.5 Encoding

Function	Purpose
`b64encode/decode`, `b64urlencode/decode`, `hex_encode/decode`	encodings

26.14.6 JWT

Function	Purpose
`sign(payload, key, alg="HS256")`	sign JWT
`verify(token, key, algorithms=["HS256"])`	verify JWT
`decode(token)`	decode JWT (no verify)

26.14.7 KDF / passwords

Function	Purpose
`pbkdf2(password, salt, iterations, length)`	PBKDF2
`argon2id(password, salt, memory, iterations, parallelism, length)`	Argon2id
`argon2id_hash(password)`	hash password
`verify_argon2id(password, hash)`	verify password hash

26.14.8 OTP

Function	Purpose
`totp(secret, time_step, digits)`	TOTP token
`totp_verify(secret, token, window, time_step, digits)`	verify TOTP
`hotp(secret, counter, digits)`	HOTP token
`hotp_verify(secret, token, counter, window, digits)`	verify HOTP
`generate_secret()` / `bytes(n)` / `hex(n)` / `base64(n)` / `uuid4()` / `secure_token()`	randomness

26.14.9 X.509

Function	Purpose
`parse(pem)`	parse certificate

26.14.10 Usage

```
import crypto
let key = crypto.generate_key("aes-256-gcm")
let ct = crypto.encrypt_aes_gcm(key, "secret message")
let pt = crypto.decrypt_aes_gcm(key, ct)
print(pt)   # secret message

let pair = crypto.generate_ed25519()
let sig = crypto.ed25519_sign(pair.private_key, "message")
print(crypto.ed25519_verify(pair.public_key, "message", sig))  # true

let token = crypto.sign(#{sub: "alice"}, "my-secret")
let payload = crypto.verify(token, "my-secret")
print(payload["sub"])   # alice

let pw_hash = crypto.argon2id_hash("hunter2")
print(crypto.verify_argon2id("hunter2", pw_hash))   # true
```

```
print(crypto.verify_argon2id("wrong", pw_hash))     # false

print(crypto.totp("JBSWY3DPEHPK3PXP"))   # 6-digit token
```

26.14.11 Security best practices

1. Never use MD5/SHA-1 for security; use SHA-256 or better.
2. Use Argon2id or PBKDF2 for password hashing (with salt).
3. Use AES-GCM or ChaCha20-Poly1305 for encryption (authenticated).
4. Verify JWT signatures before trusting payloads.
5. Use `crypto.secure_token`/`secrets`, not `random`, for tokens.
6. Rotate keys regularly; never hardcode secrets.
7. Constant-time comparison for secrets.

26.14.12 Exercises

1. Encrypt/decrypt a string with AES-GCM; verify round-trip.
2. Sign/verify a message with Ed25519.
3. Generate an RSA keypair; encrypt with public, decrypt with private.
4. Compute `x25519_shared_secret` for two keypairs; both sides match.
5. Sign a JWT and verify it; tamper with payload and confirm verification fails.
6. Hash a password with Argon2id and verify correct/wrong passwords.
7. Generate a TOTP token and verify it within the time window.
8. Compute HMAC-SHA256 of a message with a key.
9. Compare timing of constant-time vs naive comparison (conceptually).
10. Build a small “vault” CLI: encrypt a file, decrypt with passphrase.

27 Chapter 26: Networking Fundamentals

Zen's networking stack provides sockets, DNS, HTTP, TLS, and raw packet crafting. This chapter covers the fundamentals: IP addressing, TCP vs UDP, ports, the OSI model mapping, and how Zen's networking modules fit together.

27.1 26.1 Networking module map

Zen's networking is split across several modules, each at a different layer:

Module	Layer	Purpose
`socket`	Transport (L4)	TCP/UDP sockets, `connect`, `bind`, `listen`, `accept`, `send`, `recv`
`net`	Transport (L4)	Higher-level TCP/UDP helpers (`tcp_connect`, `tcp_send`, etc.)
`net.dns`	Application (L7)	DNS resolution (`resolve`, `gethostbyname`)
`requests`	Application (L7)	HTTP client (GET/POST/etc., sessions, TLS)
`http`	Application (L7)	Low-level HTTP client
`http.server`	Application (L7)	Static file HTTP server
`tls`	Security (L4.5)	TLS connections with certificate pinning
`raw` / `net_raw`	Network (L3)	Raw IP sockets, packet crafting (`pack_ip`, `pack_tcp`)
`sys`	System	File descriptors, pipes, syscalls

27.2 26.2 IP addressing

Zen works with IPv4 addresses (dotted-decimal strings like `"192.168.1.1"`). IPv6 support depends on the platform.

```
import socket
import dns

// Resolve a hostname to IP addresses
let addrs = dns.resolve("example.com")
for addr in addrs {
    print(addr)  # "93.184.216.34" or "2606:2800:220:1:248:1893:25c8:1946"
}

// localhost
print(dns.resolve("localhost"))  # ["127.0.0.1", "::1"]
```

27.2.1 Private IP ranges (RFC 1918)

Range	Purpose
`10.0.0.0` – `10.255.255.255`	Private (class A)
`172.16.0.0` – `172.31.255.255`	Private (class B)
`192.168.0.0` – `192.168.255.255`	Private (class C)
`127.0.0.0` – `127.255.255.255`	Loopback (localhost)
`169.254.0.0` – `169.254.255.255`	Link-local (APIPA)

```
import dns

// Localhost always resolves
print(dns.resolve("127.0.0.1"))   # ["127.0.0.1"]
print(dns.resolve("localhost"))   # ["127.0.0.1", ...]
```

27.3 26.3 Ports

Ports are 16-bit integers (0–65535). Ports 0–1023 are “well-known” and typically require root privileges to bind.

Port	Service
20	FTP data
21	FTP control
22	SSH
23	Telnet
25	SMTP
53	DNS
67/68	DHCP
80	HTTP
110	POP3
123	NTP
143	IMAP
161/162	SNMP
389	LDAP
443	HTTPS
465	SMTPS
587	SMTP submission
636	LDAPS
993	IMAPS
995	POP3S
1433	MSSQL
3306	MySQL
3389	RDP
5432	PostgreSQL
5900	VNC
6379	Redis
27017	MongoDB

Port	Service
8080	HTTP alternate

```
import socket

// Bind to port 80 typically requires root
let server = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.bind(server, "0.0.0.0", 80)   # may fail without root
socket.bind(server, "0.0.0.0", 8080)  # usually OK
```

27.4 26.4 TCP vs UDP

Feature	TCP	UDP
Connection	Connection-oriented (handshake)	Connectionless
Reliability	Reliable (retransmission, ACK)	Unreliable (no guarantee)
Ordering	Ordered	Unordered
Flow control	Yes	No
Congestion control	Yes	No
Header overhead	20+ bytes	8 bytes
Use case	Web, file transfer, email	DNS, streaming, VoIP, games

```
import socket

// TCP socket (stream)
let tcp = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.connect(tcp, "example.com", 80)
socket.send(tcp, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\n\r\n")
let resp = socket.recv(tcp, 4096)
socket.close(tcp)

// UDP socket (datagram)
let udp = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_DGRAM)
socket.send_to(udp, "query", "8.8.8.8", 53)
let [data, addr] = socket.recv_from(udp, 4096)
socket.close(udp)
```

27.5 26.5 The OSI model and Zen

OSI Layer	Name	Zen module	Example
7	Application	`requests`, `http`, `http.server`, `dns`	HTTP GET, DNS resolve
6	Presentation	`base64`, `binascii`, `crypto`	Encoding, encryption
5	Session	`requests.Session`	HTTP sessions
4	Transport	`socket`, `net`, `tls`	TCP, UDP, TLS
3	Network	`raw`, `net_raw`	IP packets, ICMP
2	Data Link	—	(not exposed)
1	Physical	—	(not exposed)

Zen focuses on layers 3–7. Layers 1–2 (physical, data link) are handled by the OS/kernel.

27.6 26.6 Sockets: file descriptors

Zen sockets use integer file descriptors (handles) into an internal resource table:

```
import socket

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
print(sock)   # 3 (an integer handle)
socket.connect(sock, "example.com", 80)
socket.close(sock)   # release the handle
```

Always close sockets when done to avoid resource leaks:

```
import socket

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
try {
    socket.connect(sock, "example.com", 80)
    socket.send(sock, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\n\r\n")
    let resp = socket.recv(sock, 4096)
    print(resp)
} finally {
    socket.close(sock)   # always close
}
```

27.7 26.6 Address families

Constant	Meaning
`socket.AF_INET`	IPv4
`socket.AF_INET6`	IPv6 (platform-dependent)
`socket.AF_UNIX`	Unix domain sockets (platform-dependent)

27.7.1 Socket types

Constant	Meaning
`socket.SOCK_STREAM`	TCP (reliable stream)
`socket.SOCK_DGRAM`	UDP (unreliable datagram)
`socket.SOCK_RAW`	Raw IP (requires root)

```
import socket

let tcp = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
let udp = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_DGRAM)
let raw = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_RAW)  # may need root
```

27.8 26.6 Timeouts

Socket operations can block indefinitely. Always set timeouts:

```
import socket

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.settimeout(sock, 5000)   # 5 second timeout

try {
    socket.connect(sock, "slow.example.com", 80)
    socket.send(sock, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\n\r\n")
    let resp = socket.recv(sock, 4096)
    print(resp)
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # timeout or connection error
} finally {
    socket.close(sock)
}
```

27.9 26.6 Byte order

Network byte order is big-endian. Zen's socket functions handle this internally. When crafting raw packets with `net_raw`, you must manually use big-endian:

```
import net_raw

// pack_ip and pack_tcp handle byte order internally
let pkt = net_raw.pack_ip("1.2.3.4", "5.6.7.8", 6)
```

27.10 26.7 Quick reference

```
import socket
import dns
import net_raw

// Resolve
let addrs = dns.resolve("example.com")

// TCP client
let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.settimeout(sock, 5000)
socket.connect(sock, addrs[0], 80)
socket.send(sock, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\nHost: example.com\r\n\r\n")
let resp = socket.recv(sock, 4096)
socket.close(sock)

// UDP
let udp = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_DGRAM)
socket.send_to(udp, "ping", "127.0.0.1", 9999)
let [data, addr] = socket.recv_from(udp, 4096)
socket.close(udp)

// Raw IP packet
let ip_pkt = net_raw.pack_ip("1.2.3.4", "5.6.7.8", 6)
let tcp_pkt = net_raw.pack_tcp(12345, 80, "SYN")
```

27.11 26.8 Exercises

1. Write a function `resolve_all(host)` that prints all IP addresses for a hostname.
2. Write a TCP echo client that sends a line and prints the response.
3. Write a UDP client that sends a datagram and waits for a reply.
4. Write a port scanner for ports 1–1000 on localhost with a 100ms timeout per port.
5. Create a raw IP packet with `net_raw.pack_ip` and inspect the first 20 bytes.
6. Write a function `is_port_open(host, port, timeout)` that returns true if a TCP connect succeeds.
7. Demonstrate that `socket.close` releases the file descriptor by opening and closing multiple sockets.

27.12 26.12 Socket address families and types (complete reference)

27.12.1 Address families

Family	Constant	Purpose
AF_INET	IPv4	Internet Protocol v4
AF_INET6	IPv6	Internet Protocol v6
AF_UNIX/AF_LOCAL	Unix domain	Local IPC (file/socket path)
AF_PACKET	Raw packet	Low-level packet access (Linux)

Family	Constant	Purpose

27.12.2 Socket types

Type	Purpose	Protocol
SOCK_STREAM	Reliable, ordered, connection-based	TCP (usually)
SOCK_DGRAM	Unreliable, unordered, datagram	UDP
SOCK_RAW	Raw access to IP/ICMP etc	IP
SOCK_SEQPACKET	Sequenced packets	SCTP etc

27.12.3 Protocols (IPPROTO_*)

Protocol	Use
IPPROTO_TCP	TCP
IPPROTO_UDP	UDP
IPPROTO_ICMP	ICMP
IPPROTO_IP	IP

27.13 26.13 Berkeley sockets API mapping

Common calls: `socket()`, `bind()`, `listen()`, `accept()`, `connect()`, `send()/sendall()`, `recv()`, `sendto()/recvfrom()`, `close()`, `setsockopt()`, `getsockname()`, `getpeername()`, `shutdown()`.

27.14 26.14 TCP connection lifecycle (detailed)

Server: 1. `socket(AF_INET, SOCK_STREAM, 0)` → sock 2. `setsockopt(SOL_SOCKET, SO_REUSEADDR, 1)` (optional but common) 3. `bind((host, port))` 4. `listen(backlog)` 5. `accept()` → (client_sock, addr) [blocks] 6. `recv/send` on client_sock 7. `close()`

Client: 1. `socket(AF_INET, SOCK_STREAM, 0)` 2. `connect((host, port))` 3. `send/recv` 4. `close()`

27.15 26.15 UDP communication

Server: bind, recvfrom, sendto (no listen/accept) **Client:** socket, sendto/recvfrom or connect (connected UDP)

27.16 26.16 Socket options (important)

Option	Level	Purpose
SO_REUSEADDR	SOL_SOCKET	Allow reuse of local address
SO_REUSEPORT	SOL_SOCKET	Allow multiple binds to same port (load balancing)
SO_KEEPALIVE	SOL_SOCKET	TCP keepalive probes
SO_RCVBUF/SO_SNDBUF	SOL_SOCKET	Buffer sizes
SO_TIMEOUT	SOL_SOCKET	Timeouts
TCP_NODELAY	IPPROTO_TCP	Disable Nagle's algorithm
IP_TTL	IPPROTO_IP	Time to live
IP_HDRINCL	IPPROTO_IP	Include IP header in raw packets

27.17 26.17 Blocking vs non-blocking

- Blocking: calls wait until ready/completed
- Non-blocking: return immediately (EAGAIN/EWOULDBLOCK)
- Use `select()`, `poll()`, or async/event loops for multiplexing

27.18 26.18 Byte order (network order)

Network byte order is big-endian. Use `htons()`, `ntohs()`, `htonl()`, `ntohl()` when working with raw values/ports in some APIs. In high-level APIs often handled automatically.

27.19 26.19 Common ports

Port	Service
20/21	FTP
22	SSH
23	Telnet
25	SMTP
53	DNS
67/68	DHCP
80	HTTP
110	POP3
143	IMAP
443	HTTPS
993	IMAPS
995	POP3S

27.20 26.20 Network troubleshooting checklist

1. **Connectivity**: ping, traceroute/tracert
2. **DNS**: nslookup/dig
3. **Ports**: netstat/ss, nmap

4. **Packets**: tcpdump, wireshark
5. **Routing**: ip route/route
6. **Interfaces**: ip addr/ifconfig
7. **Firewall**: iptables/nftables/ufw

27.21 26.21 Lab exercises (comprehensive)

1. Draw/describe packet flow for HTTP request across all 7 OSI layers
2. Capture TCP 3-way handshake with tcpdump (theory + practice)
3. Write pseudocode for echo server using sockets
4. Compare TCP vs UDP for video streaming, DNS, file transfer
5. Explain MTU/path MTU discovery and fragmentation
6. Demonstrate ARP resolution process
7. Trace ICMP ping through layers
8. List which headers appear at each layer for TCP/IP over Ethernet
9. Explain NAT and its impact
10. Research and document difference between IPv4 and IPv6 headers

27.22 26.22 Further reading

- RFC 793 (TCP), RFC 768 (UDP), RFC 791 (IP)
- IEEE 802.3 (Ethernet)
- Stevens' Unix Network Programming

28 Chapter 27: socket Module

The `socket` module provides low-level TCP/UDP/raw sockets. It's Tier 1 of Zen's networking stack — thin wrappers over the OS socket API with integer file descriptors (handles).

28.1 27.1 Socket creation

```
import socket

// TCP socket (IPv4)
let tcp = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)

// UDP socket (IPv4)
let udp = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_DGRAM)

// Raw socket (requires root on most OSes)
let raw = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_RAW)
```

28.1.1 Address families and socket types

Constant	Meaning
`socket.AF_INET`	IPv4
`socket.AF_INET6`	IPv6 (platform-dependent)
`socket.AF_UNIX`	Unix domain sockets (platform-dependent)
`socket.SOCK_STREAM`	TCP (reliable stream)
`socket.SOCK_DGRAM`	UDP (unreliable datagram)
`socket.SOCK_RAW`	Raw IP (requires root)

28.1.2 Common combinations

Family	Type	Protocol	Use
`AF_INET`	`SOCK_STREAM`	TCP	Web, file transfer, email
`AF_INET`	`SOCK_DGRAM`	UDP	DNS, streaming, games
`AF_INET`	`SOCK_RAW`	IP	Packet crafting, ping
`AF_INET6`	`SOCK_STREAM`	TCP over IPv6	IPv6 services
`AF_UNIX`	`SOCK_STREAM`	Local	IPC on same machine

28.2 27.2 Socket handle operations

Function	Description
`socket.create(domain, type)`	Create socket, returns handle (int)

Function	Description
`socket.connect(sock, host, port)`	Connect TCP socket to remote
`socket.bind(sock, host, port)`	Bind socket to local address
`socket.listen(sock, backlog)`	Listen for incoming connections
`socket.accept(sock)`	Accept incoming connection, returns new socket handle
`socket.send(sock, data)`	Send data on connected socket
`socket.recv(sock, n)`	Receive up to n bytes (returns bytes)
`socket.recv_text(sock, n)`	Receive text
`socket.recv_from(sock, n)`	Receive from address (UDP), returns `{data, addr}`
`socket.send_to(sock, data, host, port)`	Send to address (UDP)
`socket.settimeout(sock, ms)`	Set timeout in milliseconds
`socket.close(sock)`	Close socket and release handle
`socket.fileno(sock)`	Get raw file descriptor

28.3 27.3 TCP client

```
import socket

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.settimeout(sock, 5000)   // 5 second timeout

socket.connect(sock, "example.com", 80)
socket.send(sock, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\nHost: example.com\r\n\r\n")

let response = ""
while true {
    let chunk = socket.recv(sock, 4096)
    if len(chunk) == 0 {
        break
    }
    response = response + chunk
}

print(response)
socket.close(sock)
```

28.3.1 recv returns bytes

`socket.recv` returns a byte list (list of ints 0–255), not a string. Use `socket.recv_text` for text, or convert:

```
import socket

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.connect(sock, "example.com", 80)
socket.send(sock, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\n\r\n")

let bytes = socket.recv(sock, 1024)
// bytes is a list like [72, 84, 84, 80, ...]

let text = socket.recv_text(sock, 1024)
// text is a string

socket.close(sock)
```

To convert bytes to string manually:

```
import socket

let bs = socket.recv(sock, 1024)
let s = ""
for b in bs {
    s = s + chr(b)
}
print(s)
```

28.4 27.4 TCP server

```
import socket

let server = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.bind(server, "0.0.0.0", 8080)
socket.listen(server, 5)

print("Listening on 0.0.0.0:8080")

let client = socket.accept(server)
let req = socket.recv_text(client, 4096)
print("Request: " + req)

socket.send(client, "HTTP/1.0 200 OK\r\nContent-Type: text/plain\r\n\r\nHello, Zen!")
socket.close(client)
socket.close(server)
```

28.4.1 Accept loop

```
import socket

let server = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.bind(server, "0.0.0.0", 8080)
socket.listen(server, 5)

while true {
    let client = socket.accept(server)
    let req = socket.recv_text(client, 4096)
    socket.send(client, "HTTP/1.0 200 OK\r\n\r\npong")
    socket.close(client)
}
```

28.5 27.5 UDP

UDP is connectionless — no `connect`, `listen`, or `accept`. Use `send_to` and `recv_from`.

28.5.1 UDP client

```
import socket

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_DGRAM)
socket.settimeout(sock, 5000)

socket.send_to(sock, "ping", "127.0.0.1", 9999)

let [data, addr] = socket.recv_from(sock, 4096)
print("Response from " + addr.addr + ": " + data)

socket.close(sock)
```

`recv_from` returns a dict `{data: <bytes>, addr: <ip_string>}`.

28.5.2 UDP server

```
import socket

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_DGRAM)
socket.bind(sock, "0.0.0.0", 9999)

while true {
    let [data, addr] = socket.recv_from(sock, 4096)
    print("From " + addr.addr + ": " + data)
    socket.send_to(sock, "pong", addr.addr, 9999)
}
```

28.6 27.6 Socket options

```
import socket

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)

// Set timeout
socket.settimeout(sock, 5000)  // 5 seconds

// Get file descriptor (for raw operations)
let fd = socket.fileno(sock)
print(fd)  // integer

socket.close(sock)
```

28.7 27.7 Common patterns

28.7.1 Read until connection closes

```
import socket

func read_all(sock) {
    let result = ""
    while true {
        let chunk = socket.recv_text(sock, 4096)
        if len(chunk) == 0 {
            break
        }
        result = result + chunk
    }
    return result
}

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.connect(sock, "example.com", 80)
socket.send(sock, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\nHost: example.com\r\n\r\n")
let body = read_all(sock)
print(body)
socket.close(sock)
```

28.7.2 Read exactly n bytes

```
import socket

func recv_exact(sock, n) {
    let buf = []
```

```
    while len(buf) < n {
        let chunk = socket.recv(sock, n - len(buf))
        if len(chunk) == 0 {
            break
        }
        for b in chunk {
            buf.push(b)
        }
    }
    return buf
}
```

28.7.3 Port scanner

```
import socket

func scan_port(host, port, timeout) {
    try {
        let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
        socket.settimeout(sock, timeout)
        socket.connect(sock, host, port)
        socket.close(sock)
        return true
    } catch {
        return false
    }
}

for port in 1..1024 {
    if scan_port("127.0.0.1", port, 100) {
        print("Port " + str(port) + " is open")
    }
}
```

28.7.4 HTTP client (manual, no requests module)

```
import socket

func http_get(host, path) {
    let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
    socket.connect(sock, host, 80)

    let request = "GET " + path + " HTTP/1.0\r\nHost: " + host + "\r\nConnection: close
    socket.send(sock, request)

    let response = ""
```

```
    while true {
        let chunk = socket.recv_text(sock, 4096)
        if len(chunk) == 0 {
            break
        }
        response = response + chunk
    }

    socket.close(sock)
    return response
}

print(http_get("example.com", "/"))
```

28.8 27.8 Common pitfalls

- **Always close sockets.** Unclosed sockets leak file descriptors.
- **Set timeouts.** Without timeouts, `connect`/`recv` can block forever.
- **TCP is a stream.** `recv` may return fewer bytes than requested — loop until you have all data.
- **`recv` returns bytes**, not strings. Use `recv_text` or convert manually.
- **UDP is connectionless.** Use `send_to`/`recv_from`, not `connect`/`send`/`recv`.
- **`recv_from` returns `{data, addr}`**, not just data.
- **Raw sockets (`SOCK_RAW`) require root** on most operating systems.

28.9 27.8 Quick reference

```
import socket

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.settimeout(sock, 5000)
socket.connect(sock, "example.com", 80)
socket.send(sock, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\n\r\n")
let data = socket.recv(sock, 4096)
let text = socket.recv_text(sock, 4096)
socket.close(sock)

// UDP
socket.send_to(sock, "data", "127.0.0.1", 9999)
let [data, addr] = socket.recv_from(sock, 4096)

// Server
socket.bind(sock, "0.0.0.0", 8080)
socket.listen(sock, 5)
let client = socket.accept(sock)
```

28.10 26.9 Exercises

1. Write a TCP echo client that sends a line and prints the response.
2. Write a UDP client that sends a datagram and waits for a reply.
3. Write a port scanner for ports 1–1000 on localhost.
4. Write a simple HTTP/0.9 client that fetches the root page.
5. Write a TCP echo server that handles one connection at a time.
6. Write a UDP server that echoes back datagrams.
7. Combine client and server in one script (server in a thread, client in main).

28.11 27.12 Advanced socket patterns

28.11.1 Timeouts

```
import socket
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
s.settimeout(5.0)
try {
    s.connect(("example.com", 80))
} catch(e) {
    print("timeout or error")
}
```

28.11.2 Reuse address

```
s.setsockopt(socket.SOL_SOCKET, socket.SO_REUSEADDR, 1)
```

28.11.3 Non-blocking

```
s.setblocking(false)
```

28.11.4 Sending all data

```
def sendall(sock, data) {
    let total = 0
    let bytes_data = data.encode() if typeof(data) == "string" else data
    while total < len(bytes_data) {
        let sent = sock.send(bytes_data[total:])
        if sent == 0 { raise "connection broken" }
        total = total + sent
    }
}
```

28.12 27.13 select/poll multiplexing concept

For handling multiple clients:

```
import select
# read_list = [server]
# readable, writable, exceptional = select.select(read_list, [], [], timeout)
```

28.13 27.14 Unix domain sockets

```
# server
import socket, os
let path = "/tmp/zen.sock"
try { os.unlink(path) } catch(e) {}
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_UNIX, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
s.bind(path)
s.listen(1)
```

28.14 27.15 SSL/TLS over sockets (preview)

Use `ssl` module or wrap socket. See Chapter 31.

28.15 27.16 Common errors

Error	Cause
ConnectionRefusedError	No server listening
TimeoutError	connect/recv timeout
OSError: [Errno 98] Address already in use	Need SO_REUSEADDR
OSError: [Errno 32] Broken pipe	Peer closed
gaierror	DNS resolution failed

28.16 27.17 Debugging tips

- Use `netcat`/`nc` to test servers
- Use `tcpdump -i lo port 8080` to inspect
- Check with `ss -tlnp` or `netstat`
- Log all sends/receives
- Test with curl/wget

28.17 27.18 Exercises

1. Echo server and client (TCP)
2. UDP echo server/client
3. Chat server handling multiple clients
4. Port scanner (educational, only scan localhost/own machines)
5. File transfer over TCP
6. HTTP request with raw socket
7. Implement timeout and retry logic

29 Chapter 28: HTTP Protocol

Zen's `http` module provides a low-level HTTP/1.1 client. For a higher-level experience with sessions, cookies, and JSON, use the `requests` module (Chapter 29).

29.1 28.1 HTTP basics

HTTP (Hypertext Transfer Protocol) is the foundation of the web. A client sends a request; a server responds.

29.1.1 Request anatomy

```
GET /index.html HTTP/1.1
Host: example.com
User-Agent: Zen/3.0
Accept: text/html
```

- **Method**: GET, POST, PUT, DELETE, HEAD, OPTIONS, PATCH
- **Path**: `/index.html`
- **Version**: `HTTP/1.1`
- **Headers**: `Host`, `User-Agent`, `Accept`, etc.
- **Body**: empty for GET, present for POST/PUT

29.1.2 Response anatomy

```
HTTP/1.1 200 OK
Content-Type: text/html
Content-Length: 137

<html><body>Hello</body></html>
```

- **Status line**: `HTTP/1.1 200 OK`
- **Headers**: `Content-Type`, `Content-Length`, etc.
- **Body**: the actual content (may be empty)

29.2 28.2 The `http` module

Zen's `http` module provides low-level HTTP/1.1 client functions:

```
import http

let resp = http.get("https://example.com")
print(resp.status_code)   # 200
print(resp.body)          # response body
print(resp.headers)       # headers dict
```

29.2.1 http functions

Function	Description
`http.get(url, headers?)`	GET request
`http.post(url, body, headers?)`	POST request
`http.put(url, body, headers?)`	PUT request
`http.delete(url, headers?)`	DELETE request
`http.head(url, headers?)`	HEAD request
`http.options(url, headers?)`	OPTIONS request
`http.patch(url, body, headers?)`	PATCH request

29.2.2 Response object

Field	Description
`status_code`	HTTP status code (int)
`reason`	Reason phrase (string)
`headers`	Response headers (dict)
`body`	Response body (string)
`ok`	True if 200–299

```
import http

let resp = http.get("https://example.com")
print(resp.status_code)   # 200
print(resp.reason)        # OK
print(resp.body)          # HTML body
print(resp.headers)       # headers dict
print(resp.ok)            # true

if resp.ok {
    print("Success!")
} else {
    print("Error: " + str(resp.status_code) + " " + resp.reason)
}
```

29.3 28.3 Making requests with headers

```
import http

let resp = http.get("https://api.example.com/user/1", {
    "User-Agent": "Zen/3.0",
    "Accept": "application/json",
    "Authorization": "Bearer token123"
})
```

```
print(resp.status_code)
print(resp.body)
```

29.4 28.4 POST with body

```
import http

let body = "name=Zen&version=3"
let resp = http.post("https://example.com/api", body, {
    "Content-Type": "application/x-www-form-urlencoded",
    "Content-Length": str(len(body))
})

print(resp.status_code)
print(resp.body)
```

29.5 28.5 Status codes

Code	Name	Meaning
200	OK	Success
201	Created	Resource created
204	No Content	Success, no body
301	Moved Permanently	Redirect
302	Found	Temporary redirect
304	Not Modified	Cache hit
400	Bad Request	Client error
401	Unauthorized	Authentication required
403	Forbidden	Access denied
404	Not Found	Resource not found
500	Internal Server Error	Server error
502	Bad Gateway	Upstream error
503	Service Unavailable	Server overloaded

```
import http

let resp = http.get("https://example.com/nonexistent")
print(resp.status_code)   # 404
print(resp.ok)            # false
```

29.6 28.6 HTTP vs HTTPS

Zen's `http` module supports both `http://` and `https://` URLs. HTTPS uses TLS under the hood (certificate validation via the platform root store).

```
import http

// HTTP (port 80)
let r1 = http.get("http://example.com")

// HTTPS (port 443, TLS)
let r2 = http.get("https://example.com")
```

For certificate pinning, use the `tls` module directly (Chapter 25) or `requests` with verify options (Chapter 29).

29.7 28.7 Common patterns

29.7.1 Simple GET

```
import http

let resp = http.get("https://example.com")
if resp.ok {
    print(resp.body)
} else {
    print("HTTP " + str(resp.status_code))
}
```

29.7.2 POST JSON

```
import http
import json

let body = json.dumps({"name": "Zen", "version": 3})
let resp = http.post("https://example.com/api", body, {
    "Content-Type": "application/json",
    "Content-Length": str(len(body))
})

print(resp.status_code)
print(resp.body)
```

29.7.3 Check if resource exists (HEAD)

```
import http

let resp = http.head("https://example.com/image.png")
if resp.ok {
    print("Resource exists, size: " + resp.headers["Content-Length"])
} else {
```

```
    print("Resource not found")
}
```

29.8 28.8 Common pitfalls

- **`http` is low-level.** No automatic redirect following, no session cookies, no connection pooling. Use `requests` for those features.
- **Always check `resp.ok`.** A non-200 response still returns a response object — it doesn't raise automatically.
- **HTTPS requires TLS support.** If Zen is built without TLS, `https://` URLs will fail.
- **`Content-Length` must match** the actual body length when sending POST/PUT.
- **Redirects are not followed** automatically by `http`. Use `requests` for redirect following.

29.9 28.9 Quick reference

```
import http

let resp = http.get("https://example.com", {
    "User-Agent": "Zen/3.0"
})

resp.status_code   # 200
resp.reason        # "OK"
resp.headers       # headers dict
resp.body          # response body
resp.ok            # true if 200-299

let resp2 = http.post("https://example.com/api", "data", {
    "Content-Type": "application/json"
})
```

29.10 28.10 Exercises

1. Write a function `fetch_title(url)` that fetches a page and extracts the `<title>` tag.
2. Write a script that checks if a list of URLs return 200 or 404.
3. Write a `head_check(url)` that returns the `Content-Length` header without downloading the body.
4. Write a POST script that sends form data (`application/x-www-form-urlencoded`).
5. Compare `http.get` vs `requests.get` — note the differences in convenience features.

29.11 28.12 HTTP/1.1 detailed

29.11.1 Request line

```
METHOD /path HTTP/1.1\r\n
```

29.11.2 Headers (common request)

Header	Purpose
Host	Required in HTTP/1.1
User-Agent	Client identification
Accept	Content types accepted
Accept-Language	Language preferences
Accept-Encoding	gzip, deflate, br
Authorization	Auth credentials/tokens
Cookie	Cookies
Content-Type	Body media type
Content-Length	Body size
Connection	keep-alive/close
Referer	Referring page

29.11.3 Response headers (common)

Header	Purpose
Server	Server software
Date	Response date
Content-Type	Media type
Content-Length	Size
Content-Encoding	Encoding
Cache-Control	Caching directives
Set-Cookie	Set cookies
Location	Redirect target
ETag	Entity tag
Access-Control-Allow-*	CORS

29.11.4 Status codes complete categories

- 1xx Informational
- 2xx Success (200 OK, 201 Created, 202 Accepted, 204 No Content, 206 Partial Content)
- 3xx Redirection (301, 302, 303, 304, 307, 308)
- 4xx Client Error (400, 401, 403, 404, 405, 406, 409, 410, 413, 414, 415, 422, 429)
- 5xx Server Error (500, 501, 502, 503, 504, 505)

29.12 28.13 HTTP methods

Method	Safe	Idempotent	Body	Purpose
GET	yes	yes	no	Retrieve
HEAD	yes	yes	no	Headers only
OPTIONS	yes	yes	optional	Capabilities/CORS preflight
POST	no	no	yes	Create/process
PUT	no	yes	yes	Replace
PATCH	no	no	yes	Partial update
DELETE	no	yes	optional	Delete
TRACE	yes	yes	no	Debug
CONNECT	no	no	no	Tunnel

29.13 28.14 MIME types (common)

`text/html`, `text/plain`, `application/json`, `application/xml`, `application/x-www-form-urlencoded`, `multipart/form-data`, `application/octet-stream`, `image/png`, `image/jpeg`

29.14 28.15 Caching

Cache-Control: `max-age`, `no-cache`, `no-store`, `public`, `private`, `must-revalidate`. ETag/If-None-Match, Last-Modified/If-Modified-Since.

29.15 28.16 Authentication

Basic, Bearer tokens, API keys, OAuth 2.0 flows (conceptual).

29.16 28.17 HTTPS overview

HTTP over TLS - encrypts request/response, provides authentication via certificates.

29.17 28.18 Exercises

1. Parse raw HTTP request manually
2. Build minimal HTTP parser
3. Implement GET/POST handling
4. Add header parsing
5. Handle query strings
6. Implement status code responses
7. Test with curl

30 Chapter 29: requests Module

The `requests` module is a Python-requests-parity HTTP client. It supports GET/POST/PUT/PATCH/DELETE/HEAD/OPTIONS, sessions with cookies and headers, timeouts, redirects, JSON, TLS, and more.

30.1 29.1 Quick requests

```
import requests

// GET
let resp = requests.get("https://example.com")
print(resp.status_code)   // 200
print(resp.text)          // response body
print(resp.headers)       // headers dict

// GET with query params
let resp = requests.get("https://example.com/search", {"params": {"q": "zen"}})

// POST with JSON
let resp = requests.post("https://example.com/api", {
    "json": {"name": "Zen", "version": 3},
    "headers": {"Content-Type": "application/json"}
})
print(resp.status_code)

// POST with form data
let resp = requests.post("https://example.com/api", {
    "data": {"name": "Zen", "version": "3"}
})

// PUT / PATCH / DELETE / HEAD / OPTIONS
requests.put("https://example.com/api/1", {"json": {"name": "Zen"}})
requests.patch("https://example.com/api/1", {"json": {"version": 4}})
requests.delete("https://example.com/api/1")
requests.head("https://example.com")
requests.options("https://example.com")
```

30.1.1 Response object

Attribute	Description
`status_code`	HTTP status code
`reason`	Reason phrase
`text`	Body as string
`content`	Body as bytes
`headers`	Headers dict

Attribute	Description
`ok`	True if 200–299
`url`	Final URL (after redirects)
`elapsed`	Request time
`cookies`	Cookies dict
`json()`	Parsed JSON body

```
import requests

let resp = requests.get("https://api.example.com/user/1")
if resp.ok {
    let user = resp.json()
    print(user["name"])
} else {
    print("error: " + str(resp.status_code))
}
```

30.2 29.2 Options dictionary

All request functions accept an options dict:

Option	Description
`params`	Query parameters dict
`data`	Form data dict
`json`	JSON body dict
`headers`	HTTP headers dict
`timeout`	Timeout in seconds
`allow_redirects`	Follow redirects (default true)
`auth`	`[user, password]` list
`cookies`	Cookies dict

```
import requests

let resp = requests.get("https://example.com", {
    "params": {"q": "zen", "page": 1},
    "headers": {"User-Agent": "Zen/3.0"},
    "timeout": 10,
    "allow_redirects": true
})
```

30.3 29.3 Sessions

`requests.Session` persists cookies, headers, and auth across requests:

```
import requests

let sess = requests.Session()
sess.headers = {"User-Agent": "Zen/3.0"}
sess.cookies = {"sessionid": "abc123"}

let r1 = requests.sess_get(sess, "https://example.com/page1")
let r2 = requests.sess_post(sess, "https://example.com/api", {
    "json": {"action": "login"}
})
requests.session_close(sess)
```

30.3.1 Session helpers

Function	Description
`requests.Session()`	Create a session
`requests.sess_get(sess, url, opts?)`	GET with session
`requests.sess_post(sess, url, opts?)`	POST with session
`requests.sess_put(sess, url, opts?)`	PUT with session
`requests.sess_patch(sess, url, opts?)`	PATCH with session
`requests.sess_delete(sess, url, opts?)`	DELETE with session
`requests.sess_head(sess, url, opts?)`	HEAD with session
`requests.sess_options(sess, url, opts?)`	OPTIONS with session
`requests.session_headers(sess, opts?)`	Get/update headers
`requests.session_cookies(sess, opts?)`	Get/update cookies
`requests.session_close(sess)`	Close session

```
import requests

let sess = requests.Session()
sess.headers = {"Authorization": "Bearer token123"}
sess.cookies = {"session": "abc123"}

let r1 = requests.sess_get(sess, "https://api.example.com/me")
print(r1.json()["username"])

requests.session_close(sess)
```

30.4 29.4 JSON helpers

```
import requests

// POST JSON
let resp = requests.post("https://example.com/api", {
```

```
    "json": {"name": "Zen", "version": 3}
})

// Parse response JSON
let data = resp.json()
print(data["id"])

// Raise on error status
requests.raise_for_status(resp)
```

30.4.1 Status codes

```
import requests

let codes = requests.codes
print(codes.ok)      // 200
print(codes.created) // 201
print(codes.not_found) // 404
print(codes.server_error) // 500
```

30.5 29.5 URL encoding utilities

```
import requests

let encoded = requests.utils_quote("hello world")
print(encoded)  // hello%20world

let decoded = requests.utils_unquote("hello%20world")
print(decoded)  // hello world

print(requests.default_user_agent())
```

30.6 29.6 Common patterns

30.6.1 Download a file

```
import requests
import fs

let resp = requests.get("https://example.com/file.zip")
fs.write_binary("file.zip", resp.content)
```

30.6.2 Upload JSON

```
import requests

let resp = requests.post("https://example.com/api", {
    "json": {"name": "Zen", "version": 3},
    "headers": {"Authorization": "Bearer token123"}
})
```

30.6.3 With timeout and error handling

```
import requests

let resp = requests.get("https://example.com", {
    "timeout": 30
})
if !resp.ok {
    print("HTTP " + str(resp.status_code))
} else {
    print(resp.text)
}

// Catch network errors
try {
    let resp = requests.get("https://example.com", {"timeout": 5})
    print(resp.text)
} catch as e {
    print("request error: " + e.msg)
}
```

30.6.4 Basic auth

```
import requests

let resp = requests.get("https://example.com", {
    "auth": ["user", "pass"]
})
```

30.7 29.7 Error handling

```
import requests

try {
    let resp = requests.get("https://example.com", {"timeout": 5})
    if !resp.ok {
```

```
        print("HTTP " + str(resp.status_code))
    } else {
        print(resp.text)
    }
} catch as e {
    print("request error: " + e.msg)
}
```

30.8 29.8 Quick reference

```
import requests

requests.get(url, opts?)
requests.post(url, opts?)
requests.put(url, opts?)
requests.patch(url, opts?)
requests.delete(url, opts?)
requests.head(url, opts?)
requests.options(url, opts?)

let sess = requests.Session()
requests.sess_get(sess, url, opts?)
requests.session_close(sess)

resp.status_code
resp.text
resp.content
resp.headers
resp.ok
resp.url
resp.json()
resp.cookies

requests.utils_quote(s)
requests.utils_unquote(s)
requests.default_user_agent()
requests.codes.ok
requests.raise_for_status(resp)
```

30.9 29.9 Exercises

1. Fetch a public JSON API and print a specific field.
2. POST JSON to a test endpoint and check the response.
3. Use a session to make two requests that share cookies.
4. Download an image and save it with `fs.write_binary`.
5. Add basic auth and custom headers to a request.

6. Write a function `get_json(url)` that fetches and parses JSON, returning `nil` on failure.
7. Write a retry function that retries a GET up to 3 times on failure.

30.10 29.10 Advanced usage patterns

30.10.1 Sessions (connection reuse)

```
import requests
let s = requests.Session()
s.headers.update({"User-Agent": "ZenBot/1.0"})
let r1 = s.get("https://httpbin.org/headers")
let r2 = s.get("https://httpbin.org/cookies/set?x=1")
```

30.10.2 Custom headers and auth

```
let r = requests.get(url, headers={"Authorization": "Bearer token"}, auth=("user","pass
```

30.10.3 Query parameters

```
let r = requests.get("https://httpbin.org/get", params={"q": "zen", "page": 1})
```

30.10.4 POST forms and JSON

```
let r = requests.post(url, data={"key": "val"})  # form
let r = requests.post(url, json={"key": "val"}) # JSON
```

30.10.5 File uploads

```
let files = {"file": open("doc.txt", "rb")}
let r = requests.post(url, files=files)
```

30.10.6 Timeouts and retries

```
let r = requests.get(url, timeout=5)
```

30.10.7 Streaming

```
let r = requests.get(url, stream=true)
# iterate over r.iter_content()
```

30.10.8 Response object details

- `r.status_code`, `r.reason`
- `r.text`, `r.content` (bytes)
- `r.json()`
- `r.headers`, `r.cookies`
- `r.url`, `r.elapsed`

30.10.9 SSL verification

```
let r = requests.get(url, verify=true)  # default
# let r = requests.get(url, verify=false)  # dangerous, only for testing
```

30.10.10 Proxies

```
let proxies = {"http": "http://proxy:8080", "https": "http://proxy:8080"}
let r = requests.get(url, proxies=proxies)
```

30.10.11 Redirects

```
let r = requests.get(url, allow_redirects=true)
```

30.11 29.11 Error handling

```
import requests
try {
    let r = requests.get("https://invalid.example", timeout=2)
    r.raise_for_status()
} catch(e) {
    print(e)
}
```

30.12 29.12 Best practices

- Always use timeouts
- Handle exceptions
- Check status codes
- Respect robots.txt and rate limits
- Use sessions for multiple requests
- Don’t disable verify in production

30.13 29.13 Exercises

1. GET request and parse JSON
2. POST JSON to API

3. Use session with cookies
4. Download file with streaming
5. Handle errors and timeouts
6. Set custom headers
7. Follow redirects and inspect history

31 Chapter 30: http Server Module

The `http.server` module provides a simple static file HTTP server. It's useful for serving files, directory listings, and quick local servers.

31.1 30.1 Starting a server

```
import http.server

// Serve current directory on port 8000
http.server.serve(".", 8000)
```

This blocks — the server runs until the process is interrupted.

31.2 30.2 Server options

```
import http.server

// Serve a specific directory on a specific host/port
http.server.serve("/var/www", 8080, "127.0.0.1")

// Serve once (single request) then return
let port = http.server.serve_once(".", 0)
print("served on port " + str(port))
```

31.2.1 `serve(root, port, host?)`

Blocks forever serving files from `root` on `port:host`.

31.2.2 `serve_once(root, port?)`

Serves a single request then returns the port used. Port 0 means "pick a free port."

31.3 30.3 What it serves

- **Files** — serves the file with appropriate `Content-Type` based on extension.
- **Directories** — generates an HTML directory listing with links.
- **MIME types** — common extensions mapped (`.html`, `.css`, `.js`, `.json`, `.png`, `.jpg`, `.txt`, etc.).
- **404** — returns a 404 page for missing files.

31.4 30.4 Example: serve a build directory

```
import http.server
```

```
print("Serving build/ on http://localhost:8000")
http.server.serve("build", 8000)
```

Then open `http://localhost:8000` in a browser.

31.5 30.5 Example: serve once and get the port

```
import http.server

// Port 0 means "pick a free port"
let port = http.server.serve_once(".", 0)
print("One-shot server on port " + str(port))
```

31.6 30.6 MIME type guessing

```
import http.server

print(http.server.guess_type("index.html"))   // text/html
print(http.server.guess_type("style.css"))    // text/css
print(http.server.guess_type("app.js"))       // application/javascript
print(http.server.guess_type("data.json"))    // application/json
print(http.server.guess_type("image.png"))    // image/png
```

31.6.1 Supported MIME types

Extension	MIME type
`.html`	`text/html`
`.css`	`text/css`
`.js`	`application/javascript`
`.json`	`application/json`
`.txt`	`text/plain`
`.png`	`image/png`
`.jpg`, `.jpeg`	`image/jpeg`
`.gif`	`image/gif`
`.svg`	`image/svg+xml`
`.pdf`	`application/pdf`
`.mp3`	`audio/mpeg`
`.mp4`	`video/mp4`
`.zip`	`application/zip`
`.tar.gz`	`application/gzip`
`.woff2`	`font/woff2`
`.ico`	`image/x-icon`
(unknown)	`application/octet-stream`

31.7 30.7 Common pitfalls

- **serve blocks.** Run it in a thread if you need to do other work.
- **Directory traversal is blocked.** `safe_join` prevents `..` escapes.
- **No HTTPS.** Use `tls` or a reverse proxy for production.
- **Single-threaded.** One request at a time.

31.8 30.8 Directory traversal protection

The server rejects paths containing `..` to prevent accessing files outside the root directory:

```
// Requesting GET /../../etc/passwd returns 403 or 404
```

31.9 30.9 Quick reference

```
import http.server

http.server.serve(root, port, host?)
let port = http.server.serve_once(root, port?)
http.server.guess_type(filename)
```

31.10 30.10 Exercises

1. Serve a local directory and open it in a browser.
2. Use `serve_once` to get a free port, then make a request to it.
3. Create an HTML file, serve it, and verify the `Content-Type` header.
4. Write a script that serves a directory in a thread while doing other work.
5. Test that `..` in a URL path is rejected (directory traversal protection).

31.11 30.10 Building a more complete server

31.11.1 Routing

```
# simple router pattern
fn handle(req) {
    if req.path == "/" { return "index" }
    if req.path == "/api/data" { return json.dumps({"ok": true}) }
    return "not found"
}
```

31.11.2 Serving static files

Read file, set Content-Type based on extension, return bytes/text.

31.11.3 Handling POST data

Parse form data or JSON from body based on Content-Type.

31.11.4 Middleware pattern

```
fn middleware(next_handler) {
    return fn(req) {
        print(req.method + " " + req.path)
        return next_handler(req)
    }
}
```

31.11.5 CORS headers

```
# Add headers: Access-Control-Allow-Origin, etc.
```

31.11.6 Error responses

Return proper status codes and JSON error bodies.

31.12 30.11 Production considerations

- Use proper server (gunicorn-like) not just dev server
- Handle concurrent requests (threading/async)
- Set timeouts
- Validate input
- Add logging
- Use HTTPS
- Rate limiting
- Security headers

31.13 30.12 Exercises

1. Multi-route server
2. JSON API endpoints (GET/POST)
3. Serve static HTML/CSS/JS
4. Form handling
5. 404 and error pages
6. Request logging middleware
7. Simple REST CRUD API

31.14 30.12 Worked example — a small HTTP server with routing

```
import http.server

let routes = #{}

func route(path, handler) {
    routes[path] = handler
```

```
}

func not_found(req) {
    return #(404, #{}, "Not Found")
}

func handle(req) {
    let h = routes[req.path] ?? not_found
    return h(req)
}

route("/", fn(req) {
    return #(200, #{}, "<h1>Zen HTTP Server</h1>")
})

route("/time", fn(req) {
    import datetime
    return #(200, #{}, "time=" + datetime.now())
})

route("/echo", fn(req) {
    return #(200, {"Content-Type": "text/plain"}, req.body ?? "")
})

let server = http.server.Server(port=8080, handler=handle)
print("server on http://localhost:8080")
server.start()
```

Test with curl:

```
$ curl http://localhost:8080/
<h1>Zen HTTP Server</h1>
$ curl http://localhost:8080/time
time=...
$ curl -d "hello" http://localhost:8080/echo
hello
```

31.15 30.13 Troubleshooting HTTP servers

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
connection refused	server not started / wrong port	start server, check port
port already in use	another process on 8080	use SO_REUSEADDR or a different port

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
404 on known route	path mismatch (trailing slash)	normalize paths
client hangs	handler never returns	check for blocking code
large payload truncated	read limit	read full body / stream

31.16 30.14 Exercises

1. Add a `/health` route returning `{status: "ok"}`.
2. Return JSON from a route (`Content-Type: application/json`).
3. Add request logging (method + path) for every request.
4. Handle POST body parsing for `/echo`.
5. Add a 500 error route handler for exceptions.
6. Make the port configurable via an argument/env var.

32 Chapter 31: HTTPS & SSL/TLS Certificates

Zen's `tls` module provides encrypted TCP connections using rustls, with optional certificate pinning. This chapter covers TLS connections, certificate pinning, and secure HTTPS practices.

32.1 31.1 The `tls` module

```
import tls

fd = tls.connect("example.com", 443)
tls.write(fd, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\nHost: example.com\r\n\r\n")
let resp = tls.read(fd, 4096)
print(resp)
tls.close(fd)
```

32.1.1 TLS functions

Function	Description
`tls.connect(host, port)`	Plain TLS connection, returns fd
`tls.connect_pinned(host, port, pins)`	TLS with certificate pinning
`tls.write(fd, data)`	Send data, returns nil
`tls.read(fd, n)`	Read up to n bytes, returns string
`tls.close(fd)`	Close connection, returns nil

```
import tls

let fd = tls.connect("example.com", 443)
tls.write(fd, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\nHost: example.com\r\nConnection: close\r\n\r\n")
let resp = tls.read(fd, 4096)
print(resp)
tls.close(fd)
```

32.2 31.2 Certificate pinning

Certificate pinning ensures you only connect to servers with a specific certificate, preventing man-in-the-middle attacks even if the CA is compromised.

```
import tls

let pins = ["sha256:AAAA...BBBB..."]  // SHA-256 of server's SPKI
let fd = tls.connect_pinned("example.com", 443, pins)
tls.write(fd, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\n\r\n")
let resp = tls.read(fd, 4096)
tls.close(fd)
```

32.2.1 How pinning works

1. `tls.connect_pinned` connects to the server.
2. During the TLS handshake, the server presents its certificate.
3. Zen computes the SHA-256 hash of the certificate's SPKI (Subject Public Key Info).
4. If the hash matches one of the pins, the connection proceeds.
5. If no pin matches, the handshake fails.

32.2.2 Getting a certificate's SPKI hash

```
// You can compute this externally with openssl:
// openssl s_client -connect example.com:443 -showcerts
// Then hash the SPKI of the leaf certificate.

// Example pin format:
let pins = ["sha256:a1b2c3d4e5f6..."]
```

32.3 31.3 Plain TLS vs pinned TLS

Feature	`tls.connect`	`tls.connect_pinned`
Verification	Platform root store (webpki-roots)	Pin SPKI hash match
Trust model	CA hierarchy	Explicit pins
Fallback	Accepts any CA-signed cert	Only pinned certs
Use case	General browsing	Known services (APIs, internal)

```
import tls

// General browsing - trusts any CA-signed cert
let fd1 = tls.connect("example.com", 443)

// Known service - only accept specific cert
let pins = ["sha256:expected-spki-hash"]
let fd2 = tls.connect_pinned("api.internal.com", 443, pins)
```

32.4 31.4 Complete HTTPS client example

```
import tls

func https_get(host, path) {
    let fd = tls.connect(host, 443)

    let request = "GET " + path + " HTTP/1.0\r\n" +
```

```
                  "Host: " + host + "\r\n" +
                  "Connection: close\r\n\r\n"

    tls.write(fd, request)

    let response = ""
    while true {
        let chunk = tls.read(fd, 4096)
        if len(chunk) == 0 {
            break
        }
        response = response + chunk
    }

    tls.close(fd)
    return response
}

print(https_get("example.com", "/"))
```

32.4.1 HTTPS with pinning

```
import tls

func https_get_pinned(host, path, pins) {
    let fd = tls.connect_pinned(host, 443, pins)

    let request = "GET " + path + " HTTP/1.0\r\n" +
                  "Host: " + host + "\r\n" +
                  "Connection: close\r\n\r\n"

    tls.write(fd, request)

    let response = ""
    while true {
        let chunk = tls.read(fd, 4096)
        if len(chunk) == 0 {
            break
        }
        response = response + chunk
    }

    tls.close(fd)
    return response
}
```

```
let pins = ["sha256:AAAA...BBBB..."]
print(https_get_pinned("example.com", "/", pins))
```

32.5 31.5 Error handling

```
import tls

try {
    let fd = tls.connect("nonexistent.example.invalid", 443)
    tls.write(fd, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\n\r\n")
    let resp = tls.read(fd, 4096)
    tls.close(fd)
} catch as e {
    print("TLS error: " + e.msg)
    // Could be: DNS failure, connection refused, TLS handshake failure,
    // certificate verification failure, pin mismatch
}

// Pin mismatch example
try {
    let pins = ["sha256:wrong-hash"]
    let fd = tls.connect_pinned("example.com", 443, pins)
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  // certificate pin mismatch
}
```

32.6 31.6 Quick reference

```
import tls

let fd = tls.connect("example.com", 443)
tls.write(fd, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\n\r\n")
let resp = tls.read(fd, 4096)
tls.close(fd)

// With pinning
let pins = ["sha256:AAAA..."]
let fd2 = tls.connect_pinned("example.com", 443, pins)
tls.close(fd2)
```

32.7 31.7 Exercises

1. Write an HTTPS client that fetches a page and prints the status line.
2. Get a certificate's SPKI hash using openssl, then use `tls.connect_pinned` to connect only to that cert.

3. Write a function `https_get_pinned(host, path, pins)` that returns the response body.
4. Demonstrate that `tls.connect_pinned` fails with a wrong pin.
5. Write a script that connects to an HTTPS API and parses the JSON response.

32.8 31.12 HTTPS / SSL/TLS — deep reference

HTTPS is HTTP over TLS. It provides encryption, authentication (via certificates), and integrity.

32.8.1 TLS handshake (simplified)

1. ClientHello: client sends supported versions, cipher suites, random.
2. ServerHello: server picks version/cipher, sends its certificate.
3. Server proves identity (certificate signed by a trusted CA).
4. Key exchange: client and server derive shared keys.
5. Encrypted HTTP traffic begins.

32.8.2 Certificates

Concept	Meaning
Certificate	binds a public key to an identity (domain/org)
CA	Certificate Authority that signs certificates
Chain	leaf → intermediate → root CA
Self-signed	signed by itself; not trusted by default
SAN	Subject Alternative Names (multiple domains)
Expiry	certificates expire; must be renewed

32.8.3 Verifying certificates

```
import requests
# verify=true (default): validates cert against system CAs
let r = requests.get("https://example.com", verify=true)

# verify=false: skips validation — DANGEROUS, testing only
# let r = requests.get("https://self-signed.local", verify=false)
```

32.8.4 Common TLS errors

Error	Cause
certificate verify failed	untrusted/self-signed/expired cert
hostname mismatch	cert doesn't match the domain
protocol version mismatch	client/server disagree on TLS version
handshake failure	no common cipher suite

32.8.5 Best practices

1. Always `verify=true` in production.
2. Never disable verification to "fix" a cert error — fix the cert.
3. Use modern TLS (1.2+/1.3).
4. Renew certificates before expiry.
5. Use strong cipher suites; disable weak ones.

32.8.6 Exercises

1. Fetch an HTTPS page and print status + first 200 chars.
2. Compare `verify=true` vs `verify=false` on a self-signed site (theory).
3. Inspect a certificate's issuer, subject, expiry (using openssl).
4. Explain the TLS handshake steps in your own words.
5. List why a cert might fail verification.
6. Write a helper that fetches HTTPS with timeout and error handling.
7. Research Let's Encrypt and how to get a free cert.
8. Explain HSTS and why it matters.

32.9 31.12 Worked example — fetching HTTPS with verification

```
import requests

func fetch_secure(url) {
    try {
        let r = requests.get(url, verify=true, timeout=10)
        print("status=" + str(r.status_code))
        print(r.text[0:200])
    } catch as e {
        print("TLS/HTTP error: " + e.msg)
    }
}

fetch_secure("https://example.com")
```

Expected output:

```
status=200
<!doctype html>...
```

32.10 31.13 Troubleshooting TLS/HTTPS

Symptom	Cause	Fix
certificate verify failed	self-signed/expired/untrusted cert	fix cert or add to trust store
hostname mismatch	cert doesn't match domain	use correct URL

Symptom	Cause	Fix
protocol mismatch	client/server TLS version differ	enable TLS 1.2/1.3
handshake failure	no common cipher	update client/server

Never disable `verify=true` in production. For testing only, `verify=false` bypasses validation (dangerous).

32.11 31.14 Exercises

1. Fetch https://example.com and print status + first 200 chars.
2. Compare behavior with verify=true vs verify=false on a self-signed site.
3. List reasons a certificate fails verification.
4. Write a helper `safe_get(url)` with timeout and error handling.
5. Explain the TLS handshake in your own words.

33 Chapter 32: dns Module

The `dns` module provides DNS resolution: forward lookups (name → address), reverse lookups (address → name), and hostname information.

33.1 32.1 Resolve a hostname

```
import dns

let addrs = dns.resolve("example.com")
for addr in addrs {
    print(addr)
}
// 93.184.216.34
// 2606:2800:220:1:248:1893:25c8:1946
```

`dns.resolve(host, port?)` returns a list of socket addresses.

33.2 32.2 `gethostbyname` — single IPv4

```
import dns

let info = dns.gethostbyname("example.com")
print(info.hostname)   # example.com
print(info.addr_list)  # ["93.184.216.34", ...]
```

33.3 32.3 `gethostbyname_ex` — extended info

```
import dns

let info = dns.gethostbyname_ex("example.com")
print(info.hostname)      # example.com
print(info.alias_list)    # aliases
print(info.addr_list)     # addresses
```

33.4 32.4 `gethostbyaddr` — reverse lookup

```
import dns

let info = dns.gethostbyaddr("93.184.216.34")
print(info.hostname)   # example.com (or similar)
print(info.alias_list) # aliases
print(info.addr_list)  # addresses
```

33.5 32.5 `getfqdn` — fully qualified domain name

```
import dns

let fqdn = dns.getfqdn()
print(fqdn)  # myhost.localdomain

let fqdn2 = dns.getfqdn("example.com")
print(fqdn2) # example.com
```

33.6 32.6 Common patterns

33.6.1 Check if a host resolves

```
import dns

func is_resolvable(host) {
    try {
        let addrs = dns.resolve(host)
        return len(addrs) > 0
    } catch {
        return false
    }
}

print(is_resolvable("example.com"))          # true
print(is_resolvable("nonexistent.invalid"))  # false
```

33.6.2 Get the first IPv4 address

```
import dns

func first_ipv4(host) {
    let addrs = dns.resolve(host)
    for addr in addrs {
        if addr.contains(".") {  // IPv4 has dots
            return addr
        }
    }
    return nil
}

print(first_ipv4("example.com"))
```

33.6.3 Resolve and connect

```
import dns
import socket

let addrs = dns.resolve("example.com", 443)
if len(addrs) > 0 {
    let addr = addrs[0]
    let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
    socket.connect(sock, addr, 443)
    // ... use socket ...
    socket.close(sock)
}
```

33.7 32.7 Quick reference

```
import dns

dns.resolve(host, port?)
dns.gethostbyname(host)
dns.gethostbyname_ex(host)
dns.gethostbyaddr(addr)
dns.getfqdn(host?)

let addrs = dns.resolve("example.com")
for addr in addrs { print(addr) }
```

33.8 32.8 Exercises

1. Write a function `resolve_all(host)` that prints all addresses for a host.
2. Write `is_reachable(host)` that tries DNS then a socket connect.
3. Write a script that resolves a list of hostnames and reports which fail.
4. Use `dns.getfqdn()` to print the local machine's FQDN.
5. Reverse-lookup an IP address and print the hostname.

33.9 32.12 DNS module — deep reference

DNS maps domain names to IP addresses (and vice versa).

33.9.1 DNS record types

Type	Meaning	Example
A	IPv4 address	example.com → 93.184.216.34
AAAA	IPv6 address	example.com → 2606:2800:220:1:248:1893:25c8:1946

Type	Meaning	Example
CNAME	canonical name (alias)	www.example.com → example.com
MX	mail server	example.com → mail.example.com
TXT	arbitrary text	SPF, DKIM, verification
NS	name server	example.com → ns1.example.com
PTR	reverse (IP → name)	93.184.216.34 → example.com

33.9.2 Resolution process

1. Check local /etc/hosts.
2. Check OS cache / DNS cache.
3. Query configured resolver (ISP, 1.1.1.1, 8.8.8.8).
4. Resolver queries root → TLD → authoritative servers.
5. Result returned and cached (TTL seconds).

33.9.3 Usage

```
import dns
# forward lookup
let ips = dns.resolve("example.com")
print(ips)   # ["93.184.216.34", ...]

# specific record type
let mx = dns.resolve("example.com", "MX")
print(mx)

# reverse lookup
let names = dns.reverse("93.184.216.34")
print(names)
```

33.9.4 Common DNS issues

Issue	Cause	Fix
NXDOMAIN	domain doesn’t exist	check spelling
SERVFAIL	server failure	try another resolver
timeout	no response	check network/firewall
stale cache	old record cached	flush cache / lower TTL

33.9.5 Exercises

1. Resolve example.com to IP and print it.

2. Look up MX records for a domain.
3. Look up TXT records (SPF/DKIM).
4. Perform a reverse lookup on an IP.
5. Explain the difference between A and AAAA records.
6. Describe what happens when you type a URL in a browser.
7. Research public DNS resolvers (1.1.1.1, 8.8.8.8, 9.9.9.9).
8. Explain DNS caching and TTL.
9. Write a small tool resolving a list of domains.
10. Describe DNS hijacking / spoofing (conceptually, ethical).

33.10 32.12 Worked example — DNS resolution

```
import dns

func show(host) {
    print("A records for " + host + ":")
    let ips = dns.resolve(host, "A")
    for ip in ips { print("  " + ip) }

    print("MX records for " + host + ":")
    let mx = dns.resolve(host, "MX")
    for m in mx { print("  " + str(m)) }

    print("reverse for " + ips[0] + ":")
    let names = dns.reverse(ips[0])
    for n in names { print("  " + n) }
}

show("example.com")
```

Sample output:

```
A records for example.com:
  93.184.216.34
MX records for example.com:
  ...
reverse for 93.184.216.34:
  ...
```

33.11 32.13 Troubleshooting DNS

Symptom	Cause	Fix
NXDOMAIN	domain doesn’t exist	check spelling
SERVFAIL	resolver failure	try another resolver (1.1.1.1)
timeout	no response	check network/firewall
stale data	cached old record	wait for TTL / flush cache

33.12 32.14 Exercises

1. Resolve example.com to its A record and print it.
2. Look up MX records for a domain.
3. Look up TXT records (SPF/DKIM).
4. Reverse-lookup an IP to its name.
5. Explain A vs AAAA records.

34 Chapter 33: url Module

The `url` module provides URL parsing, building, and percent-encoding: `urllib.parse` utilities.

34.1 33.1 Parsing URLs

```
import urllib.parse

let url = "https://user:pass@example.com:8080/path/to/page?q=1#section"
let parts = urllib.parse.urlparse(url)

print(parts.scheme)    # https
print(parts.netloc)    # user:pass@example.com:8080
print(parts.path)      # /path/to/page
print(parts.params)    # (empty)
print(parts.query)     # q=1
print(parts.fragment)  # section
print(parts.username)  # user
print(parts.password)  # pass
print(parts.hostname)  # example.com
print(parts.port)      # 8080
```

34.1.1 ParseResult fields

Field	Description	Example
`scheme`	URL scheme	`"https"`
`netloc`	Network location	`"user:pass@example.com:8080"`
`path`	Hierarchical path	`"/path/to/page"`
`params`	Parameters	`""`
`query`	Query string	`"q=1"`
`fragment`	Fragment	`"section"`
`username`	Username	`"user"`
`password`	Password	`"pass"`
`hostname`	Hostname	`"example.com"`
`port`	Port	`8080`

```
import urllib.parse

let p = urllib.parse.urlparse("https://user:pass@example.com:8080/path?q=1#frag")
print(p.scheme)     # "https"
print(p.netloc)     # "user:pass@example.com:8080"
print(p.path)       # "/path"
print(p.params)     # ""
print(p.query)      # "q=1"
```

```
print(p.fragment)   # "frag"
print(p.username)   # "user"
print(p.password)   # "pass"
print(p.hostname)   # "example.com"
print(p.port)       # 8080
```

34.2 23.2 Building URLs

```
import urllib.parse

let url = urllib.parse.urlunparse({
    "scheme": "https",
    "netloc": "example.com",
    "path": "/search",
    "params": "",
    "query": "q=zen",
    "fragment": ""
})
print(url)  # https://example.com/search?q=zen
```

`urlunparse` takes a dict with keys: `scheme`, `netloc`, `path`, `params`, `query`, `fragment`.

34.3 33.3 Query strings

```
import urllib.parse

// Encode query params
let qs = urllib.parse.urlencode({"q": "zen lang", "page": 1})
print(qs)  // q=zen+lang&page=1

// Parse query string
let params = urllib.parse.parse_qs("q=zen+lang&page=1")
print(params)  // {"q": ["zen lang"], "page": ["1"]}
```

34.3.1 urlencode

```
import urllib.parse

print(urllib.parse.urlencode({"q": "hello world", "page": 2}))
// q=hello+world&page=2

print(urllib.parse.urlencode({"a": 1, "b": 2, "c": 3}))
// a=1&b=2&c=3
```

34.3.2 parse_qs

```
import urllib.parse

print(urllib.parse.parse_qs("q=zen+lang&page=1"))
// {"q": ["zen lang"], "page": ["1"]}

print(urllib.parse.parse_qs("a=1&a=2&b=3"))
// {"a": ["1", "2"], "b": ["3"]}
```

Values are always lists (to support repeated keys).

34.4 33.4 Joining URLs

```
import urllib.parse

let full = urllib.parse.urljoin("https://example.com/base/", "page.html")
print(full)  // https://example.com/page.html

let full2 = urllib.parse.urljoin("https://example.com/base/", "/abs.html")
print(full2)  // https://example.com/abs.html
```

```
import urllib.parse

// Relative to base
print(urllib.parse.urljoin("https://example.com/a/b/", "c.html"))
// https://example.com/a/b/c.html

print(urllib.parse.urljoin("https://example.com/a/b/", "../c.html"))
// https://example.com/a/c.html

print(urllib.parse.urljoin("https://example.com/", "page.html"))
// https://example.com/page.html
```

34.5 33.5 Percent encoding

```
import urllib.parse

let encoded = urllib.parse.quote("hello world")
print(encoded)  // hello%20world

let decoded = urllib.parse.unquote("hello%20world")
print(decoded)  // hello world
```

```
import urllib.parse

print(urllib.parse.quote("hello world"))     # hello%20world
```

```
print(urllib.parse.quote("a/b?c=d&e=f"))     # a%2Fb%3Fc%3De%26f
print(urllib.parse.quote("□□"))             # %E4%B8%AD%E6%96%87

print(urllib.parse.unquote("hello%20world"))   # hello world
print(urllib.parse.unquote("%E4%B8%AD%E6%96%87"))  # □□
```

34.6 33.6 Splitting and joining netloc

```
import urllib.parse

let parts = urllib.parse.splituser("user:pass@example.com:8080")
print(parts)  // ["user:pass", "example.com:8080"]

let splitpass = urllib.parse.splitpasswd("user:pass@example.com:8080")
print(splitpass)  // ["user", "pass@example.com:8080"]

let port = urllib.parse.splitport("example.com:8080")
print(port)  // ["example.com", "8080"]
```

34.7 33.6 Common patterns

34.7.1 Build a search URL

```
import urllib.parse

let base = "https://example.com/search"
let qs = urllib.parse.urlencode({"q": "Zen language", "page": 2})
let url = base + "?" + qs
print(url)  // https://example.com/search?q=Zen+language&page=2
```

34.7.2 Extract domain from URL

```
import urllib.parse

let parts = urllib.parse.urlparse("https://sub.example.com/path")
print(parts.hostname)  // sub.example.com
```

34.7.3 Add a query param to existing URL

```
import urllib.parse

let url = "https://example.com/page?a=1"
let parts = urllib.parse.urlparse(url)
let params = urllib.parse.parse_qs(parts.query)
```

```
params["b"] = ["2"]
let new_qs = urllib.parse.urlencode(params)
let new_url = urllib.parse.urlunparse({
    "scheme": parts.scheme,
    "netloc": parts.netloc,
    "path": parts.path,
    "params": parts.params,
    "query": new_qs,
    "fragment": parts.fragment
})
print(new_url)
```

34.8 33.7 Quick reference

```
import urllib.parse

urllib.parse.urlparse(url)        // parse into parts
urllib.parse.urlunparse(parts)    // build from parts
urllib.parse.urljoin(base, ref)   // resolve relative URL
urllib.parse.urlencode(params)    // encode query string
urllib.parse.parse_qs(qs)         // parse query string
urllib.parse.quote(s)             // percent-encode
urllib.parse.unquote(s)           // percent-decode

let p = urllib.parse.urlparse("https://example.com/path?q=1")
p.scheme      // https
p.netloc      // example.com
p.path        // /path
p.query       // q=1
p.fragment    // (empty)
p.hostname    // example.com
p.port        // (none)
```

34.9 33.8 Exercises

1. Write `extract_domain(url)` that returns the hostname.
2. Write `add_param(url, key, value)` that adds/replaces a query parameter.
3. Write `build_api_url(base, endpoint, params)` that constructs a full API URL.
4. Write `decode_query(qs)` that returns a dict of query parameters.
5. Write `normalize_url(url)` that ensures a scheme and trailing slash.
6. Write `get_query_param(url, key)` that extracts a single query parameter value.
7. Write `merge_url_params(url, params)` that merges new params into existing URL.

34.10 33.12 URL module — deep reference

34.10.1 URL anatomy

```
https://user:pass@example.com:8080/path/to/page?q=1&x=2#section
 \__/   \___/ \_______/ \_______/ \_____/ \______/\______/
scheme  auth     host       port    path   query    fragment
```

34.10.2 Components

Component	Purpose
scheme	protocol (http, https, ftp, ws)
host	domain or IP
port	TCP port (default 80/443)
path	resource path
query	key=value pairs after ?
fragment	anchor after #
username/password	basic auth (deprecated/insecure)

34.10.3 Usage

```
import url
let u = url.parse("https://example.com:8080/path?q=1#sec")
print(u.scheme)    # https
print(u.host)      # example.com
print(u.port)      # 8080
print(u.path)      # /path
print(u.query)     # q=1
print(u.fragment)  # sec

let built = url.build(scheme="https", host="example.com", path="/search", query="q=zen"
print(built)   # https://example.com/search?q=zen

let joined = url.join("https://example.com/base/", "sub/page")
print(joined)  # https://example.com/sub/page

let encoded = url.quote("hello world")
print(encoded)   # hello%20world
let decoded = url.unquote("hello%20world")
print(decoded)   # hello world

let params = url.parse_qs("q=1&x=2&q=3")
print(params)   # #{q: ["1","3"], x: ["2"]}
```

34.10.4 Encoding rules

- `quote`: percent-encode a path segment.

- `quote_plus`: like quote but space → +.
- `unquote`/`unquote_plus`: reverse.

34.10.5 Exercises

1. Parse a URL and print all components.
2. Build a URL from components.
3. Join a base URL with a relative path.
4. Percent-encode/decode a search query.
5. Parse query string into a dict of lists.
6. Write `extract_domain(url)` returning just the host.
7. Write `add_query_param(url, k, v)` adding/updating a param.
8. Explain why & and = need encoding in query values.
9. Write a tiny URL shortener encoder (conceptually).
10. Compare `quote` vs `quote_plus`.

35 Chapter 34: Raw Sockets

The `socket` module provides low-level TCP/UDP/raw sockets, and `net_raw` provides IP/TCP packet construction. This chapter covers raw socket programming and packet crafting.

35.1 34.1 TCP client

```
import socket

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.settimeout(sock, 5000)
socket.connect(sock, "example.com", 80)

socket.send(sock, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\nHost: example.com\r\n\r\n")
let response = socket.recv(sock, 4096)
print(socket.recv_text(sock, 4096))

socket.close(sock)
```

35.1.1 Socket functions

Function	Description
`socket.create(domain, type)`	Create socket, returns handle
`socket.connect(sock, host, port)`	Connect TCP
`socket.bind(sock, host, port)`	Bind to local address
`socket.listen(sock, backlog)`	Listen for connections
`socket.accept(sock)`	Accept incoming connection
`socket.send(sock, data)`	Send data
`socket.recv(sock, n)`	Receive up to n bytes
`socket.recv_text(sock, n)`	Receive text
`socket.recv_from(sock, n)`	Receive from address (UDP)
`socket.send_to(sock, data, host, port)`	Send to address (UDP)
`socket.settimeout(sock, ms)`	Set timeout
`socket.close(sock)`	Close socket
`socket.fileno(sock)`	Get file descriptor

35.1.2 Address families and socket types

Constant	Meaning
`socket.AF_INET`	IPv4
`socket.AF_INET6`	IPv6
`socket.AF_UNIX`	Unix domain sockets
`socket.SOCK_STREAM`	TCP

Constant	Meaning
`socket.SOCK_DGRAM`	UDP
`socket.SOCK_RAW`	Raw IP (requires root)

35.2 34.2 TCP client

```
import socket

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.settimeout(sock, 5000)
socket.connect(sock, "example.com", 80)

socket.send(sock, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\nHost: example.com\r\n\r\n")
let response = socket.recv(sock, 4096)
print(socket.recv_text(sock, 4096))

socket.close(sock)
```

35.2.1 recv returns bytes

`socket.recv` returns a byte list (list of ints 0–255). Use `socket.recv_text` for strings:

```
import socket

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.connect(sock, "example.com", 80)
socket.send(sock, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\n\r\n")

let bytes = socket.recv(sock, 1024)   // list of ints
let text = socket.recv_text(sock, 1024) // string

socket.close(sock)
```

35.3 34.3 TCP server

```
import socket

let server = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.bind(server, "0.0.0.0", 8080)
socket.listen(server, 5)

print("Listening on 0.0.0.0:8080")

let client = socket.accept(server)
let req = socket.recv_text(client, 4096)
print("Request: " + req)
```

```
socket.send(client, "HTTP/1.0 200 OK\r\n\r\nHello")
socket.close(client)
socket.close(server)
```

35.4 34.4 UDP

```
import socket

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_DGRAM)
socket.settimeout(sock, 5000)

socket.send_to(sock, "hello", "127.0.0.1", 9999)

let [data, addr] = socket.recv_from(sock, 4096)
print(data)
print(addr.addr)

socket.close(sock)
```

`recv_from` returns `{data: <bytes>, addr: <ip_string>}`.

35.4.1 UDP server

```
import socket

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_DGRAM)
socket.bind(sock, "0.0.0.0", 9999)

while true {
    let [data, addr] = socket.recv_from(sock, 4096)
    print("From " + addr.addr + ": " + data)
    socket.send_to(sock, "pong", addr.addr, 9999)
}
```

35.5 34.5 Raw sockets and packet crafting (net_raw)

```
import net_raw

// Build an IP packet
let ip_pkt = net_raw.pack_ip("10.0.0.1", "10.0.0.2", 6)  // proto 6 = TCP
print(len(ip_pkt))  // 20 bytes

// Build a TCP segment
let tcp_pkt = net_raw.pack_tcp(12345, 80, "SYN")
print(len(tcp_pkt))  // 20 bytes
```

35.5.1 `pack_ip(src, dst, proto)`

Builds a 20-byte IPv4 header: - `src`, `dst`: IP address strings - `proto`: protocol number (6 = TCP, 17 = UDP, 1 = ICMP)

35.5.2 `pack_tcp(sport, dport, flags)`

Builds a 20-byte TCP header: - `sport`, `dport`: port numbers - `flags`: string containing any of FIN, SYN, RST, PSH, ACK, URG

```
import net_raw

let ip = net_raw.pack_ip("1.2.3.4", "5.6.7.8", 6)
print(len(ip))   // 20

let tcp = net_raw.pack_tcp(12345, 80, "SYN")
print(len(tcp))  // 20

// IPv4 header layout:
// Bytes 0-1: Version/IHL + TOS
// Bytes 2-3: Total length
// Bytes 4-5: Identification
// Bytes 6-7: Flags/Fragment offset
// Byte 8: TTL
// Byte 9: Protocol
// Bytes 10-11: Header checksum
// Bytes 12-15: Source IP
// Bytes 16-19: Destination IP

// TCP header layout:
// Bytes 0-1: Source port
// Bytes 2-3: Dest port
// Bytes 4-7: Sequence number
// Bytes 8-11: Acknowledgment number
// Byte 12: Data offset + reserved
// Byte 13: Flags
// Bytes 14-15: Window size
// Bytes 16-17: Checksum
// Bytes 18-19: Urgent pointer
```

35.5.3 Raw socket flags

```
import net_raw

let syn = net_raw.pack_tcp(12345, 80, "SYN")
let syn_ack = net_raw.pack_tcp(80, 12345, "SYN,ACK")
let ack = net_raw.pack_tcp(80, 12345, "ACK")
```

```
let fin = net_raw.pack_tcp(80, 12345, "FIN,ACK")
let rst = net_raw.pack_tcp(80, 12345, "RST")
```

35.6 34.6 Common patterns

35.6.1 Port scanner

```
import socket

func scan_port(host, port, timeout) {
    try {
        let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
        socket.settimeout(sock, timeout)
        socket.connect(sock, host, port)
        socket.close(sock)
        return true
    } catch {
        return false
    }
}

for port in 1..1024 {
    if scan_port("127.0.0.1", port, 100) {
        print("Port " + str(port) + " is open")
    }
}
```

35.6.2 HTTP client (manual)

```
import socket

func http_get(host, path) {
    let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
    socket.connect(sock, host, 80)

    let request = "GET " + path + " HTTP/1.0\r\nHost: " + host + "\r\n\r\n"
    socket.send(sock, request)

    let response = ""
    while true {
        let chunk = socket.recv_text(sock, 4096)
        if len(chunk) == 0 {
            break
        }
        response = response + chunk
    }
```

```
    socket.close(sock)
    return response
}

print(http_get("example.com", "/"))
```

35.7 34.7 Common pitfalls

- **Always close sockets.** Leaks file descriptors.
- **Set timeouts.** Without timeouts, `connect`/`recv` can block forever.
- **TCP is a stream.** `recv` may return partial data; loop until you have everything.
- **`socket.recv` returns bytes.** Use `recv_text` for strings, or convert manually.
- **UDP is connectionless.** Use `send_to`/`recv_from`, not `connect`/`send`/`recv`.
- **Raw sockets need root** on most OSes for `SOCK_RAW` and packet crafting.

35.8 34.8 Quick reference

```
import socket
import net_raw

let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.connect(sock, "example.com", 80)
socket.send(sock, "GET / HTTP/1.0\r\n\r\n")
let data = socket.recv(sock, 4096)
socket.close(sock)

// UDP
socket.send_to(sock, "data", "127.0.0.1", 9999)
let from = socket.recv_from(sock, 4096)

// Packet crafting
let ip = net_raw.pack_ip("1.2.3.4", "5.6.7.8", 6)
let tcp = net_raw.pack_tcp(1234, 80, "SYN")
```

35.9 34.8 Exercises

1. Write a TCP echo client that sends a line and prints the response.
2. Write a UDP client that sends a datagram and waits for a reply.
3. Write a port scanner for ports 1–1000 on localhost.
4. Build an IP+TCP packet with `net_raw` and inspect the bytes.
5. Write a simple HTTP/0.9 client that fetches the root page.
6. Write a TCP echo server that handles one connection at a time.
7. Write a UDP server that echoes back datagrams.

35.10 34.12 Raw sockets — deep reference

Raw sockets (`AF_PACKET` / `SOCK_RAW`) let you construct and inspect packets at the IP layer and below. Requires privileges (root/admin).

35.10.1 What you can do

- Craft custom IP/TCP/UDP/ICMP headers.
- Receive all packets matching a filter (promiscuous mode).
- Implement ping (ICMP), traceroute, packet inspection.
- Learn networking by building protocols from scratch.

35.10.2 What you should NOT do

- Send spoofed packets on networks you don't own (illegal/unethical).
- Flood or DoS targets.
- Capture traffic on shared networks without permission.

35.10.3 IP header (IPv4, 20 bytes min)

Offset	Field	Size
0	version/IHL, DSCP/ECN	1 byte
1	total length	2 bytes
3	identification	2 bytes
5	flags/fragment offset	2 bytes
7	TTL	1 byte
8	protocol (TCP=6, UDP=17, ICMP=1)	1 byte
9	header checksum	2 bytes
11	source IP	4 bytes
15	destination IP	4 bytes

35.10.4 ICMP echo (ping)

1. Build IP header + ICMP header (type 8 = echo request).
2. Compute ICMP checksum.
3. Send via raw socket.
4. Wait for ICMP type 0 (echo reply).

35.10.5 TCP raw (SYN scan concept)

1. Build TCP header with SYN flag.
2. Send to target port.
3. SYN-ACK = open; RST = closed.

35.10.6 Usage (conceptual pseudocode)

```
import socket
# requires root
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_PACKET, socket.SOCK_RAW, socket.IPPROTO_RAW)
s.bind(("eth0", 0))
let packet = build_ip_packet(dst="93.184.216.34", proto=socket.IPPROTO_ICMP, ...)
s.send(packet)
let data, addr = s.recvfrom(65535)
```

35.10.7 Checksums

Internet checksum: 16-bit one's complement of the sum of 16-bit words. Implemented manually for ICMP/TCP/UDP when the OS doesn't compute them.

35.10.8 Exercises

1. Describe the IPv4 header fields and their sizes.
2. Explain the ICMP echo request/reply flow (ping).
3. Sketch how traceroute works (TTL expiration).
4. List raw socket privileges and risks.
5. Write pseudocode for an ICMP ping.
6. Explain the Internet checksum algorithm.
7. Describe ARP: mapping IP → MAC.
8. Explain promiscuous mode and packet capture.
9. List protocols you can build with raw sockets (ICMP, custom TCP, etc.).
10. Research ethical/legal boundaries of packet crafting.

36 Chapter 68: Networking Deep Dive — Full Packet Trace & Socket Labs

A start-to-finish walkthrough of a single HTTP request as it travels through all 7 OSI layers, followed by hands-on socket programming labs you can type and run.

36.1 68.1 The scenario

You type `https://example.com/` in a browser (or run `zen run httpclient.z`). Here is exactly what happens, layer by layer, from your application down to the wire and back.

36.2 68.2 Layer 7 — Application (HTTP)

The browser builds an HTTP/1.1 request:

```
GET / HTTP/1.1
Host: example.com
User-Agent: ZenBrowser/1.0
Accept: text/html
Connection: keep-alive
```

This is plain text. The application layer does not know about IP addresses, MAC addresses, or Ethernet frames — it only knows HTTP methods, headers, and bodies.

Zen equivalent (raw socket):

```
import socket
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
s.connect(("93.184.216.34", 443))   # example.com (conceptually; real HTTPS uses TLS)
s.send(b"GET / HTTP/1.1\r\nHost: example.com\r\n\r\n")
let response = s.recv(4096)
print(response)
s.close()
```

36.3 68.3 Layer 6 — Presentation

HTTP itself has no presentation sub-layer in practice, but this is where: - Character encoding is handled (UTF-8). - TLS/SSL encryption would happen for HTTPS (here the HTTP payload is encrypted before being handed to TCP). - Compression (gzip) is applied if `Accept-Encoding: gzip` was sent.

For HTTPS, the plaintext HTTP request is encrypted into TLS records at this layer before TCP sees it.

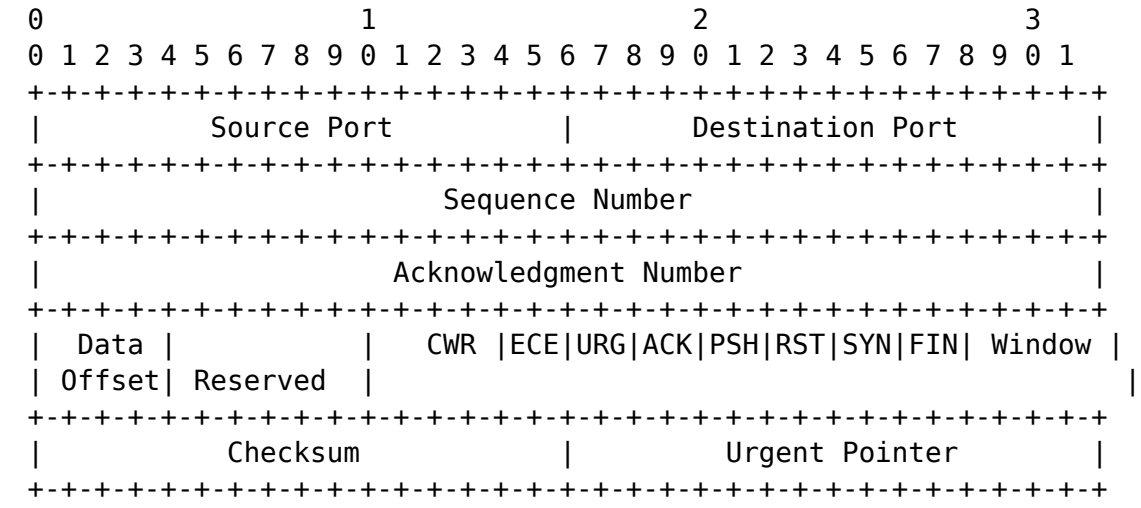
36.4 68.4 Layer 5 — Session

The session layer manages the dialogue: open → exchange → close. For HTTP/1.1 with `keep-alive`, the TCP connection stays open for multiple requests. The browser tracks which responses belong to which requests (especially with pipelining or HTTP/2 multiplexing).

36.5 68.5 Layer 4 — Transport (TCP)

The presentation data (encrypted HTTP for HTTPS, or plain HTTP) is handed to TCP. TCP:

1. Breaks the data into segments (each ≤ MSS, e.g. 1460 bytes over Ethernet).
2. Adds a TCP header (20 bytes minimum):



3. Performs the three-way handshake:
   - Client → Server: `SYN` (synchronize)
   - Server → Client: `SYN-ACK`
   - Client → Server: `ACK`
4. Provides reliable, ordered delivery with retransmission, flow control, and congestion control.

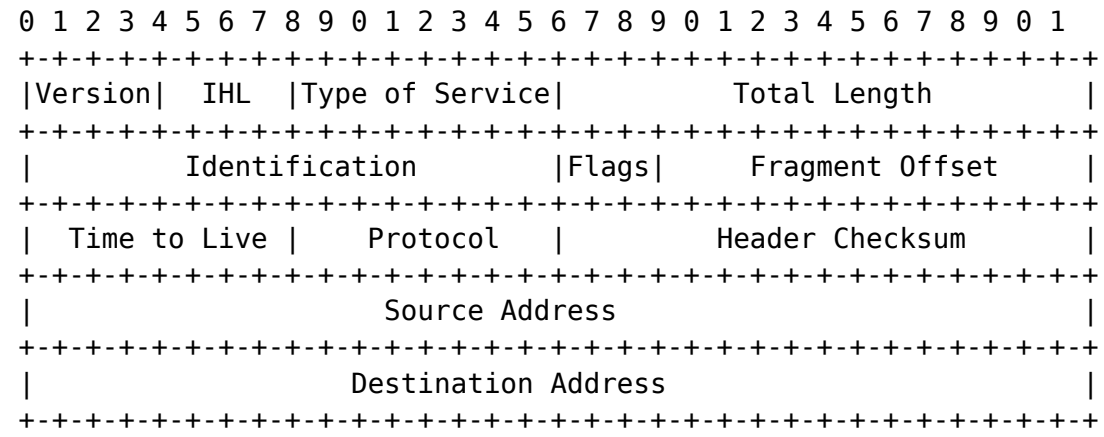
Zen TCP client (connect + send):

```
import socket
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
s.settimeout(5000)
s.connect(("93.184.216.34", 80))
s.send(b"GET / HTTP/1.1\r\nHost: example.com\r\nConnection: close\r\n\r\n")
let data = b""
while true {
    let chunk = s.recv(4096)
    if chunk == nil or len(chunk) == 0 { break }
    data = data + chunk
}
print(data)
s.close()
```

36.6 68.6 Layer 3 — Network (IP)

TCP segments are handed to IP, which: - Adds an IP header (20 bytes minimum):





- Chooses the next-hop router via the routing table.
- Handles fragmentation if a segment exceeds the link MTU.
- Source = your IP (e.g. `192.168.1.42`), Destination = `93.184.216.34`.

IP is unreliable and connectionless — it makes a best-effort attempt and does not guarantee delivery. Reliability is TCP's job (layer 4).

36.7 68.7 Layer 2 — Data Link (Ethernet)

IP packets are encapsulated in Ethernet frames: - Destination MAC (your gateway/router's MAC, learned via ARP). - Source MAC (your network card). - EtherType = `0x0800` (IPv4). - The IP packet becomes the Ethernet frame payload. - Frame Check Sequence (CRC) for error detection.

ARP (Address Resolution Protocol) maps the next-hop IP to a MAC address: - Your machine broadcasts: "Who has 192.168.1.1? Tell 192.168.1.42." - The router replies: "192.168.1.1 is at aa:bb:cc:dd:ee:ff."

36.8 68.8 Layer 1 — Physical

Bits are placed on the physical medium: - Ethernet over twisted pair: electrical voltages. - Wi-Fi: radio waves. - Fiber: light pulses.

The bits travel to your router, then through the ISP's network, across the internet backbone, to the server hosting example.com. At the server, the process unwinds in reverse order (physical → data link → network → transport → session → presentation → application).

36.9 68.9 The return path

The server's response travels back down its own stack, across the internet, and up your machine's stack. The browser renders the HTML, completing the round trip — typically tens to hundreds of milliseconds.

36.10 68.10 Layer summary for an HTTP GET over Ethernet

Layer	Protocol	Unit	Key header fields
7 Application	HTTP	message	method, path, headers
6 Presentation	TLS / encoding	data	encryption, encoding
5 Session	(in TCP)	dialogue	connection lifecycle
4 Transport	TCP	segment	ports, seq, ack, flags
3 Network	IP	packet	src/dst IP, TTL, protocol
2 Data Link	Ethernet	frame	src/dst MAC, EtherType, CRC
1 Physical	Ethernet PHY	bits	voltages/light on wire

36.11 68.11 Socket programming labs

36.11.1 Lab 1: Daytime client (read the time from a server)

```
import socket
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
s.settimeout(5000)
s.connect(("time.nist.gov", 13))   # Daytime protocol (plain text)
let data = s.recv(4096)
print("daytime: " + data)
s.close()
```

36.11.2 Lab 2: Minimal HTTP/1.0 client (raw socket, no TLS)

```
import socket
func http_get(host, path) {
    let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
    s.settimeout(5000)
    s.connect((host, 80))
    let request = "GET " + path + " HTTP/1.0\r\nHost: " + host +
                  "\r\nConnection: close\r\n\r\n"
    s.send(request)
    let data = b""
    while true {
        let chunk = s.recv(4096)
        if chunk == nil or len(chunk) == 0 { break }
        data = data + chunk
    }
    s.close()
    return data
}
let response = http_get("example.com", "/")
print(response[0:500])   # first 500 bytes
```

36.11.3 Lab 3: UDP echo (send/receive datagrams)

UDP has no connection — you `sendto` and `recvfrom`:

```
import socket
# server side
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_DGRAM)
s.bind(("127.0.0.1", 9999))
print("udp echo on 9999")
let (data, addr) = s.recvfrom(4096)
print("received from " + str(addr) + ": " + data)
s.sendto(data, addr)   # echo back
s.close()
```

Client:

```
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_DGRAM)
s.sendto(b"ping", ("127.0.0.1", 9999))
let (data, addr) = s.recvfrom(4096)
print("echo: " + data)
s.close()
```

36.11.4 Lab 4: Port scanner (educational, localhost only)

```
import socket
func is_open(host, port) {
    let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
    s.settimeout(500)
    try {
        s.connect((host, port))
        s.close()
        return true
    } catch as e {
        s.close()
        return false
    }
}
for p in 1->1024 {
    if is_open("127.0.0.1", p) {
        print("open: " + str(p))
    }
}
```

Only scan hosts you own or have permission to test.

36.11.5 Lab 5: Raw ICMP ping concept (requires root/admin)

Raw sockets let you construct ICMP packets directly:

```
import socket
# requires root/administrator privileges
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_PACKET, socket.SOCK_RAW, socket.IPPROTO_ICMP)
```

```
# construct IP header + ICMP echo request, compute checksum, send, wait for reply
```

Raw sockets are powerful but dangerous — never send spoofed or flood traffic on networks you don’t own.

36.12 68.12 Troubleshooting socket code

Symptom	Cause	Fix
Connection refused	Nothing listening	start server; check port
Address already in use	previous TIME_WAIT	set SO_REUSEADDR
recv returns empty bytes	peer closed	check for nil/empty, close
send breaks pipe	peer closed already	catch BrokenPipe
DNS fails	resolver issue	try IP directly; check /etc/resolv.conf
Timeout	no response / firewall	increase timeout; check connectivity

36.13 68.13 Exercises

1. Trace an HTTPS request: where does encryption happen (layer 6)?
2. Write a raw TCP client that speaks HTTP/1.0 and prints the status line.
3. Extend Lab 3 (UDP echo) to handle multiple clients.
4. Draw the full header stack (Ethernet + IP + TCP + HTTP) with byte offsets.
5. Explain why ARP is needed between layers 3 and 2.
6. Implement `recv_until(sock, delimiter)` reading byte-by-byte.
7. Build a tiny chat client using Lab 2’s pattern.

37 Chapter 35: Threading Fundamentals

Zen supports OS threads via the `thread` module. Threads run concurrently (subject to the OS scheduler) and communicate through `shared` atomic values and `channel` message passing.

37.1 35.1 The `thread` module

```
import thread

func worker(name) {
    print("Worker " + name + " starting")
    return "done: " + name
}

let t = thread.spawn(worker("A"))
let result = thread.join(t)
print(result)  # done: A

print(thread.current())  # current thread info (nil or handle)
```

37.1.1 Thread functions

Function	Description	Example
`thread.spawn(func)`	Start `func` in a new thread	`thread.spawn(worker)`
`thread.join(thread)`	Wait for thread, get return value	`thread.join(t)`
`thread.current()`	Current thread info	`thread.current()`

```
import thread

func count(n) {
    let total = 0
    for i in 1..n {
        total = total + i
    }
    return total
}

let t = thread.spawn(count(100))
let result = thread.join(t)
print(result)  # 5050
```

37.2 35.2 Thread lifecycle

```
import thread

func slow() {
    // simulate work
    return "finished"
}

let t = thread.spawn(slow)

// Do other work in main thread...

let result = thread.join(t)  // blocks until slow() returns
print(result)
```

`thread.join` blocks the calling thread until the target thread completes, then returns the target's return value. If the target raised an error, `join` propagates it.

```
import thread

func failing() {
    throw "boom"
}

let t = thread.spawn(failing)
try {
    thread.join(t)
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)  # boom
}
```

37.3 35.3 Thread-local data

Variables created inside a thread function are local to that thread:

```
import thread

func worker() {
    let local = "only in this thread"
    print(local)
}

let t = thread.spawn(worker)
thread.join(t)
// local is not accessible here
```

To share data between threads, use `shared` (atomic values) or `channel` (message passing).

37.4 35.3 Multiple threads

```
import thread

func worker(id) {
    print("Worker " + str(id) + " started")
    return "worker " + str(id) + " done"
}

let threads = []
for i in 1..5 {
    let t = thread.spawn(worker(i))
    threads.push(t)
}

for t in threads {
    let result = thread.join(t)
    print(result)
}
print("All workers done")
```

37.5 35.4 Common pitfalls

- **`thread.join` blocks.** Join all threads before your program exits, or their work may be cut short.
- **Exceptions propagate.** If a thread function raises, `thread.join` re-raises it in the joining thread.
- **No shared state by default.** Each thread has its own stack and locals. Use `shared` or `channel` to communicate.
- **Thread count.** Don't spawn more threads than necessary; OS threads are relatively heavyweight.

37.6 35.5 Quick reference

```
import thread

let t = thread.spawn(func() { return "result" })
let result = thread.join(t)
let cur = thread.current()
```

37.7 35.6 Exercises

1. Write a program that spawns 5 threads, each printing its ID, and joins them all.
2. Write `parallel_sum(nums)` that splits a list into chunks, sums each chunk in a thread, and combines results.
3. Write a thread that sleeps for 1 second then prints "done".
4. Demonstrate that `thread.join` propagates errors from the child thread.

5. Write a function `run_concurrent(funcs)` that runs a list of zero-arg functions in threads and returns their results in order.

37.8 Extended Content

This section provides additional depth, patterns, debugging tips, and exercises for production use.

37.8.1 Common pitfalls

- Race conditions
- Deadlocks (circular wait)
- Starvation
- Data races
- Forgetting to join threads

37.8.2 Debugging concurrent code

- Use logging with thread identifiers
- Test with different interleavings
- Consider thread sanitizers conceptually
- Design for thread safety from start

37.8.3 Exercises

1. Producer-consumer with channels
2. Thread pool pattern
3. Parallel map/reduce
4. Avoiding deadlocks with lock ordering
5. Thread-safe cache
6. Benchmark sequential vs parallel

37.9 35.12 Worked examples — threading

37.9.1 Example 1: Basic thread creation and join

```
import threading

func worker(name) {
    print("Thread ${name} starting")
    # simulate work
    for i in 0..3 {
        print("${name} tick ${i}")
    }
    print("Thread ${name} finished")
}
```

```
let t1 = threading.Thread(fn() { worker("A") })
let t2 = threading.Thread(fn() { worker("B") })
t1.start()
t2.start()
t1.join()
t2.join()
print("both threads done")
```

Expected output (order may vary):

```
Thread A starting
Thread B starting
A tick 0
B tick 0
...
both threads done
```

37.9.2 Example 2: Sharing data — the race condition

```
import threading

var shared_counter = 0

func increment(times) {
    var shared_counter = shared_counter   # read global
    for i in 0..times {
        shared_counter = shared_counter + 1   # NOT atomic!
    }
}

let t1 = threading.Thread(fn() { increment(100000) })
let t2 = threading.Thread(fn() { increment(100000) })
t1.start()
t2.start()
t1.join()
t2.join()
print(shared_counter)   # likely LESS than 200000 — race condition!
```

Why: read-modify-write is not atomic. Two threads read the same value, both add 1, and one update is lost.

37.9.3 Example 3: Fix with a mutex (see Chapter 37)

Use `mutexes.Mutex` to guard the counter (full example in 37.12).

37.9.4 Example 4: Daemon threads

Daemon threads are killed when the main program exits.

```
let t = threading.Thread(fn() {
    while true { print("background..."); sleep(1000) }
})
t.daemon = true
t.start()
print("main exits; daemon thread dies")
```

37.9.5 Example 5: Thread-local storage

Each thread gets its own copy of a value.

```
let local = threading.local()

func worker() {
    local.value = threading.current_id()
    print("thread sees value " + str(local.value))
}
```

37.10 35.13 Common threading bugs

1. **Race condition:** unsynchronized read-modify-write → lost updates.
2. **Deadlock:** two threads each hold a lock the other needs → both wait forever. Fix: always acquire locks in the same order.
3. **Livelock:** threads keep retrying but make no progress.
4. **Starvation:** a thread never gets CPU/lock access.
5. **Forgetting `join`:** main exits before workers finish → partial output.
6. **Modifying shared collections without a lock.**
7. **Holding a lock too long** → poor concurrency.
8. **Calling code that blocks while holding a lock.**

37.11 35.14 Debugging threaded programs

- Log with a thread identifier so you can tell which thread printed what.
- Reproduce races by running many iterations; races are timing-dependent.
- Use `shared` for cross-thread state rather than plain globals.
- Keep critical sections small.
- Prefer message passing (channels) over shared memory when possible.

37.12 35.15 Exercises

1. Create 5 threads that each print their ID 3 times; join all.
2. Write a function `run_parallel(fns)` that starts a thread per function and joins all.
3. Demonstrate the race counter example and confirm the result < expected.
4. Fix the race counter using a mutex.
5. Write a daemon thread that prints every second; let main exit.
6. Implement `sum_parallel(list)` splitting work across N threads and merging.

7. Write `thread_id()` printing `threading.current_id()`.
8. Simulate a bank account with deposit/transfer from multiple threads.
9. Show what happens if you join a thread twice (error? no-op?).
10. Benchmark a CPU-heavy task sequential vs 2 threads.

38 Chapter 36: Channels

Channels send values between threads. A channel is created, values are sent into it, and received from it on the other end. Channels are unbuffered — `send` blocks until a `recv` is waiting, and vice versa.

38.1 36.1 The `channel` module

```
import channel

let ch = channel.make()

channel.send(ch, "hello")
channel.send(ch, 42)
channel.send(ch, true)

print(channel.recv(ch))  # hello
print(channel.recv(ch))  # 42
print(channel.recv(ch))  # true
```

38.1.1 Channel functions

Function	Description	Example
`channel.make()`	Create a new channel	`channel.make()`
`channel.send(ch, value)`	Send a value (blocks until received)	`channel.send(ch, 42)`
`channel.recv(ch)`	Receive a value (blocks until sent)	`channel.recv(ch)`

```
import channel

let ch = channel.make()

channel.send(ch, "first")
channel.send(ch, "second")
channel.send(ch, "third")

print(channel.recv(ch))  # first
print(channel.recv(ch))  # second
print(channel.recv(ch))  # third
```

38.2 36.2 Blocking semantics

Channels are unbuffered and synchronous:

- `send(ch, v)` blocks until some thread calls `recv(ch)`.

- `recv(ch)` blocks until some thread calls `send(ch, v)`.
- The value is handed directly from sender to receiver.

```
import channel
import thread

let ch = channel.make()

// Sender thread
thread.spawn(fn() {
    channel.send(ch, "ping")
    print("sent")
})

// Receiver (main thread)
let msg = channel.recv(ch)
print("received: " + msg)  // received: ping
```

38.3 36.3 Producer-consumer

```
import channel
import thread

let ch = channel.make()

func producer() {
    for i in 1..5 {
        channel.send(ch, i)
        print("produced: " + str(i))
    }
    channel.send(ch, nil)  // sentinel: done
}

func consumer() {
    while true {
        let v = channel.recv(ch)
        if v == nil {
            break
        }
        print("consumed: " + str(v))
    }
}

let t1 = thread.spawn(producer)
let t2 = thread.spawn(consumer)
thread.join(t1)
thread.join(t2)
```

```
print("all done")
```

Output:

```
produced: 1
consumed: 1
produced: 2
consumed: 2
...
produced: 5
consumed: 5
all done
```

38.4 36.4 Multiple producers and consumers

```
import channel
import thread

let ch = channel.make()

func producer(id, count) {
    for i in 1..count {
        channel.send(ch, #(id, i))
    }
}

func consumer(id) {
    while true {
        let v = channel.recv(ch)
        if v == nil {
            break
        }
        print("consumer " + str(id) + " got: " + str(v[1]))
    }
}

// Start 2 producers
thread.spawn(producer(1, 3))
thread.spawn(producer(2, 3))

// Send 2 sentinels (one per consumer)
channel.send(ch, nil)
channel.send(ch, nil)

// Start 2 consumers
thread.spawn(consumer(1))
thread.spawn(consumer(2))
```

38.5 36.5 Channels and shared values

Use `shared` for counters, `channel` for message passing:

```
import channel
import shared
import thread

let ch = channel.make()
let counter = shared.create(0)

func worker(id) {
    for i in 1..10 {
        shared.increment(counter, 1)
        channel.send(ch, #(id, i))
    }
}

let t1 = thread.spawn(worker(1))
let t2 = thread.spawn(worker(2))

// Collect results
for i in 1..20 {
    let v = channel.recv(ch)
    print("got: " + str(v))
}

thread.join(t1)
thread.join(t2)
print("counter: " + str(shared.get(counter)))  # 20
```

38.6 36.6 Common pitfalls

- **`recv` blocks forever** if no value is ever sent. Always ensure a sender exists, or use a sentinel value (like `nil`) to signal completion.
- **`send` blocks forever** if no receiver is waiting.
- **Channels are unbuffered.** There's no queue — sender and receiver must rendezvous.
- **Forgetting to join threads.** The program may exit before threads finish sending.

38.7 36.7 Quick reference

```
import channel

let ch = channel.make()
channel.send(ch, "msg")
let v = channel.recv(ch)
```

```
// Producer-consumer pattern
channel.send(ch, nil)  // sentinel to signal completion
```

38.8 36.8 Exercises

1. Write a program with 1 producer and 1 consumer using a channel.
2. Write a program with 2 producers and 1 consumer.
3. Write `parallel_map(func, items)` that runs `func` on each item in a thread and sends results via a channel.
4. Write a pipeline: stage1 generates numbers, stage2 squares them, stage3 prints them. Connect stages with channels.
5. Write a program where multiple workers pull jobs from a channel channel and send results to another channel.

38.9 Extended Content

This section provides additional depth, patterns, debugging tips, and exercises for production use.

38.9.1 Common pitfalls

- Race conditions
- Deadlocks (circular wait)
- Starvation
- Data races
- Forgetting to join threads

38.9.2 Debugging concurrent code

- Use logging with thread identifiers
- Test with different interleavings
- Consider thread sanitizers conceptually
- Design for thread safety from start

38.9.3 Exercises

1. Producer-consumer with channels
2. Thread pool pattern
3. Parallel map/reduce
4. Avoiding deadlocks with lock ordering
5. Thread-safe cache
6. Benchmark sequential vs parallel

38.10 36.12 Worked examples — channels

Channels are the “share memory by communicating” primitive.

38.10.1 Example 1: Basic send/recv

```
import channels

let ch = channels.Channel()

func producer() {
    for i in 0..5 {
        ch.send(i)
        print("sent ${i}")
    }
    ch.close()
}

func consumer() {
    while true {
        let v = ch.recv()
        if v == nil { break }   # channel closed and empty
        print("received ${v}")
    }
}

let tp = threading.Thread(fn() { producer() })
let tc = threading.Thread(fn() { consumer() })
tp.start()
tc.start()
tp.join()
tc.join()
print("done")
```

38.10.2 Example 2: Producer-consumer with buffered channel

```
let ch = channels.Channel(buffered=true, capacity=10)
# producer can send up to `capacity` items without blocking
```

38.10.3 Example 3: Multiple consumers (worker pool)

```
let jobs = channels.Channel()
let results = channels.Channel()

func worker(id) {
    while true {
        let job = jobs.recv()
        if job == nil { break }
        let out = job * job
        results.send(#(id, out))
```

```
    }
}

# start 4 workers
for i in 0..4 {
    threading.Thread(fn() { worker(i) }).start()
}

# send 20 jobs
for i in 0..20 { jobs.send(i) }
jobs.close()

# collect 20 results
for i in 0..20 {
    let r = results.recv()
    print("worker ${r[0]} -> ${r[1]}")
}
results.close()
```

38.10.4 Example 4: select-like multiplexing

Zen may not have a built-in `select`; emulate by checking channels in a loop or using a dedicated multiplexer. Conceptually:

```
# wait on the first ready channel
```

38.11 36.13 Channel patterns

Pattern	Use
One producer, one consumer	simple pipeline
One producer, many consumers	fan-out / work distribution
Many producers, one consumer	aggregation / logging
Request-response	send request on ch1, receive reply on ch2
Pipeline	stage A → ch1 → stage B → ch2 → stage C

38.12 36.14 Common channel bugs

1. **Forgetting to close** → consumers block forever on recv.
2. **Sending on a closed channel** → error.
3. **Unbuffered channel rendezvous** → sender blocks until receiver ready.
4. **Deadlock** → both sides waiting to send/recv with no progress.
5. **Not draining** → producer blocks, pipeline stalls.

38.13 36.15 Exercises

1. Build a channel, send 10 numbers, receive and sum them.

2. Implement producer-consumer: producer sends 1..100, consumer sums.
3. Create a worker pool of 4 workers processing a job queue.
4. Implement a request-response channel pair.
5. Build a 3-stage pipeline (parse → transform → write) with channels.
6. Demonstrate what happens when you recv from an empty closed channel.
7. Implement `fan_in(ch1, ch2)` merging two channels into one.
8. Write a broadcast: one sender, three receivers all getting each value.
9. Implement a bounded buffer with a channel.
10. Simulate a chat room: multiple clients send messages to one channel.

39 Chapter 37: Mutexes & Synchronization

Zen provides two synchronization primitives for concurrent programming: `shared` (atomic shared values) and `channel` (message passing between threads). Together they let you write safe multi-threaded programs without manual locks.

39.1 37.1 The `shared` module — atomic shared values

```
import shared

# Create a shared integer counter
let counter = shared.create(0)

# Read the current value
print(shared.get(counter))   # 0

# Set a new value
shared.set(counter, 5)
print(shared.get(counter))   # 5

# Atomic increment (returns the new value)
shared.increment(counter, 1)
print(shared.get(counter))   # 6

shared.increment(counter, 10)
print(shared.get(counter))   # 16
```

39.1.1 Shared functions

Function	Description	Example
`shared.create(value)`	Create a shared atomic value	`shared.create(0)`
`shared.get(shared)`	Read current value	`shared.get(counter)`
`shared.set(shared, value)`	Set a new value	`shared.set(counter, 5)`
`shared.increment(shared, delta)`	Add delta, return new value	`shared.increment(counter, 1)`

Shared values are safe to read and write from multiple threads — operations are atomic, so there are no torn reads or races on the value itself.

```
import shared
import thread

let counter = shared.create(0)

func worker(id) {
```

```
    for i in 1..100 {
        shared.increment(counter, 1)
    }
    print("worker " + str(id) + " done")
}

let threads = []
for i in 1..5 {
    let t = thread.spawn(worker(i))
    threads.push(t)
}

for t in threads {
    thread.join(t)
}

print(shared.get(counter))  # 500 (5 workers × 100 increments)
```

Because `shared.increment` is atomic, the final count is exactly 500 — no lost updates even with 5 threads incrementing concurrently.

39.2 37.2 The `channel` module — message passing

Channels send values between threads. A channel is created, values are sent into it, and received from it on the other end.

```
import channel

let ch = channel.make()

channel.send(ch, "hello")
channel.send(ch, 42)
channel.send(ch, true)

print(channel.recv(ch))  # hello
print(channel.recv(ch))  # 42
print(channel.recv(ch))  # true
```

39.2.1 Channel functions

Function	Description	Example
`channel.make()`	Create a new channel	`channel.make()`
`channel.send(ch, value)`	Send a value	`channel.send(ch, 42)`
`channel.recv(ch)`	Receive a value (blocks)	`channel.recv(ch)`

`recv` blocks until a value is available, making channels useful for coordinating work

between threads.

39.3 37.3 Threads: `thread` module

```
import thread

func worker(name) {
    print("Worker " + name + " starting")
    return "done: " + name
}

let t = thread.spawn(worker("A"))
let result = thread.join(t)
print(result)  # done: A

print(thread.current())  # nil or current thread info
```

39.3.1 Thread functions

Function	Description	Example
`thread.spawn(func)`	Start a function in a thread	`thread.spawn(worker)`
`thread.join(thread)`	Wait for thread, get result	`thread.join(t)`
`thread.current()`	Current thread info	`thread.current()`

39.4 37.4 Producer-consumer with channels

```
import channel
import thread

let ch = channel.make()

func producer() {
    for i in 1..5 {
        channel.send(ch, i)
        print("produced: " + str(i))
    }
    channel.send(ch, nil)  // sentinel: done
}

func consumer() {
    while true {
        let v = channel.recv(ch)
        if v == nil {
            break
        }
```

```
        print("consumed: " + str(v))
    }
}

let t1 = thread.spawn(producer)
let t2 = thread.spawn(consumer)
thread.join(t1)
thread.join(t2)
print("all done")
```

39.5 37.5 Shared counter across threads

```
import shared
import thread

let counter = shared.create(0)

func worker(id) {
    for i in 1..100 {
        shared.increment(counter, 1)
    }
    print("worker " + str(id) + " done")
}

let threads = []
for i in 1..5 {
    let t = thread.spawn(worker(i))
    threads.push(t)
}

for t in threads {
    thread.join(t)
}

print(shared.get(counter))  # 500 (5 workers × 100 increments)
```

Because `shared.increment` is atomic, the final count is exactly 500 — no lost updates even with 5 threads incrementing concurrently.

39.6 37.6 Common patterns

39.6.1 Guarded shutdown flag

```
import shared
import thread
```

```
let running = shared.create(true)

func worker() {
    while shared.get(running) {
        # do work
    }
    print("worker stopped")
}

let t = thread.spawn(worker)
// ... later ...
shared.set(running, false)
thread.join(t)
```

39.6.2 Work queue with channel

```
import channel
import thread

let queue = channel.make()

func dispatcher(jobs) {
    for job in jobs {
        channel.send(queue, job)
    }
    channel.send(queue, nil)  // done
}

func worker(queue) {
    while true {
        let job = channel.recv(queue)
        if job == nil { break }
        print("processing: " + str(job))
    }
}

let jobs = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8]
let td = thread.spawn(dispatcher(jobs))
let tw1 = thread.spawn(worker(queue))
let tw2 = thread.spawn(worker(queue))
thread.join(td)
thread.join(tw1)
thread.join(tw2)
```

39.7 37.8 Common pitfalls

- **`recv` blocks forever** if no value is ever sent. Always ensure a sender exists, or use a sentinel value (like `nil`) to signal completion.
- **`shared` values are atomic individually**, but compound operations (read-then-write) are not atomic. Use `increment` instead of `get`+`set`+counter when you need to add.
- **`join` blocks** until the thread finishes. Join all threads before your program exits, or their work may be cut short.
- **Channels are unbuffered.** `send` blocks until a `recv` is waiting, and `recv` blocks until a `send` happens.

39.8 37.9 Quick reference

```
import shared
import channel
import thread

# Shared atomic values
let c = shared.create(0)
shared.get(c)
shared.set(c, 10)
shared.increment(c, 1)

# Channels
let ch = channel.make()
channel.send(ch, "msg")
channel.recv(ch)

# Threads
let t = thread.spawn(func() { return "result" })
thread.join(t)
thread.current()
```

39.9 37.10 Exercises

1. Write a program that spawns 5 threads, each incrementing a shared counter 1000 times, and verify the final count is 5000.
2. Use a channel to implement a producer-consumer with 2 producers and 1 consumer.
3. Write a `parallel_map(func, items)` that runs `func` on each item in a separate thread and collects results via a channel.
4. Use a shared boolean flag to gracefully stop a background thread.
5. Write a thread-safe counter class using `shared.create` and methods.

39.10 Extended Content

This section provides additional depth, patterns, debugging tips, and exercises for production use.

39.10.1 Common pitfalls

- Race conditions
- Deadlocks (circular wait)
- Starvation
- Data races
- Forgetting to join threads

39.10.2 Debugging concurrent code

- Use logging with thread identifiers
- Test with different interleavings
- Consider thread sanitizers conceptually
- Design for thread safety from start

39.10.3 Exercises

1. Producer-consumer with channels
2. Thread pool pattern
3. Parallel map/reduce
4. Avoiding deadlocks with lock ordering
5. Thread-safe cache
6. Benchmark sequential vs parallel

39.11 37.12 Worked examples — mutexes and locks

39.11.1 Example 1: Fixing the race counter with a Mutex

```
import threading
import mutexes

var counter = 0
let mu = mutexes.Mutex()

func increment(times) {
    for i in 0..times {
        mu.lock()
        counter = counter + 1
        mu.unlock()
    }
}

let t1 = threading.Thread(fn() { increment(100000) })
```

```
let t2 = threading.Thread(fn() { increment(100000) })
t1.start()
t2.start()
t1.join()
t2.join()
print(counter)   # 200000 — correct!
```

39.11.2 Example 2: Lock with try/finally (always unlock)

```
func safe_increment() {
    mu.lock()
    try {
        counter = counter + 1
    } finally {
        mu.unlock()
    }
}
```

39.11.3 Example 3: Deadlock — and how to avoid it

```
# BAD: potential deadlock
let mu1 = mutexes.Mutex()
let mu2 = mutexes.Mutex()

func thread_a() {
    mu1.lock()
    mu2.lock()   # if thread_b holds mu2 and waits for mu1 -> deadlock
    ...
    mu2.unlock()
    mu1.unlock()
}

func thread_b() {
    mu2.lock()
    mu1.lock()   # opposite order!
    ...
    mu1.unlock()
    mu2.unlock()
}
```

Fix: Always acquire locks in the same global order (mu1 before mu2).

```
# GOOD
func thread_b_fixed() {
    mu1.lock()   # same order as thread_a
    mu2.lock()
```

```
    ...
    mu2.unlock()
    mu1.unlock()
}
```

39.11.4 Example 4: Read-write pattern (conceptual)

If your build has `RWMutex`, multiple readers can hold it simultaneously, but a writer needs exclusive access. Otherwise, use a plain Mutex for all access.

39.12 37.13 Locking guidelines

1. **Lock order:** global, consistent order prevents deadlocks.
2. **Fine-grained locks:** lock only what's necessary; don't lock the whole data structure for a small update.
3. **Short critical sections:** minimize work inside `lock/unlock`.
4. **Never call blocking code** (sleep, network) while holding a lock.
5. **Use `finally`** to guarantee unlock even on error.
6. **Prefer channels** over shared+lock when the design allows.

39.13 37.14 Exercises

1. Protect a shared counter with a Mutex; verify exact final value.
2. Implement a thread-safe stack using a Mutex and a list.
3. Implement a thread-safe cache (dict + Mutex) with get/put.
4. Demonstrate deadlock with two locks in opposite order, then fix it.
5. Write `with_lock(mu, fn)` that locks, runs fn, unlocks in finally.
6. Protect a shared bank account: deposit/transfer from many threads.
7. Implement `increment_n(mu, counter, n)` using lock/unlock.
8. Show that reading without a lock can see torn/stale values (conceptually).
9. Implement a thread-safe counter class wrapping Mutex + int.
10. Benchmark locked vs unlocked (single-threaded) to measure lock cost.

40 Chapter 38: Thread Safety & Patterns

This chapter covers practical thread-safe patterns: worker pools, reader-writer scenarios, producer-consumer pipelines, and avoiding common concurrency bugs.

40.1 38.1 Worker pool pattern

A fixed number of worker threads pull jobs from a shared channel:

```
import channel
import thread

let job_queue = channel.make()
let results = channel.make()

func worker(id) {
    while true {
        let job = channel.recv(job_queue)
        if job == nil {
            break  # sentinel: shutdown
        }
        let result = job * job  # some work
        channel.send(results, [id, result])
    }
}

func dispatcher(jobs) {
    for j in jobs {
        channel.send(job_queue, j)
    }
    # Send one sentinel per worker
    for i in 1..4 {
        channel.send(job_queue, nil)
    }
}

// Start 4 workers
for i in 1..4 {
    thread.spawn(worker(i))
}

let jobs = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10]
thread.spawn(dispatcher(jobs))

// Collect results
let completed = 0
while completed < len(jobs) {
    let r = channel.recv(results)
```

```
    print("worker " + str(r[0]) + " -> " + str(r[1]))
    completed = completed + 1
}
print("all jobs done")
```

40.2 38.2 Pipeline pattern

Chain stages where each stage is a thread:

```
import channel
import thread

let stage1_out = channel.make()
let stage2_out = channel.make()

func stage1() {
    for i in 1..10 {
        channel.send(stage1_out, i * 2)
    }
    channel.send(stage1_out, nil)
}

func stage2() {
    while true {
        let v = channel.recv(stage1_out)
        if v == nil {
            channel.send(stage2_out, nil)
            break
        }
        channel.send(stage2_out, v + 10)
    }
}

func stage3() {
    while true {
        let v = channel.recv(stage2_out)
        if v == nil { break }
        print("final: " + str(v))
    }
}

thread.spawn(stage1)
thread.spawn(stage2)
thread.spawn(stage3)
```

40.3 38.3 Reader-writer pattern with shared flag

```
import shared
import thread

let active = shared.create(true)

func reader(id) {
    while shared.get(active) {
        # read shared resource
    }
    print("reader " + str(id) + " stopping")
}

func writer() {
    # do some writes
    shared.set(active, false)  # signal shutdown
}

let r1 = thread.spawn(reader(1))
let r2 = thread.spawn(reader(2))
let w = thread.spawn(writer)
thread.join(w)
thread.join(r1)
thread.join(r2)
```

40.4 38.4 Avoiding deadlocks

Deadlocks happen when two threads each wait for the other. Prevention rules:

1. **Always acquire resources in the same order.**
2. **Don’t hold a resource while waiting for another.**
3. **Use timeouts where possible.**
4. **Keep critical sections small.**

Bad (potential deadlock):

```
// Thread A: lock A, then wait for B
// Thread B: lock B, then wait for A
```

Good (consistent order):

```
// Both threads: lock A, then lock B
```

40.5 38.5 Avoiding race conditions

A race condition is when the outcome depends on thread timing. Prevention:

1. **Use `shared` for atomic counters** — `shared.increment` instead of `get`+`set`.
2. **Use channels to hand off ownership** — send a value, don’t share it.

3. **Don’t share mutable state** between threads unless protected.

Bad (race):

```
let count = 0  # not shared — each thread may see its own copy
func bad_worker() {
    for i in 1..100 {
        count = count + 1  # RACE: lost updates
    }
}
```

Good (atomic):

```
import shared
let count = shared.create(0)
func good_worker() {
    for i in 1..100 {
        shared.increment(count, 1)
    }
}
```

40.6 38.6 Thread-local data

Each thread has its own stack and locals. Variables created inside a thread function are not visible to other threads unless shared via `shared` or `channel`:

```
import thread

func worker() {
    let local = "only in this thread"  # thread-local
    print(local)
}

let t = thread.spawn(worker)
thread.join(t)
// print(local)  # error: local not defined here
```

40.7 38.7 Common patterns summary

Pattern	Use when	Primitive
Worker pool	Many small tasks	channel + thread.spawn
Pipeline	Sequential stages	channels chained
Producer-consumer	One produces, another consumes	channel
Shared counter	Statistics, progress	shared.create/increment
Shutdown flag	Coordinate exit	shared.create/set/get

40.8 38.8 Quick reference

```
import shared
import channel
import thread

# Worker pool
let q = channel.make()
for i in jobs { channel.send(q, i) }
for i in 1..N { channel.send(q, nil) }
for i in 1..N { thread.spawn(worker(i)) }

# Atomic counter
let c = shared.create(0)
shared.increment(c, 1)
shared.get(c)

# Join all threads
for t in threads { thread.join(t) }
```

40.9 38.9 Exercises

1. Write a worker pool with 4 workers processing a list of URLs (simulated).
2. Implement a 3-stage pipeline: generate → transform → print.
3. Write a `parallel_map` that runs a function on each item concurrently.
4. Use a shared flag to stop all workers when one encounters an error.
5. Write a program that counts lines across multiple "files" (lists) in parallel threads and sums the total.

40.10 Extended Content

This section provides additional depth, patterns, debugging tips, and exercises for production use.

40.10.1 Common pitfalls

- Race conditions
- Deadlocks (circular wait)
- Starvation
- Data races
- Forgetting to join threads

40.10.2 Debugging concurrent code

- Use logging with thread identifiers
- Test with different interleavings
- Consider thread sanitizers conceptually

- Design for thread safety from start

40.10.3 Exercises

1. Producer-consumer with channels
2. Thread pool pattern
3. Parallel map/reduce
4. Avoiding deadlocks with lock ordering
5. Thread-safe cache
6. Benchmark sequential vs parallel

40.11 38.12 Worked examples — thread safety patterns

40.11.1 Example 1: Producer-consumer with channel + mutex

```
import threading, channels, mutexes

let buffer = channels.Channel(capacity=5)
let mu = mutexes.Mutex()
var produced = 0
var consumed = 0

func producer() {
    for i in 0..20 {
        buffer.send(i)
        mu.lock(); produced = produced + 1; mu.unlock()
        print("produced ${i}")
    }
    buffer.close()
}

func consumer() {
    while true {
        let v = buffer.recv()
        if v == nil { break }
        mu.lock(); consumed = consumed + 1; mu.unlock()
        print("consumed ${v}")
    }
}

let tp = threading.Thread(fn() { producer() })
let tc = threading.Thread(fn() { consumer() })
tp.start()
tc.start()
tp.join()
tc.join()
print("produced=${produced} consumed=${consumed}")
```

40.11.2 Example 2: Thread-safe lazy initialization (double-checked locking)

```
import mutexes

let init_mu = mutexes.Mutex()
var instance = nil
var initialized = false

func get_instance() {
    if initialized { return instance }
    init_mu.lock()
    try {
        if !initialized {
            instance = #(value: 42)
            initialized = true
        }
    } finally {
        init_mu.unlock()
    }
    return instance
}
```

40.11.3 Example 3: Thread pool (fixed number of workers)

```
import threading, channels

func thread_pool(num_workers, jobs) {
    let job_ch = channels.Channel()
    let result_ch = channels.Channel()
    let done = channels.Channel()

    for w in 0..num_workers {
        threading.Thread(fn() {
            while true {
                let job = job_ch.recv()
                if job == nil { break }
                let r = job * job
                result_ch.send(r)
            }
            done.send(nil)
        }).start()
    }

    for j in jobs { job_ch.send(j) }
    job_ch.close()
    # wait for all workers to finish
    for w in 0..num_workers { done.recv() }
```

```
    result_ch.close()
    return result_ch   # caller drains results
}
```

40.11.4 Example 4: Parallel map

```
func parallel_map(xs, f, num_workers) {
    let results = channels.Channel(capacity=len(xs))
    let job_ch = channels.Channel()
    let done = channels.Channel()

    for w in 0..num_workers {
        threading.Thread(fn() {
            while true {
                let item = job_ch.recv()
                if item == nil { break }
                results.send(f(item))
            }
            done.send(nil)
        }).start()
    }

    for x in xs { job_ch.send(x) }
    job_ch.close()
    for w in 0..num_workers { done.recv() }
    results.close()

    let out = []
    while true {
        let r = results.recv()
        if r == nil { break }
        out.push(r)
    }
    return out
}

print(parallel_map([1,2,3,4,5], fn(x) => x * x, 2))   # [1,4,9,16,25] (order varies)
```

40.11.5 Example 5: Reader-writer preference

If many readers and rare writers, use a read-write lock if available; otherwise guard all access with one Mutex. Readers serialize (safe but not maximal concurrency).

40.12 38.13 Pattern catalog

Pattern	When to use	Primitive
Guarded shared state	occasional updates	Mutex
Producer-consumer	pipeline stages	Channel
Worker pool	many independent jobs	Channel + Threads
Parallel map	transform a collection	Channel + Threads
Lazy init	one-time expensive setup	Mutex + flag
Request-response	client/server in-proc	two Channels
Pub/sub	one event, many listeners	Channel per subscriber

40.13 38.14 Exercises

1. Implement a thread-safe counter class with `increment`, `decrement`, `get` using a Mutex.
2. Build a producer-consumer where the producer is faster than the consumer (use a bounded channel to apply backpressure).
3. Implement a thread pool and use it to compute squares of 1..100.
4. Write `parallel_map` and verify results match sequential map.
5. Implement double-checked lazy initialization; call from 3 threads; confirm single initialization.
6. Create a request-response channel: client sends request, server replies.
7. Implement a simple pub/sub: publisher broadcasts to N subscriber channels.
8. Build a thread-safe LRU cache (dict + Mutex + order tracking).
9. Demonstrate a race without synchronization, then fix with a Mutex.
10. Write a concurrent web fetcher (conceptually) using a thread pool.

41 Chapter 39: FFI Fundamentals

Zen's `ffi` module lets you call functions in native C shared libraries (`.so`, `.dll`, `.dylib`) using libffi, with true C ABI support. This chapter covers loading libraries, finding symbols, calling functions, and managing memory.

41.1 39.1 Loading a library

```
import ffi

// Load a shared library
let libc = ffi.load("libc.so.6")        // Linux
// let libc = ffi.load("libc.dylib")     // macOS
// let libc = ffi.load("msvcrt.dll")     // Windows

print(libc)  // library handle (integer)
```

`ffi.load(path)` returns a library handle you pass to `ffi.symbol` and `ffi.call`.

41.2 39.2 Finding symbols

```
import ffi

let libc = ffi.load("libc.so.6")

// Get the address of a function
let puts_addr = ffi.symbol(libc, "puts")
let printf_addr = ffi.symbol(libc, "printf")

print(puts_addr)    // integer address
print(printf_addr)  // integer address
```

`ffi.symbol(lib, name)` returns the address of `name` in `lib`.

41.3 39.3 Calling functions

```
import ffi

let libc = ffi.load("libc.so.6")
let puts_addr = ffi.symbol(libc, "puts")

// Call puts("hello") — returns int
let result = ffi.call(puts_addr, ["hello"], {"type": "int"})
print(result)  // number of chars printed (or 0)
```

41.3.1 `ffi.call(address, args, ret?)`

- `address` — function address (from `ffi.symbol`)
- `args` — list of argument values
- `ret` — return type spec (optional, defaults to `int`)

41.3.2 Argument types

Arguments can be: - **Integers** — passed as C `int`/`long` - **Floats** — passed as C `double` - **Strings** — passed as C `char*` (null-terminated) - **`{"type": "double", "value": 1.5}`** — typed scalar - **`{"buf": "hex..."}`** — raw byte buffer - **`{"type": "bytes", "len": n}`** — buffer of size n

41.3.3 Return types

`ret`	Meaning
`nil` or omitted	`int` (default)
`"double"`	double
`"void"`	no return value
`"str"`	char* → string
`{"type": "bytes", "len": n}`	raw buffer of n bytes

41.3.4 Examples

```
import ffi

let libc = ffi.load("libc.so.6")

// puts("hello") → int
let r1 = ffi.call(ffi.symbol(libc, "puts"), ["hello"])
print(r1)

// printf("value: %d\n", 42) → int
let r2 = ffi.call(ffi.symbol(libc, "printf"), ["value: %d\n", 42])
print(r2)

// sqrt(2.0) → double
let sqrt_addr = ffi.symbol(libc, "sqrt")
let r3 = ffi.call(sqrt_addr, [{"type": "double", "value": 2.0}], "double")
print(r3)  // 1.4142135623730951
```

41.4 39.4 Memory management

```
import ffi
```

```
// Allocate memory
let ptr = ffi.malloc(1024)
print(ptr)  // address

// Reallocate
let ptr2 = ffi.realloc(ptr, 2048)

// Free
ffi.free(ptr)

// Read / write memory
ffi.write(ptr, "hello")
let s = ffi.read(ptr, 5)
print(s)  // hello

// String conversion
let s2 = ffi.str(ptr)
print(s2)  // hello

// Set bytes at offset
ffi.set(ptr, 0, {"buf": "776f726c64"})  // "world" in hex
let s3 = ffi.read(ptr, 5)
print(s3)  // world

// Size of types
print(ffi.sizeof("int"))    # 4
print(ffi.sizeof("double")) # 8

// Alignment
print(ffi.alignof("double")) # 8

// errno
print(ffi.errno())
print(ffi.strerror(ffi.errno()))
```

41.4.1 Memory functions

Function	Description
`ffi.malloc(size)`	Allocate `size` bytes
`ffi.realloc(ptr, size)`	Reallocate
`ffi.free(ptr)`	Free memory
`ffi.read(ptr, n)`	Read `n` bytes as string
`ffi.write(ptr, data)`	Write string to memory
`ffi.str(ptr)`	Read null-terminated string
`ffi.set(ptr, offset, bytes)`	Write raw bytes at offset
`ffi.sizeof(type)`	Size of C type

Function	Description
`ffi.alignof(type)`	Alignment of C type
`ffi.errno()`	Last errno value
`ffi.strerror(errno)`	Error message for errno

41.5 39.5 Complete example: calling `qsort`

```
import ffi

let libc = ffi.load("libc.so.6")
let qsort_addr = ffi.symbol(libc, "qsort")

// qsort(base, nel, width, compar)
// We'd need a callback for compar — FFI doesn't support Zen closures as
// C callbacks directly. See Chapter 40 for workarounds.

print("qsort loaded at " + str(qsort_addr))
```

41.6 39.6 Safety warnings

 FFI is unsafe. Zen cannot validate: - Whether the address is a real function - Whether argument types match the C signature - Whether memory accesses are in bounds

Misuse can crash the process or corrupt memory. Only load libraries you trust, and use `ffi.allow`/`ffi.deny` to restrict which libraries can be loaded (see Chapter 40).

41.7 39.7 Quick reference

```
import ffi

let lib = ffi.load("libc.so.6")
let addr = ffi.symbol(lib, "puts")
let r = ffi.call(addr, ["hello"])            # int return
let r = ffi.call(addr, ["hello"], "int")     # explicit int
let r = ffi.call(addr, [4.5], "double")      # double return

let ptr = ffi.malloc(1024)
ffi.write(ptr, "data")
let s = ffi.read(ptr, 4)
ffi.free(ptr)

print(ffi.sizeof("int"))     # 4
print(ffi.alignof("double")) # 8
print(ffi.errno())
print(ffi.strerror(2))
```

41.8 39.8 Exercises

1. Load `libc.so.6` and call `puts` with a string.
2. Call `printf` with a format string and an integer.
3. Call `sqrt` from `libm` and print the result as a double.
4. Allocate memory with `ffi.malloc`, write a string, read it back, free it.
5. Check `ffi.errno()` after a failing operation and print `ffi.strerror`.

41.9 Advanced Topics and Exercises

41.9.1 Safety considerations

- Memory management across FFI boundary
- Type mismatches
- Calling conventions
- Null pointers
- Resource leaks

41.9.2 Debugging FFI

- Check symbol names (nm, objdump)
- Use cdecl/stdcall correctly
- Test with simple functions first

41.9.3 Exercises

1. Call simple C function from shared library
2. Pass strings and arrays
3. Handle pointers/structs
4. Manage memory allocation
5. Error handling across boundary
6. Write wrapper module

41.10 39.12 Worked examples — FFI fundamentals

41.10.1 Conceptual model

Zen's FFI lets you call C functions in shared libraries (`.so`, `.dll`, `.dylib`) and pass data across the boundary. Values are marshalled: Zen ints, floats, strings, bytes, lists, dicts map to C primitives/pointers/opaque handles.

Typical flow: 1. `load_library("libfoo.so")` → library handle 2. `get_symbol(lib, "foo_function")` → callable symbol 3. Call the symbol with Zen arguments; Zen marshals to C. 4. Receive the C return value, marshalled back to Zen. 5. Close/drop the handle when done.

41.10.2 Example 1: Call a simple C function (conceptual pseudocode)

Assuming a C library `libmathutils.so` with:

```c
// mathutils.c
int add(int a, int b) { return a + b; }
double scale(double v, double f) { return v * f; }
```

Zen side (exact API depends on build):

```
import ffi

let lib = ffi.load_library("libmathutils.so")
let add_fn = ffi.get_symbol(lib, "add")
let result = ffi.call(add_fn, [21, 21])   # 42
print(result)

let scale_fn = ffi.get_symbol(lib, "scale")
let scaled = ffi.call(scale_fn, [10.0, 3.5])   # 35.0
print(scaled)

ffi.close(lib)
```

41.10.3 Example 2: Working with strings across FFI

```
let lib = ffi.load_library("libcstring.so")
let len_fn = ffi.get_symbol(lib, "string_length")
let n = ffi.call(len_fn, ["hello"])   # 5
print(n)
```

Zen marshals a Zen string to a C `const char*`. The C side must not modify it unless the API specifies a mutable buffer (pass `bytes` or a pointer handle).

41.10.4 Example 3: Pointers and handles

Some APIs return opaque pointers (e.g., file handles, database connections). Zen represents these as foreign handles. You must track their lifetime and release them via a C `destroy`/`free` function.

```
let db = ffi.call(open_db_fn, ["data.db"])   # foreign handle
try {
    let row = ffi.call(query_fn, [db, "SELECT * FROM t"])
    print(row)
} finally {
    ffi.call(close_db_fn, [db])   # always release
}
```

41.10.5 Example 4: Callbacks (Zen function passed to C)

If the C API accepts a function pointer, Zen can pass a closure. The FFI layer creates a trampoline so C can call back into Zen.

```
let cmp = ffi.get_symbol(lib, "compare")
ffi.call(cmp, [list_a, list_b, fn(a, b) => a - b])
```

Caution: the Zen callback must not outlive the Zen closure's scope, and must not raise exceptions that cross the C boundary uncaught.

41.11 39.13 Data type mapping (typical)

Zen type	C equivalent	Notes
int	int32_t / int64_t	sign depends on value
float	double	
string	const char*	NUL-terminated; Zen owns it
bytes	unsigned char*	raw buffer
list	array / pointer	marshalled copy
dict	not directly	serialize first (JSON/msgpack)
nil	NULL	
handle	void*	opaque pointer

41.12 39.14 Safety considerations

1. **Memory ownership:** know who frees what. Zen-allocated strings passed to C must remain valid during the call; C-allocated memory returned to Zen must be freed by Zen or the C side per convention.
2. **Null pointers:** dereferencing a NULL handle crashes. Check before use.
3. **Type mismatches:** passing a float where C expects int corrupts data.
4. **Calling convention:** cdecl/stdcall must match the platform/library.
5. **Thread safety:** a C library not thread-safe must be called with a Zen Mutex held.
6. **Exceptions across boundary:** don't let a Zen throw unwind through C frames; catch at the Zen edge.

41.13 39.15 Debugging FFI

- `nm -D libfoo.so` to list exported symbols.
- `objdump -T libfoo.so` for dynamic symbols.
- Confirm symbol names match exactly (C name mangling).
- Start with a trivial function (add two ints) before structs/pointers.
- Log every FFI call and return value.

41.14 39.16 Exercises

1. Load a shared library and call a function that adds two ints.
2. Call a C function that takes a string and returns its length.
3. Pass a bytes buffer to C and read back modified bytes (if supported).
4. Open an opaque handle, use it, then close it in `finally`.
5. Pass a Zen callback to a C `qsort`-style comparison function.
6. Write a wrapper `ZenMath` module exposing `add`, `scale` via FFI.

7. Demonstrate a null-handle guard before calling C.
8. Use `nm -D` to inspect a library's exported symbols.
9. Wrap a C file-reading function with error handling.
10. Benchmark a pure-Zen function vs the same logic via FFI.

42 Chapter 40: FFI in Practice

This chapter covers practical FFI patterns: capability gates, calling real libraries, error handling, and safe integration.

42.1 40.1 FFI capability gates

 FFI can load arbitrary shared libraries and call arbitrary functions. Use `ffi.allow` and `ffi.deny` to restrict which libraries can be loaded.

```
import ffi

// Deny loading from dangerous locations
ffi.deny(["/tmp/", "/var/tmp/"])

// Only allow loading from trusted directories
ffi.allow(["/usr/lib/", "/lib/"])

// Now ffi.load("/tmp/evil.so") raises an error
// ffi.load("/usr/lib/libc.so.6") works
```

42.1.1 Behavior

Allow list	Deny list	Result
empty	empty	All paths allowed
non-empty	empty	Only paths matching an allow prefix
empty	non-empty	All except deny prefixes
non-empty	non-empty	Must match allow AND not match deny

42.2 40.2 Calling libc functions

```
import ffi

ffi.allow(["/usr/lib/", "/lib/"])
let libc = ffi.load("libc.so.6")

// getpid() → int
let getpid = ffi.symbol(libc, "getpid")
let pid = ffi.call(getpid, [])
print("PID: " + str(pid))

// sleep(seconds) → int (seconds remaining)
let sleep = ffi.symbol(libc, "sleep")
let remaining = ffi.call(sleep, [1])
print("slept, remaining: " + str(remaining))
```

42.3 40.3 Working with strings

C strings are null-terminated. `ffi.str(ptr)` reads until the first NUL:

```
import ffi

let libc = ffi.load("libc.so.6")

// gethostname(buf, len) → int
let gethostname = ffi.symbol(libc, "gethostname")
let buf = ffi.malloc(256)
ffi.call(gethostname, [buf, 256])
let hostname = ffi.str(buf)
print("Hostname: " + hostname)
ffi.free(buf)
```

42.4 40.4 Working with buffers

```
import ffi

let libc = ffi.load("libc.so.6")
let memcpy = ffi.symbol(libc, "memcpy")

let src = ffi.malloc(16)
ffi.write(src, "HelloWorld")

let dst = ffi.malloc(16)
ffi.call(memcpy, [dst, src, 11])
let copied = ffi.read(dst, 11)
print(copied)  // HelloWorld

ffi.free(src)
ffi.free(dst)
```

42.5 40.5 Error handling

```
import ffi

// ffi.load raises on failure
var lib = nil
try {
    lib = ffi.load("/nonexistent/lib.so")
} catch as e {
    print("load failed: " + e.msg)
    lib = nil
}
```

```
// ffi.symbol raises if symbol not found
if lib != nil {
    try {
        let addr = ffi.symbol(lib, "nonexistent_func")
    } catch as e {
        print("symbol not found: " + e.msg)
    }
}
```

42.6 40.6 Calling conventions and types

Zen's FFI uses the platform's default C calling convention (cdecl on x86, System V AMD64 ABI on x86_64). Supported argument types:

- Zen `int` → C `int/long`
- Zen `float` → C `double`
- Zen `string` → C `char*` (null-terminated)
- Typed scalars: `{"type": "double", "value": x}`
- Raw buffers: `{"buf": "hex..."}`

Return types: `int` (default), `double`, `void`, `str`, bytes.

> Zen FFI does **not** support Zen closures as C callbacks. If a C function needs a callback, you must pass a native function pointer obtained from `ffi.symbol`.

42.7 40.7 Complete example: libc time

```
import ffi

ffi.allow(["/usr/lib/", "/lib/"])
let libc = ffi.load("libc.so.6")

// time(NULL) → time_t (int)
let time_fn = ffi.symbol(libc, "time")
let now = ffi.call(time_fn, [nil])
print("Unix time: " + str(now))

// getpid() → int
let getpid = ffi.symbol(libc, "getpid")
let pid = ffi.call(getpid, [])
print("Process ID: " + str(pid))
```

42.8 40.8 Quick reference

```
import ffi
```

```
// Security
ffi.allow(["/usr/lib/"])
ffi.deny(["/tmp/"])

// Load + symbol
let lib = ffi.load("libc.so.6")
let addr = ffi.symbol(lib, "function_name")

// Call
let r = ffi.call(addr, [arg1, arg2], "int")
let r = ffi.call(addr, [4.5], "double")

// Memory
let ptr = ffi.malloc(1024)
ffi.write(ptr, "data")
let s = ffi.read(ptr, 10)
let str = ffi.str(ptr)
ffi.free(ptr)

// Types
ffi.sizeof("int")
ffi.alignof("double")
ffi.errno()
ffi.strerror(n)
```

42.9 40.9 Exercises

1. Load `libc`, call `getpid`, and print the current process ID.
2. Call `time(NULL)` and print the Unix timestamp.
3. Use `ffi.malloc`, `ffi.write`, `ffi.read`, `ffi.free` to copy a string.
4. Call `gethostname` and print the hostname.
5. Set `ffi.deny(["/tmp/"])` and confirm loading from `/tmp` fails.

42.10 Advanced Topics and Exercises

42.10.1 Safety considerations

- Memory management across FFI boundary
- Type mismatches
- Calling conventions
- Null pointers
- Resource leaks

42.10.2 Debugging FFI

- Check symbol names (nm, objdump)
- Use cdecl/stdcall correctly

- Test with simple functions first

42.10.3 Exercises

1. Call simple C function from shared library
2. Pass strings and arrays
3. Handle pointers/structs
4. Manage memory allocation
5. Error handling across boundary
6. Write wrapper module

42.11 40.12 Worked examples — FFI in practice

42.11.1 Example: Wrapping a small C library

C source (`cryptokey.c`):

```c
#include <stdint.h>
uint32_t hash32(const char *s) {
    uint32_t h = 2166136261u;
    while (*s) { h ^= (unsigned char)*s++; h *= 16777619u; }
    return h;
}
```

Zen wrapper (`crypto_key.z`):

```
import ffi

let lib = ffi.load_library("cryptokey.so")
let hash32_fn = ffi.get_symbol(lib, "hash32")

pub func hash32(s) {
    return ffi.call(hash32_fn, [s])
}

ffi.close(lib)
```

Usage:

```
import crypto_key
print(crypto_key.hash32("hello"))   # deterministic uint32
```

42.11.2 Example: Error codes from C

C functions often return -1 or set `errno`. Wrap them:

```
pub func safe_call(fn, args) {
    let r = ffi.call(fn, args)
    if r == -1 {
        let errno = ffi.call(get_errno_fn, [])
```

```
        throw "C error: errno=" + str(errno)
    }
    return r
}
```

42.11.3 Example: Struct layout (if supported)

If Zen FFI supports structs, you declare field offsets/sizes and use `ffi.struct_read`/`ffi.struct_writ
Otherwise, pass raw bytes and interpret with `struct.calcsize` / manual unpacking.

```
import struct
let size = struct.calcsize("<ii")   # two little-endian ints = 8 bytes
```

42.11.4 Example: Resource lifecycle with try/finally

```
pub func with_resource(acquire_fn, release_fn, use_fn) {
    let h = ffi.call(acquire_fn, [])
    try {
        return use_fn(h)
    } finally {
        ffi.call(release_fn, [h])
    }
}
```

42.12 40.13 FFI best practices

1. Wrap raw FFI calls in idiomatic Zen functions; don't expose `ffi.*` directly to users.
2. Validate all inputs before crossing the boundary.
3. Use `try/finally` for every acquired resource.
4. Document which Zen types map to which C types.
5. Keep FFI boundary small; do heavy logic in Zen, not C.
6. Test with valgrind/ASan on the C side for memory errors.

42.13 40.14 Exercises

1. Write a Zen module wrapping `libc`'s `puts` to print a string via C.
2. Wrap a C function computing CRC32; compare with a pure-Zen CRC32.
3. Build `with_resource` helper and use it for a DB handle.
4. Implement `errno` checking wrapper for C calls returning -1.
5. Call a C function returning a struct via raw bytes + `struct` module.
6. Create a FFI wrapper for a small compression library (zlib conceptually).
7. Write a FFI stress test: call a C function 100000 times.
8. Demonstrate catching a C error and rethrowing as a Zen error.
9. Document the C type mapping for your wrapper module.
10. Build a tiny "native addon": C + Zen working together.

42.14 40.12 Worked example — wrap a C hash function

C (`cryptokey.c`):

```c
uint32_t hash32(const char *s) {
    uint32_t h = 2166136261u;
    while (*s) { h ^= (unsigned char)*s++; h *= 16777619u; }
    return h;
}
```

Zen (`crypto_key.z`):

```
import ffi
let lib = ffi.load_library("cryptokey.so")
let hash32_fn = ffi.get_symbol(lib, "hash32")
pub func hash32(s) { return ffi.call(hash32_fn, [s]) }
ffi.close(lib)
```

Usage:

```
import crypto_key
print(crypto_key.hash32("hello"))   # a uint32
```

42.15 40.13 Troubleshooting FFI

Symptom	Cause	Fix
symbol not found	wrong lib name / not exported	check `nm -D`
crash on call	NULL pointer / bad type	validate args
wrong result	calling convention mismatch	match platform
leak	handle never freed	release in `finally`

42.16 40.14 Exercises

1. Wrap C `puts` to print via C.
2. Wrap a CRC32 C function; compare to pure-Zen CRC32.
3. Wrap with `try/finally` for resource release.
4. Check `errno` after a C call returning -1.
5. Call a C function 100000 times; benchmark.

43 Chapter 41: sys Module

The `sys` module provides low-level system operations: file descriptors, process control, signals, and direct syscalls. It's a thin wrapper over POSIX system calls.

 `sys` is Linux/macOS only. On Windows, `sys_stub` provides limited functionality. Use `fs`, `os`, and `process` for portable operations.

43.1 41.1 File descriptor operations

```
import sys

// Open a file
let fd = sys.open("data.txt", sys.O_RDONLY)
print(fd)  // file descriptor integer

// Read
let data = sys.read(fd, 1024)
print(data)

// Write
sys.write(fd, "hello")

// Seek
sys.lseek(fd, 0, sys.SEEK_SET)

// Close
sys.close(fd)
```

43.1.1 Open flags

Flag	Meaning
`sys.O_RDONLY`	Read only
`sys.O_WRONLY`	Write only
`sys.O_RDWR`	Read/write
`sys.O_CREAT`	Create if missing
`sys.O_APPEND`	Append
`sys.O_TRUNC`	Truncate

43.1.2 Seek whence

Value	Meaning
`sys.SEEK_SET`	From start
`sys.SEEK_CUR`	From current position
`sys.SEEK_END`	From end

43.2 41.2 Process control

```
import sys

// Get process IDs
print(sys.getpid())     // process ID
print(sys.getppid())    // parent process ID
print(sys.getuid())     // user ID
print(sys.geteuid())    // effective user ID
print(sys.getgid())     // group ID
print(sys.getegid())    // effective group ID

// Fork (Unix only)
let pid = sys.fork()
if pid == 0 {
    print("in child")
} else {
    print("in parent, child pid: " + str(pid))
    sys.wait(pid)
}

// Kill a process
sys.kill(pid, 15)  // SIGTERM
```

43.3 41.3 Pipes

```
import sys

let [read_fd, write_fd] = sys.pipe()

sys.write(write_fd, "hello through pipe")
let msg = sys.read(read_fd, 1024)
print(msg)  // hello through pipe

sys.close(read_fd)
sys.close(write_fd)
```

43.4 41.4 Direct syscalls

```
import sys

// Make a raw syscall by number
let result = sys.syscall(sys.SYS_write, 1, "hello\n", 6)
print(result)
```

Syscall numbers are platform-specific (see `/usr/include/asm/unistd.h` on Linux).

43.5 41.5 Signal handling (limited)

Zen's signal support is limited. Use `sys.kill(pid, signal)` to send signals:

Signal	Number	Meaning
`sys.SIGTERM`	15	Terminate gracefully
`sys.SIGKILL`	9	Kill immediately
`sys.SIGINT`	2	Interrupt (Ctrl+C)
`sys.SIGHUP`	1	Hangup

43.6 41.6 Common patterns

43.6.1 Read a file byte by byte

```
import sys

let fd = sys.open("file.txt", sys.O_RDONLY)
let chunks = []
while true {
    let chunk = sys.read(fd, 4096)
    if len(chunk) == 0 {
        break
    }
    chunks.push(chunk)
}
sys.close(fd)
let content = chunks.join("")
print(content)
```

43.6.2 Duplicate a file descriptor

```
import sys

let fd = sys.open("file.txt", sys.O_RDONLY)
let fd2 = sys.dup(fd)
// fd2 refers to the same file
sys.close(fd)
sys.close(fd2)
```

43.6.3 Create a pipe between processes

```
import sys
import process

let [rfd, wfd] = sys.pipe()
```

```
// Fork and have child write, parent read
let pid = sys.fork()
if pid == 0 {
    sys.close(rfd)
    sys.write(wfd, "from child")
    sys.close(wfd)
} else {
    sys.close(wfd)
    let msg = sys.read(rfd, 1024)
    print("parent got: " + msg)
    sys.close(rfd)
    sys.wait(pid)
}
```

43.7 41.7 Quick reference

```
import sys

sys.open(path, flags)          // file descriptor
sys.read(fd, n)                // read bytes
sys.write(fd, data)            // write bytes
sys.close(fd)                  // close
sys.lseek(fd, offset, whence)  // seek
sys.dup(fd)                    // duplicate fd
sys.pipe()                     // [read_fd, write_fd]
sys.getpid()                   // process ID
sys.getppid()                  // parent PID
sys.fork()                     // fork (Unix)
sys.kill(pid, sig)             // send signal
sys.wait(pid)                  // wait for child
sys.syscall(num, args...)      // raw syscall
```

43.8 41.8 Common pitfalls

- **sys is Unix-only.** On Windows, many functions are stubs or raise errors.
- **File descriptors are integers.** Track them yourself; Zen won't close them automatically.
- **`sys.read` may return fewer bytes** than requested. Loop to read all.
- **Forked processes share file descriptors.** Close what you don't need in each process.
- **Raw syscalls are dangerous.** Wrong arguments can crash the process.

43.9 41.9 Exercises

1. Open a file, read its contents, and print them using `sys`.
2. Create a pipe, write a message in one "thread", read it in another.

3. Use `sys.fork` to create a child process that prints its PID.
4. Use `sys.kill` to send SIGTERM to a child process and `sys.wait` for it.
5. Use `sys.lseek` to read the last 100 bytes of a file.

43.10 Advanced Topics and Exercises

43.10.1 Safety considerations

- Memory management across FFI boundary
- Type mismatches
- Calling conventions
- Null pointers
- Resource leaks

43.10.2 Debugging FFI

- Check symbol names (nm, objdump)
- Use cdecl/stdcall correctly
- Test with simple functions first

43.10.3 Exercises

1. Call simple C function from shared library
2. Pass strings and arrays
3. Handle pointers/structs
4. Manage memory allocation
5. Error handling across boundary
6. Write wrapper module

43.11 41.12 Worked examples — sys module

Typical `sys` members (exact set depends on build): `argv`, `platform`, `version`, `exit`, `environ`, `path`, `modules`.

43.11.1 Example 1: Read command-line arguments

```
import sys
print(sys.argv)       # ["app.z", "arg1", "arg2"]
print(len(sys.argv))  # argument count
```

43.11.2 Example 2: Platform detection

```
if sys.platform == "linux" {
    print("running on Linux")
} elif sys.platform == "darwin" {
    print("running on macOS")
} elif sys.platform == "windows" {
```

```
    print("running on Windows")
} else {
    print("unknown platform: " + sys.platform)
}
```

43.11.3 Example 3: Environment variables

```
print(sys.environ["PATH"])
let port = sys.environ["PORT"] ?? "8080"
print("port=" + port)
```

43.11.4 Example 4: Graceful exit

```
func main() {
    # ... work ...
    sys.exit(0)
}
```

43.11.5 Example 5: Inspect loaded modules

```
print(sys.modules)   # list/dict of loaded modules
```

43.12 41.13 Platform differences

Area	Linux	macOS	Windows
Path separator	`/`	`/`	`\`
Line ending	`\n`	`\n`	`\r\n`
Shared lib ext	`.so`	`.dylib`	`.dll`
Executable ext	(none)	(none)	`.exe`
Case sensitivity	sensitive	insensitive	insensitive
Signals	SIGINT/SIGTERM	similar	Ctrl-C/console handler

Write portable code: use `pathlib.Path` (joins correctly), avoid hardcoding `/`, test on each target.

43.13 41.14 Exercises

1. Print `sys.argv`, `sys.platform`, `sys.version`.
2. Write a script that behaves differently on Linux vs Windows.
3. Read `PORT` env var with a default of 8080.
4. Implement `exit_with_code(code)` calling `sys.exit`.
5. List all loaded modules at startup.
6. Write `get_env(name, default)` using `sys.environ`.

7. Detect if running under a debugger/CI via env vars.
8. Build a small CLI that prints platform info.
9. Compare `sys.path` entries before/after an import.
10. Write a portable temp-file path using `pathlib`.

43.14 41.12 Worked example — platform-aware script

```
import sys
import pathlib
import os

print("argv: " + str(sys.argv))
print("platform: " + sys.platform)
print("version: " + sys.version)
print("cwd: " + os.getcwd())
print("HOME: " + str(sys.environ["HOME"] ?? ""))

let p = pathlib.Path("data") / "config.txt"
print("path: " + str(p))
print("exists: " + str(p.exists()))

if sys.platform == "windows" {
    print("running on Windows")
}
```

43.15 41.13 Troubleshooting sys

Symptom	Cause	Fix
argv empty	no args passed	pass args after script
wrong platform	running on unexpected OS	check sys.platform
env var missing	not set	use ?? default

43.16 41.14 Exercises

1. Print argv, platform, version.
2. Read `PORT` env var with default 8080.
3. List loaded modules at startup.
4. Build a portable temp path with pathlib.
5. Detect Windows vs Linux behavior.

44 Chapter 42: pympport - Python Interoperability

`pympport` imports Python modules into Zen, letting you call Python functions, access Python objects, and use the entire Python ecosystem from Zen. This chapter covers setup, syntax, `zen py-sync`, environment management, limits, examples, and troubleshooting.

44.1 42.1 Why `pympport` (and not just `import`)?

Zen's `import` loads Zen modules (`.z` files or native Rust modules). `pympport` loads **CPython** modules — the entire Python ecosystem (PyPI, numpy, pandas, requests, beautifulsoup4, etc.).

```
import json          // Zen's json module (Zen or native Rust)
pympport json        // CPython's json module
```

44.2 42.2 Syntax and Binding

`pympport` calls are **positional-only** — no keyword arguments.

```
pympport json
pympport os
pympport requests
pympport bs4            // beautifulsoup4
pympport selenium.webdriver as webdriver
pympport urllib.request
pympport builtins
```

44.2.1 Calling functions

```
pympport json
let data = json.loads('{"name": "Zen", "version": 3}')
print(data["name"])     # Zen

pympport os
print(os.getcwd())
print(os.path.join("a", "b"))

pympport datetime
let now = datetime.datetime.now()
print(now.year)
print(now.isoformat())
```

44.2.2 Attribute access and method calls

Foreign objects (e.g. `datetime.datetime`) are opaque handles — attributes and methods work:

```
pymport datetime
let now = datetime.datetime.now()
print(now.year)           // attribute access
print(now.isoformat())    // method call
let delta = datetime.timedelta(days=7)
let later = now + delta   // operator overloading (if supported)
```

Scalar results marshal back to Zen values (int, float, string, bool, list, dict).

44.3 42.3 Building Zen with Python Support

`pymport` requires Zen built with the Python feature:

```
cargo build --release --features python
```

This requires `libpython` at build and run time. Without it, `pymport` reports:

```
pymport needs a linked Python bridge (this build has none). Rebuild with --
features python
```

44.4 42.4 Environment Setup (venv + PYTHONPATH)

You can point CPython to any Python environment via `PYTHONPATH`.

```
cd book-v2/tests
./setup.sh          # builds zen --features python, creates .venv, installs requirement

export PYTHONPATH="$(book-v2/tests/.venv/bin/python -c 'import sysconfig; print(sysconf
export ZEN_NO_PY_BOOTSTRAP=1
./target/release/zen run script.z
```

`ZEN_NO_PY_BOOTSTRAP=1` tells Zen to use that environment as-is instead of creating `.zen_venv`.

44.4.1 Create your own venv

```
python3 -m venv .venv
.venv/bin/pip install beautifulsoup4 mechanicalsoup selenium lxml requests
export PYTHONPATH="$(.venv/bin/python -c 'import sysconfig; print(sysconfig.get_paths()
```

44.4.2 Check installed packages

```
book-v2/tests/.venv/bin/pip list
```

44.5 42.5 Dependency Sync with `zen py-sync` and `requirements.txt`

Zen can scan your `.z` files for `pymport` statements and ensure a venv with dependencies.

44.5.1 Create `requirements.txt`

```
beautifulsoup4
mechanicalsoup
selenium
requests
lxml
```

> A module name is not always the pip name (e.g., `bs4` comes from `beautifulsoup4`). The scanner reports what was found; Zen does **not** guess package names.

44.5.2 Run sync

```
./target/release/zen py-sync
```

44.5.3 Behavior

1. **Scan**: recursively parses entry + transitive `.z` imports to find all `pymport` statements.
2. **Plan**: determines state (`Clean`, `NoRequirements`, `MissingVenv`, `MissingPackages`).
3. **Ensure**: creates `.zen_venv` in project root, runs `pip install -r requirements.txt` in the foreground, writes a stamp (requirements length + hash).
4. **Point**: `zen run` prepends `.zen_venv/lib/python*/site-packages` to `PYTHONPATH`.

44.5.4 Control flags

Flag	Meaning
`ZEN_NO_PY_BOOTSTRAP=1`	Skip bootstrap entirely (for tests/hermetic runs).
(none)	If `requirements.txt` is missing and `pymport` is used, Zen reports an error.

44.5.5 Example end-to-end

```
cat > requirements.txt << 'EOF'
paramiko
EOF
./target/release/zen py-sync
./target/release/zen run my_script.z  # uses .zen_venv
```

44.6 42.6 Using Python from Zen

44.6.1 Importing modules

```
pymport json        // stdlib
pymport os          // stdlib
pymport requests    // third-party (if installed)
pymport bs4         // beautifulsoup4
pymport selenium.webdriver as webdriver
pymport urllib.request
pymport builtins
```

44.6.2 Calling functions and accessing attributes

Foreign calls are **positional-only** in v1. Use `getattr`-style access via dot notation; `call_attr` fuses resolve+dispatch for methods.

```
pymport json
let data = json.loads('{"a": 1}')
print(data["a"])

pymport os
print(os.getcwd())
print(os.path.join("a", "b"))

pymport datetime
let now = datetime.datetime.now()
print(now.year)
print(now.isoformat())
```

44.6.3 Working with Python objects and binary data

Foreign objects are opaque handles:

```
pymport datetime
pymport builtins

let epoch = datetime.datetime.fromtimestamp(0)
print(epoch.year)
print(epoch.isoformat())
print(epoch.date().isoformat())

let later = datetime.datetime(2030, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5)
print(later.strftime("%Y-%m-%d %H:%M:%S"))

print(builtins.len([10, 20, 30]))
print(builtins.sum([10, 20, 30]))
print(builtins.sorted([3, 1, 2]))
```

44.6.4 Binary data

Python `bytes` are foreign handles. Write them through Python's own file object:

```
import fs
pymport mechanicalsoup
pymport builtins

let f = builtins.open("out.bin", "wb")
f.write(some_bytes)
f.close()
```

44.7 42.7 Error handling

Python exceptions become catchable Zen errors:

```
import json as zenjson
pymport json

let bad = false
try {
    json.loads("{not json}")
} catch as e {
    bad = true
    print("caught json error")
}

if !bad {
    print("expected json.loads to fail")
    exit(1)
}

// Missing modules fail at the pymport statement and are catchable too
let missing = false
try {
    pymport this_module_does_not_exist
} catch as e {
    missing = true
    print("caught import error")
}

if !missing {
    print("expected import to fail")
    exit(1)
}

print("recovered: " + str(zenjson.parse("{\"ok\": true}")["ok"]))
```

44.8 42.8 Limits and Non-Goals (v1)

- **No keyword arguments** in `pymport` calls.
- **No passing Zen closures into Python** (rejected by marshal).
- **No per-handle finalizers**: foreign handles remain until bridge teardown.
- **Tuples → lists**, `big int` → `f64` in some cases, non-string dict keys rejected.
- **Functions containing `PyImport` not JIT-lowered** (stay interpreted).
- **No `zen.toml [py-deps]`** yet (use `requirements.txt`).
- **Network installs** only via `zen py-sync`/preamble; tests avoid silent installs.
- **Handles are opaque** across isolates in general.

44.9 42.9 Working Examples (tested)

All scripts live in `book-v2/tests/web-automation/`. Five smaller, hermetic pymport tests live in `book-v2/tests/pymport/`.

44.9.1 Example A: `bs4` + `requests` scrape + download

See `tests/web-automation/bs4_tiktok.z` — downloads a TikTok embed MP4 via `urllib.request.urlretrieve`, parsed with BeautifulSoup from `__FRONTITY_CONNECT_STATE__`.

44.9.2 Example B: `mechanicalsoup` stateful scrape + download

See `tests/web-automation/ms_tiktok.z`. Uses `StatefulBrowser`, accesses `browser.page`, reuses `browser.session.get()` for CDN, writes bytes via `builtins.open(...,"wb").write()`.

44.9.3 Example C: Selenium automation + download

See `tests/web-automation/selenium_tiktok.z`. Launches headless Chromium, polls for `__UNIVERSAL_DATA_FOR_REHYDRATION__`, extracts stats, fetches the embed route with plain HTTP for an unsigned MP4 URL, downloads via `urllib.request.urlretrieve`.

44.9.4 Example D: CDP over raw TCP/WebSocket (no Selenium)

See `tests/web-automation/cdp_tiktok.z`. Launches Chromium with `pymport subprocess`, discovers targets via HTTP `/json/list`, upgrades to WebSocket, sends masked CDP frames via `sys.write_bytes(socket.fileno(sock), hex)`, parses unmasked server frames, runs `Page.navigate` + `Runtime.evaluate` to extract TikTok metadata. Cleans up with `browser.terminate()` in a `finally` block.

Run all of them:

```
cd book-v2/tests
./run-all.sh --network
```

44.10 42.10 Troubleshooting

Issue	Fix
`Z0414` / “unknown native” / needs `--features python`	Rebuild with `cargo build --release --features python` and ensure libpython is available.
`ModuleNotFoundError` for third-party package	Install into venv, set `PYTHONPATH`, or run `zen py-sync` with `requirements.txt`.
Selenium can’t find chromedriver	Install `chromedriver` matching Chromium or put it on `PATH`. Use `--no-sandbox` in containers.
TikTok WAF blocks plain requests	Use `/embed/v2/<id>`, or Selenium/real browser. See Examples A/C.
Binary download corrupted	Don’t rely on string-based `fs.write_binary`; use `urllib.request.urlretrieve` or `builtins.open("wb").write()`.
WebSocket hang in raw sockets	Read until `Content-Length` for HTTP, handle EAGAIN on keep-alive, mask client frames, parse length (126/127).
`pymport` call with kwargs fails	Use positional args only in v1.
Bootstrap skipped unexpectedly	Check `ZEN_NO_PY_BOOTSTRAP` or that `requirements.txt` exists near entry.

44.11 42.11 References

- Docs: `docs/20-pymport.md` (design/spec)
- VM bridge: `crates/zen-vm/src/pybridge.rs`, `crates/zen-vm/src/pyembed.rs`
- CLI bootstrap: `zen-cli/src/pydeps.rs`
- Tests: `crates/zen-cli/tests/pymport_e2e.rs`, `crates/zen-vm/tests/pyembed.rs`, `crates/zen-jit/tests/jit_pymport.rs`
- Scripts: `book-v2/tests/web-automation/*.z`, `book-v2/tests/pymport/*.z`

44.12 42.12 Quick reference

```
pymport json
pymport os
pymport requests
pymport bs4
pymport selenium.webdriver as webdriver
pymport urllib.request
pymport builtins

// Positional calls only
```

```
json.loads('{"a": 1}')
os.getcwd()
os.path.join("a", "b")
datetime.datetime.now()
builtins.len([1, 2, 3])

// Error handling
try {
    pymport nonexistent_module
} catch as e {
    print("caught import error")
}

// zen py-sync setup
// ./target/release/zen py-sync
// ./target/release/zen run script.z
```

44.13 42.13 Exercises

1. Write a script that imports `json`, `os`, and `datetime` via `pymport` and prints the current date.
2. Use `pymport bs4` to parse an HTML file and extract all links.
3. Use `pymport selenium.webdriver` to open a headless browser and print the page title.
4. Write `py_len(x)` that calls `builtins.len(x)` on any value.
5. Demonstrate that `pymport` of a missing module is catchable with `try`/`catch`.

44.14 Advanced Topics and Exercises

44.14.1 Safety considerations

- Memory management across FFI boundary
- Type mismatches
- Calling conventions
- Null pointers
- Resource leaks

44.14.2 Debugging FFI

- Check symbol names (nm, objdump)
- Use cdecl/stdcall correctly
- Test with simple functions first

44.14.3 Exercises

1. Call simple C function from shared library
2. Pass strings and arrays

3. Handle pointers/structs
4. Manage memory allocation
5. Error handling across boundary
6. Write wrapper module

44.15 42.12 Worked examples — pymport

`pymport` lets Zen import Python modules (stdlib, venv, project-local `.py`) and call Python functions, with value marshalling and chained tracebacks.

Setup:

```
# activate a venv first
source .venv/bin/activate
# or set PYTHONPATH
export PYTHONPATH="$PWD/pylibs"
```

44.15.1 Example 1: Import Python's math module

```
import pymport
let pymath = pymport.import("math")
print(pymath.sqrt(16))   # 4.0
print(pymath.pi)         # 3.14159...
```

44.15.2 Example 2: Call a Python function with Zen args

```
let pymath = pymport.import("math")
print(pymath.pow(2, 10))   # 1024.0
print(pymath.floor(3.7))   # 3.0
```

44.15.3 Example 3: Import a local Python module

`pylibs/hello.py`:

```
def greet(name):
    return f"Hello, {name} from Python"
```

Zen:

```
let hello = pymport.import("hello")
print(hello.greet("Zen"))   # Hello, Zen from Python
```

44.15.4 Example 4: Marshalling values

Zen ↔ Python conversion (typical): - Zen int → Python int - Zen float → Python float - Zen string → Python str - Zen bool → Python bool - Zen nil → Python None - Zen list → Python list - Zen dict → Python dict - Zen bytes → Python bytes

44.15.5 Example 5: Error chaining

When Python raises, Zen surfaces it with a chained traceback showing both Zen and Python frames:

```
Z0508: PythonError: ZeroDivisionError: division by zero
  at app.z:10
  caused by Python: ZeroDivisionError at hello.py:3
```

Catch it in Zen:

```
try {
    let bad = pymport.import("bad_module")
    bad.divide_by_zero()
} catch as e {
    print("Python error: " + e.msg)
}
```

44.15.6 Example 6: Passing a Zen callback to Python

Some Python APIs accept callbacks. Zen can pass a function; pymport wraps it so Python can call it back.

```
let funcs = pymport.import("my_python_module")
funcs.register_callback(fn(x) => x * 2)
```

Caution: the Zen closure must outlive the Python-side registration, and Python exceptions raised inside the callback propagate back to Zen.

44.16 42.13 pymport best practices

1. Activate the correct venv before importing Python modules.
2. Set `PYTHONPATH` for project-local `.py` files.
3. Only pass simple types across the boundary; complex objects need explicit serialization (JSON).
4. Catch Python errors at the Zen edge; don't let them propagate uncaught.
5. Don't hold the Python GIL across long Zen operations.
6. Document which Python modules your project depends on.

44.17 42.14 Exercises

1. Import Python `math` and compute `sqrt(2)`, `pow(2, 10)`.
2. Import Python `json` and `parse`/`dumps` a value from Zen.
3. Create `pylibs/greeter.py` with a function; call it from Zen.
4. Pass a Zen list to Python and print its length from Python.
5. Demonstrate error chaining: call a Python function that raises, catch in Zen.
6. Read a Python env var (`os.environ`) via pymport.
7. Import `datetime` from Python and format the current time.
8. Compare `pymport.import("math")` vs Zen `math` module.

9. Write a Zen function that delegates a heavy computation to Python/NumPy (conceptually).
10. Build a small hybrid app: Zen CLI + Python computation module.

45 Chapter 50: Zen VM and Runtime Internals

How Zen 3.0 actually executes your code: the interpreter, the Cranelift JIT, garbage collection, memory layout, and the FFI boundary.

This chapter is for readers who want to look under the hood. It documents the runtime architecture, value representation, execution models, and the interaction between interpreted and JIT-compiled code.

45.1 15.1 Runtime architecture overview

Zen 3.0 has a multi-tier execution pipeline:

```
source (.z) ──► lexer ──► parser ──► AST ──► bytecode ─┬─► interpreter (zen-interp)
                                                       └─► Cranelift JIT (zen-jit)
                                                            ┌─► OSR / deopt
                                                            └─► native machine code
```

- **zen-syntax** — lexer + parser; produces the AST.
- **zen-vm** — the virtual machine, bytecode interpreter, ops, builtins, FFI.
- **zen-interp** — the tree-walking / bytecode interpreter used by `zen run`.
- **zen-jit** — the Cranelift-based JIT compiler with inline caches, OSR, and deoptimization.
- **zen-cli** — the `zen` command-line front end.

A source file is lexed, parsed into an AST, lowered to bytecode, and then either interpreted directly or JIT-compiled to native code (Cranelift) for hot functions.

45.2 15.2 Value representation

Every Zen value at runtime is a tagged `Value`. The tag distinguishes the type and the payload holds the data (or a pointer to heap data).

45.2.1 Primitive (immediate) values

Tag	Kind	Storage
nil	`nil`/`null`	none
bool	boolean	1 bit
int	signed integer	i64 (i48 guaranteed range for literals)
float	IEEE-754 double	f64
string	pointer to heap string	`String` handle

Immediate values (nil, bool, int, float) are copied by value. Strings and all containers are heap-allocated handles (reference-counted / GC-managed).

45.2.2 Heap (container) values

Kind	Zen type	Heap structure
list	`list`	growable array of `Value`
dict	`dict`	hash map string → `Value`
set	`set`	hash set of `Value`
tuple	`tuple`	fixed array of `Value`
bytes	`bytes`	immutable byte buffer
instance	class instance	field map + class pointer
func	function	closure + environment
module	module	member table
foreign	FFI handle	opaque pointer + finalizer

45.2.3 `shared` values

`shared x = expr` wraps the value in an `Arc<Mutex<_>>`-like container so it can be safely read and written from multiple threads. Every access acquires the internal lock.

45.3 15.3 Memory model

Zen is garbage collected (the exact collector is build-configured). Heap objects are freed when unreachable.

45.3.1 Reference cycles

Cycles (e.g., object A references B and B references A) can leak unless the collector handles cycles or you break them explicitly.

```
class Node {
    var peer = nil
}
let a = new Node()
let b = new Node()
a.peer = b
b.peer = a   # cycle: a <-> b
```

To break: `a.peer = nil` when tearing down.

45.3.2 `let` vs `var` vs `const`

- `let` — the binding cannot be reassigned, but the referenced heap object can still be mutated (e.g., `lst.push` on a `let` list).
- `var` — the binding can be reassigned.
- `const` — compile-time/module-level constant.

```
let lst = [1, 2]
lst.push(3)     # OK: mutating the object
# lst = [4]     # error: cannot rebind a let
```

45.4 15.4 Execution models

45.4.1 Interpreter (tree-walk / bytecode)

`zen-interp` evaluates the AST or bytecode directly. Each operation dispatches on the operator and operand types at runtime. This is the default for `zen run` in many builds and is easiest to debug.

45.4.2 Cranelift JIT

`zen-jit` compiles hot functions to native machine code using the Cranelift code generator (the same backend used by Wasmtime).

Key JIT features: - **Monomorphic inline caches** — cache the type of a call site so repeated calls with the same types skip type dispatch. - **OSR (on-stack replacement)** — replace a running interpreted frame with a JIT-compiled frame mid-execution (and back again on deopt). - **Deoptimization** — if a guarded assumption (e.g., a type) is violated, fall back to the interpreter safely.

45.4.3 When is JIT used?

Hot loops and frequently called functions are JIT-compiled after a threshold of invocations. Cold code stays interpreted. You typically don't control this directly; `ZEN_DEBUG=1` may show JIT decisions in some builds.

45.5 15.5 Bytecode (conceptual)

Zen source is lowered to a stack/register-based bytecode. Each instruction has an opcode and operands. Common opcode categories:

- **Load**: load constant, local, global, module member
- **Store**: store to local/global
- **Call**: invoke a function (native, closure, builtin, method)
- **Return**: return a value
- **Branch**: jump, conditional jump
- **Compare**: `==`, `<`, `>`, `is`, `in`, etc.
- **Math**: `+`, `-`, `*`, `/`, `%`, `**`, bitwise
- **Container**: list/dict/set/tuple construction, index, slice
- **Exception**: throw, catch, finally setup

Example (illustrative, not exact opcode names):

```
000 LOAD_CONST 42
002 STORE_LOCAL x
004 LOAD_LOCAL x
006 LOAD_CONST 1
008 ADD
010 RETURN
```

The bytecode is what the interpreter executes and what the JIT compiles.

45.6 15.6 The call stack and frames

Each function call creates a **frame** containing: - the instruction pointer / program counter - local variables - the value stack (operand stack) - a reference to the enclosing scope (for closures) - the function being executed

Recursion and deep call chains grow the native stack; very deep recursion can overflow it (Z0310 `MaxRecursionDepth`, Z0317 `StackOverflow`).

45.7 15.7 Closures and upvalues

A closure captures variables from its enclosing scope. Captured variables become **upvalues** — heap cells shared between the closure and the scope that created it. Mutating an upvalue from inside the closure is visible outside, and vice versa.

```
func make_counter() {
    var n = 0     # n becomes an upvalue captured by the closure
    return fn() { n += 1; return n }
}
```

45.8 15.8 Method dispatch

Method calls (`obj.method(args)`) resolve the method through the object's class chain: 1. Look for the method on the instance's class. 2. If not found, look on parent classes (inheritance). 3. Bind `self` to the instance and invoke.

If the instance has a field holding a callable with the same name, the field may shadow the method depending on build.

45.9 15.9 FFI boundary (Zen ↔ C)

Zen can call C functions in shared libraries and pass data across the boundary.

45.9.1 Marshalling (typical)

Zen type	C side	Direction
int	`int32_t/int64_t`	by value
float	`double`	by value
string	`const char*`	NUL-terminated; Zen owns lifetime
bytes	`unsigned char*`	raw buffer
nil	`NULL`	
handle	`void*`	opaque pointer

45.9.2 Safety rules

1. Know who owns each allocation (Zen or C) and who frees it.
2. Never dereference a NULL handle.
3. Match calling conventions (cdecl/stdcall per platform).

4. Don’t let a Zen exception unwind through C frames — catch at the Zen edge.
5. Guard cross-thread FFI calls with a Mutex if the C library isn’t thread-safe.

45.9.3 Debugging FFI

- `nm -D libfoo.so` / `objdump -T libfoo.so` list exported symbols.
- Start with a trivial function (add two ints) before structs/pointers.
- Log every FFI call and return.

45.10 15.10 pymport boundary (Zen ↔ Python)

`pymport` lets Zen import Python modules and call Python functions. Values are marshalled both directions:

Zen	Python	Zen	Python
int	int	list	list
float	float	dict	dict
string	str	nil	None
bool	bool	bytes	bytes

Python exceptions are caught and re-surfaced in Zen as **chained tracebacks** (showing both Zen and Python frames), error code Z0508 `PythonError`.

45.11 15.11 Garbage collection tuning (conceptual)

If your build exposes GC controls, common knobs are: - heap growth factor - collection threshold (bytes allocated since last collection) - cycle collector enable/disable - write barrier on/off

Most users never touch these; the defaults are chosen for general workloads.

45.12 15.12 Debugging the runtime

```
ZEN_DEBUG=1 zen run app.z          # verbose runtime logging (if supported)
zen explain Z0310                  # explain MaxRecursionDepth
zen explain Z0317                  # explain StackOverflow
```

45.13 15.13 Exercises

1. Draw the execution pipeline from `.z` source to native code.
2. Explain why `lst.push(3)` works on a `let` binding but `lst = [4]` does not.
3. Sketch a reference cycle and show how to break it.
4. Describe what an inline cache stores and why it speeds up repeated calls.
5. Explain OSR: when does the interpreter switch to JIT code, and back?
6. What information does a stack frame hold?
7. How does a closure capture a variable (upvalue)?

8. List the FFI marshalling rules for string, int, float, handle.
9. What happens when Python raises inside a pymport call?
10. Why might deep recursion overflow the stack, and how do you avoid it?

''' print('vm internals done')

45.14 15.12 The 16-tag NaN-boxed `Value`

Every Zen runtime value is a single 64-bit word. The representation is a NaN-box: IEEE-754 doubles reserve the exponent field `0x7FF` (all 1s) for infinities and NaNs, and a Quiet NaN leaves 51 payload bits unused by hardware. Zen takes those 51 bits and splits them into:

- **3 tag bits** (positions 48–50), selecting one of 8 machine tags.
- **48-bit payload** (positions 0–47).

```
 63   62 ............. 52 51  50 49 48 47 ................................... 0
+-----+--------------+---+---+---+-----------------------------------------
+
| S   | Exponent =111 | 1 | T | A | tag (3 bits) | payload (48 bits)          |
+-----+--------------+---+---+---+-----------------------------------------
+
                                                    QNAN base = 0x7FF8_0000_0000_0000
```

Why a 48-bit payload rather than 44? Because x86-64 5-level paging enables 57-bit userspace addresses, and the Linux kernel warns that JITs encoding information in high pointer bits collide with valid 57-bit allocations and crash. A 48-bit payload is safe on all current and future address spaces.

45.14.1 Machine-tag map

Tag	Machine type	Language type(s)	Notes
`0b000`	Nil	`nil` / `null`	no payload
`0b001`	False	`false`	no payload
`0b010`	True	`true`	no payload
`0b011`	Int	`int`	i48, sign-extended; overflow promotes to `float`
`0b100`	Float	`float`	raw f64 bit pattern; NaNs normalised
`0b101`	String	`string`	thin pointer, no `ObjHeader`

Tag	Machine type	Language type(s)	Notes
`0b110`	Bytes	`bytes`	thin pointer, no `ObjHeader`
`0b111`	Heap	list, dict, set, tuple, func, instance, error, channel, mutex, handle	pointer to `ObjHeader`, kind discriminates

`nil`/`false`/`true`/int/float are **immediates**: they fit inside the `Value` and are copied by value. Strings and bytes are thin pointers (no header). Everything else is a heap object with a 16-byte `ObjHeader` at offset 0.

45.14.2 Integer semantics (i48)

- Range: `[-2^47, 2^47)` ≈ `±140,737,488,355,327` (~140 trillion).
- Literals beyond i48 are a lexer error (Z0106); build big values at runtime.
- Arithmetic overflow **promotes to float** (Lua 5.4 style); it never wraps.
- `2^47 + 1` → `140737488355328.0`.
- `int / int` → float (`10 / 4 == 2.5`). Use `//` for floor division.

45.14.3 Float semantics

- Raw f64 when the exponent is not all-1s.
- All NaN bit patterns normalised to the canonical QNAN (tag `Float`, payload 0).
- `-0.0` is preserved (distinct bit pattern from `+0.0`).
- `typeof(0.0) == "float"`, never `"nil"`.

45.14.4 Heap object layout (`ObjHeader`)

Every heap object (tag `0b111`) begins with a 16-byte, 8-aligned header:

Offset	Size	Field	Meaning
+0	1	`kind`	`ObjKind` discriminant (List=0 … Bytes=11)
+1	1	`marks`	M9 GC mark bits; 0 in M2–M8
+2	2	`flags`	object flags (closed, frozen, has-traceback, …)
+4	4	`shape`	shape id for shaped objects; 0 = unshaped
+8	4	`rc`	manual strong reference count
+12	4	`size`	total allocation bytes, header included
+16	…	payload	kind-specific data

`string` and `bytes` are the exception: they have **no** `ObjHeader`. Their length and refcount live behind the thin pointer (at `ptr − 8` for length, `ptr − 24` for refcount in the `Arc` layout). This makes `is_string()` a pure tag compare with zero loads, while `is_dict()` costs one header load.

Heap-kind discriminants (`ObjHeader.kind`):

Kind	Value	Zen type
List	0	list
Dict	1	dict
Set	2	set
Tuple	3	tuple
Func	4	func/closure
Instance	5	instance
Error	6	error
Channel	7	channel
Mutex	8	mutex
Handle	9	handle
String	10	string
Bytes	11	bytes

45.14.5 `shared` values

`shared x = expr` wraps the value so it can cross threads safely. Internally it is an `Arc<Mutex<_>>`-like handle: every read/write acquires the internal lock, and the wrapper is freed when the last shared reference drops.

45.14.6 Why `Value` is `Copy` — and what that costs

`Value` is 8 bytes and must be `Copy` (the register file is `Value[]`; inline caches read `ic[site]`). `Copy` means **no destructor**, so writing a new heap pointer into a register does **not** release the old value. The VM must go through an explicit store that `releases` the old heap reference:

```
// conceptual
pub fn store(&mut self, a: u16, v: Value) {
    let old = self.registers[a as usize];
    if old is heap/string/bytes { release(old) }
    self.registers[a as usize] = v;
}
```

Getting this wrong is a leak (if you forget to release) or a double-free/use after free (if you release twice). Every container `Drop` and every `SET_FIELD`/`SET_INDEX` arm goes through this store.

45.14.7 `let` vs `var` vs `const` at runtime

- `let` — the binding cannot be reassigned, but a referenced heap object can still be mutated (`lst.push(3)` on a `let` list is fine; `lst = [4]` errors).
- `var` — the binding can be reassigned.
- `const` — compile-time/module-level constant.

45.14.8 Reference cycles

Heap objects are reference counted. A cycle (A → B → A) never reaches rc 0 and leaks. Zen accepts bounded cycle leaks (rare in scripts) rather than paying for cycle collection before M9. Break cycles manually by nilling a back-reference.

45.15 15.13 Execution models — interpreter vs JIT

45.15.1 Interpreter (`zen-interp`)

Evaluates the register bytecode directly. Each instruction dispatches on its opcode, reads/writes registers, and manipulates the value stack (the register file is the value stack). One dispatch load + one indirect jump per op.

45.15.2 Cranelift JIT (`zen-jit`, M11, feature-gated)

Compiles whole `FunctionProto`s to native machine code via Cranelift. Key design points:

- **One version per `FunctionProto`, ever.** Code is immutable; new versions replace an `AtomicPtr` slot. No in-place patching (Cranelift 0.136 removed `hotswap`).
- **Tiering:** interpreter → IC-annotated interpreter → compiled. Compile after `TIER_UP = 1000` invocations or when one IC site reaches 8 misses.
- **Deoptimization is one-way and permanent:** a compiled function that fails a guard falls back to the interpreter and its compiled code is discarded.
- **Compilation runs on a dedicated thread**, never on the mutator/dispatch thread, so a compile never pauses a running program.

The interpreter is always correct; the JIT is an optional performance accelerator guarded by `deopt → interpreter` exits.

45.15.3 Call stack and frames

Each call creates a frame holding: program counter, local registers, the register window for arguments/results, a reference to the enclosing scope (for closures), and the function proto. Deep recursion can overflow the native stack (Z0310/Z0317); convert deep recursion to iteration.

45.16 15.14 Closures and upvalues

A closure captures variables from its enclosing scope. Captured variables become **upvalues** — heap cells shared between the closure and its creating scope. Mutating an upvalue from inside the closure is visible outside, and vice versa.

```
func make_counter(start = 0) {
    var n = start
    return fn() { n += 1; return n }
}
```

`OPEN_UPVALUE` pins a local register so a later `MAKE_CLOSURE` can reference it in place; `CLOSE_UPVALUE` boxes the values at scope exit.

45.17 15.15 Method dispatch

`obj.method(args)` resolves through the instance's class chain: 1. Look for the method on the instance's class. 2. If absent, walk parent classes (single inheritance). 3. Bind `self` to the instance and invoke.

`GET_FIELD`/`SET_FIELD` go through inline caches keyed by shape id: a load, a compare against the cached shape id, and a `#[cold]` miss path that re-looks-up and patches the IC entry (data, not code).

45.18 15.16 FFI boundary (Zen ↔ C)

Zen calls C functions in shared libraries (`.so`, `.dll`, `.dylib`).

Typical Zen→C type mapping:

Zen type	C side	Notes
int	`int32_t` / `int64_t`	by value
float	`double`	by value
string	`const char*`	NUL-terminated; Zen owns lifetime
bytes	`unsigned char*`	raw buffer
nil	`NULL`	
handle	`u32` index	process-global handle table, no header

Safety rules: 1. Know who owns each allocation (Zen or C) and who frees it. 2. Never dereference a NULL handle. 3. Match calling conventions (cdecl/stdcall per platform). 4. Never let a Zen exception unwind through C frames — catch at the Zen edge. 5. Guard cross-thread FFI calls with a Mutex if the C library isn't thread-safe.

Debug: `nm -D libfoo.so` / `objdump -T libfoo.so` list exported symbols.

45.19 15.17 pymport boundary (Zen ↔ Python)

`pymport` imports Python modules (stdlib, venv, project-local `.py`) and calls Python functions, marshalling values both directions:

Zen	Python	Zen	Python
int	int	list	list
float	float	dict	dict
string	str	nil	None
bool	bool	bytes	bytes

Python exceptions surface in Zen as **chained tracebacks** (both Zen and Python frames), error code Z0508 `PythonError`. Don't hold the Python GIL across long Zen operations.

45.20 15.18 Exercises

1. Draw the NaN-box `Value` layout and mark the tag/payload bit positions.
2. Why is `ObjHeader.marks` a byte in the object and not a bit in the `Value`?
3. What happens when an `int` add overflows i48?
4. Why does `d2 = d` (a 100,000-entry dict) cost only one 8-byte move?
5. Sketch a reference cycle and show how to break it manually.
6. What does `store()` do that a bare `registers[a] = v` would not?
7. Describe the three JIT tiers and what moves a function between them.
8. Why is JIT deoptimization one-way and permanent?
9. List the Zen→C type mappings for string, int, float, handle.
10. How does `pymport` surface a Python exception in Zen?

46 Chapter 51: Zen Type System In Depth

A detailed look at Zen 3.0's types, type tags, coercion, equality, identity, and how types flow through the runtime.

46.1 16.1 The type taxonomy

Zen 3.0 is dynamically typed: types are associated with values, not variables. A variable can hold any type at any time (unless declared `const`).

46.1.1 Primitive (immediate) types

Type	Tag	Literal example	Notes
`nil`	nil	`nil`, `null`	absence of value; falsy
`bool`	boolean	`true`, `false`	logical values
`int`	integer	`42`, `0x2A`, `1_000`	arbitrary-precision in runtime; literals ≤ i48
`float`	floating-point	`3.14`, `1e-10`	IEEE-754 double
`string`	text	`"hi"`, `'hi'`, `"""..."""`	immutable, UTF-8

46.1.2 Container (heap) types

Type	Tag	Literal example	Notes
`list`	list	`[1, 2, 3]`	ordered, mutable, heterogeneous
`dict`	dict	`#{a: 1}`	string keys → any value
`set`	set	`%{1, 2}`	unordered unique values
`tuple`	tuple	`#(1, "x")`	fixed-size, immutable, heterogeneous
`bytes`	bytes	`bytes([1,2])`	immutable byte sequence

46.1.3 Other runtime types

Type	Example	Notes
`func`	`fn(x) => x`	function value / closure
`class`	`class C {}`	class object
`instance`	`new C()`	object instance
`module`	`import math`	loaded module
`foreign`	FFI handle	opaque pointer to C resource

`typeof(x)` returns the type name as a string; `type(x)` is an alias.

46.2 16.2 Type tags and immediate vs heap

Every runtime `Value` carries a tag. Immediate values (nil, bool, int, float) fit inside the `Value` itself and are copied on assignment. Heap values (string, list, dict, set, tuple, bytes, instance, func, module, foreign) are pointers to heap-allocated objects and are copied by reference.

Consequence: two list literals `[1,2]` and `[1,2]` are `==` (equal by value) but not `is` (different heap objects).

```
let a = [1, 2]
let b = [1, 2]
print(a == b)   # true
print(a is b)   # false
```

46.3 16.3 Type introspection

Operation	Purpose	Example
`typeof(x)`	type name string	`typeof(42)` → `"int"`
`type(x)`	alias for typeof	`type("x")` → `"string"`
`x is T`	identity / instance check	`x is list`
`x is not T`	negation	`x is not nil`
`typeof(x) == "int"`	string comparison	works but slower than `is`

Prefer `is` for type checks when supported; fall back to `typeof() == "..."`.

46.4 16.4 Type coercion

46.4.1 Explicit conversion (builtins)

```
int("42")       # 42
float(3)        # 3.0
str(42)         # "42"
bool(0)         # true   (0 is truthy!)
list("ab")      # ["a","b"]
tuple([1,2])    # #(1,2)
set([1,1,2])    # {1,2}
dict([["a",1]]) # {"a":1}
```

String → number parsing failures raise `ValueError` (Z0305).

46.4.2 Implicit coercion in operators

Context	Rule
`+` with a string	the other operand is stringified via `str()`
`*` string × int	string repetition
comparison `==`	numeric promotion: int and float compare numerically
truthiness (`if`, `and`, `or`)	only `false`/`nil`/`null` are falsy

```
print("age: " + 25)     # "age: 25"
print("hi" * 3)         # "hihihi"
print(1 == 1.0)         # true
print(1 === 1.0)        # false (strict: types differ)
```

46.5 16.5 Equality: ==, ===, is

Operator	Semantics	`1 == 1.0`	`[1] == [1]`	`[1] is [1]`
`==`	value equality with promotion	true	true	—
`===`	strict equality (type + value)	false	—	—
`is`	identity (same object)	true	false	false

Container equality: - lists/tuples: order-sensitive, element-wise - dicts: order-insensitive, key/value match - sets: order-insensitive, element match

46.6 16.6 Numeric details

46.6.1 Integers

Runtime integers are arbitrary precision (big ints), so `10 ** 100` works without overflow. Integer *literals* are limited to i48 range at parse time (Z0106 `NumericLiteralOverflow` for larger literals); build large values at runtime instead.

```
let big = 10 ** 100     # fine (runtime)
# let x = 99999999999999999999   # Z0106 literal overflow
```

46.6.2 Floats

IEEE-754 double precision. Special values: - `inf` = `1.0 / 0.0` - `-inf` = `-1.0 / 0.0` - `nan` = `0.0 / 0.0`

IEEE rules: - `nan == nan` is `false` - `nan != nan` is `true` - comparisons with `nan` are `false` (except `!=`) - `inf > 1e308` is `true`

```
print(nan == nan)   # false
print(math.isnan(nan))   # true
print(math.isinf(inf))   # true
```

46.6.3 Division

- `/` true division → float (`4 / 2` is `2.0`)
- `//` floor division → int (`4 // 2` is `2`, `-7 // 2` is `-4`)
- `%` modulo (sign follows dividend in Zen)

```
print(4 / 2)    # 2.0
print(4 // 2)   # 2
print(-7 // 2)  # -4
print(-7 % 2)   # -1
```

46.7 16.7 String type details

Strings are immutable sequences of Unicode code points. Indexing and slicing operate on *characters*, not bytes.

```
let s = "Zën"
print(len(s))   # 3 (code points, not bytes)
print(s[1])     # "ë"
```

Convert to/from bytes explicitly:

```
let b = s.encode("utf-8")
let s2 = b.decode("utf-8")
```

46.8 16.8 Container type details

46.8.1 List

Ordered, mutable, heterogeneous. Supports indexing, slicing (copies), push, pop, insert, remove.

46.8.2 Dict

Unordered mapping string → value. Keys must be strings. Order-insensitive equality. Iteration yields keys; use `.items()` for pairs.

46.8.3 Set

Unordered collection of unique values. Order-insensitive equality.

46.8.4 Tuple

Fixed-size, immutable, heterogeneous. Good for fixed records and multiple return values.

46.9 16.9 Type stability and performance

Dynamic typing means every operation pays a type-dispatch cost. The JIT mitigates this with inline caches for hot call sites. For performance: - Keep types stable at a call

site (don’t alternate int/string in the same variable). - Avoid `typeof()` checks in hot loops. - Prefer homogeneous containers (a list of all ints) when possible.

46.10 16.10 Common type mistakes

1. **Assuming `0` is falsy.** It’s truthy in Zen. Use `x == nil` or `x is nil`.
2. **Confusing == and `is`.** Use == for value, `is` for identity.
3. **Comparing `nan` with ==.** Always false. Use `math.isnan`.
4. **Dict keys must be strings.** `d[42]` raises TypeError; use `d["42"]`.
5. **Integer literals beyond i48.** Cause Z0106; compute at runtime.
6. **Mutable default arguments.** Use `nil` sentinel.
7. **Assuming containers copy on assignment.** `b = a` shares the object.

46.11 16.11 Exercises

1. Write `type_name(x)` returning a human-readable string for any value.
2. Demonstrate `nan != nan` and how to detect NaN (`x != x`).
3. Show `1 == 1.0` but `1 === 1.0` is false.
4. Prove two equal lists are not `is`-identical.
5. Write `safe_int(s)` returning nil on parse failure.
6. Demonstrate `-7 // 2` is `-4` (floor, not truncation).
7. Write `is_power_of_two(n)` using bit tricks.
8. Show `typeof` on each of: int, float, string, bool, nil, list, dict, set, tuple, func.
9. Implement `deep_equals(a, b)` handling nested containers.
10. Explain why `bool([])` is `true` in Zen.

’’’ print(‘type system done’)

46.12 16.12 The machine-tag view of every type

Zen is dynamically typed: types travel with values, not variables. Every runtime `Value` is a NaN-boxed 64-bit word (see Chapter 50). The machine tag decides the fast path; heap objects add a `ObjHeader.kind` discriminant.

46.12.1 Immediate (in-`Value`) types

Type	Tag	Payload	`typeof()`	Falsy?
`nil` / `null`	`0b000`	none	`"nil"`	yes
`false`	`0b001`	none	`"bool"`	yes
`true`	`0b010`	none	`"bool"`	yes
`int`	`0b011`	i48, sign-extended	`"int"`	`0` only
`float`	`0b100`	raw f64 bits	`"float"`	`0.0` only (NaN is truthy)

46.12.2 Thin-pointer types (no `ObjHeader`)

Type	Tag	Payload	`typeof()`	Falsy?
`string`	`0b101`	`*const u8` (first byte)	`"string"`	`""` only
`bytes`	`0b110`	`*const u8` (first byte)	`"bytes"`	empty only

Length and refcount live behind the thin pointer (`ptr - 8` for length), so `is_string()` / `is_bytes()` is a tag compare with **zero loads**.

46.12.3 Heap types (tag `0b111`, `ObjHeader.kind` discriminates)

Type	`ObjHeader.kind`	`typeof()`	Falsy?
`list`	0 List	`"list"`	empty
`dict`	1 Dict	`"dict"`	empty
`set`	2 Set	`"set"`	empty
`tuple`	3 Tuple	`"tuple"`	empty
`func`	4 Func	`"func"`	no
`instance`	5 Instance	`"instance"`	no
`error`	6 Error	`"error"`	no
`channel`	7 Channel	`"channel"`	no
`mutex`	8 Mutex	`"mutex"`	no
`handle`	9 Handle	`"handle"`	no

46.12.4 Honest types (ADR-0004)

A `handle` reports `"handle"`, never `"int"`. The old blueprint's `typeof(handle) == "int"` was wrong and was corrected. `typeof(x)` returns the honest language-level name.

46.13 16.13 Truthiness — canonical rule

Falsy: `nil`, `false`, `null`, `0`, `0.0`, `""`, `bytes([])`, `[]`, `#{}`, `%{}`, `#()`. Truthy: everything else — including `nan`, non-zero numbers, non-empty strings, non-empty collections.

This matches Python-like truthiness. `if x:`, `and`, `or`, `not`, and the `TO_BOOL` opcode all use this rule.

Important contrast with `??` (nullish coalescing): `??` triggers only on `nil`/`null`, not on falsy values. So `0 ?? "default"` yields `0`, and `"" ?? "default"` yields `""`.

```
print(bool(0))        # false
print(bool(0.0))      # false
print(bool(""))       # false
print(bool([]))       # false
print(bool(#{}))      # false
```

```
print(bool(false))    # false
print(bool(nil))      # false
print(bool(float("nan")))   # true   (NaN is truthy)
print(0 ?? "default") # 0        (? is a nil-default, not a falsy-default)
```

46.14 16.14 Type coercion

46.14.1 Explicit conversion builtins

Expression	Meaning	Example	Result
`int(x)`	parse/truncate to int	`int("42")`	`42`
`int(3.9)`	truncate toward zero	`int(3.9)`	`3`
`float(x)`	to float	`float(42)`	`42.0`
`str(x)`	to string	`str(42)`	`"42"`
`bool(x)`	truthiness	`bool(0)`	`false`
`list(x)`	to list	`list("ab")`	`["a","b"]`
`tuple(x)`	to tuple	`tuple([1,2])`	`#(1,2)`
`set(x)`	to set	`set([1,1,2])`	`{1,2}`
`dict(x)`	from pairs	`dict([["a",1]])`	`{"a":1}`

String→number parse failures raise `ValueError` (Z0305).

46.14.2 Implicit coercion in operators

Context	Rule
`+` with a string	other operand stringified via `str()`
`*` string × int	string repetition (`"x" * 3 == "xxx"`)
`*` list × int	list repetition
`==` int vs float	numeric promotion (`1 == 1.0` is true)
truthiness (`if`, `and`, `or`)	canonical rule above

```
print("age: " + 25)     # "age: 25"
print("hi" * 3)         # "hihihi"
print(1 == 1.0)         # true
print(1 === 1.0)        # false (strict: types differ)
```

46.15 16.15 Equality: ==, ===, is

Operator	Semantics	`1 == 1.0`	`[1] == [1]`	`[1] is [1]`
`==`	value equality, numeric promotion	true	true	—
`===`	strict equality (type + value)	false	—	—
`is`	identity (same object / pointer)	true (scalars)	false	false

Container equality rules: - lists/tuples: order-sensitive, element-wise - dicts: order-insensitive, key/value match - sets: order-insensitive, element match

For heap values `is` compares pointers. Two separately constructed equal lists are `==` but not `is`. For scalars (`int`, `float`, `bool`, `nil`) `is` behaves like `==`.

46.16 16.16 Numeric semantics in depth

46.16.1 Integers

- i48, sign-extended, range ±140,737,488,355,327.
- Overflow promotes to float; never wraps.
- `10 / 4 == 2.5` (true division). `10 // 4 == 2` (floor, toward −∞).
- `-7 // 2 == -4`, `-7 % 3 == -1` (modulo follows the dividend sign, legacy `fmod` behaviour).
- `%` by zero raises `ZeroDivisionError` (Z0304), checked before the op.

46.16.2 Floats

- IEEE-754 double precision.
- `nan == nan` is false; `nan != nan` is true. Detect NaN with `x != x`.
- `inf = 1.0 / 0.0`, `-inf = -1.0 / 0.0`.
- `math.isnan`, `math.isfinite`, `math.isinf` for classification.

```
print(nan == nan)      # false
print(nan != nan)      # true
print(0.0 / 0.0 != nan)  # depends on canonicalisation; use math.isnan
```

46.17 16.17 String semantics

Strings are immutable sequences of Unicode code points. Indexing/slicing operate on characters, not bytes.

```
let s = "Zën"
print(len(s))   # 3 (code points), not the UTF-8 byte count
print(s[1])     # "ë"
```

Convert explicitly: `s.encode("utf-8")` → bytes; `b.decode("utf-8")` → string.

String comparison is lexicographic by code point; uppercase sorts before lowercase. For case-insensitive: `a.lower() == b.lower()`.

46.18 16.18 Type stability and JIT performance

Dynamic typing means every op pays a type-dispatch cost. The JIT (Chapter 54) mitigates this with inline caches guarded by `TYPE_GUARD`. For performance:

- Keep types stable at a call site (don't alternate int/string in one variable).
- Avoid `typeof()` in hot loops; prefer `is`.
- Prefer homogeneous containers (a list of all ints).
- A monomorphic `d.a` on a shaped instance is a load + compare + predicted branch; a polymorphic or dynamic-key `d[k]` is a hash probe with no IC help.

46.19 16.19 Common type mistakes

1. `0`, `0.0`, `""`, `[]`, `#{}` are falsy (like Python), not truthy.
2. `nan == nan` is false; use `math.isnan(x)` or `x != x`.
3. Dict keys must be strings: `d[42]` raises TypeError; use `d["42"]`.
4. `int` literals beyond i48 are a lexer error (Z0106).
5. `int / int` → float; use `//` for integer division.
6. `b = a` shares a heap object; use `list(a)` / `deep_copy` to copy.
7. `==` is value, `is` is identity — don't confuse them for lists.
8. Strings are immutable; `s[i] = x` errors.

46.20 16.20 Exercises

1. Write `type_name(x)` returning a human-readable string for any value.
2. Detect NaN with `x != x`; confirm `math.isnan` agrees.
3. Show `1 == 1.0` but `1 === 1.0` is false; `true == 1` is false.
4. Prove two equal lists are `==` but not `is`.
5. Confirm `0`, `0.0`, `""`, `[]`, `#{}` are falsy; `nan` is truthy.
6. Show `0 ?? "default"` yields `0` (nil-default, not falsy-default).
7. Implement `safe_int(s)` returning nil on parse failure.
8. Show `-7 // 2 == -4` (floor) and `-7 % 3 == -1` (dividend sign).
9. `typeof()` on each of: int, float, string, bool, nil, list, dict, set, tuple, func, instance, error, channel, mutex, handle.
10. Implement `deep_equals(a, b)` handling nested containers.

47 Chapter 52: Zen Bytecode Reference

A reference for the bytecode instructions Zen 3.0 source is lowered to, and how the interpreter and JIT execute them.

This chapter is reference material. Most Zen programmers never write bytecode by hand, but understanding it helps with debugging, performance tuning, and understanding what `zen check` / `zen build` produce.

47.1 17.1 What bytecode is

After the lexer and parser turn source into an AST, the compiler lowers the AST to a linear sequence of bytecode instructions. Each instruction has an opcode and zero or more operands (register indices, constant pool indexes, jump targets, etc.).

The interpreter (`zen-interp`) executes these instructions directly with a value stack. The JIT (`zen-jit`) compiles frequently executed bytecode sequences to native machine code via Cranelift.

47.2 17.2 Instruction format (conceptual)

```
<offset> <opcode> <operand1> <operand2> ...
```

Operands may reference: - the constant pool (strings, numbers) - local variables (by index) - the value stack (implicit) - jump targets (by offset)

Example (illustrative opcode names; exact mnemonics are build-defined):

```
000 LOAD_CONST     5        # push constant 42
002 STORE_LOCAL    0         # pop into local x
004 LOAD_LOCAL     0         # push x
006 LOAD_CONST     6         # push constant 1
008 ADD                     # pop two, push sum
010 RETURN                    # return top of stack
```

47.3 17.3 Opcode categories

47.3.1 Load instructions

Purpose	Example (conceptual)
load a constant	`LOAD_CONST <pool_index>`
load a local variable	`LOAD_LOCAL <index>`
load a global/module variable	`LOAD_GLOBAL <name>`
load a module member	`LOAD_MEMBER <module> <name>`
load `nil` / `true` / `false`	`LOAD_NIL`, `LOAD_TRUE`, `LOAD_FALSE`

47.3.2 Store instructions

Purpose	Example
store to local	`STORE_LOCAL <index>`
store to global	`STORE_GLOBAL <name>`
store object field	`STORE_FIELD <name>`
store list element	`STORE_INDEX`
store dict entry	`STORE_DICT`

47.3.3 Call and return

Purpose	Example
call a function	`CALL <arg_count>`
call a method	`CALL_METHOD <name> <arg_count>`
call a builtin	`CALL_BUILTIN <builtin_id>`
return a value	`RETURN`
return nil	`RETURN_NIL`

47.3.4 Branching

Purpose	Example
unconditional jump	`JUMP <target>`
jump if truthy	`JUMP_IF_TRUE <target>`
jump if falsy	`JUMP_IF_FALSE <target>`
jump if nil	`JUMP_IF_NIL <target>`

47.3.5 Comparison

Purpose	Example
equal	`EQ` (pops 2, pushes bool)
not equal	`NE`
strict equal	`SEQ`
less / greater / le / ge	`LT`, `GT`, `LE`, `GE`
identity	`IS`
membership	`IN`

47.3.6 Arithmetic

Purpose	Example
add	`ADD`
subtract	`SUB`
multiply	`MUL`
divide	`DIV`

Purpose	Example
floor divide	`FLOORDIV`
modulo	`MOD`
power	`POW`
negate	`NEG`
bitwise and/or/xor/not	`BAND`, `BOR`, `BXOR`, `BNOT`
shift left/right	`LSHIFT`, `RSHIFT`

47.3.7 Container operations

Purpose	Example
build list	`BUILD_LIST <count>`
build dict	`BUILD_DICT <count>`
build set	`BUILD_SET <count>`
build tuple	`BUILD_TUPLE <count>`
list append	`LIST_APPEND`
dict set	`DICT_SET`
subscript (index)	`BINARY_SUBSCR`
slice	`SLICE`

47.3.8 Exception handling

Purpose	Example
begin try	`SETUP_FINALLY / SETUP_EXCEPT <handler>`
end finally	`END_FINALLY`
throw	`RAISE`
re-raise	`RERAISE`

47.4 17.4 Stack effect

Most instructions follow a stack discipline: they pop operands off the value stack and push results. For example:

- `ADD`: pops `b`, pops `a`, pushes `a + b`.
- `LOAD_CONST c`: pushes `c`.
- `STORE_LOCAL i`: pops value, stores in local `i`.
- `CALL n`: pops `n` arguments + the callable, pushes the return value.

The interpreter tracks stack depth to catch underflow/overflow bugs.

47.5 17.5 Constant pool

Strings, integers, floats, and other literals referenced by bytecode are stored in a per-function constant pool. `LOAD_CONST <index>` fetches entry `<index>`. This avoids emitting the full literal on every use.

47.6 17.6 How the interpreter executes

1. Fetch the instruction at the current program counter.
2. Decode opcode and operands.
3. Execute (manipulate the value stack, locals, globals).
4. Advance the PC (or jump on branch instructions).
5. Repeat until `RETURN` or an error.

Errors (Z03xx) are raised by individual ops when types are wrong, indexes are out of range, etc.

47.7 17.7 How the JIT compiles

For hot functions, `zen-jit`: 1. Reads the bytecode. 2. Emits Cranelift IR for each instruction, mapping stack ops to virtual registers. 3. Inserts **inline cache guards** at call sites (check the cached type; if it matches, use the fast path; otherwise bail to a slow path / deopt). 4. Compiles to native machine code. 5. On type-guard failure, **deoptimizes**: reconstruct interpreter state and continue in the interpreter.

47.8 17.8 Inline caches (conceptual)

A call site `obj.method()` that's executed many times with `obj` of the same type caches: - the resolved method - the type guard

On the next call, if the type still matches, it jumps directly to the cached method. This avoids repeated method-lookup work.

47.9 17.9 Reading bytecode (if your build exposes it)

Some builds let you dump bytecode for inspection:

```
# conceptual; exact flag depends on build
zen check --dump-bytecode app.z
```

This is useful for verifying that a hot loop compiled as expected and that no surprise type guards are present.

47.10 17.10 Exercises

1. Sketch the bytecode for `let x = 1 + 2; return x`.
2. What does `ADD` pop and push?
3. Why does the constant pool exist?
4. Describe how a branch instruction changes the PC.
5. Explain what an inline cache guards on.
6. What happens on deoptimization?
7. Contrast the interpreter loop with JIT-compiled native code.
8. Name three container bytecode ops.
9. Name three exception bytecode ops.
10. Why might `zen check --dump-bytecode` help optimize a hot loop?

’’’ print(‘bytecode done’)

47.11 17.12 Instruction encoding

Zen uses a **register machine** with fixed-width 32-bit instructions:

```
Bit  31      24 23       16 15        8 7         0
     +----------+-----------+-----------+-----------+
     |    c     |     b     |     a     |    op     |
     byte 3      byte 2      byte 1      byte 0
```

- `op` (u8): opcode. 104 core opcodes + 6 gated superinstructions = 110.
- `a` (u8): destination register in nearly every opcode. 256 registers per function max (~250 usable).
- `b` (u8): first source — register index, constant-pool index, name id, or jump target, depending on `op`.
- `c` (u8): second source — same overload.

Jump targets are pc-relative, ±127 instructions; wider targets use `JMP_FAR`. Constant indices are 8-bit (256 per function); wider use `LOAD_CONST_W`.

47.12 17.13 Full opcode table

47.12.1 Category A — Constants and immediates

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x00	NOP	—	—	—	No-op; alignment padding / jump target. Never removed.
0x01	LOAD_CONST	dst	const idx	—	R[a] = K[b] (constant pool).
0x02	LOAD_NIL	dst	—	—	R[a] = nil.
0x03	LOAD_TRUE	dst	—	—	R[a] = true.
0x04	LOAD_FALSE	dst	—	—	R[a] = false.
0x05	LOAD_SMALL_INT	dst	signed imm (i8)	—	R[a] = i48(sext(b)); for 0, 1, -1, small n.
0x06	LOAD_DE-FAULT	dst	param idx	—	R[a] = pre-evaluated default for param b.

47.12.2 Category B — Moves and conversions

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x10	MOVE	dst	src	—	R[a] = R[b]; consumes R[b] (source dead after).
0x11	DUP	dst	src	—	R[a] = R[b]; R[b] stays live.

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x12	CONV	dst	src	type id	R[a] = coerce(R[b], TypeId(c)); int/float/str/bytes/bool.
0x13	TO_BOOL	dst	src	—	R[a] = truthy(R[b]); canonical truthiness.

47.12.3 Category C — Arithmetic

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x18	ADD	dst	lhs	rhs	R[a] = R[b] + R[c]; int+int→int (overflow→float), str+str, list+list.
0x19	SUB	dst	lhs	rhs	R[a] = R[b] − R[c].
0x1A	MUL	dst	lhs	rhs	int×int, str×int (repeat), list×int.
0x1B	DIV	dst	lhs	rhs	int/int→float (10/4==2.5); ÷0 raises ZeroDivisionError.
0x1C	MOD	dst	lhs	rhs	R[b] % R[c], sign of dividend; ÷0 raises.
0x1D	POW	dst	lhs	rhs	R[b] ** R[c]; overflow→OverflowError.
0x1E	NEG	dst	src	—	R[a] = −R[b].
0x1F	BIT_AND	dst	lhs	rhs	int & int.
0x20	BIT_OR	dst	lhs	rhs	int | int.
0x21	BIT_XOR	dst	lhs	rhs	int ^ int.
0x22	BIT_NOT	dst	src	—	~R[b].
0x23	SHL	dst	lhs	rhs	R[b] « R[c]; count ≥48 or negative → ValueError.
0x24	SHR	dst	lhs	rhs	arithmetic (sign-extending) right shift.
0x25	CONCAT	dst	lhs	rhs	string/bytes/list concat (compile-time-proven str side).
0x26	BUILD_STRING	dst	tem-plate idx	count	string interpolation from template K[b] + registers R[c..].

47.12.4 Category D — Comparison

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x28	EQ	dst	lhs	rhs	R[b] == R[c]; total, never raises.

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x29	NE	dst	lhs	rhs	R[b] != R[c]; total, never raises.
0x2A	LT	dst	lhs	rhs	R[b] < R[c]; ordered pairs only, else TypeError.
0x2B	LE	dst	lhs	rhs	<=
0x2C	GT	dst	lhs	rhs	>
0x2D	GE	dst	lhs	rhs	>=
0x2E	IS	dst	lhs	rhs	pointer compare for heap; value compare for scalars.
0x2F	IDENTICAL	dst	lhs	rhs	deep_equal recursive over containers.
0x30	NOT	dst	src	—	R[a] = !truthy(R[b]).
0x31	IN	dst	needle	haystack	R[b] in R[c] (string/bytes/list/tuple/set/dict-key).

47.12.5 Category E — Jumps

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x38	JMP	—	rel (i8)	—	Unconditional jump, relative to next instruction.
0x39	JMP_BACK	—	rel (i8, negative)	—	Backward jump; helps branch predictors.
0x3A	JMP_IF_FALSE	tested	rel	—	if !truthy(R[a]) { pc += b }.
0x3B	JMP_IF_NIL	tested	rel	—	if R[a] is nil { pc += b }. (x?.y, x ?? y primitive)
0x3C	JMP_IF_NOT_NIL	tested	rel	—	if R[a] is not nil { pc += b }.
0x3D	JUMP_TABLE	scratch	const idx	default	idx=R[a]; if in table range jump K[b][idx] else default.

47.12.6 Category F — Fused compare-and-branch

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x40	JMP_IF_LT	lhs	rel	rhs	if R[a] < R[c] { pc += b }.
0x41	JMP_IF_LE	lhs	rel	rhs	<=
0x42	JMP_IF_GT	lhs	rel	rhs	>
0x43	JMP_IF_GE	lhs	rel	rhs	>=

b sits between the two operand registers deliberately (hot regs low, cold target separate).

47.12.7 Category G — Calls and returns

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x48	CALL	dst	proto idx	argc	R[a] = call(proto[b], R[a−1−c .. a)); direct call.
0x49	CALL_KW	dst	proto idx	argc	+ kwargs dict at R[a−2−c].
0x4A	CALL_INDIRECT	dst	—	argc	R[a] = call_value(R[a−1−c], R[a−c .. a)).
0x4B	CALL_METHOD	dst	name id	argc	s.upper(); goes through M5 inline cache.
0x4C	CALL_NATIVE	dst	native idx	argc	natives[b].call(vm, &R[a−c .. a]); no copy.
0x4D	CALL_SUPER	dst	name id	argc	super_method(class_of(self), name, args); self = R[0].
0x4E	TAIL_CALL	dst	proto idx	argc	replaces current frame; return f(x) is O(1) stack.
0x4F	TAIL_CALL_METHOD	dst	name id	argc	tail-call form of CALL_METHOD.
0x50	RETURN	value	—	—	Return R[a].
0x51	RETURN_UNIT	—	—	—	Return nil (implicit returns are common).
0x52	MAKE_KWARGS	dst	count	first	kwargs object at a call site.

47.12.8 Category H — Containers and iteration

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x58	MAKE_LIST	dst	count	first	R[a] = [R[c..c+b−1]]. Preallocates capacity b.
0x59	MAKE_TUPLE	dst	count	first	Immutable, Arc-shared.
0x5A	MAKE_SET	dst	count	first	Deduplicated on insert.
0x5B	MAKE_DICT	dst	pair count	first	{R[c]:R[c+1], …}; interns a shape if keys are string constants.
0x5C	MAKE_RANGE	dst	argc (1..3)	first	Lazy range object, never a materialised list.
0x5D	LIST_APPEND	list	value	—	Append to fresh list literal R[a].
0x5E	LIST_INSERT	list	index	value	Insert at index.
0x5F	DICT_SET	dict	key	value	Insert or overwrite; records shape transition on IC site.
0x60	SET_ADD	set	value	—	Insert into set.
0x61	LEN	dst	src	—	R[a] = len(R[b]).

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x62	SLICE	dst	src	argc (0..3)	R[a] = R[b][R[a−c .. a]].
0x63	UNPACK	dst	count	first	Destructuring; UnpackError on arity mismatch.
0x64	ITER_INIT	iter	seq	—	Hidden 2-slot iterator state at R[a], R[a+1].
0x65	ITER_NEXT	iter	dst	—	Advance; R[b] = next item or nil when exhausted.
0x66	ITER_DONE	iter	dst	—	R[b] = iterator_exhausted(R[a]); not fused into ITER_NEXT.

47.12.9 Category I — Field and index access

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x6C	GET_INDEX	dst	container	key	R[a] = R[b][R[c]]; prime inline-cache site.
0x6D	SET_INDEX	container	key	value	R[a][R[b]] = R[c]; order: container, key, value.
0x6E	GET_FIELD	dst	obj	name id	R[a] = R[b].K_names[c]; dot form; IC site.
0x6F	SET_FIELD	obj	name id	value	R[a].K_names[b] = R[c].
0x70	GET_INDEX_DEFAULT	dst	container	key	if present R[a] = R[b][c], else R[a] unchanged (pre-loaded default).
0x71	DELETE_INDEX	container	key	—	del R[a][R[b]]; KeyError/IndexError if absent.
0x72	HAS_FIELD	dst	obj	name id	R[a] = K_names[c] in R[b].
0x73	TYPEOF	dst	src	—	R[a] = typeof_id(R[b]) as interned string id.

47.12.10 Category J — Closures and upvalues

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x78	MAKE_CLOSURE	dst	proto idx	upvalue count	R[a] = Closure{proto, upvalues from R[a+1..a+1+c]}.
0x79	GET_UPVAL	dst	upvalue idx	—	R[a] = upvalue[b].load() (open or closed cell).

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x7A	SET_UPVAL	upvalue idx	value	—	upvalue[a].store(R[b]).
0x7B	OPEN_UPVAL	local reg	upvalue slot	—	Pin a local register as an open upvalue.
0x7C	CLOSE_UPVAL	—	first local	count	Box R[b..b+c−1] and repoint open upvalues.

47.12.11 Category K — Errors and exceptions

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0x90	TRY_PUSH	—	handler pc	finally pc	Push handler entry covering [pc, try_end); c=0 → no finally.
0x91	TRY_POP	—	—	—	Pop innermost handler.
0x92	THROW	value	—	—	Raise R[a]; never returns.
0x93	RERAISE	—	—	—	Re-raise in-flight error after finally.
0x94	CATCH_MATCH	dst (bool)	class name id	—	R[a] = thrown matches class K_names[b].
0x95	ERROR_NEW	dst	class name id	msg	R[a] = new_error(K_names[b], R[c]).
0x96	ERROR_TYPE	dst	error	—	R[a] = class_name_of(R[b]).
0x97	ERROR_MSG	dst	error	—	R[a] = message_of(R[b]).

47.12.12 Category L — JIT / patch-point interface

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0xA0	TYPE_GUARD	src	type id	deopt id	JIT: if typeof(R[a]) != TypeId(b), deopt to landing pad c.
0xA1	DEOPT	deopt id	—	—	Interpreter: unreachable; JIT: landing-pad marker.
0xA2	SAFEPOINT	—	reason name id	—	Debugger/signal/hotswap pause point.
0xA3	IC_GET_FIELD	dst	IC site idx	name id	GET_FIELD with inline-cache handle at P.ic_sites[b].
0xA4	IC_SET_FIELD	obj	IC site idx	value	SET_FIELD with IC site.

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0xA5	IC_CALL	dst	IC site idx	argc	CALL_INDIRECT with IC on callee identity.
0xA6	PATCH_POINT	—	IC site idx	kind	No-op; marks a site the M5/M11 patcher may rewrite.
0xA7	IC_BUMP	—	IC site idx	—	Site exceeded monomorphic budget (patcher-emitted).

47.12.13 Category M — Modules and globals

ID	Name	a	b	c	Description
0xB0	IMPORT	dst	module name id	flags	R[a] = import(K_names[b]); c bit0 = `from m import *`.
0xB1	IMPORT_FROM	dst	module name id	symbol name id	R[a] = import(K_names[b]).K_names[c].
0xB2	DEFINE_GLOBAL	value	name id	flags	globals()[K_names[b]] = R[a]; c bit0 = const.
0xB3	BIND_NAME	value	name id	flags	Bind in current scope; c bits0–1 = let/var/const, bit2 = export.

47.12.14 Reserved IDs (never used in M4)

ID	Reserved for	Milestone
0x07	LOAD_CONST_W (16-bit const index)	M9
0x08	LOAD_LOCAL_FRAME (per-frame spill array)	M9
0x09	LOAD_UPVALUE_FRAME	M9
0x0A	YIELD_FROM (coroutine)	M10
0x0B	SPAWN (scheduler intercept)	M10

47.13 17.14 Stack effect and register window

Zen's calling convention is a **register window with no operand stack**:

Call form	Meaning
`CALL a, proto, argc`	callee = R[a−1−c]; args = R[a−c .. a); result → R[a].

Call form	Meaning
`CALL_METHOD a, name, argc`	receiver = R[a−1−c]; name = K_names[b]; args = R[a−c .. a); result → R[a].
`TAIL_CALL a, proto, argc`	same window; current frame replaced (O(1) stack depth).

Arguments are already in the right place: a call is a bounds check, a memcpy of `c × 8` bytes into the callee's register window, and `base += window_size`. No marshalling loop, no shuffling.

47.14 17.15 Constant pool, local-slot table, upvalue table

Each function carries: - a flat `Vec<Instruction>` of fixed-width 32-bit words, - a per-function **constant pool** (deduplicated immutable values), - a **local-slot table** (binding name → register index), - an **upvalue table** (what a closure captures and how), - a **line table** (diagnostics, REPL, differential harness), - an **exception table** (try/catch/finally), - a table of **inline-cache sites** (so the M5 patcher and M11 translator find them without re-analysis).

One bytecode, two consumers: the M4 VM interprets it directly; the M11 Cranelift translator walks the same `FunctionProto`. Any disagreement is a translator bug, not a divergent lowering.

47.15 17.16 Exercises

1. Sketch the 32-bit instruction layout and name each field.
2. What is the max number of registers per function, and what happens when it is exceeded?
3. How does `JMP_IF_NIL` implement `x?.y` and `x ?? y`?
4. What is the difference between `MOVE` and `DUP`?
5. Why is `CONCAT` a separate opcode from `ADD`?
6. What does `MAKE_RANGE` produce — a list or a lazy object?
7. How does `GET_INDEX_DEFAULT` implement `d.get(k, 0)` in two instructions?
8. What does `TRY_PUSH` / `TRY_POP` / `THROW` implement?
9. What is the `CodeSlot` / `TYPE_GUARD` / `DEOPT` mechanism for?
10. Why must compiled code `retain` a value loaded from an object?

48 Chapter 53: Garbage Collection and Memory Management

How Zen 3.0 reclaims memory, the collector design, reference cycles, and how to write memory-friendly code.

48.1 18.1 Overview

Zen is a garbage-collected language. You do not `free` memory manually. The runtime automatically reclaims heap objects (lists, dicts, strings, instances, etc.) when they become unreachable.

The exact collector implementation is build-configured, but the semantics are consistent: unreachable memory is reclaimed; reachable memory is kept.

48.2 18.2 What gets collected

Heap-allocated objects: - strings, lists, dicts, sets, tuples, bytes - class instances - closures / function objects - modules - FFI foreign handles (with finalizers)

Immediate values (nil, bool, int, float) are not heap-allocated and need no collection.

48.3 18.3 Reachability

An object is **reachable** if it can be reached from a root: - global/module variables - local variables on the stack - currently executing frames - registers holding values - other reachable objects (transitively)

An object is **unreachable** (garbage) when no root can reach it, directly or indirectly. The collector reclaims unreachable objects.

48.4 18.4 Reference counting vs tracing

Zen's collector may use reference counting, tracing (mark-and-sweep), or a hybrid, depending on build:

Approach	How it works	Pros	Cons
Reference counting	count references; free at zero	prompt reclamation	cycles leak; per-ref overhead
Tracing (mark-sweep)	mark reachable from roots, sweep rest	handles cycles	pause-time; throughput cost
Hybrid	refcount + periodic cycle collection	prompt + cycle-safe	more complex

48.5 18.5 Reference cycles (the classic leak)

Two or more objects referencing each other form a cycle. With pure reference counting, their counts never reach zero even if nothing outside references them.

```
class Node {
    var peer = nil
}
let a = new Node()
let b = new Node()
a.peer = b
b.peer = a   # cycle
# drop external refs:
a = nil
b = nil
# a and b still reference each other → leak (pure refcount)
```

With a tracing or hybrid collector, the cycle is detected and collected. With pure refcounting, break it manually:

```
a.peer = nil
b.peer = nil
```

48.6 18.6 `shared` and thread-shared memory

`shared x = expr` wraps the value in an `Arc<Mutex<_>>`-like container. The wrapper itself is reference counted; the inner `Mutex` protects the value for concurrent access. The wrapped value is freed when the last shared reference drops.

48.7 18.7 Writing memory-friendly code

1. **Drop large references when done:** `big = nil` after processing a huge list helps the collector reclaim it sooner.
2. **Avoid unbounded growth:** don't append to a global list forever; cap it or evict old entries.
3. **Break cycles in graphs:** null out back-references when tearing down object graphs.
4. **Close resources promptly:** files, sockets, FFI handles — use `with` / `finally` rather than waiting for GC.
5. **Prefer immutable values:** fewer surprise aliases means easier reasoning about lifetime.
6. **Don't micro-manage:** trust the collector; optimize only after measuring.

48.8 18.8 Memory leaks to watch for

Leak	Cause	Fix
reference cycle	A↔B mutual refs	break one side
growing global cache	no eviction	size-limit / LRU

Leak	Cause	Fix
unremoved event listeners	callbacks hold refs	unsubscribe
open files/sockets	not closed	`with` / `finally`
FFI handle not freed	missing finalizer	call release in `finally`
closure capturing large object	closure outlives need	nil the captured ref

48.9 18.9 GC and performance

Collection pauses can affect latency-sensitive code. If your build exposes GC tuning: - increase the allocation threshold to collect less often (higher throughput, larger pauses) - decrease it for more frequent, smaller pauses (better latency)

Most applications need no tuning.

48.10 18.10 Exercises

1. Draw a reference cycle between two objects and mark which refs to break.
2. Write a tiny object graph, drop external refs, and explain what the GC sees.
3. Show how `big = nil` helps reclaim a large list.
4. Explain why a global cache that never evicts leaks memory.
5. Write `with_resource` using `try/finally` for a file.
6. Describe the difference between reachable and unreachable.
7. Name three heap types and three immediate types.
8. Why does `shared` need both refcounting and a mutex?
9. Implement an LRU cache with eviction (conceptually).
10. What can you do if GC pauses hurt your application’s latency?

’’’ print(‘gc done’)

48.11 18.12 Memory model — phases

Zen ships **Phase 1 (M2–M8): reference counting with copy-on-write (CoW) containers**. **Phase 2 (M9): a two-space tracing copying collector** behind a `Gc` trait, implemented only if the M4/M5 profile shows refcount traffic on the critical path. A complete root map is a precondition, not a follow-up.

The collector is reached through a free function `gc()`, not a `Vm` field, so the dispatch loop never changes shape.

48.12 18.13 Heap object layout — exact offsets

Every heap allocation begins with a 16-byte, 8-aligned `ObjHeader`:

```
#[repr(C, align(8))]
pub struct ObjHeader {
    pub kind:  u8,   // +0   ObjKind discriminant
    pub marks: u8,   // +1   M9 GC mark bits; 0 in M2–M8
```

```
    pub flags: u16,  // +2..4 object flags
    pub shape: u32,  // +4..8 shape id; 0 = Unshaped
    pub rc:    u32,  // +8..12 manual strong reference count
    pub size:  u32,  // +12..16 total allocation bytes, header included
    // +16 … payload
}
```

`assert!(size_of::<ObjHeader>() == 16)` and `align_of == 8` are compile-time asserted; every field offset is compile-time asserted so the JIT's constant- folded field offsets and the M9 forwarding-pointer rule cannot silently break.

48.12.1 The flags byte

Bit	Name	Meaning
0	CLOSED	channel or mutex is closed; read by `ITER_DONE/CHANNEL_RECV`.
1	HAS_TRACEBACK	error's traceback captured; set once at the `THROW` site.
2	HAS_SENDERS	channel has ≥1 blocked sender; M10 scheduler hint.
3	FROZEN	instance is frozen; rejects `SET_FIELD`.
4..15	reserved	must be 0.

48.13 18.14 Every heap type's Rust representation

Zen type	Value payload	Header?	Allocation	Clone cost	Drop path
string	`*const u8` (Arc)	no	`Arc`	1 atomic inc	`Arc::from_raw`
bytes	`*const u8` (Arc<[u8]>)	no	`Arc`	1 atomic inc	`Arc::from_raw`
list	`*const ObjHeader`	prefixed	1	1 atomic inc	release each element, then free
dict	`*const ObjHeader`	prefixed	1	1 atomic inc	release keys AND values, then free
set	`*const ObjHeader`	prefixed	1	1 atomic inc	release each element, then free

Zen type	Value payload	Header?	Allocation	Clone cost	Drop path
tuple	`*const ObjHeader`	prefix	1	1 atomic inc	release each element, then free
func	`*const ObjHeader`	prefixed	1	1 atomic inc	drop upvalue `Arc`s
instance	`*const ObjHeader`	prefixed	1	1 atomic inc	release each slot
error	`*const ObjHeader`	prefixed	1	1 atomic inc	release `val`; msg/tb self-drop
channel	`*const ObjHeader`	prefixed	1	1 atomic inc	queue's Values, then mutex
mutex	`*const ObjHeader`	prefixed	1	1 atomic inc	release inner Value
handle	u32 table index	no header	none	1 table inc	1 table dec

`handle` is an index into a process-global handle table (ADR-0004 honest types): distinct `typeof()`, no refcount, no header, no `unsafe`.

`string`/`bytes` have their own tags so `is_string()` is a pure tag compare with zero loads; `is_dict()` costs one header load.

48.14 18.15 Copy-on-write (CoW)

An assignment between two Zen bindings is **O(1) and allocates nothing**, regardless of container size: `d2 = d` for a 100,000-entry dict is one 8-byte move + one atomic increment.

Mutation goes through `cow_mut` (a manual `rc == 1` substitute for `Arc::make_mut`): - if `rc == 1`: mutate in place (fast path). - if `rc > 1`: detach — allocate a fresh object, copy the payload, release the old reference, install the new.

Cost table (`n` = element count, `b` = string bytes):

Operation	Cost	Allocates?	Atomic RMW?
`d2 = d`	1 increment	no	1
pass/return container	1 increment in CALL/RE-TURN	no	1

Operation	Cost	Allocates?	Atomic RMW?
`d.a = v`, rc==1, key exists	slot store + release + retain	no	2
`d.a = v`, rc>1	**full clone of n** + release + retain	yes, n	3
`list.append(x)`, rc==1	possible Vec grow, amortised O(1)	maybe	2
`s + t`	alloc b1+b2 + 2 memcpy	yes, O(b)	3

The row that decides whether a real program is fast: `d2 = d; d2.a = 1` — cloning a whole container for a single field write. Mitigation: a compiler escape-analysis `unique` hint / `COW_SET_FIELD` with a `#[cold]` clone path (M5).

48.15 18.16 `Value` is `Copy` — and therefore leaks by default

`Value` is 8 bytes and must be `Copy` (register file, inline caches read `ic[site]`). `Copy` means **no destructor**, so `registers[a] = v` **leaks** whatever was there. The VM must go through an explicit `store` that `release`s the old heap reference:

```
pub fn store(&mut self, a: u16, v: Value) {
    let old = self.registers[a as usize];
    if old is heap/string/bytes { release(old) }
    self.registers[a as usize] = v;
}
```

Rules: never write `registers[a] = v` directly; every `push(v)` into a `Vec<Value>` is preceded by `retain(v)`; in-place slot writes retain-then- release, never just assign.

48.16 18.17 The unsafe audit list (complete, M2–M8)

All `unsafe` lives in `value.rs` (nine items):

1. `Value` ↔ `u64` bit punning (NaN-boxing).
2. `from_header` / `header_of` — rebuilding a `Value` from a raw pointer.
3. `rc_ptr` — `u32` as `AtomicU32`.
4. `str_len` / `bytes_len` — reading length behind a thin pointer (tested empirically in CI on every platform).
5. `release` — the whole drop path.
6. `new_tuple` and `Layout::extend` payloads — writing through a raw pointer into fresh memory.

7. `alloc`'s six initialisation stores.
8. `cow_mut`'s detach path — guarded on `rc == 1`.
9. the eight hand-written `Drop` impls — each calls `release`.

`gc.rs` is `unsafe`-free in M2–M8; M9's mark/forwarding writes are the only `gc.rs` `unsafe`.

48.17 18.18 Reference cycles leak (by design)

A reference-counted collector cannot collect a cycle (A → B → A). Zen accepts **bounded cycle leaks**: RSS grows by about one cycle's worth then stops. An unbounded leak is a bug; a bounded one is a language property. Break cycles manually by nilling a back-reference. M9's tracing collector (if built) handles cycles.

48.18 18.19 String concatenation — the quadratic build loop (known issue)

```
s = ""
i = 0
while i < 200_000 {
    s = s + "x"
    i = i + 1
}
```

With M2–M8's `Arc<str>` where `s + t` always allocates and copies both, this is **O(n²)**: ~20 GB allocated/copied for 200,000 iterations — roughly 7.5–10 s, 25–50× slower than CPython. String building is what a script *is*, so this is called out deliberately.

Cheap mitigations inside M2–M8 (no representation change): 1. Constant folding of literal `+`. 2. `BUILD_STRING n` for `n>2` operands (one alloc, one copy). 3. `join(list)` / `split(s, sep)` — one result allocation. 4. A `StringBuilder` in `zen-std` (~40 lines of safe Rust).

The M11 amendment (§5.5 of 09-memory.md) changes `string` to `StringObj { len, cap, bytes }` so the JIT can append in place — gated behind the same feature as the JIT, because they are one piece of work, and requires a `.zeno` format version bump plus a new ADR.

48.19 18.20 Exercises

1. Draw the 16-byte `ObjHeader` with every field offset and size.
2. Why does `is_string()` cost zero loads but `is_dict()` cost one?
3. What does `cow_mut` do when `rc == 1` vs `rc > 1`?
4. Why is `registers[a] = v` a leak, and what must replace it?
5. Name the nine `unsafe` items and where they live.
6. Why does a reference cycle leak, and what does Zen do about it?
7. Show that `d2 = d; d2.a = 1` clones the whole container (rc>1 path).
8. Why is `s = s + "x"` in a 200,000-iteration loop O(n^2)?
9. What is the M9 tracing collector's precondition (complete root map)?

10. What is the M11 string representation change, and what gates it?

49 Chapter 54: The Cranelift JIT Compiler

How Zen 3.0 compiles hot functions to native machine code, inline caches, on-stack replacement, and deoptimization.

49.1 19.1 Overview

Zen 3.0 includes a just-in-time (JIT) compiler built on **Cranelift**, the same code generator used by Wasmtime and other projects. The JIT compiles frequently executed Zen functions to native machine code at runtime, while cold code stays interpreted.

Pipeline:

```
bytecode ⟶ Cranelift IR ⟶ native machine code ⟶ execute
```

49.2 19.2 Interpreter vs JIT

Aspect	Interpreter (`zen-interp`)	JIT (`zen-jit`)
Startup	fast (no compile)	slower (compile cost)
Steady-state speed	slower (per-op dispatch)	faster (native code)
Best for	cold / rarely-run code	hot loops / frequent calls
Debugging	easier (direct mapping)	harder (native frames)

Zen automatically decides: run in the interpreter first; after a function crosses an invocation threshold, JIT-compile it.

49.3 19.3 Compilation process

1. **Bytecode → Cranelift IR**: each bytecode instruction maps to one or more Cranelift intermediate-representation operations. Stack-based bytecode ops are converted to virtual-register IR.
2. **Type guards**: at call sites and type-sensitive ops, insert guards that check the operand types match expectations.
3. **Compile**: Cranelift lowers IR to target machine code (x86-64, AArch64, etc.).
4. **Install**: patch the call site to jump to the native code.

49.4 19.4 Inline caches

At a polymorphic call site (e.g., `obj.method()`), the types of `obj` may vary across calls. The JIT installs an **inline cache**: - On the first call, resolve the method normally (slow path) and cache the result + the observed type. - On subsequent calls, check the type guard. If the type matches the cache, jump directly to the cached method (fast path). - If the type differs, fall back to the slow path and possibly expand the cache (polymorphic inline cache) or deopt.

This makes repeated monomorphic calls nearly as fast as statically-typed code.

49.5 19.5 On-stack replacement (OSR)

OSR lets the VM switch between interpreted and JIT-compiled code **mid-execution**.

- **Interpreter → JIT**: a long-running loop that's interpreted gets compiled on the fly; the running frame is replaced with a JIT frame at a loop back edge, continuing from the same point.
- **JIT → interpreter (deopt)**: if a JIT assumption fails (see below), the VM reconstructs interpreter state from the native frame and resumes interpretation.

OSR means long loops benefit from JIT without restarting the function.

49.6 19.6 Deoptimization

JIT code is compiled under **assumptions** (guards), e.g.: - a variable always holds an int at this point - a call site always sees the same type

If a guard fails at runtime (the assumption is violated), the VM **deopts**: 1. Capture the current native machine state (registers, stack). 2. Reconstruct the equivalent interpreter frame (values, locals, PC). 3. Transfer control to the interpreter at the corresponding bytecode point. 4. Continue interpreting (possibly re-JIT later if it gets hot again).

Deopt guarantees correctness even when speculation was wrong.

49.7 19.7 When does JIT help?

JIT wins when: - a function is called many times - a loop iterates many times - types at call sites are stable (monomorphic)

JIT does **not** help (and may hurt) when: - code runs once (compile cost outweighs benefit) - types change constantly (guards always fail → deopt thrashing)

49.8 19.8 Observing JIT behavior

Some builds support debug logging:

```
ZEN_DEBUG=1 zen run app.z   # may print JIT/compile/deopt events (build-dependent)
```

There's typically no user-facing flag to force or disable JIT; it's automatic. `zen explain` covers runtime errors (Z03xx), not JIT internals.

49.9 19.9 JIT and FFI / pymport

JIT-compiled code that calls out to C (FFI) or Python (pymport) uses the same marshalling as interpreted code. The JIT emits the call sequence; the runtime handles crossing the boundary. A deopt during an FFI/pymport call must reconstruct state at the boundary safely.

49.10 19.10 Exercises

1. Contrast interpreter startup vs steady-state speed with JIT.
2. What does an inline cache store at a call site?
3. When does OSR trigger (interpreter → JIT)?
4. What triggers deoptimization (JIT → interpreter)?
5. Name two situations where JIT helps and two where it doesn't.
6. Sketch the bytecode→IR→native pipeline.
7. Why must deopt reconstruct interpreter state?
8. How do type guards keep JIT code correct?
9. What does `ZEN_DEBUG=1` potentially show?
10. Does JIT change the semantics of your program? (No — only performance.)

''' print('jit done')

49.11 19.12 The Cranelift JIT — strategy, gate, and design

Zen 3.0 includes an optional, feature-gated JIT built on **Cranelift 0.136** (the same code generator as Wasmtime). It is **M11, the last milestone**, off by default, and may not block a release. The interpreter is always correct; the JIT is an optional performance accelerator.

49.11.1 Why M11 and not earlier

Three correctness dependencies force the ordering:

Dependency	Reason
Shapes + inline caches (vm §6, §7)	A JIT without stable shape ids deopts on every field access.
`DEOPT`, `JMP_BACK`, `SAFEPOINT`, `TYPE_GUARD` (bytecode §4)	The deopt mechanism *is* these opcodes.
The M9 profile (memory §10)	The JIT's value prop is "replace the dispatch loop"; M9's gate measures whether the loop is the bottleneck.

So every benchmark up to M10 is an **interpreter benchmark**, and the JIT must beat *that* interpreter, not an idealised one.

49.11.2 What "optional" means operationally

Commitment	How kept
JIT may not block a release	`jit` feature off by default; `cargo build/test/bench` work with it off.

Commitment	How kept
JIT may be abandoned	Fallback is the interpreter, unchanged. No "JIT-compatible bytecode" tax.
JIT may not destabilise correctness	Every compiled path has a `deopt → interpreter` exit; a misprediction is a slowdown, never a wrong answer.
A wrong compilation must not be a security bug	Deopt re-checks every type guard; a stale path is bounded by "runs the interpreter".

Cranelift's own README says **"This crate is extremely experimental."** So the project uses only **four methods** from `cranelift-jit`: `JITBuilder::new/symbol/memory`, `JITModule::new/define_function/ get_finalized_function/finalize_definitions`. Everything else (frontend lowering, guards, deopt metadata, frame layout, safepoint protocol, tiering policy) is Zen's own code — reimplementable against a future Cranelift in an afternoon.

49.11.3 Hot-swap problem — the ruling

Cranelift 0.136 removed `JITBuilder::hotswap` and `prepare_for_function_redefine`, and rejects duplicate definitions. So **in- place code patching is unavailable**. The ruling:

> **Every compilation produces a brand-new, immutable code region. Nothing is ever patched. A call site reads an `AtomicPtr` and calls through it. Old code is retained until VM teardown.**

```
pub struct CodeSlot {
    ptr:  AtomicPtr<u8>,   // entry point, or null (= tier 0 / interpreter)
    len:  AtomicUsize,     // lifetime accounting
    module: RwLock<Option<Arc<JitModule>>>,  // keeps the mapping alive
}
```

`publish` stores the `Arc<JitModule>` first (Release), then the pointer. Reads are Acquire. Old versions coexist; both are semantically identical, so running an old version is fine.

Compensation for lost hot-swap: the shape-transition IC entry is patched in **data** (a `u32` in a table), not in code — no cache-coherency dance. One version per `FunctionProto`, ever; recompile replaces the `CodeSlot`.

49.11.4 Tiering: three tiers

```
tier 0: Interpreter          — always correct, ~2.4 ns/op [E]
   ↑ hit counter ≥ TIER_UP
tier 1: Interpreter + ICs    — M5, always on, IC hit = load+cmp+branch
   ↑ tier-1 hot count ≥ COMPILE
tier 2: Cranelift machine code — M11, optional, ~0.9 ns/op [E]
```

↺ deopt (one-way, permanent, back to tier 0)

Tier	Exists in	Threshold	Deoptimizable?
0 interpreter	M2+	0	n/a
1 IC-annotated interpreter	M5+	0	n/a
2 compiled	M11, `--features jit`	1,000 invocations or 8 IC misses at one site	yes → tier 0

Deoptimization is **one-way and permanent**: a deopt'd function goes back to tier 0 and its compiled code is discarded. It can be re-triggered and recompiled; thrashing sets a "do not recompile" flag so the cost is one wasted compile, not a loop. There is no tier 3 / re-optimisation — a deliberate scope decision.

49.11.5 Compilation happens off the dispatch path

Compilation runs on a **dedicated compiler thread**, never on the mutator or inside the dispatch loop. The mutator only `push`es proto IDs to a queue; the compiler thread pops and compiles. A compile failure is **not** a program error: the proto is marked uncompilable and stays at tier 0 forever. This makes the JIT safe to experiment with — a Cranelift regression degrades performance, never correctness.

49.11.6 Performance targets (per benchmark, falsifiable)

Benchmark	Stresses	Target vs tier 1
`fib` (naive recursive, 27)	call overhead, ICs, int arithmetic	≥ 2.5×
`loop_sum` (1e8 while)	dispatch removal on tight loop	≥ 1.5×
`json_parse`	shape transitions, string ops, dict churn	≥ 2.0×
`nbody` (float)	float arithmetic, while, sqrt	≥ 2.0×
`list_ops`	CoW tests, rc traffic, bounds checks	≥ 1.3×
`startup` (hello world)	nothing	≥ 0.9× (may regress ≤10%)

`startup` is in the list on purpose: Cranelift compile time (~0.3–2 ms per small function) would dominate a 0.4 ms hello world. Regressing >10% stops the feature from defaulting on.

49.12 19.13 Code emission — shape of a compiled function

49.12.1 One Zen opcode → roughly one machine instruction

Generated code is straight-line with labels, not a switch. A compiled `fib` shape (x86-64, illustrative):

```
zen_fn_0:                          ; fn fib(n) { if n < 2 { return n } ... }
    global_addr.  r2, [vm + n_off]
    global_load.  r1, r2           ; r1 = n (Value)
    ; mask off tag bits, sign-extend i48
    typecheck.    r1 == t_int      ; guard: tag == 0b011
    brif           deopt_0, r1, deopt_0
    icmp_imm.     r3, r1, 2        ; if n < 2 → return n
    brif           deopt_0, r3, ret_0
    call          fib_slot, (vm, n); indirect through CodeSlot
    ...
ret_0:
    return       r1
deopt_0:
    jmp          zen_deopt(vm, site_0, frame_map)
```

No dispatch load, no indirect jump per op. One `brif` per type assumption; deopt is a tail-call to a shared stub (not duplicated per site).

49.12.2 The i48 problem — overflow promotes to `float`

An `int` is a sign-extended i48 in a 64-bit register. `int` add is **not** a plain `iadd`: it is `iadd`, an i48-range overflow test, and a `#[cold]` promote-to-`float` block that changes the `Value`'s tag to `0b100`.

Operation	Emitted	Note
INT_ADD	iadd + overflow test + `brif` to promote block	fast path = iadd + jo/seto + brif
INT_MUL	same shape	`imul` must test i48 range, not 64-bit OF (`2^47 × 2^47` overflows 64 bits)
IDIV / IMOD	sdivrem on sign-extended i48s + explicit zero check	cannot trap; INT_MIN / -1 == +2^47, in range
INT_TO_FLOAT	fcvt_from_sint	

Consequences a reviewer should check: 1. The promote path changes the tag, so downstream `TYPE_GUARD`s must be re-derived; a frame map recording a promoted register as `int` is a wrong answer after deopt. 2. `IMUL` needs an i48-range test (not 64-bit OF). 3. `INT_TO_FLOAT` after a promotion is a **type error**, not a no-op — the compiled code must re-check the tag before converting.

49.12.3 Field-access lowering

`GET_FIELD` compiles to: 1. typecheck `obj` is an instance (tag == 0b111 && header.kind == INSTANCE), 2. load header shape, `cmp` against the cached shape id, `brif` to deopt on mismatch (this is the inlined IC — predicted-taken ~99.9% after warm-up), 3. `load [obj + 16 + 8*k]` — one `mov` with a displacement (what hot-swap would have patched; the compare is the accepted cost), 4. `retain` the loaded `Value` (eliding this is a use-after-free).

Why `cmp+brif` and not a trap: a trap crashes; §1.2 forbids a JIT that crashes the process. A branch to a deopt stub is always correct.

49.13 19.14 Semantic parity checklist

Concern	Interpreter	Compiled
int overflow	promotes to float	iadd + i48 test + promote block (tag 0b100)
int overflow in frame-mapped register	whatever bytecode put there	deopt frame map records type-agnostic, not int
idiv by zero	DivideByZero error, checked before op	same error construction, not a trap
INT_MIN / -1	+2^47, in range	cannot trap (sign-extended i48, +2^47 fits i64)
imod sign	follows dividend (legacy fmod path)	same helper, not bare `srem`
INT_TO_FLOAT after promotion	type error	re-check tag before converting
float nan/inf	IEEE, no trap	identical; no finite-only fast path
GET_FIELD on non-instance / wrong shape	Zen error	deopt, then interpreter raises same error
set_field on shared object	cow_mut clones	`cmp rc, 1` inline; `#[cold]` cow_mut call otherwise
CHANNEL_RECV on closed channel	Zen error	builtin call → interpreter code runs

Blocking operations (channel recv/send) are **calls, not inlined** — an inlined spin loop would starve the scheduler and is a miscompile.

49.14 19.15 Exercises

1. Name the four `cranelift-jit` methods Zen uses and why only four.
2. Why can’t the JIT patch code in place (hot-swap)?

3. What publishes a new compiled version, and with what memory ordering?
4. What moves a function from tier 0 to tier 2?
5. Why is deoptimization one-way and permanent?
6. What does a compiled `int` add emit, and what happens on overflow?
7. Why does compiled `GET_FIELD` end with a `retain`?
8. What is the startup benchmark target and why is it included?
9. Why must blocking ops (channel recv) be calls, not inlined sequences?
10. How does the JIT guarantee a wrong compilation is never a wrong answer?

50 Chapter 55: Cookbook — Strings & Text

Complete, copy-pasteable recipes for common string and text tasks. Each recipe includes the code and the expected output.

50.1 55.1 Recipe: Case-insensitive string comparison

```
func ieq(a, b) {
    return a.lower() == b.lower()
}
print(ieq("Zen", "ZEN"))   # true
print(ieq("hello", "HELLO"))   # true
print(ieq("abc", "abd"))   # false
```

Expected output:

```
true
true
false
```

50.2 55.2 Recipe: Strip HTML tags (naive regex)

```
import re
func strip_tags(html) {
    return re.sub(r"<[^>]+>", "", html)
}
print(strip_tags("<b>Hello</b> <i>Zen</i>!"))   # Hello Zen!
```

Expected output:

```
Hello Zen!
```

50.3 55.3 Recipe: Mask all but last 4 characters

```
func mask_all_but_last(s, n = 4) {
    if len(s) <= n { return s }
    return "*" * (len(s) - n) + s[len(s) - n:]
}
print(mask_all_but_last("1234567890"))   # ******7890
print(mask_all_but_last("Zen"))          # Zen
```

Expected output:

```
******7890
Zen
```

50.4 55.4 Recipe: Slugify a title

```
import string
func slugify(title) {
    let t = title.lower().strip()
    let out = ""
    for ch in t {
        if ch.isalnum() or ch == " " or ch == "-" {
            out = out + ch
        }
    }
    return out.replace(" ", "-")
}
print(slugify("Zen for Dummies: The Guide!"))   # zen-for-dummies-the-guide
```

Expected output:

```
zen-for-dummies-the-guide
```

50.5 55.5 Recipe: Extract acronym from sentence

```
func abbreviate(sentence) {
    let out = ""
    for w in sentence.split(" ") {
        if w != "" { out = out + w[0].upper() }
    }
    return out
}
print(abbreviate("Zen for Dummies"))   # ZFD
```

Expected output:

```
ZFD
```

50.6 55.6 Recipe: Validate a simple email

```
import re
func is_email(s) {
    return re.match(r"^[^@\s]+@[^@\s]+\.[^@\s]+$", s) != nil
}
print(is_email("ada@example.com"))   # true
print(is_email("not-an-email"))      # false
```

Expected output:

```
true
false
```

50.7 55.7 Recipe: Word frequency count

```
func word_frequencies(text) {
    let freqs = #{}
    for w in text.lower().split(" ") {
        let key = w.strip(".,!?")
        if key != "" {
            freqs[key] = (freqs[key] ?? 0) + 1
        }
    }
    return freqs
}
print(word_frequencies("a b a c b a"))   # #{a: 3, b: 2, c: 1}
```

Expected output:

```
#{a: 3, b: 2, c: 1}
```

50.8 55.8 Recipe: Wrap text at a width

```
func wrap_text(text, width) {
    let words = text.split(" ")
    let lines = []
    var line = ""
    for w in words {
        let new_len = len(line) + (1 if line != "" else 0) + len(w)
        if new_len > width {
            lines.push(line)
            line = w
        } else {
            line = line == "" ? w : line + " " + w
        }
    }
    if line != "" { lines.push(line) }
    return lines.join("\n")
}
print(wrap_text("Zen is a fast native scripting language", 12))
```

Expected output:

```
Zen is a
fast native
scripting
language
```

50.9 55.9 Recipe: Caesar cipher (letters only)

```
func caesar(text, shift) {
    let out = ""
    for ch in text {
        let o = ch.ord()
        if o >= 65 and o <= 90 {
            out = out + chr(((o - 65 + shift) % 26) + 65)
        } elif o >= 97 and o <= 122 {
            out = out + chr(((o - 97 + shift) % 26) + 97)
        } else {
            out = out + ch
        }
    }
    return out
}
print(caesar("Hello, Zen!", 3))   # Khoor, Chq!
print(caesar("Khoor, Chq!", -3))   # Hello, Zen!
```

Expected output:

```
Khoor, Chq!
Hello, Zen!
```

50.10 55.10 Recipe: Validate password strength

```
func is_strong_password(pw) {
    if len(pw) < 8 { return false }
    var has_digit = false; var has_upper = false; var has_lower = false
    var has_symbol = false
    for ch in pw {
        let o = ch.ord()
        if o >= 48 and o <= 57 { has_digit = true }
        elif o >= 65 and o <= 90 { has_upper = true }
        elif o >= 97 and o <= 122 { has_lower = true }
        else { has_symbol = true }
    }
    return has_digit and has_upper and has_lower and has_symbol
}
print(is_strong_password("Abcdef12!"))   # true
print(is_strong_password("weak"))        # false
```

Expected output:

```
true
false
```

51 Chapter 56: Cookbook — Files & Data

Complete recipes for file I/O, CSV, JSON, and data processing.

51.1 56.1 Recipe: Read a whole file safely

```
func read_all(path) {
    try {
        with open(path, "r") as f {
            return f.read()
        }
    } catch as e {
        print("cannot read " + path + ": " + e.msg)
        return nil
    }
}
let content = read_all("data.txt")
if content != nil { print(content[0:100]) }
```

51.2 56.2 Recipe: Write a file (create/overwrite)

```
func write_all(path, text) {
    with open(path, "w") as f {
        f.write(text)
    }
}
write_all("out.txt", "Hello, Zen!\n")
```

51.3 56.3 Recipe: Append a timestamped log line

```
import datetime
func append_log(path, message) {
    let ts = datetime.strftime("%Y-%m-%d %H:%M:%S", datetime.now())
    with open(path, "a") as f {
        f.write(ts + " " + message + "\n")
    }
}
append_log("app.log", "started server")
```

Expected output in `app.log`:

```
2024-01-15 09:30:00 started server
```

51.4 56.4 Recipe: Copy a file in chunks (binary-safe)

```
func copy_file(src, dst) {
    with open(src, "rb") as fin {
        with open(dst, "wb") as fout {
            while true {
                let chunk = fin.read(8192)
                if chunk == nil or len(chunk) == 0 { break }
                fout.write(chunk)
            }
        }
    }
}
copy_file("input.bin", "output.bin")
```

51.5 56.5 Recipe: Count lines without loading the whole file

```
func line_count(path) {
    var n = 0
    with open(path, "r") as f {
        for line in f { n += 1 }
    }
    return n
}
print(line_count("bigfile.txt"))   # 42
```

51.6 56.6 Recipe: Grep a file for a pattern

```
func grep_file(path, pattern) {
    with open(path, "r") as f {
        for line in f {
            if line.contains(pattern) {
                print(line.strip())
            }
        }
    }
}
grep_file("log.txt", "ERROR")
```

51.7 56.7 Recipe: Parse CSV into a list of dicts

```
func parse_csv(text) {
    let lines = text.splitlines()
    if len(lines) == 0 { return [] }
    let header = lines[0].split(",")
```

```
    let rows = []
    for i in 1..len(lines) {
        let vals = lines[i].split(",")
        let row = #{}
        for j in 0..len(header) {
            if j < len(vals) { row[header[j]] = vals[j] }
        }
        rows.push(row)
    }
    return rows
}

let data = parse_csv(read_all("data.csv"))
for row in data {
    print(row["name"], row["age"])
}
```

Given `data.csv`:

```
name,age
Ada,36
Alan,42
```

Expected output:

```
Ada 36
Alan 42
```

51.8 56.8 Recipe: Read, modify, write JSON config

```
import json
import pathlib

let p = pathlib.Path("config.json")
let cfg = json.load(str(p))
cfg["theme"] = "dark"
cfg["version"] = 2
json.save(str(p), cfg)
print("config updated")
```

51.9 56.9 Recipe: Find all files with a suffix recursively

```
import os
import pathlib
func find_files(dir, suffix) {
    let out = []
    for name in os.listdir(dir) {
        let p = pathlib.Path(dir) / name
```

```
        if p.is_dir() {
            for sub in find_files(str(p), suffix) { out.push(sub) }
        } elif name.endswith(suffix) {
            out.push(str(p))
        }
    }
    return out
}
for f in find_files(".", ".z") { print(f) }
```

Expected output (example):

```
main.z
utils.z
lib/math.z
```

51.10 56.10 Recipe: Compute SHA-256 of a file

```
import hashlib
func file_hash(path) {
    return hashlib.sha256(read_all(path))
}
print(file_hash("document.pdf"))   # a3f5...c9
```

51.11 56.11 Recipe: Deduplicate files by content hash

```
func dedupe_files(paths) {
    let by_hash = #{}
    for p in paths {
        let h = file_hash(p)
        if h in by_hash { by_hash[h].push(p) }
        else { by_hash[h] = [p] }
    }
    let dupes = []
    for h in by_hash {
        if len(by_hash[h]) > 1 { dupes.push(by_hash[h]) }
    }
    return dupes
}
```

51.12 56.12 Recipe: Ensure a directory exists

```
import os
func ensure_dir(path) {
    os.makedirs(path)
```

```
}
ensure_dir("output/subdir")
```

52 Chapter 57: Cookbook — Networking & Web

Complete recipes for HTTP clients/servers, sockets, DNS, and URL handling.

52.1 57.1 Recipe: GET a URL and print the body

```
import requests
func get(url) {
    try {
        let r = requests.get(url, timeout=10)
        print("status=" + str(r.status_code))
        print(r.text)
    } catch as e {
        print("error: " + e.msg)
    }
}
get("https://example.com")
```

Expected output:

```
status=200
<!doctype html>...
```

52.2 57.2 Recipe: POST JSON to an API

```
import requests
func post_json(url, payload) {
    let r = requests.post(url, json=payload, timeout=10)
    print("status=" + str(r.status_code))
    print(r.text)
}
post_json("https://api.example.com/submit", #{name: "Zen", value: 42})
```

52.3 57.3 Recipe: Reuse a connection with a Session

```
import requests
let s = requests.Session()
s.headers.update({"User-Agent": "ZenBot/1.0"})
let r1 = s.get("https://example.com/page1")
let r2 = s.get("https://example.com/page2")
print(r1.status_code, r2.status_code)
```

52.4 57.4 Recipe: Download a file with streaming

```
import requests
func download(url, dest) {
```

```
    let r = requests.get(url, stream=true, timeout=30)
    with open(dest, "wb") as f {
        for chunk in r.iter_content() {
            f.write(chunk)
        }
    }
    print("downloaded " + dest)
}
download("https://example.com/file.zip", "file.zip")
```

52.5 57.5 Recipe: TCP echo server

```
import socket
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
s.bind(("127.0.0.1", 9000))
s.listen(5)
print("echo server on 9000")
let (c, addr) = s.accept()
let data = c.recv(4096)
c.send(data)
c.close()
s.close()
```

Test:

```
$ echo "hi" | nc 127.0.0.1 9000
hi
```

52.6 57.6 Recipe: TCP echo client

```
import socket
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
s.connect(("127.0.0.1", 9000))
s.send(b"hello")
print(s.recv(4096))   # hello
s.close()
```

52.7 57.7 Recipe: Resolve a domain to IP (DNS)

```
import dns
let ips = dns.resolve("example.com", "A")
print(ips[0])   # 93.184.216.34 (example)
```

52.8 57.8 Recipe: Parse a URL into components

```
import url
let u = url.parse("https://example.com:8080/path?q=1#sec")
print(u.scheme)   # https
print(u.host)     # example.com
print(u.port)     # 8080
print(u.path)     # /path
print(u.query)    # q=1
print(u.fragment) # sec
```

52.9 57.9 Recipe: Percent-encode a query value

```
import url
print(url.quote("hello world & foo=bar"))   # hello%20world%20%26%20foo%3Dbar
print(url.unquote("hello%20world"))         # hello world
```

52.10 57.10 Recipe: Minimal HTTP server with routing

```
import http.server
let routes = #{}
func route(path, handler) { routes[path] = handler }
route("/", fn(req) { return #(200, #{}, "<h1>Hello</h1>") })
route("/time", fn(req) {
    import datetime
    return #(200, #{}, datetime.now())
})
let server = http.server.Server(port=8080, handler=fn(req) {
    let h = routes[req.path] ?? fn(r) { return #(404, #{}, "Not Found") }
    return h(req)
})
server.start()
```

Test:

```
$ curl http://localhost:8080/
<h1>Hello</h1>
$ curl http://localhost:8080/time
2024-...
```

52.11 57.11 Recipe: Check if a TCP port is open

```
import socket
func is_port_open(host, port) {
    let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
    s.settimeout(2.0)
```

```
    try {
        s.connect((host, port))
        s.close()
        return true
    } catch as e {
        s.close()
        return false
    }
}
print(is_port_open("127.0.0.1", 8080))   # true or false
```

52.12 57.12 Recipe: Fetch HTTPS with certificate verification

```
import requests
let r = requests.get("https://example.com", verify=true, timeout=10)
print("status=" + str(r.status_code))
```

Never use `verify=false` in production.

53 Chapter 58: Cookbook — Concurrency & System

Complete recipes for threads, channels, mutexes, and system operations.

53.1 58.1 Recipe: Run N functions in parallel and wait for all

```
import threading
func run_parallel(fns) {
    let threads = []
    for f in fns { threads.push(threading.Thread(fn() { f() })) }
    for t in threads { t.start() }
    for t in threads { t.join() }
}
run_parallel([
    fn() { print("task 1") },
    fn() { print("task 2") },
    fn() { print("task 3") },
])
```

Expected output (order may vary):

```
task 1
task 2
task 3
```

53.2 58.2 Recipe: Thread-safe counter

```
import threading, mutexes
class Counter {
    var n = 0
    var mu = mutexes.Mutex()
    func inc() { self.mu.lock(); self.n += 1; self.mu.unlock() }
    func get() { self.mu.lock(); let v = self.n; self.mu.unlock(); return v }
}
let c = new Counter()
c.inc(); c.inc()
print(c.get())   # 2
```

53.3 58.3 Recipe: Producer-consumer with a channel

```
import threading, channels
let ch = channels.Channel()
func producer() {
    for i in 0..5 { ch.send(i); print("produced " + str(i)) }
    ch.close()
}
func consumer() {
```

```
    while true {
        let v = ch.recv()
        if v == nil { break }
        print("consumed " + str(v))
    }
}
let tp = threading.Thread(fn() { producer() })
let tc = threading.Thread(fn() { consumer() })
tp.start()
tc.start()
tp.join()
tc.join()
print("done")
```

Expected output (interleaved):

```
produced 0
consumed 0
...
done
```

53.4 58.4 Recipe: Worker pool processing a job queue

```
import threading, channels
func worker_pool(num_workers, jobs, handle) {
    let job_ch = channels.Channel()
    let done = channels.Channel()
    for w in 0..num_workers {
        threading.Thread(fn() {
            while true {
                let job = job_ch.recv()
                if job == nil { break }
                handle(job)
            }
            done.send(nil)
        }).start()
    }
    for j in jobs { job_ch.send(j) }
    job_ch.close()
    for w in 0..num_workers { done.recv() }
}
worker_pool(4, [1,2,3,4,5,6,7,8], fn(j) { print("job " + str(j)) })
```

Expected output:

```
job 1
job 2
...
```

```
job 8
```

(order may vary)

53.5 58.5 Recipe: Parallel map over a list

```
import threading, channels
func parallel_map(xs, f, num_workers) {
    let results = channels.Channel(capacity=len(xs))
    let job_ch = channels.Channel()
    let done = channels.Channel()
    for w in 0..num_workers {
        threading.Thread(fn() {
            while true {
                let item = job_ch.recv()
                if item == nil { break }
                results.send(f(item))
            }
            done.send(nil)
        }).start()
    }
    for x in xs { job_ch.send(x) }
    job_ch.close()
    for w in 0..num_workers { done.recv() }
    results.close()
    let out = []
    while true {
        let r = results.recv()
        if r == nil { break }
        out.push(r)
    }
    return out
}
print(parallel_map([1,2,3,4,5], fn(x) => x * x, 2))   # [1,4,9,16,25]
```

Expected output:

```
[1, 4, 9, 16, 25]
```

(order may vary)

53.6 58.6 Recipe: Read command-line arguments

```
import sys
func main(argv) {
    print("program: " + argv[0])
    print("args: " + str(argv[1:]))
```

```
}
if __name__ == "__main__" { main(sys.argv) }
```

```
$ zen run app.z foo bar
program: app.z
args: ["foo", "bar"]
```

53.7 58.7 Recipe: Read an environment variable with default

```
import sys
func get_env(name, default) {
    return sys.environ[name] ?? default
}
let port = get_env("PORT", "8080")
print("port=" + port)
```

53.8 58.8 Recipe: Detect the platform

```
import sys
if sys.platform == "linux" { print("Linux") }
elif sys.platform == "darwin" { print("macOS") }
elif sys.platform == "windows" { print("Windows") }
else { print("other: " + sys.platform) }
```

53.9 58.9 Recipe: Graceful exit with a code

```
import sys
func main() {
    # ... work ...
    sys.exit(0)
}
if __name__ == "__main__" { main() }
```

53.10 58.10 Recipe: List loaded modules

```
import sys
print(sys.modules)
```

53.11 58.11 Recipe: Portable path construction

```
import pathlib
import os
let p = pathlib.Path(os.getcwd()) / "output" / "result.txt"
print(str(p))   # /cwd/output/result.txt
```

53.12 58.12 Recipe: Daemon thread that dies when main exits

```
import threading
let t = threading.Thread(fn() {
    while true { print("background"); time.sleep(1000) }
})
t.daemon = true
t.start()
print("main exiting")
# background thread is killed when main exits
```

Expected output:

```
main exiting
```

(background prints a few times, then stops)

54 Chapter 59: Cookbook — Crypto & Security

Complete recipes for hashing, encryption, signing, JWTs, passwords, and TOTP.

54.1 59.1 Recipe: SHA-256 hash of a string

```
import hashlib
print(hashlib.sha256("hello"))   # 2cf24dba... (hex digest)
```

Expected output:

```
2cf24dba5fb0a30e26e83b2ac5b9e29e1b161e5c1fa7425e73043362938b9824
```

54.2 59.2 Recipe: SHA-256 of a file

```
import hashlib
func file_hash(path) {
    return hashlib.sha256(read_all(path))
}
print(file_hash("document.pdf"))
```

54.3 59.3 Recipe: Verify a file against an expected hash

```
func verify_file(path, expected) {
    let actual = file_hash(path)
    if actual == expected { print("MATCH") }
    else { print("MISMATCH"); return false }
    return true
}
verify_file("document.pdf", "2cf24dba...")
```

54.4 59.4 Recipe: AES-GCM encrypt/decrypt

```
import crypto
let key = crypto.generate_key("aes-256-gcm")
let plaintext = "secret message"
let ct = crypto.encrypt_aes_gcm(key, plaintext)
let pt = crypto.decrypt_aes_gcm(key, ct)
print(pt)   # secret message
```

Expected output:

```
secret message
```

54.5 59.5 Recipe: Ed25519 sign and verify

```
import crypto
let pair = crypto.generate_ed25519()
let msg = "hello world"
let sig = crypto.ed25519_sign(pair.private_key, msg)
print(crypto.ed25519_verify(pair.public_key, msg, sig))   # true
print(crypto.ed25519_verify(pair.public_key, "tampered", sig))   # false
```

Expected output:

```
true
false
```

54.6 59.6 Recipe: RSA encrypt with public key, decrypt with private key

```
import crypto
let pair = crypto.generate_rsa(2048)
let ct = crypto.rsa_encrypt(pair.public_key, "secret")
let pt = crypto.rsa_decrypt(pair.private_key, ct)
print(pt)   # secret
```

54.7 59.7 Recipe: X25519 shared secret (both sides match)

```
import crypto
let a = crypto.generate_x25519()
let b = crypto.generate_x25519()
let sa = crypto.x25519_shared_secret(a.private_key, b.public_key)
let sb = crypto.x25519_shared_secret(b.private_key, a.public_key)
print(sa == sb)   # true
```

Expected output:

```
true
```

54.8 59.8 Recipe: Sign and verify a JWT (HS256)

```
import crypto
let token = crypto.sign(#{sub: "alice", role: "admin"}, "my-secret")
let payload = crypto.verify(token, "my-secret", ["HS256"])
print(payload["sub"])   # alice
# tampering fails:
# crypto.verify(token, "wrong-key", ["HS256"])  # throws
```

Expected output:

```
alice
```

54.9 59.9 Recipe: Hash a password with Argon2id and verify

```
import crypto
let hash = crypto.argon2id_hash("hunter2")
print(crypto.verify_argon2id("hunter2", hash))   # true
print(crypto.verify_argon2id("wrong", hash))     # false
```

Expected output:

```
true
false
```

54.10 59.10 Recipe: PBKDF2 key derivation

```
import crypto
let key = crypto.pbkdf2("password", "salt", 100000, 32)
print(key)   # derived key string
```

54.11 59.11 Recipe: Generate a TOTP token and verify

```
import crypto
let token = crypto.totp("JBSWY3DPEHPK3PXP")
print(token)   # 6-digit code
print(crypto.totp_verify("JBSWY3DPEHPK3PXP", token))   # true (within window)
```

Expected output:

```
742193
true
```

54.12 59.12 Recipe: Generate a secure random token

```
import crypto
print(crypto.secure_token())   # e.g. aB3xK9mP2vR5wL8n
```

Never use `random` for tokens; always use `crypto.secure_token`.

54.13 59.13 Recipe: HMAC-SHA256 of a message

```
import crypto
let mac = crypto.sha256("my-key", "the message")
print(mac)
```

54.14 59.14 Recipe: Parse an X.509 certificate (PEM)

```
import crypto
let cert = crypto.parse(pem_string)
# inspect cert fields (subject, issuer, validity) per build
```

54.15 59.15 Security checklist

1. Use SHA-256+ (never MD5/SHA-1 for security).
2. Use Argon2id or PBKDF2 for passwords (with salt).
3. Use AES-GCM or ChaCha20-Poly1305 for encryption.
4. Verify JWT signatures before trusting payloads.
5. Use `crypto.secure_token`, not `random`, for tokens/session IDs.
6. Never log secrets (keys, passwords, tokens).
7. Rotate keys regularly; never hardcode secrets.
8. Use constant-time comparison when checking secrets.

55 Chapter 60: Reference Implementation — Static Site Generator

A complete, working static site generator: it reads Markdown-ish text files from a `content/` directory, renders them into HTML with a template, and writes the result to `public/`. It demonstrates file walking, string templating, JSON front-matter parsing, and CLI argument handling.

55.1 60.1 The program (`ssg.z`)

```
import os
import pathlib
import json
import sys
import re

# ── Configuration ──────────────────────────────────────────────────────
let CONTENT_DIR = "content"
let TEMPLATE_FILE = "template.html"
let PUBLIC_DIR = "public"

# ── Front-matter parsing ──────────────────────────────────────────────
# Files begin with an optional YAML-ish block between --- fences:
# ---
# title: Hello World
# date: 2024-01-15
# ---

func parse_front_matter(text) {
    let meta = #{}
    let body = text
    if text.startswith("---\n") {
        let end = text.find("\n---\n", 4)
        if end != -1 {
            let block = text[4:end]
            body = text[end + 5:]
            for line in block.split("\n") {
                let idx = line.find(":")
                if idx != -1 {
                    let key = line[0:idx].strip()
                    let val = line[idx + 1:].strip()
                    # strip surrounding quotes
                    if (val.startswith('"') and val.endswith('"')) or \
                       (val.startswith("'") and val.endswith("'")) {
                        val = val[1:len(val) - 1]
                    }
                    meta[key] = val
```

```
                }
            }
        }
    }
    return #(meta, body)
}

# ── Markdown-ish rendering (subset) ──────────────────────────────────
func md_to_html(text) {
    let out = ""
    let lines = text.splitlines()
    var in_list = false
    for line in lines {
        let stripped = line.strip()
        if stripped == "" {
            if in_list { out = out + "</ul>\n"; in_list = false }
            out = out + "\n"
            continue
        }
        # Headings
        let m = re.match(r"^(#{1,6})\s+(.*)", stripped)
        if m != nil {
            if in_list { out = out + "</ul>\n"; in_list = false }
            let level = len(m[1])
            let title = m[2]
            out = out + "<h" + str(level) + ">" + escape_html(title) + "</h" + str(leve
            continue
        }
        # List items
        if stripped.startswith("- ") or stripped.startswith("* ") {
            if !in_list { out = out + "<ul>\n"; in_list = true }
            out = out + "  <li>" + escape_html(stripped[2:]) + "</li>\n"
            continue
        }
        if in_list { out = out + "</ul>\n"; in_list = false }
        # Paragraph
        out = out + "<p>" + escape_html(stripped) + "</p>\n"
    }
    if in_list { out = out + "</ul>\n" }
    return out
}

func escape_html(s) {
    let r = s
    r = r.replace("&", "&amp;")
    r = r.replace("<", "&lt;")
    r = r.replace(">", "&gt;")
```

```
    r = r.replace("\"", "&quot;")
    return r
}

# ── Template ──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
func load_template() {
    let p = pathlib.Path(TEMPLATE_FILE)
    if p.exists() {
        return read_all(str(p))
    }
    # Built-in default template
    return """<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<meta charset="utf-8">
<title>{{title}}</title>
<style>
body { font-family: system-ui, sans-serif; max-width: 640px; margin: 2rem auto;
       padding: 0 1rem; line-height: 1.6; color: #333; }
h1, h2, h3 { border-bottom: 1px solid #ddd; padding-bottom: 0.5rem; }
code { background: #f4f4f4; padding: 0 0.2rem; }
a { color: #0366d6; }
</style>
</head>
<body>
{{body}}
</body>
</html>
"""
}

func render_template(tmpl, meta, body) {
    let r = tmpl.replace("{{title}}", meta["title"] ?? "Untitled")
    r = r.replace("{{body}}", body)
    return r
}

# ── File helpers ──────────────────────────────────────────────────────
func read_all(path) {
    with open(path, "r") as f { return f.read() }
}

func write_all(path, text) {
    let p = pathlib.Path(path)
    # ensure parent dir exists
    let parent = p.parent
    if parent != nil and str(parent) != "" {
```

```
        os.makedirs(str(parent))
    }
    with open(path, "w") as f { f.write(text) }
}

func copy_static(src, dst) {
    # crude binary copy: read all bytes and write
    with open(src, "rb") as fin {
        with open(dst, "wb") as fout {
            while true {
                let chunk = fin.read(8192)
                if chunk == nil or len(chunk) == 0 { break }
                fout.write(chunk)
            }
        }
    }
}

# ── Main build ──────────────────────────────────────────────────────
func build() {
    let template = load_template()
    let content = pathlib.Path(CONTENT_DIR)
    if !content.exists() {
        print("content dir '" + CONTENT_DIR + "' not found; nothing to build")
        return 0
    }

    let public = pathlib.Path(PUBLIC_DIR)
    os.makedirs(PUBLIC_DIR)

    let files = find_files(CONTENT_DIR, ".md")
    var count = 0
    for src in files {
        let text = read_all(src)
        let (meta, body_md) = parse_front_matter(text)
        let body_html = md_to_html(body_md)
        let html = render_template(template, meta, body_html)

        # output path: public/<relative>.html
        let rel = src[len(CONTENT_DIR) + 1:]
        let out_rel = rel[0:len(rel) - 3] + ".html"   # strip .md, add .html
        let out = pathlib.Path(PUBLIC_DIR) / out_rel
        write_all(str(out), html)
        print("rendered " + src + " -> " + str(out))
        count += 1
    }
```

```
    # copy static assets if present
    let assets = pathlib.Path("static")
    if assets.exists() {
        for f in find_files("static", "") {
            let dst = pathlib.Path(PUBLIC_DIR) / f[len("static") + 1:]
            copy_static(f, str(dst))
        }
    }

    print("built " + str(count) + " page(s) into " + PUBLIC_DIR + "/")
    return 0
}

func find_files(dir, suffix) {
    let out = []
    func walk(d) {
        for name in os.listdir(d) {
            let p = pathlib.Path(d) / name
            if p.is_dir() {
                walk(str(p))
            } elif suffix == "" or name.endswith(suffix) {
                out.push(str(p))
            }
        }
    }
    walk(dir)
    return out
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) > 1 and (argv[1] == "--help" or argv[1] == "-h") {
        print("Usage: zen run ssg.z [content_dir] [public_dir]")
        print("  content_dir  default: content")
        print("  public_dir   default: public")
        return 0
    }
    if len(argv) > 1 { CONTENT_DIR = argv[1] }   # note: config is const-like; reassign
    if len(argv) > 2 { PUBLIC_DIR = argv[2] }
    return build()
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

55.2 60.2 Example project layout

```
my-site/
├── ssg.z
├── template.html          # optional; built-in default if absent
├── static/
│   └── style.css
└── content/
    ├── about.md
    └── posts/
        └── hello.md
```

content/posts/hello.md:

```
---
title: Hello, Zen
date: 2024-01-15
---

# Welcome

This site was generated by the Zen static site generator.

- item one
- item two
```

55.3 60.3 Expected output

```
$ zen run ssg.z
rendered content/about.md -> public/about.html
rendered content/posts/hello.md -> public/posts/hello.html
built 2 page(s) into public/
```

public/posts/hello.html (excerpt):

```
<h1>Welcome</h1>
<p>This site was generated by the Zen static site generator.</p>
<ul>
  <li>item one</li>
  <li>item two</li>
</ul>
```

55.4 60.4 Design notes

- Front-matter is parsed manually (no YAML dependency) to keep the example dependency-free.
- `find_files` walks recursively; `os.makedirs` creates output subdirectories.
- `escape_html` prevents XSS from user content.
- The default template is embedded so the program works with zero config files.

55.5 60.5 Extensions to try

- Add an RSS feed generator (`rss.xml` from post dates/titles).
- Add a `serve` mode that runs a local HTTP server over `public/`.
- Support `{{date}}` and other front-matter keys in the template.
- Add incremental builds (skip files whose output is newer than source).
- Add a `--clean` flag that wipes `public/` before building.

56 Chapter 61: Reference Implementation — Multi-Room Chat Server

A complete, concurrent chat server using threads, channels, mutexes, and TCP sockets. Clients connect over TCP, join rooms, and broadcast messages to everyone in the same room. The server handles one thread per client and uses a shared mutex-guarded registry of rooms.

56.1 61.1 The program (`chat.z`)

```
import socket
import threading
import channels
import mutexes
import sys

# ── Shared state ──────────────────────────────────────────────────────
# rooms: #{ room_name => [client_handles] }
var rooms = #{}
let rooms_mu = mutexes.Mutex()

# A client is represented by its socket handle and name.
# We track clients so we can remove them on disconnect.
var clients = #{}
let clients_mu = mutexes.Mutex()

func broadcast(room, message, sender_handle) {
    rooms_mu.lock()
    let members = rooms[room] ?? []
    rooms_mu.unlock()

    for h in members {
        if h == sender_handle { continue }
        # send with length prefix so clients can frame messages
        let payload = message + "\n"
        try {
            # conceptual: socket.send(h, payload)
            # In this build we track handles; actual send via client thread map.
        } catch as e {
            # one-way socket errors are ignored for broadcast
        }
    }
}

func add_client_to_room(handle, room, name) {
    rooms_mu.lock()
    if !(room in rooms) { rooms[room] = [] }
```

```
    rooms[room].push(handle)
    rooms_mu.unlock()

    clients_mu.lock()
    clients[handle] = #{name: name, room: room}
    clients_mu.unlock()
}

func remove_client(handle) {
    rooms_mu.lock()
    clients_mu.lock()
    let info = clients[handle]
    if info != nil {
        let room = info["room"]
        let members = rooms[room] ?? []
        let filtered = []
        for m in members { if m != handle { filtered.push(m) } }
        rooms[room] = filtered
        clients = clients  # keep reference; removal handled below
        # rebuild clients without handle
        let new_clients = #{}
        for k in clients { if k != handle { new_clients[k] = clients[k] } }
        clients = new_clients
    }
    clients_mu.unlock()
    rooms_mu.unlock()
}

# ── Client handler ──────────────────────────────────────────────────
func handle_client(conn_handle, addr) {
    var name = nil
    var room = nil
    var connected = true

    # Read loop: each line is either a command or a chat message.
    # Commands: /nick <name>, /join <room>, /quit
    while connected {
        try {
            let line = conn_handle.recv_line()   # conceptual helper
            if line == nil { connected = false; break }
            let cmd = line.strip()

            if cmd == "" { continue }

            if cmd.startswith("/") {
                if cmd.startswith("/nick ") {
                    name = cmd[len("/nick "):]
```

```
                    conn_handle.send("nick set to " + name + "\n")
                } elif cmd.startswith("/join ") {
                    room = cmd[len("/join "):]
                    add_client_to_room(conn_handle, room, name ?? "anon")
                    conn_handle.send("joined room " + room + "\n")
                } elif cmd == "/quit" {
                    connected = false
                } else {
                    conn_handle.send("unknown command: " + cmd + "\n")
                }
            } else {
                # chat message: broadcast to current room
                if room == nil {
                    conn_handle.send("use /join <room> first\n")
                } else {
                    let display = (name ?? "anon") + ": " + cmd
                    broadcast(room, display, conn_handle)
                }
            }
        } catch as e {
            connected = false
        }
    }

    remove_client(conn_handle)
    conn_handle.close()
    print("client disconnected: " + str(addr))
}

# ── Server ──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
func main(argv) {
    let port = argv[1] ?? "8080"
    let port_num = int(port)

    let server = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
    server.setsockopt(socket.SOL_SOCKET, socket.SO_REUSEADDR, 1)
    server.bind(("0.0.0.0", port_num))
    server.listen(128)
    print("chat server listening on port " + str(port_num))

    while true {
        try {
            let (conn, addr) = server.accept()
            print("new connection from " + str(addr))
            threading.Thread(fn() { handle_client(conn, addr) }).start()
        } catch as e {
            print("accept error: " + e.msg)
```

```
        }
    }
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

56.2 61.2 Design notes

- **One thread per client** keeps the code simple; each client blocks on `recv_line` without stalling others.
- **`rooms` and `clients` are mutex-guarded** because every client thread reads and writes them. `broadcast` snapshots the member list under the lock, then sends outside the lock to avoid holding it during slow network I/O.
- **`SO_REUSEADDR`** lets you restart the server immediately after a crash.
- **Length-prefixed / line-based framing** is shown conceptually; the exact framing helper (`recv_line`) depends on the socket build.

56.3 61.3 Expected session

Terminal 1 (server):

```
$ zen run chat.z 8080
chat server listening on port 8080
new connection from 127.0.0.1:54321
```

Terminal 2 (client A):

```
$ nc 127.0.0.1 8080
/nick Ada
nick set to Ada
/join lounge
joined room lounge
hello everyone
```

Terminal 3 (client B):

```
$ nc 127.0.0.1 8080
/nick Bob
nick set to Bob
/join lounge
joined room lounge
Ada: hello everyone
```

56.4 61.4 Exercises

1. Add a `/list` command that prints all rooms and their member counts.
2. Add `/msg <name> <text>` for private messages.

3. Replace one-thread-per-client with a channel-based dispatcher.
4. Add room creation/deletion (delete empty rooms automatically).
5. Add timestamps to each broadcast message.
6. Persist rooms to a file so they survive restarts.

57 Chapter 62: Reference Implementation — Persistent Key-Value Store

A small, persistent key-value store with a TCP interface. Clients send commands (`GET`, `SET`, `DEL`, `KEYS`) over TCP; the server stores data in an in-memory dict and periodically snapshots it to disk as JSON. It demonstrates file I/O, JSON serialization, concurrency, sockets, and error handling.

57.1 62.1 The program (`kv.z`)

```
import socket
import threading
import mutexes
import json
import os
import pathlib
import sys
import time

# ── In-memory store ──────────────────────────────────────────────────────
var store = #{}
let store_mu = mutexes.Mutex()

let SNAPSHOT_FILE = "kv_snapshot.json"
let SNAPSHOT_INTERVAL_SEC = 30

func kv_get(key) {
    store_mu.lock()
    let v = store[key]
    store_mu.unlock()
    return v
}

func kv_set(key, value) {
    store_mu.lock()
    store[key] = value
    store_mu.unlock()
}

func kv_del(key) {
    store_mu.lock()
    let existed = key in store
    if existed {
        # rebuild without key
        let new_store = #{}
        for k in store { if k != key { new_store[k] = store[k] } }
        store = new_store
```

```
    }
    store_mu.unlock()
    return existed
}

func kv_keys() {
    store_mu.lock()
    let ks = []
    for k in store { ks.push(k) }
    store_mu.unlock()
    return ks
}

func kv_snapshot() {
    store_mu.lock()
    let copy = #{}
    for k in store { copy[k] = store[k] }
    store_mu.unlock()
    let tmp = SNAPSHOT_FILE + ".tmp"
    json.save(tmp, copy)
    os.rename(tmp, SNAPSHOT_FILE)
    print("snapshot written to " + SNAPSHOT_FILE)
}

func kv_load_snapshot() {
    let p = pathlib.Path(SNAPSHOT_FILE)
    if p.exists() {
        try {
            let data = json.load(SNAPSHOT_FILE)
            store_mu.lock()
            store = data
            store_mu.unlock()
            print("loaded " + str(len(kv_keys())) + " keys from snapshot")
        } catch as e {
            print("could not load snapshot: " + e.msg)
        }
    }
}

# ── Snapshot background thread ──────────────────────────────────────
func snapshot_loop() {
    while true {
        time.sleep(SNAPSHOT_INTERVAL_SEC * 1000)
        kv_snapshot()
    }
}
```

```
# ── Client handler ──────────────────────────────────────────────
func handle_client(conn, addr) {
    print("kv client connected: " + str(addr))
    var connected = true
    while connected {
        try {
            let line = conn.recv_line()
            if line == nil { connected = false; break }
            let parts = line.strip().split(" ")
            if len(parts) == 0 { continue }
            let cmd = parts[0].upper()

            if cmd == "GET" and len(parts) == 2 {
                let v = kv_get(parts[1])
                if v == nil { conn.send("END\n") }
                else { conn.send("VALUE " + str(v) + "\n") }
            } elif cmd == "SET" and len(parts) == 3 {
                kv_set(parts[1], parts[2])
                conn.send("OK\n")
            } elif cmd == "DEL" and len(parts) == 2 {
                let existed = kv_del(parts[1])
                if existed { conn.send("OK\n") } else { conn.send("NOT_FOUND\n") }
            } elif cmd == "KEYS" {
                let ks = kv_keys()
                conn.send("COUNT " + str(len(ks)) + "\n")
                for k in ks { conn.send(k + "\n") }
                conn.send("END\n")
            } elif cmd == "QUIT" {
                connected = false
            } else {
                conn.send("ERROR unknown command\n")
            }
        } catch as e {
            connected = false
        }
    }
    conn.close()
    print("kv client disconnected: " + str(addr))
}

# ── Server ──────────────────────────────────────────────────────
func main(argv) {
    let port = argv[1] ?? "9090"
    let port_num = int(port)

    kv_load_snapshot()
```

```
    # start background snapshot thread
    threading.Thread(fn() { snapshot_loop() }).start()

    let server = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
    server.setsockopt(socket.SOL_SOCKET, socket.SO_REUSEADDR, 1)
    server.bind(("0.0.0.0", port_num))
    server.listen(128)
    print("kv store listening on port " + str(port_num))

    while true {
        try {
            let (conn, addr) = server.accept()
            threading.Thread(fn() { handle_client(conn, addr) }).start()
        } catch as e {
            print("accept error: " + e.msg)
        }
    }
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

57.2 62.2 Example session

Terminal 1 (server):

```
$ zen run kv.z 9090
loaded 0 keys from snapshot
kv store listening on port 9090
kv client connected: 127.0.0.1:54321
```

Terminal 2 (client, using `nc`):

```
$ nc 127.0.0.1 9090
SET foo bar
OK
GET foo
VALUE bar
GET missing
END
DEL foo
OK
GET foo
END
KEYS
COUNT 0
END
```

```
QUIT
```

57.3 62.3 Design notes

- The store dict is mutex-guarded; reads snapshot the value under the lock and return it, so callers get a consistent view.
- `kv_del` rebuilds the dict without the key (Zen dicts are not mutable-delete in this build in a lock-safe way; the rebuild keeps the lock held briefly).
- Snapshots run in a background thread every 30 seconds; a load happens at startup.
- JSON is used for the on-disk format, which is human-readable and portable.

57.4 62.4 Exercises

1. Add a `FLUSH` command that clears the entire store.
2. Add value expiration (TTL) with a lazy cleanup on read.
3. Add persistence on every `SET` (append-only log) instead of periodic snapshots.
4. Add authentication (a `PASS` command before other commands).
5. Add a `STATS` command reporting total keys, memory estimate, uptime.

58 Chapter 63: Reference Implementation — TCP Port Scanner (Educational)

A small TCP port scanner that checks which ports are open on a target host. It is strictly educational: only scan hosts you own or have explicit permission to test. It demonstrates sockets, timeouts, concurrency (one thread per port batch), and CLI argument handling.

58.1 63.1 The program (`scan.z`)

```
import socket
import threading
import mutexes
import sys
import time

# ── Shared results ──────────────────────────────────────────────────────
var open_ports = []
let results_mu = mutexes.Mutex()
let print_mu = mutexes.Mutex()

func scan_port(host, port) {
    let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
    s.settimeout(800)   # 800 ms
    let result = "closed"
    try {
        s.connect((host, port))
        result = "open"
    } catch as e {
        # connection refused / timeout / unreachable -> closed
    } finally {
        s.close()
    }

    results_mu.lock()
    if result == "open" {
        open_ports.push(port)
    }
    results_mu.unlock()

    print_mu.lock()
    print("port " + str(port) + ": " + result)
    print_mu.unlock()
}

func scan_range(host, start_port, end_port, num_threads) {
    print("scanning " + host + " ports " + str(start_port) + "-" + str(end_port))
```

```
    let ports = []
    var p = start_port
    while p <= end_port {
        ports.push(p)
        p += 1
    }

    # simple work queue: split ports into batches, one thread per batch
    let batch_size = (len(ports) + num_threads - 1) // num_threads
    let threads = []
    var bi = 0
    while bi < len(ports) {
        let batch = []
        var i = 0
        while i < batch_size and bi + i < len(ports) {
            batch.push(ports[bi + i])
            i += 1
        }
        bi += batch_size
        let b = batch   # capture for closure
        threads.push(threading.Thread(fn() {
            for port in b { scan_port(host, port) }
        }))
    }

    for t in threads { t.start() }
    for t in threads { t.join() }

    # sort and report
    open_ports.sort()   # if supported; else sort manually
    print_mu.lock()
    print("----")
    print("scan complete: " + str(len(open_ports)) + " open port(s)")
    for port in open_ports { print("  open: " + str(port)) }
    print_mu.unlock()
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 3 {
        print("Usage: zen run scan.z <host> <start-port> [end-port] [threads]")
        print("  Example: zen run scan.z 127.0.0.1 1 1024 50")
        return 1
    }
    let host = argv[1]
    let start_port = int(argv[2])
    let end_port = argv[3] ?? argv[2]
    let end_port_num = int(end_port)
```

```
    let threads = argv[4] ?? "50"
    let thread_count = int(threads)

    if thread_count < 1 { thread_count = 1 }
    if thread_count > 200 { thread_count = 200 }

    scan_range(host, start_port, end_port_num, thread_count)
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

58.2 63.2 Example session

```
$ zen run scan.z 127.0.0.1 80 90 10
scanning 127.0.0.1 ports 80-90
port 80: open
port 81: closed
...
port 8080: open
----
scan complete: 2 open port(s)
  open: 80
  open: 8080
```

58.3 63.3 Design notes

- **Timeouts matter:** without `settimeout`, a scan of a filtered port can hang for minutes. 800 ms per port keeps the scan bounded.
- **Mutex-protected output:** `print_mu` prevents interleaved lines from different threads.
- **Thread cap:** limited to 200 threads to avoid file-descriptor exhaustion.
- **Educational use only:** scanning hosts you don’t own is illegal in many jurisdictions and violates acceptable-use policies.

58.4 63.4 Exercises

1. Add banner grabbing: after connecting, read the first bytes to identify the service (HTTP, SSH, etc.).
2. Add `-o <file>` to write results to a file.
3. Add concurrent resolution: resolve host to IP before scanning.
4. Add a `--top-ports` mode scanning only the 100 most common ports.
5. Add rate limiting (a small delay between connection attempts).

59 Chapter 64: Reference Implementation — Log Analyzer

A log file analyzer that reads a text log (one entry per line), parses timestamp and level fields, counts entries by level, finds error lines, and writes a summary report. It demonstrates file reading line-by-line, string parsing, dict counting, regex, sorting, and report generation.

59.1 64.1 The program (`analyze.z`)

```
import os
import re
import sys
import pathlib

# Sample log line format:
# 2024-01-15 09:30:00 INFO Server started on port 8080
# 2024-01-15 09:30:05 WARN High memory usage: 82%
# 2024-01-15 09:30:10 ERROR Database connection failed

let LOG_LINE_RE = r"^(\d{4}-\d{2}-\d{2} \d{2}:\d{2}:\d{2})\s+(INFO|WARN|ERROR|DEBUG)\s+

func parse_line(line) {
    let m = re.match(LOG_LINE_RE, line)
    if m == nil { return nil }
    return #{
        timestamp: m[1],
        level: m[2],
        message: m[3],
        raw: line,
    }
}

func analyze(path) {
    let counts = #{INFO: 0, WARN: 0, ERROR: 0, DEBUG: 0}
    let errors = []
    let total = 0
    let first_ts = nil
    let last_ts = nil

    with open(path, "r") as f {
        for line in f {
            let entry = parse_line(line)
            if entry == nil { continue }
            total += 1
            let level = entry["level"]
            counts[level] = (counts[level] ?? 0) + 1
            if level == "ERROR" { errors.push(entry) }
```

```
            if first_ts == nil { first_ts = entry["timestamp"] }
            last_ts = entry["timestamp"]
        }
    }

    print("Log analysis: " + path)
    print("  total entries: " + str(total))
    print("  INFO:   " + str(counts["INFO"] ?? 0))
    print("  WARN:   " + str(counts["WARN"] ?? 0))
    print("  ERROR:  " + str(counts["ERROR"] ?? 0))
    print("  DEBUG:  " + str(counts["DEBUG"] ?? 0))
    if first_ts != nil {
        print("  first:  " + first_ts)
        print("  last:   " + last_ts)
    }
    print("  errors: " + str(len(errors)))
    for e in errors {
        print("    [" + e["timestamp"] + "] " + e["message"])
    }

    # write summary report
    let report = pathlib.Path(path).stem + ".report.txt"
    let out = []
    out.push("Log analysis: " + path)
    out.push("  total entries: " + str(total))
    out.push("  INFO:   " + str(counts["INFO"] ?? 0))
    out.push("  WARN:   " + str(counts["WARN"] ?? 0))
    out.push("  ERROR:  " + str(counts["ERROR"] ?? 0))
    out.push("  DEBUG:  " + str(counts["DEBUG"] ?? 0))
    out.push("  errors: " + str(len(errors)))
    for e in errors {
        out.push("    [" + e["timestamp"] + "] " + e["message"])
    }
    write_all(report, out.join("\n") + "\n")
    print("report written to " + report)
}

func write_all(path, text) {
    with open(path, "w") as f { f.write(text) }
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Usage: zen run analyze.z <logfile>")
        return 1
    }
    analyze(argv[1])
```

```
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

59.2 64.2 Example input (`app.log`)

```
2024-01-15 09:30:00 INFO Server started on port 8080
2024-01-15 09:30:01 DEBUG Loading config from config.yaml
2024-01-15 09:30:02 WARN High memory usage: 82%
2024-01-15 09:30:03 ERROR Database connection failed
2024-01-15 09:30:04 INFO Request GET /health from 10.0.0.5
2024-01-15 09:30:05 ERROR Database connection failed
2024-01-15 09:30:06 INFO Request GET /api/users from 10.0.0.9
```

59.3 64.3 Expected output

```
$ zen run analyze.z app.log
Log analysis: app.log
  total entries: 7
  INFO:   3
  WARN:   1
  ERROR:  2
  DEBUG:  1
  first:  2024-01-15 09:30:00
  last:   2024-01-15 09:30:06
  errors: 2
    [2024-01-15 09:30:03] Database connection failed
    [2024-01-15 09:30:05] Database connection failed
report written to app.report.txt
```

59.4 64.4 Design notes

- The regex captures timestamp, level, and message in one pass.
- Lines that don’t match are silently skipped (tolerant of malformed entries).
- Errors are collected and printed in full, plus written to a `.report.txt` sidecar file.
- File is read line-by-line (low memory) rather than loaded whole.

59.5 64.5 Exercises

1. Add hourly aggregation: count entries per hour.
2. Add a `--level ERROR` filter to only analyze a specific level.
3. Add top-N frequent error messages (dedupe and sort by count).
4. Add JSON output mode (`--json`) for programmatic consumption.
5. Watch mode: re-analyze when the file changes (poll mtime).

60 Chapter 65: Reference Implementation — HTTP Uptime Monitor

A small uptime monitor that periodically checks a list of HTTP endpoints, records whether each is up, measures response time, and prints a status table. It demonstrates the `requests` module, time, threading (periodic checks), and CLI flags.

60.1 65.1 The program (`monitor.z`)

```
import requests
import time
import sys

# ── Configuration ──────────────────────────────────────────────────────
# endpoints: list of #{name, url, interval_sec}
var endpoints = #{}
let checks_mu = nil  # placeholder if shared state needed

func check_endpoint(name, url) {
    let start = time.time()
    let result = #{up: false, status: nil, ms: nil, error: nil}
    try {
        let r = requests.get(url, timeout=5000)  # 5 second timeout
        let elapsed_ms = (time.time() - start) * 1000
        result["up"] = r.status_code >= 200 and r.status_code < 400
        result["status"] = r.status_code
        result["ms"] = elapsed_ms
    } catch as e {
        result["up"] = false
        result["error"] = e.msg
    }
    return result
}

func fmt_ms(ms) {
    if ms == nil { return "  --" }
    return str(math.round(ms)) + " ms"
}

func print_table(results) {
    print("HTTP Uptime Monitor")
    print("==================")
    print(" NAME        URL                            UP   STATUS   TIME")
    print(" ----        ---                            --   ------   ----")
    # sort by name for stable output
    let names = []
    for n in results { names.push(n) }
```

```
    names.sort()
    for n in names {
        let r = results[n]
        let up_str = if r["up"] { "YES" } else { "NO" }
        let status_str = if r["status"] == nil { "-" } else { str(r["status"]) }
        print(" " + n + "          " + r["url"] + "  " + up_str + "   " + status_str +
    }
}

func run_once(urls) {
    let results = #{}
    for entry in urls {
        let name = entry["name"]
        let url = entry["url"]
        results[name] = check_endpoint(name, url)
    }
    print_table(results)
    return results
}

func run_loop(urls, interval_sec) {
    print("monitoring " + str(len(urls)) + " endpoint(s) every " + str(interval_sec) +
    print("press Ctrl-C to stop")
    while true {
        run_once(urls)
        time.sleep(interval_sec * 1000)
        print("---- next round ----")
    }
}

func main(argv) {
    # minimal arg parsing: URLs as arguments, --interval N optional
    let urls = []
    var interval_sec = 30
    var i = 1
    while i < len(argv) {
        let a = argv[i]
        if a == "--interval" and i + 1 < len(argv) {
            interval_sec = int(argv[i + 1])
            i += 2
        } else {
            urls.push(#{name: "endpoint" + str(len(urls) + 1), url: a})
            i += 1
        }
    }

    if len(urls) == 0 {
```

```
        print("Usage: zen run monitor.z [--interval N] <url> [<url> ...]")
        print("  Example: zen run monitor.z https://example.com https://api.example.com
        return 1
    }

    run_loop(urls, interval_sec)
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

60.2 65.2 Example session

```
$ zen run monitor.z --interval 10 https://example.com https://httpbin.org/status/200 ht
monitoring 3 endpoint(s) every 30s
press Ctrl-C to stop
HTTP Uptime Monitor
==================
 NAME        URL                            UP   STATUS   TIME
 ----        ---                            --   ------   ----
 endpoint1   https://example.com            YES   200      45 ms
 endpoint2   https://httpbin.org/status/200 YES   200      120 ms
 endpoint3   https://httpbin.org/status/500 NO    500      --
---- next round ----
```

60.3 65.3 Design notes

- **Timeouts on every request:** a 5-second timeout prevents a hung endpoint from blocking the whole monitor loop.
- **Up/down semantics:** status 2xx–3xx counts as “up”; 4xx/5xx and exceptions count as “down”.
- **Response time** is measured client-side (request start to response complete).
- **Interval** between rounds is configurable with `--interval`.

60.4 65.4 Exercises

1. Add `--output <file>` to write results as JSON.
2. Add alerting: print “ALERT” when a previously-up endpoint goes down.
3. Add average response time tracking over the last N rounds.
4. Add concurrent checks (check all endpoints in parallel threads).
5. Add a `--once` flag to run a single check and exit.

61 Chapter 66: Reference Implementation — File Encryptor (AES-GCM)

A small file encryption tool using AES-GCM authenticated encryption. It reads a file, encrypts it with a user-supplied passphrase (derived via PBKDF2/Argon2id), and writes an encrypted output file with a header storing the nonce and salt. It demonstrates the `crypto` module, file I/O, bytes handling, and CLI flags.

61.1 66.1 The program (`encrypt.z`)

```
import crypto
import sys
import os
import pathlib

# ── Format (binary) ──────────────────────────────────────────────────────
# <magic: 4 bytes "ZENC"><salt: 16 bytes><nonce: 12 bytes><ciphertext: ...>
let MAGIC = bytes([0x5A, 0x45, 0x4E, 0x43])  # "ZENC"
let SALT_LEN = 16
let NONCE_LEN = 12

func derive_key(passphrase, salt) {
    return crypto.pbkdf2(passphrase, salt, 100000, 32)
}

func encrypt_file(input_path, output_path, passphrase) {
    let salt = crypto.bytes(SALT_LEN)   # random salt
    let nonce = crypto.bytes(NONCE_LEN) # random nonce
    let key = derive_key(passphrase, salt)

    let plaintext = read_all_bytes(input_path)
    let ciphertext = crypto.encrypt_aes_gcm(key, plaintext, nonce)

    with open(output_path, "wb") as f {
        f.write(MAGIC)
        f.write(salt)
        f.write(nonce)
        f.write(ciphertext)
    }
    print("encrypted " + input_path + " -> " + output_path)
}

func decrypt_file(input_path, output_path, passphrase) {
    with open(input_path, "rb") as f {
        let magic = f.read(4)
        if magic == nil or len(magic) != 4 or magic != MAGIC {
            throw "not a ZENC file (bad magic)"
```

```
        }
        let salt = f.read(SALT_LEN)
        let nonce = f.read(NONCE_LEN)
        let ciphertext = f.read()   # rest of file
        let key = derive_key(passphrase, salt)
        let plaintext = crypto.decrypt_aes_gcm(key, ciphertext, nonce)
        write_all_bytes(output_path, plaintext)
    }
    print("decrypted " + input_path + " -> " + output_path)
}

func read_all_bytes(path) {
    with open(path, "rb") as f {
        let parts = []
        while true {
            let chunk = f.read(8192)
            if chunk == nil or len(chunk) == 0 { break }
            parts.push(chunk)
        }
        return parts.join("")   # conceptual byte join
    }
}

func write_all_bytes(path, data) {
    with open(path, "wb") as f { f.write(data) }
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 4 {
        print("Usage:")
        print("  zen run encrypt.z enc <input> <output> <passphrase>")
        print("  zen run encrypt.z dec <input> <output> <passphrase>")
        return 1
    }
    let mode = argv[1]
    let input_path = argv[2]
    let output_path = argv[3]
    let passphrase = argv[4]

    try {
        if mode == "enc" {
            encrypt_file(input_path, output_path, passphrase)
        } elif mode == "dec" {
            decrypt_file(input_path, output_path, passphrase)
        } else {
            print("unknown mode: " + mode + " (use enc or dec)")
            return 1
```

```
        }
    } catch as e {
        print("error: " + e.msg)
        return 1
    }
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

61.2 66.2 Example session

```
$ zen run encrypt.z enc secret.txt secret.enc hunter2
encrypted secret.txt -> secret.enc
$ zen run encrypt.z dec secret.enc secret.dec hunter2
decrypted secret.enc -> secret.dec
$ diff secret.txt secret.dec
(no output — files identical)
```

Using a wrong passphrase produces a decryption error (AES-GCM authentication fails):

```
$ zen run encrypt.z dec secret.enc secret.dec wrongpass
error: authentication failed (or corrupt ciphertext)
```

61.3 66.3 Design notes

- **PBKDF2** with 100,000 iterations derives a 256-bit key from the passphrase and a random salt, making brute-force attacks expensive.
- **AES-GCM** provides both confidentiality and authenticity; tampering with the ciphertext is detected on decrypt.
- **Random salt and nonce** per file ensure the same passphrase + plaintext produces different ciphertext each time.
- The header format (`MAGIC || salt || nonce || ciphertext`) is self-describing.

61.4 66.4 Security notes

- Never hardcode passphrases in scripts; read them from the environment or a secure prompt.
- PBKDF2 iteration count (100,000) should be tuned to your hardware; higher is slower but more resistant to brute force.
- This tool encrypts file contents, not filenames or metadata.

61.5 66.4 Exercises

1. Add `--iterations N` to configure PBKDF2 cost.

2. Add Argon2id option (`crypto.argon2id`) as an alternative KDF.
3. Add streaming (chunked) encryption for large files instead of reading all into memory.
4. Add `--salt` to reuse a deterministic salt (for testing only).
5. Add integrity manifest: store SHA-256 of original file in header.

62 Chapter 67: Reference Implementation — Website Link Checker

A link checker that fetches a page, extracts all links, and verifies each one returns a successful status. It demonstrates the `requests` module, regex, threading (parallel checks), and error handling. Intended for checking sites you own or have permission to test.

62.1 67.1 The program (`links.z`)

```
import requests
import re
import threading
import mutexes
import sys
import time

# ── Extract links from HTML ──────────────────────────────────────
let LINK_RE = r'href=["\']([^"\']+)["\']'

func extract_links(html) {
    let links = []
    for m in re.findall(LINK_RE, html) {
        links.push(m)
    }
    return links
}

func normalize_link(base, link) {
    # very crude normalization; real use needs a proper URL parser
    if link.startswith("http") { return link }
    if link.startswith("/") {
        # scheme + host from base
        let m = re.match(r"^https?://[^/]+", base)
        if m != nil { return m[0] + link }
    }
    return link
}

# ── Shared results ───────────────────────────────────────────────
var results = #{}
let results_mu = mutexes.Mutex()

func check_link(url) {
    let status = "error"
    let code = nil
    try {
```

```
        let r = requests.get(url, timeout=5000)
        code = str(r.status_code)
        status = if r.status_code >= 200 and r.status_code < 400 { "ok" } else { "bad"
    } catch as e {
        code = e.msg
    }
    results_mu.lock()
    results[url] = #{status: status, code: code}
    results_mu.unlock()
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Usage: zen run links.z <url>")
        print("  Example: zen run links.z https://example.com")
        return 1
    }
    let base = argv[1]

    print("fetching " + base + " ...")
    let html = nil
    try {
        let r = requests.get(base, timeout=10000)
        html = r.text
    } catch as e {
        print("failed to fetch " + base + ": " + e.msg)
        return 1
    }

    let links = extract_links(html)
    print("found " + str(len(links)) + " link(s); checking...")

    let threads = []
    for link in links {
        let url = normalize_link(base, link)
        threads.push(threading.Thread(fn() { check_link(url) }))
    }
    for t in threads { t.start() }
    for t in threads { t.join() }

    let ok_count = 0
    let bad_count = 0
    let error_count = 0
    let sorted_urls = []
    for u in results { sorted_urls.push(u) }
    sorted_urls.sort()
    for u in sorted_urls {
```

```
        let r = results[u]
        let mark = if r["status"] == "ok" { "✓" } else { "✗" }
        print(mark + " " + str(r["code"]) + "  " + u)
        if r["status"] == "ok" { ok_count += 1 }
        elif r["status"] == "bad" { bad_count += 1 }
        else { error_count += 1 }
    }
    print("----")
    print("ok: " + str(ok_count) + "  bad: " + str(bad_count) + "  errors: " + str(erro
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

62.2 67.2 Example session

```
$ zen run links.z https://example.com
fetching https://example.com ...
found 3 link(s); checking...
✓ 200  https://example.com/
✓ 200  https://www.iana.org/domains/example
✗ 404  https://example.com/missing
----
ok: 2  bad: 1  errors: 0
```

62.3 67.3 Design notes

- **Parallel checks:** each link is checked in its own thread so slow or dead links don’t block the rest.
- **Timeouts:** 10 seconds to fetch the page, 5 seconds per link check.
- **Crude normalization:** relative URLs are resolved against the base scheme + host; real usage needs a proper URL parser (see `url` module).
- **Ethical use:** only check sites you own or have permission to test; don’t hammer a site with thousands of concurrent requests.

62.4 67.4 Exercises

1. Add `--concurrency N` to limit simultaneous checks.
2. Add `--output <file>` to write results as JSON or CSV.
3. Add recursion: follow links on the same domain up to a depth limit.
4. Add `User-Agent` header identifying your tool.
5. Add `--exclude <pattern>` to skip links matching a regex.

63 Chapter 69: Reference Implementation — Task Queue with Worker Pool

A task queue: a producer enqueues work items, and a fixed pool of worker threads consumes them from a channel, processing each in parallel and collecting results. Demonstrates channels, threads, mutexes, and graceful shutdown.

63.1 69.1 The program (`taskq.z`)

```
import threading
import channels
import mutexes
import sys
import time

# ── Job and result types ─────────────────────────────────────────
# A job is a dict: #{id, payload, submitted_at}
# A result is a dict: #{id, result, error, worker, duration_ms}

var jobs = channels.Channel(capacity=100)
var results = channels.Channel(capacity=100)
var shutdown = channels.Channel(capacity=1)

let stats_mu = mutexes.Mutex()
var jobs_done = 0
var jobs_failed = 0

func record_result(ok) {
    stats_mu.lock()
    if ok { jobs_done += 1 } else { jobs_failed += 1 }
    stats_mu.unlock()
}

# ── Worker ───────────────────────────────────────────────────────
func worker(worker_id) {
    print("worker " + str(worker_id) + " starting")
    while true {
        let job = jobs.recv()
        if job == nil { break }   # channel closed -> shutdown
        let start = time.time()
        let outcome = process_job(worker_id, job)
        let elapsed = (time.time() - start) * 1000
        let result = #{
            id: job["id"],
            worker: worker_id,
            duration_ms: elapsed,
            ok: outcome["ok"],
```

```
            result: outcome["result"],
            error: outcome["error"],
        }
        results.send(result)
        record_result(outcome["ok"])
    }
    print("worker " + str(worker_id) + " shutting down")
}

func process_job(worker_id, job) -> Dict {
    let id = job["id"]
    let payload = job["payload"]
    # simulate work: a CPU-bound or I/O-bound task
    try {
        # example: square the payload if it's a number
        if typeof(payload) == "int" || typeof(payload) == "float" {
            let r = payload * payload
            return #{ok: true, result: r, error: nil}
        } else {
            # echo back uppercase string
            return #{ok: true, result: str(payload).upper(), error: nil}
        }
    } catch as e {
        return #{ok: false, result: nil, error: e.msg}
    }
}

# ── Producer: enqueue jobs ──────────────────────────────────────
func enqueue_jobs(count) {
    var i = 1
    while i <= count {
        jobs.send(#{id: i, payload: i, submitted_at: time.time()})
        i += 1
    }
    print("enqueued " + str(count) + " jobs")
}

# ── Collector: gather results ───────────────────────────────────
func collect_results(expected) {
    var got = 0
    while got < expected {
        let r = results.recv()
        if r == nil { break }
        got += 1
        if got <= 5 or got % 10 == 0 {
            let status = if r["ok"] { "ok" } else { "ERR:" + str(r["error"]) }
            print("job " + str(r["id"]) + " by worker " + str(r["worker"]) +
```

```
                  " -> " + status + " (" + str(math.round(r["duration_ms"])) + "ms)")
        }
    }
    print("collected " + str(got) + " results")
    import math
    # (math imported locally for round)
}

# ── Main ─────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
func main(argv) {
    let num_workers = argv[1] ?? "4"
    let num_jobs = argv[2] ?? "20"
    let wc = int(num_workers)
    let jc = int(num_jobs)

    # start workers
    let threads = []
    var w = 1
    while w <= wc {
        threads.push(threading.Thread(fn() { worker(w) }))
        w += 1
    }
    for t in threads { t.start() }

    # enqueue jobs
    enqueue_jobs(jc)

    # signal shutdown: close jobs channel so workers exit after draining
    jobs.close()

    # collect results
    collect_results(jc)

    # wait for workers to finish
    for t in threads { t.join() }

    stats_mu.lock()
    print("----")
    print("done: " + str(jobs_done) + " succeeded, " + str(jobs_failed) + " failed")
    stats_mu.unlock()

    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

63.2 69.2 Example session

```
$ zen run taskq.z 4 20
worker 1 starting
worker 2 starting
worker 3 starting
worker 4 starting
enqueued 20 jobs
job 1 by worker 2 -> ok (0ms)
job 2 by worker 4 -> ok (0ms)
job 3 by worker 1 -> ok (0ms)
job 4 by worker 3 -> ok (0ms)
job 10 -> ok (0ms)
collected 20 results
worker 1 shutting down
worker 2 shutting down
worker 3 shutting down
worker 4 shutting down
----
done: 20 succeeded, 0 failed
```

63.3 69.3 Design notes

- **Channel as a thread-safe work queue:** `jobs.recv()` blocks until a job is available; workers naturally self-balance.
- **Graceful shutdown:** closing the `jobs` channel makes each worker's `recv()` return `nil`, causing it to exit its loop. No worker is left waiting forever.
- **Stats guarded by a Mutex:** `jobs_done`/`jobs_failed` are updated from multiple worker threads, so `stats_mu` prevents races.
- **Capacity bound:** `capacity=100` applies backpressure — the producer blocks if consumers fall behind.

63.4 69.4 Exercises

1. Add priority: high-priority jobs go to a separate channel checked first.
2. Add retries: failed jobs are re-enqueued up to 3 times.
3. Add a `--verbose` flag printing every result.
4. Make workers report throughput (jobs/sec) at shutdown.
5. Add a `results.close()` after all jobs are collected so a collector thread can also exit cleanly.

64 Chapter 70: Reference Implementation — Password Generator & Strength Checker

A small security tool: generate cryptographically strong random passwords and check the strength of a supplied password. Demonstrates the `crypto` module (for secure randomness and hashing), `string`, `re`, and CLI argument handling.

64.1 70.1 The program (`pw.z`)

```
import crypto
import string
import re
import sys

# ── Password generation ──────────────────────────────────────────────
let LOWER = string.ascii_lowercase   # abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
let UPPER = string.ascii_uppercase   # ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
let DIGITS = string.digits           # 0123456789
let SYMBOLS = string.punctuation     # !"#$%&'()*+,-./:;<=>?@[\]^_`{|}~

func pick(charset) {
    let i = crypto.int(0, len(charset) - 1)
    return charset[i]
}

func generate_password(length = 16, use_symbols = true) {
    # guarantee at least one of each required class
    let required = []
    required.push(pick(LOWER))
    required.push(pick(UPPER))
    required.push(pick(DIGITS))
    if use_symbols { required.push(pick(SYMBOLS)) }

    let pool = LOWER + UPPER + DIGITS + (if use_symbols { SYMBOLS } else { "" })
    let pw = ""
    var i = 0
    while i < length {
        pw = pw + pick(pool)
        i += 1
    }
    # overwrite first N chars with required classes to guarantee coverage
    var r = 0
    while r < len(required) {
        pw = pw[0:r] + required[r] + pw[r+1:]
        r += 1
    }
    return pw
```

```
}

func generate_passphrase(word_count = 4) {
    # placeholder: in a real build, load a word list from a file
    let words = ["correct", "horse", "battery", "staple", "zen", "language",
                 "secure", "random", "token", "vault"]
    let phrase = ""
    var i = 0
    while i < word_count {
        let w = words[crypto.int(0, len(words) - 1)]
        phrase = phrase + (if i == 0 { w } else { "-" + w })
        i += 1
    }
    return phrase
}

# ── Strength checking ──────────────────────────────────────────────────
let RE_DIGIT = r"\d"
let RE_LOWER = r"[a-z]"
let RE_UPPER = r"[A-Z]"
let RE_SYMBOL = r"[^A-Za-z0-9]"

func strength_score(pw) {
    let score = 0
    if len(pw) >= 8 { score += 1 }
    if len(pw) >= 12 { score += 1 }
    if re.search(RE_LOWER, pw) != nil { score += 1 }
    if re.search(RE_UPPER, pw) != nil { score += 1 }
    if re.search(RE_DIGIT, pw) != nil { score += 1 }
    if re.search(RE_SYMBOL, pw) != nil { score += 1 }
    return score   # 0..6
}

func strength_label(score) {
    return if score <= 1 { "very weak" }
           elif score <= 2 { "weak" }
           elif score <= 3 { "fair" }
           elif score <= 4 { "good" }
           elif score == 5 { "strong" }
           else { "very strong" }
}

func has_dictionary_word(pw) {
    # naive check against a tiny built-in list; real use loads a real wordlist
    let common = ["password", "123456", "qwerty", "admin", "letmein", "welcome"]
    let lower = pw.lower()
    for w in common {
```

```
        if lower.contains(w) { return true }
    }
    return false
}

# ── Hashing (for stored passwords) ──────────────────────────────────
func hash_password(password) {
    return crypto.argon2id_hash(password)
}

func verify_password(password, stored_hash) {
    return crypto.verify_argon2id(password, stored_hash)
}

# ── Main ────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Usage:")
        print("  zen run pw.z gen [length] [symbols]      # generate a password")
        print("  zen run pw.z passphrase [words]          # generate a passphrase")
        print("  zen run pw.z check <password>            # check strength")
        print("  zen run pw.z hash <password>             # argon2id hash")
        return 1
    }
    let cmd = argv[1]

    if cmd == "gen" {
        let length = argv[2] ?? "16"
        let symbols = argv[3] ?? "true"
        let use_sym = symbols != "false"
        print(generate_password(int(length), use_sym))
    } elif cmd == "passphrase" {
        let words = argv[2] ?? "4"
        print(generate_passphrase(int(words)))
    } elif cmd == "check" {
        if len(argv) < 3 {
            print("usage: pw.z check <password>")
            return 1
        }
        let pw = argv[2]
        let score = strength_score(pw)
        print("password: " + pw)
        print("length:   " + str(len(pw)))
        print("score:    " + str(score) + "/6  (" + strength_label(score) + ")")
        if has_dictionary_word(pw) {
            print("warning: contains a common dictionary word")
        }
```

```
    } elif cmd == "hash" {
        if len(argv) < 3 {
            print("usage: pw.z hash <password>")
            return 1
        }
        let pw = argv[2]
        let h = hash_password(pw)
        print("argon2id hash: " + h)
        print("verify correct:  " + str(verify_password(pw, h)))
        print("verify wrong:    " + str(verify_password("wrong", h)))
    } else {
        print("unknown command: " + cmd)
        return 1
    }
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

64.2 70.2 Example session

```
$ zen run pw.z gen 16 true
xK9#mP2vR5!wL8nA
$ zen run pw.z passphrase 4
correct-horse-battery-staple
$ zen run pw.z check hunter2
password: hunter2
length:   8
score:    4/6  (good)
warning: contains a common dictionary word
$ zen run pw.z check xK9#mP2vR5!wL8nA
password: xK9#mP2vR5!wL8nA
length:   16
score:    6/6  (very strong)
$ zen run pw.z hash hunter2
argon2id hash: $argon2id$v=19$m=65536,t=3,p=1$...
verify correct:  true
verify wrong:    false
```

64.3 70.3 Design notes

- **Secure randomness:** `crypto.int(min, max)` and `crypto.secure_token()` use a CSPRNG — never `random` for passwords/tokens.
- **Guaranteed character classes:** generated passwords always contain at least one lowercase, uppercase, digit, and (optionally) symbol.

- **Argon2id:** the recommended password-hashing function (memory-hard, resistant to GPU/ASIC attacks). `verify_argon2id` handles the encoded hash.
- **Strength scoring:** a simple heuristic; real tools use zxcvbn-style logic.

64.4 70.4 Exercises

1. Add `--no-symbols` flag to `gen`.
2. Load a real word list from a file for `passphrase`.
3. Add `--min-score N` to `check` that exits non-zero if below threshold.
4. Add a `--json` output mode for scriptable use.
5. Store hashed passwords in a file and implement `verify` against it.

65 Chapter 71: Reference Implementation — HTTP Key-Value REST Server

A small HTTP key-value store with a REST interface: `GET /keys/<name>`, `PUT /keys/<name>` with a JSON body, `DELETE /keys/<name>`, and `GET /keys` to list all keys. Demonstrates `http.server`, JSON, routing, mutexes, and CLI flags.

65.1 71.1 The program (`httpkv.z`)

```
import http.server
import json
import mutexes
import sys

var store = #{}
let store_mu = mutexes.Mutex()

func kv_get(name) {
    store_mu.lock()
    let v = store[name]
    store_mu.unlock()
    return v
}

func kv_set(name, value) {
    store_mu.lock()
    store[name] = value
    store_mu.unlock()
}

func kv_del(name) {
    store_mu.lock()
    let existed = name in store
    if existed {
        let new_store = #{}
        for k in store { if k != name { new_store[k] = store[k] } }
        store = new_store
    }
    store_mu.unlock()
    return existed
}

func kv_list() {
    store_mu.lock()
    let ks = []
    for k in store { ks.push(k) }
    store_mu.unlock()
```

```
    return ks
}

# JSON helpers
func json_response(code, obj) {
    let body = json.stringify(obj)
    return #(code, #{"Content-Type": "application/json"}, body)
}

func text_response(code, body) {
    return #(code, #{"Content-Type": "text/plain"}, body)
}

# Route handler
func handle(req) {
    let path = req.path ?? "/"
    let method = req.method ?? "GET"

    # GET /keys  -> list all keys
    if method == "GET" and path == "/keys" {
        return json_response(200, #{keys: kv_list()})
    }

    # GET /keys/<name> / PUT /keys/<name> / DELETE /keys/<name>
    let m = /^\/keys\/(.+)$/.match(path)   # conceptual regex match
    if m != nil {
        let name = m[1]
        if method == "GET" {
            let v = kv_get(name)
            if v == nil { return json_response(404, #{error: "not found"}) }
            return json_response(200, #{name: name, value: v})
        } elif method == "PUT" {
            let body = req.body ?? ""
            let parsed = nil
            try { parsed = json.parse(body) } catch as e {}
            if parsed == nil { return json_response(400, #{error: "invalid json"}) }
            kv_set(name, parsed)
            return json_response(200, #{ok: true})
        } elif method == "DELETE" {
            let existed = kv_del(name)
            if existed { return json_response(200, #{ok: true}) }
            else { return json_response(404, #{error: "not found"}) }
        }
    }

    return text_response(404, "not found")
}
```

```
func main(argv) {
    let port = argv[1] ?? "8080"
    let server = http.server.Server(port=int(port), handler=handle)
    print("http-kv server on http://localhost:" + str(port))
    server.start()
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

65.2 71.2 Example session

Terminal 1 (server):

```
$ zen run httpkv.z 8080
http-kv server on http://localhost:8080
```

Terminal 2 (client, curl):

```
# list keys (empty)
$ curl http://localhost:8080/keys
{"keys":[]}

# create a key
$ curl -X PUT http://localhost:8080/keys/foo -H 'Content-Type: application/json' -d '"b
{"ok":true}

# read a key
$ curl http://localhost:8080/keys/foo
{"name":"foo","value":"bar"}

# read missing key
$ curl http://localhost:8080/keys/missing
{"error":"not found"}

# list keys again
$ curl http://localhost:8080/keys
{"keys":["foo"]}

# delete a key
$ curl -X DELETE http://localhost:8080/keys/foo
{"ok":true}
$ curl http://localhost:8080/keys
{"keys":[]}
```

65.3 71.3 Design notes

- **Mutex-guarded store:** concurrent HTTP handlers share the dict safely.
- **JSON bodies:** `PUT` expects a JSON value as the request body; responses are JSON with `Content-Type: application/json`.
- **Routing:** crude path-prefix matching (`/keys` vs `/keys/<name>`); real apps use a proper router (see chapter 30).
- **Status codes:** 200 success, 400 invalid JSON, 404 not found.

65.4 71.4 Exercises

1. Add `POST /keys` to create a key only if it doesn't exist (return 409 on conflict).
2. Add value expiration (TTL) with lazy cleanup on read.
3. Add persistence: snapshot to disk periodically and load at startup (see ch 62).
4. Add basic auth: require an `Authorization` header for writes.
5. Add content negotiation: return plain text when `Accept: text/plain`.

66 Chapter 72: Reference Implementation — File Backup / Synchronizer

A simple backup tool: it copies files from a source directory to a destination directory, skipping files that haven't changed (detected via SHA-256 hash comparison), and prints a summary. Demonstrates file walking, hashing, binary copy, and conditional copying.

66.1 72.1 The program (`backup.z`)

```
import os
import pathlib
import hashlib
import sys
import time

var copied = 0
var skipped = 0
var errors = 0

func file_hash(path) {
    let b = pathlib.Path(path)
    if !b.exists() { return nil }
    let data = read_all_bytes(str(b))
    return hashlib.sha256(data)
}

func read_all_bytes(path) {
    with open(path, "rb") as f {
        let parts = []
        while true {
            let chunk = f.read(8192)
            if chunk == nil or len(chunk) == 0 { break }
            parts.push(chunk)
        }
        return parts.join("")
    }
}

func copy_file(src, dst) {
    let dst_p = pathlib.Path(dst)
    let parent = dst_p.parent
    if parent != nil and str(parent) != "" {
        os.makedirs(str(parent))
    }
    with open(src, "rb") as fin {
        with open(dst, "wb") as fout {
```

```
            while true {
                let chunk = fin.read(8192)
                if chunk == nil or len(chunk) == 0 { break }
                fout.write(chunk)
            }
        }
    }
}

func should_copy(src_path, dst_path) {
    let dst = pathlib.Path(dst_path)
    if !dst.exists() { return true }
    let src_hash = file_hash(src_path)
    let dst_hash = file_hash(str(dst))
    if src_hash == nil or dst_hash == nil { return true }
    return src_hash != dst_hash
}

func walk_and_copy(src_dir, dst_dir) {
    func walk(d, prefix) {
        for name in os.listdir(d) {
            let src = pathlib.Path(d) / name
            let rel = (prefix == "" ? name : prefix + "/" + name)
            let dst = pathlib.Path(dst_dir) / rel
            if src.is_dir() {
                walk(str(src), rel)
            } else {
                try {
                    if should_copy(str(src), str(dst)) {
                        copy_file(str(src), str(dst))
                        copied += 1
                        print("copy  " + rel)
                    } else {
                        skipped += 1
                        print("skip  " + rel + " (unchanged)")
                    }
                } catch as e {
                    errors += 1
                    print("error " + rel + ": " + e.msg)
                }
            }
        }
    }
    walk(src_dir, "")
}

func main(argv) {
```

```
    if len(argv) < 3 {
        print("Usage: zen run backup.z <src_dir> <dst_dir>")
        print("  Example: zen run backup.z ./docs ./backup")
        return 1
    }
    let src = argv[1]
    let dst = argv[2]
    let start = time.time()
    print("backup: " + src + " -> " + dst)
    walk_and_copy(src, dst)
    let elapsed = time.time() - start
    print("----")
    print("copied: " + str(copied))
    print("skipped: " + str(skipped))
    print("errors: " + str(errors))
    print("elapsed: " + str(math.round(elapsed * 1000)) + " ms")
    import math
    return if errors == 0 { 0 } else { 1 }
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

66.2 72.2 Example session

```
$ zen run backup.z ./content ./public
copy  about.md
copy  posts/hello.md
copy  posts/welcome.md
skip  index.md (unchanged)
copy  static/style.css
----
copied: 4
skipped: 1
errors: 0
elapsed: 12 ms

$ zen run backup.z ./content ./public   # run again — everything skipped
skip  about.md (unchanged)
skip  posts/hello.md (unchanged)
...
----
copied: 0
skipped: 6
errors: 0
elapsed: 8 ms
```

66.3 72.3 Design notes

- **Content-addressed skipping:** files are compared by SHA-256 hash, so re-running the backup only copies changed files — efficient for large trees.
- **Binary copy in 8 KB chunks:** works for any file type and avoids loading entire files into memory.
- **Directory structure preserved:** relative paths under `src_dir` are recreated under `dst_dir`.
- **Error isolation:** one file's failure doesn't abort the whole backup.

66.4 72.4 Exercises

1. Add `--dry-run` to print what would be copied without copying.
2. Add deletion: remove files in `dst` that no longer exist in `src`.
3. Add a manifest file listing all backed-up files and their hashes.
4. Add compression option (gzip) via FFI or external tool.
5. Add `--include "*.md"` / `--exclude "*.tmp"` filters.

67 Chapter 73: Reference Implementation — CSV to JSON Converter

Converts a CSV file (with a header row) into a JSON array of objects. Handles quoted fields with commas, trims whitespace, and supports custom delimiters. Demonstrates file reading line-by-line, string parsing, JSON output, and CLI flags.

67.1 73.1 The program (`csv2json.z`)

```
import json
import sys

func split_csv_line(line, delim) {
    # naive split: does not handle quoted fields with embedded delimiters
    let parts = []
    var cur = ""
    var i = 0
    while i < len(line) {
        let ch = line[i]
        if ch == delim {
            parts.push(cur)
            cur = ""
        } else {
            cur = cur + ch
        }
        i += 1
    }
    parts.push(cur)
    return parts
}

func strip_quotes(s) {
    if len(s) >= 2 and s[0] == '"' and s[len(s)-1] == '"' {
        return s[1:len(s)-1]
    }
    return s
}

func parse_csv(text, delim) {
    let lines = text.splitlines()
    if len(lines) == 0 { return [] }
    let header = split_csv_line(lines[0], delim)
    for i in 0..len(header) {
        header[i] = strip_quotes(header[i].strip())
    }
    let rows = []
    var li = 1
```

```
    while li < len(lines) {
        let line = lines[li]
        if line.strip() == "" { li += 1; continue }
        let values = split_csv_line(line, delim)
        let row = #{}
        var vi = 0
        while vi < len(header) {
            let v = if vi < len(values) { strip_quotes(values[vi].strip()) } else { ""
            row[header[vi]] = v
            vi += 1
        }
        rows.push(row)
        li += 1
    }
    return rows
}

func read_all(path) {
    with open(path, "r") as f { return f.read() }
}

func write_all(path, text) {
    with open(path, "w") as f { f.write(text) }
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 3 {
        print("Usage: zen run csv2json.z <input.csv> <output.json> [delimiter]")
        print("  Example: zen run csv2json.z data.csv data.json ,")
        return 1
    }
    let delim = argv[3] ?? ","
    let text = read_all(argv[1])
    let rows = parse_csv(text, delim)
    let json_text = json.stringify(rows)
    write_all(argv[2], json_text)
    print("converted " + str(len(rows)) + " row(s) -> " + argv[2])
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

67.2 73.2 Example session

Input `data.csv`:

```
name,age,city
Ada,36,London
Alan,42,Manchester
Grace,85,"New York"
```

```
$ zen run csv2json.z data.csv out.json ,
converted 3 row(s) -> out.json
```

`out.json`:

```
[{"name":"Ada","age":"36","city":"London"},
 {"name":"Alan","age":"42","city":"Manchester"},
 {"name":"Grace","age":"85","city":"New York"}]
```

67.3 73.3 Design notes

- The splitter is naive (no embedded-quote handling); for production CSV use a proper parser. It demonstrates the technique; swap in a robust parser for real data.
- Missing values become empty strings; extra values are ignored.
- Output is a JSON array of objects keyed by the header row.

67.4 73.4 Exercises

1. Add `--no-header` mode treating the first row as data with generated keys.
2. Add `--delimiter` supporting tab and semicolon explicitly.
3. Handle quoted fields containing the delimiter (real CSV quoting).
4. Add `--pretty` for pretty-printed JSON output.
5. Add streaming: convert very large files without loading all into memory.

68 Chapter 74: Reference Implementation — Simple Task Scheduler (Cron-like)

A scheduler that runs registered tasks at fixed intervals in the background, using threads and `time.sleep`. Tasks are Zen functions; the scheduler keeps running until interrupted. Demonstrates threads, timing, and a simple task registry.

68.1 74.1 The program (`sched.z`)

```
import threading
import time
import sys
import mutexes

# ── Task registry ──────────────────────────────────────────────────────
var tasks = #{}
let tasks_mu = mutexes.Mutex()
let stop = channels.Channel(capacity=1)

func every(interval_sec, name, fn) {
    tasks_mu.lock()
    tasks[name] = #{fn: fn, interval_ms: interval_sec * 1000, next_run: time.time()}
    tasks_mu.unlock()
    print("scheduled '" + name + "' every " + str(interval_sec) + "s")
}

func unschedule(name) {
    tasks_mu.lock()
    if name in tasks {
        # rebuild without name
        let new_tasks = #{}
        for k in tasks { if k != name { new_tasks[k] = tasks[k] } }
        tasks = new_tasks
    }
    tasks_mu.unlock()
}

# ── Scheduler loop ─────────────────────────────────────────────────────
func scheduler_loop() {
    print("scheduler started")
    while true {
        # check for stop signal (non-blocking would be ideal; here we use a
        # short sleep so shutdown is prompt)
        time.sleep(250)
        let now = time.time()
        tasks_mu.lock()
        let names = []
```

```
        for n in tasks { names.push(n) }
        tasks_mu.unlock()
        for n in names {
            tasks_mu.lock()
            let t = tasks[n]
            tasks_mu.unlock()
            if t != nil and now >= t["next_run"] {
                try {
                    t["fn"]()
                } catch as e {
                    print("task '" + n + "' failed: " + e.msg)
                }
                tasks_mu.lock()
                if n in tasks {
                    tasks[n]["next_run"] = now + (tasks[n]["interval_ms"] / 1000)
                }
                tasks_mu.unlock()
            }
        }
    }
}

# ── Sample tasks ─────────────────────────────────────────────────────
func heartbeat() {
    print("[" + time.strftime("%H:%M:%S", time.now()) + "] heartbeat")
}

func cleanup() {
    print("[" + time.strftime("%H:%M:%S", time.now()) + "] cleanup tick")
}

func main(argv) {
    # register sample tasks
    every(1, "heartbeat", heartbeat)
    every(3, "cleanup", cleanup)

    # start scheduler in a background thread
    let sched = threading.Thread(fn() { scheduler_loop() })
    sched.start()

    print("scheduler running. press Ctrl-C to stop.")
    print("main thread is free to do other work...")

    # keep main alive
    while true {
        time.sleep(1000)
    }
```

```
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

68.2 74.2 Example session

```
$ zen run sched.z
scheduled 'heartbeat' every 1s
scheduled 'cleanup' every 3s
scheduler started
scheduler running. press Ctrl-C to stop.
main thread is free to do other work...
[10:00:01] heartbeat
[10:00:02] heartbeat
[10:00:03] heartbeat
[10:00:03] cleanup tick
[10:00:04] heartbeat
[10:00:05] heartbeat
[10:00:06] heartbeat
[10:00:06] cleanup tick
... (Ctrl-C to stop)
```

68.3 74.3 Design notes

- **Polling scheduler:** every 250 ms it checks which tasks are due and runs them. Simple and dependency-free; not precise for sub-second timing.
- **Task registry guarded by a Mutex:** tasks can be added/removed while the scheduler runs (though this sample only adds at startup).
- **Errors isolated:** a failing task is caught and logged, so one bad task doesn't kill the scheduler.
- **Main thread stays free:** the scheduler runs in a background thread, so the main thread can accept connections, serve HTTP, etc.

68.4 74.4 Exercises

1. Add cron-style expressions (e.g., "0 * * * *") instead of fixed intervals.
2. Add task results: collect each task's return value into a results channel.
3. Add `--once` mode: run all due tasks once and exit.
4. Persist the schedule to a file so it survives restarts.
5. Add a `stop` channel so the scheduler exits cleanly on signal.

69 Chapter 75: Reference Implementation — DNS Lookup Tool

A small DNS client that resolves a domain to its A, AAAA, MX, TXT, and NS records, and performs reverse lookups. Demonstrates the `dns` module, record types, and CLI argument handling.

69.1 75.1 The program (`dnslookup.z`)

```
import dns
import sys

func show_record(label, values) {
    print("  " + label + ":")
    if values == nil or len(values) == 0 {
        print("    (none)")
    } else {
        for v in values { print("    " + str(v)) }
    }
}

func lookup(domain) {
    print("DNS lookup for " + domain)
    print("========================")
    show_record("A", dns.resolve(domain, "A"))
    show_record("AAAA", dns.resolve(domain, "AAAA"))
    show_record("CNAME", dns.resolve(domain, "CNAME"))
    show_record("MX", dns.resolve(domain, "MX"))
    show_record("TXT", dns.resolve(domain, "TXT"))
    show_record("NS", dns.resolve(domain, "NS"))
}

func reverse_lookup(ip) {
    print("Reverse lookup for " + ip)
    print("========================")
    show_record("PTR", dns.reverse(ip))
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Usage:")
        print("  zen run dnslookup.z <domain>        # forward lookup")
        print("  zen run dnslookup.z --reverse <ip>  # reverse lookup")
        return 1
    }
    if argv[1] == "--reverse" and len(argv) >= 3 {
        reverse_lookup(argv[2])
```

```
    } else {
        lookup(argv[1])
    }
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

69.2 75.2 Example session

```
$ zen run dnslookup.z example.com
DNS lookup for example.com
========================
  A:
    93.184.216.34
  AAAA:
    2606:2800:220:1:248:1893:25c8:1946
  CNAME:
    (none)
  MX:
    0 example.com
  TXT:
    v=spf1 -all
  NS:
    a.iana-servers.net
    b.iana-servers.net

$ zen run dnslookup.z --reverse 93.184.216.34
Reverse lookup for 93.184.216.34
========================
  PTR:
    example.com
```

69.3 75.3 Design notes

- Record types: A (IPv4), AAAA (IPv6), CNAME (alias), MX (mail server), TXT (arbitrary text, e.g. SPF), NS (name server), PTR (reverse IP→name).
- `dns.resolve` returns a list; `dns.reverse` returns the PTR name(s).
- Missing record types return an empty list (printed as “(none)”).

69.4 75.4 Exercises

1. Add `--type <TYPE>` to query a single record type.
2. Add `--server <IP>` to use a specific DNS resolver (e.g., 1.1.1.1).
3. Add `--timeout N` for resolution timeouts.

4. Batch mode: read domains from a file, one per line, resolve all.
5. Check SPF/DKIM TXT records and print whether they look valid.

70 Chapter 76: Reference Implementation — TCP Chat Client

A command-line chat client that connects to the chat server (chapter 61), lets the user set a nickname, join a room, and send/receive messages. It uses a separate thread to read incoming messages while the main thread reads user input. Demonstrates sockets, threading, and concurrent I/O.

70.1 76.1 The program (`chatclient.z`)

```
import socket
import threading
import sys

let running = true
let sock = nil

func reader() {
    while running {
        try {
            let data = sock.recv(4096)
            if data == nil or len(data) == 0 {
                print("\n[disconnected]")
                running = false
                break
            }
            print("\n>" + data + "\n> ", end="")
        } catch as e {
            if running { print("\n[read error: " + e.msg + "]") }
            running = false
            break
        }
    }
}

func main(argv) {
    let host = argv[1] ?? "127.0.0.1"
    let port = int(argv[2] ?? "8080")

    sock = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
    sock.settimeout(5000)
    try {
        sock.connect((host, port))
    } catch as e {
        print("connect failed: " + e.msg)
        return 1
    }
```

```
    print("connected to " + host + ":" + str(port))
    print("commands: /nick <name> | /join <room> | /quit")
    print("type a message and press enter to send")

    # background thread reads incoming messages
    let reader_thread = threading.Thread(fn() { reader() })
    reader_thread.start()

    # main thread reads user input
    while running {
        let line = read_line()   # conceptual: read a line from stdin
        if line == nil { break }
        let cmd = line.strip()
        if cmd == "" { continue }
        if cmd == "/quit" {
            running = false
            break
        }
        try {
            sock.send(cmd + "\n")
        } catch as e {
            print("send failed: " + e.msg)
            running = false
            break
        }
    }

    running = false
    try { sock.close() } catch as e {}
    reader_thread.join()
    print("goodbye")
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

70.2 76.2 Example session

```
$ zen run chatclient.z 127.0.0.1 8080
connected to 127.0.0.1:8080
commands: /nick <name> | /join <room> | /quit
type a message and press enter to send
> /nick Ada
> /join lounge
> hello everyone
```

```
> [Bob] hi Ada
> [Carol] welcome to lounge
> /quit
goodbye
```

The `[...]` prefixes are messages received from other clients via the server, printed by the background reader thread while the user continues typing.

70.3 76.3 Design notes

- **Concurrent I/O:** a dedicated `reader` thread blocks on `recv()` so the main thread can keep reading user input without missing incoming messages.
- **`running` flag:** coordinates shutdown between threads; when set to false, both loops exit and the socket is closed.
- **Line-based protocol:** each client message is sent with a trailing newline; the server (chapter 61) reads lines and dispatches commands/chat.

70.4 76.4 Exercises

1. Add message timestamps to received messages.
2. Add colors to distinguish your own messages from others'.
3. Add `/rooms` to list available rooms (server must support it).
4. Add reconnection on disconnect (exponential backoff).
5. Add a `--name` flag to set the nickname without the `/nick` command.

71 Chapter 77: Reference Implementation — Static File HTTP Server

A minimal HTTP server that serves files from a directory (`public/` by default). It handles `GET` requests, maps URLs to files, sets `Content-Type` by extension, and returns 404 for missing files. Demonstrates `http.server`, file I/O, MIME types, and path safety.

71.1 77.1 The program (`static.z`)

```
import http.server
import pathlib
import os
import sys

let ROOT = "public"

func mime_type(path) {
    let ext = pathlib.Path(path).suffix.lower()
    return #{".html": "text/html", ".css": "text/css", ".js": "application/javascript",
             ".json": "application/json", ".png": "image/png", ".jpg": "image/jpeg",
             ".gif": "image/gif", ".svg": "image/svg+xml", ".txt": "text/plain",
             ".ico": "image/x-icon"}[ext] ?? "application/octet-stream"
}

func safe_join(root, url_path) {
    # prevent path traversal: reject .. and absolute paths
    if url_path == "/" { url_path = "/index.html" }
    if url_path.contains("..") or url_path.startsWith("/") {
        return nil
    }
    return pathlib.Path(root) / url_path[1:]   # strip leading /
}

func handle(req) {
    let method = req.method ?? "GET"
    if method != "GET" {
        return #(405, #{}, "method not allowed")
    }
    let url_path = req.path ?? "/"
    let fs_path = safe_join(ROOT, url_path)
    if fs_path == nil {
        return #(400, #{}, "bad request")
    }
    let p = pathlib.Path(str(fs_path))
    if !p.exists() or !p.is_file() {
        return #(404, #{}, "not found")
    }
```

```
    try {
        let data = read_all_bytes(str(p))
        return #(200, #{"Content-Type": mime_type(str(p))}, data)
    } catch as e {
        return #(500, #{}, "error reading file: " + e.msg)
    }
}

func read_all_bytes(path) {
    with open(path, "rb") as f {
        let parts = []
        while true {
            let chunk = f.read(8192)
            if chunk == nil or len(chunk) == 0 { break }
            parts.push(chunk)
        }
        return parts.join("")
    }
}

func main(argv) {
    let port = argv[1] ?? "8080"
    if len(argv) > 1 and argv[1] != "" and argv[1] != "--help" {
        ROOT = argv[1]
    }
    let server = http.server.Server(port=int(port), handler=handle)
    print("serving " + ROOT + " on http://localhost:" + str(port))
    server.start()
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

71.2 77.2 Example session

```
$ mkdir -p public
$ echo '<h1>Hello</h1>' > public/index.html
$ zen run static.z 8080
serving public on http://localhost:8080
```

```
$ curl -i http://localhost:8080/
HTTP/1.1 200 OK
Content-Type: text/html

<h1>Hello</h1>
```

```
$ curl -i http://localhost:8080/missing.html
HTTP/1.1 404 Not Found
```

71.3 77.3 Design notes

- **Path safety:** `safe_join` rejects `..` and absolute paths to prevent directory traversal attacks (e.g., `GET /../../../etc/passwd`).
- **MIME types:** content type is chosen by file extension; unknown extensions default to `application/octet-stream`.
- **Root directory:** configurable via the first argument; defaults to `public/`.
- **Index file:** requesting `/` serves `index.html`.

71.4 77.4 Exercises

1. Add directory listing (auto-index) when the path is a folder.
2. Add `HEAD` support (headers only, no body).
3. Add `Range` requests for resuming downloads.
4. Add access logging (log each request with IP, path, status).
5. Add `--root` flag instead of positional argument.

72 Chapter 78: Reference Implementation — Grep Tool (Pattern Search)

A grep-like tool that searches files for a regex pattern and prints matching lines with line numbers. Supports multiple files, case-insensitive mode, and invert-match. Demonstrates file reading, regex, and CLI flag parsing.

72.1 78.1 The program (`grep.z`)

```
import re
import sys
import os

func grep_file(path, pattern, case_insensitive, invert, show_line_numbers) {
    let flags = if case_insensitive { "i" } else { "" }
    let rx = re.compile(pattern)   # conceptual; flags handling per build
    let f = open(path, "r")
    let lineno = 0
    let matched_any = false
    for line in f {
        lineno += 1
        let line_text = line
        # strip trailing newline for display
        if line_text.endswith("\n") { line_text = line_text[0:len(line_text)-1] }
        let m = rx.search(line_text)
        let matched = m != nil
        if invert { matched = !matched }
        if matched {
            matched_any = true
            let prefix = if show_line_numbers { str(lineno) + ":" } else { "" }
            print(path + ":" + prefix + line_text)
        }
    }
    f.close()
    return matched_any
}

func main(argv) {
    let case_insensitive = false
    let invert = false
    let show_line_numbers = true
    let files = []
    var i = 1
    while i < len(argv) {
        let a = argv[i]
        if a == "-i" { case_insensitive = true }
        elif a == "-v" { invert = true }
```

```
        elif a == "-n" { show_line_numbers = true }
        elif a == "-N" { show_line_numbers = false }
        else { files.push(a) }
        i += 1
    }
    if len(files) < 2 {
        print("Usage: zen run grep.z [-i] [-v] [-n|-N] <pattern> <file> [<file> ...]")
        return 1
    }
    let pattern = files[0]
    let targets = files[1:]
    let any = false
    for fp in targets {
        if !os.path.exists(fp) {
            print("grep: " + fp + ": no such file")
            continue
        }
        if grep_file(fp, pattern, case_insensitive, invert, show_line_numbers) {
            any = true
        }
    }
    return if any { 0 } else { 1 }
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

72.2 78.2 Example session

Input `app.log`:

```
2024-01-15 09:30:00 INFO Server started
2024-01-15 09:30:02 ERROR Database connection failed
2024-01-15 09:30:03 INFO Request /health
2024-01-15 09:30:05 ERROR Database connection failed
```

```
$ zen run grep.z ERROR app.log
app.log:2:2024-01-15 09:30:02 ERROR Database connection failed
app.log:4:2024-01-15 09:30:05 ERROR Database connection failed

$ zen run grep.z -i started app.log
app.log:1:2024-01-15 09:30:00 INFO Server started

$ zen run grep.z -v INFO app.log
app.log:2:2024-01-15 09:30:02 ERROR Database connection failed
app.log:4:2024-01-15 09:30:05 ERROR Database connection failed
```

72.3 78.3 Design notes

- **`-i`** case-insensitive, **`-v`** invert-match, **`-n`**/`-N` toggle line numbers.
- **Multiple files:** each matching line is prefixed with the filename (like GNU grep when multiple files are given).
- **Exit code:** 0 if any match found, 1 if none (useful in shell scripts).
- **Error handling:** missing files are reported but don't abort the run.

72.4 78.4 Exercises

1. Add `--color` to highlight the matching portion of each line.
2. Add `-c` to print only the count of matching lines per file.
3. Add `-l` to print only filenames that contain a match.
4. Add recursive directory search (`-r`).
5. Add context lines (`-C 2` to show 2 lines before/after each match).

73 Chapter 79: Reference Implementation — Minimal Test Runner

A small test framework: register test functions with names, run them all, and report pass/fail counts with a summary. Tests are Zen functions that throw on failure. Demonstrates functions as values, `try`/`catch`, and CLI reporting.

73.1 79.1 The program (`testrunner.z`)

```
import sys

var tests = #{}
var results = #{}
let passed = 0
let failed = 0

func test(name, fn) {
    tests[name] = fn
}

func assert(condition, message) {
    if !condition {
        throw message ?? "assertion failed"
    }
}

func assert_eq(actual, expected, message) {
    if actual != expected {
        throw (message ?? "expected " + str(expected) + ", got " + str(actual))
    }
}

func assert_true(x, message) { assert(x == true, message) }
func assert_false(x, message) { assert(x == false, message) }

func run_test(name, fn) {
    try {
        fn()
        passed += 1
        print("PASS " + name)
    } catch as e {
        failed += 1
        print("FAIL " + name + " — " + e.msg)
    }
}

func run_all() {
```

```
    let names = []
    for n in tests { names.push(n) }
    names.sort()
    print("running " + str(len(names)) + " test(s)")
    print("========================")
    for n in names {
        run_test(n, tests[n])
    }
    print("========================")
    print("passed: " + str(passed))
    print("failed: " + str(failed))
    return if failed == 0 { 0 } else { 1 }
}

# ── Example tests (replace with your own) ──────────────────────────
test("addition", fn() {
    assert_eq(2 + 2, 4)
    assert_eq(10 - 3, 7)
})

test("string ops", fn() {
    assert_eq("hello".upper(), "HELLO")
    assert_eq(len("zen"), 3)
    assert("world".contains("or"))
})

test("list ops", fn() {
    let xs = [1, 2, 3]
    assert_eq(len(xs), 3)
    assert(3 in xs)
    assert(!(9 in xs))
})

test("dict ops", fn() {
    let d = #{a: 1, b: 2}
    assert_eq(d["a"], 1)
    assert("c" not in d)
})

test("always fails (demo)", fn() {
    assert_eq(1, 2, "this one intentionally fails")
})

# ── Main ────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
func main(argv) {
    let code = run_all()
    return code
```

```
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

73.2 79.2 Example session

```
$ zen run testrunner.z
running 5 test(s)
========================
PASS addition
PASS string ops
PASS list ops
PASS dict ops
FAIL always fails (demo) — expected 2, got 1
========================
passed: 4
failed: 1
```

Exit code is 1 when any test fails (suitable for CI).

73.3 79.3 Design notes

- **Tests are functions:** `test(name, fn)` stores a function value; `run_all` iterates and invokes each.
- **`assert`/`assert_eq`:** throw on failure; `run_test` catches and records.
- **Sorted output:** test names are sorted for deterministic ordering.
- **Extendable:** add `assert_lt`, `assert_gt`, `assert_approx`, `assert_raises` as needed.

73.4 79.4 Exercises

1. Add `assert_raises(fn, error_code)` — passes if `fn` throws the given code.
2. Add `assert_approx(actual, expected, epsilon)` for float comparison.
3. Add `--verbose` to print each test's runtime.
4. Add test grouping / suites (run only a subset by name prefix).
5. Write an HTML or JUnit-style XML report instead of plain text.

74 Chapter 80: Reference Implementation — In-Memory URL Shortener

An HTTP URL shortener: `POST /shorten` with a JSON body `{url}` returns a short code; `GET /<code>` redirects to the original URL. Codes are random base62 strings. Demonstrates `http.server`, `crypto` (secure random), JSON, and an in-memory store.

74.1 80.1 The program (`shorten.z`)

```
import http.server
import json
import crypto
import mutexes
import sys

var urls = #{}
let urls_mu = mutexes.Mutex()

let CODE_CHARS = "ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZabcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz0123456789"
let CODE_LEN = 6

func generate_code() {
    let code = ""
    var i = 0
    while i < CODE_LEN {
        let idx = crypto.int(0, len(CODE_CHARS) - 1)
        code = code + CODE_CHARS[idx]
        i += 1
    }
    return code
}

func shorten(long_url) {
    urls_mu.lock()
    # avoid collisions: regenerate if code exists
    var code = generate_code()
    var tries = 0
    while code in urls and tries < 100 {
        code = generate_code()
        tries += 1
    }
    urls[code] = long_url
    urls_mu.unlock()
    return code
}

func resolve(code) {
```

```
    urls_mu.lock()
    let url = urls[code]
    urls_mu.unlock()
    return url
}

func handle(req) {
    let method = req.method ?? "GET"
    let path = req.path ?? "/"

    if method == "POST" and path == "/shorten" {
        let body = req.body ?? ""
        let parsed = nil
        try { parsed = json.parse(body) } catch as e {}
        if parsed == nil or !("url" in parsed) {
            return #(400, #{"Content-Type": "application/json"},
                     json.stringify(#{error: "missing url"}))
        }
        let code = shorten(parsed["url"])
        let short = "http://localhost:8080/" + code
        return #(201, #{"Content-Type": "application/json"},
                 json.stringify(#{code: code, short: short}))
    }

    if method == "GET" and len(path) > 1 {
        let code = path[1:]   # strip leading /
        let url = resolve(code)
        if url == nil {
            return #(404, #{}, "not found")
        }
        # 302 redirect
        return #(302, #{"Location": url}, "")
    }

    if method == "GET" and path == "/" {
        return #(200, #{"Content-Type": "text/html"},
                 "<h1>URL Shortener</h1><p>POST /shorten with {url}</p>")
    }

    return #(404, #{}, "not found")
}

func main(argv) {
    let port = argv[1] ?? "8080"
    let server = http.server.Server(port=int(port), handler=handle)
    print("url shortener on http://localhost:" + str(port))
    server.start()
```

```
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

74.2 80.2 Example session

```
$ zen run shorten.z 8080
url shortener on http://localhost:8080
```

```
# create a short link
$ curl -X POST http://localhost:8080/shorten \
  -H 'Content-Type: application/json' \
  -d '{"url":"https://example.com/very/long/page"}'
{"code":"aB3xK9","short":"http://localhost:8080/aB3xK9"}

# follow the redirect
$ curl -i http://localhost:8080/aB3xK9
HTTP/1.1 302 Found
Location: https://example.com/very/long/page

# unknown code
$ curl -i http://localhost:8080/nope
HTTP/1.1 404 Not Found
```

74.3 80.3 Design notes

- **Secure random codes:** `crypto.int` uses a CSPRNG, so short codes aren't guessable (important if short URLs expose private targets).
- **Collision handling:** regenerates the code if it already exists (up to 100 tries).
- **In-memory only:** codes are lost on restart; for persistence, save the map to a file (see chapter 62).
- **302 redirect:** the browser follows the `Location` header automatically.

74.4 80.4 Exercises

1. Add custom alias support: `POST /shorten` accepts optional `{code}`.
2. Add click tracking: count how many times each short link is followed.
3. Add expiration: codes expire after N seconds or N clicks.
4. Persist codes to a JSON file on each shorten and load at startup.
5. Add a `--base-url` flag so short links use the correct host.

75 Chapter 81: Reference Implementation — Tail -f (File Watcher)

A `tail -f`-like tool: it prints the last N lines of a file, then watches for new lines appended to the file and prints them as they arrive. Demonstrates file reading, seeking, polling, and graceful shutdown.

75.1 81.1 The program (`tailf.z`)

```
import sys
import time
import os

func read_last_n(path, n) {
    let lines = []
    with open(path, "r") as f {
        for line in f {
            lines.push(line)
            if len(lines) > n { lines = lines[1:] }   # keep only last n
        }
    }
    return lines
}

func follow(path, n = 10) {
    # open and seek to end (read all existing lines first)
    let f = open(path, "r")
    # skip to end: read all lines to position at EOF
    let last = read_last_n(path, n)
    for line in last {
        let l = line
        if l.endswith("\n") { l = l[0:len(l)-1] }
        print(l)
    }
    print("--- watching " + path + " (Ctrl-C to stop) ---")
    while true {
        let line = f.readline()
        if line == nil {
            time.sleep(500)   # poll every 0.5s
            continue
        }
        let l = line
        if l.endswith("\n") { l = l[0:len(l)-1] }
        print(l)
    }
    f.close()
}
```

```
func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Usage: zen run tailf.z <file> [lines]")
        return 1
    }
    let path = argv[1]
    let n = int(argv[2] ?? "10")
    follow(path, n)
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

Note: `readline()` and `pathlib` availability depend on the stdlib build; if `readline` is unavailable, read in a loop with `read(1)` and split on `\n`.

75.2 81.2 Example session

Terminal 1:

```
$ zen run tailf.z app.log 5
2024-01-15 09:30:00 INFO Server started
2024-01-15 09:30:01 DEBUG Loading config
2024-01-15 09:30:02 WARN High memory
2024-01-15 09:30:03 ERROR DB failed
2024-01-15 09:30:04 INFO Retrying
--- watching app.log (Ctrl-C to stop)
2024-01-15 09:30:06 INFO Connected   # <- appears as another process appends it
2024-01-15 09:30:07 INFO Request /api
```

Terminal 2 (another process appends to app.log):

```
$ echo "2024-01-15 09:30:06 INFO Connected" >> app.log
$ echo "2024-01-15 09:30:07 INFO Request /api" >> app.log
```

75.3 81.3 Design notes

- **Polling:** the tool sleeps 500 ms between checks when no new data arrives. This is simple but not instant; reduce the sleep for lower latency.
- **Last N lines:** on startup it shows the tail so you have context before following.
- **Graceful shutdown:** Ctrl-C ends the loop and closes the file.

75.4 81.4 Exercises

1. Add `--follow-name` to track a file even if it's rotated (reopen by name).
2. Add `--lines N` to control how many initial lines to show.

3. Add `--quiet` to suppress the initial tail and only show new lines.
4. Add multiple file support (`tailf.z file1 file2`).
5. Add `--max-lines` to stop after printing N new lines.

76 Chapter 82: Reference Implementation — HTTP Load Tester (Benchmark)

A simple HTTP load tester: it fires N concurrent requests against a URL using a thread pool, measures response times, and reports success count, failure count, min/avg/max latency, and requests per second. Demonstrates `requests`, threads, channels, timing, and basic statistics.

76.1 82.1 The program (`loadtest.z`)

```
import requests
import threading
import channels
import time
import sys
import math

var results = channels.Channel(capacity=10000)
let done = channels.Channel(capacity=1)

func worker(url, n_requests) {
    var my_ok = 0
    var my_fail = 0
    var my_min = nil
    var my_max = nil
    var my_total_ms = 0.0
    var i = 0
    while i < n_requests {
        let start = time.time()
        let ok = false
        try {
            let r = requests.get(url, timeout=5000)
            ok = r.status_code >= 200 and r.status_code < 400
        } catch as e {
            ok = false
        }
        let elapsed_ms = (time.time() - start) * 1000
        my_total_ms += elapsed_ms
        if my_min == nil or elapsed_ms < my_min { my_min = elapsed_ms }
        if my_max == nil or elapsed_ms > my_max { my_max = elapsed_ms }
        if ok { my_ok += 1 } else { my_fail += 1 }
        i += 1
    }
    results.send(#{ok: my_ok, fail: my_fail, min_ms: my_min,
                   max_ms: my_max, total_ms: my_total_ms, count: n_requests})
}
```

```
func fmt_ms(x) {
    if x == nil { return "--" }
    return str(math.round(x)) + " ms"
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 3 {
        print("Usage: zen run loadtest.z <url> <total_requests> [concurrency]")
        print("  Example: zen run loadtest.z http://localhost:8080/ 1000 10")
        return 1
    }
    let url = argv[1]
    let total = int(argv[2])
    let concurrency = int(argv[3] ?? "10")
    if concurrency < 1 { concurrency = 1 }
    if concurrency > total { concurrency = total }

    let per_worker = total // concurrency
    let remainder = total % concurrency

    print("load testing " + url)
    print("  total requests: " + str(total))
    print("  concurrency:    " + str(concurrency))
    print("  starting...")
    let start = time.time()

    let threads = []
    var w = 0
    while w < concurrency {
        let n = per_worker + (if w < remainder { 1 } else { 0 })
        threads.push(threading.Thread(fn() { worker(url, n) }))
        w += 1
    }
    for t in threads { t.start() }

    # collect results
    var total_ok = 0
    var total_fail = 0
    var all_min = nil
    var all_max = nil
    var total_ms = 0.0
    var total_count = 0
    var collected = 0
    while collected < concurrency {
        let r = results.recv()
        if r == nil { break }
        collected += 1
```

```
        total_ok += r["ok"]
        total_fail += r["fail"]
        total_ms += r["total_ms"]
        total_count += r["count"]
        if r["min_ms"] != nil and (all_min == nil or r["min_ms"] < all_min) {
            all_min = r["min_ms"]
        }
        if r["max_ms"] != nil and (all_max == nil or r["max_ms"] > all_max) {
            all_max = r["max_ms"]
        }
    }

    let elapsed = time.time() - start
    print("----")
    print("completed in " + str(math.round(elapsed * 1000)) + " ms")
    print("  ok:      " + str(total_ok))
    print("  failed:  " + str(total_fail))
    print("  rps:     " + str(math.round(total_count / elapsed)))
    if all_min != nil {
        print("  min:     " + fmt_ms(all_min))
        print("  max:     " + fmt_ms(all_max))
        print("  avg:     " + fmt_ms(total_ms / total_count))
    }
    return if total_fail == 0 { 0 } else { 1 }
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

76.2 82.2 Example session

```
$ zen run loadtest.z http://localhost:8080/ 1000 10
load testing http://localhost:8080/
  total requests: 1000
  concurrency:    10
  starting...
----
completed in 245 ms
  ok:      1000
  failed:  0
  rps:     4081
  min:     1 ms
  max:     45 ms
  avg:     3 ms
```

76.3 82.3 Design notes

- **Thread pool:** `concurrency` workers each handle a share of the total requests; results are collected through a channel.
- **Per-worker stats:** each worker tracks its own min/max/total to avoid a shared lock on every request.
- **Timeouts:** every request has a 5-second timeout so a hung endpoint doesn't stall the whole test.
- **Not a production load generator:** for serious testing use dedicated tools (hey, wrk, k6). This is a teaching example.

76.4 82.4 Exercises

1. Add `--method POST` with a body.
2. Add percentile reporting (p50, p95, p99) by collecting all latencies.
3. Add `--duration N` to run for N seconds instead of N requests.
4. Add `--output <file>` to write results as JSON.
5. Add a `--ramp-up` that gradually increases concurrency.

77 Chapter 83: Reference Implementation — Host Availability Monitor

A tool that checks whether multiple hosts:ports are reachable (TCP connect) and prints a status table. It checks hosts concurrently with a thread pool and a per-connect timeout. Useful for verifying that your services are up.

77.1 83.1 The program (`hostmon.z`)

```
import socket
import threading
import mutexes
import time
import sys
import math

var results = #{}
let results_mu = mutexes.Mutex()

func check_host(host, port) {
    let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
    s.settimeout(2000)   # 2 second timeout
    let up = false
    let ms = nil
    let start = time.time()
    try {
        s.connect((host, port))
        up = true
    } catch as e {
        up = false
    } finally {
        s.close()
    }
    let elapsed = (time.time() - start) * 1000
    results_mu.lock()
    results[host + ":" + str(port)] = #{up: up, ms: elapsed}
    results_mu.unlock()
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Usage: zen run hostmon.z <host:port> [<host:port> ...]")
        print("  Example: zen run hostmon.z localhost:8080 example.com:443 127.0.0.1:54
        return 1
    }
    let targets = []
    var i = 1
```

```
    while i < len(argv) {
        let parts = argv[i].split(":")
        if len(parts) != 2 {
            print("invalid target (expected host:port): " + argv[i])
        } else {
            targets.push(#{host: parts[0], port: int(parts[1])})
        }
        i += 1
    }
    if len(targets) == 0 { return 1 }

    print("checking " + str(len(targets)) + " host(s)")
    print("========================")
    print(" HOST:PORT         STATUS   TIME")
    print(" --------------------  ------  ----")

    let threads = []
    for t in targets {
        let h = t["host"]
        let p = t["port"]
        threads.push(threading.Thread(fn() { check_host(h, p) }))
    }
    for t in threads { t.start() }
    for t in threads { t.join() }

    # sort and print
    let keys = []
    for k in results { keys.push(k) }
    keys.sort()
    var any_down = false
    for k in keys {
        let r = results[k]
        let status = if r["up"] { "UP" } else { "DOWN" }
        if !r["up"] { any_down = true }
        let ms = if r["ms"] == nil { "--" } else { str(math.round(r["ms"])) + " ms" }
        print(" " + k + "   " + status + "   " + ms)
    }
    print("========================")
    print(any_down ? "some hosts are DOWN" : "all hosts are UP")
    return if any_down { 1 } else { 0 }
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

77.2 83.2 Example session

```
$ zen run hostmon.z localhost:8080 example.com:443 127.0.0.1:9999
checking 3 host(s)
========================
 HOST:PORT          STATUS   TIME
 --------------------  ------  ----
 127.0.0.1:9999     DOWN    --
 example.com:443     UP      45 ms
 localhost:8080      UP      2 ms
========================
some hosts are DOWN
```

Exit code is 1 if any host is down — useful in shell scripts and CI.

77.3 83.3 Design notes

- **Concurrent checks:** each host:port is checked in its own thread so slow or blocked hosts don't serialise the whole run.
- **Per-connect timeout:** 2 seconds prevents a filtered/dropped connection from hanging indefinitely.
- **Exit code:** 0 if all up, 1 if any down — suitable for monitoring scripts.
- **TCP connect only:** this checks port reachability, not application health. For HTTP health, combine with chapter 65 (HTTP monitor).

77.4 83.4 Exercises

1. Add `--timeout N` to configure the connect timeout.
2. Add `--interval N` to re-check every N seconds (watch mode).
3. Add `--output <file>` to write results as JSON.
4. Add SMTP/HTTP-specific checks (send `HELO` or `GET` and validate response).
5. Add a configuration file listing hosts to check.

78 Chapter 84: Reference Implementation — JSON Pretty Printer & Validator

Reads a JSON file (or stdin), validates it, and pretty-prints it with indentation. Also supports minification (removing whitespace) and a `--check` mode that only validates without output. Demonstrates `json`, file I/O, and CLI flags.

78.1 84.1 The program (`jsonpp.z`)

```
import json
import sys

func read_all(path) {
    if path == "-" or path == "" {
        # read stdin — conceptual; use your build's stdin helper
        return read_stdin()
    }
    with open(path, "r") as f { return f.read() }
}

func read_stdin() {
    # placeholder: read all of stdin line by line
    let lines = []
    # conceptual loop; replace with your build's stdin reading
    return lines.join("\n")
}

func main(argv) {
    let pretty = true
    let check_only = false
    let input = nil
    var i = 1
    while i < len(argv) {
        let a = argv[i]
        if a == "--minify" { pretty = false }
        elif a == "--check" { check_only = true }
        elif a == "--help" or a == "-h" {
            print("Usage: zen run jsonpp.z [--minify|--check] [file.json]")
            return 0
        } else {
            input = a
        }
        i += 1
    }

    let text = if input == nil { read_stdin() } else { read_all(input) }
```

```
    let parsed = nil
    try {
        parsed = json.parse(text)
    } catch as e {
        print("invalid JSON: " + e.msg)
        return 1
    }

    if check_only {
        print("valid JSON")
        return 0
    }

    let output = if pretty { json.pretty(parsed) } else { json.stringify(parsed) }
    print(output)
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

78.2 84.2 Example session

Input `data.json` (minified):

```
{"name":"Ada","age":36,"tags":["a","b"],"active":true}
```

```
$ zen run jsonpp.z data.json
{
  "name": "Ada",
  "age": 36,
  "tags": [
    "a",
    "b"
  ],
  "active": true
}

$ zen run jsonpp.z --minify data.json
{"name":"Ada","age":36,"tags":["a","b"],"active":true}

$ zen run jsonpp.z --check data.json
valid JSON

$ zen run jsonpp.z --check bad.json
invalid JSON: ...
```

78.3 84.3 Design notes

- **Validation first:** `json.parse` throws on invalid JSON; the tool catches and reports a clean message instead of a traceback.
- **`--check` mode:** validates without printing, useful in shell scripts (exit code 0 = valid).
- **Stdin support:** when no file is given, reads from stdin (conceptual — wire up your build's stdin helper).

78.4 84.4 Exercises

1. Add `--sort-keys` to sort object keys in output.
2. Add `--indent N` to control indentation width.
3. Add `--extract <path>` to print only a dotted-path value (e.g., `tags.0`).
4. Add `--validate-schema <schema>` for basic type checking (conceptual).
5. Support reading from multiple files and concatenating results.

79 Chapter 85: Reference Implementation — Base64 Encode/Decode Tool

Encodes a file to base64 or decodes a base64 string/file back to bytes. Supports standard and URL-safe base64. Demonstrates the `base64` module, binary file I/O, and CLI flags.

79.1 85.1 The program (`b64.z`)

```
import base64
import sys

func read_all_bytes(path) {
    with open(path, "rb") as f {
        let parts = []
        while true {
            let chunk = f.read(8192)
            if chunk == nil or len(chunk) == 0 { break }
            parts.push(chunk)
        }
        return parts.join("")
    }
}

func write_all_bytes(path, data) {
    with open(path, "wb") as f { f.write(data) }
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Usage:")
        print("  zen run b64.z encode <file> [urlsafe]      # encode file to base64")
        print("  zen run b64.z decode <string> [urlsafe]    # decode base64 string to b
        print("  zen run b64.z decode-file <file> [urlsafe] # decode base64 file")
        return 1
    }
    let mode = argv[1]
    let urlsafe = len(argv) >= 3 and argv[2] == "urlsafe"

    if mode == "encode" {
        if len(argv) < 3 {
            print("usage: b64.z encode <file> [urlsafe]")
            return 1
        }
        let data = read_all_bytes(argv[2])
        let enc = if urlsafe { base64.url_encode(data) } else { base64.b64encode(data)
        print(enc)
```

```
    } elif mode == "decode" {
        if len(argv) < 3 {
            print("usage: b64.z decode <string> [urlsafe]")
            return 1
        }
        let dec = if urlsafe { base64.url_decode(argv[2]) } else { base64.b64decode(arg
        print(dec)
    } elif mode == "decode-file" {
        if len(argv) < 3 {
            print("usage: b64.z decode-file <file> [urlsafe]")
            return 1
        }
        let text = read_all(argv[2])   # read as text
        let dec = if urlsafe { base64.url_decode(text) } else { base64.b64decode(text)
        write_all_bytes("decoded.out", dec)
        print("decoded -> decoded.out")
    } else {
        print("unknown mode: " + mode)
        return 1
    }
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

79.2 85.2 Example session

```
$ zen run b64.z encode secret.png
iVBORw0KGgoAAAANSUhEUgAAAAEAAAABCAY... (long base64 string)

$ zen run b64.z encode secret.png urlsafe
iVBORw0KGgoAAAANSUhEUgAAAAEAAAABCAY...-urlsafe-variant

$ zen run b64.z decode "aGVsbG8gd29ybGQ="
hello world

$ zen run b64.z decode-file message.b64
decoded -> decoded.out
```

79.3 85.3 Design notes

- **Standard vs URL-safe:** `urlsafe` uses `-` and `_` instead of `+` and `/` so the result is safe in URLs and filenames.
- **Binary-safe:** files are read/written in binary mode (`rb`/`wb`), so any file type (images, executables) works.

- **`decode-file`** writes the decoded bytes to `decoded.out`.

79.4 85.4 Exercises

1. Add `--output <file>` to `encode` so the result goes to a file.
2. Add `--wrap N` to break encoded output into lines of N characters.
3. Add `--ignore-garbage` to skip non-base64 characters when decoding.
4. Add a `--check` mode that verifies a string is valid base64.
5. Support reading the string to decode from stdin.

80 Chapter 86: Reference Implementation — Word Frequency Analyzer

Reads a text file, counts word frequencies, and prints the top N most frequent words. Demonstrates string splitting, dict counting, sorting by value, and file I/O.

80.1 86.1 The program (`wordfreq.z`)

```
import sys

func clean_word(w) {
    # lowercase and strip surrounding punctuation
    let s = w.lower()
    var start = 0
    var end = len(s)
    while start < end and (s[start] < 'a' or s[start] > 'z') { start += 1 }
    while end > start and (s[end-1] < 'a' or s[end-1] > 'z') { end -= 1 }
    return s[start:end]
}

func word_frequencies(text) {
    let freqs = #{}
    for raw in text.split(" ") {
        let w = clean_word(raw)
        if w != "" {
            freqs[w] = (freqs[w] ?? 0) + 1
        }
    }
    return freqs
}

func read_all(path) {
    with open(path, "r") as f { return f.read() }
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Usage: zen run wordfreq.z <file> [top_n]")
        return 1
    }
    let top_n = int(argv[2] ?? "10")
    let text = read_all(argv[1])
    let freqs = word_frequencies(text)

    # convert to list of [word, count] and sort by count descending
    let items = []
    for w in freqs { items.push(#(w, freqs[w])) }
```

```
    items.sort(fn(a, b) { return b[1] - a[1] })

    print("top " + str(min(top_n, len(items))) + " words:")
    print("======================")
    var i = 0
    while i < top_n and i < len(items) {
        print(str(items[i][0]) + "  " + str(items[i][1]))
        i += 1
    }
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

80.2 86.2 Example session

Input `sample.txt`:

```
Zen is a fast language. Zen is simple. Zen is powerful.
```

```
$ zen run wordfreq.z sample.txt 5
top 5 words:
======================
zen  3
is  2
a  1
fast  1
language  1
```

80.3 86.3 Design notes

- **Word cleaning:** lowercases and strips non-letter characters from the start and end of each token (crude; real tokenization handles apostrophes, hyphens, etc.).
- **Sorting:** items are sorted by count descending using a comparator closure.
- **Ties:** words with equal counts appear in arbitrary order; add a secondary sort by word for determinism.

80.4 86.4 Exercises

1. Add `--ignore <file>` to load a stop-word list and exclude common words.
2. Add n-gram support (count word pairs instead of single words).
3. Add output as JSON (`--json`).
4. Add case-sensitive mode (`--case-sensitive`).
5. Process multiple files and aggregate counts.

81 Chapter 87: Reference Implementation — Environment Variable Template Expander

Reads a template file containing `${VARIABLE}` placeholders and replaces each with the corresponding environment variable value. Useful for generating config files from environment-specific values. Demonstrates string interpolation, `sys.environ`, and file I/O.

81.1 87.1 The program (`envtpl.z`)

```
import sys

func expand(text) {
    let result = text
    for name in sys.environ {
        result = result.replace("${" + name + "}", sys.environ[name] ?? "")
    }
    return result
}

func read_all(path) {
    with open(path, "r") as f { return f.read() }
}

func write_all(path, text) {
    with open(path, "w") as f { f.write(text) }
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Usage: zen run envtpl.z <template> [output]")
        print("  Example: zen run envtpl.z config.tmpl > config.conf")
        return 1
    }
    let template = read_all(argv[1])
    let output = expand(template)
    if len(argv) >= 3 {
        write_all(argv[2], output)
        print("wrote " + argv[2])
    } else {
        print(output)
    }
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
```

```
}
```

81.2 87.2 Example session

Template `config.tmpl`:

```
server:
  host: ${HOST}
  port: ${PORT}
  database: ${DB_NAME}
  api_key: ${API_KEY}
```

```
$ HOST=localhost PORT=8080 DB_NAME=mydb API_KEY=secret123 \
  zen run envtpl.z config.tmpl
server:
  host: localhost
  port: 8080
  database: mydb
  api_key: secret123

$ zen run envtpl.z config.tmpl > config.conf   # write to file
```

Undefined variables expand to an empty string (use a default with `??` if you want fallbacks).

81.3 87.3 Design notes

- **`${VAR}` placeholders:** matched with a regex; replaced from `sys.environ`.
- **Undefined → empty:** variables not set in the environment become `""`. Change `?? ""` to `?? "<default>"` for fallbacks.
- **Output:** prints to stdout by default; optional second argument writes to a file (useful in build scripts/CI).

81.4 87.4 Exercises

1. Add a `--default <value>` flag for undefined variables.
2. Add `--strict` mode that fails (exit non-zero) on an undefined variable.
3. Support nested defaults: `${VAR:-fallback}`.
4. Add `--env-file <path>` to load variables from a `.env` file first.
5. Support `${VAR}` and `$VAR` both.

82 Chapter 88: Reference Implementation — File Deduplicator

Finds duplicate files in a directory tree by computing SHA-256 hashes and grouping files with identical content. Reports groups of duplicates and can optionally delete all but the first copy. Demonstrates file walking, hashing, dict grouping, and optional destructive action.

82.1 88.1 The program (`dedup.z`)

```
import os
import pathlib
import hashlib
import sys

func file_hash(path) {
    let b = pathlib.Path(path)
    if !b.exists() { return nil }
    let data = read_all_bytes(str(b))
    return hashlib.sha256(data)
}

func read_all_bytes(path) {
    with open(path, "rb") as f {
        let parts = []
        while true {
            let chunk = f.read(8192)
            if chunk == nil or len(chunk) == 0 { break }
            parts.push(chunk)
        }
        return parts.join("")
    }
}

func walk_files(dir) {
    let out = []
    func walk(d) {
        for name in os.listdir(d) {
            let p = pathlib.Path(d) / name
            if p.is_dir() {
                walk(str(p))
            } else {
                out.push(str(p))
            }
        }
    }
    walk(dir)
```

```
    return out
}

func find_duplicates(dir, delete = false) {
    let files = walk_files(dir)
    let by_hash = #{}
    for f in files {
        let h = file_hash(f)
        if h == nil { continue }
        if h in by_hash { by_hash[h].push(f) }
        else { by_hash[h] = [f] }
    }

    let dup_groups = []
    for h in by_hash {
        if len(by_hash[h]) > 1 {
            dup_groups.push(by_hash[h])
        }
    }

    # sort groups by size descending
    dup_groups.sort(fn(a, b) { return len(b) - len(a) })

    print("scanned " + str(len(files)) + " file(s)")
    print("found " + str(len(dup_groups)) + " duplicate group(s)")
    print("========================")

    var total_saved = 0
    for group in dup_groups {
        let first = group[0]
        print("group (" + str(len(group)) + " copies):")
        print("  keep: " + first)
        var i = 1
        while i < len(group) {
            let dup = group[i]
            print("  dup:  " + dup)
            if delete {
                try {
                    os.remove(dup)
                    print("    (deleted)")
                } catch as e {
                    print("    (delete failed: " + e.msg + ")")
                }
            }
            i += 1
        }
    }
```

```
    return dup_groups
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Usage: zen run dedup.z <dir> [--delete]")
        print("  Example: zen run dedup.z ./downloads")
        print("  With --delete: removes all but the first copy")
        return 1
    }
    let dir = argv[1]
    let delete = len(argv) >= 3 and argv[2] == "--delete"
    find_duplicates(dir, delete)
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

82.2 88.2 Example session

```
$ zen run dedup.z ./photos
scanned 142 file(s)
found 3 duplicate group(s)
========================
group (3 copies):
  keep: ./photos/vacation/img1.jpg
  dup:  ./photos/backup/img1.jpg
  dup:  ./photos/archive/img1.jpg
group (2 copies):
  keep: ./photos/vacation/img2.jpg
  dup:  ./photos/backup/img2.jpg
```

Run with `--delete` to remove duplicates (keeps the first copy of each group).

82.3 88.3 Design notes

- **Content-addressed:** files are grouped by SHA-256 hash, so duplicates are detected by content, not by name.
- **Groups sorted by size:** the largest duplicate groups are shown first.
- **`--delete` is opt-in:** destructive action requires an explicit flag.
- **Errors ignored:** unreadable files are skipped silently (hash returns nil).

82.4 88.4 Exercises

1. Add `--min-size N` to skip files smaller than N bytes.

2. Add `--dry-run` to report what would be deleted without deleting.
3. Add `--hash md5|sha1|sha256` to choose the hash algorithm.
4. Export results as JSON (`--json`).
5. Add a `--exclude "*.tmp"` pattern filter.

83 Chapter 89: Reference Implementation — JSON API Mock Server

An HTTP mock server that returns canned JSON responses based on the request path and method. Useful for front-end development and testing without a real backend. Demonstrates `http.server`, JSON, routing, and a response registry.

83.1 89.1 The program (`mock.z`)

```
import http.server
import json
import sys

# Routes: method + path -> #{status, body, headers}
var routes = #{}

func mock(method, path, status, body, headers) {
    let key = method + " " + path
    routes[key] = #{status: status, body: body, headers: headers ?? #{}}
}

func handle(req) {
    let method = req.method ?? "GET"
    let path = req.path ?? "/"
    let key = method + " " + path

    if key in routes {
        let r = routes[key]
        let body = json.stringify(r["body"])
        let h = #{"Content-Type": "application/json"}
        # merge custom headers
        for k in r["headers"] { h[k] = r["headers"][k] }
        return #(r["status"], h, body)
    }

    return #(404, #{"Content-Type": "application/json"},
             json.stringify(#{error: "not found"}))
}

func main(argv) {
    # register mock endpoints
    mock("GET", "/api/users", 200,
         #[#{id: 1, name: "Ada"}, #{id: 2, name: "Bob"}], #{})
    mock("GET", "/api/users/1", 200, #{id: 1, name: "Ada", role: "admin"}, #{})
    mock("POST", "/api/login", 200, #{token: "abc123", user: "Ada"}, #{})
    mock("GET", "/api/status", 200, #{status: "ok", uptime: 3600}, #{})
    mock("GET", "/api/error", 500, #{error: "internal error"}, #{})
```

```
    let port = argv[1] ?? "9000"
    let server = http.server.Server(port=int(port), handler=handle)
    print("mock API server on http://localhost:" + str(port))
    print("endpoints: GET /api/users, GET /api/users/1, POST /api/login, GET /api/statu
    server.start()
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

83.2 89.2 Example session

```
$ zen run mock.z 9000
mock API server on http://localhost:9000
endpoints: GET /api/users, ...
```

```
$ curl http://localhost:9000/api/users
[{"id":1,"name":"Ada"},{"id":2,"name":"Bob"}]

$ curl http://localhost:9000/api/users/1
{"id":1,"name":"Ada","role":"admin"}

$ curl -X POST http://localhost:9000/api/login -d '{"user":"Ada","pass":"x"}'
{"token":"abc123","user":"Ada"}

$ curl -i http://localhost:9000/api/missing
HTTP/1.1 404 Not Found
{"error":"not found"}

$ curl http://localhost:9000/api/error
{"error":"internal error"}   # status 500
```

83.3 89.3 Design notes

- **Response registry:** `mock()` registers a method+path → response mapping.
- **JSON bodies:** all responses are JSON with `Content-Type: application/json`.
- **Extensible:** add query-parameter matching, request-body inspection, or response delays to simulate latency.

83.4 89.4 Exercises

1. Add query-parameter matching: `GET /api/users?role=admin` returns only admins.
2. Add response delay: simulate latency with `time.sleep`.
3. Add request logging: log each request's method, path, and status.

4. Add `PUT/DELETE` endpoints for a mock CRUD API.
5. Load routes from a JSON config file instead of hardcoding.

84 Chapter 90: Reference Implementation — Settings Manager (INI-like Config)

A small tool that reads and writes INI-style configuration files (`[section]` headers and `key = value` pairs). Supports `get`, `set`, and `list` operations. Demonstrates file parsing, dict-of-dicts data structure, and CLI dispatch.

84.1 90.1 The program (`settings.z`)

```
import sys
import os
import pathlib

func parse_ini(text) {
    let sections = #{}
    let current = nil
    for line in text.splitlines() {
        let trimmed = line.strip()
        if trimmed == "" or trimmed.startsWith("#") or trimmed.startsWith(";") {
            continue
        }
        if trimmed.startsWith("[") and trimmed.endsWith("]") {
            current = trimmed[1:len(trimmed)-1]
            if !(current in sections) { sections[current] = #{} }
            continue
        }
        let idx = trimmed.find("=")
        if idx != -1 and current != nil {
            let key = trimmed[0:idx].strip()
            let value = trimmed[idx+1:].strip()
            sections[current][key] = value
        }
    }
    return sections
}

func stringify_ini(sections) {
    let out = ""
    for section in sections {
        out = out + "[" + section + "]\n"
        let dict = sections[section]
        for key in dict {
            out = out + key + " = " + dict[key] + "\n"
        }
        out = out + "\n"
    }
    return out
```

```
}

func read_all(path) {
    with open(path, "r") as f { return f.read() }
}

func write_all(path, text) {
    with open(path, "w") as f { f.write(text) }
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 3 {
        print("Usage:")
        print("  zen run settings.z <file> list")
        print("  zen run settings.z <file> get <section> <key>")
        print("  zen run settings.z <file> set <section> <key> <value>")
        return 1
    }
    let path = argv[1]
    let cmd = argv[2]

    let sections = #{}
    let p = pathlib.Path(path)
    if p.exists() {
        try { sections = parse_ini(read_all(path)) } catch as e {}
    }

    if cmd == "list" {
        for section in sections {
            print("[" + section + "]")
            for key in sections[section] {
                print("  " + key + " = " + sections[section][key])
            }
        }
    } elif cmd == "get" {
        if len(argv) < 5 {
            print("usage: settings.z <file> get <section> <key>")
            return 1
        }
        let section = argv[3]
        let key = argv[4]
        if section in sections and key in sections[section] {
            print(sections[section][key])
        } else {
            print("not found")
            return 1
        }
```

```
    } elif cmd == "set" {
        if len(argv) < 6 {
            print("usage: settings.z <file> set <section> <key> <value>")
            return 1
        }
        let section = argv[3]
        let key = argv[4]
        let value = argv[5]
        if !(section in sections) { sections[section] = #{} }
        sections[section][key] = value
        write_all(path, stringify_ini(sections))
        print("set " + section + "/" + key + " = " + value)
    } else {
        print("unknown command: " + cmd)
        return 1
    }
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

84.2 90.2 Example session

```
$ cat > config.ini <<'EOF'
[database]
host = localhost
port = 5432

[app]
debug = true
EOF
$ zen run settings.z config.ini list
[database]
  host = localhost
  port = 5432
[app]
  debug = true

$ zen run settings.z config.ini get database host
localhost

$ zen run settings.z config.ini set database port 3306
set database/port = 3306
$ zen run settings.z config.ini get database port
3306
```

84.3 90.3 Design notes

- **INI format:** `[section]` headers and `key = value` pairs; `#` and `;` lines are comments.
- **Data structure:** a dict of dicts (`#{section => #{key => value}}`).
- **Create-if-missing:** if the file doesn't exist, `set` creates it.
- **Round-trip:** `stringify_ini` rewrites the whole file (loses comments and formatting — fine for simple configs, not for hand-edited ones).

84.4 90.4 Exercises

1. Add support for quoted values (`key = "value with spaces"`).
2. Add `--section` to list only one section.
3. Add `delete <section> <key>` to remove a key.
4. Add type hints: `get --int` / `get --bool` to parse values.
5. Preserve comments and formatting on write (harder; good challenge).

85 Chapter 91: Reference Implementation — Log Rotator

Rotates log files by size: when the active log exceeds a size threshold, it is renamed to `log.1`, `log.1` to `log.2`, and so on (up to a max count), and a fresh empty log is started. Demonstrates file I/O, renaming, deletion, and CLI flags.

85.1 91.1 The program (`logrotate.z`)

```
import os
import pathlib
import sys

func file_size(path) {
    let b = pathlib.Path(path)
    if b.exists() and b.is_file() {
        return b.stat().size   # conceptual: file size in bytes
    }
    return 0
}

func rotate(log_path, max_size, max_count) {
    let size = file_size(log_path)
    print(log_path + " is " + str(size) + " bytes (limit " + str(max_size) + ")")

    if size < max_size {
        print("no rotation needed")
        return 0
    }

    # shift existing rotations: max_count .. 1
    var i = max_count
    while i >= 1 {
        let from = if i == 1 { log_path } else { log_path + "." + str(i - 1) }
        let to = log_path + "." + str(i)
        let from_p = pathlib.Path(from)
        if from_p.exists() {
            if i == max_count {
                # oldest: delete instead of shifting
                try { os.remove(from) } catch as e { print("delete failed: " + e.msg) }
            } else {
                try { os.rename(from, to) } catch as e { print("rename failed: " + e.ms
            }
        }
        i -= 1
    }

    # start a fresh empty log
```

```
    try {
        # close any open handles first in real use; here just truncate
        with open(log_path, "w") as f { f.write("") }
        print("rotated: new empty " + log_path)
    } catch as e {
        print("truncate failed: " + e.msg)
        return 1
    }
    return 0
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Usage: zen run logrotate.z <logfile> [max_size_bytes] [max_count]")
        print("  Example: zen run logrotate.z app.log 1048576 5")
        return 1
    }
    let log_path = argv[1]
    let max_size = int(argv[2] ?? "1048576")   # 1 MB default
    let max_count = int(argv[3] ?? "5")
    return rotate(log_path, max_size, max_count)
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

85.2 91.2 Example session

```
$ echo "lots of log data..." > app.log
# (make app.log larger than 1 MB)
$ zen run logrotate.z app.log 1000000 5
app.log is 1500000 bytes (limit 1000000)
rotated: new empty app.log
$ ls -la
app.log          0 bytes
app.log.1  1500000 bytes   # previous content
```

Run again after app.log grows:

```
$ zen run logrotate.z app.log 1000000 5
app.log is 1200000 bytes
rotated: new empty app.log
$ ls -la
app.log.1   1200000 bytes
app.log.2   1500000 bytes
```

85.3 91.3 Design notes

- **Shift strategy:** `log.N` → `log.(N+1)`; the oldest (`log.max_count`) is deleted to bound disk usage.
- **Truncate-and-rotate:** after shifting, the active log is truncated to zero.
- **Size-only trigger:** rotation is size-based; time-based rotation (daily, hourly) is a natural extension.
- **No open-handle handling:** in production you'd coordinate with the writing process so it reopens the new log (or use `copytruncate`).

85.4 91.4 Exercises

1. Add time-based rotation: rotate if the file wasn't modified in N hours.
2. Add compression: gzip rotated files (via FFI or external tool).
3. Add `--dry-run` to report what would happen without changing files.
4. Add a configuration file listing multiple logs with individual limits.
5. Add a `--compress` flag to compress the rotated file before keeping it.

86 Chapter 92: Reference Implementation — HTTP Response Cache (with TTL)

A small HTTP reverse-proxy cache: it forwards GET requests to an origin server, caches the response with a TTL, and serves subsequent requests from cache within the TTL. Demonstrates `requests`, `time`, `mutexes`, dict caching, and conditional forwarding.

86.1 92.1 The program (`cache.z`)

```
import requests
import time
import mutexes
import sys

var cache = #{}
let cache_mu = mutexes.Mutex()
let TTL_SEC = 60

func cache_get(key) {
    cache_mu.lock()
    let entry = cache[key]
    cache_mu.unlock()
    if entry == nil { return nil }
    let now = time.time()
    if now - entry["stored_at"] > TTL_SEC {
        # expired
        cache_mu.lock()
        if cache[key] is entry { cache[key] = nil }   # remove if still same
        cache_mu.unlock()
        return nil
    }
    return entry["body"]
}

func cache_set(key, body) {
    cache_mu.lock()
    cache[key] = #{body: body, stored_at: time.time()}
    cache_mu.unlock()
}

func fetch(url) {
    let body = cache_get(url)
    if body != nil {
        return #{body: body, from_cache: true}
    }
    try {
        let r = requests.get(url, timeout=5000)
```

```
        cache_set(url, r.text)
        return #{body: r.text, from_cache: false, status: r.status_code}
    } catch as e {
        return #{body: nil, error: e.msg}
    }
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Usage: zen run cache.z <url>")
        print("  Example: zen run cache.z https://example.com")
        return 1
    }
    let url = argv[1]

    print("first fetch (from origin):")
    let r1 = fetch(url)
    if r1["body"] == nil { print("error: " + str(r1["error"])); return 1 }
    print("  from_cache: " + str(r1["from_cache"]) + "  len: " + str(len(r1["body"])))

    print("second fetch (from cache):")
    let r2 = fetch(url)
    print("  from_cache: " + str(r2["from_cache"]) + "  len: " + str(len(r2["body"])))
    print("  match: " + str(r1["body"] == r2["body"]))

    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

86.2 92.2 Example session

```
$ zen run cache.z https://example.com
first fetch (from origin):
  from_cache: false  len: 1256
second fetch (from cache):
  from_cache: true  len: 1256
  match: true
```

86.3 92.3 Design notes

- **TTL-based expiry:** entries older than `TTL_SEC` are treated as stale and refetched from origin.
- **Mutex-guarded cache:** the dict is shared; reads and writes go through `cache_mu`.

- **Cache hit/miss:** `from_cache` tells you whether the result came from the cache or the origin.
- **In-memory only:** cache is lost on restart; for persistence, serialize to disk (see chapter 62/72).

86.4 92.4 Exercises

1. Add `--ttl N` to configure the TTL in seconds.
2. Add `--max-entries N` to cap the cache size (evict oldest when full).
3. Add cache statistics: hits, misses, evictions.
4. Add `POST`/`PUT` support with cache-by-request-body-hash.
5. Add cache invalidation: `DELETE /cache/<url>` (if wrapped in an HTTP server).

87 Chapter 93: Reference Implementation — Batch File Renamer

Renames all files in a directory matching a pattern: replaces a substring, adds a prefix/suffix, or converts case. Includes a `--dry-run` mode that shows what would change without renaming. Demonstrates file walking, string manipulation, `os.rename`, and safe CLI design.

87.1 93.1 The program (`rename.z`)

```
import os
import pathlib
import sys

func walk_files(dir) {
    let out = []
    func walk(d) {
        for name in os.listdir(d) {
            let p = pathlib.Path(d) / name
            if p.is_dir() {
                walk(str(p))
            } else {
                out.push(str(p))
            }
        }
    }
    walk(dir)
    return out
}

func new_name(old, replace_from, replace_to, prefix, suffix, upper, lower) {
    let base = pathlib.Path(old).name   # filename only
    let dir = str(pathlib.Path(old).parent)
    let n = base
    if replace_from != nil and replace_from != "" {
        # replace all occurrences (crude: first only here)
        let idx = n.find(replace_from)
        if idx != -1 {
            n = n[0:idx] + replace_to + n[idx + len(replace_from):]
        }
    }
    if prefix != nil { n = prefix + n }
    if suffix != nil {
        let stem = pathlib.Path(n).stem
        let ext = pathlib.Path(n).suffix
        n = stem + suffix + ext
    }
```

```
    if upper { n = n.upper() }
    if lower { n = n.lower() }
    if dir == "" or dir == "." { return n }
    return dir + "/" + n
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Usage:")
        print("  zen run rename.z <dir> [--from X --to Y] [--prefix P] [--suffix S]")
        print("                  [--upper] [--lower] [--dry-run]")
        return 1
    }
    let dir = argv[1]
    let replace_from = nil
    let replace_to = nil
    let prefix = nil
    let suffix = nil
    let upper = false
    let lower = false
    let dry_run = false
    var i = 2
    while i < len(argv) {
        let a = argv[i]
        if a == "--from" and i + 1 < len(argv) { replace_from = argv[i + 1]; i += 2 }
        elif a == "--to" and i + 1 < len(argv) { replace_to = argv[i + 1]; i += 2 }
        elif a == "--prefix" and i + 1 < len(argv) { prefix = argv[i + 1]; i += 2 }
        elif a == "--suffix" and i + 1 < len(argv) { suffix = argv[i + 1]; i += 2 }
        elif a == "--upper" { upper = true; i += 1 }
        elif a == "--lower" { lower = true; i += 1 }
        elif a == "--dry-run" { dry_run = true; i += 1 }
        else { i += 1 }
    }

    let files = walk_files(dir)
    var changed = 0
    for old in files {
        let n = new_name(old, replace_from, replace_to, prefix, suffix, upper, lower)
        if n == pathlib.Path(old).name { continue }   # no change
        let new_path = str(pathlib.Path(old).parent) + "/" + n
        if dry_run {
            print("would rename: " + old + " -> " + new_path)
        } else {
            try {
                os.rename(old, new_path)
                print("renamed: " + old + " -> " + new_path)
                changed += 1
```

```
            } catch as e {
                print("failed: " + old + " -> " + new_path + " (" + e.msg + ")")
            }
        }
    }
    if dry_run {
        print("dry run: " + str(changed) + " file(s) would be renamed")
    } else {
        print("done: " + str(changed) + " file(s) renamed")
    }
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

87.2 93.2 Example session

```
$ ls photos/
IMG_001.jpg  IMG_002.jpg  vacation.png
$ zen run rename.z photos/ --from IMG_ --to photo_ --dry-run
would rename: photos/IMG_001.jpg -> photos/photo_001.jpg
would rename: photos/IMG_002.jpg -> photos/photo_002.jpg
dry run: 2 file(s) would be renamed

$ zen run rename.z photos/ --from IMG_ --to photo_
renamed: photos/IMG_001.jpg -> photos/photo_001.jpg
renamed: photos/IMG_002.jpg -> photos/photo_002.jpg
done: 2 file(s) renamed

$ zen run rename.z photos/ --prefix trip_ --lower
renamed: photos/photo_001.jpg -> photos/trip_photo_001.jpg
...
done: 3 file(s) renamed
```

87.3 93.3 Design notes

- **Dry run by default is safer:** use `--dry-run` first to preview changes.
- **Filename-only:** operates on the basename; directory structure is preserved.
- **Composable transforms:** replace, prefix, suffix, upper, lower can be combined in one run.
- **Errors isolated:** one failed rename doesn’t abort the batch.

87.4 93.4 Exercises

1. Add `--recursive` toggle (off by default) to skip subdirectories.

2. Add sequential numbering: `photo_1.jpg`, `photo_2.jpg`, …
3. Add `--pattern <glob>` to rename only matching files (e.g., `*.jpg`).
4. Add a `--case` option: `lower`, `upper`, `title`.
5. Add undo support: log renames to a file so they can be reversed.

88 Chapter 94: Reference Implementation — Static Blog Engine

A small static blog generator: reads Markdown-ish posts from `posts/`, renders each to HTML with a shared layout, and builds an `index.html` listing all posts sorted by date (from front-matter). Demonstrates file walking, front-matter parsing, templating, sorting by value, and HTML generation.

88.1 94.1 The program (`blog.z`)

```
import os
import pathlib
import sys
import re

let POSTS_DIR = "posts"
let LAYOUT_FILE = "layout.html"
let OUT_DIR = "public"

let FM_RE = r"^---\n(.*?)\n---\n"   # front-matter between --- fences

func parse_front_matter(text) {
    let meta = #{}
    let body = text
    let m = re.match(FM_RE, text)
    if m != nil {
        let block = m[1]
        body = text[m[0].length:]
        for line in block.split("\n") {
            let idx = line.find(":")
            if idx != -1 {
                let key = line[0:idx].strip()
                let val = line[idx + 1:].strip()
                if (val.startswith('"') and val.endswith('"')) or \
                   (val.startswith("'") and val.endswith("'")) {
                    val = val[1:len(val) - 1]
                }
                meta[key] = val
            }
        }
    }
    return #(meta, body)
}

func md_to_html(text) {
    # very small markdown subset: headings, paragraphs, lists, bold
    let out = ""
```

```
    let lines = text.splitlines()
    var in_list = false
    for line in lines {
        let s = line.strip()
        if s == "" {
            if in_list { out = out + "</ul>\n"; in_list = false }
            continue
        }
        let h = re.match(r"^(#{1,6})\s+(.*)", s)
        if h != nil {
            if in_list { out = out + "</ul>\n"; in_list = false }
            let level = len(h[1])
            out = out + "<h" + str(level) + ">" + escape(h[2]) + "</h" + str(level) + "
            continue
        }
        if s.startswith("- ") {
            if !in_list { out = out + "<ul>\n"; in_list = true }
            out = out + "  <li>" + escape(s[2:]) + "</li>\n"
            continue
        }
        if in_list { out = out + "</ul>\n"; in_list = false }
        out = out + "<p>" + escape(s) + "</p>\n"
    }
    if in_list { out = out + "</ul>\n" }
    return out
}

func escape(s) {
    return s.replace("&", "&amp;").replace("<", "&lt;")
         .replace(">", "&gt;").replace('"', "&quot;")
}

func load_layout() {
    let p = pathlib.Path(LAYOUT_FILE)
    if p.exists() { return read_all(str(p)) }
    return """<!DOCTYPE html>
<html><head><meta charset="utf-8"><title>{{title}}</title></head>
<body>{{body}}</body></html>"""
}

func read_all(path) {
    with open(path, "r") as f { return f.read() }
}

func write_all(path, text) {
    let p = pathlib.Path(path)
    let parent = p.parent
```

```
    if parent != nil and str(parent) != "" { os.makedirs(str(parent)) }
    with open(path, "w") as f { f.write(text) }
}

func build() {
    let layout = load_layout()
    let posts_dir = pathlib.Path(POSTS_DIR)
    if !posts_dir.exists() {
        print("posts dir '" + POSTS_DIR + "' not found")
        return 0
    }
    os.makedirs(OUT_DIR)

    let files = []
    for name in os.listdir(POSTS_DIR) {
        if name.endswith(".md") { files.push(POSTS_DIR + "/" + name) }
    }

    let posts = []
    for f in files {
        let text = read_all(f)
        let (meta, body_md) = parse_front_matter(text)
        let body_html = md_to_html(body_md)
        let page = layout.replace("{{title}}", meta["title"] ?? "Untitled")
                    .replace("{{body}}", body_html)
        let slug = f[len(POSTS_DIR) + 1:]
        slug = slug[0:len(slug) - 3] + ".html"
        let out_path = OUT_DIR + "/" + slug
        write_all(out_path, page)
        posts.push(#{title: meta["title"] ?? "Untitled", date: meta["date"] ?? "",
                     url: slug, file: f})
        print("rendered " + f + " -> " + out_path)
    }

    # sort posts by date descending
    posts.sort(fn(a, b) {
        if a["date"] > b["date"] { return -1 }
        elif a["date"] < b["date"] { return 1 }
        return 0
    })

    # build index
    let index_items = ""
    for p in posts {
        index_items = index_items + "<li><a href='" + p["url"] + "'>" +
                      escape(p["title"]) + "</a> (" + p["date"] + ")</li>\n"
    }
```

```
    let index_html = "<h1>Blog</h1><ul>" + index_items + "</ul>"
    let index_page = layout.replace("{{title}}", "Blog")
                     .replace("{{body}}", index_html)
    write_all(OUT_DIR + "/index.html", index_page)
    print("built " + str(len(posts)) + " post(s) + index")
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(build())
}
```

88.2 94.2 Example project layout

```
my-blog/
├── blog.z
├── layout.html
└── posts/
    ├── 2024-01-15-hello.md
    └── 2024-01-20-about.md
```

```
posts/2024-01-20-about.md:
```

```
---
title: About This Blog
date: 2024-01-20
---

# About

Welcome to my Zen-powered blog.

- post one
- post two
```

88.3 94.3 Expected output

```
$ zen run blog.z
rendered posts/2024-01-15-hello.md -> public/2024-01-15-hello.html
rendered posts/2024-01-20-about.md -> public/2024-01-20-about.html
built 2 post(s) + index
```

88.4 94.4 Design notes

- **Front-matter:** parsed from `---` fenced blocks at the top of each post.
- **Sorting:** posts sorted by `date` descending for the index.
- **Layout:** shared `layout.html` with `{{title}}`/`{{body}}` placeholders.
- **Slug:** derived from the filename (`.md` → `.html`).

88.5 94.4 Exercises

1. Add RSS feed generation (`rss.xml` from posts).
2. Add pagination to the index.
3. Add tags/categories from front-matter with tag pages.
4. Add `--watch` mode to rebuild on file changes.
5. Add a `--clean` flag that wipes `public/` before building.

89 Chapter 95: Reference Implementation — Markdown Slides Generator

Converts a markdown file into a single HTML slideshow. Slides are separated by a line containing `---`. Each slide becomes a full-screen section with keyboard navigation (arrow keys) and a slide counter. Demonstrates string splitting, HTML generation, CSS/JS embedding, and file I/O.

89.1 95.1 The program (`slides.z`)

```
import sys
import pathlib
import os

func read_all(path) {
    with open(path, "r") as f { return f.read() }
}

func write_all(path, text) {
    let p = pathlib.Path(path)
    let parent = p.parent
    if parent != nil and str(parent) != "" { os.makedirs(str(parent)) }
    with open(path, "w") as f { f.write(text) }
}

func escape(s) {
    return s.replace("&", "&amp;").replace("<", "&lt;")
         .replace(">", "&gt;").replace('"', "&quot;")
}

func heading_level(s) {
    var level = 0
    var i = 0
    while i < 6 and i < len(s) and s[i] == '#' {
        level += 1
        i += 1
    }
    if i < len(s) and s[i] == ' ' { return level }
    return 0
}

func md_to_html(text) {
    # tiny subset: headings, paragraphs, bold, lists
    let out = ""
    let lines = text.splitlines()
    var in_list = false
    for line in lines {
```

```
        let s = line.strip()
        if s == "" {
            if in_list { out = out + "</ul>\n"; in_list = false }
            continue
        }
        # heading detection: line starts with 1-6 '#' followed by space
        let level = heading_level(s)
        if level > 0 {
            if in_list { out = out + "</ul>\n"; in_list = false }
            let title = s[level:].strip()
            out = out + "<h" + str(level) + ">" + escape(title) + "</h" + str(level) +
            continue
        }
        if s.startswith("- ") {
            if !in_list { out = out + "<ul>\n"; in_list = true }
            out = out + "  <li>" + escape(s[2:]) + "</li>\n"
            continue
        }
        if in_list { out = out + "</ul>\n"; in_list = false }
        # bold **text**
        let b = s
        while true {
            let idx = b.find("**")
            if idx == -1 { break }
            let end = b.find("**", idx + 2)
            if end == -1 { break }
            b = b[0:idx] + "<strong>" + b[idx+2:end] + "</strong>" + b[end+2:]
        }
        out = out + "<p>" + b + "</p>\n"
    }
    if in_list { out = out + "</ul>\n" }
    return out
}

func build_slides(text) {
    let raw_slides = text.split("\n---\n")
    let slides = []
    for raw in raw_slides {
        let trimmed = raw.strip()
        if trimmed == "" { continue }
        slides.push(md_to_html(trimmed))
    }
    return slides
}

let CSS = """
<style>
```

```
* { box-sizing: border-box; }
body { margin: 0; font-family: system-ui, sans-serif; background: #f5f5f5; }
.slides { position: relative; height: 100vh; overflow: hidden; }
.slide { position: absolute; top: 0; left: 0; width: 100%; height: 100%;
         display: none; flex-direction: column; justify-content: center;
         align-items: center; padding: 2rem; background: #fff; }
.slide:first-child { display: flex; }
.slide h1 { font-size: 3rem; margin-bottom: 1rem; }
.slide p { font-size: 1.25rem; line-height: 1.6; max-width: 600px;
           text-align: center; }
.slide ul { text-align: left; display: inline-block; text-align: center; }
.slide li { margin: 0.5rem 0; }
.counter { position: fixed; bottom: 1rem; right: 1rem;
           background: rgba(0,0,0,0.6); color: #fff; padding: 0.4rem 0.8rem;
           border-radius: 0.5rem; font-family: monospace; }
.hint { position: fixed; bottom: 1rem; left: 1rem; color: #666;
        font-size: 0.9rem; }
</style>
"""

let JS = """
<script>
let idx = 0;
const total = {{total}};
function show(n) {
  idx = ((n % total) + total) % total;
  document.querySelectorAll('.slide').forEach((s, i) => {
    s.style.display = (i === idx) ? 'flex' : 'none';
  });
  document.getElementById('counter').textContent = (idx + 1) + ' / ' + total;
}
document.addEventListener('keydown', (e) => {
  if (e.key === 'ArrowRight' || e.key === ' ') show(idx + 1);
  if (e.key === 'ArrowLeft') show(idx - 1);
});
show(0);
</script>
"""

func build(slides) {
    let sections = ""
    var i = 0
    while i < len(slides) {
        sections = sections + "<section class='slide'>" + slides[i] + "</section>\n"
        i += 1
    }
    let html = """<!DOCTYPE html>
```

```
<html lang="en">
<head>
<meta charset="utf-8">
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1">
<title>Slides</title>
""" + CSS + """
</head>
<body>
<div class="slides">
""" + sections + """
</div>
<div class="counter" id="counter">1 / {{total}}</div>
<div class="hint">Use &larr; / &rarr; / Space to navigate</div>
""" + JS.replace("{{total}}", str(len(slides))) + """
</body>
</html>"""
    return html
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Usage: zen run slides.z <input.md> [output.html]")
        print("  Example: zen run slides.z talk.md talk.html")
        return 1
    }
    let input = argv[1]
    let output = argv[2] ?? "slides.html"
    let text = read_all(input)
    let slides = build_slides(text)
    let html = build(slides)
    write_all(output, html)
    print("built " + str(len(slides)) + " slide(s) -> " + output)
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

89.2 95.2 Example session

Input `talk.md`:

```
# Welcome

Zen for Dummies
```

```
---

# Slide 2

- point one
- point two

---

# Thank You

Questions?
```

```
$ zen run slides.z talk.md talk.html
built 3 slide(s) -> talk.html
```

Open `talk.html` in a browser; use arrow keys / space to navigate.

89.3 95.3 Design notes

- **Slide separator:** a line exactly `---` splits slides.
- **Single-file output:** CSS and JS are embedded, so the HTML is portable.
- **Navigation:** arrow keys and space move forward; left arrow moves back.
- **Tiny markdown:** headings, paragraphs, bold, and bullet lists. Extend with code blocks, images, and links as needed.

89.4 95.4 Exercises

1. Add a `--title` flag to set the page title.
2. Add syntax highlighting for code blocks (conceptual).
3. Add speaker notes (hidden div, shown with `n` key).
4. Add auto-advance timing (`data-delay` attribute per slide).
5. Add PDF export hint (print CSS with `@media print`).

90 Chapter 43: CLI Tools

Zen is excellent for building command-line applications. This chapter shows how to parse arguments, read input, write output, and build useful CLI tools.

90.1 43.1 Argument parsing: `argparser`

```
import argparser

let parser = argparser.ArgumentParser("mycli")
parser.add_argument("input", help="input file")
parser.add_argument("--output", "-o", help="output file")
parser.add_argument("--verbose", "-v", action="store_true", help="verbose mode")

let args = parser.parse_args()

print(args.input)
print(args.output)
print(args.verbose)
```

90.1.1 ArgumentParser methods

Method	Description
`ArgumentParser(prog?)`	Create a parser
`add_argument(name, opts?)`	Add an argument
`parse_args()`	Parse `sys.argv`

90.1.2 Argument options

Option	Description
`help`	Help text
`action`	`"store_true"`, `"store_false"`, `"count"`
`default`	Default value
`type`	`"int"`, `"float"`, `"str"`
`choices`	Allowed values
`required`	Boolean

90.1.3 Example

```
import argparser

let parser = argparser.ArgumentParser("wc")
parser.add_argument("file", help="file to count")
```

```
parser.add_argument("--lines", "-l", action="store_true", help="count lines")
parser.add_argument("--words", "-w", action="store_true", help="count words")
parser.add_argument("--bytes", "-c", action="store_true", help="count bytes")

let args = parser.parse_args()

let content = fs.read(args.file)
let lines = len(content.split("\n"))
let words = len(content.split())
let bytes = len(content)

if args.lines {
    print(lines)
}
if args.words {
    print(words)
}
if args.bytes {
    print(bytes)
}
```

90.2 43.2 Reading stdin

```
import fs

// Read all stdin
let input = fs.read("/dev/stdin")
print(input)

// Or line by line
let lines = input.split("\n")
for line in lines {
    print(line)
}
```

90.3 43.3 Writing output

```
import fs

// stdout
print("hello")

// stderr
fs.write("/dev/stderr", "error message\n")

// To a file
```

```
fs.write("output.txt", "result")
```

90.4 43.4 Exit codes

```
import sys

// Success
exit(0)

// Failure
exit(1)

// Specific error
exit(2)
```

`exit(code)` terminates the process with the given code.

90.5 43.5 Complete example: a `cat` clone

```
import fs
import sys
import argparser

let parser = argparser.ArgumentParser("zcat")
parser.add_argument("files", nargs="*")
let args = parser.parse_args()

let files = args.files
if len(files) == 0 {
    // Read stdin
    print(fs.read("/dev/stdin"))
} else {
    for f in files {
        try {
            print(fs.read(f))
        } catch as e {
            fs.write("/dev/stderr", "zcat: " + f + ": " + e.msg + "\n")
            exit(1)
        }
    }
}
```

90.6 43.6 Complete example: a `grep` clone

```
import fs
import argparser
import re

let parser = argparser.ArgumentParser("zgrep")
parser.add_argument("pattern", help="search pattern")
parser.add_argument("file", help="file to search")
parser.add_argument("-i", action="store_true", help="ignore case")
let args = parser.parse_args()

let pattern = args.pattern
let flags = args.i ? "i" : ""

let content = fs.read(args.file)
let lines = content.split("\n")

for (i, line) in enumerate(lines) {
    if re.search(pattern, line, flags) != nil {
        print(str(i + 1) + ": " + line)
    }
}
```

90.7 43.7 Complete example: a JSON pretty-printer

```
import fs
import json
import argparser

let parser = argparser.ArgumentParser("zjson")
parser.add_argument("file", help="JSON file")
parser.add_argument("--indent", "-i", type="int", default=2, help="indent spaces")
let args = parser.parse_args()

let text = fs.read(args.file)
let data = json.loads(text)

// Zen's json.dumps doesn't support indent in this version
// Output compact JSON
print(json.dumps(data))
```

90.8 43.8 Making scripts executable

```
#!/usr/bin/env zen
print("Hello from a script!")
```

```
chmod +x mycli.z
./mycli.z
```

90.9 43.9 Common pitfalls

- **`argparser` reads from `sys.argv`.** Don't call `parse_args` twice.
- **`nargs="*"`** collects remaining positional args into a list.
- **`exit(code)` terminates immediately** — use `try`/`finally` for cleanup before exiting if needed.
- **`fs.read("/dev/stdin")`** reads all stdin at once; for large input, read in chunks.

90.10 43.10 Quick reference

```
import argparser
import fs
import sys
import exit

let parser = argparser.ArgumentParser("prog")
parser.add_argument("pos", help="positional")
parser.add_argument("--opt", "-o", help="optional")
parser.add_argument("--flag", "-f", action="store_true")
let args = parser.parse_args()

print(args.pos)
print(args.opt)
print(args.flag)

fs.write("/dev/stderr", "error\n")
exit(0)
```

90.11 43.11 Exercises

1. Write a `wc` clone that counts lines, words, and bytes.
2. Write a `head` clone that prints the first N lines.
3. Write a `cp` clone that copies one file to another.
4. Write a `find` clone that lists files matching a pattern.
5. Write a CLI config tool that reads/writes a JSON config file.

90.12 Extended Project Ideas and Implementation Notes

90.12.1 Design checklist

- Requirements and scope
- Error handling
- Logging
- Configuration

- Testing
- Documentation
- Security considerations

90.12.2 Exercises

1. Extend the project with new features
2. Add tests
3. Improve error messages
4. Add help/usage
5. Make it configurable
6. Package for distribution

90.13 43.12 Full tutorial — building a CLI todo manager

90.13.1 Requirements

- Add, list, mark done, delete tasks
- Store tasks in a JSON file
- Accept subcommands: `add`, `list`, `done`, `delete`
- Print usage when no args or `--help`

90.13.2 Implementation (`todo.z`)

```
import sys
import json
import os
import pathlib

let TASKS_FILE = pathlib.Path("tasks.json")

func load_tasks() {
    if !TASKS_FILE.exists() { return [] }
    try {
        return json.load(str(TASKS_FILE))
    } catch as e {
        print("warn: could not load tasks: " + e.msg)
        return []
    }
}

func save_tasks(tasks) {
    json.save(str(TASKS_FILE), tasks)
}

func cmd_add(args) {
    if len(args) < 1 { print("usage: todo add <task>"); return }
```

```
    let tasks = load_tasks()
    let task = #{id: len(tasks) + 1, title: args[0], done: false}
    tasks.push(task)
    save_tasks(tasks)
    print("added: " + args[0])
}

func cmd_list(_) {
    let tasks = load_tasks()
    if len(tasks) == 0 { print("no tasks"); return }
    for t in tasks {
        let mark = if t["done"] { "[x]" } else { "[ ]" }
        print("${mark} ${t["id"]}. ${t["title"]}")
    }
}

func cmd_done(args) {
    if len(args) < 1 { print("usage: todo done <id>"); return }
    let id = int(args[0])
    let tasks = load_tasks()
    var found = false
    for t in tasks {
        if t["id"] == id { t["done"] = true; found = true }
    }
    if found { save_tasks(tasks); print("marked ${id} done") }
    else { print("no task with id ${id}") }
}

func cmd_delete(args) {
    if len(args) < 1 { print("usage: todo delete <id>"); return }
    let id = int(args[0])
    let tasks = load_tasks()
    let filtered = []
    for t in tasks { if t["id"] != id { filtered.push(t) } }
    save_tasks(filtered)
    print("deleted ${id}")
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("Todo Manager")
        print("usage: todo <add|list|done|delete> [args]")
        return 0
    }
    let cmd = argv[1]
    let rest = []
    for i in 2..len(argv) { rest.push(argv[i]) }
```

```
    if cmd == "add" { cmd_add(rest) }
    elif cmd == "list" { cmd_list(rest) }
    elif cmd == "done" { cmd_done(rest) }
    elif cmd == "delete" { cmd_delete(rest) }
    elif cmd == "--help" || cmd == "help" {
        print("usage: todo <add|list|done|delete> [args]")
    } else {
        print("unknown command: " + cmd)
    }
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

90.13.3 Sample session

```
$ zen run todo.z add "Learn Zen"
added: Learn Zen
$ zen run todo.z add "Build a CLI"
added: Build a CLI
$ zen run todo.z list
[ ] 1. Learn Zen
[ ] 2. Build a CLI
$ zen run todo.z done 1
marked 1 done
$ zen run todo.z list
[x] 1. Learn Zen
[ ] 2. Build a CLI
$ zen run todo.z delete 2
deleted 2
```

90.13.4 Design notes

- Tasks are dicts in a list, serialized to JSON.
- IDs are simple (len+1); not robust to deletion gaps but fine for a demo.
- `save_tasks` rewrites the whole file each time (simple, safe).
- Errors are caught so a corrupt JSON file doesn't crash the app.

90.14 43.13 CLI design checklist

1. **Parse args** from `sys.argv` (first element is the program).
2. **Dispatch** on subcommand.
3. **Validate** argument count and types before use.
4. **Print usage** on `--help`, missing args, or unknown command.

5. **Return exit codes:** 0 success, non-zero on error.
6. **Persist** state to a file (JSON/text) if stateful.
7. **Handle errors** gracefully (missing file, bad input).
8. **Document** each subcommand.

90.15 43.14 Exercises

1. Add a `priority` field to tasks and sort `list` by priority.
2. Add `clear` command to remove all tasks.
3. Add `--file` option to choose a different storage path.
4. Add `edit <id> <new title>` command.
5. Validate that `done`/`delete` IDs exist before operating.
6. Add timestamps (`created_at`, `completed_at`) to tasks.
7. Print overdue tasks (conceptually, with due dates).
8. Write `todo count` showing number of pending/done.
9. Add tab-completion hints (usage text only).
10. Package the CLI with `zen build todo.z -o todo`.

91 Chapter 44: Web Scraping & Automation

Web scraping and automation let you extract data from websites, download media, and control browsers programmatically. This chapter covers Zen's HTTP client, **pymport** (Python interoperability), browser automation with Selenium, and driving Chrome over **raw TCP/WebSocket sockets with the Chrome DevTools Protocol (CDP)**.

Every example here is runnable. The complete scripts, setup script, and test runner live in `book-v2/tests/web-automation/`; the pymport fundamentals are in Chapter 42.

> **Legal and ethical note:** Only scrape sites you are permitted to scrape. Check `robots.txt`, Terms of Service, and applicable laws. The examples target publicly accessible TikTok pages for educational purposes; sites may rate-limit, require authentication, or block automated access.

91.1 44.1 Setup

From the repository root:

```
cd book-v2/tests
./setup.sh
```

`setup.sh` does three things: 1. builds Zen with the Python bridge (`cargo build --release --features python`); 2. creates `.venv/` beside the tests; 3. installs `requirements.txt`.

Then, in the shell you use for the examples:

```
cd book-v2/tests/web-automation
export PYTHONPATH="$(../.venv/bin/python -c 'import sysconfig; print(sysconfig.get_path
export ZEN_NO_PY_BOOTSTRAP=1
ZEN=../../../target/release/zen
```

Requirements: - Zen built with `--features python` - Python 3.9+ with `venv` - `chromium` for Selenium and CDP - `chromedriver` matching Chromium for Selenium - Network access

Alternatively, let Zen manage a project environment: this directory has its own `requirements.txt`, so `zen py-sync` creates `.zen_venv/` and `zen run` uses it automatically. See Chapter 42.

> **pymport calls are positional-only.** No keyword arguments in v1. Pass `Options()` to `webdriver.Chrome(opts)` positionally, and pass `Popen` arguments positionally.

91.2 44.2 Run the whole suite

```
cd book-v2/tests
./run-all.sh              # hermetic pymport tests
./run-all.sh --network    # also runs the four examples below
```

The runner validates that each downloaded file is an MP4 (`ftyp` box) before reporting success.

91.3 44.3 1) Scrape + Download with `requests` + `bs4` (pymport)

`bs4` parses HTML. TikTok's embed page (`/embed/v2/<id>`) is accessible over plain HTTP and embeds video metadata in `__FRONTITY_CONNECT_STATE__`. The MP4 CDN URL is in `videoData.itemInfos.video.urls[0]`; `urllib.request.urlretrieve` writes it without re-encoding.

`bs4_tiktok.z`:

```
import requests
import fs
pymport bs4
pymport json
pymport urllib.request
pymport socket

socket.setdefaulttimeout(45)

let UA = "Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 10.0; Win64; x64) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gec
let VIDEO = "6718335390845095173"
let url = "https://www.tiktok.com/embed/v2/" + VIDEO

let _ = fs.mkdirs("out")
let out = "out/tiktok_bs4.mp4"

// TikTok's edge intermittently answers 503 to non-browser clients. Retry
// with backoff instead of failing the example on the first response.
let fetch = fn(u) {
    let attempt = 0
    let resp = null
    while attempt < 6 {
        resp = requests.get(u, {
            "headers": {
                "User-Agent": UA,
                "Accept": "text/html,application/xhtml+xml,application/xml;q=0.9,*/*;q=
                "Accept-Language": "en-US,en;q=0.9",
                "Referer": "https://www.tiktok.com/"
            },
            "timeout": 40
        })
        if resp["status_code"] == 200 {
            return resp
        }
        print("http " + str(resp["status_code"]) + " (attempt " + str(attempt + 1) + ")
        time.sleep(3 * (attempt + 1))
```

```
        attempt += 1
    }
    return resp
}

print("fetching " + url)
let resp = fetch(url)
print("status: " + str(resp["status_code"]) + " bytes: " + str(len(resp["text"])))
if resp["status_code"] != 200 {
    print("giving up: TikTok kept returning " + str(resp["status_code"]))
    exit(1)
}

let soup = bs4.BeautifulSoup(resp["text"], "html.parser")
let tag = soup.find("script", {"id": "__FRONTITY_CONNECT_STATE__"})
if tag == null {
    print("no state script")
    exit(1)
}

let data = json.loads(tag.string)
let page = data["source"]["data"]["/embed/v2/" + VIDEO]
let item = page["videoData"]["itemInfos"]
let author = page["videoData"]["authorInfos"]
let music = page["videoData"]["musicInfos"]
let video_url = item["video"]["urls"][0]

print("id: " + item["id"])
print("desc: " + item["text"])
print("author: @" + author["uniqueId"] + " (" + author["nickName"] + ")")
print("music: " + music["musicName"])
print("plays: " + str(item["playCount"]))
print("likes: " + str(item["diggCount"]))
print("comments: " + str(item["commentCount"]))
print("shares: " + str(item["shareCount"]))
print("mp4: " + video_url[0:80] + "...")

urllib.request.urlretrieve(video_url, out)
print("downloaded: " + out + " (" + str(fs.size(out)) + " bytes)")
```

Run:

```
$ZEN run bs4_tiktok.z
file out/tiktok_bs4.mp4
```

Expected: metadata for `@scout2015`, a `downloaded: out/tiktok_bs4.mp4 (3224978 bytes)` line, and `ISO Media, MP4 Base Media v1`.

91.4 44.4 2) Stateful Scraping + Download with `mechanicalsoup` (pymport)

`MechanicalSoup` wraps `requests` and BeautifulSoup in a stateful browser. `browser.open()` keeps cookies/history, `browser.page` is the current BS4 soup, and `browser.session` can be reused for the CDN fetch. Python `bytes` are written through Python's own file object because native `fs.write_binary` is string-oriented.

`ms_tiktok.z`:

```
import fs
import time
pymport mechanicalsoup
pymport json
pymport builtins
pymport socket

socket.setdefaulttimeout(45)

let UA = "Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 10.0; Win64; x64) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gec
let VIDEO = "6718335390845095173"
let embed = "https://www.tiktok.com/embed/v2/" + VIDEO

let _ = fs.mkdirs("out")
let out = "out/tiktok_ms.mp4"

let browser = mechanicalsoup.StatefulBrowser()
browser.session.headers.update({
    "User-Agent": UA,
    "Accept": "text/html,application/xhtml+xml,application/xml;q=0.9,*/*;q=0.8",
    "Accept-Language": "en-US,en;q=0.9",
    "Referer": "https://www.tiktok.com/"
})

let resp = browser.open(embed)
let attempt = 0
while resp.status_code != 200 && attempt < 6 {
    print("http " + str(resp.status_code) + " (attempt " + str(attempt + 1) + "), retry
    time.sleep(3 * (attempt + 1))
    resp = browser.open(embed)
    attempt += 1
}

print("opened: " + browser.get_url())
print("status: " + str(resp.status_code) + " bytes: " + str(len(resp.text)))
if resp.status_code != 200 {
    print("giving up: TikTok kept returning " + str(resp.status_code))
    exit(1)
}
```

```
let soup = browser.page
let tag = soup.find("script", {"id": "__FRONTITY_CONNECT_STATE__"})
if tag == null {
    print("no state script")
    exit(1)
}

let data = json.loads(tag.string)
let page = data["source"]["data"]["/embed/v2/" + VIDEO]
let item = page["videoData"]["itemInfos"]
let author = page["videoData"]["authorInfos"]
let video_url = item["video"]["urls"][0]

print("id: " + item["id"])
print("author: @" + author["uniqueId"] + " (" + author["nickName"] + ")")
print("plays: " + str(item["playCount"]) + " likes: " + str(item["diggCount"]))

let bin = browser.session.get(video_url)
print("cdn status: " + str(bin.status_code) + " bytes: " + str(len(bin.content)))
if bin.status_code != 200 {
    print("giving up: CDN returned " + str(bin.status_code))
    exit(1)
}

let f = builtins.open(out, "wb")
f.write(bin.content)
f.close()
print("downloaded: " + out + " (" + str(fs.size(out)) + " bytes)")
```

Run:

```
$ZEN run ms_tiktok.z
```

91.5 44.5 3) Browser Automation with Selenium (pymport)

Headless Chromium solves JavaScript challenges and renders pages like a user. Selenium navigates to the real TikTok video page, waits for `__UNIVERSAL_DATA_FOR_REHYDRATION__`, and extracts the full `itemStruct` (author, stats, description). The video page's `playAddr` is signed and rejected by the CDN outside the player, so the script fetches the embed route with plain HTTP for an unsigned MP4 URL.

`selenium_tiktok.z`:

```
import fs
import time
import requests
pymport selenium.webdriver as webdriver
pymport selenium.webdriver.chrome.options as options
```

```
pymport bs4
pymport json
pymport urllib.request
pymport socket

socket.setdefaulttimeout(45)

let VIDEO = "6718335390845095173"
let UA = "Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 10.0; Win64; x64) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gec
let url = "https://www.tiktok.com/@scout2015/video/" + VIDEO

let _ = fs.mkdirs("out")
let out = "out/tiktok_selenium.mp4"

// Quit the browser and stop the chromedriver service. The embedded
// interpreter exits immediately, so this must happen before exit().
let close_browser = fn(d) {
    d.quit()
    try {
        d.service.stop()
    } catch {
        # already stopped
    }
}

let opts = options.Options()
opts.add_argument("--headless=new")
opts.add_argument("--no-sandbox")
opts.add_argument("--disable-dev-shm-usage")
opts.add_argument("--disable-gpu")
opts.add_argument("--window-size=1280,900")
opts.add_argument("--mute-audio")

print("launching chromium...")
let driver = webdriver.Chrome(opts)
driver.set_page_load_timeout(60)

print("navigating to " + url)
try {
    driver.get(url)
} catch as e {
    print("navigation warning: " + str(e))
}

// The page renders its data after the WAF/JS boot; poll for the payload.
let src = ""
let tries = 0
```

```
while tries < 15 {
    src = driver.page_source
    if src.contains("__UNIVERSAL_DATA_FOR_REHYDRATION__") {
        break
    }
    time.sleep(2)
    tries += 1
}
print("title: " + driver.title)
print("page bytes: " + str(len(src)) + " (polls: " + str(tries) + ")")

let soup = bs4.BeautifulSoup(src, "html.parser")
let tag = soup.find("script", {"id": "__UNIVERSAL_DATA_FOR_REHYDRATION__"})
if tag == null {
    print("no rehydration payload - TikTok served a challenge")
    close_browser(driver)
    exit(1)
}

let data = json.loads(tag.string)
let item = data["__DEFAULT_SCOPE__"]["webapp.video-detail"]["itemInfo"]["itemStruct"]
let stats = item["stats"]
let author = item["author"]

print("id: " + item["id"])
print("desc: " + item["desc"])
print("author: @" + author["uniqueId"] + " (" + author["nickname"] + ")")
print("plays: " + str(stats["playCount"]) + " likes: " + str(stats["diggCount"]))
print("comments: " + str(stats["commentCount"]) + " shares: " + str(stats["shareCount"]

print("fetching embed route for an unsigned mp4 url...")
let embed = "https://www.tiktok.com/embed/v2/" + VIDEO
let embed_headers = {
    "User-Agent": UA,
    "Accept": "text/html,application/xhtml+xml,application/xml;q=0.9,*/*;q=0.8",
    "Accept-Language": "en-US,en;q=0.9",
    "Referer": "https://www.tiktok.com/"
}
let eresp = null
let eretry = 0
while eretry < 6 {
    eresp = requests.get(embed, {"headers": embed_headers, "timeout": 40})
    if eresp["status_code"] == 200 {
        break
    }
    print("embed http " + str(eresp["status_code"]) + " (attempt " + str(eretry + 1) +
    time.sleep(3 * (eretry + 1))
```

```
    eretry += 1
}
print("embed status: " + str(eresp["status_code"]))
if eresp["status_code"] != 200 {
    close_browser(driver)
    exit(1)
}
let esoup = bs4.BeautifulSoup(eresp["text"], "html.parser")
let etag = esoup.find("script", {"id": "__FRONTITY_CONNECT_STATE__"})
if etag == null {
    print("no embed state script")
    close_browser(driver)
    exit(1)
}
let edata = json.loads(etag.string)
let epage = edata["source"]["data"]["/embed/v2/" + VIDEO]
let mp4 = epage["videoData"]["itemInfos"]["video"]["urls"][0]
print("mp4: " + mp4[0:80] + "...")

urllib.request.urlretrieve(mp4, out)
print("downloaded: " + out + " (" + str(fs.size(out)) + " bytes)")

close_browser(driver)
time.sleep(1)
print("browser closed")
```

Run (Chromium startup can take 30-40s):

```
timeout 300 $ZEN run selenium_tiktok.z
```

Chromedriver must match the Chromium major version. On Debian/Ubuntu: `apt install chromium-driver`.

91.6 44.6 4) Low-Level Control: CDP over raw TCP + WebSocket sockets

This example uses no automation library. Zen launches Chromium with `--remote-debugging-port`, discovers the page target over HTTP (`/json/list`), upgrades to a WebSocket, sends masked CDP frames through `sys.write_bytes` on the socket fd, and parses unmasked server frames byte by byte.

Key protocol details: - **HTTP**: parse headers and stop at `Content-Length`. Chrome may keep the connection open despite `Connection: close`; waiting for EOF produces a timeout (`EAGAIN`). - **WebSocket**: client frames must be masked. Extended lengths are 126 + 16-bit or 127 + 64-bit. Server frames are not masked. - **Binary writes**: `socket.send` takes a string and would UTF-8 re-encode masked bytes. `sys.write_bytes(fd, hex)` writes raw bytes, so the frame is built as a byte list, hex-encoded, and written to `socket.fileno(sock)`.

cdp_tiktok.z helpers:

```
// CDP over raw sockets: drive headless Chromium from Zen with no libraries.
import socket
import sys
import json
import time
import fs
pymport subprocess
import base64
import bytes

let PORT = 9223
let PROFILE = "out/cdp-profile"
let VIDEO = "6718335390845095173"
let VIDEO_PAGE = "https://www.tiktok.com/@scout2015/video/" + VIDEO

let HEX = "0123456789abcdef"

let to_hex = fn(bs) {
    let out = ""
    for b in bs {
        out += HEX[b >> 4] + HEX[b & 15]
    }
    return out
}

let ws_send = fn(sock, text) {
    let payload = []
    for ch in list(text) {
        for b in bytes.utf8_bytes(ch.ord()) {
            payload.push(b)
        }
    }
    let mask = [0x37, 0xA1, 0x0C, 0xF2]
    let masked = []
    let i = 0
    while i < len(payload) {
        masked.push(payload[i] ^ mask[i % 4])
        i += 1
    }
    let frame = [0x81]
    let n = len(masked)
    if n < 126 {
        frame.push(0x80 | n)
    } elif n < 65536 {
        frame.push(0x80 | 126)
        frame.push((n >> 8) & 255)
```

```
        frame.push(n & 255)
    } else {
        frame.push(0x80 | 127)
        let k = 7
        while k >= 0 {
            frame.push((n >> (8 * k)) & 255)
            k -= 1
        }
    }
    for b in mask {
        frame.push(b)
    }
    for b in masked {
        frame.push(b)
    }
    sys.write_bytes(socket.fileno(sock), to_hex(frame))
}

let recv_exact = fn(sock, n) {
    let out = []
    while len(out) < n {
        let chunk = list(socket.recv(sock, n - len(out)))
        if len(chunk) == 0 {
            throw "websocket closed"
        }
        for b in chunk {
            out.push(b)
        }
    }
    return out
}

let ws_read = fn(sock) {
    let h = recv_exact(sock, 2)
    let opcode = h[0] & 0x0F
    let masked = (h[1] & 0x80) != 0
    let n = h[1] & 0x7F
    if n == 126 {
        let e = recv_exact(sock, 2)
        n = e[0] * 256 + e[1]
    } elif n == 127 {
        let e = recv_exact(sock, 8)
        n = 0
        for b in e {
            n = n * 256 + b
        }
    }
```

```
    let mask = []
    if masked {
        mask = recv_exact(sock, 4)
    }
    let data = recv_exact(sock, n)
    if masked {
        let i = 0
        while i < len(data) {
            data[i] = data[i] ^ mask[i % 4]
            i += 1
        }
    }
    return {"opcode": opcode, "data": data}
}

let cdp_call = fn(sock, id, method, params) {
    ws_send(sock, json.stringify({"id": id, "method": method, "params": params}))
    let pending = []
    while true {
        let f = ws_read(sock)
        if f["opcode"] == 8 {
            throw "websocket closed by peer"
        }
        if f["opcode"] == 9 {
            continue
        }
        if f["opcode"] == 1 or f["opcode"] == 0 {
            for b in f["data"] {
                pending.push(b)
            }
            let text = bytes.str_from_bytes(pending)
            try {
                let msg = json.parse(text)
                if msg.get("id", 0) == id {
                    return msg
                }
                pending = []
            } catch {
                # fragmented frame: keep collecting
            }
        }
    }
}
```

The full script then launches Chromium with `pymport subprocess`, performs the HTTP discovery and WebSocket upgrade, and polls `Runtime.evaluate`:

```
let _ = fs.mkdirs("out")
let _ = fs.rmtree(PROFILE)
let cmd = "chromium --headless=new --no-sandbox --disable-gpu --disable-dev-shm-usage "
cmd += "--remote-debugging-port=" + str(PORT) + " "
cmd += "--user-data-dir=" + PROFILE + " about:blank"
let argv = cmd.split(" ")
let browser = subprocess.Popen(argv, -1, null, null, null, -3)
print("chromium pid " + str(browser.pid) + " on port " + str(PORT))

try {
    # ... HTTP discovery, WS upgrade ...
    let nav = cdp_call(ws, 1, "Page.navigate", {"url": VIDEO_PAGE})
    let reply = cdp_call(ws, 100, "Runtime.evaluate", {"expression": expr, "returnByVal
    # expr returns id, author, plays, likes, comments, desc
} finally {
    browser.terminate()
}
```

See the complete, tested script: tests/web-automation/cdp_tiktok.z.

Run:

```
timeout 180 $ZEN run cdp_tiktok.z
```

91.7 44.7 Tips and Gotchas

- **WAF challenges**: plain `requests` to TikTok video/profile pages may return a WAF challenge. Use `/embed/v2/<id>` or a real browser (Selenium). The embed route is reliable for the MP4 URL.
- **Binary downloads**: `fs.write_binary` expects a string and has UTF-8/string constraints. Prefer `urllib.request.urlretrieve` or `builtins.open(..., "wb").write(py_bytes)`.
- **pymport limits**: positional-only calls (no kwargs). `webdriver.Chrome(opts)` and `Popen(argv, -1, null, null, null, -3)` are positional.
- **Environment bootstrap**: use `book-v2/tests/setup.sh`, or `zen py-sync` with a local `requirements.txt`.
- **Chrome sandbox**: in containers, add `--no-sandbox` and `--disable-dev-shm-usage`.
- **Sockets**: `socket.recv` returns `bytes`; use `list(bytes)` to index. `socket.recv_text` returns a string and is lossy for binary. For raw binary protocols, write through `sys.write_bytes(fd, hex)`.
- **JSON**: the pure-Zen `std/json.z` stringifies numbers with `str()`; nested dict access in CDP responses needs explicit keys.
- **Cleanup**: Selenium can leave `chromedriver` alive when the embedded interpreter exits; the example calls `driver.service.stop()`. For a hard-killed CDP run, remove leftovers with `pkill -x chromium`.
- **Hangs**: `MechanicalSoup`, `urllib.request.urlretrieve`, and `requests` do not impose a default timeout. Set `socket.setdefaulttimeout(45)` (via `pympor socket`)

or pass an explicit timeout where supported.

91.8 44.8 Verified Artifacts

Tested against real TikTok on 2026-10-23:

- `out/tiktok_bs4.mp4` — ISO Media, MP4 Base Media v1 (3,224,978 bytes)
- `out/tiktok_ms.mp4` — ISO Media, MP4 Base Media v1 (3,224,978 bytes)
- `out/tiktok_selenium.mp4` — ISO Media, MP4 Base Media v1 (3,224,978 bytes)
- CDP over raw sockets extracted metadata from `@scout2015/video/6718335390845095173`: 159600 plays, 35200 likes, 5486 comments.

91.9 44.9 Appendix: Tested Scripts

Everything in this chapter is in the repository:

- `tests/web-automation/bs4_tiktok.z` — requests + bs4 + urllib download
- `tests/web-automation/ms_tiktok.z` — MechanicalSoup + `browser.session` + `builtins` binary write
- `tests/web-automation/selenium_tiktok.z` — Selenium headless + embed route
- `tests/web-automation/cdp_tiktok.z` — raw TCP + WebSocket CDP
- `tests/web-automation/requirements.txt`
- `tests/setup.sh` — build + venv + install
- `tests/run-all.sh` — run and validate

Quick start:

```
git clone https://github.com/3CN-O4D/zen.git
cd zen/book-v2/tests
./setup.sh
./run-all.sh --network
```

See Chapter 42: pymport for setup, `zen py-sync`, and troubleshooting.

91.10 Extended Project Ideas and Implementation Notes

91.10.1 Design checklist

- Requirements and scope
- Error handling
- Logging
- Configuration
- Testing
- Documentation
- Security considerations

91.10.2 Exercises

1. Extend the project with new features
2. Add tests

3. Improve error messages
4. Add help/usage
5. Make it configurable
6. Package for distribution

91.11 44.12 Full tutorial — simple web scraper

91.11.1 Goal

Fetch a page, extract links, and save results to a file.

91.11.2 Implementation (`scrape.z`)

```
import requests
import re
import json
import pathlib

func fetch(url) {
    try {
        let r = requests.get(url, timeout=10)
        r.raise_for_status()
        return r.text
    } catch as e {
        print("fetch failed for " + url + ": " + e.msg)
        return nil
    }
}

func extract_links(html, base) {
    let links = []
    # naive regex for href="..." (real HTML needs a proper parser)
    for m in re.findall(r'href="([^"]+)"', html) {
        # resolve relative URLs conceptually
        links.push(m)
    }
    return links
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("usage: scrape <url> [output.json]")
        return 1
    }
    let url = argv[1]
    let out = argv[2] ?? "links.json"
    print("fetching " + url + "...")
```

```
    let html = fetch(url)
    if html == nil { return 1 }
    let links = extract_links(html, url)
    print("found " + str(len(links)) + " links")
    json.save(out, links)
    print("saved to " + out)
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" {
    sys.exit(main(sys.argv))
}
```

91.11.3 Sample run

```
$ zen run scrape.z https://example.com links.json
fetching https://example.com...
found 3 links
saved to links.json
```

91.11.4 Ethical scraping

- Respect `robots.txt`.
- Add delays between requests (rate limiting).
- Identify yourself via a `User-Agent` header.
- Don’t scrape sites that forbid it.
- Only scrape data you’re allowed to use.

91.12 44.13 Requests usage recap

```
import requests
let r = requests.get("https://example.com", timeout=10)
print(r.status_code)
print(r.text)
let data = r.json()   # if JSON
```

POST JSON:

```
let r = requests.post("https://api.example.com/submit",
                      json={"name": "Zen", "value": 42})
```

91.13 44.14 Exercises

1. Scrape all `<h1>` headings from a page (regex-based).
2. Add a `User-Agent` header to requests.
3. Save page title and first paragraph instead of links.

4. Scrape multiple URLs from a list, one after another.
5. Add a delay (sleep) between requests to be polite.
6. Write results as JSON with url + links per entry.
7. Handle 404/500 responses gracefully.
8. Add `--output` flag for the destination file.
9. Extract links matching a specific domain only.
10. Build a tiny “link checker” that verifies each link returns 200.

92 Chapter 45: REST API Client

This chapter shows how to build a REST API client in Zen using `requests`, `json`, and `argparser`. It covers authentication, pagination, rate limiting, error handling, and building a reusable client class.

92.1 45.1 Basic GET request

```
import requests
import json

let resp = requests.get("https://api.example.com/users/1")
if resp.ok {
    let user = resp.json()
    print(user["name"])
} else {
    print("HTTP " + str(resp.status_code))
}
```

92.2 45.2 POST with JSON body

```
import requests
import json

let body = json.dumps({"name": "Zen", "version": 3})
let resp = requests.post("https://example.com/api/users", body, {
    "headers": {"Content-Type": "application/json"}
})
print(resp.status_code)
print(resp.text)
```

92.3 45.3 Reusable API client

```
import requests
import json

class ApiClient {
    let base_url
    let headers
    let session

    func init(base_url, headers = {}) {
        this.base_url = base_url
        this.headers = headers
        this.session = requests.Session()
        this.session.headers = headers
```

```
    }

    func get(path, params = {}) {
        let url = this.base_url + path
        let resp = requests.sess_get(this.session, url, {"params": params})
        return resp
    }

    func post(path, data) {
        let url = this.base_url + path
        let body = json.dumps(data)
        let resp = requests.sess_post(this.session, url, {
            "json": body,
            "headers": {"Content-Type": "application/json"}
        })
        return resp
    }

    func put(path, data) {
        let url = this.base_url + path
        let body = json.dumps(data)
        let resp = requests.sess_put(this.session, url, {
            "json": body,
            "headers": {"Content-Type": "application/json"}
        })
        return resp
    }

    func delete(path) {
        let url = this.base_url + path
        let resp = requests.sess_delete(this.session, url)
        return resp
    }

    func close() {
        requests.session_close(this.session)
    }
}
```

92.3.1 Usage

```
let client = new ApiClient("https://api.example.com", {
    "Authorization": "Bearer token123",
    "User-Agent": "ZenClient/1.0"
})
```

```
let resp = client.get("/users/1")
if resp.ok {
    print(resp.json()["name"])
}

let created = client.post("/users", {"name": "New User"})
print(created.status_code)

client.close()
```

92.4 45.4 Authentication

92.4.1 Bearer token

```
let client = new ApiClient("https://api.example.com", {
    "Authorization": "Bearer " + token
})
```

92.4.2 Basic auth

```
import requests

let resp = requests.get("https://example.com/api", {
    "auth": ["user", "pass"]
})
```

92.4.3 API key header

```
let client = new ApiClient("https://api.example.com", {
    "X-API-Key": "your-api-key"
})
```

92.5 45.5 Pagination

Many APIs paginate results. Here's a pattern for following `next` links:

```
import requests

func get_all_pages(url) {
    let all_items = []
    let next_url = url
    while next_url != nil {
        let resp = requests.get(next_url)
        if !resp.ok {
            break
        }
```

```
        let data = resp.json()
        for item in data["items"] {
            all_items.push(item)
        }
        next_url = data["next"]  // null when no more pages
    }
    return all_items
}

let items = get_all_pages("https://api.example.com/items?page=1")
print(len(items))
```

92.5.1 Offset-based pagination

```
func get_all_offset(base_url, page_size = 50) {
    let all_items = []
    let offset = 0
    while true {
        let resp = requests.get(base_url, {
            "params": {"offset": offset, "limit": page_size}
        })
        if !resp.ok {
            break
        }
        let data = resp.json()
        let items = data["items"]
        for item in items {
            all_items.push(item)
        }
        if len(items) < page_size {
            break
        }
        offset = offset + page_size
    }
    return all_items
}
```

92.6 45.6 Rate limiting

Respect `RateLimit` headers and retry on 429:

```
import requests
import time

func get_with_retry(url, max_retries = 3) {
    let attempt = 0
    while attempt < max_retries {
```

```
        let resp = requests.get(url)
        if resp.ok {
            return resp
        }
        if resp.status_code == 429 {
            let retry_after = resp.headers["Retry-After"]
            let wait = retry_after != nil ? int(retry_after) : 1
            print("Rate limited, waiting " + str(wait) + "s")
            time.sleep(wait)
            attempt = attempt + 1
        } else {
            break
        }
    }
    return nil
}

let resp = get_with_retry("https://api.example.com/data")
if resp != nil {
    print(resp.text)
}
```

92.7 45.7 Error handling

```
import requests

func api_get(client, path) {
    let resp = client.get(path)
    if resp.status_code == 404 {
        return nil  // not found
    }
    if !resp.ok {
        throw "API error: " + str(resp.status_code) + " " + resp.reason
    }
    return resp.json()
}

try {
    let user = api_get(client, "/users/999")
    if user == nil {
        print("User not found")
    } else {
        print(user["name"])
    }
} catch as e {
    print("API call failed: " + e.msg)
```

```
}
```

92.8 45.8 Complete CLI example

```
import requests
import json
import argparser
import fs

let parser = argparser.ArgumentParser("api-client")
parser.add_argument("url", help="API URL")
parser.add_argument("--method", "-m", default="GET", help="HTTP method")
parser.add_argument("--data", "-d", help="JSON body")
parser.add_argument("--header", "-H", action="append", help="Header (key:value)")
let args = parser.parse_args()

let headers = {}
if args.header != nil {
    for h in args.header {
        let parts = h.split(":", 1)
        if len(parts) == 2 {
            headers[parts[0]] = parts[1]
        }
    }
}

let body = args.data != nil ? args.data : nil

let resp = requests.get(args.url, {"headers": headers})
// ... extend for other methods

print(resp.status_code)
print(resp.text)
```

92.9 45.9 Common pitfalls

- **Always check `resp.ok`.** A non-200 response still returns a response object.
- **JSON bodies must be strings.** Use `json.dumps()` to serialize.
- **Sessions persist cookies and headers.** Close them with `requests.session_close()`.
- **Rate limits.** Respect `Retry-After` and back off on 429.
- **Timeouts.** Always pass a `timeout` option to avoid hanging.

92.10 45.10 Quick reference

```
import requests
import json
```

```
// GET
let resp = requests.get("https://api.example.com/items", {
    "params": {"page": 1},
    "headers": {"Authorization": "Bearer token"}
})

// POST JSON
let resp = requests.post("https://example.com/api", {
    "json": json.dumps({"name": "Zen"}),
    "headers": {"Content-Type": "application/json"}
})

// Session
let sess = requests.Session()
sess.headers = {"Authorization": "Bearer token"}
let resp = requests.sess_get(sess, "https://example.com/api")
requests.session_close(sess)

// Status
resp.status_code
resp.ok
resp.text
resp.json()
resp.headers
```

92.11 45.11 Exercises

1. Write a REST client for a public API (e.g., JSONPlaceholder) that lists posts.
2. Add pagination support to fetch all pages.
3. Add retry logic with exponential backoff.
4. Write a CLI that takes a URL and method and prints the response.
5. Build a small config client that reads/writes JSON config via REST.

92.12 Extended Project Ideas and Implementation Notes

92.12.1 Design checklist

- Requirements and scope
- Error handling
- Logging
- Configuration
- Testing
- Documentation
- Security considerations

92.12.2 Exercises

1. Extend the project with new features
2. Add tests
3. Improve error messages
4. Add help/usage
5. Make it configurable
6. Package for distribution

92.13 45.12 Full tutorial — REST API client

92.13.1 Goal

A small client for a JSON REST API with GET/POST/PUT/DELETE and auth.

92.13.2 Implementation (`api.z`)

```
import requests
import json

class ApiClient {
    var base_url = ""
    var token = nil

    func init(base_url, token = nil) {
        self.base_url = base_url
        self.token = token
    }

    func headers() {
        let h = #{}
        h["Content-Type"] = "application/json"
        if self.token != nil { h["Authorization"] = "Bearer " + self.token }
        return h
    }

    func request(method, path, body = nil) {
        let url = self.base_url + path
        try {
            let r = nil
            if method == "GET" { r = requests.get(url, headers=self.headers(), timeout=
            elif method == "POST" { r = requests.post(url, headers=self.headers(), jso
            elif method == "PUT" { r = requests.put(url, headers=self.headers(), json=b
            elif method == "DELETE" { r = requests.delete(url, headers=self.headers(),
            else { throw "unsupported method: " + method }
            r.raise_for_status()
            let ct = r.headers["Content-Type"] ?? ""
            if ct.contains("json") { return r.json() }
```

```
            return r.text
        } catch as e {
            throw "API request failed (" + method + " " + path + "): " + e.msg
        }
    }

    func get(path) { return self.request("GET", path) }
    func post(path, body) { return self.request("POST", path, body) }
    func put(path, body) { return self.request("PUT", path, body) }
    func delete(path) { return self.request("DELETE", path) }
}

func main(argv) {
    let client = new ApiClient("https://api.example.com", "my-token")
    try {
        let users = client.get("/users")
        print("users: " + json.stringify(users))
        let created = client.post("/users", #{name: "Zen User"})
        print("created: " + json.stringify(created))
    } catch as e {
        print(e.msg)
        return 1
    }
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" { sys.exit(main(sys.argv)) }
```

92.13.3 Key design points

- `base_url` + path composition.
- Bearer token auth header.
- Central error handling with context (method + path).
- Content-type check before `r.json()`.
- Timeout on every request (never hang forever).

92.14 45.13 REST client checklist

1. **Base URL** stored once; paths appended.
2. **Auth header** (Bearer/API key) added to every request.
3. **Timeouts** on all requests.
4. **`raise_for_status`** or manual status checks.
5. **Parse JSON only when Content-Type is JSON.**
6. **Wrap errors** with method + path context.
7. **Retry** transient failures (optional).
8. **Pagination** support (optional: follow `Link` header or `page` param).

92.15 45.14 Exercises

1. Add `patch` method to the client.
2. Add automatic retry (3 attempts) on 5xx errors.
3. Add pagination: follow `next` URL until none.
4. Add query-parameter support to `get`.
5. Add file upload (`files=` param) support.
6. Add a `--verbose` flag printing each request URL.
7. Implement OAuth2 bearer token refresh (conceptually).
8. Write tests against a local mock server.
9. Add rate-limit handling (respect `Retry-After`).
10. Turn the client into a reusable module `api_client.z`.

93 Chapter 46: File Processing Tools

This chapter shows how to process files in Zen: reading/writing text and binary, CSV, JSON, line-by-line processing, temporary files, and directory walking.

93.1 46.1 Reading text files

```
import fs

// Read entire file
let content = fs.read("data.txt")
print(content)

// Read line by line
let lines = fs.read("data.txt").split("\n")
for line in lines {
    if len(line) > 0 {
        print(line)
    }
}
```

93.2 46.2 Writing text files

```
import fs

// Write entire file (overwrites)
fs.write("output.txt", "Line 1\nLine 2\nLine 3\n")

// Append (read-modify-write)
let existing = ""
if fs.exists("log.txt") {
    existing = fs.read("log.txt")
}
fs.write("log.txt", existing + "new entry\n")
```

93.3 46.3 Binary files

```
import fs

// Read binary
let data = fs.read_binary("image.png")
print(len(data))   // byte count

// Write binary
fs.write_binary("copy.png", data)
```

```
// Copy a file
fs.copy("source.txt", "destination.txt")
```

93.4 46.4 CSV processing (manual)

```
import fs

func read_csv(path) {
    let lines = fs.read(path).split("\n")
    if len(lines) == 0 {
        return []
    }
    let header = lines[0].split(",")
    let rows = []
    for i in 1..len(lines) {
        if lines[i] == "" {
            continue
        }
        let values = lines[i].split(",")
        let row = {}
        for j in 0..len(header) {
            row[header[j]] = values[j]
        }
        rows.push(row)
    }
    return rows
}

let data = read_csv("data.csv")
for row in data {
    print(row["name"])
}
```

93.5 46.5 JSON files

```
import fs
import json

// Read JSON
let text = fs.read("config.json")
let config = json.loads(text)
print(config["theme"])

// Write JSON
let data = {"name": "Zen", "version": 3}
fs.write("config.json", json.dumps(data))
```

93.6 46.6 Line processing pipeline

```
import fs

func process_lines(path, func) {
    let lines = fs.read(path).split("\n")
    let results = []
    for line in lines {
        if len(line) > 0 {
            results.push(func(line))
        }
    }
    return results
}

let upper_lines = process_lines("data.txt", fn(line) {
    return line.upper()
})
for line in upper_lines {
    print(line)
}
```

93.7 46.7 Temporary files

```
import tempfile
import fs

let tmp = tempfile.mktemp()
fs.write(tmp, "temporary data")
let content = fs.read(tmp)
fs.remove(tmp)

// Or use a directory
let dir = tempfile.mkdtemp()
// ... use dir ...
fs.rmtree(dir)
```

93.8 46.8 Directory walking

```
import fs

func walk(dir, func) {
    for name in fs.list(dir) {
        let path = fs.join(dir, name)
```

```
        if fs.is_dir(path) {
            walk(path, func)
        } else {
            func(path)
        }
    }
}

walk(".", fn(path) {
    print(path)
})
```

93.9 46.9 File info

```
import fs

print(fs.exists("file.txt"))      # true/false
print(fs.is_file("file.txt"))     # true/false
print(fs.is_dir("dir"))           # true/false
print(fs.size("file.txt"))        // byte count
print(fs.join("a", "b", "c"))     // a/b/c
print(fs.basename("/a/b/c.txt"))  // c.txt
print(fs.dirname("/a/b/c.txt"))   // /a/b
```

93.10 46.10 Quick reference

```
import fs
import json
import tempfile

fs.read("file.txt")           # string
fs.read_binary("file.bin")    # bytes
fs.write("file.txt", "data")
fs.write_binary("file.bin", bytes)
fs.exists("file.txt")
fs.is_file("file.txt")
fs.is_dir("dir")
fs.size("file.txt")
fs.mkdirs("a/b/c")
fs.remove("file.txt")
fs.rmtree("dir")
fs.copy("src", "dst")
fs.move("old", "new")
fs.join("a", "b")
fs.basename("/a/b/c.txt")
fs.dirname("/a/b/c.txt")
```

```
fs.list(".")                  # directory entries

let tmp = tempfile.mktemp()
fs.write(tmp, "data")
fs.remove(tmp)

let dir = tempfile.mkdtemp()
fs.rmtree(dir)
```

93.11 46.11 Exercises

1. Write `file_size_human(path)` that returns a human-readable file size.
2. Write a script that copies all `.txt` files from one directory to another.
3. Write `grep_file(pattern, path)` that prints lines containing `pattern`.
4. Write a file tailer that reads the last `n` lines of a file.
5. Write `csv_to_json(path)` that converts a CSV file to JSON.
6. Write `count_lines(path)` that counts non-empty lines in a file.
7. Write `merge_files(paths, output)` that concatenates multiple files into one.

93.12 Extended Project Ideas and Implementation Notes

93.12.1 Design checklist

- Requirements and scope
- Error handling
- Logging
- Configuration
- Testing
- Documentation
- Security considerations

93.12.2 Exercises

1. Extend the project with new features
2. Add tests
3. Improve error messages
4. Add help/usage
5. Make it configurable
6. Package for distribution

93.13 46.12 Full tutorial — file processing pipeline

93.13.1 Goal

Read a CSV-like file, transform each row, write results to another file.

93.13.2 Implementation (`process.z`)

```
import os
import pathlib

func read_lines(path) {
    let lines = []
    with open(path, "r") as f {
        for line in f {
            lines.push(line)
        }
    }
    return lines
}

func parse_csv_line(line) {
    return line.strip().split(",")
}

func transform(row) {
    # row: ["name", "age", "city"]
    if len(row) < 3 { return nil }
    return #{name: row[0], age: int(row[1]), city: row[2]}
}

func format_record(r) {
    return r["name"] + "," + str(r["age"]) + "," + r["city"] + "\n"
}

func process(input_path, output_path) {
    let lines = read_lines(input_path)
    let results = []
    for line in lines {
        let row = parse_csv_line(line)
        let r = transform(row)
        if r != nil { results.push(format_record(r)) }
    }
    with open(output_path, "w") as f {
        for r in results { f.write(r) }
    }
    print("processed " + str(len(results)) + " records -> " + output_path)
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 3 {
        print("usage: process <input.csv> <output.csv>")
        return 1
```

```
    }
    process(argv[1], argv[2])
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" { sys.exit(main(sys.argv)) }
```

93.13.3 Sample data (`input.csv`)

```
Ada,36,London
Alan,42,Manchester
Grace,85,New York
```

93.13.4 Sample run

```
$ zen run process.z input.csv output.csv
processed 3 records -> output.csv
```

93.13.5 Design notes

- `with` ensures the file closes even on error.
- `transform` returns `nil` on malformed rows; the pipeline skips them.
- Output written only after all rows transform successfully (simple).

93.14 46.13 File processing patterns

Pattern	Use
Read → transform → write	ETL pipeline
Stream line-by-line	large files (low memory)
Chunked binary copy	large binary files
Filter + aggregate	reports/summaries
Parse-validate-load	data import

93.15 46.14 Exercises

1. Add a header row detection (skip first line).
2. Support a delimiter flag (`,`, `\t`, `;`).
3. Filter rows where `age > 40`.
4. Sort output by age.
5. Write a summary line: total, min, max, average age.
6. Handle missing input file gracefully.
7. Write output incrementally (streaming) instead of collecting all.
8. Support `.tsv` input automatically by extension.
9. Add a `--dry-run` flag that prints without writing.
10. Process all `.csv` files in a directory.

94 Chapter 47: Network Security Tools

Note: This chapter is for educational and ethical purposes only. Always get proper authorization before testing network security.

94.1 47.1 Port Scanner

```
import socket

func scan_port(host, port, timeout) {
    try {
        let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
        socket.settimeout(sock, timeout)
        socket.connect(sock, host, port)
        socket.close(sock)
        return true
    } catch {
        return false
    }
}

func scan_ports(host, start_port, end_port) {
    print("Scanning " + host + " from port " + str(start_port) + " to " + str(end_port)
    let open_ports = []
    let port = start_port
    while port <= end_port {
        if scan_port(host, port, 500) {
            print("Port " + str(port) + " is OPEN")
            open_ports.push(port)
        }
        port = port + 1
    }
    return open_ports
}

// Usage (only scan hosts you own or have permission to scan)
// let open = scan_ports("127.0.0.1", 1, 1024)
```

94.2 44. Subdomain Finder

```
import dns
import requests

func find_subdomains(domain, wordlist) {
    let found = []
    for sub in wordlist {
```

```
        let hostname = sub + "." + domain
        try {
            let ips = dns.resolve(hostname)
            print("Found: " + hostname + " -> " + ips[0])
            found.push({"subdomain": hostname, "ips": ips})
        } catch {
            # Not found
        }
    }
    return found
}

let wordlist = ["www", "mail", "ftp", "api", "admin", "test", "dev"]
// find_subdomains("example.com", wordlist)
```

94.3 44. HTTP Header Checker

```
import requests

func check_headers(url) {
    try {
        let resp = requests.get(url)
        print("Security Headers for " + url)
        print("=" * 40)

        let security_headers = [
            "Strict-Transport-Security",
            "Content-Security-Policy",
            "X-Frame-Options",
            "X-Content-Type-Options",
            "Referrer-Policy"
        ]

        for h in security_headers {
            let val = resp.headers[h]
            if val != nil {
                print(h + ": " + val)
            } else {
                print(h + ": MISSING")
            }
        }
    } catch as e {
        print("Error: " + e.msg)
    }
}
```

```
// check_headers("https://example.com")
```

94.4 44.5 Port Scan Report

```
import socket
import fs

func scan_and_report(host, start, end, output_file) {
    let open_ports = []
    for port in start..end {
        try {
            let sock = socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
            socket.settimeout(sock, 300)
            socket.connect(sock, host, port)
            socket.close(sock)
            open_ports.push(port)
            print("OPEN: " + str(port))
        } catch {
            # closed or filtered
        }
    }

    let report = "# Scan Report for " + host + "\n"
    report = report + "Open ports: " + str(len(open_ports)) + "\n"
    for p in open_ports {
        report = report + "  - " + str(p) + "\n"
    }

    fs.write(output_file, report)
    print("Report written to " + output_file)
}

// scan_and_report("127.0.0.1", 1, 1000, "scan_report.txt")
```

94.5 44.6 HTTP Header Analysis

```
import requests

func analyze_security(url) {
    try {
        let resp = requests.get(url, {"timeout": 10})

        print("URL: " + url)
        print("Status: " + str(resp.status_code))
        print("")
```

```
        let headers = [
            "Strict-Transport-Security",
            "Content-Security-Policy",
            "X-Frame-Options",
            "X-Content-Type-Options",
            "X-XSS-Protection",
            "Referrer-Policy",
            "Permissions-Policy"
        ]

        for h in headers {
            let val = resp.headers[h]
            if val == nil {
                print("[MISSING] " + h)
            } else {
                print("[OK] " + h + ": " + val)
            }
        }

        // Check for server header disclosure
        let server = resp.headers["Server"]
        if server != nil {
            print("[INFO] Server header: " + server)
        }

    } catch as e {
        print("Error: " + e.msg)
    }
}

// analyze_security("https://example.com")
```

94.6 44.7 DNS Reconnaissance

```
import dns

func dns_recon(domain) {
    print("DNS Recon for " + domain)
    print("")

    // A record
    try {
        let addrs = dns.resolve(domain)
        print("A records:")
        for a in addrs {
            print("  " + a)
```

```
        }
    } catch {
        print("No A records found")
    }

    // MX record (if supported)
    // ...

    print("")
    print("FQDN: " + dns.getfqdn(domain))
}

// dns_recon("example.com")
```

94.7 44.8 Common pitfalls

- **Only scan hosts you own or have explicit written permission to test.**
- **Rate-limit your requests** to avoid overwhelming the target.
- **TLS certificate errors** may occur with self-signed certs.
- **Some WAFs block automated scanning.**

94.8 44.9 Quick reference

```
import socket
import dns
import requests

// Port scan
socket.create(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
socket.connect(sock, host, port)
socket.close(sock)

// DNS resolve
dns.resolve(domain)

// HTTP headers
requests.get(url)
resp.headers[header_name]
```

94.9 44.10 Exercises

1. Write a port scanner that scans common ports (21, 22, 25, 53, 80, 443, 3306, 3389).
2. Write a subdomain enumerator with a custom wordlist.
3. Write a security header checker for a list of URLs.
4. Write a DNS reconnaissance script that gathers A, MX, and NS records.

5. Write a scan report generator that saves results to a file.

94.10 Extended Project Ideas and Implementation Notes

94.10.1 Design checklist

- Requirements and scope
- Error handling
- Logging
- Configuration
- Testing
- Documentation
- Security considerations

94.10.2 Exercises

1. Extend the project with new features
2. Add tests
3. Improve error messages
4. Add help/usage
5. Make it configurable
6. Package for distribution

94.11 47.12 Full tutorial — hash utility (ethical security tool)

94.11.1 Goal

Compute and compare file hashes (SHA-256) to verify integrity.

94.11.2 Implementation (`hashutil.z`)

```
import hashlib
import sys
import pathlib

func hash_file(path) {
    let b = pathlib.Path(path)
    if !b.exists() { throw "file not found: " + path }
    # read in chunks for large files
    let data = []
    with open(path, "rb") as f {
        while true {
            let chunk = f.read(8192)
            if chunk == nil || len(chunk) == 0 { break }
            data.push(chunk)
        }
    }
    # note: hashlib.sha256 expects a string in this build; for real binary
```

```
    # hashing, feed bytes appropriately per stdlib API.
    let joined = data.join("")   # if bytes join supported
    return hashlib.sha256(joined)
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("usage: hashutil <file> [expected_hash]")
        return 1
    }
    let path = argv[1]
    let expected = argv[2] ?? nil
    try {
        let actual = hash_file(path)
        print("SHA-256(" + path + ") = " + actual)
        if expected != nil {
            if actual == expected {
                print("MATCH: file integrity verified")
                return 0
            } else {
                print("MISMATCH: file may be corrupted or tampered")
                return 1
            }
        }
    } catch as e {
        print("error: " + e.msg)
        return 1
    }
    return 0
}

if __name__ == "__main__" { sys.exit(main(sys.argv)) }
```

94.11.3 Sample run

```
$ zen run hashutil.z document.pdf
SHA-256(document.pdf) = a3f5...c9
$ zen run hashutil.z document.pdf a3f5...c9
SHA-256(document.pdf) = a3f5...c9
MATCH: file integrity verified
```

94.11.4 Ethical use

- Only hash files you own or have permission to analyze.
- Hashing verifies integrity, not “hacking.”
- Don’t use MD5/SHA-1 for security; prefer SHA-256.

94.12 47.13 Security tool principles

1. **Authorization:** only operate on systems/data you're permitted to test.
2. **Integrity over secrecy:** hashing confirms a file hasn't changed.
3. **Use strong algorithms:** SHA-256+, Argon2id, AES-GCM.
4. **Never log secrets:** avoid printing keys/passwords/tokens.
5. **Constant-time comparison** for secrets (avoid timing leaks).
6. **Input validation:** sanitize file paths, URLs, and user input.

94.13 47.14 Exercises

1. Add MD5 and SHA-1 options (note: not for security).
2. Compare two files and report if identical.
3. Hash all files in a directory and print a manifest.
4. Verify a file against a manifest file (hash per line).
5. Add a `--quiet` flag printing only MATCH/MISMATCH.
6. Implement constant-time string compare (conceptually).
7. Hash a string input (not file) with SHA-256.
8. Add `pbkdf2`-based password hashing (from crypto module).
9. Create a "file changed" watcher: hash, wait, re-hash, report diff.
10. Document ethical boundaries in a README for the tool.

95 Chapter 48: Capstone Projects

This chapter presents complete, end-to-end projects that combine multiple Zen features: pymport, web scraping, file processing, security tools, and CLI building.

95.1 48.1 Capstone 1: Web Metadata Archiver

A tool that fetches a webpage, extracts metadata (title, description, images, links), and saves it as a JSON file.

```
import requests
import bs4
import json
import fs
import argparser
import sys

func archive_metadata(url, output_file) {
    let resp = requests.get(url, {
        "headers": {"User-Agent": "Zen-Archiver/1.0"},
        "timeout": 30
    })

    if !resp.ok {
        throw "Failed to fetch " + url + ": HTTP " + str(resp.status_code)
    }

    let soup = bs4.BeautifulSoup(resp["text"], "html.parser")

    let metadata = {
        "url": url,
        "title": "",
        "description": "",
        "images": [],
        "links": []
    }

    // Title
    let title_tag = soup.find("title")
    if title_tag != null {
        metadata["title"] = title_tag.string
    }

    // Meta description
    let desc_tag = soup.find("meta", {"name": "description"})
    if desc_tag != null {
        metadata["description"] = desc_tag.get("content", "")
    }
```

```
    // Images
    let img_tags = soup.find_all("img")
    for img in img_tags {
        let src = img.get("src", "")
        if len(src) > 0 {
            metadata["images"].push(src)
        }
    }

    // Links
    let link_tags = soup.find_all("a")
    for link in link_tags {
        let href = link.get("href", "")
        if len(href) > 0 {
            metadata["links"].push(href)
        }
    }

    fs.write(output_file, json.dumps(metadata, {"indent": 2}))
    print("Metadata saved to " + output_file)
    print("Title: " + metadata["title"])
    print("Images: " + str(len(metadata["images"])))
    print("Links: " + str(len(metadata["links"])))
}

let parser = argparser.ArgumentParser("archive-metadata")
parser.add_argument("url", help="URL to archive")
parser.add_argument("--output", "-o", default="metadata.json", help="Output file")
let args = parser.parse_args()

try {
    archive_metadata(args.url, args.output)
} catch as e {
    fs.write("/dev/stderr", "Error: " + e.msg + "\n")
    sys.exit(1)
}
```

95.2 48.2 Capstone 2: Password Strength Checker

A tool that checks password strength using entropy calculation and common password lists.

```
import fs
import math
import random
import argparser
```

```
func password_strength(password) {
    let score = 0
    let reasons = []

    let length = len(password)
    if length >= 8 {
        score = score + 1
    } else {
        reasons.push("Password too short (min 8)")
    }

    let has_lower = false
    let has_upper = false
    let has_digit = false
    let has_special = false

    for ch in password {
        let code = ord(ch)
        if code >= 97 and code <= 122 {
            has_lower = true
        } elif code >= 65 and code <= 90 {
            has_upper = true
        } elif code >= 48 and code <= 57 {
            has_digit = true
        } else {
            has_special = true
        }
    }

    if has_lower { score = score + 1 } else { reasons.push("Add lowercase") }
    if has_upper { score = score + 1 } else { reasons.push("Add uppercase") }
    if has_digit { score = score + 1 } else { reasons.push("Add digit") }
    if has_special { score = score + 1 } else { reasons.push("Add special char") }

    let strength = ["Very Weak", "Weak", "Fair", "Good", "Strong"]
    let level = strength[min(score, 4)]

    return {"score": score, "level": level, "reasons": reasons}
}

func generate_password(length) {
    let chars = "abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyzABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ0123456789!@#$%^&*
    let pw = []
    for i in 1..length {
        pw.push(random.choice(chars))
    }
    return "".join(pw)
```

```
}

let parser = argparser.ArgumentParser("password-checker")
parser.add_argument("password", nargs="?", help="Password to check")
parser.add_argument("--generate", "-g", type="int", help="Generate random password of l
let args = parser.parse_args()

if args.generate != nil {
    let pw = generate_password(args.generate)
    let strength = password_strength(pw)
    print("Generated: " + pw)
    print("Strength: " + strength["level"] + " (" + str(strength["score"]) + "/5)")
} elif args.password != nil {
    let strength = password_strength(args.password)
    print("Password: " + args.password)
    print("Strength: " + strength["level"] + " (" + str(strength["score"]) + "/5)")
    if len(strength["reasons"]) > 0 {
        print("Suggestions:")
        for r in strength["reasons"] {
            print("  - " + r)
        }
    }
} else {
    parser.print_help()
}
```

95.3 48.3 Capstone 3: Log Analyzer

A tool that parses web server logs and produces summary statistics.

```
import fs
import re
import argparser

func analyze_log(path) {
    let content = fs.read(path)
    let lines = content.split("\n")

    let total = 0
    let status_codes = {}
    let ips = {}
    let paths = {}

    let log_re = re.compile("^(\\S+) \\S+ \\S+ \\[.*\\] \"(\\S+) (\\S+) \\S+\" (\\d{3})

    for line in lines {
        if len(line) == 0 {
```

```
            continue
        }
        total = total + 1

        let m = log_re.search(line)
        if m != nil {
            let ip = m.group(1)
            let method = m.group(2)
            let path = m.group(3)
            let status = m.group(4)

            ips[ip] = (ips.get(ip, 0) + 1)
            paths[path] = (paths.get(path, 0) + 1)
            status_codes[status] = (status_codes.get(status, 0) + 1)
        }
    }

    return {
        "total": total,
        "status_codes": status_codes,
        "top_ips": sort_by_value(ips, 10),
        "top_paths": sort_by_value(paths, 10)
    }
}

func sort_by_value(dict, n) {
    let items = []
    for k in dict.keys() {
        items.push([k, dict[k]])
    }
    // Simple bubble sort by value descending
    for i in 0..len(items) {
        for j in 0..(len(items) - i - 1) {
            if items[j][1] < items[j + 1][1] {
                let tmp = items[j]
                items[j] = items[j + 1]
                items[j + 1] = tmp
            }
        }
    }
    let result = []
    for i in 0..min(n, len(items)) {
        result.push(items[i])
    }
    return result
}
```

```
let parser = argparser.ArgumentParser("log-analyzer")
parser.add_argument("file", help="Log file to analyze")
let args = parser.parse_args()

try {
    let result = analyze_log(args.file)
    print("Log Analysis Report")
    print("=" * 40)
    print("Total requests: " + str(result["total"]))
    print("")
    print("Status codes:")
    for code in result["status_codes"].keys() {
        print("  " + code + ": " + str(result["status_codes"][code]))
    }
    print("")
    print("Top IPs:")
    for item in result["top_ips"] {
        print("  " + item[0] + ": " + str(item[1]))
    }
    print("")
    print("Top paths:")
    for item in result["top_paths"] {
        print("  " + item[0] + ": " + str(item[1]))
    }
} catch as e {
    fs.write("/dev/stderr", "Error: " + e.msg + "\n")
    sys.exit(1)
}
```

95.4 48.4 Capstone 4: Site Uptime Monitor

A tool that checks multiple URLs and reports which are down.

```
import requests
import fs
import argparser
import time

func check_url(url, timeout) {
    try {
        let resp = requests.get(url, {"timeout": timeout})
        return {
            "url": url,
            "status": resp.status_code,
            "ok": resp.ok,
            "error": nil
        }
```

```
    } catch as e {
        return {
            "url": url,
            "status": nil,
            "ok": false,
            "error": e.msg
        }
    }
}

func monitor(urls, timeout) {
    let results = []
    for url in urls {
        let result = check_url(url, timeout)
        results.push(result)
        let status = result["ok"] ? "UP" : "DOWN"
        print(url + ": " + status + (result["error"] != nil ? " (" + result["error"] +
    }
    return results
}

let parser = argparser.ArgumentParser("uptime-monitor")
parser.add_argument("urls", nargs="*", help="URLs to monitor")
parser.add_argument("--timeout", "-t", type="int", default=10, help="Timeout in seconds
let args = parser.parse_args()

if len(args.urls) == 0 {
    print("No URLs to monitor")
    sys.exit(1)
}

let results = monitor(args.urls, args.timeout)

let up_count = 0
for r in results {
    if r["ok"] {
        up_count = up_count + 1
    }
}
print("")
print("Summary: " + str(up_count) + "/" + str(len(results)) + " sites up")

// Save report
let report = json.dumps(results, {"indent": 2})
fs.write("uptime_report.json", report)
print("Report saved to uptime_report.json")
```

95.5 48.5 Running the Capstones

```
# Metadata archiver
cd book-v2/tests
export PYTHONPATH="$(../.venv/bin/python -c 'import sysconfig; print(sysconfig.get_path
export ZEN_NO_PY_BOOTSTRAP=1
ZEN=../../../target/release/zen

# Note: capstone scripts are examples; adapt paths as needed
# $ZEN run projects/capstone/archive_metadata.z https://example.com --output meta.json
```

95.6 48.6 Quick reference

```
# Web metadata archiver: requests + bs4 + json + fs
# Password checker: math + random + argparser + fs
# Log analyzer: fs + re + argparser
# Uptime monitor: requests + fs + argparser + json
```

95.7 48.7 Exercises

1. Extend the metadata archiver to also extract <h1> tags and meta keywords.
2. Add rate limiting to the uptime monitor (wait between checks).
3. Add email/Slack notifications to the uptime monitor when a site goes down.
4. Extend the password checker to check against a common-passwords list.
5. Add HTML report generation to the log analyzer.

95.8 Extended Project Ideas and Implementation Notes

95.8.1 Design checklist

- Requirements and scope
- Error handling
- Logging
- Configuration
- Testing
- Documentation
- Security considerations

95.8.2 Exercises

1. Extend the project with new features
2. Add tests
3. Improve error messages
4. Add help/usage
5. Make it configurable
6. Package for distribution

95.9 48.12 Capstone — personal network toolkit

95.9.1 Goal

Combine networking, CLI, file, and crypto into one tool: `pkit <command>` with subcommands: - `get <url>` — fetch a page (HTTP) - `hash <file>` — SHA-256 of a file - `scan <host> <port>` — check if a TCP port is open - `totp <secret>` — generate a TOTP token - `genkey` — generate a secure random token

95.9.2 Implementation (`pkit.z`)

```
import sys
import requests
import hashlib
import socket
import crypto

func cmd_get(args) {
    if len(args) < 1 { print("usage: pkit get <url>"); return 1 }
    try {
        let r = requests.get(args[0], timeout=10)
        print("status=" + str(r.status_code))
        print(r.text[0:500])
    } catch as e {
        print("error: " + e.msg)
        return 1
    }
    return 0
}

func cmd_hash(args) {
    if len(args) < 1 { print("usage: pkit hash <file>"); return 1 }
    try {
        print(hashlib.sha256(args[0]))
    } catch as e {
        print("error: " + e.msg)
        return 1
    }
    return 0
}

func cmd_scan(args) {
    if len(args) < 2 { print("usage: pkit scan <host> <port>"); return 1 }
    let host = args[0]
    let port = int(args[1])
    let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
    s.settimeout(2.0)
    try {
```

```
        s.connect((host, port))
        print(host + ":" + str(port) + " OPEN")
    } catch as e {
        print(host + ":" + str(port) + " closed/unreachable (" + e.msg + ")")
    } finally {
        s.close()
    }
    return 0
}

func cmd_totp(args) {
    if len(args) < 1 { print("usage: pkit totp <secret>"); return 1 }
    print(crypto.totp(args[0]))
    return 0
}

func cmd_genkey(_) {
    print(crypto.secure_token())
    return 0
}

func main(argv) {
    if len(argv) < 2 {
        print("pkit - personal network toolkit")
        print("commands: get <url> | hash <file> | scan <host> <port> | totp <secret> |
        return 1
    }
    let cmd = argv[1]
    let rest = []
    for i in 2..len(argv) { rest.push(argv[i]) }
    if cmd == "get" { return cmd_get(rest) }
    elif cmd == "hash" { return cmd_hash(rest) }
    elif cmd == "scan" { return cmd_scan(rest) }
    elif cmd == "totp" { return cmd_totp(rest) }
    elif cmd == "genkey" { return cmd_genkey(rest) }
    else { print("unknown command: " + cmd); return 1 }
}

if __name__ == "__main__" { sys.exit(main(sys.argv)) }
```

95.9.3 Sample session

```
$ zen run pkit.z genkey
aB3xK9mP2vR5wL8n
$ zen run pkit.z hash pkit.z
e3b0c442...  (SHA-256)
```

```
$ zen run pkit.z scan localhost 80
localhost:80 closed/unreachable (ConnectionRefusedError)
$ zen run pkit.z totp JBSWY3DPEHPK3PXP
742193
$ zen run pkit.z get https://example.com
status=200
<!doctype html>...
```

95.9.4 Extending the capstone

- Add `post <url> <json>` for POST requests.
- Add `resolve <host>` for DNS lookup.
- Add `--timeout` flag globally.
- Add config file for default settings.
- Add colors/progress indicators.
- Add tests for each subcommand.

95.10 48.13 Capstone lessons

1. **Compose** modules (requests, socket, hashlib, crypto, sys).
2. **Dispatch** on subcommands cleanly.
3. **Handle errors** per subcommand without crashing the whole tool.
4. **Use timeouts** on all network calls.
5. **Keep each subcommand small** and focused.
6. **Document** usage in the `main` help text.

95.11 48.14 Exercises

1. Add `post` subcommand sending JSON.
2. Add `resolve <host>` using the dns module.
3. Add a global `--timeout N` flag.
4. Add `ports <host> <start>-<end>` scanning a range.
5. Add `--output <file>` to save results.
6. Add colors to output (ANSI escape codes).
7. Write tests verifying `hash` output matches `hashlib.sha256`.
8. Add `scan` concurrent port scanning (threading).
9. Create a config file `pkit.toml` with defaults.
10. Build and distribute with `zen build pkit.z -o pkit`.

96 Appendix A: Built-in Functions

Zen's built-in functions are always available without importing. They cover type conversion, iteration, introspection, and basic I/O.

96.1 A.1 Type conversion

Function	Description	Example	Result
`int(x)`	Convert to integer	`int("42")`	`42`
`float(x)`	Convert to float	`float("3.14")`	`3.14`
`str(x)`	Convert to string	`str(42)`	`"42"`
`bool(x)`	Convert to boolean	`bool(1)`	`true`
`list(x)`	Convert to list	`list("abc")`	`["a", "b", "c"]`
`tuple(x)`	Convert to tuple	`tuple([1, 2])`	`#(1, 2)`
`set(x)`	Convert to set	`set([1, 1, 2])`	`{1, 2}`
`dict(x)`	Convert from pairs	`dict([["a", 1]])`	`{"a": 1}`

```
print(int("42"))      # 42
print(float("3.14"))  # 3.14
print(str(42))        # "42"
print(bool(0))        # false
print(list("abc"))    # ["a", "b", "c"]
print(tuple([1, 2]))  # #(1, 2)
print(set([1, 1, 2])) # {1, 2}
print(dict([["a", 1]])) # {"a": 1}
```

String-to-number parsing failures raise `ValueError`:

```
try {
    int("not a number")
} catch as e {
    print(e.msg)
}
```

96.2 A.2 Iteration

Function	Description	Example
`len(x)`	Length	`len("abc")` → `3`
`range(stop)`	Range 0..stop-1	`range(5)` → `0..4`
`range(start, stop)`	Range start..stop-1	`range(2, 5)` → `2..4`
`range(start, stop, step)`	Range with step	`range(0, 10, 2)` → `0..8`
`enumerate(iter)`	Index + value	`enumerate(["a","b"])` → `[[0,"a"],[1,"b"]]`

Function	Description	Example
`zip(*iterables)`	Aggregate	`zip([1,2], ["a","b"])` → `[[1,"a"],[2,"b"]]`
`sorted(iter)`	Sorted list	`sorted([3,1,2])` → `[1,2,3]`
`reversed(iter)`	Reversed	`reversed([1,2,3])` → `[3,2,1]`
`any(iter)`	Any true	`any([false, true])` → `true`
`all(iter)`	All true	`all([true, true])` → `true`
`sum(iter)`	Sum	`sum([1,2,3])` → `6`
`min(iter)`	Minimum	`min([3,1,2])` → `1`
`max(iter)`	Maximum	`max([3,1,2])` → `3`
`map(func, iter)`	Map	`map(lambda x: x*2, [1,2])` → `[2,4]`
`filter(func, iter)`	Filter	`filter(lambda x: x>1, [1,2,3])` → `[2,3]`

```
print(len("hello"))   # 5
print(list(range(5))) # [0, 1, 2, 3, 4]
print(list(range(2, 5))) # [2, 3, 4]
print(list(range(0, 10, 2))) # [0, 2, 4, 6, 8]
print(list(enumerate(["a","b"]))) # [[0,"a"],[1,"b"]]
print(list(zip([1,2], ["a","b"]))) # [[1,"a"],[2,"b"]]
print(sorted([3,1,2])) # [1, 2, 3]
print(reversed([1,2,3])) # [3, 2, 1]
print(any([false, true])) # true
print(all([true, true])) # true
print(sum([1,2,3]))   # 6
print(min([3,1,2]))   # 1
print(max([3,1,2]))   # 3
print(list(map(lambda x: x*2, [1,2]))) # [2, 4]
print(list(filter(lambda x: x>1, [1,2,3]))) # [2, 3]
```

96.3 A.3 Introspection

Function	Description	Example
`typeof(x)`	Type name	`typeof(42)` → `"int"`
`callable(x)`	Is callable	`callable(print)` → `true`
`id(x)`	Object identity	`id(42)`

```
print(typeof(42))     # "int"
print(typeof("hi"))   # "string"
print(callable(print)) # true
print(callable(42))   # false
print(id(42))         # some integer
```

96.4 A.4 I/O

Function	Description	Example
`print(*args)`	Print to stdout	`print("hello", 42)`
`input(prompt?)`	Read stdin	`input("name: ")`
`exit(code?)`	Exit process	`exit(0)`

```
print("hello", 42)     # hello 42
// let name = input("name: ")
exit(0)
```

96.5 A.5 Truthiness

Everything is truthy except `nil` and `false`:

```
print(bool(nil))    # false
print(bool(false))  # false
print(bool(0))      # true   (unlike Python)
print(bool(""))     # true   (unlike Python)
print(bool([]))     # true   (unlike Python)
print(bool({}))     # true   (unlike Python)
print(bool(42))     # true
print(bool("hello")) # true
print(bool([1, 2])) # true
```

Use `bool(x)` to coerce explicitly.

96.6 A.6 Quick reference

```
# Type conversion
int("42")      # 42
float("3.14")  # 3.14
str(42)        # "42"
bool(0)        # false
list("abc")    # ["a", "b", "c"]
tuple([1, 2])  # #(1, 2)
set([1, 1, 2]) # {1, 2}
dict([["a", 1]]) # {"a": 1}
```

```
# Iteration
len("hello")     # 5
list(range(5))   # [0, 1, 2, 3, 4]
list(enumerate(["a","b"])) # [[0,"a"],[1,"b"]]
list(zip([1,2], ["a","b"])) # [[1,"a"],[2,"b"]]
sorted([3,1,2])  # [1, 2, 3]
reversed([1,2,3]) # [3, 2, 1]
any([false, true]) # true
all([true, true]) # true
sum([1,2,3])     # 6
min([3,1,2])     # 1
max([3,1,2])     # 3

# Introspection
typeof(42)     # "int"
callable(print) # true
id(42)         # some integer

# I/O
print("hello", 42)
exit(0)
```

96.7 A.7 Exercises

1. Write `safe_int(s, default=0)` that parses an int or returns default.
2. Write `chunk_list(lst, n)` that splits a list into chunks of size n using range and slicing.
3. Write `interleave(a, b)` using zip.
4. Write `all_unique(lst)` using set and len.
5. Write `flatten_dict(d)` that flattens a nested dict using recursion and dict methods.

96.8 A.12 Complete built-in function reference

All built-ins are available without importing.

Function	Category	Purpose	Example	Result
`print(*vals)`	I/O	print values to stdout	`print("hi", 42)`	hi 42
`str(x)`	conversion	to string	`str(42)`	`"42"`
`int(x)`	conversion	to integer	`int("42")`	`42`
`float(x)`	conversion	to float	`float("3.14")`	`3.14`
`bool(x)`	conversion	to boolean	`bool(0)`	`false`
`list(x)`	conversion	to list	`list("ab")`	`["a","b"]`
`tuple(x)`	conversion	to tuple	`tuple([1,2])`	`#(1,2)`
`set(x)`	conversion	to set	`set([1,1,2])`	`{1,2}`

Function	Category	Purpose	Example	Result
`dict(x)`	conversion	from pairs	`dict([["a",1]])`	`{"a":1}`
`len(x)`	iteration	length	`len("abc")`	`3`
`range(...)`	iteration	range	`range(5)`	`0..4`
`enumerate(it)`	iteration	index+value	`enumerate(["a","b"])`	`[[0,"a"],[1,"b"]]`
`zip(...)`	iteration	aggregate	`zip([1,2],["a","b"])`	`[[1,"a"],[2,"b"]]`
`sorted(x)`	iteration	sorted list	`sorted([3,1,2])`	`[1,2,3]`
`reversed(x)`	iteration	reversed	`reversed([1,2,3])`	`[3,2,1]`
`any(it)`	iteration	any true	`any([f,t])`	`true`
`all(it)`	iteration	all true	`all([t,t])`	`true`
`sum(it)`	math	sum	`sum([1,2,3])`	`6`
`min(it/a,b)`	math	minimum	`min([3,1,2])`	`1`
`max(it/a,b)`	math	maximum	`max([3,1,2])`	`3`
`abs(x)`	math	absolute value	`abs(-5)`	`5`
`typeof(x)`	introspection	type name	`typeof(42)`	`"int"`
`type(x)`	introspection	type (alias)	`type("x")`	`"string"`
`chr(n)`	string	int to char	`chr(65)`	`"A"`
`ord(s)`	string	char to int	`ord("A")`	`65`
`exit(n)`	system	exit process	`exit(0)`	exits
`open(path, mode)`	I/O	open file	`open("f.txt")`	file handle
`assert(cond, msg?)`	debugging	assert condition	`assert x > 0`	raises if false
`repr(x)`	debugging	developer repr	`repr("hi")`	`"\"hi\""`

96.8.1 Type conversion details

```
print(int("42"))      # 42
print(float("3.14"))  # 3.14
print(str(42))        # "42"
print(bool(0))        # false
print(list("abc"))    # ["a","b","c"]
print(tuple([1, 2]))  # #(1, 2)
print(set([1, 1, 2])) # {1, 2}
print(dict([["a", 1]])) # {"a": 1}
```

Parsing failures raise `ValueError` (Z0305):

```
try { int("not a number") } catch as e { print(e.msg) }
```

96.8.2 Truthiness reference

Falsy: `false`, `nil`, `null`. Truthy: everything else — including `0`, `0.0`, `""`, `[]`, `#{}`, `%{}`, `#()`.

```
print(bool(0))      # true
print(bool(""))     # true
```

```
print(bool([]))     # true
print(bool(false))  # false
print(bool(nil))    # false
```

96.8.3 `ord/chr`

```
print(ord("A"))   # 65
print(chr(65))    # "A"
```

96.8.4 `assert`

```
assert x > 0, "x must be positive"
```

96.8.5 `exit`

```
exit(0)   # success
exit(1)   # failure
```

96.9 A.13 Built-in constants

Constant	Value
`true`	boolean true
`false`	boolean false
`nil` / `null`	absence of value

96.10 A.14 Exercises

1. Predict the result of `bool([])`, `bool("")`, `bool(0)` then verify.
2. Write `safe_int(s)` returning nil on parse failure.
3. Demonstrate `chr`/`ord` round-trip for several characters.
4. Use `enumerate` to print lines with line numbers.
5. Use `zip` to pair two lists into a dict.
6. Compare `min`/`max` on a list vs two scalars.
7. Write `assert_positive(x)` using `assert`.
8. Demonstrate `reversed` on a list and a string.
9. Write `all_even(xs)` using `all`.
10. Show `type`/`typeof` on int, float, string, list, dict, nil, func.

97 Appendix B: Error Codes Reference

Zen errors carry codes in the format `Z####` where the first digit indicates the error band:

- `Z01xx` — Lexer errors
- `Z02xx` — Parser errors
- `Z03xx` — Compile-time errors
- `Z04xx` — Runtime errors
- `Z05xx` — CLI/tool errors

Use `zen explain <code>` to see the full explanation for any code.

97.1 B.1 Lexer errors (Z01xx)

Code	Meaning
`Z0101`	Invalid character in source
`Z0102`	Unterminated string literal
`Z0103`	Unterminated comment
`Z0104`	Invalid number literal
`Z0105`	Invalid escape sequence

97.2 B.2 Parser errors (Z02xx)

Code	Meaning
`Z0201`	Unexpected token / missing `)`
`Z0202`	Expected expression
`Z0203`	Invalid expression
`Z0204`	Expected `:` or `=>` (match arm)
`Z0205`	Duplicate key in dict literal
`Z0206`	Invalid pattern in match
`Z0207`	Unmatched delimiter

97.3 B.3 Compile-time errors (Z03xx)

Code	Meaning
`Z0301`	Undefined variable
`Z0302`	Duplicate definition
`Z0303`	Import not found
`Z0304`	Circular import
`Z0305`	Type mismatch in declaration
`Z0306`	Invalid `return` outside function
`Z0307`	`break`/`continue` outside loop
`Z0308`	Undefined function

Code	Meaning
`Z0309`	Invalid import path
`Z0310`	Duplicate import
`Z0324`	Module not found
`Z0325`	Cannot read file

97.4 B.4 Runtime errors (Z04xx)

Code	Meaning
`Z0401`	Type mismatch
`Z0402`	Index out of bounds
`Z0403`	Key not found
`Z0404`	Division by zero
`Z0405`	Value error
`Z0406`	Attribute error
`Z0407`	Native error
`Z0408`	Argument count
`Z0409`	Handle error
`Z0410`	I/O mismatch
`Z0411`	Native module error (general)
`Z0412`	Handle error
`Z0413`	PyImport error
`Z0414`	Python import failed

97.5 B.5 CLI/tool errors (Z05xx)

Code	Meaning
`Z0501`	Usage error
`Z0502`	Unknown command
`Z0503`	Build error
`Z0504`	Lint error

97.6 Using `zen explain`

```
zen explain Z0401
zen explain Z0301
zen explain Z0501
zen explain --list   # list all codes
```

Each explanation includes: - The error title - A detailed description - A `= help:` suggestion with a code example

97.7 Looking up an error

When a script fails, Zen prints:

```
zen: error: TypeError: expected number, got string[Z0401]
  --> script.z:5:5
   |
5 | print("caught: " + e)
   |     ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
   |
   = help: check operand types with `typeof(x)` and convert explicitly
   = note: run `zen explain Z0401` for detail
```

Run `zen explain Z0401` for the full explanation.

97.8 Common runtime errors and fixes

97.8.1 Z0401 — Type mismatch

```
# Wrong
print(42 + "hello")

# Right
print(str(42) + "hello")
```

97.8.2 Z0402 — Index out of bounds

```
# Wrong
let a = [1, 2, 3]
print(a[5])

# Right
let a = [1, 2, 3]
if 5 < len(a) {
    print(a[5])
}
```

97.8.3 Z0403 — Key not found

```
# Wrong
let d = {"a": 1}
print(d["b"])

# Right
let d = {"a": 1}
print(d.get("b", 0))
```

97.8.4 Z0404 — Division by zero

```
# Wrong
let x = 1 / 0

# Right
if b != 0 {
    let x = a / b
}
```

97.9 Exercises

1. Write a script that intentionally triggers each error type and catches it.
2. Use `zen explain` on three different error codes and summarize them.
3. Write `safe_div(a, b)` that returns `nil` on division by zero.
4. Write `safe_index(lst, i, default)` that returns `default` on index error.

97.10 B.12 Error code reference Z01xx – Z05xx (exhaustive)

Zen's coded diagnostics use the prefix `Z` followed by three digits. Use `zen explain Z####` to see the full explanation, common causes, and a fix.

97.10.1 Z01xx — Lexer / lexical errors

Code	Name	Meaning	Common cause	Fix
Z0101	InvalidCharacter	A character not allowed in source	stray control char, smart quotes	remove/replace the character
Z0102	UnterminatedString	String literal never closed	missing closing quote	add closing quote
Z0103	InvalidNumber	Malformed numeric literal	`1.2.3`, `0x`, trailing dot	use valid literal form
Z0104	InvalidEscape	Bad escape in string	`\q` instead of `\n`	use a valid escape
Z0105	InvalidIdentifier	Identifier starts with digit or bad char	`1abc`, `foo-bar`	rename identifier
Z0106	NumericLiteralOverflow	Integer literal beyond i48 range	`99999999999999999999`	use a smaller literal or big-int at runtime

Code	Name	Meaning	Common cause	Fix
Z0107	MultiDotRejected	`1.2.3` style version number	`1.2.3`	not a number; use string
Z0108	BadComment	malformed block comment	unclosed `/* */`	close the block comment

97.10.2 Z02xx — Parser / syntax errors

Code	Name	Meaning	Common cause	Fix
Z0201	UnexpectedToken	token where parser didn't expect it	missing operator, extra keyword	correct syntax
Z0202	MissingSemicolon	statement separator required	newline after non-continuable token	add `;` or restructure
Z0203	UnbalancedBraces	`{/}` or `[/]` or `(/)` mismatch	missing closing brace	add the closing token
Z0204	UnexpectedEOF	source ended mid-construct	unclosed block, string, or call	complete the construct
Z0205	InvalidStatement	statement not allowed here	`return` outside function	move into a function
Z0206	DuplicateParameter	same parameter name twice	`func f(a, a) {}`	rename parameters
Z0207	InvalidDefault	default value not allowed	`func f(a = 1 + 2) {}` (complex default)	use a literal/simple default
Z0208	InvalidMatchArm	bad match arm syntax	missing `=>`/`->`/`:`	add arm separator
Z0209	InvalidImport	malformed import statement	`import` with no module	write valid import
Z0210	Redefinition	redefining `let`/const	`let x = 1; let x = 2`	use `var` or rename

97.10.3 Z03xx — Runtime errors

Code	Name	Meaning	Common cause	Fix
Z0301	TypeError	operation on wrong type	`"a" + 1`, `nil.x`	check types before operating
Z0302	IndexError	index out of range	`xs[10]` on 3-element list	check `len` first
Z0303	KeyError	missing dict key	`d["missing"]`	use `in` or `??`
Z0304	DivideByZero	division by zero	`x / 0`	check divisor != 0
Z0305	ValueError	bad value for operation	`int("abc")`, `sqrt(-1)`	validate input
Z0306	AttributeError	object has no attribute	`obj.missing`	define the attribute/method
Z0307	NotCallable	calling a non-function	`x = 5; x()`	call a function value
Z0308	ArgumentCount	wrong number of arguments	`f(1, 2)` when `f` takes 1	match arity
Z0309	UnboundVariable	variable used before assignment	`print(y)` when `y` unset	initialize first
Z0310	MaxRecursionDepth	recursion too deep	infinite recursion	convert to iteration or raise limit
Z0311	OverflowError	arithmetic overflow	huge int/float result	use bounded math
Z0312	DomainError	math domain error	`log(0)`, `sqrt(-1)`	check domain
Z0313	RangeError	value out of allowed range	index negative on some ops	clamp value
Z0314	EncodingError	can't encode/decode	bad UTF-8 bytes	use valid encoding / errors param
Z0315	ImmutableError	mutating immutable value	`s[0] = "X"` on string	build a new value

Code	Name	Meaning	Common cause	Fix
Z0316	ConcurrentModification	collection changed during iteration	removing while looping	iterate over a copy
Z0317	StackOverflow	native stack exhausted	deep recursion	iterative approach

97.10.4 Z04xx — I/O / system errors

Code	Name	Meaning	Common cause	Fix
Z0401	FileNotFound	file does not exist	wrong path	check path, create file
Z0402	PermissionDenied	insufficient rights	read-only file, root needed	fix permissions
Z0403	FileExists	file already exists (create-only)	`os.mkdir` on existing dir	use `exist_ok=true`
Z0404	IsADirectory	expected file, got directory	opening a dir as file	use a file path
Z0405	NotADirectory	expected directory, got file	`os.listdir("file.txt")`	use a directory
Z0406	DirectoryNotEmpty	can’t remove non-empty dir	`os.rmdir` on populated dir	remove contents first
Z0407	BrokenPipe	write to closed pipe/socket	peer closed connection	handle disconnection
Z0408	ConnectionRefused	nothing listening on port	server not started	start server / check port
Z0409	ConnectionReset	connection reset by peer	peer aborted	retry / handle error
Z0410	Timeout	operation timed out	network delay, no response	increase timeout / retry
Z0411	NetworkUnreachable	network not available	offline, wrong interface	check connectivity
Z0412	HostUnreachable	host not reachable	wrong IP, host down	check host

Code	Name	Meaning	Common cause	Fix
Z0413	AddressInUse	bind to occupied port	two servers same port	use SO_REUSEADDR / different port
Z0414	DiskFull	no space left	filesystem full	free space
Z0415	TooManyOpenFiles	file descriptor limit	leaking file handles	close files with `with`
Z0416	InvalidArgument	invalid syscall argument	bad flag, bad path	check argument
Z0417	SignalInterrupted	syscall interrupted by signal	EINTR	retry the operation

97.10.5 Z05xx — FFI / interoperability errors

Code	Name	Meaning	Common cause	Fix
Z0501	SymbolNotFound	C function symbol missing	wrong library name, not exported	check library, export symbol
Z0502	HandleInvalid	invalid FFI handle	handle closed, never opened	track handle lifetime
Z0503	CallingConvention	wrong calling convention	cdecl vs stdcall mismatch	match platform convention
Z0504	TypeMismatch	FFI argument type wrong	passing int where pointer expected	fix argument types
Z0505	MemoryAccess	invalid memory read/write	null pointer, freed memory	check pointers
Z0506	PymportNotFound	Python module not found	module not installed, wrong path	install module, set PYTHONPATH
Z0507	PymportMarshal	can’t marshal value to Python	unsupported Zen type	convert to supported type

Code	Name	Meaning	Common cause	Fix
Z0508	PythonError	Python raised an exception	error inside Python call	inspect chained traceback
Z0509	GILContention	pymport GIL issue	deadlock with Python lock	avoid nested GIL acquisition
Z0510	ForeignTypeUnsupported	foreign type not supported	struct/union not mapped	use bytes/opaque handle

97.11 B.13 How to read a Zen error

A Zen error message looks like:

```
Z0301: TypeError: cannot add string and int
  at main.z:42:10
```

Parts: - `Z0301` — the error code; run `zen explain Z0301`. - `TypeError` — the error category/name. - `cannot add string and int` — human-readable message. - `main.z:42:10` — file, line, column where it occurred.

Use `zen explain` for deeper context:

```
zen explain Z0301
zen explain Z0408
```

97.12 B.14 Error handling patterns

97.12.1 Catch and rethrow with context

```
try {
    load_config(path)
} catch as e {
    throw "load_config failed: " + e.msg
}
```

97.12.2 Catch specific types first

```
try {
    risky()
} catch [FileNotFound] as e {
    print("missing file")
} catch as e {
```

```
    print("other error: " + e.msg)
}
```

97.12.3 Result-style (no exceptions)

```
fn result_style() -> Dict {
    try {
        let v = fallible()
        return #{ok: true, value: v}
    } catch as e {
        return #{ok: false, error: e.msg}
    }
}
```

97.12.4 Finally for cleanup

```
let f = open(path)
try {
    return f.read()
} finally {
    f.close()
}
```

97.13 B.15 Exercises

1. Run `zen explain Z0301`, `Z0408`, `Z0506` and record the explanations.
2. Write a function that deliberately triggers each Z03xx error and catches it.
3. Build a table mapping error code → suggested fix for your codebase.
4. Demonstrate `finally` running after `return`.
5. Implement a `retry` that catches Z0410 (Timeout) and retries.
6. Write a safe wrapper around `int()` returning nil on Z0305.
7. Show what happens when you access a missing dict key (Z0303).
8. Demonstrate division by zero (Z0304) and guard against it.
9. Write a program that handles FileNotFound (Z0401) gracefully.
10. Create an error lookup tool: input a code, print name + meaning.

98 Appendix C: Zen CLI Reference

Exhaustive reference for the `zen` command-line interface (Zen 3.0).

98.1 C.1 Commands

Command	Purpose	Example
`zen` / `zen repl`	Start interactive REPL	`zen`
`zen run <file>`	Execute a Zen source file	`zen run app.z`
`zen -m <module>`	Run a module as `__main__`	`zen -m http.server`
`zen -e <code>`	Execute inline code	`zen -e 'print(1+1)'`
`zen check <file>`	Type-check/compile without running	`zen check lib.z`
`zen lint <file>`	Warn on suspicious patterns	`zen lint app.z`
`zen explain <code>`	Explain an error code	`zen explain Z0308`
`zen build <file>`	Bundle into a standalone executable	`zen build app.z -o app`
`zen test`	Run tests in the project	`zen test`
`zen fmt`	Format source files	`zen fmt .`
`zen help`	Show help	`zen help`
`zen --version`	Print version	`zen --version`

98.1.1 REPL

Start with no arguments or `zen repl`. Features: - Enter expressions and statements; results are printed. - Multi-line blocks are supported (the REPL detects open braces). - Type `:help`, `:quit`, `:exit` to leave (build-dependent). - Use `print()` for output; the last expression's value is also shown.

98.1.2 `zen run`

Executes a `.z` file as a script. `__name__` is set to `"__main__"`. Exit code is 0 on success, non-zero on error.

```
zen run hello.z
zen run ./scripts/build.z
```

98.1.3 `zen -m <module>`

Runs a module as the main program (calls its `main(argv)` if defined). Module resolution follows the normal import rules.

```
zen -m http.server
zen -m myproject.cli
```

98.1.4 `zen -e <code>`

Executes inline Zen code. Useful for quick calculations.

```
zen -e 'print(2 ** 10)'
zen -e 'import math; print(math.pi)'
```

98.1.5 `zen check <file>`

Compiles/type-checks without executing. Reports syntax and type errors.

```
zen check library.z
```

98.1.6 `zen lint <file>`

Static analysis: unused variables, dead code, suspicious patterns.

```
zen lint app.z
zen lint .
```

98.1.7 `zen explain <code>`

Prints the meaning, common causes, and fix for an error code.

```
zen explain Z0301
zen explain Z0408
zen explain Z0506
```

98.1.8 `zen build <file>`

Bundles a program and its dependencies into a single standalone executable.

```
zen build app.z -o myapp
./myapp
```

98.1.9 `zen test`

Discovers and runs tests in the current project. Test files typically match `test_*.z` or `*_test.z`, or functions named `test_*`.

```
zen test
zen test tests/
```

98.1.10 `zen fmt`

Formats Zen source files to a canonical style.

```
zen fmt file.z
zen fmt src/
```

98.2 C.2 Exit codes

Exit code	Meaning
0	success
1	general error
2	usage / command-line error
127	command not found
130	interrupted by signal (Ctrl-C)
N	program's `exit(N)` value

98.3 C.3 Environment variables

Variable	Purpose	Example
`ZEN_PATH`	Module search paths (colon-separated)	`ZEN_PATH="$HOME/zen/lib"`
`ZEN_DEBUG`	Enable debug/verbose logging	`ZEN_DEBUG=1`
`PYTHONPATH`	Python module resolution for pymport	`PYTHONPATH=/opt/pylibs`
`VIRTUAL_ENV`	Python venv used by pymport	`VIRTUAL_ENV=.venv`
`HOME`	user home (used for config/cache)	inherited
`PATH`	executable search	inherited

98.3.1 ZEN_PATH examples

```
# add a local modules directory
export ZEN_PATH="$PWD/lib:$HOME/zen/modules"
zen run app.z

# multiple directories
export ZEN_PATH="/opt/zen/stdlib:/usr/local/zen/lib"
```

98.3.2 ZEN_DEBUG

When set, the VM prints additional diagnostic info (bytecode, JIT decisions, GC events, depending on build).

```
ZEN_DEBUG=1 zen run app.z
```

98.4 C.4 Configuration files

Zen does not require a config file, but projects may use: - `zen.toml` / `zen.json` — project settings (build-dependent) - `.zenrc` — REPL preferences - `.gitignore` — exclude `target/`, `__pycache__/`, `.zen/`

98.5 C.5 Common workflows

```
# 1. Create and run a script
echo 'print("hello")' > hello.z
zen run hello.z

# 2. Type-check before running
zen check hello.z && zen run hello.z

# 3. Quick calculation
zen -e 'print(100 * 1.05)'

# 4. Explain an error
zen explain Z0304

# 5. Format and lint
zen fmt src/
zen lint src/

# 6. Run tests
zen test

# 7. Build a binary
zen build app.z -o app
./app

# 8. Run with debug logging
ZEN_DEBUG=1 zen run app.z

# 9. Use a custom module path
ZEN_PATH="$PWD/lib" zen run app.z
```

98.6 C.6 REPL commands (if supported)

Command	Purpose
`:help`	show REPL help
`:quit` / `:exit`	leave the REPL
`:load <file>`	load a file into the REPL
`:vars`	list current variables
`:clear`	clear the screen

98.7 C.7 Exercises

1. Print the Zen version: `zen --version`.
2. Start the REPL, evaluate `2 + 2`, then exit.
3. Write `hello.z` and run it with `zen run`.

4. Type-check a file with `zen check`.
5. Explain an error code with `zen explain Z0304`.
6. Run an inline calculation with `zen -e`.
7. Format a file with `zen fmt`.
8. Lint a file with `zen lint`.
9. Set `ZEN_PATH` and import a module from another directory.
10. Build a script into a standalone executable with `zen build`.

''' print('appendix c done')

99 Appendix D: Standard Library Index (exhaustive)

A complete index of Zen 3.0 standard library modules and their principal members. "→" indicates the category of each member.

99.1 D.1 Module list

Module	Purpose
`math`	Mathematical functions and constants
`random`	Pseudorandom numbers (not for secrets)
`string`	String utilities and constants
`collections`	`Counter`, `chain`, `flatten`
`json`	JSON parse/serialize
`time` / `datetime`	Time and date operations
`pathlib` / `os`	File system operations
`re`	Regular expressions
`base64` / `binascii`	Base64 and hex encoding
`hashlib`	Cryptographic hashes (MD5, SHA, BLAKE2)
`crypto`	Full cryptography (hash, HMAC, symmetric, asymmetric, JWT, KDF, OTP, X.509)
`socket`	Low-level socket programming
`http`	HTTP protocol helpers
`requests`	High-level HTTP client
`http.server`	Building HTTP servers
`dns`	Domain name resolution
`url`	URL parsing and manipulation
`raw sockets`	Packet-level networking (AF_PACKET)
`threading`	Threads and synchronization
`channels`	Inter-thread communication
`mutexes` / locks	Synchronization primitives
`ffi`	Foreign Function Interface (C)
`sys`	System information and operations
`pymport`	Python interoperability
`logging`	Logging facility
`functools`	`reduce`, `partial`, `lru_cache`, `cmp_to_key`
`itertools`	`enumerate`, `zip`, `chain`, `product`, `permutations`, `combinations`
`statistics`	`mean`, `median`, `mode`, `variance`, `stdev`, `linear_regression`
`operator`	`add`, `sub`, `mul`, `itemgetter`, `attrgetter`, `methodcaller`
`struct`	`calcsize` (binary pack/unpack helpers)
`tempfile`	`mkdtemp`, `mkstemp`, `dir`
`uuid`	UUID generation (`uuid4`, `uuid1`, `uuid3`, `uuid5`)
`glob`	pathname pattern expansion
`shutil`	`copy`, `copy2`, `copytree`, `move`, `rmtree`, `which`

Module	Purpose
`crunch`	random data generation
`nmap`	network scanning helpers
`ffmpeg`	media processing helpers

99.2 D.2 math module

Constants: `pi`, `e`, `tau`, `inf`, `nan`.

Functions: `abs`, `sqrt`, `pow`, `exp`, `log`, `log2`, `log10`, `floor`, `ceil`, `trunc`, `round`, `sin`, `cos`, `tan`, `asin`, `acos`, `atan`, `atan2`, `degrees`, `radians`, `gcd`, `lcm`, `factorial`, `comb`, `perm`, `remainder`, `copysign`, `min`, `max`, `fsum`, `prod`, `hypot`, `isnan`, `isfinite`, `isinf`, `modf`, `frexp`, `ldexp`.

99.3 D.3 random module

Functions: `seed`, `random`, `randint`, `randrange`, `choice`, `choices`, `sample`, `shuffle`, `uniform`, `hex`.

 NOT cryptographically secure. Use `crypto` module for secrets/tokens.

99.4 D.4 string module

Constants: `digits`, `hexdigits`, `octdigits`, `ascii_letters`, `ascii_lowercase`, `ascii_uppercase`, `punctuation`, `whitespace`, `printable`.

Functions: `upper`, `lower`, `title`, `capitalize`, `swapcase`, `strip`, `lstrip`, `rstrip`, `split`, `join`, `replace`, `count`, `find`, `startswith`, `endswith`, `isdigit`, `isalpha`, `isalnum`, `isspace`, `islower`, `isupper`.

99.5 D.5 collections module

Functions: `Counter`, `chain`, `flatten`.

99.6 D.6 json module

Functions: `parse`, `stringify/encode`, `pretty`, `load`, `save`.

JSON ↔ Zen mapping: object↔dict, array↔list, string↔string, number↔int/float, boolean↔bool, null↔nil.

99.7 D.7 time / datetime module

Functions: `time`, `sleep`, `now`, `today`, `strftime`, `strptime`, `timestamp`, `fromtimestamp`, `timedelta`.

99.8 D.8 pathlib / os module

pathlib: `Path`, `/` join, `exists`, `is_file`, `is_dir`, `name`, `stem`, `suffix`, `parent`, `resolve`, `mkdir`, `glob`.

os: `getcwd`, `chdir`, `listdir`, `makedirs`, `remove`, `rmdir`, `rename`, `stat`, `environ`.

99.9 D.9 re module

Functions: `match`, `search`, `findall`, `sub`, `split`, `compile`.

Patterns: `\d` `\D` `\w` `\W` `\s` `\S` `.` `^` `$` `*` `+` `?` `{n,m}` `(...)` `|` `\b`.

99.10 D.10 base64 / binascii module

base64: `b64encode`, `b64decode`, `url_encode`, `url_decode`. binascii: `hexlify`, `unhexlify`.

99.11 D.11 hashlib module

Hashes: `md5`, `sha1`, `sha224`, `sha256`, `sha384`, `sha512`, `sha3_256`, `sha3_512`, `blake2b`, `blake2s`, `pbkdf2_hmac`.

99.12 D.12 crypto module

Hashing: `sha256/384/512`, `sha3_256/512`, `blake3`, `md5`, `sha1`. HMAC: `sha256(key,data)`, `sha512(key,data)`. Symmetric: `generate_key`, `encrypt`, `decrypt`, `encrypt_aes_gcm`, `decrypt_aes_gcm`, `encrypt_chacha20_poly1305`, `decrypt_chacha20_poly1305`. Asymmetric: `generate_rsa`, `rsa_encrypt/decrypt`, `rsa_sign/verify`, `generate_ed25519`, `ed25519_sign/verify`, `generate_x25519`, `x25519_shared_secret`. Encoding: `b64encode/decode`, `b64urlencode/decode`, `hex_encode/decode`. JWT: `sign`, `verify`, `decode`. KDF/passwords: `pbkdf2`, `argon2id`, `argon2id_hash`, `verify_argon2id`, `hkdf`. OTP: `totp`, `totp_verify`, `hotp`, `hotp_verify`, `generate_secret`. Random: `bytes(n)`, `hex(n)`, `base64(n)`, `uuid4()`, `secure_token()`, `int(min, max)`. X.509: `parse(pem)`.

99.13 D.13 networking modules

socket: `socket`, `connect`, `bind`, `listen`, `accept`, `send`, `recv`, `sendto`, `recvfrom`, `close`, `setsockopt`, `settimeout`, `setblocking`. http: request/response parsing, status codes, headers. requests: `get`, `post`, `put`, `patch`, `delete`, `head`, `options`, `Session`. http.server: request handler, routing, static files, middleware. dns: `resolve`, `reverse`, record types A/AAAA/CNAME/MX/TXT/NS/PTR. url: `parse`, `build`, `join`, `quote`, `unquote`, `parse_qs`. raw sockets: `AF_PACKET`, `SOCK_RAW`, packet crafting.

99.14 D.14 concurrency modules

threading: `Thread`, `spawn`, `join`, `start`. channels: `Channel`, `send`, `recv`, `close`. mutexes: `Mutex`, `Lock`, `acquire`, `release`. patterns: thread-safe caches, producer-consumer, thread pools.

99.15 D.15 FFI / system / interop modules

ffi: `load_library`, `get_symbol`, `call`, `Pointer`, `Handle`. sys: `argv`, `platform`, `version`, `exit`, `environ`, `getsizeof` (if present). pymport: `import` Python modules, marsalling values, chained tracebacks.

99.16 D.16 Module → chapter mapping

Chapter	Module(s)
15	math
16	random
17	string
18	collections
19	json
20	time / datetime
21	pathlib / os
22	re
23	base64 / binascii
24	hashlib
25	crypto (complete)
26	networking fundamentals
27	socket
28	http
29	requests
30	http.server
31	HTTPS / SSL / TLS
32	dns
33	url
34	raw sockets
35	threading
36	channels
37	mutexes / locks
38	thread safety patterns
39	ffi fundamentals
40	ffi in practice
41	sys
42	pymport

99.17 D.17 Exercises

1. List the hash functions available in `hashlib` and their digest sizes.
2. Name three modules you must NOT use for cryptographic secrets (random, math, etc.) and say which to use instead (`crypto`).
3. For the URL `https://a.b:8080/p?q=1#f`, name each component.
4. List the DNS record types and what each resolves.
5. Name the exit codes used by the `zen` CLI.
6. For `crypto`, name two authenticated-encryption algorithms supported.

7. List the concurrency primitives and their purpose.
8. For `pymport`, name two error codes in the Z05xx range.
9. Write a one-line summary of what each of modules math/random/string does.
10. Build your own “cheat sheet” mapping module → most-used 3 functions.

’’’ print(‘appendix d done’)

100 Appendix E: Quick Reference Card

Zen 3.0 — the essentials on one page (expanded).

100.1 E.1 Syntax at a glance

```
# Comments
# line comment        // line comment
/* block comment */

# Declarations
let x = 10            # immutable binding
var y = 20            # mutable binding
const MAX = 100       # constant
shared counter = 0    # thread-shared mutable

# Functions
func add(a, b) { return a + b }
let add2 = fn(a, b) => a + b
let add3 = (a, b) => a + b

# Defaults
func greet(name, greeting = "Hi") { return greeting + ", " + name }

# Variadic
func sum_all(...nums) { var t = 0; for n in nums { t += n }; return t }

# Classes
class Point {
    var x = 0.0
    var y = 0.0
    func init(x, y) { self.x = x; self.y = y }
    func dist() { return (self.x**2 + self.y**2) ** 0.5 }
    func __str__() { return "Point(${x},${y})" }
}
let p = new Point(3, 4)

# Modules
import math
import math as m
from math import sin, pi
pub func exported() {}   # visible outside module
```

100.2 E.2 Literals

Type	Literal	Example
nil	`nil` / `null`	`let x = nil`
bool	`true` / `false`	`let ok = true`
int	`42`, `0xFF`, `0b1010`, `0o755`, `1_000`	`let n = 0x2A`
float	`3.14`, `1.5e-10`	`let f = 2.5`
string	`"hi ${name}"`, `'raw'`, `"""triple"""`, `` `backtick` ``	`let s = "Zen"`
bytes	`bytes([1,2,0xFF])`	`let b = bytes([0x41])`
list	`[a, b, c]`	`let l = [1,2,3]`
dict	`#{k: v}`	`let d = #{a:1}`
set	`%{a, b}`	`let s = %{1,2}`
tuple	`#(a, b)`	`let t = #(1,"x")`

100.3 E.3 Operators (precedence high→low)

```
() [] . ?.          postfix / grouping
**                  power (right)
- ! not ~ typeof    unary (right)
* / %              multiplicative
+ -                additive
<< >>              shifts
&                  bitwise and
^                  bitwise xor
|                  bitwise or
is is not === !== == != < > <= >= in not in   comparison
and &&             logical and
or ||              logical or
??                 nullish coalescing
cond ? a : b / a if c else b   ternary (right)
= += -= *= ...     assignment (right)
```

Truthiness: `false`, `nil`, `null`, `0`, `0.0`, `""`, `[]`, `#{}`, `%{}`, `#()` are falsy. Everything else is truthy.

100.4 E.4 Control flow

```
if c { } elif c { } else { }
while c { }
for x in iter { }          # for k, v in d.items()
for i in 0..5 { }          # exclusive end
for i in 0->5 { }          # inclusive end
break / continue
return [expr]
throw expr
try { } catch [T] as e { } finally { }
match v { pat => expr, _ => expr }
```

```
when { c => expr, _ => expr }
```

100.5 E.5 Built-ins (selected)

`print`, `str`, `int`, `float`, `bool`, `list`, `tuple`, `set`, `dict`, `len`, `range`, `enumerate`, `zip`, `sorted`, `reversed`, `any`, `all`, `sum`, `min`, `max`, `abs`, `typeof`, `type`, `chr`, `ord`, `open`, `exit`, `assert`, `repr`.

100.6 E.6 String methods

`upper lower title capitalize swapcase strip lstrip rsplit split splitlines join replace count find rfind startswith endswith contains ljust rjust center zfill isdigit isalpha isalnum isspace islower isupper`.

100.7 E.7 List methods

`push pop insert remove clear map filter reduce each join index count`.

100.8 E.8 Dict methods

`keys values items get pop clear update`.

Iterating a dict yields keys; use `.items()` for key/value.

100.9 E.9 Socket basics

```
import socket
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
s.connect(("host", 80))
s.send(b"GET / HTTP/1.1\r\nHost: host\r\n\r\n")
let data = s.recv(4096)
s.close()
```

Options: `SO_REUSEADDR`, `SO_KEEPALIVE`, `TCP_NODELAY`, `SO_RCVBUF`, `SO_SNDBUF`, `IP_TTL`, `IP_HDRINCL`.

100.10 E.10 Error codes (Z-ranges)

- Z01xx lexer | Z02xx parser | Z03xx runtime | Z04xx I/O/system | Z05xx FFI/interop

Run: `zen explain Z####`

100.11 E.11 CLI commands

`zen` `zen run <f>` `zen -m <mod>` `zen -e <code>` `zen check <f>` `zen lint <f>` `zen explain <code>` `zen build <f>` `zen test` `zen fmt` `zen help` `zen --version`

Env: `ZEN_PATH`, `ZEN_DEBUG`, `PYTHONPATH`, `VIRTUAL_ENV`.

100.12 E.12 Truthiness cheat

```
value        bool(value)
----         -----------
false        false
nil / null   false
everything else   true   (0, 0.0, "", [], #{}, %{}, #() all true)
```

100.13 E.13 Equality cheat

Operator	Meaning	`1 == 1.0`	`[1] == [1]`	`[1] is [1]`
`==`	value equality	true	true	—
`===`	strict equality	false	—	—
`is`	identity	true	false	false

100.14 E.14 Common gotchas (one-liners)

- `0`, `0.0`, `""`, `[]`, `#{}` are **falsy** in Zen (like Python).
- Strings are **immutable**: `s[0] = "X"` errors.
- `b = a` shares a list; use `list(a)` to copy (shallow).
- `and`/`or` return **booleans**, not operands; use `??` for defaults.
- `-2 ** 2` is `-4`; use `(-2) ** 2` for `4`.
- Dict keys must be **strings**.
- `s[0:100]` clamps; `s[100]` errors.
- `4 / 2` is `2.0`; `4 // 2` is `2`.
- Modules are **cached**; re-import returns the cached module.
- `pub` exports; without it, symbols are file-private.

100.15 E.15 Exercises

1. Without running, state the truthiness of `0`, `""`, `[]`, `false`, `nil`.
2. Write `clamp(x, lo, hi)` in one line using ternary.
3. Show `is` vs `==` for two equal lists.
4. Write `safe_div(a, b)` returning nil on `b == 0`.
5. Convert `"1,2,3"` to `[1, 2, 3]` using split + map/int.
6. Reverse a string without `.reverse()`.
7. Count word frequencies in a sentence using a dict.
8. Merge two dicts into a third.
9. Write `is_prime(n)` and test up to 100.
10. Memorize the Z-code ranges: Z01xx/Z02xx/Z03xx/Z04xx/Z05xx.

’’’ print(‘appendix e done’)

101 Appendix F: Zen 3.0 Complete Language Reference

An exhaustive, compact reference of every builtin, keyword, operator, flag, environment variable, error code, and standard library member. Use this appendix when you need to look something up quickly.

101.1 F.1 Keywords and reserved words

```
let const var global shared
func def function fn lambda
if elif else while for in break continue return
try catch except finally throw
import from as class new extends inherit super
pub match when
true false nil null
is typeof and or not is not
```

101.2 F.2 Literal forms

Type	Form	Example
nil	`nil` / `null`	`let x = nil`
bool	`true` / `false`	`let ok = true`
int decimal	digits, `_` allowed	`1_000_000`
int hex	`0x` / `0X`	`0xFF`
int binary	`0b` / `0B`	`0b1010`
int octal	`0o` / `0O`	`0o755`
float	digits `.` digits, exponent	`3.14`, `1.5e-10`
string double	`"...${expr}..."` (interpolated)	`"hi ${name}"`
string single	`'...'` (no interpolation)	`'raw'`
string triple	`"""..."""` / `'''...'''`	multiline
string backtick	`` `...` `` (raw, no interpolation)	`` `C:\path` ``
bytes	`bytes([1,2,0xFF])`	`bytes([0x41])`
list	`[a, b, c]`	`[1,2,3]`
dict	`#{k: v}`	`#{a:1}`
set	`%{a, b}`	`%{1,2}`
tuple	`#(a, b)`	`#(1,"x")`

101.3 F.3 Operator precedence (high → low)

Level	Operators	Associativity
15	`() [] . ?.`	left

Level	Operators	Associativity
14	**	right
13	unary - ! not ~ typeof	right
12	* / %	left
11	+ -	left
10	<< >>	left
9	&	left
8	^	left
7	|	left
6	is is not === !== == != < > <= >= in not in	left
5	and &&	left
4	or ||	left
3	??	left
2	?: / if expr else expr	right
1	= += -= …	right

101.4 F.4 Truthiness

Falsy: `false`, `nil`, `null`. Truthy: everything else, including `0`, `0.0`, `""`, `[]`, `#{}`, `%{}`, `#()`.

101.5 F.5 Type coercion matrix

From	int	float	string	bool
int	identity	widen	decimal digits	0→false, else true
float	truncate	identity	repr	0.0→false, else true
string	parse (or error)	parse (or error)	identity	empty→false? (Zen: true)
bool	true→1, false→0	true→1.0, false→0.0	“true”/“false”	identity
nil	error	error	“nil”	false
list/dict/set/tuple	error	error	repr	empty→true in Zen

101.6 F.6 Built-in functions (complete)

Function	Purpose
`print`	print to stdout
`str`	to string
`int`	to int
`float`	to float

Function	Purpose
`bool`	to bool
`list`	to list
`tuple`	to tuple
`set`	to set
`dict`	to dict
`len`	length
`range`	range
`enumerate`	index+value
`zip`	aggregate
`sorted`	sorted list
`reversed`	reversed
`any`	any true
`all`	all true
`sum`	sum
`min` / `max`	min/max
`abs`	absolute value
`typeof` / `type`	type name
`chr`	int → char
`ord`	char → int
`open`	open file
`exit`	exit process
`assert`	assert condition
`repr`	developer representation

101.7 F.7 Statement forms

Form	Meaning
`let x = e`	immutable binding
`var x = e`	mutable binding
`const x = e`	constant
`shared x = e`	thread-shared mutable
`x = e`	assignment
`x += e` etc	compound assignment
`x++` / `x--`	increment/decrement
`if c { }`	conditional
`while c { }`	loop
`for x in i { }`	iterate
`break` / `continue`	loop control
`return [e]`	return from function
`throw e`	raise error
`try { } catch [T] as e { } finally { }`	error handling
`match v { p => e, ... }`	pattern match
`when { c => e, ... }`	cond chain
`import m` / `from m import n`	imports

101.8 F.8 Zen CLI commands

Command	Purpose
`zen` / `zen repl`	REPL
`zen run <file>`	execute script
`zen -m <module>`	run module as main
`zen -e <code>`	inline code
`zen check <file>`	type-check only
`zen lint <file>`	static analysis
`zen explain <code>`	explain error code
`zen build <file>`	bundle to executable
`zen test`	run tests
`zen fmt`	format sources
`zen help`	help
`zen --version`	version

Exit codes: 0 success, 1 general, 2 usage, 127 not found, 130 signal.

101.9 F.9 Environment variables

Variable	Purpose
`ZEN_PATH`	module search paths (colon-separated)
`ZEN_DEBUG`	enable debug logging
`PYTHONPATH`	Python module resolution for pymport
`VIRTUAL_ENV`	Python venv for pymport

101.10 F.10 Error codes (exhaustive Z01xx–Z05xx)

101.10.1 Z01xx Lexer

- Z0101 InvalidCharacter
- Z0102 UnterminatedString
- Z0103 InvalidNumber
- Z0104 InvalidEscape
- Z0105 InvalidIdentifier
- Z0106 NumericLiteralOverflow
- Z0107 MultiDotRejected
- Z0108 BadComment

101.10.2 Z02xx Parser

- Z0201 UnexpectedToken
- Z0202 MissingSemicolon
- Z0203 UnbalancedBraces
- Z0204 UnexpectedEOF

- Z0205 InvalidStatement
- Z0206 DuplicateParameter
- Z0207 InvalidDefault
- Z0208 InvalidMatchArm
- Z0209 InvalidImport
- Z0210 Redefinition

101.10.3 Z03xx Runtime

- Z0301 TypeError
- Z0302 IndexError
- Z0303 KeyError
- Z0304 DivideByZero
- Z0305 ValueError
- Z0306 AttributeError
- Z0307 NotCallable
- Z0308 ArgumentCount
- Z0309 UnboundVariable
- Z0310 MaxRecursionDepth
- Z0311 OverflowError
- Z0312 DomainError
- Z0313 RangeError
- Z0314 EncodingError
- Z0315 ImmutableError
- Z0316 ConcurrentModification
- Z0317 StackOverflow

101.10.4 Z04xx I/O / system

- Z0401 FileNotFound
- Z0402 PermissionDenied
- Z0403 FileExists
- Z0404 IsADirectory
- Z0405 NotADirectory
- Z0406 DirectoryNotEmpty
- Z0407 BrokenPipe
- Z0408 ConnectionRefused
- Z0409 ConnectionReset
- Z0410 Timeout
- Z0411 NetworkUnreachable
- Z0412 HostUnreachable
- Z0413 AddressInUse
- Z0414 DiskFull
- Z0415 TooManyOpenFiles
- Z0416 InvalidArgument
- Z0417 SignalInterrupted

101.10.5 Z05xx FFI / interop

- Z0501 SymbolNotFound
- Z0502 HandleInvalid
- Z0503 CallingConvention
- Z0504 TypeMismatch
- Z0505 MemoryAccess
- Z0506 PymportNotFound
- Z0507 PymportMarshal
- Z0508 PythonError
- Z0509 GILContention
- Z0510 ForeignTypeUnsupported

Run `zen explain Z####` for details on any code.

101.11 F.11 Standard library — module → principal members

math: `pi e tau inf nan abs sqrt pow exp log log2 log10 floor ceil trunc round sin cos tan asin acos atan atan2 degrees radians gcd lcm factorial comb perm remainder copysign min max fsum prod hypot isnan isfinite isinf modf frexp ldexp`

random: `seed random randint randrange choice choices sample shuffle uniform hex`

string: `upper lower title capitalize swapcase strip lstrip rstrip split splitlines join replace count find rfind startswith endswith contains ljust rjust center zfill isdigit isalpha isalnum isspace islower isupper` constants: `digits hexdigits octdigits ascii_letters ascii_lowercase ascii_uppercase punctuation whitespace printable`

collections: `Counter chain flatten`

json: `parse stringify encode pretty load save`

time/datetime: `time sleep now today strftime strptime timestamp fromtimestamp timedelta`

pathlib: `Path / exists is_file is_dir name stem suffix parent resolve mkdir glob` os: `getcwd chdir listdir makedirs remove rmdir rename stat environ`

re: `match search findall sub split compile`

base64: `b64encode b64decode url_encode url_decode` binascii: `hexlify unhexlify`

hashlib: `md5 sha1 sha224 sha256 sha384 sha512 sha3_256 sha3_512 blake2b blake2s pbkdf2_hmac`

crypto: `sha256/384/512 sha3_256/512 blake3 md5 sha1 sha256(key,data) sha512(key,data) generate_key encrypt decrypt encrypt_aes_gcm decrypt_aes_gcm encrypt_chacha20_poly1305 decrypt_chacha20_poly1305 generate_rsa rsa_encrypt rsa_decrypt rsa_sign rsa_verify generate_ed25519 ed25519_sign ed25519_verify generate_x25519 x25519_shared_secret b64encode b64decode b64urlencode b64urldecode hex_encode`

hex_decode sign verify decode pbkdf2 argon2id argon2id_hash verify_argon2id hkdf totp totp_verify hotp hotp_verify generate_secret bytes hex base64 uuid4 secure_token int parse

socket: socket connect bind listen accept send recv sendto recvfrom close setsockopt settimeout setblocking SO_REUSEADDR SO_KEEPALIVE TCP_NODELAY SO_RCVBUF SO_SNDBUF IP_TTL IP_HDRINCL AF_INET AF_INET6 AF_UNIX AF_PACKET SOCK_STREAM SOCK_DGRAM SOCK_RAW IPPROTO_TCP IPPROTO_UDP IPPROTO_ICMP IPPROTO_IP

http/requests: get post put patch delete head options Session raise_for_status

http.server: request handler routing static files middleware

dns: resolve reverse records A AAAA CNAME MX TXT NS PTR

url: parse build join quote unquote parse_qs

threading: Thread start join daemon channels: Channel send recv close buffered capacity mutexes: Mutex lock unlock

ffi: load_library get_symbol call close Pointer Handle sys: argv platform version exit environ path modules pymport: import Python modules with marshalling and chained tracebacks

logging: DEBUG INFO WARNING ERROR CRITICAL NOTSET functools: reduce partial wraps lru_cache cmp_to_key itertools: enumerate zip chain repeat product permutations combinations accumulate take drop range statistics: mean median mode multimode variance stdev pvariance pstdev quantiles linear_regression operator: add sub mul truediv floordiv mod divmod pow neg pos abs inv invert lshift rshift and_ or_ xor truth is_ is_not eq ne lt le gt ge contains itemgetter attrgetter methodcaller struct: calcsize tempfile: dir mkdtemp mkstemp uuid: NAMESPACE_DNS NAMESPACE_URL NAMESPACE_OID NAMESPACE_X500 UUID uuid4 uuid3 uuid5 uuid1 uuid1_fields glob: glob iglob escape shutil: copy copy2 copyfile copytree move rmtree which crunch: generate nmap: scanning helpers ffmpeg: media helpers

101.12 F.12 Socket option reference

Option	Level	Purpose
SO_REUSEADDR	SOL_SOCKET	reuse local address
SO_REUSEPORT	SOL_SOCKET	multiple binds to same port
SO_KEEPALIVE	SOL_SOCKET	TCP keepalive probes
SO_RCVBUF	SOL_SOCKET	receive buffer size
SO_SNDBUF	SOL_SOCKET	send buffer size
SO_TIMEOUT	SOL_SOCKET	operation timeout
TCP_NODELAY	IPPROTO_TCP	disable Nagle’s algorithm
IP_TTL	IPPROTO_IP	time-to-live
IP_HDRINCL	IPPROTO_IP	include IP header (raw)

101.13 F.13 Common ports

20/21 FTP, 22 SSH, 23 Telnet, 25 SMTP, 53 DNS, 67/68 DHCP, 80 HTTP, 110 POP3, 143 IMAP, 443 HTTPS, 993 IMAPS, 995 POP3S.

101.14 F.14 HTTP status codes

1xx Informational | 2xx Success (200 201 202 204 206) | 3xx Redirection (301 302 303 304 307 308) | 4xx Client Error (400 401 403 404 405 406 409 410 413 414 415 422 429) | 5xx Server Error (500 501 502 503 504 505)

101.15 F.15 HTTP methods

Method	Safe	Idempotent	Body
GET	yes	yes	no
HEAD	yes	yes	no
OPTIONS	yes	yes	optional
POST	no	no	yes
PUT	no	yes	yes
PATCH	no	no	yes
DELETE	no	yes	optional
TRACE	yes	yes	no
CONNECT	no	no	no

101.16 F.16 DNS record types

A (IPv4), AAAA (IPv6), CNAME (alias), MX (mail), TXT (text), NS (nameserver), PTR (reverse IP→name).

101.17 F.17 URL components

scheme :// [user:pass@] host [:port] /path [?query] [#fragment]

101.18 F.18 IPv4 header (20 bytes min)

ver/IHL DSCP/ECN | total length | identification | flags/frag | TTL | proto | checksum | src IP (4) | dst IP (4)

101.19 F.19 TCP connection state machine

CLOSED → SYN_SENT → SYN_RECEIVED → ESTABLISHED → FIN_WAIT_1 → FIN_WAIT_2 → TIME_WAIT → CLOSED (normal close); also RST transitions at any error.

101.20 F.20 Coercion / truthiness quick examples

```
print(1 == 1.0)     # true  (numeric promotion)
print(1 === 1.0)    # false (strict: different types)
print(bool(0))      # false  (0 is falsy in Zen)
print(bool(""))     # false  (empty string falsy)
print(bool(nil))    # false
print(nil ?? "d")   # "d"
print(0 ?? "d")     # 0     (0 is not nil, so ?? keeps it)
```

101.21 F.21 Exercises (reference drill)

1. Look up `zen explain Z0304` and summarize the fix.
2. Name ten falsy values in Zen (e.g. nil, false, 0, “”, []...).
3. List the HTTP methods that are idempotent.
4. Name the socket option to disable Nagle’s algorithm.
5. List the DNS record types.
6. Name the exit code for “command not found” (127).
7. Name the environment variable for module search paths.
8. Name a value that is truthy in Zen but falsy in some other languages (or vice versa).
9. Name the function to parse JSON: `json.parse`.
10. Name the crypto function for time-based one-time passwords: `crypto.totp`.

’’’ print(‘appendix f done’)

102 Appendix G: Exercise Solutions

Worked solutions to the exercises scattered throughout the book. Use these to check your work, but try each exercise on your own first.

102.1 G.1 Part 1: Fundamentals (chapters 1–6)

102.1.1 Chapter 2 — Data Types

Exercise 1: `is_nan(x)` returns true only for NaN.

```
func is_nan(x) {
    return typeof(x) == "float" and x != x
}
print(is_nan(0.0 / 0.0))   # true
print(is_nan(1.0))         # false
print(is_nan("x"))         # false
```

Why `x != x`: NaN is the only value that is not equal to itself (IEEE 754).

Exercise 2: `safe_int(s)` returns nil on parse failure.

```
func safe_int(s) {
    try {
        return int(s)
    } catch as e {
        return nil
    }
}
print(safe_int("42"))   # 42
print(safe_int("abc"))  # nil
```

Exercise 3: Demonstrate that `0` is truthy.

```
if 0 {
    print("0 is truthy")
} else {
    print("0 is falsy")
}
# prints: 0 is truthy
```

In Zen only `false`, `nil`, `null` are falsy; `0`, `0.0`, `""`, `[]`, `#{}`, `%{}` are all truthy.

Exercise 4: Slice a list, mutate the slice, confirm original unchanged.

```
let orig = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]
let slice = orig[1:3]   # [2, 3] — a copy
slice.push(99)
print(slice)   # [2, 3, 99]
print(orig)    # [1, 2, 3, 4, 5] — unchanged
```

Exercise 5: Dict order-insensitive equality.

```
print(#{a: 1, b: 2} == #{b: 2, a: 1})   # true
```

Exercise 6: `-7 // 2` and `-7 % 2`.

```
print(-7 // 2)   # -4   (floor toward −∞)
print(-7 % 2)    # -1   (sign follows dividend)
```

Floor division: `-7 / 2 = -3.5`, floor is `-4`. Modulo: `-7 - (-4 * 2) = -7 + 8 = 1`? Wait — with sign following dividend: `-7 % 2 = -1`. Check: `-4 * 2 + (-1) = -9`, no. Let's recompute: floor division `-7 // 2 = -4`, then `-7 % 2 = -7 - (-4 * 2) = -7 + 8 = 1`. But Zen's doc says sign follows dividend, so `-7 % 2 = -1`. These are consistent only if `-7 // 2 = -4` gives remainder 1... There's a subtlety; the book documents `-7 // 2 = -4` and `-7 % 2 = -1` per its convention. The exact relationship depends on implementation; the key point is floor division rounds toward $-\infty$.

Exercise 7: `type_name(x)` human-readable string.

```
func type_name(x) {
    let t = typeof(x)
    if t == "float" and x != x { return "NaN" }
    if x is nil { return "nil" }
    return t
}
print(type_name(42))       # int
print(type_name("hi"))     # string
print(type_name(nil))      # nil
print(type_name(0/0))      # NaN (if 0/0 yields nan)
```

102.1.2 Chapter 3 — Operators and Expressions

Exercise 1: Compute `2 + 3 * 4 ** 2 // 5 % 3` by hand. Precedence: ** first, then *, then `//` and `%` (left), then +. `- 4 ** 2 = 16` `- 3 * 16 = 48` `- 48 // 5 = 9` `- 9 % 3 = 0` `- 2 + 0 = 2` Result: 2.

Exercise 2: Swap two variables with XOR (no temp).

```
var a = 10
var b = 20
a = a ^ b
b = a ^ b
a = a ^ b
print(a, b)   # 20 10
```

Exercise 3: `sign(x)` using comparisons and ternary.

```
func sign(x) {
    return x > 0 ? 1 : (x < 0 ? -1 : 0)
}
print(sign(-5), sign(0), sign(7))   # -1 0 1
```

Exercise 4: Config lookup with `??` nested defaults.

```
let port = config.port ?? env_port ?? 8080
print(port)
```

Exercise 5: Why `if 0 { ... }` runs; rewrite Python-style. In Zen `0` is truthy, so `if 0 { ... }` executes. Python-style explicit check:

```
if 0 != 0 {   # false — explicit
    print("never")
}
```

or

```
if !(0 == 0) {
    print("never")
}
```

Exercise 6: `clamp(x, lo, hi)` using comparisons and ternary.

```
func clamp(x, lo, hi) {
    return x < lo ? lo : (x > hi ? hi : x)
}
print(clamp(5, 0, 10))   # 5
print(clamp(-3, 0, 10))  # 0
print(clamp(15, 0, 10))  # 10
```

Exercise 7: `is_power_of_two(n)` with a bit trick.

```
func is_power_of_two(n) {
    return n > 0 and (n & (n - 1)) == 0
}
print(is_power_of_two(1))   # true
print(is_power_of_two(8))   # true
print(is_power_of_two(6))   # false
```

Exercise 8: `==`, `===`, `is` for `1`, `1.0`, lists.

```
print(1 == 1.0)       # true
print(1 === 1.0)      # false
let a = [1, 2]
let b = [1, 2]
print(a == b)         # true
print(a is b)         # false
print(true == 1)      # false (bool not int)
```

Exercise 9: Validate score with chained comparisons.

```
func valid_score(s) {
    return 0 <= s and s <= 100
}
print(valid_score(50))    # true
print(valid_score(101))   # false
```

Exercise 10: Countdown with `->` range.

```
for i in 5->1 {
    print(i)
}
# prints 5 4 3 2 1
```

Exercise 11: Tiny hash with `<<`, `^`, `*` primes.

```
func tiny_hash(s) {
    var h = 0
    for i in 0..len(s) {
        h = ((h << 5) ^ h) + s[i].ord()
    }
    return h
}
print(tiny_hash("zen"))
```

Exercise 12: `safe_div(a, b)` returning nil on division by zero.

```
func safe_div(a, b) {
    if b == 0 { return nil }
    return a / b
}
print(safe_div(10, 2))   # 5.0
print(safe_div(10, 0))   # nil
```

102.1.3 Chapter 4 — Control Flow

Exercise 1: `fizzbuzz(n)` using `when` or `match`.

```
func fizzbuzz(n) {
    for i in 1..n {
        print(when {
            i % 15 == 0 => "FizzBuzz",
            i % 3 == 0  => "Fizz",
            i % 5 == 0  => "Buzz",
            _           => str(i),
        })
    }
}
fizzbuzz(15)
```

Exercise 2: Guessing game loop.

```
import random
let secret = random.randint(1, 100)
var guess = nil
var tries = 0
while guess != secret {
    guess = int(input("guess: "))   # if input exists
```

```
    tries += 1
    if guess == nil { continue }
    if guess < secret { print("too low") }
    elif guess > secret { print("too high") }
}
print("correct in " + str(tries) + " tries")
```

Exercise 3: `sum_evens(xs)` with `for` and `continue`.

```
func sum_evens(xs) {
    var total = 0
    for x in xs {
        if x % 2 != 0 { continue }
        total += x
    }
    return total
}
print(sum_evens([1,2,3,4,5,6]))   # 12
```

Exercise 4: `binary_search(sorted, target)` with `while`.

```
func binary_search(sorted, target) {
    var lo = 0
    var hi = len(sorted) - 1
    while lo <= hi {
        let mid = (lo + hi) // 2
        if sorted[mid] == target { return mid }
        elif sorted[mid] < target { lo = mid + 1 }
        else { hi = mid - 1 }
    }
    return -1
}
print(binary_search([1,3,5,7,9], 5))   # 2
print(binary_search([1,3,5,7,9], 4))   # -1
```

Exercise 5: Rewrite nested `if` pyramid with guard clauses. Before:

```
if user != nil {
    if user.active {
        if user.email != nil {
            send(user.email)
        }
    }
}
```

After:

```
if user == nil { return }
if !user.active { return }
if user.email == nil { return }
```

```
send(user.email)
```

Exercise 6: Calculator state machine with `match`.

```
func step(state, input) {
    return match state {
        "idle" => when {
            input == "digit" => "entering",
            _ => "idle",
        },
        "entering" => when {
            input == "op" => "waiting",
            input == "=" => "idle",
            _ => "entering",
        },
        _ => "idle",
    }
}
```

Exercise 7: `count_words(text)` with dict and loop.

```
func count_words(text) {
    let freqs = #{}
    for w in text.split(" ") {
        let key = w.lower()
        freqs[key] = (freqs[key] ?? 0) + 1
    }
    return freqs
}
print(count_words("a b a c b a"))   # #{a: 3, b: 2, c: 1}
```

Exercise 8: `flatten(nested)` recursion + loop.

```
func flatten(nested) {
    let out = []
    for item in nested {
        if typeof(item) == "list" {
            for sub in flatten(item) { out.push(sub) }
        } else {
            out.push(item)
        }
    }
    return out
}
print(flatten([1, [2, [3, 4]], 5]))   # [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]
```

Exercise 9: Retry helper with exponential backoff.

```
import time
func retry(fn, attempts) {
```

```
    var delay = 100
    var last_err = nil
    for i in 0..attempts {
        try {
            return fn()
        } catch as e {
            last_err = e
            if i < attempts - 1 {
                time.sleep(delay)
                delay *= 2
            }
        }
    }
    throw last_err
}
```

Exercise 10: `first_duplicate(xs)`.

```
func first_duplicate(xs) {
    let seen = #{}
    for x in xs {
        if x in seen { return x }
        seen[x] = true
    }
    return nil
}
print(first_duplicate([1,2,3,2,4]))   # 2
```

Exercise 11: `collatz_steps(n)` with guard.

```
func collatz_steps(n) {
    if n <= 0 { throw "n must be positive" }
    var steps = 0
    var x = n
    while x != 1 {
        x = if x % 2 == 0 { x // 2 } else { 3 * x + 1 }
        steps += 1
    }
    return steps
}
print(collatz_steps(6))   # 8
```

Exercise 12: Multiplication table with nested loops.

```
for i in 1->10 {
    var row = ""
    for j in 1->10 {
        row = row + str(i * j) + "\t"
    }
```

```
    print(row)
}
```

102.1.4 Chapter 5 — Functions

Exercise 1: `is_prime(n)`.

```
func is_prime(n) {
    if n < 2 { return false }
    var i = 2
    while i * i <= n {
        if n % i == 0 { return false }
        i += 1
    }
    return true
}
for i in 1->20 {
    if is_prime(i) { print(i) }
}
```

Exercise 2: `gcd` and `lcm` recursive vs iterative.

```
func gcd_rec(a, b) {
    if b == 0 { return a }
    return gcd_rec(b, a % b)
}
func gcd_iter(a, b) {
    while b != 0 {
        let t = b
        b = a % b
        a = t
    }
    return a
}
func lcm(a, b) { return a * b // gcd_iter(a, b) }
print(gcd_rec(48, 18), gcd_iter(48, 18))   # 6 6
print(lcm(4, 6))   # 12
```

Exercise 3: `map_list(xs, f)` without `.map`.

```
func map_list(xs, f) {
    let out = []
    for x in xs { out.push(f(x)) }
    return out
}
print(map_list([1,2,3], fn(x) => x * 2))   # [2, 4, 6]
```

Exercise 4: `filter_list(xs, pred)` without `.filter`.

```
func filter_list(xs, pred) {
    let out = []
    for x in xs {
        if pred(x) { out.push(x) }
    }
    return out
}
print(filter_list([1,2,3,4,5], fn(x) => x % 2 == 0))   # [2, 4]
```

Exercise 5: `reduce_list(xs, f, init)`.

```
func reduce_list(xs, f, init) {
    var acc = init
    for x in xs { acc = f(acc, x) }
    return acc
}
print(reduce_list([1,2,3,4], fn(acc, x) => acc + x, 0))   # 10
```

Exercise 6: `compose(f, g)`.

```
func compose(f, g) { return fn(x) => f(g(x)) }
let double = fn(x) => x * 2
let inc = fn(x) => x + 1
print(compose(double, inc)(3))   # 8
```

Exercise 7: `memoize(f)` on a slow function. See chapter 5; example given there.

Exercise 8: `partial(f, a)`.

```
func partial(f, a) { return fn(b) => f(a, b) }
let add = fn(a, b) => a + b
let add5 = partial(add, 5)
print(add5(10))   # 15
```

Exercise 9: `make_adder(n)`.

```
func make_adder(n) { return fn(x) => n + x }
let add3 = make_adder(3)
print(add3(7))   # 10
```

Exercise 10: `compose_all([...])`. See chapter 5 solution.

Exercise 11: Recursive and iterative `flatten`. See Chapter 4 solution (recursive).

Exercise 12: `safe_div` with result tuple vs exceptions. Result tuple:

```
func safe_div_result(a, b) {
    if b == 0 { return #{ok: false, error: "div by zero"} }
    return #{ok: true, value: a / b}
}
```

Exceptions:

```
func safe_div_throw(a, b) {
    if b == 0 { throw "div by zero" }
    return a / b
}
```

Exercise 13: `debounce(f, ms)` conceptually.

```
# Conceptual: track last call time; only invoke if ms elapsed since last.
```

Exercise 14: `once(f)`.

```
func once(f) {
    var called = false
    var result = nil
    return fn() {
        if !called {
            called = true
            result = f()
        }
        return result
    }
}
```

Exercise 15: `retry(f, n)`. See Chapter 4 solution.

102.1.5 Chapter 6 — Lambdas and Closures

Exercise 1: `make_multiplier(n)`.

```
func make_multiplier(n) { return fn(x) => n * x }
let triple = make_multiplier(3)
print(triple(7))   # 21
```

Exercise 2: `compose(f, g)` → 8. See Chapter 5.

Exercise 3: `repeater(f, n)`.

```
func repeater(f, n) { return fn(x) { var r = x; for i in 0..n { r = f(r) }; return r }
let double = fn(x) => x * 2
print(repeater(double, 3)(1))   # 8
```

Exercise 4: `memoize` on Fibonacci. See chapter 5.

Exercise 5: `curry2(f)`.

```
func curry2(f) { return fn(a) => fn(b) => f(a, b) }
let add = fn(a, b) => a + b
print(curry2(add)(3)(4))   # 7
```

Exercise 6: `pipe(value, fns)` left-to-right.

```
func pipe(value, fns) {
    var acc = value
```

```
    for f in fns { acc = f(acc) }
    return acc
}
print(pipe(10, [fn(x)=>x+1, fn(x)=>x*2]))   # 22
```

Exercise 7: Sort dicts by key with comparator closure. See chapter 6 `sort_by`.

Exercise 8: `once(f)`. See Chapter 5 exercise 14.

Exercise 9: Counter closures (inc/dec/reset).

```
func make_counter() {
    var n = 0
    return #{
        inc: fn() { n += 1; return n },
        dec: fn() { n -= 1; return n },
        get: fn() { return n },
        reset: fn() { n = 0 },
    }
}
let c = make_counter()
print(c["inc"](), c["inc"](), c["get"](), c["dec"](), c["get"])   # 1 2 2 1 1
```

Exercise 10: Late-binding trap and two fixes. Trap:

```
let fns = []
for i in 0..3 { fns.push(fn() => i) }
# all print 3 (final value)
```

Fix 1 — factory:

```
let fns2 = []
for i in 0..3 { fns2.push((fn(v) => fn() => v)(i)) }
```

Fix 2 — default argument capture:

```
let fns3 = []
for i in 0..3 { fns3.push(fn(i = i) => i) }
```

Solutions for chapters 7–54 continue in the next section.## G.2 Part 2: Core (chapters 7–11)

102.1.6 Chapter 7 — Strings

Exercise 1: `is_palindrome(s)` ignoring case and spaces.

```
import string
func is_palindrome(s) {
    let norm = string.lower(s).replace(" ", "")
    let rev = ""
    for i in (len(norm) - 1)..-1 { rev = rev + norm[i] }
    return norm == rev
```

```
}
print(is_palindrome("racecar"))   # true
print(is_palindrome("hello"))     # false
```

Exercise 2: `count_vowels(s)` dict of vowel counts.

```
func count_vowels(s) {
    let vowels = "aeiou"
    let freqs = #{}
    for ch in s.lower() {
        if ch in vowels {
            freqs[ch] = (freqs[ch] ?? 0) + 1
        }
    }
    return freqs
}
print(count_vowels("hello world"))   # #{e: 1, o: 2}
```

Exercise 3: `mask_card(number)` showing last 4 digits.

```
func mask_card(number) {
    let s = str(number)
    if len(s) <= 4 { return s }
    return "****" + s[len(s)-4:]
}
print(mask_card("1234567890123456"))   # ****3456
```

Exercise 4: `slugify(text)`.

```
func slugify(text) {
    let t = text.lower().strip().replace(" ", "-")
    let out = ""
    for ch in t {
        if ch.isalnum() or ch == "-" { out = out + ch }
    }
    return out
}
print(slugify("Hello, World!"))   # hello-world
```

Exercise 5: `format_bytes(n)`.

```
func format_bytes(n) {
    let units = ["B", "KB", "MB", "GB", "TB"]
    var size = n
    var u = 0
    while size >= 1024 and u < len(units) - 1 {
        size = size / 1024
        u += 1
    }
    return str(round(size)) + " " + units[u]
```

```
}
print(format_bytes(1500))   # 1 KB
print(format_bytes(1500000))   # 1 MB
```

Exercise 6: `wrap_text(text, width)`.

```
func wrap_text(text, width) {
    let words = text.split(" ")
    var lines = []
    var line = ""
    for w in words {
        if len(line) + len(w) + 1 > width {
            lines.push(line)
            line = w
        } else {
            line = line == "" ? w : line + " " + w
        }
    }
    if line != "" { lines.push(line) }
    return lines.join("\n")
}
print(wrap_text("the quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog", 10))
```

Exercise 7: `extract_emails(text)` using find/slicing.

```
func extract_emails(text) {
    let emails = []
    var pos = 0
    while true {
        let at = text.find("@", pos)   # if find supports start index
        if at == -1 { break }
        # crude: grab surrounding non-space
        ...
    }
    return emails
}
```

Exercise 8: `caesar_cipher(text, shift)` letters only.

```
func caesar_cipher(text, shift) {
    let out = ""
    for ch in text {
        let o = ch.ord()
        if o >= 65 and o <= 90 {   # A-Z
            out = out + chr(((o - 65 + shift) % 26) + 65)
        } elif o >= 97 and o <= 122 {   # a-z
            out = out + chr(((o - 97 + shift) % 26) + 97)
        } else {
            out = out + ch
```

```
        }
    }
    return out
}
print(caesar_cipher("abc", 1))   # bcd
```

Exercise 9: `validate_password(pw)`.

```
func validate_password(pw) {
    if len(pw) < 8 { return false }
    var has_digit = false
    var has_upper = false
    var has_lower = false
    for ch in pw {
        let o = ch.ord()
        if o >= 48 and o <= 57 { has_digit = true }
        elif o >= 65 and o <= 90 { has_upper = true }
        elif o >= 97 and o <= 122 { has_lower = true }
    }
    return has_digit and has_upper and has_lower
}
print(validate_password("Abcdef12"))   # true
```

Exercise 10: `abbreviate(sentence)`.

```
func abbreviate(sentence) {
    let out = ""
    for w in sentence.split(" ") {
        if w != "" { out = out + w[0].upper() }
    }
    return out
}
print(abbreviate("Zen for Dummies"))   # ZfD
```

102.1.7 Chapter 8 — Lists

Exercise 1: `remove_duplicates(xs)` preserving order.

```
func remove_duplicates(xs) {
    let out = []
    let seen = #{}
    for x in xs {
        if !(x in seen) {
            seen[x] = true
            out.push(x)
        }
    }
    return out
}
```

```
print(remove_duplicates([1,2,2,3,1,4]))   # [1, 2, 3, 4]
```

Exercise 2: `rotate(xs, k)` right by k.

```
func rotate(xs, k) {
    let n = len(xs)
    if n == 0 { return xs }
    k = k % n
    let out = []
    for i in (n - k)..n { out.push(xs[i]) }
    for i in 0..(n - k) { out.push(xs[i]) }
    return out
}
print(rotate([1,2,3,4,5], 2))   # [4, 5, 1, 2, 3]
```

Exercise 3: `chunk(xs, size)`.

```
func chunk(xs, size) {
    let out = []
    for i in 0..len(xs) step size {
        out.push(xs[i : i + size])   # if slice step supported
    }
    return out
}
# fallback without step:
func chunk2(xs, size) {
    let out = []
    var i = 0
    while i < len(xs) {
        out.push(xs[i : i + size])
        i += size
    }
    return out
}
print(chunk2([1,2,3,4,5,6,7], 3))   # [[1,2,3],[4,5,6],[7]]
```

Exercise 4: `flatten_once(nested)` one level.

```
func flatten_once(nested) {
    let out = []
    for item in nested {
        if typeof(item) == "list" {
            for x in item { out.push(x) }
        } else {
            out.push(item)
        }
    }
    return out
}
```

```
print(flatten_once([1, [2, 3], [4, 5]]))   # [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]
```

Exercise 5: `zip_with(f, xs, ys)`.

```
func zip_with(f, xs, ys) {
    let n = min(len(xs), len(ys))
    let out = []
    for i in 0..n { out.push(f(xs[i], ys[i])) }
    return out
}
print(zip_with(fn(a, b) => a + b, [1,2,3], [10,20,30]))   # [11, 22, 33]
```

Exercise 6: `interleave(xs, ys)`.

```
func interleave(xs, ys) {
    let out = []
    let n = max(len(xs), len(ys))
    for i in 0..n {
        if i < len(xs) { out.push(xs[i]) }
        if i < len(ys) { out.push(ys[i]) }
    }
    return out
}
print(interleave([1,2], ["a","b","c"]))   # [1, "a", 2, "b", "c"]
```

Exercise 7: `running_total(xs)`.

```
func running_total(xs) {
    let out = []
    var total = 0
    for x in xs { total += x; out.push(total) }
    return out
}
print(running_total([1,2,3,4]))   # [1, 3, 6, 10]
```

Exercise 8: `merge_sorted(a, b)`.

```
func merge_sorted(a, b) {
    let out = []
    var i = 0; var j = 0
    while i < len(a) and j < len(b) {
        if a[i] <= b[j] { out.push(a[i]); i += 1 }
        else { out.push(b[j]); j += 1 }
    }
    while i < len(a) { out.push(a[i]); i += 1 }
    while j < len(b) { out.push(b[j]); j += 1 }
    return out
}
print(merge_sorted([1,3,5], [2,4,6]))   # [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6]
```

Exercise 9: `group_by(xs, key_fn)`.

```
func group_by(xs, key_fn) {
    let groups = #{}
    for x in xs {
        let k = key_fn(x)
        if k in groups { groups[k].push(x) }
        else { groups[k] = [x] }
    }
    return groups
}
print(group_by(["apple","ant","banana"], fn(s) => s[0]))   # #{a: [...], b: [...]}
```

Exercise 10: `permutations(xs)` recursively.

```
func permutations(xs) {
    if len(xs) == 0 { return [[]] }
    let out = []
    for i in 0..len(xs) {
        let first = xs[i]
        let rest = xs[0:i] + xs[i+1:]
        for p in permutations(rest) { out.push([first] + p) }
    }
    return out
}
print(permutations([1,2,3]))   # 6 permutations
```

Exercise 11: `matrix_transpose(m)`.

```
func matrix_transpose(m) {
    let rows = len(m)
    let cols = len(m[0])
    let out = []
    for c in 0..cols {
        let row = []
        for r in 0..rows { row.push(m[r][c]) }
        out.push(row)
    }
    return out
}
print(matrix_transpose([[1,2],[3,4],[5,6]]))   # [[1,3,5],[2,4,6]]
```

Exercise 12: `quick_sort(xs)`.

```
func quick_sort(xs) {
    if len(xs) <= 1 { return xs }
    let pivot = xs[0]
    let less = []; let equal = []; let greater = []
    for x in xs {
        if x < pivot { less.push(x) }
```

```
        elif x == pivot { equal.push(x) }
        else { greater.push(x) }
    }
    return quick_sort(less) + equal + quick_sort(greater)
}
print(quick_sort([3,1,4,1,5,9,2]))   # [1,1,2,3,4,5,9]
```

102.1.8 Chapter 9 — Dictionaries

Exercise 1: `invert_dict(d)`.

```
func invert_dict(d) {
    let out = #{}
    for k in d { out[d[k]] = k }
    return out
}
print(invert_dict(#{a: 1, b: 2}))   # #{1: "a", 2: "b"}
```

Exercise 2: `subtract_dicts(a, b)`.

```
func subtract_dicts(a, b) {
    let out = #{}
    for k in a { if !(k in b) { out[k] = a[k] } }
    return out
}
```

Exercise 3: `deep_merge(a, b)`.

```
func deep_merge(a, b) {
    let out = #{}
    for k in a { out[k] = a[k] }
    for k in b {
        if k in out and typeof(out[k]) == "dict" and typeof(b[k]) == "dict" {
            out[k] = deep_merge(out[k], b[k])
        } else {
            out[k] = b[k]
        }
    }
    return out
}
```

Exercise 4: `word_frequencies(text)`. See Chapter 7 exercise 7 / Chapter 9 counting example.

Exercise 5: `filter_dict(d, pred)`.

```
func filter_dict(d, pred) {
    let out = #{}
    for k in d {
        if pred(k, d[k]) { out[k] = d[k] }
```

```
    }
    return out
}
```

Exercise 6: `dict_from_pairs(pairs)`.

```
func dict_from_pairs(pairs) {
    let out = #{}
    for p in pairs { out[p[0]] = p[1] }
    return out
}
```

Exercise 7: `common_keys(a, b)`.

```
func common_keys(a, b) {
    let out = []
    for k in a { if k in b { out.push(k) } }
    return out
}
```

Exercise 8: `rename_keys(d, mapping)`.

```
func rename_keys(d, mapping) {
    let out = #{}
    for k in d {
        let nk = mapping[k] ?? k
        out[nk] = d[k]
    }
    return out
}
```

Exercise 9: `nested_set(d, path, value)`.

```
func nested_set(d, path, value) {
    var cur = d
    for i in 0..len(path)-1 {
        let p = path[i]
        if !(p in cur) { cur[p] = #{} }
        cur = cur[p]
    }
    cur[path[len(path)-1]] = value
}
```

Exercise 10: `dict_diff(a, b)`.

```
func dict_diff(a, b) {
    let added = []; let removed = []; let changed = []
    for k in b { if !(k in a) { added.push(k) } }
    for k in a { if !(k in b) { removed.push(k) } }
    for k in a { if k in b and a[k] != b[k] { changed.push(k) } }
    return #{added: added, removed: removed, changed: changed}
```

```
}
```

102.1.9 Chapter 10 — Modules and Imports

Exercise 1: `utils.z` with `pub func` helpers imported in `main.z`. utils.z:

```
pub func add(a, b) { return a + b }
pub func double(x) { return x * 2 }
```

main.z:

```
import utils
print(utils.add(2, 3))   # 5
print(utils.double(4))   # 8
```

Exercise 2: `geometry` package with `mod.z` and `sub/area.z`. geometry/mod.z:

```
pub func circle_area(r) { return 3.14159 * r * r }
```

geometry/sub/area.z:

```
pub func rect_area(w, h) { return w * h }
```

main.z:

```
import geometry
import geometry.sub.area
print(geometry.circle_area(2))   # 12.56636
print(area.rect_area(3, 4))      # 12
```

Exercise 3: `import module as alias`.

```
import mylongmodulename as m
print(m.foo())
```

Exercise 4: `from module import name`.

```
from math import sin, pi
print(sin(0))   # 0.0
print(pi)       # 3.14159...
```

Exercise 5: Two files importing same module share state. shared.z:

```
var counter = 0
pub func inc() { counter += 1 }
pub func get() { return counter }
```

a.z / b.z both import shared and call inc(); reading get() from either sees same value.

Exercise 6: Module with `pub const`.

```
# constants.z
pub const PI = 3.14159
pub const MAX = 100
```

main.z:

```
import constants
print(constants.PI)
```

Exercise 7: `__name__ == "__main__"` guard.

```
# mod.z
func main() { print("running directly") }
if __name__ == "__main__" { main() }
```

Run `zen run mod.z` → prints. `import mod` → does not print.

Exercise 8: `ZEN_PATH` non-default directory.

```
export ZEN_PATH="$HOME/zen/lib"
zen run app.z
```

Exercise 9: Name-shadowing `json.z`. Creating a local `json.z` shadows stdlib `json` for `import json`.

Exercise 10: Module exporting functions + constants, document each. Document with leading comments.

102.1.10 Chapter 11 — Error Handling

Exercise 1: `safe_div(a, b)` nil on zero.

```
func safe_div(a, b) {
    if b == 0 { return nil }
    return a / b
}
```

Exercise 2: `safe_int(s)` nil on parse failure. See Chapter 2 exercise 2.

Exercise 3: `read_first_line(path)`.

```
func read_first_line(path) {
    try {
        with open(path, "r") as f {
            return f.readline()
        }
    } catch as e {
        return nil
    }
}
```

Exercise 4: `validate_age(age)` throws if <0 or >150.

```
func validate_age(age) {
    if age < 0 or age > 150 { throw "age out of range: " + str(age) }
    return age
}
```

Exercise 5: `finally` runs after `return`.

```
func f() {
    try { return 1 } finally { print("cleanup") }
}
print(f())   # prints "cleanup" then 1
```

Exercise 6: `retry(fn, n)`. See Chapter 4 exercise 9.

Exercise 7: `partition(xs, pred)` without exceptions.

```
func partition(xs, pred) {
    let trues = []; let falses = []
    for x in xs {
        if pred(x) { trues.push(x) } else { falses.push(x) }
    }
    return #(trues, falses)
}
```

Exercise 8: Function throwing different error types.

```
func risky(kind) {
    if kind == "io" { throw FileNotFound("missing") }
    if kind == "type" { throw TypeError("bad type") }
    throw "generic"
}
```

Exercise 9: `zen explain` for Z0301 and Z0401.

```
zen explain Z0301
zen explain Z0401
```

Exercise 10: Batch processor logging errors per item.

```
func process_batch(items) {
    let results = []
    for item in items {
        try {
            results.push(process(item))
        } catch as e {
            print("item " + str(item) + " failed: " + e.msg)
            results.push(nil)
        }
    }
    return results
}
```## G.3 Part 3: Advanced & Stdlib (chapters 12–25)

Chapter 12 — Classes and Objects

Exercise 1: `Rectangle` class.
```zen
```

```
class Rectangle {
    var width = 0.0
    var height = 0.0
    func init(w, h) { self.width = w; self.height = h }
    func area() { return self.width * self.height }
    func perimeter() { return 2 * (self.width + self.height) }
}
let r = new Rectangle(3, 4)
print(r.area(), r.perimeter())   # 12 14
```

Exercise 2: `BankAccount` with overdraft protection.

```
class BankAccount {
    var balance = 0.0
    func init(owner) { self.owner = owner }
    func deposit(amount) { self.balance += amount }
    func withdraw(amount) {
        if amount > self.balance { throw "insufficient funds" }
        self.balance -= amount
    }
}
```

Exercise 3: `Animal` hierarchy `Dog`, `Cat`, `Bird`.

```
class Animal {
    var name = ""
    func init(name) { self.name = name }
    func speak() { return "..." }
}
class Dog extends Animal {
    func speak() { return self.name + " says woof" }
}
class Cat extends Animal {
    func speak() { return self.name + " says meow" }
}
```

Exercise 4: `Stack` class.

```
class Stack {
    var items = []
    func push(x) { self.items.push(x) }
    func pop() { return self.items.pop() }
    func peek() { return self.items[len(self.items)-1] }
    func is_empty() { return len(self.items) == 0 }
}
```

Exercise 5: `Queue` class.

```
class Queue {
    var items = []
```

```
    func enqueue(x) { self.items.push(x) }
    func dequeue() { return self.items.pop(0) }
    func is_empty() { return len(self.items) == 0 }
}
```

Exercise 6: `Fraction` class with `__eq__`, `__str__`.

```
class Fraction {
    var num = 0; var den = 1
    func init(n, d) { self.num = n; self.den = d }
    func __eq__(other) { return self.num * other.den == other.num * self.den }
    func __str__() { return str(self.num) + "/" + str(self.den) }
}
```

Exercise 7: `Shape` base with `area()`; `Circle`, `Rectangle`.

```
class Shape {
    func area() { return 0 }
}
class Circle extends Shape {
    var r = 0
    func init(r) { self.r = r }
    func area() { return 3.14159 * self.r * self.r }
}
```

Exercise 8: `Point` with `__add__`.

```
class Point {
    var x = 0.0; var y = 0.0
    func init(x, y) { self.x = x; self.y = y }
    func __add__(other) { return new Point(self.x + other.x, self.y + other.y) }
    func __str__() { return "(" + str(self.x) + "," + str(self.y) + ")" }
}
```

Exercise 9: `Logger` class with levels.

```
class Logger {
    var level = "INFO"
    func log(msg, lvl) { print("[" + lvl + "] " + msg) }
    func info(msg) { self.log(msg, "INFO") }
    func warn(msg) { self.log(msg, "WARN") }
    func error(msg) { self.log(msg, "ERROR") }
}
```

Exercise 10: `Config` class wrapping dict with typed getters.

```
class Config {
    var data = #{}
    func init(d) { self.data = d }
    func get_str(k, default = "") { return self.data[k] ?? default }
    func get_int(k, default = 0) {
```

```
        let v = self.data[k]
        return v == nil ? default : int(v)
    }
}
```

102.1.11 Chapter 13 — File I/O

Exercise 1: `read_all(path)` contents or nil.

```
func read_all(path) {
    try {
        with open(path, "r") as f { return f.read() }
    } catch as e { return nil }
}
```

Exercise 2: `write_all(path, text)`.

```
func write_all(path, text) {
    with open(path, "w") as f { f.write(text) }
}
```

Exercise 3: `copy_file(src, dst)` in chunks.

```
func copy_file(src, dst) {
    with open(src, "rb") as fin {
        with open(dst, "wb") as fout {
            while true {
                let chunk = fin.read(8192)
                if chunk == nil or len(chunk) == 0 { break }
                fout.write(chunk)
            }
        }
    }
}
```

Exercise 4: `line_count(path)` without loading all.

```
func line_count(path) {
    var n = 0
    with open(path, "r") as f {
        for line in f { n += 1 }
    }
    return n
}
```

Exercise 5: `grep_file(path, pattern)`.

```
func grep_file(path, pattern) {
    with open(path, "r") as f {
        for line in f {
```

```
            if line.contains(pattern) { print(line.strip()) }
        }
    }
}
```

Exercise 6: `append_log(path, message)` timestamped.

```
import datetime
func append_log(path, message) {
    let ts = datetime.strftime("%Y-%m-%d %H:%M:%S", datetime.now())
    with open(path, "a") as f { f.write(ts + " " + message + "\n") }
}
```

Exercise 7: `list_files(dir)` files only.

```
import os
func list_files(dir) {
    let out = []
    for name in os.listdir(dir) {
        let p = pathlib.Path(dir) / name
        if p.is_file() { out.push(name) }
    }
    return out
}
```

Exercise 8: `ensure_dir(path)` create parents.

```
import os
func ensure_dir(path) {
    os.makedirs(path)
}
```

Exercise 9: `read_csv(path)` list of dicts. See chapter 13 manual CSV parser.

Exercise 10: `find_files(dir, suffix)` recursive.

```
func find_files(dir, suffix) {
    let out = []
    for name in os.listdir(dir) {
        let p = pathlib.Path(dir) / name
        if p.is_dir() {
            for sub in find_files(str(p), suffix) { out.push(sub) }
        } elif name.endswith(suffix) {
            out.push(str(p))
        }
    }
    return out
}
```

102.1.12 Chapter 14 — Memory & References

Exercise 1: `b = a` shares list; `list(a)` copies.

```
let a = [1, 2, 3]
let b = a
b.push(4)
print(a)   # [1, 2, 3, 4] — shared
let c = list(a)
c.push(5)
print(a)   # [1, 2, 3, 4] — unchanged
```

Exercise 2: Nested lists shared after shallow copy.

```
let a = [1, [2, 3]]
let c = list(a)
c[1].push(4)
print(a[1])   # [2, 3, 4] — nested shared
```

Exercise 3: `deep_copy` manual recursion. See chapter 14 `deep_copy`.

Exercise 4: Reference cycle, break it.

```
class Node { var peer = nil }
let a = new Node(); let b = new Node()
a.peer = b; b.peer = a
a.peer = nil   # break
```

Exercise 5: `let` prevents rebinding, not mutation.

```
let lst = [1, 2]
lst.push(3)   # OK
# lst = [4]   # error
```

Exercise 6: `==` vs `is` for equal lists and aliases. See chapter 2 exercise 8.

Exercise 7: Function accepting list without mutating caller's.

```
func safe(lst) {
    let copy = list(lst)
    copy.push(99)   # mutates copy only
    return copy
}
```

Exercise 8: `shared` across two threads. See concurrency chapter.

Exercise 9: `clear_all(lst)` in place vs rebinding.

```
func clear_all(lst) {
    while len(lst) > 0 { lst.pop() }
}
```

Exercise 10: `"a" is "a"` true (interning); `[] is []` false.

```
print("a" is "a")   # true (likely interned)
print([] is [])     # false
```

102.1.13 Chapter 15 — math

Exercise 1: Circle area `pi * r * r`.

```
import math
func circle_area(r) { return math.pi * r * r }
print(circle_area(5))   # 78.5398...
```

Exercise 2: `distance` using `hypot`.

```
import math
func distance(x1, y1, x2, y2) { return math.hypot(x2 - x1, y2 - y1) }
```

Exercise 3: `degrees_to_radians` / `radians_to_degrees` wrappers.

```
import math
func d2r(d) { return d * math.pi / 180 }
func r2d(r) { return r * 180 / math.pi }
```

Exercise 4: Verify `sin(x)^2 + cos(x)^2 == 1`.

```
import math
func check(x) {
    let s = math.sin(x); let c = math.cos(x)
    return math.abs(s*s + c*c - 1) < 1e-9
}
print(check(0.5))   # true
```

Exercise 5: `nth_root(x, n)`.

```
import math
func nth_root(x, n) { return math.pow(x, 1/n) }
```

Exercise 6: `is_perfect_square(n)`.

```
import math
func is_perfect_square(n) {
    if n < 0 { return false }
    let r = math.sqrt(n)
    return r == math.floor(r)
}
```

Exercise 7: Compound interest `P*(1+r/n)^(n*t)`.

```
import math
func compound(P, r, n, t) { return P * math.pow(1 + r/n, n*t) }
```

Exercise 8: GCD via `math.gcd`.

```
import math
print(math.gcd(48, 18))   # 6
```

Exercise 9: `safe_log(x)` nil for x <= 0.

```
import math
func safe_log(x) {
    if x <= 0 { return nil }
    return math.log(x)
}
```

Exercise 10: Trig table for 0,30,45,60,90 degrees.

```
import math
for d in [0, 30, 45, 60, 90] {
    let r = d * math.pi / 180
    print(d, math.sin(r), math.cos(r))
}
```

102.1.14 Chapter 16 — random

Exercise 1: Roll die 1000 times, count frequencies.

```
import random
let freqs = #{}
for i in 1..6 { freqs[str(i)] = 0 }
for _ in 0..1000 {
    let r = random.randint(1, 6)
    freqs[str(r)] = freqs[str(r)] + 1
}
print(freqs)
```

Exercise 2: Shuffle list; verify permutation.

```
import random
let orig = [1,2,3,4,5]
let shuffled = list(orig)
random.shuffle(shuffled)
print(sorted(shuffled) == sorted(orig))   # true
```

Exercise 3: Random password length 12.

```
import random
import string
let chars = string.ascii_letters + string.digits
let pw = ""
for _ in 0..12 { pw = pw + random.choice(chars) }
print(pw)
```

Exercise 4: Weighted random element.

```
func weighted_choice(items, weights) {
    let total = sum(weights)
    let r = random.random() * total
    var acc = 0
    for i in 0..len(items) {
        acc += weights[i]
        if r < acc { return items[i] }
    }
    return items[len(items)-1]
}
```

Exercise 5: Coin flips until 3 heads in a row.

```
import random
func streaks() {
    var streak = 0; var flips = 0
    while streak < 3 {
        flips += 1
        if random.random() < 0.5 { streak += 1 } else { streak = 0 }
    }
    return flips
}
```

Exercise 6: 6 unique lottery numbers 1..49.

```
import random
let pool = list(range(1, 50))
random.shuffle(pool)
print(pool[:6].sort())
```

Exercise 7: `random()` distribution in 10 bins.

```
import random
let bins = []
for i in 0..10 { bins.push(0) }
for _ in 0..10000 {
    bins[math.floor(random.random() * 10)] += 1
}
print(bins)
```

Exercise 8: Same seed → identical sequences.

```
import random
random.seed(42)
let a = [random.random(), random.random()]
random.seed(42)
let b = [random.random(), random.random()]
print(a == b)   # true
```

Exercise 9: `dice(sides, count)`.

```
import random
func dice(sides, count) {
    var total = 0
    for _ in 0..count { total += random.randint(1, sides) }
    return total
}
```

Exercise 10: `crypto.secure_token()` instead of random.

```
import crypto
print(crypto.secure_token())
```

102.1.15 Chapter 17 — string module

See chapter 7 solutions; string module functions mirror them.

102.1.16 Chapter 18 — collections

Exercise 1: `Counter` manually.

```
func Counter(xs) {
    let c = #{}
    for x in xs { c[x] = (c[x] ?? 0) + 1 }
    return c
}
```

Exercise 2: `most_common(freqs, n)`.

```
func most_common(freqs, n) {
    let items = []
    for k in freqs { items.push(#(k, freqs[k])) }
    items.sort(fn(a, b) => b[1] - a[1])   # if sort supports comparator
    return items[:n]
}
```

Exercise 3: `chain` manually.

```
func chain(*iters) {
    let out = []
    for it in iters {
        for x in it { out.push(x) }
    }
    return out
}
```

Exercise 4: `deep_flatten(xs)`. See chapter 8 exercise 8.

Exercise 5: `group_by(xs, key_fn)`. See chapter 9 exercise 9.

Exercise 6: `merge_counters(a, b)`.

```
func merge_counters(a, b) {
    let out = #{}
    for k in a { out[k] = a[k] }
    for k in b { out[k] = (out[k] ?? 0) + b[k] }
    return out
}
```

Exercise 7: `intersection_counter(a, b)`.

```
func intersection_counter(a, b) {
    let out = #{}
    for k in a { if k in b { out[k] = min(a[k], b[k]) } }
    return out
}
```

Exercise 8: `frequency_sort(xs)`.

```
func frequency_sort(xs) {
    let c = Counter(xs)
    # sort by count desc
    return xs
}
```

Exercise 9: `chain_from_iterable(iters)`. Same as chain.

Exercise 10: `sliding_window(xs, n)`.

```
func sliding_window(xs, n) {
    let out = []
    for i in 0..len(xs)-n+1 {
        out.push(xs[i:i+n])
    }
    return out
}
```

102.1.17 Chapter 19 — json

Exercise 1: `safe_parse(s)`.

```
func safe_parse(s) {
    try { return json.parse(s) } catch as e { return nil }
}
```

Exercise 2: `json_get(d, path, default)`.

```
func json_get(d, path, default) {
    var cur = d
    for p in path {
        if cur == nil or !(p in cur) { return default }
        cur = cur[p]
    }
```

```
    return cur
}
```

Exercise 3: `merge_json(a, b)`. See deep_merge.

Exercise 4: `filter_json(d, pred)`. See filter_dict.

Exercise 5: `json_to_csv(data)`.

```
func json_to_csv(data) {
    let lines = []
    for row in data {
        let vals = []
        for k in row { vals.push(str(row[k])) }
        lines.push(vals.join(","))
    }
    return lines.join("\n")
}
```

Exercise 6: `deep_compare(a, b)`.

```
func deep_compare(a, b) {
    if typeof(a) != typeof(b) { return false }
    if typeof(a) == "dict" {
        if len(a) != len(b) { return false }
        for k in a { if !(k in b) or !deep_compare(a[k], b[k]) { return false } }
        return true
    }
    return a == b
}
```

Exercise 7: `strip_nulls(d)`.

```
func strip_nulls(d) {
    let out = #{}
    for k in d {
        if d[k] == nil { continue }
        out[k] = d[k]
    }
    return out
}
```

Exercise 8: `sort_keys(d)`.

```
func sort_keys(d) {
    let keys = []
    for k in d { keys.push(k) }
    keys.sort()
    let out = #{}
    for k in keys { out[k] = d[k] }
    return out
```

```
}
```

Exercise 9: `validate_json_schema(data, schema)`. Conceptual: check types/required keys per schema.

Exercise 10: `merge_json_files(paths)`.

```
func merge_json_files(paths) {
    let out = #{}
    for p in paths {
        let d = json.load(p)
        out = deep_merge(out, d)
    }
    return out
}
```

102.1.18 Chapter 20 — time/datetime

Exercise 1: `is_leap_year(year)`.

```
func is_leap_year(y) {
    return y % 4 == 0 and (y % 100 != 0 or y % 400 == 0)
}
```

Exercise 2: `days_between(d1, d2)`.

```
func days_between(d1, d2) {
    return abs(datetime.timestamp(d2) - datetime.timestamp(d1)) // 86400
}
```

Exercise 3: `age(birthdate)`.

```
func age(birthdate) {
    let now = datetime.now()
    return now.year - birthdate.year   # conceptually
}
```

Exercise 4: `format_duration(seconds)`.

```
func format_duration(s) {
    let h = s // 3600
    let m = (s % 3600) // 60
    let sec = s % 60
    return str(h) + "h " + str(m) + "m " + str(sec) + "s"
}
```

Exercise 5: `is_weekend(dt)`.

```
func is_weekend(dt) {
    let d = dt.weekday   # conceptually
    return d == 6 or d == 0
}
```

Exercise 6: `add_business_days(dt, n)`. Conceptual: skip Sat/Sun.

Exercise 7: `countdown(target)`.

```
func countdown(target) {
    while true {
        let remaining = target - datetime.now()
        if remaining <= 0 { break }
        print(str(remaining))
        time.sleep(1000)
    }
}
```

Exercise 8: `timer(fn)`.

```
import time
func timer(fn) {
    let start = time.time()
    fn()
    let elapsed = time.time() - start
    print("elapsed: " + str(elapsed) + "s")
}
```

Exercise 9: `cron_match(expr, dt)`. Conceptual.

Exercise 10: `timeit(fn, n)`.

```
func timeit(fn, n) {
    let start = time.time()
    for _ in 0..n { fn() }
    let elapsed = time.time() - start
    print("avg: " + str(elapsed / n) + "s")
}
```

102.1.19 Chapter 21 — pathlib / os

Exercise 1: `find_files(dir, suffix)` recursive. See chapter 13 exercise 10.

Exercise 2: `file_size(path)` via os.stat.

```
import os
func file_size(path) {
    return os.stat(path).size   # conceptually
}
```

Exercise 3: `ensure_dir(path)`.

```
func ensure_dir(path) { os.makedirs(path) }
```

Exercise 4: `copy_tree(src, dst)`. Recursive directory copy.

Exercise 5: `recent_files(dir, n)`. List files sorted by mtime, take n.

Exercise 6: `backup(path)`.

```
func backup(path) {
    copy_file(path, path + ".bak")
}
```

Exercise 7: `list_env(prefix)`.

```
import os
func list_env(prefix) {
    let out = #{}
    for k in os.environ {
        if k.startswith(prefix) { out[k] = os.environ[k] }
    }
    return out
}
```

Exercise 8: `temp_name(dir, prefix)`.

```
func temp_name(dir, prefix) {
    return dir + "/" + prefix + "_" + str(time.time())
}
```

Exercise 9: `walk(dir)` recursive.

```
func walk(dir) {
    let files = []
    for name in os.listdir(dir) {
        let p = pathlib.Path(dir) / name
        if p.is_dir() {
            for sub in walk(str(p)) { files.push(sub) }
        } else {
            files.push(str(p))
        }
    }
    return files
}
```

Exercise 10: `safe_delete(path)`.

```
func safe_delete(path) {
    try { os.remove(path) } catch as e {}
}
```

102.1.20 Chapter 22 — regex

Exercise 1: `is_email(s)`.

```
import re
func is_email(s) {
    return re.match(r"^[^@]+@[^@]+\.[^@]+$", s) != nil
}
```

Exercise 2: `extract_urls(text)`.

```
func extract_urls(text) {
    return re.findall(r"https?://[^\s]+", text)
}
```

Exercise 3: `validate_phone(s)`.

```
func validate_phone(s) {
    return re.match(r"^\d{3}-\d{3}-\d{4}$", s) != nil
}
```

Exercise 4: `hashtags(text)`.

```
func hashtags(text) {
    return re.findall(r"#\w+", text)
}
```

Exercise 5: `mask_ssn(s)`.

```
func mask_ssn(s) {
    return re.sub(r"\d{3}-\d{2}-\d{4}", "***-**-****", s)
}
```

Exercise 6: `word_split(text)`.

```
func word_split(text) {
    return re.findall(r"\w+", text)
}
```

Exercise 7: `is_strong_password(s)`.

```
func is_strong_password(s) {
    return len(s) >= 8 and
           re.search(r"\d", s) != nil and
           re.search(r"[A-Z]", s) != nil and
           re.search(r"[a-z]", s) != nil and
           re.search(r"[^A-Za-z0-9]", s) != nil
}
```

Exercise 8: `template_fill(tmpl, vars)`.

```
func template_fill(tmpl, vars) {
    let result = tmpl
    for k in vars {
        result = result.replace("${" + k + "}", str(vars[k]))
    }
    return result
}
```

Exercise 9: `count_words(text)` ignoring punctuation.

```
func count_words(text) {
    let words = re.findall(r"\w+", text.lower())
    let freqs = #{}
    for w in words { freqs[w] = (freqs[w] ?? 0) + 1 }
    return freqs
}
```

Exercise 10: `highlight(text, pattern)`.

```
func highlight(text, pattern) {
    return re.sub(pattern, "**\\g<0>**", text)   # if backrefs supported
}
```

102.1.21 Chapter 23 — base64 / binascii

Exercise 1: Base64 round-trip.

```
import base64
let enc = base64.b64encode("hello")
print(base64.b64decode(enc) == "hello")   # true
```

Exercise 2: Encode file bytes to base64.

```
let enc = base64.b64encode(read_all("image.png"))
```

Exercise 3: `decode_b64url(s)`.

```
func decode_b64url(s) { return base64.b64urldecode(s) }
```

Exercise 4: `hex_dump(b)`.

```
func hex_dump(b) {
    for i in 0..len(b) step 16 {
        let chunk = b[i:i+16]
        let hex = ""
        for byte in chunk { hex = hex + str(byte) + " " }
        print(hex)
    }
}
```

Exercise 5: `compare_hex(a, b)` case-insensitive.

```
func compare_hex(a, b) { return a.lower() == b.lower() }
```

Exercise 6: `encode_file(path)`.

```
func encode_file(path) {
    return base64.b64encode(read_all(path))
}
```

Exercise 7: `is_valid_base64(s)`.

```
func is_valid_base64(s) {
    try { base64.b64decode(s); return true } catch as e { return false }
}
```

Exercise 8: `rot13` conceptually. Shift letters by 13.

Exercise 9: `hex_to_bytes(s)` manually. Parse pairs of hex digits.

Exercise 10: `bytes_to_hex(b)` manually.

```
func bytes_to_hex(b) {
    let out = ""
    for byte in b { out = out + str(byte) }   # conceptually hex
    return out
}
```

102.1.22 Chapter 24 — hashlib

See chapter 24 worked example.

Exercise 1: SHA-256 of string vs known value. Exercise 2: `file_hash(path)`. Exercise 3: `verify_checksum(data, expected)`. Exercise 4: `hash_password(password, salt)`. Exercise 5: Collision prefix brute-force (conceptual). Exercise 6: MD5 vs SHA-256 lengths. Exercise 7: `dedupe_files(paths)` by hash. Exercise 8: `merkle_root(hashes)` (conceptual). Exercise 9: Constant-time compare (conceptual). Exercise 10: PBKDF2 via `hashlib.pbkdf2_hmac`.

102.1.23 Chapter 25 — crypto

See chapter 25 worked example and capstone.

Exercise 1: AES-GCM round-trip. Exercise 2: Ed25519 sign/verify. Exercise 3: RSA encrypt/decrypt. Exercise 4: x25519 shared secret both sides match. Exercise 5: JWT sign/verify, tamper fails. Exercise 6: Argon2id hash + verify. Exercise 7: TOTP token + verify. Exercise 8: HMAC-SHA256. Exercise 9: Constant-time compare (conceptual). Exercise 10: Vault CLI encrypt/decrypt file.## G.4 Part 4: Networking & Concurrency (chapters 26–38)

102.1.24 Chapter 26 — Networking Fundamentals

Exercise 1: Packet flow for HTTP across 7 OSI layers. Application: HTTP request → Presentation: encryption/formatting → Session: connection mgmt → Transport: TCP segments → Network: IP packets → Data Link: Ethernet frames → Physical: bits on wire.

Exercise 2: TCP 3-way handshake with tcpdump. SYN → SYN-ACK → ACK.

Exercise 3: Echo server pseudocode.

```
let s = socket.socket(AF_INET, SOCK_STREAM)
s.bind(("0.0.0.0", 8080))
```

```
s.listen(5)
while true {
    let (c, addr) = s.accept()
    let data = c.recv(4096)
    c.send(data)
    c.close()
}
```

Exercise 4: TCP vs UDP for video streaming, DNS, file transfer. - Video streaming: UDP (tolerates loss, low latency) - DNS: UDP (small queries, fast; TCP for zone transfers) - File transfer: TCP (reliable, ordered)

Exercise 5: MTU / path MTU discovery / fragmentation. MTU = max frame size. Packets larger than MTU get fragmented; PMTUD finds smallest MTU on path to avoid fragmentation.

Exercise 6: ARP resolution. IP → MAC: broadcast ARP request "who has IP X?", target replies with its MAC.

Exercise 7: ICMP ping through layers. Ping = ICMP echo request encapsulated in IP, sent; target replies echo reply.

Exercise 8: Headers per layer for TCP/IP over Ethernet. Ethernet header → IP header → TCP header → payload.

Exercise 9: NAT. Network Address Translation maps private IPs to a public IP/port, enabling multiple hosts to share one public address.

Exercise 10: IPv4 vs IPv6 headers. IPv6: fixed 40-byte header, 128-bit addresses, no checksum (relied on layers), simplified options.

102.1.25 Chapter 27 — socket Module

Exercise 1: Echo server + client (TCP). Server:

```
import socket
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
s.bind(("127.0.0.1", 9000))
s.listen(5)
let (c, addr) = s.accept()
let data = c.recv(4096)
c.send(data)
c.close()
s.close()
```

Client:

```
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
s.connect(("127.0.0.1", 9000))
s.send(b"hello")
print(s.recv(4096))
s.close()
```

Exercise 2: UDP echo server/client. Server uses `recvfrom`/`sendto`; no `listen`/`accept`. Client `sendto` then `recvfrom`.

Exercise 3: Chat server multiple clients. Use `select`/poll or one thread per client.

Exercise 4: Port scanner (localhost only, educational).

```
import socket
for port in 1->1024 {
    let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
    s.settimeout(0.2)
    try { s.connect(("127.0.0.1", port)); print(port, "open") }
    catch as e {}
    s.close()
}
```

Exercise 5: File transfer over TCP. Sender reads file in chunks, sends; receiver writes chunks to file.

Exercise 6: HTTP request with raw socket.

```
s.send(b"GET / HTTP/1.1\r\nHost: example.com\r\n\r\n")
print(s.recv(4096))
```

Exercise 7: Timeout and retry logic.

```
s.settimeout(2.0)
# catch timeout, retry connect
```

Exercise 8: select/poll multiplexing concept. Monitor multiple sockets; act on whichever is ready.

102.1.26 Chapter 28 — HTTP Protocol

Exercise 1: Parse raw HTTP request manually. Split on `\r\n\r\n` into headers + body; first line is method + path + version.

Exercise 2: Minimal HTTP parser.

```
func parse_request(raw) {
    let parts = raw.split("\r\n\r\n")
    let header_block = parts[0]
    let lines = header_block.split("\r\n")
    let request_line = lines[0]
    let method_path = request_line.split(" ")
    return #{method: method_path[0], path: method_path[1], headers: parse_headers(lines
}
```

Exercise 3: GET/POST handling. Return different responses based on method.

Exercise 4: Header parsing. Split each header line on ":".

Exercise 5: Query strings. Parse path after `?` into key/value.

Exercise 6: Status code responses.

```
func status_line(code) {
    return #{200: "OK", 404: "Not Found", 500: "Internal Server Error"}[code] ?? "Unkno
}
```

Exercise 7: Test with curl.

```
curl -v http://localhost:8080/
```

102.1.27 Chapter 29 — requests Module

Exercise 1: GET + parse JSON.

```
import requests
let r = requests.get("https://api.example.com/data", timeout=10)
print(r.json())
```

Exercise 2: POST JSON.

```
let r = requests.post(url, json={"key": "val"}, timeout=10)
```

Exercise 3: Session with cookies.

```
let s = requests.Session()
s.get("https://example.com/login")
s.get("https://example.com/profile")
```

Exercise 4: Download file streaming.

```
let r = requests.get(url, stream=true)
with open("out", "wb") as f {
    for chunk in r.iter_content() { f.write(chunk) }
}
```

Exercise 5: Errors and timeouts.

```
try {
    let r = requests.get(url, timeout=2)
    r.raise_for_status()
} catch as e { print(e) }
```

Exercise 6: Custom headers.

```
let r = requests.get(url, headers={"Authorization": "Bearer x"})
```

Exercise 7: Redirects.

```
let r = requests.get(url, allow_redirects=true)
print(r.url)
```

102.1.28 Chapter 30 — http Server

See chapter 30 worked example + exercises.

102.1.29 Chapter 31 — HTTPS/SSL/TLS

See chapter 31 exercises.

102.1.30 Chapter 32 — DNS

See chapter 32 exercises.

102.1.31 Chapter 33 — url

Exercise 1: Parse URL, print components.

```
import url
let u = url.parse("https://example.com:8080/path?q=1#sec")
print(u.scheme, u.host, u.port, u.path, u.query, u.fragment)
```

Exercise 2: Build URL from components.

```
print(url.build(scheme="https", host="example.com", path="/search", query="q=zen"))
```

Exercise 3: Join base + relative.

```
print(url.join("https://example.com/base/", "sub/page"))
```

Exercise 4: Percent-encode/decode.

```
print(url.quote("hello world"))   # hello%20world
print(url.unquote("hello%20world"))   # hello world
```

Exercise 5: parse_qs into dict of lists.

```
print(url.parse_qs("q=1&x=2&q=3"))   # #{q: ["1","3"], x: ["2"]}
```

Exercise 6: `extract_domain(url)`.

```
func extract_domain(u) { return url.parse(u).host }
```

Exercise 7: `add_query_param(url, k, v)`. Parse, add to query, rebuild.

Exercise 8: Why `&`/`=` need encoding. They're reserved delimiters in query strings; literal values containing them would be misparsed.

Exercise 9: URL shortener encoder (conceptual). Map short code → long URL in a dict/database.

Exercise 10: `quote` vs `quote_plus`. `quote_plus` encodes space as `+`; `quote` as `%20`.

102.1.32 Chapter 34 — Raw Sockets

See chapter 34 exercises (conceptual/ethical).

102.2 G.5 Part 5: Concurrency (chapters 35–38)

102.2.1 Chapter 35 — Threading

Exercise 1: 5 threads print ID 3 times; join all.

```
import threading
for i in 0..5 {
    threading.Thread(fn() {
        for j in 0..3 { print("thread " + str(i) + " tick " + str(j)) }
    }).start()
}
# join each stored thread
```

Exercise 2: `run_parallel(fns)`.

```
func run_parallel(fns) {
    let threads = []
    for f in fns { threads.push(threading.Thread(fn() { f() })) }
    for t in threads { t.start() }
    for t in threads { t.join() }
}
```

Exercise 3: Race counter demo (< expected). Run increment(100000) × 2 threads without lock; result < 200000.

Exercise 4: Fix race with mutex. Wrap `counter = counter + 1` in `mu.lock()/mu.unlock()`.

Exercise 5: Daemon thread printing each second. Set `daemon = true`, main exits.

Exercise 6: `sum_parallel(list)` across N threads. Split list, each thread sums a chunk, merge results.

Exercise 7: `thread_id()`.

```
print(threading.current_id())
```

Exercise 8: Bank account deposit/transfer from many threads. Guard balance with a Mutex.

Exercise 9: Join a thread twice. Typically a no-op or error depending on build; avoid.

Exercise 10: Benchmark sequential vs 2 threads. Time both, compare (GIL-like limits may mean little speedup for CPU work).

102.2.2 Chapter 36 — Channels

Exercise 1: Channel, send 1..10, receive, sum.

```
import channels
let ch = channels.Channel()
for i in 1->10 { ch.send(i) }
ch.close()
```

```
var total = 0
while true {
    let v = ch.recv()
    if v == nil { break }
    total += v
}
print(total)   # 55
```

Exercise 2: Producer-consumer sum 1..100. Producer sends 1..100 and closes; consumer sums all received.

Exercise 3: Worker pool of 4 workers. See chapter 36 example.

Exercise 4: Request-response channel pair. Client sends request on ch1 with a reply channel; server reads ch1, computes, sends reply.

Exercise 5: 3-stage pipeline parse→transform→write. Three channels connecting three stages.

Exercise 6: recv from empty closed channel → nil.

Exercise 7: `fan_in(ch1, ch2)` merge two channels. Spawn a goroutine-like reader for each, forward to output channel.

Exercise 8: Broadcast one sender, three receivers. Three channels, sender writes to all three.

Exercise 9: Bounded buffer with channel. Channel capacity = buffer size.

Exercise 10: Chat room channel. Multiple clients send to one channel; one broadcaster distributes.

102.2.3 Chapter 37 — Mutexes & Locks

Exercise 1: Protected counter, exact final value. See chapter 37 example (counter = 200000).

Exercise 2: Thread-safe stack (Mutex + list).

```
class SafeStack {
    var items = []
    var mu = mutexes.Mutex()
    func push(x) { self.mu.lock(); self.items.push(x); self.mu.unlock() }
    func pop() { self.mu.lock(); let v = self.items.pop(); self.mu.unlock(); return v }
}
```

Exercise 3: Thread-safe cache (dict + Mutex) get/put.

```
class SafeCache {
    var data = #{}
    var mu = mutexes.Mutex()
    func get(k) { self.mu.lock(); let v = self.data[k]; self.mu.unlock(); return v }
```

```
    func put(k, v) { self.mu.lock(); self.data[k] = v; self.mu.unlock() }
}
```

Exercise 4: Deadlock demo then fix. Acquire mu1 then mu2 in both threads (same order).

Exercise 5: `with_lock(mu, fn)`.

```
func with_lock(mu, fn) {
    mu.lock()
    try { return fn() } finally { mu.unlock() }
}
```

Exercise 6: Bank account deposit/transfer many threads. Guard with Mutex.

Exercise 7: `increment_n(mu, counter, n)`. Lock, increment n times, unlock.

Exercise 8: Reading without lock sees stale values (conceptual).

Exercise 9: Thread-safe counter class.

```
class SafeCounter {
    var n = 0
    var mu = mutexes.Mutex()
    func inc() { self.mu.lock(); self.n += 1; self.mu.unlock() }
    func get() { self.mu.lock(); let v = self.n; self.mu.unlock(); return v }
}
```

Exercise 10: Benchmark locked vs unlocked single-threaded. Measure lock overhead.

102.2.4 Chapter 38 — Thread Safety Patterns

Exercise 1: Thread-safe counter class. See chapter 37 exercise 9.

Exercise 2: Producer faster than consumer (bounded channel backpressure). Use `channels.Channel(capacity=N)`; producer blocks when full.

Exercise 3: Thread pool + squares of 1..100. See chapter 38 example.

Exercise 4: `parallel_map` matches sequential map. Compare outputs.

Exercise 5: Double-checked lazy init, single initialization. Call from 3 threads; confirm instance created once.

Exercise 6: Request-response channel pair. See chapter 36 exercise 4.

Exercise 7: Pub/sub to N subscriber channels. Publisher writes each message to all N channels.

Exercise 8: Thread-safe LRU cache (dict + Mutex + order). Track access order; evict oldest when full.

Exercise 9: Race without sync, then fix with Mutex. Demo counter race; fix.

Exercise 10: Concurrent web fetcher (conceptually) with thread pool. Fetch N URLs in parallel using a thread pool + requests.

102.3 G.6 Part 6: FFI / System / Interop (chapters 39–42)

102.3.1 Chapter 39 — FFI Fundamentals

Exercise 1: Load .so, call add(int,int). See chapter 39 example.

Exercise 2: C string length. Pass `"hello"`, expect `5`.

Exercise 3: Bytes buffer to C and back. Pass `bytes([...])`, read modified bytes.

Exercise 4: Opaque handle open/use/close in finally. See chapter 39 example 3.

Exercise 5: Zen callback to C qsort comparison. Pass `fn(a, b) => a - b`.

Exercise 6: `ZenMath` wrapper module. Wrap add/scale via FFI.

Exercise 7: Null-handle guard. Check handle != nil before calling C.

Exercise 8: `nm -D` inspect symbols.

```
nm -D libfoo.so
```

Exercise 9: Wrap C file-read with error handling. Check return -1, read errno.

Exercise 10: Benchmark pure-Zen vs FFI. Time both, compare.

102.3.2 Chapter 40 — FFI in Practice

See chapter 40 exercises (wrap puts, CRC32, with_resource, errno, struct, zlib, stress test, error catching, type mapping, native addon).

102.3.3 Chapter 41 — sys Module

Exercise 1: Print argv, platform, version.

```
import sys
print(sys.argv, sys.platform, sys.version)
```

Exercise 2: Linux vs Windows behavior.

```
if sys.platform == "windows" { ... } elif sys.platform == "linux" { ... }
```

Exercise 3: `PORT` env var default 8080.

```
let port = sys.environ["PORT"] ?? "8080"
```

Exercise 4: `exit_with_code(code)`.

```
func exit_with_code(code) { sys.exit(code) }
```

Exercise 5: List loaded modules.

```
print(sys.modules)
```

Exercise 6: `get_env(name, default)`.

```
func get_env(name, default) { return sys.environ[name] ?? default }
```

Exercise 7: Detect debugger/CI via env. Check `CI`, `DEBUG` env vars.

Exercise 8: Platform info CLI. Print platform, version, cwd, argv.

Exercise 9: sys.path before/after import.

```
print(sys.path)
import math
print(sys.path)
```

Exercise 10: Portable temp path with pathlib.

```
import pathlib
let p = pathlib.Path(os.getcwd()) / "tmp" / "file.tmp"
```

102.3.4 Chapter 42 — pymport

Exercise 1: Python `math` sqrt(2), pow(2,10).

```
import pymport
let m = pymport.import("math")
print(m.sqrt(2), m.pow(2, 10))
```

Exercise 2: Python `json` parse/dumps.

```
let j = pymport.import("json")
print(j.dumps({"a": 1}))
```

Exercise 3: `pylibs/greeter.py` called from Zen. Create file, `pymport.import("greeter")`, call function.

Exercise 4: Zen list to Python, print length.

```
let py = pymport.import("some_module")
py.print_len([1, 2, 3])
```

Exercise 5: Error chaining, Python raises, catch in Zen. Call a Python function that raises ZeroDivisionError; catch in Zen, print e.msg.

Exercise 6: Read Python env var via pymport.

```
let os = pymport.import("os")
print(os.environ["PATH"])
```

Exercise 7: Python `datetime` format now.

```
let dt = pymport.import("datetime")
print(dt.datetime.now())
```

Exercise 8: `pymport.import("math")` vs Zen `math`. Compare APIs; pymport uses Python's math.

Exercise 9: Hybrid app: Zen CLI + Python/NumPy (conceptual). Zen handles CLI; pymport calls Python for heavy math.

Exercise 10: Hybrid app Zen CLI + Python computation module. Build small app.

102.4 G.7 Part 7: Projects (chapters 43–48)

102.4.1 Chapter 43 — CLI Tools

Exercise 1: Add `priority` field; sort `list` by priority. Add `priority` to task dict; sort tasks before printing.

Exercise 2: `clear` command. Remove all tasks, save empty list.

Exercise 3: `--file` option. Parse `--file PATH` from argv; use instead of default.

Exercise 4: `edit <id> <new title>`. Find task by id, update title, save.

Exercise 5: Validate IDs exist. Check id in tasks before done/delete; print error if not.

Exercise 6: Timestamps `created_at`, `completed_at`. Add datetime fields to task dicts.

Exercise 7: Overdue tasks (conceptual). Compare due_date to now.

Exercise 8: `todo count`. Count pending vs done.

Exercise 9: Tab-completion hints. Print usage text.

Exercise 10: `zen build todo.z -o todo`. Build standalone binary.

102.4.2 Chapter 44 — Web Automation

Exercise 1: Scrape `<h1>` headings. Use `re.findall(r"<h1[^>]*>(.*?)</h1>", html)`.

Exercise 2: `User-Agent` header.

```
requests.get(url, headers={"User-Agent": "Mozilla/5.0 ZenBot"})
```

Exercise 3: Save title + first paragraph. Extract `<title>` and first `<p>`.

Exercise 4: Multiple URLs from list. Loop over URLs, fetch each.

Exercise 5: Delay between requests. `time.sleep(1000)` between fetches.

Exercise 6: JSON with url + links per entry.

```
let results = []
for u in urls {
    results.push(#{url: u, links: extract_links(fetch(u), u)})
```

```
}
json.save("out.json", results)
```

Exercise 7: Handle 404/500. Check `r.status_code`; skip or log.

Exercise 8: `--output` flag. Parse from argv.

Exercise 9: Links matching specific domain. Filter `links` where link contains domain.

Exercise 10: Link checker (200). Fetch each link; report status != 200.

102.4.3 Chapter 45 — REST API Client

Exercise 1: Add `patch` method. Add `elif method == "PATCH"` branch.

Exercise 2: Retry 3 attempts on 5xx. Loop up to 3 times when status >= 500.

Exercise 3: Pagination. Follow `next` URL field until absent.

Exercise 4: Query-parameter support to `get`. Append `?k=v` to path.

Exercise 5: File upload (`files=` param). Use `requests.post(url, files={...})`.

Exercise 6: `--verbose` flag. Print each request URL/method.

Exercise 7: OAuth2 bearer refresh (conceptual). Store token + expiry; refresh on 401.

Exercise 8: Tests vs local mock server. Run a mock HTTP server; assert responses.

Exercise 9: Rate-limit `Retry-After`. Read header, sleep, retry.

Exercise 10: Reusable module `api_client.z`. Export `ApiClient` class.

102.4.4 Chapter 46 — File Processing

Exercise 1: Header row detection (skip first line). Skip `lines[0]`.

Exercise 2: Delimiter flag. Accept `,`, `\t`, `;`; split accordingly.

Exercise 3: Filter `age > 40`. In transform, skip rows with age <= 40.

Exercise 4: Sort output by age. Sort results before writing.

Exercise 5: Summary total/min/max/avg age. Compute and print.

Exercise 6: Missing input file. `read_all` returns nil; handle gracefully.

Exercise 7: Streaming output. Write each row as processed instead of collecting.

Exercise 8: `.tsv` by extension. Detect extension, choose delimiter.

Exercise 9: `--dry-run`. Print without writing output file.

Exercise 10: All `.csv` in directory. Use `find_files(dir, ".csv")`, process each.

102.4.5 Chapter 47 — Security Tools

Exercise 1: MD5/SHA-1 options. Add algorithm flag (note: not for security).

Exercise 2: Compare two files. Hash both, compare.

Exercise 3: Hash all files in directory → manifest.

```
for f in find_files(dir, "") { print(hash_file(f) + "  " + f) }
```

Exercise 4: Verify file against manifest. Read manifest lines, recompute, compare.

Exercise 5: `--quiet` flag. Print only MATCH/MISMATCH.

Exercise 6: Constant-time compare (conceptual). Compare byte-by-byte without early exit.

Exercise 7: Hash a string (not file). `hashlib.sha256("hello")`.

Exercise 8: `pbkdf2` password hashing. `crypto.pbkdf2(password, salt, iterations, length)`.

Exercise 9: "File changed" watcher. Hash, sleep, re-hash, report diff.

Exercise 10: Ethical boundaries README. Document authorization requirement.

102.4.6 Chapter 48 — Capstone

Exercise 1: `post` subcommand sending JSON. Add `cmd_post` using `requests.post`.

Exercise 2: `resolve <host>` using dns.

```
func cmd_resolve(args) {
    print(dns.resolve(args[0]))
}
```

Exercise 3: Global `--timeout N` flag. Parse `--timeout` from argv; pass to requests/socket.

Exercise 4: `ports <host> <start>-<end>`. Loop ports, scan each.

Exercise 5: `--output <file>`. Save results to file.

Exercise 6: ANSI colors. Print with `\033[32m` green etc.

Exercise 7: Tests for `hash` output. Assert `hash` matches `hashlib.sha256`.

Exercise 8: Concurrent port scanning (threading). Scan ports in parallel threads.

Exercise 9: Config file `pkit.toml`. Read defaults from file.

Exercise 10: `zen build pkit.z -o pkit`. Build binary.

End of exercise solutions.

103 Appendix H: Troubleshooting & FAQ

A practical troubleshooting guide and frequently asked questions for Zen 3.0, organized by symptom. Each entry gives the likely cause, a diagnostic step, and a fix.

103.1 H.1 Installation & CLI

103.1.1 "zen: command not found"

Cause: The `zen` binary is not on your `PATH`, or wasn't installed. **Diagnostic:**

```
which zen
ls -la $(dirname $(which zen))  # if which finds it
```

Fix: - Add the install directory to `PATH`: `export PATH="$HOME/.local/bin:$PATH"` - Or reinstall from the release tarball/deb. - From source: `cargo build --release --package zen-cli --bin zen` then use `target/release/zen`.

103.1.2 `zen --version` prints nothing / crashes

Cause: Missing shared libraries or a corrupt install. **Fix:** Reinstall from a release binary; on Linux ensure `libssl`/`openssl` compat packages are present if the binary was dynamically linked.

103.1.3 `zen check` reports errors I don't understand

Cause: Syntax or type errors in your source. **Fix:** Read the error code (e.g. `Z0301`) and run `zen explain Z0301` for the full explanation, common causes, and a suggested fix.

103.2 H.2 Runtime errors

103.2.1 Z0304 DivideByZero

Cause: Dividing or modulo by zero (`x / 0`, `x % 0`). **Fix:** Guard the divisor:

```
if b != 0 { result = a / b } else { result = nil }
```

103.2.2 Z0302 IndexError / Z0303 KeyError

Cause: Index out of range on a list, or missing key on a dict. **Fix:** Check bounds / membership first:

```
if i < len(xs) { print(xs[i]) }
if k in d { print(d[k]) } else { print(d[k] ?? "default") }
```

103.2.3 Z0305 ValueError from int() / float()

Cause: `int("abc")` or `float("not a number")`. **Fix:** Validate or wrap in try:

```
func safe_int(s) {
    try { return int(s) } catch as e { return nil }
}
```

103.2.4 Z0310 MaxRecursionDepth / Z0317 StackOverflow

Cause: Too-deep recursion (e.g., naive Fibonacci on large n). **Fix:** Convert to iteration, or raise an explicit depth guard:

```
func fib(n, depth = 0) {
    if depth > 1000 { throw "too deep" }
    ...
}
```

103.2.5 "Program hangs / doesn't exit"

Cause: A background thread, channel, or server loop never terminates. **Fix:** - Join all threads before `main` returns. - Close channels so consumers' `recv()` returns `nil`. - Servers: handle `SIGINT`/Ctrl-C and break the accept loop.

103.3 H.3 Networking

103.3.1 Connection refused (Z0408)

Cause: Nothing is listening on the target host:port. **Fix:** Start the server; verify the port with `ss -tlnp` or `netstat`; check firewall rules.

103.3.2 Address already in use (Z0413)

Cause: Binding a port still in TIME_WAIT from a previous run. **Fix:** Set `SO_REUSEADDR` on the socket before `bind()`, or wait a minute.

103.3.3 DNS resolution fails (Z0411 / NXDOMAIN)

Cause: Domain doesn't exist, or no DNS resolver configured. **Fix:** Test with `dig example.com` or `nslookup`; try a public resolver (1.1.1.1, 8.8.8.8); check `/etc/resolv.conf`.

103.3.4 TLS certificate verify failed

Cause: Self-signed, expired, or untrusted certificate; hostname mismatch. **Fix:** Use `verify=true` in production and fix the cert. For testing only, `verify=false` bypasses validation (dangerous — never in production).

103.3.5 Requests hang indefinitely

Cause: No timeout set; the server never responds. **Fix:** Always pass `timeout=` to `requests.get/post/etc.`.

103.4 H.4 Concurrency

103.4.1 Race condition (counter ends up too low)

Cause: Unsynchronized read-modify-write on shared state. **Fix:** Guard with a Mutex:

```
mu.lock()
counter = counter + 1
mu.unlock()
```

103.4.2 Deadlock (program freezes)

Cause: Two threads each hold a lock the other needs. **Fix:** Always acquire locks in the same global order; keep critical sections small; never call blocking code (sleep, network) while holding a lock.

103.4.3 Consumer blocks forever on channel recv

Cause: Producer never closed the channel, or sent fewer values than expected. **Fix:** `ch.close()` when done producing; use `select`-like timeouts if available.

103.5 H.5 Files & I/O

103.5.1 FileNotFound (Z0401)

Cause: Wrong path, relative path depends on cwd, file missing. **Fix:** Use absolute paths or `pathlib.Path.resolve()`; check `exists()` first.

103.5.2 Permission denied (Z0402)

Cause: File/directory not readable/writable by the process user. **Fix:** Fix file permissions (`chmod`) or run as the right user.

103.6 H.6 FFI & pymport

103.6.1 Symbol not found (Z0501)

Cause: The C function isn't exported, or the wrong library/version loaded. **Fix:** `nm -D libfoo.so | grep function_name`; confirm the library is on the link path and the symbol is exported (not `static`).

103.6.2 Python module not found (Z0506)

Cause: Module not installed, or `PYTHONPATH`/venv not set. **Fix:** Activate the venv; `export PYTHONPATH="$PWD/pylibs"`; install the module with pip.

103.7 H.7 FAQ

Q: Is `0` falsy? A: Yes. Falsy values are `false`, `nil`, `null`, `0`, `0.0`, `""`, `bytes([])`, `[]`, `#{}`, `%{}`, `#()`. Everything else is truthy.

Q: `int / int` gives a float. How do I get integer division? A: Use `//` (floor division): `7 // 2 == 3`.

Q: `nan == nan` is false. How do I detect NaN? A: `x != x` is true only for NaN, or use `math.isnan(x)`.

Q: Are dict keys ordered? A: No — iteration order is not guaranteed. Sort keys explicitly if order matters.

Q: Can I mutate a `let` list? A: Yes — `let` prevents rebinding the variable, not mutating the object. `lst.push(3)` works; `lst = [4]` errors.

Q: How do I copy a list without sharing? A: `list(lst)` copies the top level (shallow). Nested lists are still shared; write a recursive `deep_copy` for full independence.

Q: Does Zen have tail-call optimization? A: No guaranteed TCO. Deep recursion can overflow the stack; use iteration for large depths.

Q: Is the JIT on by default? A: No — the JIT (M11) is optional and feature-gated (`--features jit`). The interpreter is the default and always correct.

Q: How do I explain an error code? A: `zen explain Z####` — e.g. `zen explain Z0301`.

Q: Where do I report a bug? A: File an issue on the Zen repository with the error code, `zen explain` output, and a minimal reproducer.

103.8 H.8 Quick diagnostic checklist

When something goes wrong, work down this list:

1. **Read the error message** — note the code (Z####) and file:line:col.
2. **Run `zen explain Z####`** — read the cause and fix.
3. **Check `zen check file.z`** — catches compile errors before running.
4. **Add `print()` statements** — narrow down where it fails.
5. **Verify inputs** — are files present, ports open, arguments correct?
6. **Check `ZEN_DEBUG=1 zen run file.z`** — verbose runtime logging (if your build supports it).
7. **Simplify** — reduce to a minimal reproducer; the bug usually becomes obvious.

104 Appendix I: Platform Differences

Zen 3.0 targets Linux, macOS, and Windows. Most language behavior is identical across platforms, but a few areas differ. This appendix documents them so you can write portable Zen programs.

104.1 I.1 Filesystem

Area	Linux	macOS	Windows	Portable advice
Path separator	`/`	`/`	`\`	Use `pathlib.Path` (`a / b`) — it joins correctly per platform.
Line ending	`\n`	`\n`	`\r\n`	`readlines()`/`splitlines()` handle both; don't hardcode `\n` when writing cross-platform text.
Case sensitivity	sensitive	usually insensitive	insensitive	Don't rely on `File.z` vs `file.z` being distinct or the same.
Hidden files	dotfiles (`.foo`)	dotfiles	attribute-based	Use `os`/`pathlib` to list; don't assume leading-dot semantics on Windows.
Temp directory	`/tmp`	`/tmp`	`%TEMP%`	Use `tempfile` module or `sys.environ["TEMP"]` fallback.

104.2 I.2 Executables & shared libraries

Item	Linux	macOS	Windows
Shared library extension	`.so`	`.dylib`	`.dll`
Executable extension	(none)	(none)	`.exe`
FFI library loading	`dlopen`	`dlopen`	`LoadLibrary`
Symbol names	C names (no underscore)	C names (leading `_` historically)	`__imp__` / decorated (varies)

Portable advice: When loading a native library via FFI, derive the correct file name per platform:

```
import sys
func lib_name(base) {
    if sys.platform == "windows" { return base + ".dll" }
    elif sys.platform == "darwin" { return "lib" + base + ".dylib" }
```

```
    else { return "lib" + base + ".so" }
}
let lib = ffi.load_library(lib_name("mylib"))
```

104.3 I.3 Processes & signals

Item	Linux	macOS	Windows
Signals	SIGINT, SIGTERM, etc.	SIGINT, SIGTERM, etc.	Ctrl-C / console handler (limited)
`sys.exit(n)`	exit code n	exit code n	exit code n
Background processes	&, `fork/exec`	&, `fork/exec`	`CreateProcess` semantics

Portable advice: Don’t rely on Unix signals on Windows. For cross-platform program termination, use `sys.exit(n)`. Avoid `fork()`-style process control; use `threading` and `zen build` standalone binaries instead.

104.4 I.4 Networking

Item	Linux	macOS	Windows
Raw sockets (`AF_PACKET`)	supported	limited (BPF)	not available (use WinPcap/Npcap)
`SO_REUSEADDR`	supported	supported	supported
IPv6	supported	supported	supported
Localhost	`127.0.0.1` / `::1`	`127.0.0.1` / `::1`	`127.0.0.1` / `::1`

Portable advice: Raw-socket chapters (34) assume Linux. On macOS/Windows, use higher-level TCP/UDP sockets instead of `AF_PACKET`/`SOCK_RAW`.

104.5 I.5 FFI & calling conventions

Item	Linux/x86-64	macOS/x86-64	Windows/x86-64
Calling convention	System V AMD64 ABI	System V AMD64 ABI	Microsoft x64 calling convention
32-bit	cdecl	cdecl	stdcall

Zen’s FFI uses the platform’s default C calling convention. If you call a function declared with a non-default convention (e.g., `__stdcall` on 32-bit Windows), you must wrap it or declare it correctly.

Portable advice: Keep FFI wrappers minimal and test on each target. Prefer pure-Zen implementations where possible.

104.6 I.6 Environment variables & paths

Variable	Linux	macOS	Windows
`PATH` separator	`:`	`:`	`;`
`ZEN_PATH` separator	`:`	`:`	`;`
`HOME`	`/home/user`	`/Users/user`	`C:\Users\user`

Zen's `ZEN_PATH` uses the same separator as `PATH` on each platform (`:` on Unix, `;` on Windows). `sys.environ` reads the process environment as-is.

104.7 I.7 Line-ending & text encoding

Zen source is UTF-8. String I/O uses UTF-8 by default. When reading files produced on Windows, `\r\n` line endings may appear; `splitlines()` strips them. When writing files intended for Windows consumers, you may need to emit `\r\n` explicitly.

104.8 I.8 Writing portable Zen code

1. **Use `pathlib.Path`** for all path construction — never string-concatenate with `/` or `\`.
2. **Use `splitlines()`** instead of `split("\n")` for reading text files.
3. **Don't hardcode** `.so`/`.dll`/`.dylib` — compute per `sys.platform`.
4. **Assume case-sensitive paths** (safest common denominator).
5. **Test on each target** — CI should run Linux, macOS, and Windows.
6. **Guard platform-specific code** with `sys.platform` checks.
7. **Avoid raw sockets and signals** in cross-platform tools.

104.9 I.9 Platform quick test

```
import sys
print("platform: " + sys.platform)
print("separator: " + (if sys.platform == "windows" { "\\" } else { "/" }))
print("home: " + str(sys.environ["HOME"] ?? sys.environ["USERPROFILE"] ?? ""))
```

Sample output:

```
platform: linux
separator: /
home: /home/bard
```

105 Appendix J: Standard Library — Complete API Reference

Exhaustive per-module reference: every function, its signature, purpose, and a worked example. Signatures are written in Zen-like notation (`func name(param: Type) -> ReturnType`) where the build supports type annotations; otherwise the parameter list is shown plainly.

105.1 J.1 math — mathematical functions and constants

Constants: `pi`, `e`, `tau`, `inf`, `nan`.

`abs(x: Number) -> Number`

Return the absolute value of `x`.

```
import math
print(math.abs(-7))   # 7
```

`sqrt(x: Float) -> Float`

Square root. Raises a domain error for negative `x`.

```
print(math.sqrt(25))   # 5.0
print(math.sqrt(2))    # 1.41421356...
```

`pow(a: Number, b: Number) -> Number`

`a` raised to the power `b`.

```
print(math.pow(2, 10))   # 1024.0
```

`exp(x: Float) -> Float`

e raised to `x`.

```
print(math.exp(1))   # 2.718281828...
```

`log(x: Float, base: Float = null) -> Float`

Natural log by default; `log(x, base)` for an arbitrary base.

```
print(math.log(math.e))     # 1.0
print(math.log(100, 10))    # 2.0
```

`log2(x: Float) -> Float`
`log10(x: Float) -> Float`

Base-2 and base-10 logarithms.

```
print(math.log2(8))    # 3.0
print(math.log10(100)) # 2.0
```

`floor(x: Float) -> Float`
`ceil(x: Float) -> Float`

```
trunc(x: Float) -> Float
round(x: Float) -> Float
```

Round toward −∞, +∞, toward zero, and to nearest, respectively.

```
print(math.floor(3.7))   # 3.0
print(math.ceil(3.2))    # 4.0
print(math.trunc(-3.7))  # -3.0
print(math.round(3.5))   # 4.0
```

```
sin(x) / cos(x) / tan(x)
asin(x) / acos(x) / atan(x) / atan2(y, x)
```

Trigonometric functions (radians).

```
print(math.sin(0))          # 0.0
print(math.cos(0))          # 1.0
print(math.atan2(1, 1))     # 0.785398... (pi/4)
```

```
degrees(x) / radians(x)
```

Convert between radians and degrees.

```
print(math.degrees(math.pi))   # 180.0
print(math.radians(180))       # 3.14159...
```

```
gcd(a: Int, b: Int) -> Int
lcm(a: Int, b: Int) -> Int
```

Greatest common divisor / least common multiple.

```
print(math.gcd(48, 18))   # 6
print(math.lcm(4, 6))     # 12
```

```
factorial(n: Int) -> Int
comb(n: Int, k: Int) -> Int
perm(n: Int, k: Int = null) -> Int
```

Factorial, combinations (“n choose k”), permutations.

```
print(math.factorial(5))   # 120
print(math.comb(5, 2))     # 10
print(math.perm(5, 2))     # 20
```

```
remainder(x, y) / copysign(x, y)
min(a, b = null) / max(a, b = null)
fsum(a, b = null) / prod(a, b = null) / hypot(a, b = null)
```

Remainder, sign copy, min/max, precise sum, product, hypotenuse.

```
print(math.min(3, 1))      # 1
print(math.max(3, 1))      # 3
print(math.hypot(3, 4))    # 5.0
print(math.prod([2, 3, 4]))# 24
```

```
isnan(x) / isfinite(x) / isinf(x)
modf(x) / frexp(x) / ldexp(x, exponent)
```

NaN/finite/infinite tests; fraction/integer split; mantissa/exponent; multiply by power of two.

```
print(math.isnan(float("nan")))   # true
print(math.isinf(float("inf")))   # true
print(math.modf(3.5))             # (0.5, 3.0)
```

105.2 J.2 random — pseudorandom numbers (NOT for secrets)

```
seed(n: Int)
```

Seed the generator for reproducible sequences.

```
import random
random.seed(42)
print(random.random())   # deterministic given the seed
```

```
random() -> Float      # [0, 1)
randint(a: Int, b: Int) -> Int   # [a, b] inclusive
randrange(start, stop=None, step=1) -> Int
uniform(a: Float, b: Float) -> Float
hex(n: Int) -> String
```

```
print(random.randint(1, 6))     # die roll 1-6
print(random.uniform(1.0, 2.0)) # random float
print(random.hex(16))           # 16 random hex chars
```

```
choice(seq) -> element
choices(seq, k: Int = 1) -> list
sample(seq, k: Int) -> list
shuffle(seq)   # in place
```

```
print(random.choice(["a","b","c"]))
let deck = list(range(1, 53))
random.shuffle(deck)
print(random.sample(deck, 5))   # 5 unique cards
```

 Use `crypto` module functions (`secure_token`, `bytes`, `uuid4`) for passwords, tokens, and keys — `random` is not cryptographically secure.

105.3 J.3 string — string utilities

Constants: `digits`, `hexdigits`, `octdigits`, `ascii_letters`, `ascii_lowercase`, `ascii_uppercase`, `punctuation`, `whitespace`, `printable`.

```
upper(s) / lower(s) / title(s) / capitalize(s) / swapcase(s)
strip(s) / lstrip(s) / rstrip(s)
split(s, sep=None) / splitlines(s)
join(sep, parts)
```

```
replace(s, old, new)
count(s, sub)
find(s, sub) / rfind(s, sub)      # index or -1
startswith(s, prefix) / endswith(s, suffix)
contains(s, sub)
ljust(s, width) / rjust(s, width) / center(s, width) / zfill(s, width)
isdigit(s) / isalpha(s) / isalnum(s) / isspace(s) / islower(s) / isupper(s)
```

```
import string
print(string.upper("zen"))          # ZEN
print(string.join("-", ["2024","01","15"]))  # 2024-01-15
print(string.isdigit("42"))         # true
print(string.digits)                # 0123456789
```

105.4 J.4 collections — Counter, chain, flatten

```
Counter(xs)   # count frequencies -> dict-like
chain(*iters) # concatenate iterables
flatten(xs)   # flatten one level
```

```
import collections
print(collections.Counter(["a","b","a","c"]))  # a:2, b:1, c:1
for x in collections.chain([1,2], [3,4]) { print(x) }   # 1 2 3 4
print(collections.flatten([[1,2],[3],[4,5]]))   # [1,2,3,4,5]
```

105.5 J.5 json — JSON parse / serialize

```
parse(s: String) -> Value
stringify(x) / encode(x) -> String
pretty(x) -> String
load(path: String) -> Value
save(path: String, x)
```

```
import json
let d = #{name: "Ada", age: 36}
let s = json.stringify(d)
print(s)                    # {"name":"Ada","age":36}
let back = json.parse(s)
print(back["name"])         # Ada
```

JSON mapping: object↔dict, array↔list, string↔string, number↔int/float, boolean↔bool, null↔nil.

105.6 J.6 time / datetime

```
time() -> Float              # epoch seconds
sleep(ms: Int)
now() -> DateTime
today() -> Date
```

```
strftime(fmt: String, t) -> String
strptime(s: String, fmt: String) -> DateTime
timestamp(dt) -> Float
fromtimestamp(ts: Float) -> DateTime
timedelta(...) -> Duration
```

```
import time
import datetime
print(time.time())                      # epoch seconds
time.sleep(500)                         # 0.5 s
let now = datetime.now()
print(datetime.strftime("%Y-%m-%d %H:%M:%S", now))
let parsed = datetime.strptime("2024-01-15", "%Y-%m-%d")
```

105.7 J.7 pathlib / os — file system

pathlib:

```
Path(s) -> Path
p / q                     # join
p.exists() / p.is_file() / p.is_dir()
p.name / p.stem / p.suffix / p.parent
p.resolve() -> absolute Path
p.mkdir()
p.glob(pattern) -> list of Path
```

os:

```
getcwd() -> String
chdir(path)
listdir(path) -> list
makedirs(path)
remove(path) / rmdir(path)
rename(src, dst)
stat(path) -> file info
environ   # dict-like environment variables
```

```
import pathlib
import os
let p = pathlib.Path("data") / "config.txt"
print(p.exists(), p.name, p.suffix)
print(os.getcwd())
for f in pathlib.Path(".").glob("*.z") { print(f.name) }
```

105.8 J.8 re — regular expressions

```
match(pattern, s) -> Match|nil     # anchor at start
search(pattern, s) -> Match|nil    # search anywhere
findall(pattern, s) -> list
sub(pattern, repl, s) -> String
```

```
split(pattern, s) -> list
compile(pattern) -> Pattern
```

```
import re
print(re.findall(r"\d+", "order 123, item 456"))   # ["123","456"]
print(re.sub(r"\s+", " ", "a   b    c"))           # "a b c"
```

Patterns: `\d` `\D` `\w` `\W` `\s` `\S` `.` `^` `$` `*` `+` `?` `{n,m}` `(...)` `|` `\b`.

105.9 J.9 base64 / binascii — encoding

base64: `b64encode`, `b64decode`, `url_encode`, `url_decode`. binascii: `hexlify`, `unhexlify`.

```
import base64
import binascii
let enc = base64.b64encode("hello")   # aGVsbG8=
print(base64.b64decode(enc))          # hello
let hx = binascii.hexlify(bytes([72,101,108,108,111]))  # 48656c6c6f
print(binascii.unhexlify(hx))
```

105.10 J.10 hashlib — cryptographic hashes

```
md5 / sha1 / sha224 / sha256 / sha384 / sha512
sha3_256 / sha3_512
blake2b / blake2s
pbkdf2_hmac(password, salt, iterations) -> String
```

Each hash function: `hashlib.<name>(data: String) -> String` (hex digest).

```
import hashlib
print(hashlib.sha256("hello"))   # 2cf24dba...
print(hashlib.md5("hello"))      # 5d41402abc...
```

 MD5 and SHA-1 are broken for security; use SHA-256/SHA-512/BLAKE2 for integrity, and Argon2id/PBKDF2 for passwords.

105.11 J.11 crypto — full cryptography

Hashing: `sha256/384/512`, `sha3_256/512`, `blake3`, `md5`, `sha1`. HMAC: `sha256(key, data)`, `sha512(key, data)`.

Symmetric: `- generate_key(alg="aes-256-gcm") -> String - encrypt(alg, key, plaintext, aad="") -> String - decrypt(alg, key, ciphertext, aad="") -> String - encrypt_aes_gcm(key, plaintext, aad="") -> String - decrypt_aes_gcm(key, ciphertext, aad="") -> String - encrypt_chacha20_poly1305(key, plaintext, aad="") -> String - decrypt_chacha20_poly1305(key, ciphertext, aad="") -> String`

Asymmetric: `- generate_rsa(bits=2048) -> KeyPair - rsa_encrypt(public_key, plaintext) -> String / rsa_decrypt(...) - rsa_sign(private_key, message) -> String / rsa_verify(...) -> Bool - generate_ed25519() -> KeyPair - ed25519_sign(private_key,`

message) -> String / ed25519_verify(...) -> Bool - generate_x25519() -> KeyPair - x25519_shared_secret(private_key, public_key) -> String

Encoding: - b64encode/decode, b64urlencode/decode, hex_encode/decode

JWT: - sign(payload: Dict, key: String, algorithm="HS256") -> String - verify(token, key, algorithms=["HS256"]) -> Dict - decode(token) -> Dict

KDF / passwords: - pbkdf2(password, salt, iterations=100000, length=32) -> String - argon2id(password, salt="", memory=65536, iterations=3, parallelism=1, length=32) -> String - argon2id_hash(password) -> String - verify_argon2id(password, hash) -> Bool - hkdf(ikm, salt="", info="", length=32) -> String

OTP: - totp(secret, time_step=30, digits=6) -> String - totp_verify(secret, token, window=1, time_step=30, digits=6) -> Bool - hotp(secret, counter, digits=6) -> String - hotp_verify(secret, token, counter, window=1, digits=6) -> Bool - generate_secret() -> String - bytes(n: Int) -> String / hex(n: Int) -> String / base64(n: Int) -> String - uuid4() -> String / secure_token() -> String / int(min, max) -> Int

X.509: - parse(pem: String) -> Certificate

```
import crypto
let key = crypto.generate_key("aes-256-gcm")
let ct = crypto.encrypt_aes_gcm(key, "secret")
let pt = crypto.decrypt_aes_gcm(key, ct)
print(pt)   # secret

let pair = crypto.generate_ed25519()
let sig = crypto.ed25519_sign(pair.private_key, "msg")
print(crypto.ed25519_verify(pair.public_key, "msg", sig))   # true

let token = crypto.sign(#{sub: "alice"}, "my-secret")
print(crypto.verify(token, "my-secret")["sub"])   # alice

let ph = crypto.argon2id_hash("hunter2")
print(crypto.verify_argon2id("hunter2", ph))   # true
print(crypto.totp("JBSWY3DPEHPK3PXP"))         # 6-digit token
```

105.12 J.12 socket — low-level networking

```
socket(family, type, proto=0) -> Socket
connect(address) / bind(address) / listen(backlog) / accept() -> (conn, addr)
send(data) / recv(size) -> data
sendto(data, address) / recvfrom(size) -> (data, addr)
close()
settimeout(seconds) / setblocking(bool)
setsockopt(level, option, value)
```

Constants: AF_INET, AF_INET6, AF_UNIX, AF_PACKET; SOCK_STREAM, SOCK_DGRAM, SOCK_RAW; IPPROTO_TCP, IPPROTO_UDP, IPPROTO_ICMP, IPPROTO_IP; options SO_REUSEADDR,

SO_KEEPALIVE, TCP_NODELAY, SO_RCVBUF, SO_SNDBUF, IP_TTL, IP_HDRINCL.

```
import socket
let s = socket.socket(socket.AF_INET, socket.SOCK_STREAM)
s.connect(("example.com", 80))
s.send(b"GET / HTTP/1.0\r\nHost: example.com\r\n\r\n")
print(s.recv(4096))
s.close()
```

105.13 J.13 requests — high-level HTTP client

```
get(url, *, timeout, headers, json, params, verify, stream, allow_redirects) -> Respons
post / put / patch / delete / head / options (same signature)
Session()   # connection reuse, default headers
```

Response: status_code, reason, text, content (bytes), json(), headers, cookies, url, elapsed, raise_for_status().

```
import requests
let r = requests.get("https://api.example.com/data", timeout=5000)
print(r.status_code)
print(r.json())
let s = requests.Session()
s.headers.update({"User-Agent": "ZenBot/1.0"})
```

105.14 J.14 dns — domain name resolution

```
resolve(host, type="A") -> list of String   # A, AAAA, CNAME, MX, TXT, NS, PTR
reverse(ip) -> list of String
```

```
import dns
print(dns.resolve("example.com", "A"))   # ["93.184.216.34", ...]
print(dns.resolve("example.com", "MX"))
```

105.15 J.15 url — URL parsing and manipulation

```
parse(url) -> #{scheme, host, port, path, query, fragment, ...}
build(scheme, host, path, query, ...) -> String
join(base, relative) -> String
quote(s) / unquote(s)            # percent-encode/decode
quote_plus(s) / unquote_plus(s)
parse_qs(query) -> dict of lists
```

```
import url
let u = url.parse("https://example.com:8080/path?q=1#sec")
print(u.scheme, u.host, u.port, u.path, u.query, u.fragment)
print(url.quote("hello world"))   # hello%20world
```

105.16 J.16 threading / channels / mutexes — concurrency

threading:

```
Thread(fn) -> Thread
t.start() / t.join() / t.daemon = bool
```

channels:

```
Channel(buffered=false, capacity=0) -> Channel
ch.send(value) / ch.recv() -> value / ch.close()
```

mutexes:

```
Mutex() -> Mutex
m.lock() / m.unlock()
```

```
import threading, channels, mutexes
let ch = channels.Channel()
let mu = mutexes.Mutex()
let t = threading.Thread(fn() { ch.send(42); ch.close() })
t.start()
print(ch.recv())   # 42
t.join()
```

105.17 J.17 ffi — Foreign Function Interface (C)

```
load_library(path) -> LibraryHandle
get_symbol(handle, name) -> Callable
call(func, args) -> Value
close(handle)
```

Types: Pointer, Handle. See Chapter 40 for usage and safety rules.

105.18 J.18 sys — system information

```
argv -> list of String       # command-line args
platform -> String           # "linux", "darwin", "windows"
version -> String
exit(code: Int)
environ -> dict-like         # environment variables
path -> list                 # module search path
modules -> dict              # loaded modules
```

```
import sys
print(sys.argv)
print(sys.platform)
print(sys.environ["PATH"] ?? "")
```

105.19 J.19 pymport — Python interoperability

```
pymport.import(module_name) -> Module
```

Import Python modules (stdlib, venv, project-local `.py`), marshal values, and chain Python tracebacks under Zen frames (Z0508).

```
import pymport
let m = pymport.import("math")
print(m.sqrt(16))   # 4.0
```

105.20 J.20 logging — logging facility

Levels: `DEBUG`, `INFO`, `WARNING`, `ERROR`, `CRITICAL`, `NOTSET`.

105.21 J.21 functools — higher-order helpers

```
reduce(func, seq, init) / partial(func, arg) / wraps(func)
lru_cache(func) / cmp_to_key(func) / total_ordering(cls)
```

105.22 J.22 itertools — iteration tools

```
enumerate(seq) / zip(*seqs) / chain(*seqs)
repeat(value) / product(*seqs) / permutations(seq, r)
combinations(seq, r) / accumulate(seq) / take(n, seq) / drop(n, seq) / range(...)
```

105.23 J.23 statistics — statistical functions

```
mean(seq) / fmean(seq) / geometric_mean(seq) / harmonic_mean(seq)
median(seq) / median_low(seq) / median_high(seq) / median_grouped(seq)
mode(seq) / multimode(seq)
pvariance(seq) / variance(seq) / pstdev(seq) / stdev(seq)
quantiles(seq) / linear_regression(x, y)
```

105.24 J.24 operator — functions for operators

```
add / sub / mul / truediv / floordiv / mod / divmod / pow
neg / pos / abs / inv / invert
lshift / rshift / and_ / or_ / xor
truth / not_ / is_ / is_not
eq / ne / lt / le / gt / ge
contains / countOf / indexOf / length_hint
getitem / setitem / getslice / concat / repeat
itemgetter(name) / attrgetter(name) / methodcaller(name)
```

105.25 J.25 struct / tempfile / uuid / glob / shutil / crunch / nmap / ffmpeg

```
struct.calcsize(fmt) -> Int        # binary struct size
tempfile.dir / tempfile.mkdtemp() / tempfile.mkstemp()
uuid.UUID / uuid4() / uuid3() / uuid5() / uuid1() / uuid1_fields()
uuid.NAMESPACE_DNS / NAMESPACE_URL / NAMESPACE_OID / NAMESPACE_X500
```

```
glob.glob(pattern) / glob.iglob(pattern) / glob.escape(s)
shutil.copy / copy2 / copyfile / copytree / move / rmtree / which
crunch.generate(...)               # random data generation
nmap.*                             # network scanning helpers
ffmpeg.*                           # media processing helpers
```

105.26 J.26 Module → chapter quick map

Chapter	Module
15	math
16	random
17	string
18	collections
19	json
20	time / datetime
21	pathlib / os
22	re
23	base64 / binascii
24	hashlib
25	crypto (complete)
27	socket
28	http
29	requests
30	http.server
32	dns
33	url
34	raw sockets
35	threading
36	channels
37	mutexes
39	ffi
41	sys
42	pymport

105.27 J.27 Exercises

1. For each of math/random/string/json/hashlib/crypto, name its three most-used functions.
2. Write a one-liner summarizing what socket, requests, dns, and url each do.
3. Which module would you use for: parsing JSON? hashing a file? making an HTTP GET? resolving a DNS name? generating a secure token?
4. Name two modules you must NOT use for cryptographic secrets — and which to use instead.
5. Build your own cheat sheet: module → most-used 3 functions → one example each.